



Merton Local Plan 2024 – 2037/38

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Chapter 01a. **Introduction**

Introduction

- 1.1.1. The London Borough of Merton Local Plan was formally adopted on the 20th of November 2024. It forms part of the development plan and is the statutory planning framework for the borough. Merton's statutory development plan comprises of the following documents with the:
- This Local Plan 2024-2037/38
 - [London Plan 2021](#)
 - [South London Waste Plan 2022 -2037](#)
 - [Estates Local Plan \(2018\)](#).
- 1.1.2. The initial draft of the Local Plan was [submitted](#) to the Secretary of State on the 2nd of December 2021 and was subject to an Examination in Public (EiP). The EiP Hearing sessions were held in public in June and October 2022, conducted by independent Planning Inspectors appointed by the Secretary of State. In October 2024 the council received the Inspectors' Report which found it to be in legally compliance and sound.

Our Local Plan

- 1.1.3. The Local Plan sets out the council's planning policy framework for the borough. It sets out the level of growth which needs to be planned for in Merton and identifies where that growth will be located and how it will be delivered. The policies set out in the plan will be used to determine planning applications in the borough.
- 1.1.4. The Local Plan must be read as a whole. The placement of chapters is no reflection on their importance or weight – it does not stand for a hierarchy.
- 1.1.5. The role of the Local Plan is to guide decision-making on planning applications and inform investment in social and physical infrastructure. The Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 requires that, *"for the purpose of making any determination under the Planning Acts, the determination must be made in accordance with the plan unless material considerations indicate otherwise"*.
- 1.1.6. This adopted Local Plan replaces the following planning documents:
- Core Planning Strategy 2011
 - Site and Policies Plan 2014
 - Policies Map 2014
- 1.1.7. The [NPPF](#) sets out the planning policies for England and how they will be applied. It provides a framework within which, local plans are prepared addressing housing needs, climate change, green and blue infrastructure and other environmental, economic and social priorities.

- 1.1.8. The NPPF must be considered in preparing the development plan; it is also a material consideration in planning decisions, although the weight attributed to the NPPF will depend on the details of each application. The national [Planning Practice Guidance \(PPG\)](#) provides further detail on policies in the NPPF.
- 1.1.9. The [London Plan](#) is the Spatial Development Strategy for Greater London and is part of the statutory development plan for all London boroughs. It sets out a policy framework covering several topics areas for example affordable housing delivery, climate change mitigation and adaption, employment and sustainable business growth. It is part of Merton's Development Plan, meaning it must be taken into account in the determination of planning applications. For plan-making, it provides the strategic, London-wide policy context for all London boroughs development documents including Local Plans, which must be '*in general conformity*' with the London Plan.

Setting the scene

- 1.1.10. The Local Plan has been informed by the following engagement and public consultations with our residents, businesses and key stakeholders:
- A "call for sites" (Stage 1) public consultation between October 2017 to January 2018.
 - Draft Local Plan Stage 2) public consultation between October 2018 to January 2019.
 - A Stage 2a draft Local Plan public consultation between November 2020 to February 2021.
 - A Stage 3 (Regulation 19) draft Local Plan public consultation between July 2021 to September 2021.
 - Post Hearing public consultation between January- February 2024.
 - Further Main Modification public consultation between July to August 2024.
- 1.1.11. Where possible, we have sought to reflect the full range of opinions and feedback we received but, it is not always possible to identify a single approach with which everyone will agree and would be found 'sound' and compliant with various statutory requirements set out in planning legislation.
- 1.1.12. The Local Plan is informed by an extensive evidence base, both technical and non-technical. This evidence has informed and influence the Local Plan direction and policies.
- 1.1.13. The Local Plan contains:
- **Strategic Objectives:** guided by consultation feedback, Merton's corporate plans, and the London Plan.
 - **Strategic policies:** are borough-wide policies, which set out Merton Council's strategy to work with local people, businesses and key stakeholders to improve neighbourhoods and create new opportunities for our communities and businesses.
 - **Development policies:** gives further detail that is needed to deliver the strategic policies.

- **Site allocations:** Site allocations set out land use requirements for sites that will contribute to the borough's growth.
- **Policies Map:** shows land uses and designations for example open space, site allocations where, specific planning policies are applied.

1.1.14. Merton Council produces an [Authority Monitoring Report \(AMR\)](#) every year that examines the performance of the planning policies.

Ensuring equality

1.1.15. Equalities, Diversity and Inclusion Assessments were carried out in accordance with the Equality Act 2010. It examined the impact of the Local Plan on the [nine protected Characteristics](#), to identify and combat discrimination and other conduct prohibited by the [Equality Act 2010](#).

Environmental, social, economic and quality of life considerations

- 1.1.16. The role of a [Sustainability Appraisal](#) is to promote sustainable development by integrating *social, economic, and environmental* considerations into the preparation of new or revised plans and strategies.
- 1.1.17. The [Strategic Environmental Assessment](#) considers the '*likely significant*' effects on the environment, including short-, medium- and long-term effects, permanent and temporary effects and cumulative effects, on for example, biodiversity, human health, flora and fauna.
- 1.1.18. [Habitat Regulation Assessment](#) is a process that decides whether the Local Plan could negatively effect on, recognised protected National Sites Network.
- 1.1.19. A Health Impact Assessment is a process to assess the effects of the Local Plan relating to health (including mental health) and wellbeing. The council's Health in All Policies approach is embedded throughout the Local Plan reinforcing the council commitment to reduce health inequalities and help in improve physical and mental health outcomes in Merton.
- 1.1.20. The council carried out all of these assessments in accordance with their respective legislation to inform the Local Plan as it developed.
- 1.1.21. Merton's Local Plan and Policies Map is available via Merton's website: www.merton.gov.uk/newlocalplan
- 1.1.22. The Policies Map is available online via the above website or directly via www.merton.gov.uk/policies-map

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Chapter 01b. **Good growth strategy**

Good Growth

- 1.2.1. The London Plan seeks to promote 'Good Growth' in London by building strong inclusive communities, making the best use of land, creating a healthy city, building more homes and affordable housing to address the housing crisis, growing and maintaining a strong economy, increasing efficiency and resilience by moving towards a net-zero carbon city by 2050 and adapting to the impacts of climate change.
- 1.2.2. Dealing with such a level of growth is undoubtedly a huge challenge, putting pressure on land, housing, infrastructure and the environment. It also comes as we are facing other unprecedented challenges: Brexit, Coronavirus (COVID-19), its impact and recovery, air pollution, climate change and entrenched inequality.
- 1.2.3. Merton's future growth must be planned in a sustainable way in accordance with the London Plan Good Growth principles. This includes:
- a. maintaining a good balance between economic, social and environmental objectives,
 - b. Creating liveable attractive and safe places for people to live, study, work and visit,
 - c. Delivering our ambition of becoming a net-zero carbon borough by 2050, creating resilient and adaptive environments, in response to the climate emergency for the benefit of all in Merton.
- 1.2.4. Future growth also means planning for and supporting predicted population growth, increased demands for affordable homes, the COVID-19 pandemic recovery and job creation. Delivering development which meets the current needs without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.
- 1.2.5. It is imperative that future growth in Merton must be **socially** and **economically inclusive** and **environmentally sustainable** and contribute to the London Plan Good Growth objectives:
- GG1 Building strong and inclusive communities.
 - GG2 Making the best use of land.
 - GG3 Creating a healthy city.
 - GG4 Delivering the homes Londoners need.
 - GG5 Growing a good economy.
 - GG6 Increasing efficiency and resilience.

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and London

- 1.2.6. [The UN Sustainable Development Goals \(SDGs\)](#) set ambitious targets to create transformative *social, economic and environmental* improvements by 2030. They provide an

integrated framework covering a comprehensive range of issues – jobs, housing, inequalities, healthcare, the environment and more, supported by targets and performance indicators. The SDGs were agreed unanimously in 2015 by the UN's 193 member states, including the United Kingdom (UK), within 'Agenda 2030' – a landmark UN Resolution on achieving sustainable development. The London Sustainable Development Commission (LSDC) was established in 2002 to provide independent advice to the Mayor of London on ways to make London a sustainable, world-class city.



- 1.2.7. [In March 2021, the London Sustainable Development Commission](#) published a progress report on how far London has come in meeting the SDGs. We will continue to work with and support the London Sustainable Development Commission in achieving the SDGs. According to the UK Government, 65% of the SDGs rely on local level implementation. For the first time, the impacts and opportunities of cities and towns have been recognised in the SDGs by countries and the United Nations. This has resulted in a global goal entirely dedicated to urban areas in the form of SDG (Sustainable Development Goals) 11: Sustainable Cities and Communities.
- 1.2.8. As acknowledged by the Royal Town Planning Institute (RTPI), planning has a key role to play in the successful implementation of the SDGs because of the profession's aim to work in the wider public interest and the overall purpose of the UK planning systems to achieve sustainable development. The goals provide an opportunity to strengthen commitment to plan for sustainable development. Merton will continue to work with the Mayor of London and partners in achieving the SDGs for London.

Growth in Merton

- 1.2.9. All growth in Merton is expected to be **socially** and **economically inclusive** and **environmentally sustainable** and contribute to the London Plan Good Growth objectives.
- 1.2.10. The effects of growth will be considered, ensuring that any significant impact is avoided, or

necessary mitigation measures employed. Delivering high quality, sustainable and resilient places through good design and effective master planning and/or Neighbourhood Plans will be essential for future growth in Merton.

Stakeholders and partner organisations

- 1.2.11. Responsibility for the successful implementation of the policies and delivering growth in Merton falls not only upon the council in its role as Local Planning Authority but also upon our partners and other stakeholders, including neighbouring boroughs, the Greater London Authority (GLA) and other public and private sector organisations, especially on strategic matters. We will work with community groups and organisations across Merton's diverse communities including resident and business associations, neighbourhood forums, cultural organisations, disability groups, faith groups, children, young people, and the veteran community at Haigh Homes, to deliver growth as well as healthy and sustainable neighbourhoods.
- 1.2.12. Landowners and developers will be important partners in the regeneration and growth of the borough. Much of the land in the growth areas is held by private landowners and their commitment and active involvement is needed for growth in the borough. We will continue to engage with landowners to support the delivery of this Local Plan.
- 1.2.13. We will consider joint development schemes with private landowners or developers holding adjacent or nearby sites which could involve joint ventures to deliver new homes, community uses and business spaces.
- 1.2.14. Merton Council's pro-active planning approach to delivering sustainable growth will be supported by several planning documents and detailed guidance, where appropriate, for example:
 - a. Local Plan documents
 - b. Supplementary Planning documents (SPDs)
 - c. Opportunity Area Planning Frameworks (OAPFs) and Development Briefs
- 1.2.15. More detail on planning frameworks can be found in the relevant sections of the Local Plan and more detail on the schedule can be found within Merton's [Local Development Scheme](#).

Coronavirus pandemic (COVID-19)

- 1.2.16. Growth will need to positively contribute to Merton's COVID-19 recovery. The pandemic has accelerated changes in shopping habits, provision for homes especially affordable, jobs and training and behavioural changes in lifestyles and travel. Therefore, it is important that

recovery and growth are sustainable, and do not simply rebuild existing systems that drive inequalities or harm our environment.

- 1.2.17. Our health inequality gap is growing; this trend was known before COVID-19. However, the pandemic has increased it and highlighted the issues across the UK. Residents suffering from poor health in Merton tend to be concentrated in our most deprived wards (Abbey, Colliers Wood, Cricket Green, Graveney, Lavender Fields, Longthornton, Lower Morden, Pollards Hill, Ravensbury and St Helier) mainly in the east. Addressing these inequalities and improving Merton's health and wellbeing, both physical and mental, goes beyond improving access to medical facilities and includes a range of measures to improve our social and physical environment.

Climate change

- 1.2.18. We must face up to the reality of the climate emergency and the need to limit Merton's contribution to this major global problem. Tackling climate change and its consequences is one of the priorities for the Local Plan. The challenge for planning is providing much needed homes and jobs in a way that does not have a detrimental impact on our climate and environment.
- 1.2.19. Merton is already experiencing the impacts of climate change with an increase in the frequency and severity of extreme weather events including extended periods of hot weather and drought, and extreme rainfall and flooding events. Climate change already affects the way we do things and will continue to do so as the scale of global warming increases. New developments will therefore need to prioritise sustainable design and construction to mitigate and adapt to the impacts of climate change, with energy efficiency, low carbon energy generation, and climate resilience on an equal footing with aesthetic appeal. Ensuring developments are energy efficient and adaptable to the impacts of climate change, making them cheaper to run and more comfortable to be in, will benefit everyone, especially people with lower incomes and in deprived areas.
- 1.2.20. The move away from petrol and diesel cars towards greener alternatives needs to be made easier with more electric vehicle charging points, dockless bikes/scooter hire, cycle parking and facilities in and around our town centres and surrounding areas. The transition to more sustainable modes of travel will help improve our air quality, considerably reduce noise pollution, and improve the health and wellbeing of people who live and work in Merton and visit the borough.
- 1.2.21. Delivering growth means prioritising climate change in all planning decisions. Several Local Plan policies both directly and indirectly address climate change mitigation and adaptation, including our climate change, flooding, air quality, design, green infrastructure, health and wellbeing and transport policies. These policies are supported by a number of strategies

including Merton's [Climate Strategy and Action Plan \(2020\)](#), [Green Infrastructure Study \(2020\)](#), [Air Quality Action Plan 2018](#) and [Strategic Flood Risk Assessment 2021](#)

Healthier and greener environments

- 1.2.22. Making Merton a healthier and greener borough, as well as a fairer one, is important. It is why health inequalities cannot be seen in isolation. Growth in Merton will need to addressing inequalities both in income and health.
- 1.2.23. Making walking and cycling the default choice of travel is essential. Making it easier and safer is important for both physical and mental health but it also contributes to the local economy, relieves stress on the National Health Service (NHS) and helps to tackle climate change.
- 1.2.24. Merton's green infrastructure and heritage assets not only provide recreational opportunities and improve mental health but also contribute to the character and attractiveness of Merton. The creation of a network of green spaces and other green infrastructure such as street trees provide multiple benefits for biodiversity, nature, recreation, climate change resilience and health and wellbeing. Protecting and enhancing our green infrastructure will help our residents to lead healthier, more active lives and provide access to nature which is good for mental health.
- 1.2.25. Our heritage assets and historic environment are irreplaceable and an essential part of what makes Merton a vibrant borough and their effective management is a fundamental. The historic environment, represented in its built form, landscape heritage and archaeology, provides a depth of character that benefits the local economy, culture and our quality of life.
- 1.2.26. Design must consider safety and security, layout and orientation, public realm, social inclusion and environmental health impacts such as noise and air quality to ensure we are creating healthy neighbourhoods, which are accessible for all. The potential harmful effects to human health such as loss of daylight and sunlight, loss of privacy, loss of outlook, overcrowding, isolation, exposure to odours, noise and vibration and appropriate ventilation must be considered in design.
- 1.2.27. All development, be it housing, commercial or infrastructure, must be designed and delivered in a way that contributes to nature and our heritage assets, not their decline.
- 1.2.28. Delivering growth means prioritising health and wellbeing in all planning decisions, including through design that supports health outcomes, and the assessment and mitigation of any potential adverse impacts of development proposals on health and health inequality.
- 1.2.29. Healthy and green approaches are embedded into a number of Local Plan policies both directly and indirectly for example, design, health and wellbeing, transport and green and blue infrastructure policies. This is supported by a number of Merton's strategies for example:

[Green Infrastructure Study \(2020\)](#), [Joint Strategic Needs Assessment](#) and [Borough Character Study \(2021\)](#).

- 1.2.30. The Mayor will be developing a London-wide Heritage Strategy, together with Historic England and other partners, to support the capital's heritage and the delivery of heritage-led growth. Merton Council supports a London-wide Heritage Strategy and we will work with the Mayor and communities in developing the strategy.

More homes and jobs

- 1.2.31. The growth in population and jobs has not been matched by the growth in the number and type of homes Merton needs. The cost of renting and house prices have risen to levels that have priced many out of the market. Merton's expected growth and development is shaped by the decisions that are made by Merton's planning committee and planners. Every individual decision to provide affordable housing helps to make the housing market fairer, reducing overcrowding and homelessness. Securing more homes is a priority, especially genuinely affordable homes which meet the actual needs of our diverse communities.
- 1.2.32. Before the pandemic a large portion of residents travelled out of the borough to work. The pandemic has changed our work patterns and trends. However, after the nationwide lockdowns people are now travelling out of borough to work again, although not at pre-pandemic levels. Alongside this it is important that Merton residents, particularly those from disadvantaged backgrounds, fully benefit from the diverse range of opportunities economic growth brings. Removing barriers to local employment and training can improve residents' life chances and help support local business growth.
- 1.2.33. We will therefore use the opportunities offered by new development, in both the construction and operational phases, to improve residents' access to skills, training and employment. This will include seeking financial contributions towards employment, education and skills initiatives, and on larger schemes, requiring apprenticeships and job placements in accordance with targets set out in an agreed Employment and Skills Plan. Securing job placements within the end use of a development, rather than solely in the construction phase, will be important to ensure residents fully benefit in the long term from the diverse opportunities economic growth brings.
- 1.2.34. Delivering growth means setting the conditions to deliver more homes, supporting businesses, providing opportunities for more jobs, employment and training. A number of Local Plan policies deliver this both directly and indirectly; for example, housing, economy, design, health and wellbeing and transport. This is supported by a number of Merton's strategies such as Merton's [Green Infrastructure Study \(2020\)](#), [Joint Strategic Needs Assessment](#), and Merton's [Housing Delivery Study 2021](#).

Supporting infrastructure

- 1.2.35. Ensuring we have the infrastructure and services to meet the needs of our growing and aging population is important, such as transport, utilities, broadband, education and health. Delivering growth means ensuring we have the right infrastructure to meet our needs for now and in the future. Careful planning together with our partners and stakeholders is key to ensuring Merton is more resilient and prepared for future needs and demands.
- 1.2.36. The right infrastructure is also needed to help businesses succeed, grow and remain in Merton. The digital economy, underpinned by world-class digital connectivity, data and digital services is of ever-increasing importance, improving processes, opening new markets and allowing more flexible working.
- 1.2.37. An [Infrastructure Delivery Plan \(IDP\)](#) has been prepared alongside the Local Plan: this is a 'live' document. It sets out the borough's key infrastructure requirements, anticipated costs and expected delivery based upon partnership working with stakeholders and utilities providers throughout the Local Plan process. The IDP will be monitored and reviewed on a regular basis to reflect the current circumstances and to inform the development management process. The Infrastructure Schedule contained in the IDP sets out an overview of the key infrastructure requirements necessary to support regeneration in the borough.
- 1.2.38. A number of planning policies, both directly and indirectly, help to deliver infrastructure for example, green and blue infrastructure, design, health and wellbeing and transport. This is supported by a number of Merton's strategies such as [Merton's Green Infrastructure Study \(2020\)](#), [Joint Strategic Needs Assessment](#) and [Merton's Infrastructure Delivery Plan](#).

Making the most of our limited land

- 1.2.39. We will promote and ensure the most efficient use of land and development while also looking to improve the quality of our environment, protect the amenity of occupiers and neighbours, and meet planning aims. It is important that development delivers not only homes, but also the infrastructure to support the new homes, employment and business spaces, which create resilient and sustainable communities.
- 1.2.40. Applying a design-led approach to determine the optimum development capacity of sites is essential to improve the quality of our environment (physical and natural), protect the amenity of occupiers and neighbours, and meet planning aims.

Density and mixed uses

- 1.2.41. We will expect high quality developments with higher densities, where appropriate, that can appropriately be delivered by the efficient use of land, particularly in neighbourhoods with good accessibility to public transport and in Merton's Opportunity Area. In accordance with the London Plan, neighbourhoods with a good public transport accessibility level (PTAL) such

as Wimbledon, South Wimbledon, Morden and Colliers Wood will generally expect densities towards the higher end, considering all aspects of local character such as heritage assets, open spaces and setting, while having regard to the borough's acute housing needs.

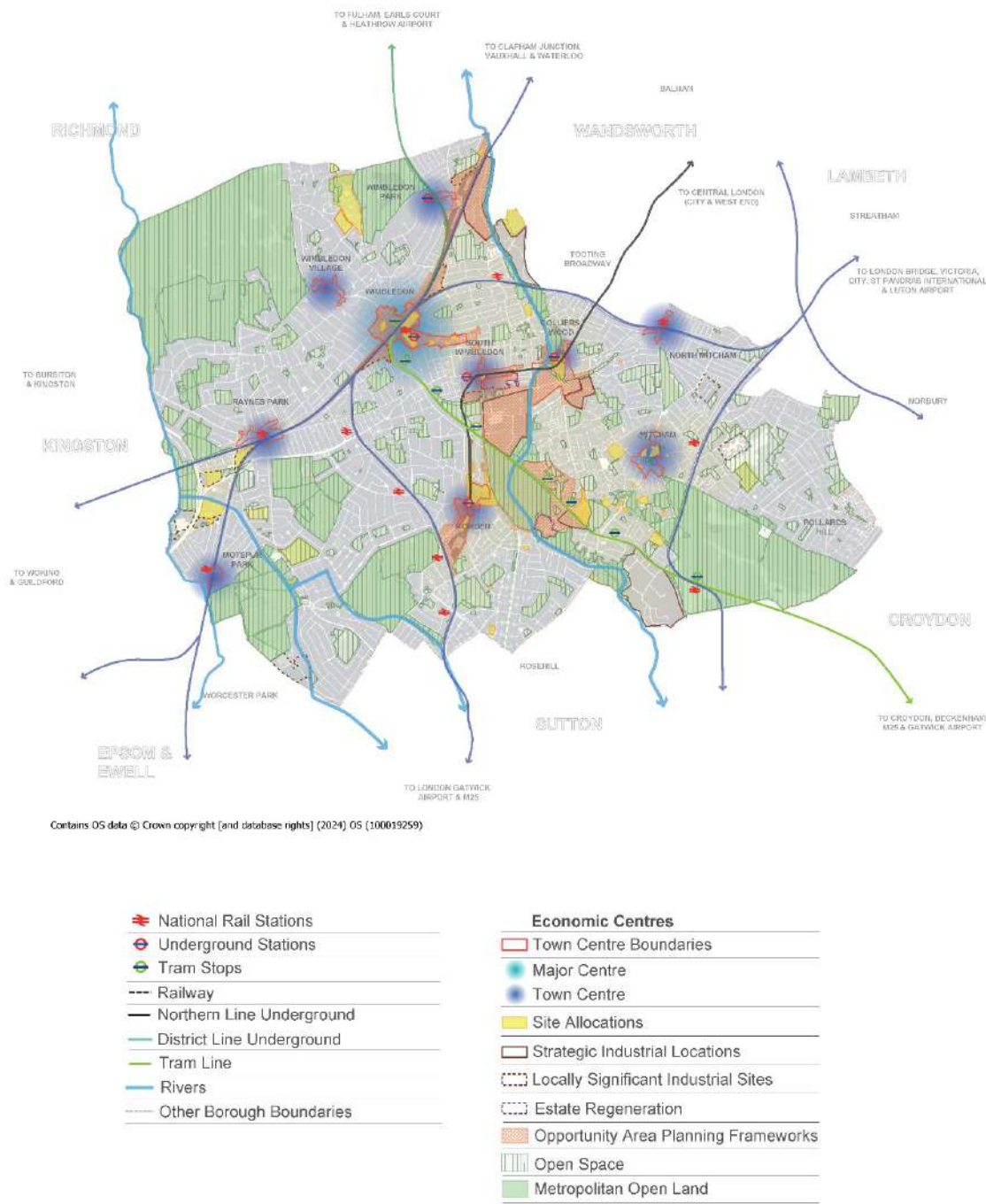
- 1.2.42. The provision of a suitable mix of uses can contribute to successfully promoting growth in Merton and, importantly, make better use of our limited land. A mix of uses can:
 - a. Increase the provision of much needed homes including those that are genuinely affordable.
 - b. Promote healthy and active neighbourhoods that have a range of activities that are used throughout the day such as entertainment, culture and restaurants.
 - c. Increase safety and security.
 - d. Reduce the need to travel, reducing the need for some journeys, helping to cut congestion in the borough and improve air quality.
- 1.2.43. In accordance with the London Plan 2021, tall buildings are one form of high-density development that can be appropriate in the locations identified in this plan, subject to excellent-exemplary design, good public transport accessibility and impact on existing character, heritage and townscape. The architectural quality and materials will need to be of an exemplary standard to ensure that the appearance and architectural integrity of the building is kept through its lifespan.

Identifying Merton's Growth areas

- 1.2.44. A considerable proportion of Merton's growth up to 2037/38 and beyond is expected to be delivered in the Opportunity Area (OA). The OA is designated in the [London Plan](#) (Table 2.1 - Opportunity Area Indicative capacity for new homes and jobs). The GLA has agreed that Morden can be included in Merton's OA.
- 1.2.45. OAs are identified as significant locations with development ability to deliver new housing, commercial development and infrastructure. The town centres found in the OA are suitable for large-scale development and significant increases in jobs and homes as they have particularly good public transport and transport interchanges, for example, Wimbledon town centre. Each centre will contribute in ways suitable to their location, centre designation and its character.
- 1.2.46. A clear focus on delivery will require all stakeholders to work together to unlock sites and drive the right sort of development. The council's overall spatial strategy is illustrated in Figure 1 below. This shows the broad locations of Merton's growth area. Development will still take place outside of the OA, although not at the same scale. Outside the OA, where

sites are not allocated, smaller scale development and more incremental change will take place. The following sections provides further detail on the parts of the borough where the most significant growth is expected to take place and the role our town centres and neighbourhoods will play in Merton's growth.

Figure 1 – Merton’s spatial strategy

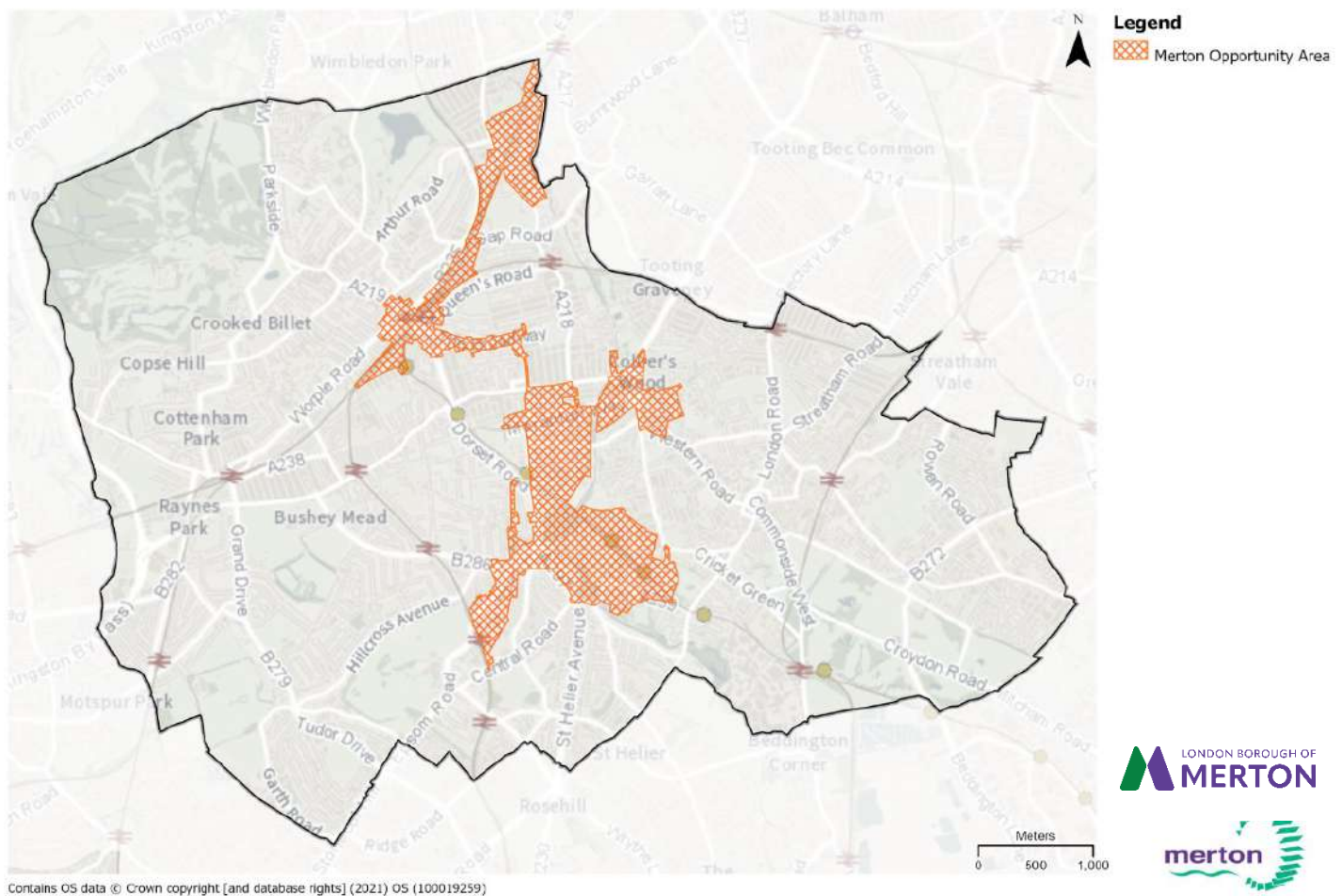


Opportunity Area (OA)

1.2.47. The London Plan ambition for Merton’s Opportunity Area of “Wimbledon, South Wimbledon

and Colliers Wood” is to deliver 5000 new homes and 6000 jobs (indicative figure up to 2041). It should be noted that these figures form the starting point from which we can carry out more precise local level exploration of what can be achieved in terms of the OA’s ability to accommodate growth. Importantly, the ambition for the OA is not predicated on the delivery of Crossrail 2. Merton’s OA is shown in the figure below and illustrated on Merton’s Policies Map.

Figure 2: Opportunity Area



- 1.2.48. To ensure that the OA fully realises its growth and regeneration potential the council will work with the GLA to produce an Opportunity Area Planning Framework (OAPF) in accordance with London Plan policy *SD1 Opportunity Areas*. The council will work with the GLA to produce an Opportunity Area Planning Framework (OAPF) should Merton's Opportunity Area persistently fail to achieve its targets for new homes and jobs. This would be subject to the GLA's agreement and resources. This plan-led approach would outline the delivery of affordable housing, create mixed and inclusive communities, and ensure the OA will contribute to regeneration objectives to tackle spatial inequalities and environmental, economic and social barriers.

- 1.2.49. The OAPF would be prepared in a collaborative way with Merton's diverse communities (including children and young people, Black, Asian and other ethnic minority groups, businesses and stakeholders). The key priorities for an OA, as outlined in the London Plan, are to:
- a. Maximise the delivery of affordable housing and create mixed and inclusive communities.
 - b. Contribute to regeneration objectives by tackling inequalities and environmental, economic and social barriers that affect the lives of people in the area.
 - c. Facilitate ambitious transport mode share targets.

Wimbledon

- 1.2.50. Wimbledon is designated a Major town centre and classified as a centre for high residential and commercial growth in the London Plan (London Plan Table A1.1 - Town Centre Network). Therefore, Wimbledon will be expected to continue to secure the development of high quality and attractive schemes. Wimbledon will become a safe and healthy place (including at night), providing a balance of mix of uses, delivering new homes including affordable, provision for flexible workspaces/hubs and offices to meet changing work patterns following the pandemic and create and secure employment and skill training opportunities. In addition, we will:
- a. Maintain and create public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment:
 - i. To improve air quality and help tackle climate change.
 - ii. To improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. To help mitigate flooding from all sources.
 - b. Support the highest quality development that preserves amenity, enhances and conserves Wimbledon's heritage assets, character and appearance.
 - c. Through town centre management initiatives, we will endeavour to ensure that the night-time economy is managed in a way that benefits residents, visitors and businesses working with local communities and stakeholders.
 - d. Maximise opportunities to enable walking and cycling with an improved network of safe and attractive greener places and routes.
 - e. Create safe and secure environments for all especially for women, children and the elderly and reduce opportunities for crime and antisocial behaviour by using Secured by Design.
 - f. Work with construction sites to minimise noise pollution and improve air quality.

- g. Encourage and enable travel behavioural changes by providing electric car charging points, more cycle parking facilities and improve road safety for all. Work with communities, TfL, GLA and other stakeholders to create a safe network for walking and cycling.
- h. Work with LoveWimbledon Business Improvement District and the Wimbledon Village Business Association to support the economic recovery, encourage business resilience and promote both local businesses and the area as a business location.

Colliers Wood

- 1.2.51. Colliers Wood town centre is designated as a District Centre and classified 'Medium' for commercial growth and 'high' for residential growth in the London Plan (London Plan Table A1.1 - Town Centre Network). Colliers Wood neighbourhood will build on its diverse mix of communities and culture, local and independent shops, small businesses and its rich heritage. In addition, we will:
- a. Reduce inequalities in the neighbourhood (health, income and social) and improve the wider determinates of health - providing a mix of uses, including new homes (including affordable), employment, social and community uses.
 - b. Maintain public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment to:
 - i. Improve air quality and help tackle climate change.
 - ii. Improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. Mitigate flooding from all sources.
 - c. Create safe and secure environments for all especially for women, children and the elderly and reduce opportunities for crime and antisocial behaviour by using Secured by Design.
 - d. Enable travel behavioural changes by providing electric car charging points and cycle parking facilities. Enable more pedestrian and cycle movement, routes and choices - making walking and 'way-finding' easier.
 - e. Provide sustainable and safe design of the highest quality that respects the character and heritage assets including the town centre. Work in partnership with cultural, historical and heritage organisations to promote the history of Colliers Wood - its historical links at Merton Priory and industrial heritage of William Morris and the Wandle Trail.
 - f. Increase significantly the number of jobs and training provided in the area. Provide employment space for identified growth sectors, small to medium enterprises and start-ups and contribute towards training and apprenticeship opportunities.

- g. Continue to work with Transport for London (TfL), to improve roads in the borough including Colliers Wood. We will seek external funding to improve safety and movement around the town centre and other busy streets in the neighbourhood to improve and increase more walking and cycling, with the aim to improve air quality and health.

South Wimbledon

- 1.2.52. South Wimbledon will become a vibrant, attractive and thriving new local centre that builds on its location between Colliers Wood and Wimbledon. Growth in this neighbourhood will need to contribute to improving the deprivation found here. In addition, we will:
- a. Make more efficient use of land, taking opportunities to provide a mix of uses, including new homes (especially affordable homes) and affordable and flexible employment floor space.
 - b. Enable and create the development of a '20 minute' neighbourhood'.
 - c. Create safe and secure environments for all especially for women, children and the elderly and reduce opportunities for crime and antisocial behaviour by way of Secured by Design.
 - d. Maintain and create new public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment to
 - i. Improve air quality and help tackle climate change.
 - ii. Improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. Mitigate flooding from all sources.
 - e. Create opportunities for jobs and training for all by supporting local businesses and new enterprises opportunities.
 - f. Promote its local identity and links to its history and environment through design and layout having regard to established local character.
 - g. Enhance and improve connectivity and public realm, with more active frontages along Merton High Street.

Morden

- 1.2.53. Morden is designated as a District centre and classified as low for commercial growth and high for residential growth in the London Plan (London Plan Table A1.1 - Town Centre Network). The Morden Regeneration Zone is expected to deliver circa 2000 new homes. In addition, we will:

- a. Reduce inequalities in the neighbourhood and improve the wider determinates of health by delivering a mix of uses, including affordable homes, offices and other employment opportunities, social and community facilities and retail to support new homes.
- b. Maintain and create new public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment to:
 - i. Improve air quality and help tackle climate change.
 - ii. Improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. Mitigate flooding from all sources.
- c. Deliver excellent public realm, with an improved network of safe and attractive places and routes for pedestrians and cyclists to enable and encourage more sustainable travel, link to neighbouring areas and reduce the dominance of traffic in the area.
- d. Deliver high quality homes, which are sympathetic to the historic area and which preserve amenity and look to enhance and conserve the significance of heritage assets such as the character and appearance of conservation areas and Morden Hall Park. park.
- e. Create safe and secure environments for all especially for women, children and the elderly and reduce opportunities for crime and antisocial behaviour using Secured by Design.
- f. Improve cycling facilities, enabling more walking and cycling, and work with Transport for London (TfL) to improve road safety for all users and pedestrians to and around Morden Underground station.
- g. Maximise densities compatible with local context, sustainable design principles and public transport capacity.
- h. Explore the development of a decentralised energy network for the town centre.

Outside the Opportunity Area

Mitcham neighbourhood

- 1.2.54. Most of the Mitcham neighbourhood lies outside the Opportunity Area (see Figure 2) aside from parts of the neighbourhood around Church Road and bordering Morden. Growth in this neighbourhood should contribute to the council's wider vision and objectives for this part of the borough. Mitcham town centre is designated as a District centre and classified as 'low' for commercial growth and 'high' for residential growth in the London Plan (London Plan Table A1.1 - Town Centre Network). Growth in this neighbourhood must positively contribute to reducing the deprivation found here. In addition, we will:

- a. Reduce inequalities in the neighbourhood and improve the wider determinates of health by providing a mix of uses, including substantial new homes (including affordable), employment and social and community uses.
- b. Create thriving '20 minute' neighbourhoods with local services which preserve local amenity.
- c. Make more efficient and intensive use of land, taking opportunities to provide a mix of tenure of new housing especially affordable homes and provide flexible employment floor space, which will provide jobs and training to improve the income deprivation.
- d. Explore opportunities for social housing estate regeneration. We will engage and work with housing providers in Mitcham neighbourhood. The council's ambition is that regeneration will focus primarily on improving the quality of housing stock but also offer the potential to create an improved physical environment and enhanced connectivity as well as address several social and economic issues.
- e. Maintain and create new public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment to:
 - i. Improve air quality and help tackle climate change.
 - ii. Improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. Mitigate flooding from all sources.
- f. Create safe and secure environments for all especially for women, children and the elderly and reduce opportunities for crime and antisocial behaviour using Secured by Design.
- g. Support local businesses, new enterprises/start-ups to create a better mix of market/retail offer in the town centre and local shopping parades.
- h. Ensure community and social facilities are coordinated and tailored to meet local needs and contribute to tackle the health and income inequalities in this neighbourhood.
- i. Improve local accessibility and interchange at the Mitcham stations (Eastfields and Mitcham Junction) with enhanced walking, cycling and bus routes to improve the town centre footfall.

Raynes Park neighbourhood (including West Barnes)

- 1.2.55. Growth in this neighbourhood should contribute to the council's wider vision and objectives for this part of the borough by:
- a. Creating a thriving a walkable neighbourhood or '20 minute' neighbourhood with local services, which preserves amenity.

- b. Maintaining and creating new public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment to:
 - i. Improve air quality and help climate change.
 - ii. Improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. Mitigate flooding from all sources.
- c. Creating safe and secure environments for all especially for women, children and the elderly and reduce opportunities for crime and antisocial behaviour by way of Secured by design.
- d. Supplying a balanced mix of uses, including housing and affordable housing, employment opportunities, community facilities, and retail.
- e. Supporting local businesses and new enterprises.
- f. Delivering excellent public realm, with an improved safe route network which enables and encourages cycling and walking with the necessary infrastructure to encourage people to adopt sustainable travel, such as cycling and scooter parking and facilities.

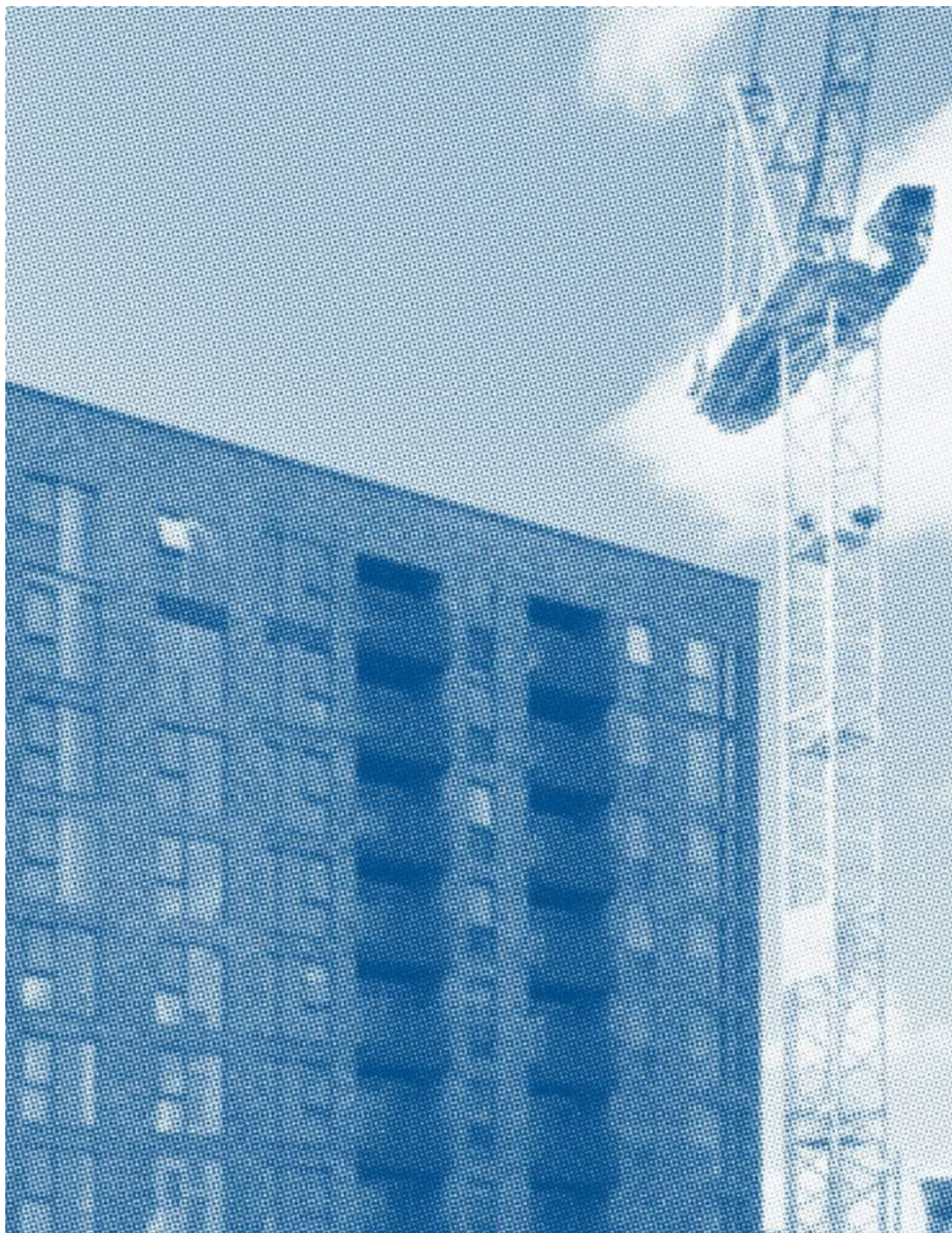
Wimbledon Chase

- 1.2.56. Development in this area must contribute to the council's wider vision and objectives for this part of the borough by:
- a. Working with transport partners, such as Transport for London (TfL) and Network Rail to relieve congestion in Kingston Road and explore Wimbledon Chase Station capacity upgrade and step-free access.
 - b. Creating a thriving local centre which will become a walkable neighbourhood or '20 minute' neighbourhood which will contribute to reducing poor air quality and improve health for all.
 - c. Creating safe and secure environments for all especially for women, children and the elderly and reduce opportunities for crime and antisocial behaviour by way of Secured by design.
 - d. Maintaining and creating new public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment to:
 - i. Improve air quality and help tackle climate change.
 - ii. Improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. Mitigate flooding from all sources.
 - e. Providing the highest quality that preserves amenity, enhances and conserves Wimbledon Chase heritage assets, character and appearance of place.

- f. Creating a more vibrant, attractive area that builds on its location between Raynes Park and Wimbledon and its transport links.
- g. Enhancing connectivity and public realm, with more active frontages along Kingston Road to support businesses and encourage shoppers.
- h. Making more efficient and intensive use of land, taking opportunities to provide a mix of uses, including new homes.

Wimbledon Village

- 1.2.57. The village will maintain its competitiveness without altering its unique green village character of equestrian pursuits, outdoor activities, book festivals and other cultural events, farmers' markets and Wimbledon Common. Whilst development opportunities here are relatively limited, Wimbledon Village will continue to contribute to the local economy with its mix of independent shops and cafes, retail and social venues, while respecting its character. Wimbledon Village will play a key role as the borough's historical and sporting tourist destination. This will be done by:
- a. Maintaining and creating new public space and greening (including appropriate tree and shrub planting) of the street environment to:
 - i. Improve air quality and help tackle climate change.
 - ii. Improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.
 - iii. Mitigate flooding from all sources.
 - b. Supporting the provision of greener transport opportunities such as electric charging points and cycle parking facilities.
 - c. Prioritising and promoting walking and cycling to reduce pressure on car parking and improve accessibility.
 - d. Supporting independent retail, business and leisure active for example, equestrian and other pursuits.



Chapter 01c. **Urban development objectives and vision**

Urban development objectives

- 1.3.1. The strategic objectives apply to the whole of Merton and provide a framework for the Local Plan, acting as stepping stones to deliver the Spatial Vision. Consultation responses, Merton's Community Plan and the London Plan (2021) have guided Merton's strategic objectives.

Strategic objective 1: tackling climate change

- 1.3.2. To make Merton an exemplary borough in mitigating and adapting to climate change, reducing pollution, developing a low carbon economy, consuming fewer resources and using them more effectively.
- 1.3.3. We will achieve this by:
- a. Ensuring that development in Merton minimises its energy use by encouraging local efficient energy generation, achieves the highest possible environmental standards and is designed to adapt to, and reduce the effects of, climate change.
 - b. Minimising energy demand, water use and greenhouse gas emissions, maximising renewable energy generation and prioritising re-use of existing building materials where possible to minimise resource use and waste.
 - c. Being resilient to the future impacts of climate change in order to minimise vulnerability of people and property; this includes the risk of flooding, water shortages, subsidence and the effects of overheating.
 - d. Promoting a circular economy to ensure that resources are kept in use at the highest level possible for as long as possible in order to consume fewer resources and minimise waste.
 - e. Applying the waste hierarchy to ensure that waste is minimised, re-used and recycled, and residual waste is disposed of sustainably in the right location using the most appropriate means.
 - f. Supporting sustainable energy infrastructure to produce energy more efficiently and utilise energy from waste.
 - g. Promoting the retrofit of existing buildings for improved energy performance and greater connections with renewable and decentralised energy.

Strategic objective 2: supporting resilience

- 1.3.4. To support those who live, work and study in Merton in resilience and recovery, to create the conditions for growth and to direct the benefits of this growth so it best meets the needs of Merton's communities.
- 1.3.5. We will achieve this by:
- a. Building more well-designed new homes, particularly affordable homes that meet the needs of households on the council's waiting list and help address the housing crisis.
 - b. Requiring new homes and buildings to be sustainable, significantly reducing carbon emissions and residents' energy bills, towards achieving Merton's net-zero carbon target in Merton's Climate Change Strategy.
 - c. Supporting investment in high streets and business areas, providing a platform for businesses and jobs recovery after COVID-19 and beyond.
 - d. Protecting and improving the borough's parks and ensuring public access to formerly private open spaces. Improving access to nature and leisure facilities, including opportunities for sport, physical activities, play and relaxation to help boost people's physical and mental health.
 - e. Supporting the existing and future successful development of our town and neighbourhood centres, while adapting to changes in their role and how people shop.

Strategic Objective 3: places for people

- 1.3.6. To provide new homes and infrastructure within Merton's town centres and residential areas, through physical regeneration and effective use of space.
- 1.3.7. We will achieve this by:
- a. Delivering quality new homes, associated infrastructure and social facilities that respect and enhance the local character of the area, in places with good public transport access. ;
 - b. Delivering social and community services and infrastructure to support new homes through new development and the effective use of space.
 - c. Providing a choice and mix of homes which are accessible, adaptable and sustainable, which apply high quality design standards to meet the needs of Merton's diverse communities.

- d. Ensuring that development makes the most efficient use of brownfield land and that it is designed at the optimum density, considering site context, connectivity by walking, cycling and public transport and access to amenities and services.
- e. Requiring major development proposals to maximise the positive impacts and minimise adverse impacts on physical and mental health and wellbeing.
- f. Working with key stakeholders such as our local Metropolitan Police Service 'design out crime' officers and planning teams, Emergency Planning Authority and British Transport Police to identify community safety needs, policies and sites required for their area and support provision of necessary infrastructure to maintain a safe and secure environment.

Strategic objective 4: good growth

- 1.3.8. To create the conditions for growth, ensuring it takes place in the most appropriate and sustainable locations, minimises the impacts of development, and to direct the benefits of this growth so it meets the needs of Merton's communities for homes, jobs and services, and preserves and enhances the borough's unique character and appearance.
- 1.3.9. We will achieve this by:
 - a. Supporting a diverse local economy and promoting a commercially viable, thriving mix of premises, including shops and services, business and industrial uses that increase jobs and services available to local people.
 - b. Promoting and supporting the successful development of the growth areas (Opportunity Area and Morden (Regeneration Zone) and to ensure that all development is supported by necessary infrastructure and maximises the opportunities and benefits for the local and surrounding communities and the borough as a whole.
 - c. Supporting sustainable growth of the visitor economy for the benefit of local communities and promoting the borough as an attractive and inviting place to visit and enjoy.
 - d. Encouraging and supporting low carbon behaviour in local businesses such as improving the energy efficiency of their buildings, maximising renewable energy generation, promoting sustainable and active travel, working with their supply chains to provide low carbon products and services, and minimising waste.
 - e. Enhancing the learning environment to improve access to education, training and jobs.
 - f. Maximising opportunities for employment and local businesses, focusing on Merton's town centres and main employment areas along the Wandle Valley.

Strategic objective 5: place plans and the 20-minute neighbourhood

- 1.3.10. To promote a high quality urban and suburban environment in Merton, providing reliable, quality local services in accessible, well designed neighbourhoods.
- 1.3.11. We will achieve this by:
- a. Encouraging low carbon and healthy lifestyles in line with Merton's net-zero carbon target by promoting walking and cycling.
 - b. Using Transport for London's (TfL) Healthy Streets Approach to prioritise health in planning decisions.
 - c. Supporting town centres and neighbourhood parades to boost the shops and services within them, working with businesses and residents to manage the changing nature of how we shop and use deliveries.
 - d. Delivering community services and infrastructure to support new homes through new development and the effective use of space.
 - e. Ensuring that development makes the most efficient use of land that is designed at the optimum density, considering site context, connectivity by walking, cycling and public transport and access to amenities and services.
 - f. Encouraging improvements to public transport, including quality and connectivity of transport interchanges, supporting the use of Smart City technology in the public highway and in co-ordinating deliveries.
 - g. Conserving and enhancing the unique historic environment, heritage and cultural assets.

Spatial vision

1.3.12. By 2037/38 Merton will have:

- a. Made progress towards becoming net-zero carbon by 2050 in partnership with other organisations and, importantly, with our residents.
- b. Continued to grow the borough's low carbon and circular economy.
- c. Minimised greenhouse gas emissions and ensured resilience from overheating, flooding and other the impacts of climate change.
- d. Improved community health and wellbeing and reduced health and income inequality within the borough and the disparities between the east and west of the borough.
- e. Provided new homes meeting the needs of communities - especially more affordable homes for households on the council's waiting list.
- f. Created attractive, safe and secure '20 minute' neighbourhoods to live, work, and socialise.
- g. Created new and improved existing neighbourhoods with a range of mixed tenure homes while respecting the local character of each area.
- h. Improved air quality, minimised noise, flood risk and other polluting impacts, and reduced carbon and water demands by minimising detrimental impacts from development.
- i. Improved access to our unique rich heritage and historic environment for all, while encouraging innovations in building technology.
- j. Achieved a shift in travel behaviour towards more people walking and cycling, particularly for short journeys.
- k. Improved interchange between transport modes and incorporated innovative solutions to manage deliveries and the highway network for all users.
- l. Continued to develop sustainable growth across Merton and in our growth areas for all.
- m. Have protected and improved access to the borough's Metropolitan Open Land (MOL), parks and open spaces, and have protected and enhanced biodiversity and areas of nature conservation.



Chapter 2. **Climate change**

Strategic Policy CC2.1 Promoting Sustainable Design to Mitigate and Adapt to Climate Change

1. To make Merton a more environmentally sustainable place and net-zero carbon by 2050 [1], Merton Council aims to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and increase local resilience to the impacts of a changing climate through sustainable design.
2. This will be achieved by requiring all development to:
 - a. Minimise greenhouse gas emissions and support the transition to a low carbon society by maximising energy efficiency, low carbon heat and local renewable energy generation;
 - b. Support the principles of the circular economy and promote more effective resource use, to ensure that resources are kept in use for as long as possible and to minimise waste;
 - c. Recognise and adapt to Merton's changing climate and ensure that development mitigates the risk of overheating and flooding, and maximises comfort and wellbeing in a changing climate;
 - d. Maximise opportunities to enhance green infrastructure and tree planting to deliver multi-functional benefits such as minimising the urban heat effect, enhancing natural carbon sinks and improving air quality; and
 - e. Promote healthy and sustainable lifestyles in line with Merton's net-zero carbon target.

Supporting text

- 2.1.1 In accordance with the NPPF-Plans should take a proactive approach to mitigating and adapting to climate change, taking into account the long-term implications for flood risk, coastal change, water supply, biodiversity and landscapes, and the risk of overheating from rising temperatures. Policies should support appropriate measures to ensure the future resilience of communities and infrastructure to climate change impacts, such as providing space for physical protection measures, or making provision for the possible future relocation of vulnerable development and infrastructure.'

A Climate Emergency and carbon reduction targets

- 2.1.2 In 2018, the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) published a Special Report [2] which concluded that global greenhouse gas emissions¹ need to reach net-zero by 2050 in order to keep global temperature rise below 1.5°C and minimise damaging climate impacts on human and natural systems. In May 2019, the Committee on Climate Change (CCC) recommended a new long-term emissions target for the UK: net-zero

¹ Also referred to throughout the Local Plan as carbon emissions.

greenhouse gases by 2050 [3]. Following the adoption of the Climate Change Act 2008 (2050 Target Amendment) Order in 2019, the UK has a statutory requirement to reduce its greenhouse gas emissions by 100% by 2050 (based on 1990 levels) [4].

- 2.1.3 Furthermore, in his 1.5C Compatible Climate Action Plan 2018 [5] and Environment Strategy 2018 [6], the Mayor of London committed to London becoming a net-zero carbon city by 2050, with energy efficient buildings, clean transport and clean energy.
- 2.1.4 In July 2019, Merton Council declared a Climate Emergency and committed to working towards becoming a carbon neutral borough by 2050 and a carbon neutral council by 2030 [7], in line with the national and regional targets mentioned above. Merton's Climate Strategy & Action Plan [1], which was approved by Council on 18 November 2020, sets out the key actions required to achieve these carbon reduction targets across a range of sectors: economy, transport, buildings and energy, and green spaces.
- 2.1.5 By 2050, Merton will need to decarbonise activities across all sectors. This will require: a transition to a low carbon and circular economy which promotes the effective use of resources and minimises waste; all journeys using petrol and diesel vehicles will need to be replaced by low carbon alternatives such as cycling and walking, and low carbon vehicles; and emissions from all existing and new buildings will need to be net-zero carbon by minimising energy demand, and meeting all our energy needs using renewable and low carbon energy [1] [8].
- 2.1.6 With some 81% of greenhouse gas emissions in Merton being generated from the energy used to heat and power our buildings, decarbonising our building stock will be a fundamental step in becoming a net-zero carbon borough [1]. The following policies aim to drive net-zero carbon development in Merton through sustainable design. These policies should be read alongside Merton's Design and Housing policies in this Local Plan.
- 2.1.7 However, development should also encourage sustainable lifestyles more broadly. For example, development should reduce the need to travel, particularly by private car, and ensure that the largest possible share of journeys are made by active travel and public transport, as set out in Merton's Sustainable Travel policies. Merton Council also encourages development to support community-led initiatives such as local food growing as set out in Merton's Green Infrastructure and Health & Wellbeing policies.

The role of sustainable design in getting to net-zero carbon

- 2.1.8 All buildings in Merton will need to operate at net-zero carbon by 2050 in order to achieve our carbon reduction target. A building which operates at net-zero carbon does not burn fossil fuels, has ultra-high energy efficiency and is 100% powered by renewable energy [9].

- 2.1.9 Extensive retrofit will be required to decarbonise Merton's existing building stock given that low carbon heat solutions require reasonable levels of energy efficiency (at least an Energy Performance Certificate (EPC) rating of C) [5], and more than three quarters of Merton's 88,000 homes have an EPC rating of D or below [1]. The costs of achieving higher standards via retrofit are three to five times higher than for new buildings and the carbon impact of delayed action is significant [10]. Merton's decarbonisation pathways modelling estimated that retrofitting Merton's existing building stock would cost in excess of £2.7 billion [8].
- 2.1.10 In order to achieve our carbon reduction target as cost effectively as possible, all new development must therefore be fit for the future (i.e. be ultra-energy efficient and climate resilient, and maximise low carbon and renewable energy) [11]. Any new buildings which are not built to operate at net-zero carbon will require expensive retrofit in the next 30 years.
- 2.1.11 Current housing projections for Merton indicate that a minimum of 12,084 additional homes will be built during the plan period. Policy must therefore ensure that new development in Merton does not create a legacy of poor performance that will require remedial action in the future and add to Merton's retrofit burden. In their Climate Emergency Design Guide (2020), the London Energy Transformation Initiative (LETI) concluded that all new buildings will need to operate at net-zero carbon by 2030 in order to achieve a zero-carbon built environment in the UK by 2050. This means that all new buildings must be designed to operate at net-zero carbon by 2025.
- 2.1.12 Developers must consider sustainability early in the design process in order to maximise energy and carbon savings, and minimise construction and operational costs.

The policy gap and the need for higher local standards

NATIONAL STANDARDS – PART L OF BUILDING REGULATIONS

- 2.1.13 The UK Green Building Council defines a net-zero carbon operational building as follows: "When the amount of carbon emissions associated with the building's operational energy on an annual basis is zero or negative. A net zero carbon building is highly energy efficient and powered from on-site and/or off-site renewable energy sources, with any remaining carbon balance offset."
- 2.1.14 There is a significant gap between current building standards (Part L 2021) and the standards required to become net-zero carbon by 2050 [51]. In order to achieve a net-zero carbon balance across the UK housing stock, LETI found that all new development will need to be designed to achieve an Energy Use Intensity (EUI), i.e. energy use measured at the meter, of 35kWh/m²/yr [9]. However, the Part L average EUI in 2020 was 140 kWh/m²/yr.

- 2.1.15 It is widely accepted that there is a significant performance gap between predicted and actual performance using the Part L methodology [9] [11]. Reasons for this include, but are not limited to, the following:
- a. Part L does not address emissions associated with unregulated equipment such as fridges, washing machines, cooking equipment, computers, etc. which can represent up to 50% of a building's operational emissions [9]. This means that a building achieving a 100% improvement against Part L doesn't necessarily achieve net-zero carbon operational emissions.
 - b. The relative improvement approach against a notional building used in Part L does not reward more efficient building forms which ultimately provide more energy and carbon savings [12].
 - c. Delays in incorporating up to date carbon factors in Part L can lead to perverse modelling outcomes by overestimating the carbon savings from gas [10]. Part L also overestimates the emissions associated with electricity use over a building's lifetime as it does not consider impacts of further projected reductions in carbon intensity of electricity in coming decades.
- 2.1.16 In addition, in recent years, policies supporting low-carbon homes, such as Zero Carbon Homes and Code for Sustainable Homes, have been weakened or withdrawn at a national level [11]. Policy proposals encouraging high energy efficiency such as the 'Interim' and 'full' Fabric Energy Efficiency Standards defined by the Zero Carbon Hub in 2009 [13] have not been enforced through Building Regulations which has led to the development of buildings which are not future-proofed for 2050 [14].
- 2.1.17 Building Regulations are expected to be updated in 2025 but current proposals for the Future Homes Standard 2025 do not address the shortcomings set out above and are not ambitious enough to deliver the savings required to achieve our carbon reduction targets [15] [16] [17] [18].

REGIONAL STANDARDS – THE LONDON PLAN

- 2.1.18 In order to drive greenhouse gas and energy savings in London, the Mayor has implemented a zero carbon policy for all residential Major Developments since 2016, and this policy was extended to non-residential Major Developments in the London Plan 2021. This policy aims to achieve net-zero carbon development in London; however, in practice, there are a number of shortcomings to the policy which must be addressed in order to genuinely achieve our net-zero carbon target:
- a. A development which achieves a 100% improvement against Part L on site in line with the Mayor's zero carbon policy, does not necessarily achieve net-zero carbon operational

emissions given that the current Part L methodology does not account for unregulated emissions [12].

- b. The London Plan allows for up to 65% of a development's regulated emissions to be offset through cash-in-lieu contributions which shifts the responsibility for offsetting any residual emissions to the local authority [12]. However, in order to achieve our net-zero carbon target, emissions will need to reduce close to zero without offsetting, so carbon offsetting must not be heavily relied upon and should only be considered where further savings cannot be achieved on-site [9] [3].
- c. The cost of carbon used to offset a development's carbon shortfall included in the London Plan does not incentivise developers to achieve further carbon savings on site as it does not reflect the actual cost of implementing carbon saving measures [12]. This in turn also limits the carbon savings which can be achieved through carbon offset funds and prevents a zero carbon balance from being achieved.
- d. The Mayor's zero carbon policy only applies to Major Developments which represent less than 10% of schemes in Merton. However, all buildings, regardless of the scale of development, will need to be net-zero carbon by 2050 in order to achieve our carbon reduction target.

2.1.19 We are committed to driving sustainable design and minimising greenhouse gas emissions through local policies in Merton. Policies CC2.2 minimising greenhouse gas emissions; CC2.3 minimising energy use and CC2.4 low carbon energy are intended to go beyond the London Plan requirements to drive building energy performance which is compatible with our 2050 net-zero carbon target, by maximising on-site savings through energy efficiency and low carbon and renewable energy generation. These policies set out Merton's requirements based on the current Building Regulations (2021) Part L methodology, but also embed recommendations from the Zero Carbon Hub, the CCC 's report on making UK housing fit for the future, LETI's Climate Emergency Design Guide and the Delivering Net Zero study where possible.

2.1.20 In addition, as operational emissions decrease with the roll out of low carbon heat and higher energy efficiency standards, embodied emissions will make up an increasing proportion of a development's whole-life cycle emissions. Policy CC2.5 Minimising Waste and Promoting a Circular Economy sets out Merton's requirements to minimise embodied carbon and Policy CC2.6 sustainable design standards sets out the sustainability standards required of development in Merton.

Climate adaptation in Merton

2.1.21 There is extensive evidence that human-induced global warming has already caused significant changes to the climate system including an increased frequency and intensity of

extreme weather events such as heatwaves and heavy precipitation events [2] [3]. This trend is expected to continue as the magnitude of warming increases.

- 2.1.22 Impacts in London will likely include increased heat, flooding and drought, with a greater frequency of severe weather events [19]. In order to ensure climate resilience in our communities and minimise future climate-related human and financial costs, these risks will need to be embedded in how we design the buildings in which we live and work by minimising the risk of overheating, flooding, subsidence and water shortages.
- 2.1.23 We will require all development proposals to demonstrate that they are well designed, fully adaptable and resilient to the impacts of a changing climate, and will not exacerbate any climate change impacts elsewhere.
- 2.1.24 Climate adaptation has been embedded within the relevant sections of the Local Plan. Overheating of buildings and subsidence are addressed in the Design policies; flooding, water shortages and the urban heat island effect are covered in the Green & Blue Infrastructure policies; and water use from development is addressed in Policy CC2.6 Sustainable Design Standards below.
- 2.1.25 Merton's climate change policies should be read alongside Chapter 9 Sustainable Infrastructure of the London Plan 2021.

Policy CC2.2 Minimising Greenhouse Gas Emissions

1. All development within the borough should seek to minimise greenhouse gas emissions on site.
2. We will require:

All development resulting in the creation of 1 or more dwellings or 500sqm or more non-residential GIA:

- a. To reduce greenhouse gas emissions on-site and minimise both annual and peak energy demand in accordance with the Mayor of London's Energy Hierarchy below:
 - i. Be lean: use less energy and manage demand during operation
 - ii. Be clean: exploit local energy resources (such as secondary heat) and supply energy efficiently and cleanly
 - iii. Be green: maximise opportunities for renewable energy by producing, storing and using renewable energy on-site
 - iv. Be seen: monitor, verify and report on energy performance
- b. To provide an energy statement demonstrating how emissions savings have been maximised at each stage of the energy hierarchy towards achieving net-zero carbon emissions on site.
- c. To achieve the relevant minimum carbon reduction targets as set out in the table below:

Development Type	Minimum on-site total reduction in CO ₂ ²	Benchmark total reduction in CO ₂ ³
Residential Major Development of 10 or more dwellings (including new build, change of use, conversions and major refurbishments)	35%	50%+
Minor new build residential development of 1 or more dwellings ³	35%	50%+
Minor residential change of use and conversions resulting in the creation of 1 or more dwellings	35%	
Office buildings of 500sqm GIA or more (including new build, change of use and major refurbishments)	25%	
School buildings of 500sqm GIA or more (including new build, change of use and major refurbishments)	35%	
Industrial buildings of 500sqm GIA or more (including new build, change of use and major refurbishments)	35%	
Hotel of 500sqm GIA or more (including new build, change of use and major refurbishments)	10%	
All other non-residential development of 500sqm GIA or more (including new build, change of use and major refurbishments)	35%	

All new build development resulting in the creation of 1 or more dwellings or 500sqm or more non-residential GIA:

- d. To demonstrate compliance with the Mayor's net-zero carbon target.
- e. Where it is clearly demonstrated that the net-zero carbon target cannot be fully achieved on site beyond the minimum requirements, any carbon shortfall to be provided, either:
 - i. through a cash-in-lieu contribution to Merton's carbon offset fund, or
 - ii. off-site provided that an alternative proposal which offers Additionality⁴ is identified, delivery is certain and subject to agreement with the council.

² This represents a minimum improvement beyond Part L of Building Regulations 2021. When Building Regulations are updated (e.g. The Future Homes Standard expected in 2025), we will clarify how the policy's requirements relate to the new Building Regulations in an Explanatory Note on Approaches to Sustainable Design & Construction.

³ Throughout, this refers to gross residential development.

⁴ See Glossary for definition of Additionality

SUPPORTING TEXT

The Mayor's Energy Hierarchy and Zero Carbon Policy

- 2.2.1 In line with the London Plan, all developments in Merton should maximise on-site carbon savings in accordance with the Mayor of London's energy hierarchy through energy efficiency, the use of clean energy, and on-site renewable energy generation.
- 2.2.2 Since 2016, the Mayor has implemented a zero carbon policy for all residential Major Developments (i.e. of 10 or more dwellings) to drive greenhouse gas and energy savings in London. This policy was extended to include non-residential Major Developments (i.e. of 1,000sqm GIA or more) in the London Plan in 2021.
- 2.2.3 To date, the Mayor's zero carbon policy has only been applied to Major Developments in Merton. However, over 90% of developments in Merton are built as minor schemes (i.e. 10 homes or less, or 1,000sqm non-residential GIA or less), of which a large proportion involves conversions and change of use to create new dwellings⁵. While individually these developments do not represent a large source of carbon emissions, their cumulative impact will significantly affect Merton's ability to achieve our national, regional and local carbon reduction targets. In order to become a net-zero carbon borough by 2050, all development, regardless of its size, will need to reduce its greenhouse gas emissions to near zero on site, and become net-zero carbon or net-positive buildings⁶ [1].
- 2.2.4 In order to drive carbon reductions in Merton's existing and new building stock, all development will therefore be expected to seek new, innovative and robust approaches to reducing energy demand and carbon emissions on site. All applications resulting in the creation of 1 or more new dwellings or 500sqm⁷ or more non-residential GIA (in both new and existing buildings) will need to provide an energy statement to demonstrate how carbon savings have been maximised at all stages of the energy hierarchy and that all reasonable endeavours have been made towards achieving net-zero carbon emissions on site.
- 2.2.5 In addition, all new build development resulting in the creation of 1 or more dwellings or 500sqm or more non-residential GIA will need to demonstrate compliance with the Mayor's net-zero carbon target. This means that any carbon shortfall⁸ will need to be offset via off-site projects which offer Additionality or via cash-in-lieu contributions.

⁵ Around 90% of applications received for non-residential developments are smaller than 1000sqm GIA. The vast majority of residential applications (around 7,000 in the last 5 years) are householder applications (i.e. proposals to alter or enlarge a single house, e.g. extensions). A large proportion of residential applications (over 1,000 in the last 5 years) are minor applications for the creation of new dwellings (including new build, conversions and change of use). A relatively small proportion of residential applications (around 100 in the last 5 years) are Major Development applications.

⁶ A building which generates more energy on-site than it uses on an annual basis.

⁷ Since 2011, Merton has applied the London Plan policies to all non-residential schemes of 500sqm GIA or more given that a significant proportion of non-residential schemes in Merton are less than 1000sqm GIA.

⁸ Using the Part L methodology.

- 2.2.6 Any development involving the change of use or conversion of an existing building will not be required to offset the carbon shortfall. This is to encourage the refurbishment of existing buildings and disincentivize the demolition of retrofittable buildings, in order to minimise embodied carbon emissions from development. However, all development will be expected to maximise carbon savings on site towards the net-zero carbon target.
- 2.2.7 As set out in Strategic Policy CC2.1 the Mayor's zero carbon target is not a reflection of true net-zero carbon development because it enables a significant proportion of regulated emissions to be offset via cash-in-lieu contributions and does not take into account unregulated energy uses. To address this gap, we have introduced higher on-site carbon reduction targets to maximise on-site savings as set out below, specified additional requirements to minimise energy demand and unregulated emissions in Policy CC2.3 Minimising Energy Use, and set out further requirements to maximise renewable and low carbon energy generation in Policy CC2.4.
- 2.2.8 This net-zero carbon target may need to be reviewed if national and regional policy changes (e.g. if the Mayor were to adopt a change in approach to include both regulated and unregulated emissions within their net-zero carbon target, to address the shortfalls highlighted above). If this were to result in a substantial change, this would be considered as part of the Local Plan review process.

Minimum on-site carbon savings

- 2.2.9 The aim of the Mayor's zero carbon policy is to drive carbon savings on site and ensure that any carbon shortfall which cannot be addressed on site is offset elsewhere in the borough to achieve a net-zero carbon balance. However, in practice, the current London Plan 2021 approach (35% minimum target) allows up to 65% of carbon emissions from development to be offset via cash-in-lieu contributions, which shifts the responsibility to the local authority to make the scheme compliant. In order to achieve our carbon reduction commitments, on-site emissions will need to reduce close to zero, so carbon offsetting must not be heavily relied upon and should only be considered where further savings cannot be achieved on site [9] [3].
- 2.2.10 In 2019/20, a study commissioned by several London boroughs (Towards Net Zero Carbon), to investigate the cost of carbon and its role in achieving greater carbon reductions on site, found that the London Plan on-site carbon reduction targets and cost of carbon were inadequate for delivering the savings required to achieve net-zero carbon [12]. The *Towards Net Zero Carbon* study demonstrated that due to the decarbonisation of the electricity grid, for the same specifications, a greater improvement over Part L was achieved with no extra effort/cost. The study also concluded that a carbon offset price of £60-£95/tCO₂ was not sufficient for local authorities to deliver the required carbon savings off site.

- 2.2.11 In 2022, following the adoption of Part L 2021 of Building Regulations, Merton and 17 other London boroughs commissioned a review of the Towards Net Zero Carbon study against Part L 2021. This review (Delivering Net Zero, May 2023) tested several building typologies against Part L 2021 and recommended the following percentage improvement targets [51]:
- a. Domestic buildings: 65% better than Part L 2021
 - b. Office buildings: 25% better than Part L 2021
 - c. School buildings: 35% better than Part L 2021
 - d. Industrial buildings: 45% better than Part L 2021
 - e. Hotel: 10% better than Part L 2021
 - f. Other non-domestic buildings: 35% better than Part L 2021
- 2.2.12 The Delivering Net Zero study was developed in response to changes to Part L of Building Regulations which came into effect in 2022. As such, this local evidence was completed and published at a late stage of the Examination process of this Local Plan. As a result of this, Policy CC2.2 part-2c contains the minimum targets and benchmarks set out in the Mayor's Energy Assessment Guidance 2022 apart from where the Delivering Net Zero study identified targets which are lower than the minimum target set out in the Mayor's Energy Assessment Guidance (i.e. 35% improvement against Part L 2021). Nonetheless, as set out in Policy CC2.2 part-2b, all development resulting in the creation of one or more dwellings or 500sqm or more non-residential GIA will be required to demonstrate how emissions savings have been maximised at each stage of the energy hierarchy towards achieving net zero carbon emissions on site.
- 2.2.13 These minimum on-site targets will be reviewed over time unless there is a local or national change in methodology for assessing building energy performance. We will seek to apply an equivalent standard when Building Regulations are updated.
- 2.2.14 However, all development is expected to get as close to zero carbon emissions on-site as possible, and will need to demonstrate that on-site savings have been maximised at all stages of the energy hierarchy whether the minimum on-site target has already been met or not. For new build development, offsetting any carbon shortfall via cash-in-lieu contributions or via off-site projects will only be considered where the council is satisfied that on-site savings have been maximised. Proposals for off-site projects should have carbon equivalence to the carbon shortfall on-site. Off-site projects should offer Additionality, and monitoring and verification measures would be expected.

Carbon offsetting for new build development and the cost of carbon

- 2.2.15 In order to genuinely deliver net-zero carbon development, carbon pricing must:
- a. Drive on-site savings by making it more cost effective for developers to deliver the savings on site than to opt to buy out of their obligation by paying carbon offset contributions; and
 - b. Where offsetting is required, ensure that carbon offset contributions are sufficient for the local authority to pay for measures which achieve carbon savings equivalent to the carbon shortfall of the development. Otherwise, developers are not achieving net-zero carbon development and the local authority cannot deliver a net-zero carbon policy [12].
- 2.2.16 The London Plan 2021 carbon offset price (£95/tCO₂) is too low to actually deliver equivalent carbon savings and therefore does not incentivise sufficient on-site savings [12][51]. Using the cost of carbon recommended in the London Plan 2021, it is cheaper and easier for developers to offset carbon emissions via cash-in-lieu contributions than it is to achieve the actual savings on site, resulting in developments with higher operational emissions and local authorities with insufficient funds to deliver equivalent carbon savings off site.
- 2.2.17 In 2019, Etude et al. found that it would cost a local authority at least £300/t to save carbon in a sustainable way, taking into account administration and management costs [12]. Local authorities therefore have insufficient funds to deliver equivalent carbon savings off site through cash-in-lieu contributions using a cost of carbon of £95/t.
- 2.2.18 In order to incentivise developers to implement lower carbon strategies on site where possible, and to ensure that any remaining carbon shortfall can adequately be addressed off site, the carbon shortfall for the assumed life of a development (e.g. 30 years) will therefore be offset at a rate of £300/tCO₂ as at 2021. The price for offsetting carbon is regularly reviewed; if prices were to change significantly this may trigger review of the policy to determine whether updates would be needed.
- 2.2.19 Where a developer is proposing to directly offset any shortfall in carbon dioxide emissions from the proposed development by installing carbon dioxide saving measures off site (e.g. photovoltaic panels on a local school), this will need to comply with the GLA's Carbon Offset Fund Guidance, and any relevant local guidance. Any off-site proposals will need to be agreed with the council and confirmed in the energy statement.
- 2.2.20 Etude et al. [12][51] modelled a number of technical scenarios and demonstrated that several low carbon solutions (involving good practice or ultra-low energy fabric, and a range of low carbon heating systems) achieved the proposed minimum on-site targets across several typologies.

- 2.2.21 These scenarios were modelled using different approaches to carbon offsetting to determine their associated construction and carbon offset costs, which were tested as part of [Merton's Local Plan Housing Viability Study](#) [20].
- 2.2.22 Developers will be expected to adopt the highest possible standards of fabric and ventilation and heating plant to maximise carbon savings on site. Any development that fails to achieve the necessary on-site performance targets or to demonstrate that carbon savings have been maximised, must provide full evidence and justification as to why the scheme is unable to comply. Where the developer contends the policy requirements in relation to viability of a particular proposal, the onus would lie with the developer to demonstrate what can viably be achieved through the submission of a viability assessment. We may seek payments from applications for the cost of independent viability assessment(s). Where it has been demonstrated that planning considerations cannot viably be supported, Policy IN14.1 sets out the infrastructure prioritisation that applicants and decisions-makers should apply in accordance with Policy DF1 of the London Plan.

Policy CC2.3 Minimising Energy Use

1. Merton Council will require all proposed development within the borough to demonstrate that they have made the fullest contribution to minimising energy use through energy efficiency on site.
2. This will be achieved by requiring:

All development resulting in the creation of 1 or more dwellings or 500sqm or more non-residential GIA

- a. To demonstrate how energy demand, including regulated and unregulated uses, has been minimised on site through passive measures and by maximising the efficiency of building form, fabric and systems.
- b. To disclose the anticipated Energy Use Intensity⁹ at design and pre-occupation stage.

All new build development resulting in the creation of 1 or more residential unit or 500sqm or more non-residential GIA

- c. To demonstrate compliance with the following relevant fabric efficiency targets*:

Type of Development	Zero Carbon Hub Interim FEES until 31 December 2022 ¹⁰	Zero Carbon Hub Full FEES from 01 January 2023 to 31 December 2024	Space Heating Demand Target from 01 January 2025 ¹¹
Blocks of flats and mid-terrace houses	<43 kWh/m ² /yr	<39 kWh/m ² /yr	<15 kWh/m ² /yr
Semi-detached, end of terrace and detached houses	<52 kWh/m ² /yr	<46 kWh/m ² /yr	<20 kWh/m ² /yr
Non-residential development	-	-	<15 kWh/m ² /yr

⁹ An annual measure of total energy consumed in a building which can be estimated at design stage and easily monitored in-use as energy bills are based on kWh of energy used by the building. It includes regulated (heating, hot water, cooling, ventilation and lighting) and unregulated (plug loads and equipment) energy.

*Both the Fabric Energy Efficiency Standard and Space Heating Demand Target are based on regulated energy use.

¹⁰ Based on the Fabric Energy Efficiency Standard for Zero Carbon Homes as defined by the Zero Carbon Hub (2009) [40].

¹¹ Based on recommendations from the Committee on Climate Change (2019) [11] and the London Energy Transformation Initiative (2020) [9].

All Major Development

- d. To monitor and report on energy use for 5 years post-occupancy¹².

Supporting text

- 2.3.1 A building's operational carbon emissions are a direct result of its energy use. In order to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and ultimately achieve our carbon reduction targets, a development will therefore first and foremost need to minimise energy use through energy efficiency, as reflected in the first tier of the Mayor's Energy Hierarchy: 'Be Lean'.
- 2.3.2 In addition, the transition to low carbon heat, which is required to deliver long term carbon savings, is contingent on having high levels of energy efficiency [21].
- 2.3.3 Energy efficiency will depend on both building and equipment design. This policy focusses primarily on fabric efficiency, and Policy CC2.4 Low Carbon Energy below addresses the importance of efficiency of plant in decarbonising heat.

The role of energy efficiency in delivering low carbon heat

- 2.3.4 In order to manage running costs and avoid external costs to the grid infrastructure, a transition to low carbon heat can only be achieved through significant improvements to energy efficiency [10]. Indeed, low carbon heating solutions (such as heat pumps and solar thermal) tend to operate most effectively at low temperatures, and are therefore much more sensitive to energy efficiency than conventional gas boiler systems [9]. Indeed, if a building's heat losses are much higher than anticipated, a low temperature heating system has to run at higher operating temperatures to compensate for this, which can result in significant increases in energy use and energy bills [10]. In addition, as we move from gas to electricity to heat our buildings, energy use needs to be minimised to reduce the demand for energy generation and peak loads on the national grid [9] [22].
- 2.3.5 However, there are limitations to using Building Regulations as a tool for driving energy efficiency. Indeed, the Part L methodology enables low carbon energy to compensate for poor building fabric and doesn't reflect efforts to improve energy efficiency through form [14]. Part L assessments also underestimate carbon savings achieved through improvements to fabric and ventilation, given that they underestimate a development's space heating requirements [12].

¹² In line with the GLA's 'Be Seen' Energy Monitoring Guidance, or equivalent.

The need for fabric energy efficiency standards

- 2.3.6 Improved fabric energy efficiency will ensure that buildings use low and zero carbon energy in the most efficient way [11]. As well as reducing greenhouse gas emissions, using ultra-high levels of fabric efficiency alongside heat pumps and Mechanical Ventilation and Heat Recovery (MVHR) systems can help reduce annual and peak electricity demand, provide comfort and health benefits to occupants, and deliver average bill savings of around £85 per year for a typical three bedroom semi-detached house [11], which will help tackle fuel poverty in Merton. This will also help ‘future proof’ developments and reduce the likelihood of buildings needing difficult and expensive refurbishment at a later date.
- 2.3.7 In 2019, the Committee on Climate Change recommended to the UK government that new homes should deliver ultra-high levels of energy efficiency achieving a space heating demand of 15kWh/m²/yr or less as soon as possible and by 2025 at the latest [11]. In 2020, the London Energy Transformation Initiative published their Climate Emergency Design Guide which concluded that in order to achieve our national carbon reduction targets, all new residential and non-residential buildings should be designed to achieve a space heating demand of 15kWh/m²/yr or less by 2025 [9].
- 2.3.8 In order to give industry the opportunity to adjust, Policy CC2.3 Minimising Energy Use, part-2c sets out a gradual increase in fabric energy efficiency standards for residential developments. To do this, Merton Council will require all new build residential developments to comply with the minimum Fabric Energy Efficiency Standard (FEES) for Zero Carbon Homes defined by the Zero Carbon Hub in 2009.
- 2.3.9 The FEES, measured in kWh/m²/yr and available through the Government’s Standard Assessment Procedure (SAP), covers space heating and space cooling energy demand. The FEES allows design flexibility, takes into account building form, promotes innovation and delivers a specific level of dwelling performance. The FEES is much better at recognising efforts made to improve energy efficiency through building form and fabric specifications than a percentage improvement against Building Regulations, as demonstrated by Etude in 2017 [14].
- 2.3.10 The Zero Carbon Hub recommended two different performance levels for (a) blocks of flats and mid terrace houses, and (b) semi-detached, end of terrace and detached houses. This is because certain dwelling types with less exposed fabric relative to floor areas, such as mid-floor apartments, can achieve a lower energy space heating and cooling demand with a less challenging construction specification than other dwelling types.
- 2.3.11 To encourage a gradual shift in fabric efficiency, the Zero Carbon Hub defined an ‘Interim FEES’ for implementation from 2013 and a ‘Full FEES’ for implementation from 2016. These standards were never introduced through Building Regulations as a result of the national Zero Carbon Homes policy being scrapped. However, in 2017, Etude demonstrated that both the interim and full FEES were technically feasible and viable with a

range of combinations of form and fabric specification [14] and these standards are already being achieved by a number of schemes in Merton.

- 2.3.12 Merton Council will therefore require all new residential development to achieve at least the 'interim' FEES until the end of 2022 and at least the 'full' FEES from the start of 2023. In line with the recommendations from LETI and the CCC, Merton Council will also require all new build residential and non-residential development to achieve a space heating demand of 15kWh/m²/yr or less by 2025.
- 2.3.13 In the past 5 years, non-residential development in Merton has included everything from a football stadium, to a hotel development, to a mixed-use development comprising a community gym/ retail space, hostel and residential development. Given the range of non-residential developments that could come forward in Merton over the lifetime of this Local Plan, the council will work with applicants towards achieving this target on a case-by-case basis for any bespoke non-residential development.

Closing the gap between predicted and actual energy demand

- 2.3.14 It is widely accepted that there is a significant performance gap between the energy use and carbon emissions estimated at design stage and the actual in-use performance of buildings using the current Building Regulations Part L methodology, and that this needs to be addressed in order to genuinely make our buildings net-zero carbon [9] [11] [23]. The Part L methodology uses carbon emissions as the main performance metric which is dependent on the carbon factor of the electricity grid and does not necessarily reflect good operational performance. The UK Passivhaus Trust found that new build houses have an average performance gap of 40% between the actual overall energy use compared to the EPC modelling carried out at design stage [22] which means that buildings are emitting significantly more carbon than predicted using the SAP methodology.
- 2.3.15 Managing the performance gap and ensuring good design is particularly important with the roll-out of low carbon heating systems which are much more sensitive to building heat losses and system inefficiencies than traditional gas heating systems [10].
- 2.3.16 In addition, current Building Regulations (2021) do not address unregulated emissions associated with cooking, white goods and other equipment which can represent up to 50% of a building's operational emissions [9]. Operational performance of buildings therefore cannot be verified using the Part L methodology. The CCC has highlighted the importance of improving building performance monitoring and focussing on 'as built' performance in order to close this performance gap which could deliver £70-260 in annual bill savings per household [11].

A new metric for measuring performance: Energy Use Intensity

- 2.3.17 LETI's Climate Emergency Design Guide and the UK Green Building Council's Net Zero Whole Life Carbon Roadmap, which set out a roadmap to net-zero carbon, both recommend the use of Energy Use Intensity (EUI) targets in regulations, policy and design decisions to drive energy efficiency [9] [24]. EUI is an annual measure of total energy consumed in a building which can be estimated at design stage and easily monitored in-use as energy bills are based on kWh of energy used by the building. It includes regulated (heating, hot water, cooling, ventilation and lighting) and unregulated (plug loads and equipment) energy [9].
- 2.3.18 In order to improve our understanding of energy demand and drive more energy efficient design of buildings, Merton Council requires applicants for all developments resulting in the creation of 1 or more dwellings or 500sqm or more non-residential GIA, to determine their anticipated EUI, at planning and pre-occupation stage. Applicants for Major Developments will need to calculate the anticipated regulated and unregulated energy demand, and combined EUI, using the Chartered Institute of Building Service Engineers (CIBSE) TM54 methodology, Passive House Planning Package (PHPP) methodology or equivalent, or successor methodologies¹³. Minor residential schemes resulting in the creation of one or more dwellings will need to estimate the expected regulated and unregulated energy demand, and combined EUI, using the Part L methodology or equivalent, or successor methodologies.
- 2.3.19 In addition, all Major Developments are required to monitor and report actual operational energy performance for at least five years post-occupancy in line with policy SI 2 in the London Plan 2021 and the GLA's 'Be Seen' Energy Monitoring Guidance 2020, or equivalent.
- 2.3.20 In 2019, Currie and Brown also recommended that absolute performance targets are used to reduce energy demand (peak demand in particular) in order to reward energy efficient designs and minimise running costs and pressures on the national grid [10].
- 2.3.21 In their Climate Emergency Design Guide, LETI identified energy consumption targets for four building typologies consistent with achieving national net-zero carbon targets; LETI concluded that all new build development should be designed to achieve these standards by 2025 [9]:
- a. Small scale residential** – reducing EUI to 35 kWh/m²/yr in GIA excluding renewable energy contribution, and reducing space heating demand to 15 kWh/m²/yr.

¹³ These methodologies enable more accurate determination of the anticipated energy demand and carbon emissions by considering factors which impact on a building's energy performance including expected occupancy and use, and calculate unregulated loads [41]. These methodologies can also be used to verify the performance of the constructed building in operation, which is not possible with Building Regulation Part L percentage reductions.

b. Medium and large scale residential – reducing EUI to 35 kWh/m²/yr in GIA excluding renewable energy contribution, and reducing space heating demand to 15 kWh/m²/yr.

c. Commercial offices – reducing EUI to 55 kWh/m²/yr in GIA excluding renewable energy contribution, and reducing space heating demand to 15 kWh/m²/yr.

d. Schools - reducing EUI to 65 kWh/m²/yr in GIA excluding renewable energy contribution, and reducing space heating demand to 15 kWh/m²/yr.

2.3.22 In 2022/2023 Etude et al. modelled several building typologies to identify the following Energy Use Intensity benchmarks for a range of development types for a consortium of 18 London boroughs including Merton [51]:

a. Residential – 35 kWh/m²/yr

b. Student or key worker accommodation, care homes, extra care homes - 35 kWh/m²/yr

c. Warehouses and light industrial units – 35 kWh/m²/yr

d. Schools - 65 kWh/m²/yr

e. Offices, Retail, HE teaching facilities, GP surgeries – 70 kWh/m²/yr

f. Hotels - 160 kWh/m²/yr

2.3.23 Merton Council expects all new development to make all reasonable but commercially prudent endeavours to achieve these EUI and space heating demand benchmarks in demonstrating that it has made the fullest contribution to minimising energy use in accordance with Policy CC2.3. In doing so, developments would help to tackle fuel poverty and lead the way in decarbonising Merton in a manner that future-proofs its new building stock.

2.3.24 Developments are also encouraged to adopt recognised and successful fabric first approaches such as Passivhaus which is seen as the most stringent low 'energy in use' standard and is consistent with LETI's Climate Emergency Design Guide. This standard also relies on a more accurate energy demand assessment methodology using the Passive House Planning Package (PHPP).

Policy CC2.4 Low Carbon Energy

1. All proposed developments within the borough must demonstrate that they have made the fullest contribution to supplying energy efficiently and cleanly, and maximising renewable and low carbon energy generation, storage and use, through the deployment of appropriately selected, sized and sited technologies.
2. This will be achieved by requiring:
 - a. All new development to use low carbon heat.
 - b. All development proposals to demonstrate in the energy statement:
 - i. How the proposal has made the best potential use of roof space to maximise local renewable and low carbon electricity and/or heat generation – 100% of energy demand should be met by renewable energy generation on site wherever possible;
 - ii. How appropriate roof spaces have been utilised to maximise the delivery of multi-functional benefits (e.g. co-location of renewable energy and green, brown or blue infrastructure);
 - iii. How demand-side response has been incorporated, specifically through the installation of smart meters, minimising peak energy demand and promoting short term energy storage;
 - iv. How the proposal has ensured efficient generation of low carbon energy on site; any developments proposing to use heat pumps to demonstrate that these are good quality and achieve a minimum standard of efficiency; and
 - v. How all Major Development proposals located within identified heat network opportunity areas have utilised decentralised energy, or are enabled for connection to current or future district heat networks, unless it is demonstrated that it is not technically feasible to do so.

Supporting text

- 2.4.1 In order to have net-zero carbon emissions, once energy demand has been minimised, the remaining energy we use to power and heat our buildings will need to be generated from clean, low carbon and renewable sources [9].

The decarbonisation of heat

- 2.4.2 Low carbon heat is an essential component of our roadmap to net-zero carbon given that heat accounts for a third of the UK's greenhouse gas emissions [11] [21]. BEIS' Clean Growth Strategy emphasized that a fundamental shift away from fossil fuels for heating is required, alongside reductions in energy demand through energy efficiency [27]. In 2015,

the Energy Technologies Institute estimated that 20,000 households per week would need to be switched from gas to low carbon heating between 2020 and 2050 in order to bring emissions from the UK's existing housing stock to near zero carbon [28].

- 2.4.3 98% of homes in Merton use gas as their primary source of heating. All buildings in Merton must be gas free by 2050 in order to achieve our carbon reduction target, unless the Government plan to supply a low carbon gas through the gas grid [1]. There is increasing interest in the use of hydrogen and biomethane as low carbon alternatives to gas [27], but insufficient evidence is currently available to demonstrate that either of these are credible options for wide-scale decarbonisation of heat in the short term [29] [30] [12] [31]¹⁴.
- 2.4.4 Low carbon heating generally requires different space heating design standards to gas heating as the former tends to operate most effectively using a low temperature system whereas the latter operates at high temperatures [10]. A building typically has a lifespan longer than 30 years, so any new building which is designed and built to use a high temperature heating system will require retrofitting to move to a low carbon system before 2050.
- 2.4.5 In their 2019 study [10] on the costs and benefits of tighter energy efficiency standards, Currie & Brown demonstrated that delayed action in decarbonising heat would have a significant carbon impact: each year of delay in adopting lower-carbon heat technologies could result in several million tonnes of avoidable carbon emissions. They found that a home built to use gas heating in 2020 which is retrofitted to use a heat pump in 2030 can be expected to emit over three times more carbon over 60 years than if the heat pump was installed from the start, as the house would have originally been built to different space heating design standards.
- 2.4.6 The costs of installing low carbon heat as a retrofit are also between three and ten times higher than delivering them in a new building [10]. The Clean Growth Strategy highlighted the importance of ensuring that all new homes can accommodate low carbon heating in order to avoid the need for expensive retrofit further down the line. In their 'UK Housing: Fit for the Future?' report (2019), the CCC concluded that no new homes should be connected to the gas grid from 2025 at the latest, with ultra-low energy homes using low carbon heat instead [11].
- 2.4.7 In order to drive the decarbonisation of heat in Merton and minimise the retrofit burden, Merton Council requires all new development to use low carbon heat efficiently. Any development that proposes to use gas-powered systems will need to provide robust justification to satisfy Merton Council that low or zero carbon systems cannot be used, to

¹⁴ There currently remains significant uncertainty around the cost and practicality of repurposing the gas grid to deliver hydrogen from low carbon sources, particularly in terms of consumer acceptability and the cost of safely distributing hydrogen to end-users [46] [45]. Biomethane could be used to reduce carbon emissions from the gas grid, but no studies have suggested that this could fully replace the role of natural gas at its current levels of use due to the relatively small available resource and its potential value elsewhere in the energy system [21, 28].

set out how the development has been future-proofed to achieve net-zero carbon by 2050, and to demonstrate that the gas-powered system is credibly being used as a stepping stone towards this objective.

The electrification of heat

- 2.4.8 The electrification of heat will likely play a major role in decarbonising heat. As well as becoming a lower carbon energy source with the decarbonisation of the national grid, electricity also provides air quality benefits which are particularly important in a London borough [12]. There are a range of technologies that can convert electricity into heat including heat pumps and direct electric heating systems.
- 2.4.9 Proposals using direct electric heat will only be deemed acceptable if the developer can demonstrate, through Passivhaus certification or equivalent, that energy use has been significantly reduced by achieving ultra-high fabric efficiency [12]. This is to ensure that direct electric heating systems do not result in high energy bills for future residents, and to mitigate the risk of fuel poverty.
- 2.4.10 Heat pumps¹⁵ are likely to play a growing role in the delivery of low carbon heat in London, as part of both low carbon heat networks and individual building heating systems [29]. Well-designed, installed and maintained heat pumps can be very energy efficient and a way of harnessing waste heat. Heat pumps typically achieve efficiencies between 260 and 320% [29], whereas direct electric systems and gas boilers typically operate between 80 and 100% efficiency [21]. In addition, heat pumps use low flow temperature and large emitters to spread heating throughout the day, resulting in reduced peak heating demand compared to gas boilers and direct electric systems which operate when heat is desired [21]. Heat pumps also have the benefit of being smart grid ready which could enable demand-side response.
- 2.4.11 Heat pumps are already a lower carbon system than gas boilers, and the carbon factor for grid electricity is expected to decrease further as more renewable energy is produced, while the carbon content of gas is likely to remain the same unless low carbon gases are introduced to the gas grid [12]. Heat pumps also provide air quality benefits given that they do not produce any direct emissions on site.
- 2.4.12 Low-carbon heat using a heat pump is cost effective when built into new homes from 2021 and should not increase running costs if the system is well designed, installed and operated, particularly in well-insulated buildings [10]. Heat pump deployment in new build properties will also play an important role in helping develop the heat pump markets and supply chains required to electrify heat in our existing building stock [30].

¹⁵ A heat pump uses electricity to increase the temperature of a low temperature heat source (e.g. air, water or ground).

- 2.4.13 However, inappropriate design, installation or operation of heat pumps can result in high energy costs and increased peak electricity demand. In order to mitigate impacts on the electricity grid and operating costs, electrical heating systems must be highly efficient and paired with high fabric efficiency [9] [29]; high performance building fabric is critical to enable the electrification of heat while keeping costs low for future residents. All new development should also be designed to harness heat at low temperatures given that heat pumps tend to operate significantly more efficiently at lower temperatures and waste heat sources are also typically at lower temperatures [9].
- 2.4.14 Where heat pumps are proposed, developments will need to demonstrate that efficiencies have been maximised through the proposed technology and heating system. A high specification of energy efficiency (coefficient of performance) will be expected to ensure the system works efficiently and reduces running costs and peak electricity demand. UKPN has indicated that they will actively plan for additional demand due to heat pumps, provided they have early visibility of any deployment plans, and are notified of installations on their networks [29].
- 2.4.15 Where heat pumps are proposed developers will also need to ensure that living conditions of existing and future occupiers of the proposed development and neighbouring properties are not materially harmed in terms of outlook, noise or vibrations in line with Design Policies D12.3 part-3g and D12.4 part-2e, and Pollution Policy P15.10.

Decentralised energy

- 2.4.16 The use of decentralised energy and local secondary heat sources is expected to play a significant part in reducing emissions from buildings in London [32]. All Major Development proposals will be expected to comply with London Plan policies on decentralised energy networks and decentralised energy.
- 2.4.17 The council will require all proposed Major Development and regeneration schemes within any identified heat network opportunity areas to fully explore and utilise decentralised energy, subject to technical and financial viability. Heat-mapping and feasibility studies undertaken by AECOM in 2017 [33]/2018 [34] identified two district heat network opportunity areas in Merton linked to two major regeneration schemes: Morden town centre and South Wimbledon (High Path estate).
- 2.4.18 Any proposals to develop or connect to a site-wide or district heat network will need to demonstrate compliance with all Merton's climate change policies, be future-proofed and demonstrate that heat losses have been minimised. Given that the carbon savings from gas engine combined heat and power (CHP) systems are declining due to the decarbonisation of the national electricity grid, and increasing evidence of adverse air quality impacts, developers will be required to use low and zero carbon heat sources and existing heat networks will need to be decarbonised [32].

Renewable energy generation

- 2.4.19 The use of renewable and low-carbon micro-generation technologies (e.g. solar photovoltaic panels, solar thermal and air source heat pumps) is now a viable, cost-effective and practical approach to ensuring developments can achieve their on-site carbon emissions requirements alongside low carbon heat and high energy efficiency, and will play a crucial role in achieving our net-zero carbon target [27] [12] [9].
- 2.4.20 In order to genuinely operate at net-zero operational carbon, all buildings must be 100% powered by renewables [9]. As renewable energy generation increases in the UK, grid electricity will continue to decarbonise [8]. However, electricity demand is expected to increase across London as a result of population growth, the electrification of heat and increased uptake of electric vehicles [32]. In order to limit pressure on the national electricity grid, contribute to the decarbonisation of grid electricity (if a development feeds back to the grid), and ultimately build a more resilient local energy supply, the council requires all development to demonstrate that on-site renewable energy generation has been maximised and that 100% of energy demand is met through on-site renewable energy generation wherever possible. Developers will need to compare their anticipated Energy Use Intensity (EUI)¹⁶ to the amount of renewable energy expected to be generated on site annually, and these will be expected to match where feasible.
- 2.4.21 Developments in conservation areas or involving heritage assets need to provide careful consideration of how sustainable energy measures may be incorporated without adversely impacting on the character, function and preservation of a specific area or asset, in accordance with the policies on design in this Local Plan. In such circumstances, development proposals should not presume that a viable sustainable solution cannot be provided. Where necessary, Merton will determine whether the provision of sustainability measures causes any adverse impact with the asset or area, and will prioritise safeguarding of the asset, as appropriate.

Demand-side response and energy storage

- 2.4.22 Demand-side response involves changing how and when electricity is used to minimise peak energy demand. Demand-side response will play an important role in embedding flexibility in our energy systems, improving the utilisation of intermittent low carbon energy generation, and ensuring that energy supply always meets demand whilst reducing pressure on the national grid [35].
- 2.4.23 Energy storage (heat and battery storage) and flexibility will need to be maximised to reduce energy use and pressure on the national grid at peak times, and ensure that variable renewable energy supply can match electricity demand at all times [11] [36] [9].

¹⁶ See Policy CC2.3 *minimising energy use* for more details.

Advancements in energy storage technology have meant that energy storage is now feasible at individual domestic level, and costs are predicted to continue to fall [10].

- 2.4.24 The council therefore requires all development to demonstrate that demand-side response has been considered and maximised alongside renewable energy generation.

Policy CC2.5 Minimising Waste and Promoting a Circular Economy

1. All development proposals should adopt a circular economy approach to building design and construction, and be designed for durability, flexibility and easy disassembly, to reduce waste, to keep materials and products in use for as long as possible, and to minimise embodied carbon.
2. This will be achieved by requiring:

All development:

- a. Where existing buildings are on site, to prioritise their reuse and retrofit wherever possible before considering the design of new buildings.
- b. To ensure resource efficiency and reduce embodied carbon emissions by sourcing and prioritising materials, and designing building shapes and forms, that can easily be maintained, repaired and renewed across the development lifetime.
- c. To minimise the environmental impact of materials by specifying sustainably-sourced, low impact and re-used or recycled materials; this should include identifying opportunities for the retention and reuse of existing materials on site (e.g. re-using demolition material on site). Materials should be locally-sourced wherever possible to minimise transport emissions.

All development resulting in the creation of 30 or more dwellings or 1000sqm or more non-residential GIA, and all development proposing to demolish and rebuild a single dwelling:

- d. To undertake a Whole Life-Cycle Carbon assessment proportionate to the scale of development and demonstrate actions taken to reduce life-cycle carbon emissions.

Supporting text

Embodied carbon and a circular economy

- 2.5.1 The construction of a development uses energy and resources which represent its embodied carbon emissions. Of the annual carbon emissions associated with the UK building stock (existing and new build) 20% is related to the embodied emissions associated with new construction [9]. Climate change policies relating to sustainable design have traditionally focused on reducing operational carbon emissions. However, as buildings become more energy efficient and energy generation is decarbonised, the proportion of operational emissions will significantly reduce and embodied carbon will represent a higher proportion of whole life-cycle carbon emissions. Embodied carbon can represent 40-70% of whole life-cycle carbon emissions in a new low carbon building [9].

- 2.5.2 A circular economy is one that seeks to promote waste minimisation by moving from a more traditional linear model of resource use, consumption and disposal, to one that promotes long-term sustained use, reuse and recycling. Merton is supportive of the move towards a more circular economy. As such, circular economy principles should be embedded across all facets of the development lifecycle - from concept and design to build-out and occupation/ use, in order to increase resource efficiency, minimise operational and embodied carbon emissions, and minimise residual waste, in line with Section R2 of the National Design Codes 'Careful selection of materials and construction techniques' [37].
- 2.5.3 Circular economy opportunities might include using materials with a lower embodied carbon (e.g. timber rather than concrete frame – using timber also provides an opportunity to sequester carbon), using more recycled content in the materials and finding other ways to enhance recovery and recyclability (e.g. reinforcement free concrete). Mechanical and electrical services will typically need to be replaced every 20 years and should therefore be designed to allow easy recovery, reconditioning and reuse whilst also optimising for performance and carbon emissions. Encouraging a 'fabric first' approach to building design can also minimise mechanical plant and services in favour of natural ventilation.
- 2.5.4 In 2020, LETI identified the following best practice upfront embodied carbon targets for buildings designed in 2020 and 2030 [9]:
- a. Residential**
 - Best practice 2020 <500kgCO₂/m²
 - Best practice 2030 <300kgCO₂/m²
 - b. Non-residential**
 - Best practice 2020 <600kgCO₂/m²
 - Best practice 2030 <350kgCO₂/m²
- 2.5.5 The GLA's Whole Life-Cycle Carbon Assessments guidance also provides benchmarks and aspirational benchmarks for different development types.
- 2.5.6 Embodied carbon benchmarks and targets are a developing knowledge area and are expected to be refined over the coming years. LETI has been consulting with industry groups including RIBA, CIBSE, IStructE, the GLA and the Whole Life Carbon Network to align definitions, scopes, measurement methodologies and targets [38].
- 2.5.7 All new build development will be expected to endeavour to minimise embodied carbon in line with best practice targets contained within the latest industry guidance.
- 2.5.8 All applications that are referable to the Mayor of London will need to submit Circular Economy Statements that have been prepared in accordance with the GLA's Circular Economy Statement Guidance.

Whole life-cycle carbon emissions

- 2.5.9 A whole life-cycle carbon approach which captures a building's operational (regulated and unregulated) and embodied emissions, as well as emissions associated with the maintenance and disassembly and disposal of the development, is required to fully understand the carbon impact of a development. Minimising whole life-cycle carbon emissions through careful and considered use of natural and renewable resources, promoting sustainable construction and minimising energy use are key considerations in securing a sustainable, low carbon future for Merton.
- 2.5.10 The Mayor requires all referable schemes to undertake a Whole Life-Cycle Carbon Assessment in line with the GLA's Whole Life-Cycle Carbon Assessment Guidance 2020, or equivalent. All Major Developments are also encouraged to undertake whole-life cycle carbon assessments under the London Plan. In order to drive a reduction in whole life-cycle carbon emissions in Merton's building stock and to develop a better understanding of whole life-cycle carbon emissions associated with development in the borough, Merton Council will require all schemes resulting in the creation of 30 or more dwellings or 1000sqm or more non-residential GIA to undertake a Whole Life-Cycle Carbon Assessment.
- 2.5.11 Historically, Merton has received a large number of applications for the substantial or total demolition of a single dwelling house and rebuild as a single dwelling. Such proposals are typically driven by design, intensification or lifestyle rather than on the grounds of structural instability.
- 2.5.12 All such proposals outside of structural instability are considered a highly inefficient use of resources and materials and contrary to the principles of sustainable development and the circular economy. Even where proposals are deemed to result in an improvement of 'in use' energy consumption, the embodied carbon footprint of whole scale demolition and rebuild means that any environmental benefits are unlikely to be realised in the long term.
- 2.5.13 The council therefore requires all proposals to demolish and rebuild a single dwelling to submit a Whole Life-cycle Carbon Assessment proportionate to the scale of development. Developers will be required to demonstrate that the development has been designed and delivered in accordance with the principles of a circular economy to minimise embodied carbon.
- 2.5.14 This policy will also apply in cases where a substantial amount, but not all, of the original building is demolished and rebuilt (for example, where the original façade is required to be retained).

Policy CC2.6 Sustainable Design Standards

1. Merton Council will seek high standards of sustainable design and construction from new development, change of use, conversions and refurbishments to ensure that all development makes effective use of resources and materials, minimises water use, and assists in meeting local and national carbon reduction targets.
2. This will be achieved by:
 - a. Requiring all development to demonstrate that the use of mains water has been minimised by incorporating measures such as smart metering, water saving and recycling measures, including retrofitting where appropriate.
 - b. Requiring all Major Developments and high water use developments to include water saving measures such as rainwater harvesting and greywater recycling to reduce mains water consumption.

Residential development:

- c. Requiring all residential development to meet a minimum internal water efficiency standard of 105 litres per person per day, as set out in Building Regulations Part G or equivalent.
- d. Requiring all conversions and changes to the use of existing buildings resulting in the creation of 10 or more new dwellings to achieve a minimum BREEAM Domestic Refurbishment rating of 'Excellent' or equivalent.

Non-residential development:

- e. Requiring all new build non-residential development of 1,000sqm GIA and above to achieve a minimum of BREEAM Non-domestic New Construction 'Excellent' standard or equivalent.
- f. Requiring all conversions and changes of use to non-residential uses of 1,000sqm GIA and above to achieve a minimum of BREEAM Non-domestic Refurbishment and Fit-out 'Excellent' standard or equivalent.

Supporting text

BREEAM

- 2.6.1 The principles of sustainable design and construction are designed to be holistic and are more wide-ranging than energy performance alone. National sustainable design and construction standards such as BREEAM ensure that a development's full impact on the environment, including water use, transport and land use and ecology, as well as energy use and waste are considered and addressed. Using these standards or any subsequently adopted set of national sustainable construction standards equivalent to those set out in the

policy, will assist in the delivery of a number of the policies covered in the Local Plan including the Transport, Green Infrastructure and Climate Change policies.

- 2.6.2 The highest standards of sustainable design and construction should be applied to improve the environmental performance of new development. Development proposals must demonstrate that sustainable design standards are integral to the proposal, including its construction and operation, and ensure that they are considered at the beginning of the design process.
- 2.6.3 The BREEAM Domestic Refurbishment standard provides a recognised scheme and methodology by which conversions and change of use can demonstrate their adherence to sustainable design and construction methodologies. Merton Council therefore requires all Major Development resulting in the creation of 10 or more new dwellings through the conversion or change of use of existing buildings to achieve a minimum BREEAM Domestic Refurbishment rating of 'Excellent' or equivalent. In particular, this scheme will help drive energy efficiency improvements across Merton's existing building stock through its post-refurbishment Energy Efficiency Rating requirements.
- 2.6.4 Merton Council also requires all Major Development of 1,000sqm or more non-residential GIA (both new and existing buildings) to achieve BREEAM 'Excellent' standard or equivalent.
- 2.6.5 Proportionally, Merton receives a large number of minor development applications which involve the conversion and change of use of existing buildings to create new dwellings. In order to make our housing fit for the future, existing homes must be made low-carbon, low-energy and resilient to a changing climate [11] through the uptake of measures including:
 - a. Improved insulation in lofts, walls and floors;
 - b. Double or triple glazing windows;
 - c. Low-carbon heating;
 - d. Draught proofing;
 - e. Highly energy efficient appliances;
 - f. Highly water efficient devices;
 - g. Passive cooling measures such as shading and ventilation;
 - h. Green space to reduce the risks of flooding and overheating;
 - i. Improved flood resilience and resistance.

Minimising water use

- 2.6.6 According to Waterwise, the UK has less available water per person than most other European countries [39]. London is drier than Istanbul, and the south-east of England has less water available per person than the Sudan and Syria. London has lower rainfall than the national average while having an extremely high population density [40].

- 2.6.7 This combination of limited water resources and high demand has resulted in the Environment Agency designating the Thames Water region to be “seriously water stressed” [41]. This trend is very likely to be exacerbated by future changes in climate and population growth [42].
- 2.6.8 All development must therefore be designed to be water efficient and reduce water consumption. Merton Council requires all development to demonstrate that the use of mains water has been minimised by incorporating measures such as smart metering, water saving and recycling measures, and retrofitting water efficiency measures where appropriate, to help achieve lower water consumption rates and to maximise future-proofing.
- 2.6.9 All residential schemes will be required to demonstrate that internal water usage rates of less than 105 litres per person per day have been achieved. All non-residential development of 1,000sqm GIA and above will be expected to achieve at least the BREEAM Excellent water-efficiency credits.
- 2.6.10 All Major Developments and high water use developments, such as hotels, hostels and student housing, will be expected to include water saving measures such as rainwater harvesting and greywater recycling to achieve lower water consumption rates.
- 2.6.11 New development, conversions and change of use of all sizes should seek new, innovative and more robust approaches to achieving a high standard of sustainable design and construction.

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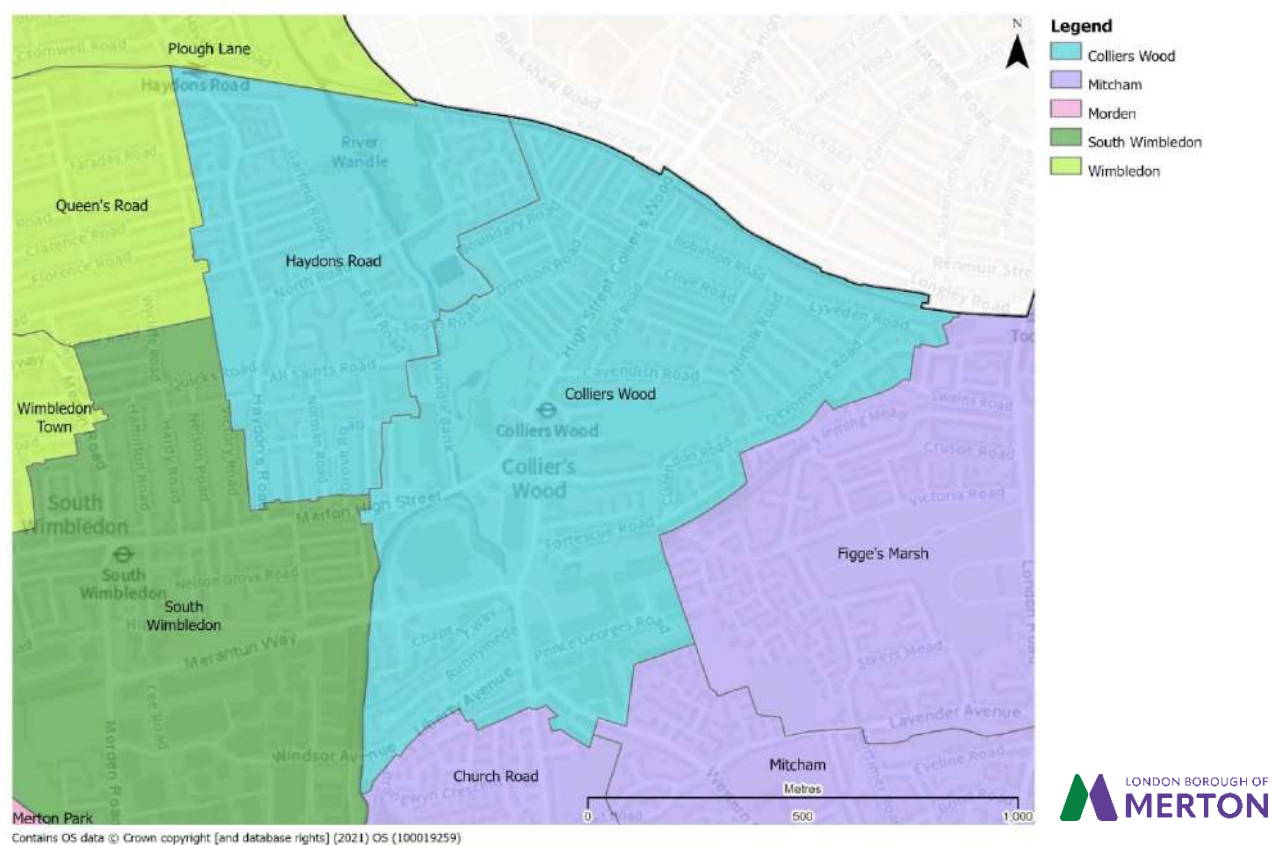
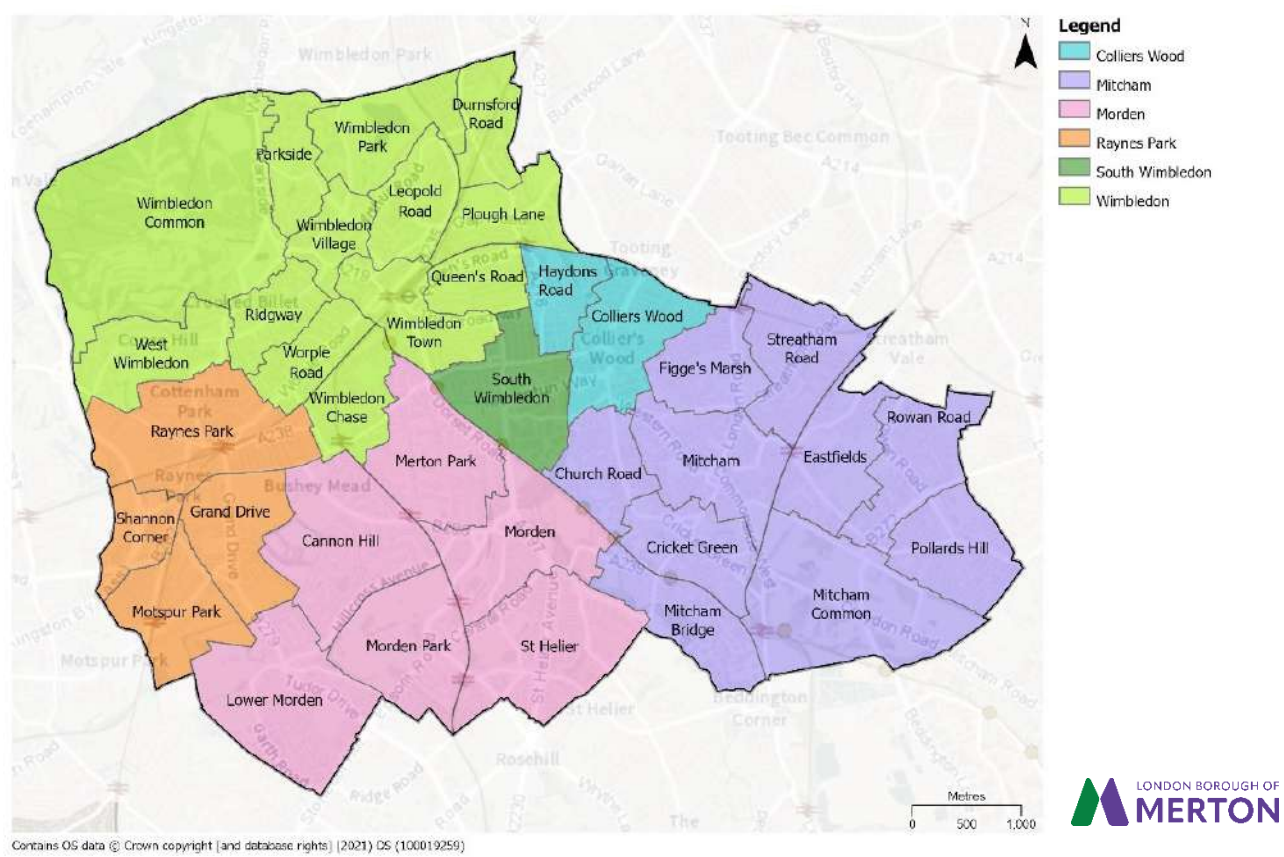
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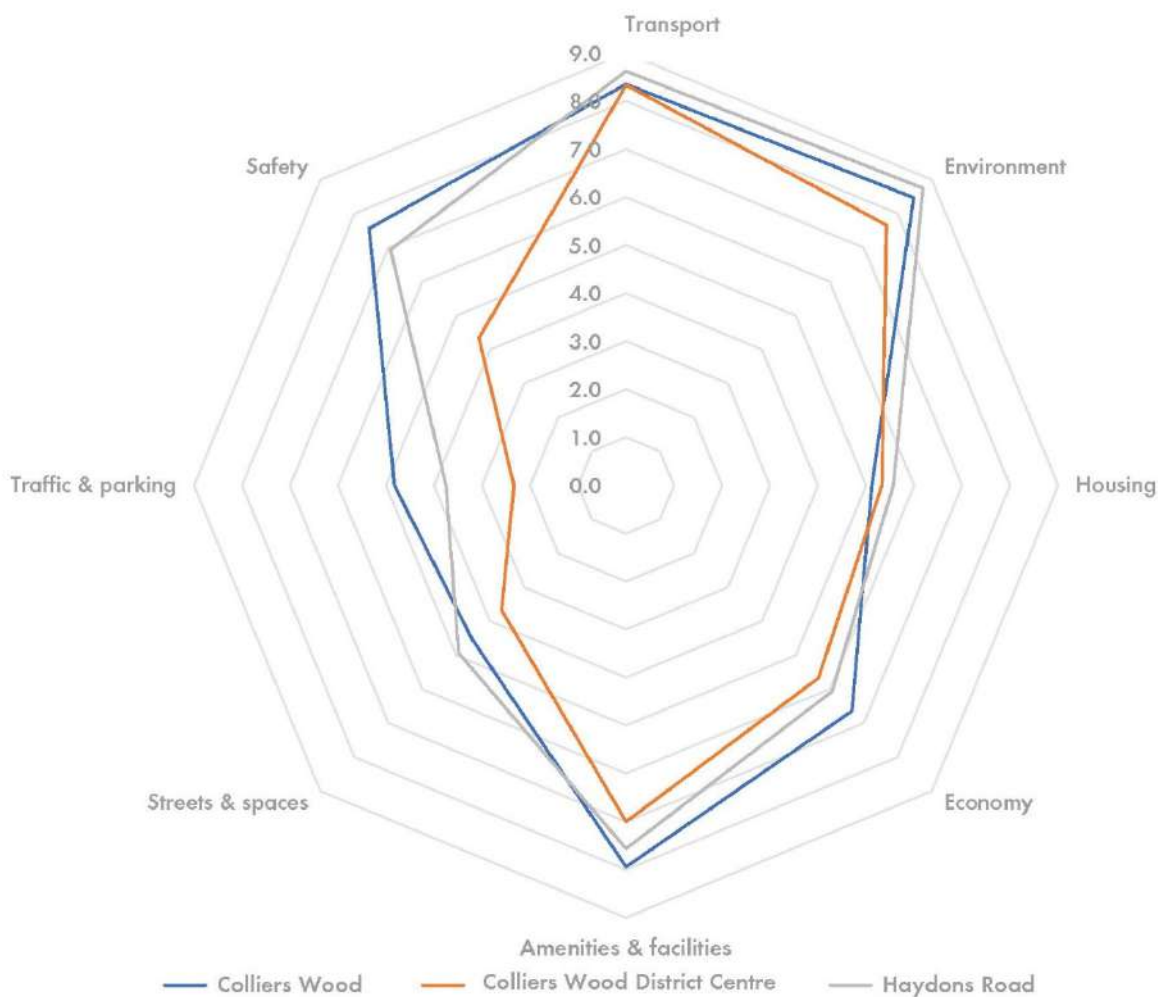


Chapter 03. **Colliers Wood**



Place profile: Colliers Wood

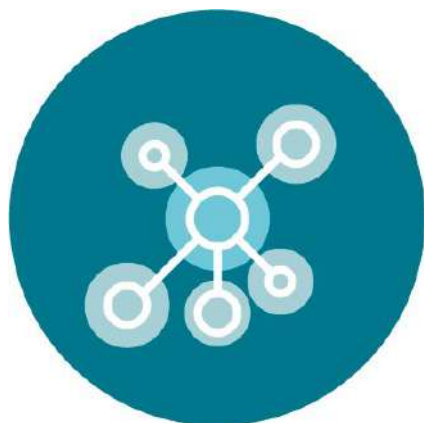
As part of the borough’s ongoing Character Study, 415 Merton residents took part in this survey, of which 37 people lived in Colliers Wood. The diagram below highlights how people felt about their neighbourhood based on a series of questions asked. This work was also used to inform the Borough Character Study 2021.



Results from residents of Colliers Wood rating their neighbourhood

Key objectives: Colliers Wood

The following objectives provide an overarching vision for Colliers Wood.



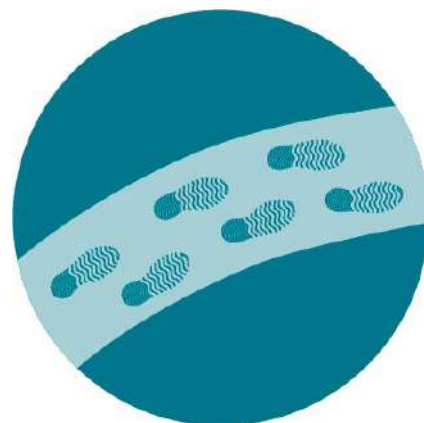
Create a new District Centre

Building on the improvements led by 'Connecting Colliers Wood', support the redevelopment of retail outlets to create new streets and attractive public spaces providing homes above shops, and help make Colliers Wood easier to navigate for pedestrians and cyclists.



Better access to heritage

Improve access to heritage assets, conserving and enhancing archaeological sites and recognising their positive contribution to regeneration and new development.



Promote active travel

Support improvements to the Wandle Trail and other transport infrastructure that will help to reduce road congestion and improve the public realm, particularly for pedestrians and cyclists.

Character: Colliers Wood

These photos illustrate the diverse character found across Colliers Wood.





Policy N3.1 Colliers Wood

1. To create a thriving and attractive District Centre at Colliers Wood. The council's strategy for Colliers Wood is:

Colliers Wood town centre

- a. To treat Colliers Wood as a District Centre in the town centre hierarchy.
- b. To build on the improvements led by "Connecting Colliers Wood" by requiring development to help create coherent spaces of high-quality design, reconfiguring the centre to create a focus and making the environment more attractive to town centre users, prioritising pedestrians and cyclists.
- c. To support the redevelopment of single or two storey retail outlets to create new streets and public spaces, provide homes above shops, and help make Colliers Wood easier to navigate and move around.
- d. To support a variety of different sized shop units and town centre uses to provide local services and encourage resilience.
- e. To work with the Environment Agency, the GLA (Greater London Authority), Thames Water and landowners to reduce flood risk and to explore viable and appropriate flood mitigation measures complementary with improving the public realm, particularly for pedestrians and cyclists.
- f. To improve access to heritage assets, including Merton Priory, Merton Abbey Mills and the Wandle Valley Conservation Area, conserving and enhancing archaeological sites and recognising their positive contribution to regeneration and new development.

Surrounding area of Colliers Wood

- g. To support development which helps to optimise housing potential and that maximises opportunities for the use of sustainable modes of travel in this highly accessible location, whilst managing vehicle use, to reduce impacts on the road network.

- h. To improve the public realm in accordance with the Healthy Streets Approach and providing an improved network of safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle routes that connect to local areas and beyond, including via the Wandle Trail and Cycle Superhighway 7.
- i. To work with the Environment Agency, Thames Water, landowners and others to reduce flood risk and to explore viable and appropriate flood mitigation measures complementary with improving the public realm.
- j. To support improvements to the Prince Georges business area.

Supporting text

- 3.1.1. Colliers Wood, as a town centre, has many unique assets including Merton Priory, the Wandle Park and a vibrant market at Merton Abbey Mills.
- 3.1.2. The town centre is situated along the River Wandle, linked by the Wandle Trail and is at the heart of the Wandle Valley Regional Park.
- 3.1.3. It has excellent public transport and road links. Colliers Wood underground station and the frequent bus services give residents, visitors and workers a variety of travel options with excellent Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL). Colliers Wood is situated on the A24 road and is the start of the Mayor of London's Cycle Superhighway 7, an 8.5-mile cycle trail starting from Colliers Wood to the City of London.
- 3.1.4. The past 10 years has seen significant investment in Colliers Wood which has transformed the look and feel of the town centre, particularly at the point of arrival from the underground station. The catalyst was the redevelopment of Britannia Point, (formerly the Brown and Root building, winner of London's Ugliest Building vote) and over £3 million investment in "Connecting Colliers Wood" by the Mayor of London, Transport for London, Merton Council and developers.
- 3.1.5. Colliers Wood now has a new public square at the heart of the town centre, a new purpose-built library, shopfront improvements, nearly 300 new homes and better connections to the surrounding neighbourhoods and the wider Wandle Valley Regional Park, particularly at the Baltic Close entrance to the Wandle Park.

- 3.1.6. Improvements to the street scene, pedestrian crossings and junction improvements have provided better conditions for cyclists and pedestrians while smoothing the flow of traffic passing through the town centre, making Colliers Wood a safer place to walk and cycle to, and around. A new health centre is being developed.
- 3.1.7. There are some key sites within Colliers Wood which still feel disconnected from the Colliers Wood area and from each other, despite being adjacent to or within easy walking distance of each other. Consultees to Stage 1 Local Plan identified Sainsbury's Supersaver, Priory Retail Park and the Tandem Centre as unattractive, inward-looking, lacking in recent investment, car-dominated; they also identified the pavements and public realm along Merantun Way as in need of similar investment to encourage walking and cycling and improve the links between the sites.
- 3.1.8. These three sites at Sainsbury's Supersaver, Priory Retail Park and the Tandem Centre are in single freeholds but with multiple tenancies. These three sites currently support a significant number of jobs and businesses and provide town centre shops and services. However, should redevelopment opportunities come up within the lifetime of this Plan, the council would strongly support more efficient use of these sites, continuing to support shops, services and business floorspace and providing new homes on upper floors, where practicable. Creating more traditional street formats within these sites – with active frontages on the ground floor and offices or flats above shops – would make more efficient use of valuable land and help make Colliers Wood easier to navigate. We will also support measures that improve public transport access, walking, cycling, air quality and help minimise road congestion, noise and excess traffic within Colliers Wood.
- 3.1.9. Merton supports the Mayor of London's proposal that Colliers Wood is part of the new London Plan's proposed Opportunity Area at "*Wimbledon / South Wimbledon / Colliers Wood*".

Colliers Wood as a District Centre

- 3.1.10. For the past five years, Colliers Wood has already functioned as a District Centre. It contains a broad mix of store sizes and formats, a variety of town centre uses (shops, markets, restaurants, theatre, visitor attractions, public space, restaurants, library, etc.) and, since the "Connecting Colliers Wood" investment, is now well integrated into the surrounding area. The

council is treating Colliers Wood town centre as a District Centre for planning purposes. The alternative would be for Colliers Wood to be considered an “out of centre” location in planning terms. In this circumstance, we would not be able to encourage new town centre uses in Colliers Wood as supporting large “out of centre” shops, offices and leisure development is contrary to the National Planning Policy Framework, the London Plan and Merton’s own planning policies.

- 3.1.11. Given the existing volume of retail floorspace in Colliers Wood and the changing nature of how we all shop, it is not the council's intention to significantly increase the quantity of retail offer in Colliers Wood but to encourage the provision of a mix of different sized premises and a wider range of business types (e.g. gyms, restaurants, social activities) to serve residents and support a more resilient town centre.

London’s Opportunity Area at Wimbledon / South Wimbledon / Colliers Wood

- 3.1.12. The London Plan has identified a new Opportunity Area in Merton directly including “*Wimbledon, Colliers Wood / South Wimbledon*”, with an indicative capacity for 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs.
- 3.1.13. Crossrail 2 construction has been delayed and if commenced, will not be finished until after 2036, therefore the benefits from over-station development in Wimbledon or development on sites that are currently safeguarded by Crossrail 2 will arise outside this Local Plan period.
- 3.1.14. However, there are opportunities outside the immediate Wimbledon area, in Colliers Wood, South Wimbledon and Morden, to work towards delivering the London Plan’s proposed Opportunity Area indicative figures for homes and jobs, even if the Crossrail 2 sites will not be realised within this Plan period.
- 3.1.15. The regeneration of Morden is proposed to deliver circa 2,000 new homes and another circa 2,000 homes will be delivered around South Wimbledon, mainly via estate regeneration during the lifetime of this plan. For jobs growth, South Wimbledon Business Area is already one of south London’s largest and most successful business areas (outside town centres) and we will continue to support this Strategic Industrial Location.
- 3.1.16. The primary location for business and jobs growth is Wimbledon town centre, which is an internationally recognised, highly accessible and most attractive location for office-based

business. There are clear opportunities for business space and jobs growth in Wimbledon town centre without Crossrail 2, for example along the Broadway, St George's Road and Worple Road. However, there are some significant sites (Wimbledon Bridge House, the area around Centre Court, Wimbledon Station and adjoining Alexandra Road, Dundonald Goods Yard) which are safeguarded for Crossrail 2 development, so won't provide significant new business space and job opportunities until Crossrail 2 is finishing beyond the 2030s.

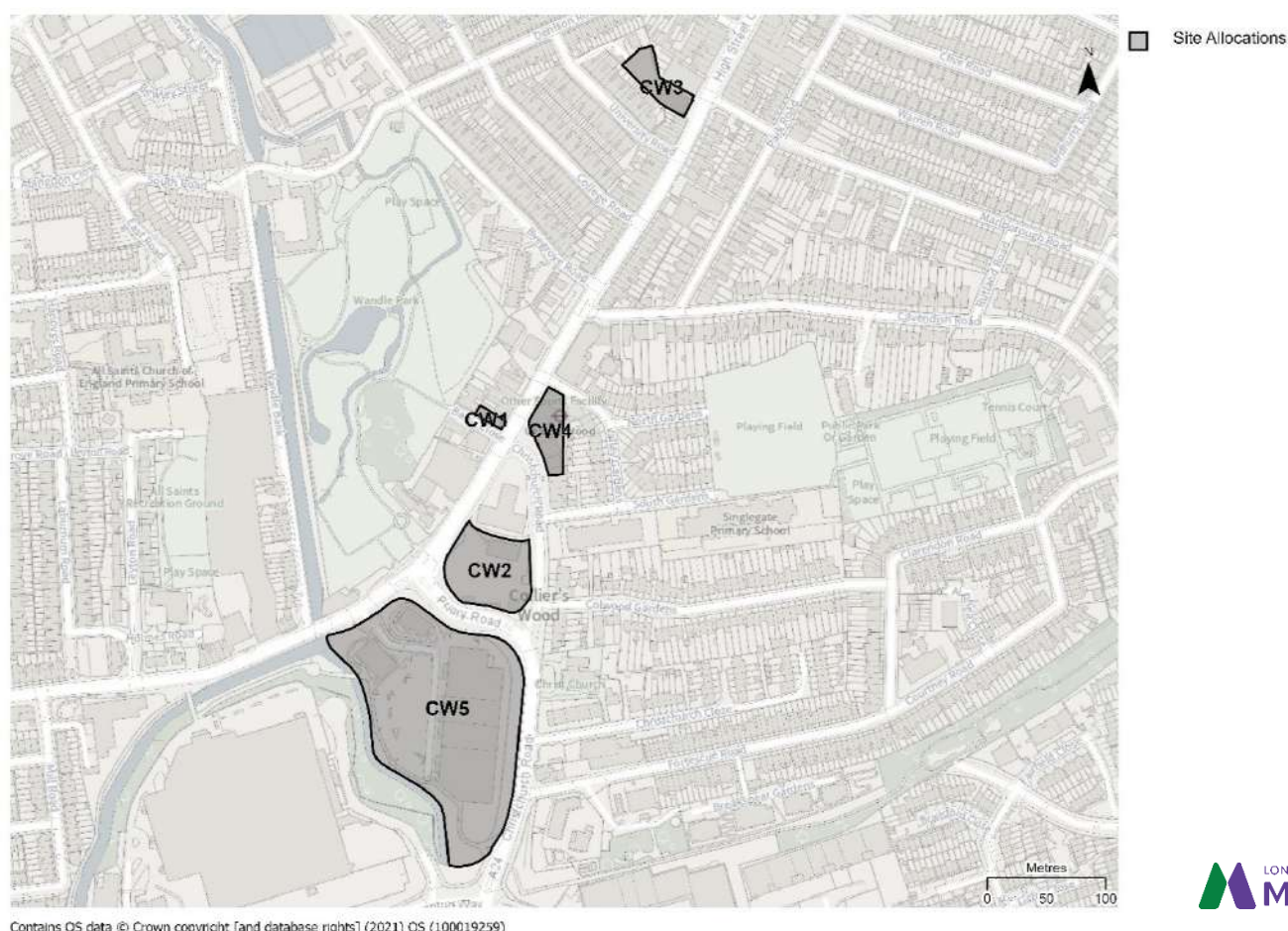
- 3.1.17. Colliers Wood has opportunities for new homes and jobs within the town centre. The town centre already supports a significant number of jobs in retailing and other town centre uses, and the council will continue to support these.
- 3.1.18. Site allocation CW2 may be an appropriate location to accommodate higher density development including tall buildings. A local Design Guide or Design Code, that provides a design-led approach to help optimise the capacity of the site, while ensuring that the final design reflects local character and design preferences, should be prepared, either by applicants or the council. New buildings must be designed, orientated and laid out within the site and within the context of nearby buildings and structures, to mitigate the potential for uncomfortable wind conditions at ground level, which would particularly affect pedestrians and cyclists. The National Design Guide and National Model Design Code will be used to guide decisions on any applications that may come forward in advance of the production of locally produced design guides or codes.
- 3.1.19. Locations sensitive to tall buildings include the historic environments of Wandle Park, Merton Abbey Mills and Merton Priory, where the potential impact on the significance and scale of the historic environment and open spaces, should be considered. For locations near to the edge of the town centre boundary, the sensitivity of low-rise residential neighbourhoods should be considered.
- 3.1.20. The heritage of the Wandle Valley is a particularly important part of the history of the borough and an important element of Merton's identity. Development proposals in Colliers Wood and its surrounds should strengthen the character and local distinctiveness of the area by playing a positive role in relation to the heritage assets, which include Merton Priory and the [Wandle Valley Conservation Area](#).
- 3.1.21. Currently, Colliers Wood and the surrounding neighbourhood are not considered attractive to

the office market. The creation of an attractive, permeable environment in central Colliers Wood, with a better street layout, a greater mix and a wider range of non-retail uses, could make Colliers Wood a more desirable destination for office-based businesses, including shared workspaces, in turn increasing the employment potential of the centre.

- 3.1.22. Environmental factors, particularly the risk of flooding, as identified in the Sustainability Appraisal and the [Strategic Flood Risk Assessment 2020](#), will need to be mitigated against before Colliers Wood can deliver to its full potential. Flood mitigation measures and any other environmental considerations will have to be economically viable and in line with the overall aim of creating a thriving and attractive town centre if they are to benefit the area. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 Infrastructure.

Site allocations

- 3.1.23. Site allocations are planning policies which apply to key potential development sites of strategic importance. Site allocations are needed to ensure that when a strategic site comes forward for redevelopment, it integrates well into its surroundings and contributes towards meeting strategic needs for new homes, jobs, public open space, public access routes, transport infrastructure and social infrastructure, such as health or education facilities.
- 3.1.24. Site allocations set out the land uses that must be provided as part of any redevelopment alongside other acceptable land uses that may be provided in addition to the required land uses. Any development proposal for a site allocation will be determined against planning policies (including the London Plan).



Site Cw1: Baltic Close 194-196 High Street Colliers Wood, SW19 2BN**Ward:** Colliers Wood**Site description:**

1. The site is a hardstanding area on the corner of High Street Colliers Wood and Baltic Close, a recently refurbished pedestrian and cycle route from High Street Colliers Wood to the Wandle Park. At the opposite side of Baltic Close to the southwest of the site is a three-storey public house (The Charles Holden). To the west of the site is a four-storey residential block (Oslo Court) with the Wandle Park beyond.
2. The High Street Colliers Wood frontage of the site is adjoined on the northern side by a three-storey shopping parade with shops at the ground level and flats above. The site is directly opposite Colliers Wood underground station. The site is close to the A24 which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN). The site is located 140m east of the River Wandle.

Site owner: Transport for London (TfL)**Site area:** 0.02ha**Existing uses:** Hard standing area – fenced off**Site allocation:** Residential and commercial mixed-use scheme**Site deliverability:** 0-5 years**Indicative site capacity (new homes):** 1- 4 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The Opportunity Area's indicative capacity for new homes and jobs, is 5,000 new homes and 6,000 new jobs. This site is expected to contribute to the OA (Opportunity Area) and future growth in Merton that is socially and economically inclusive and environmentally green and sustainable.
2. Development must respect the character, Heritage Assets and the views into and from the neighbouring conservation area and the setting of the listed building (Colliers Wood tube station) found to the east of the site.
3. Development should protect and enhance the existing cycle and pedestrian route. TfL's strategic cycling analysis has identified a need for significant additional secured cycle parking provision for commuters in Colliers Wood, which should include the provision of a cycle hub facility, to enable the long stay secure cycle storage required for commuter trips. There is also an anticipated requirement for space to accommodate docking areas for cycle / scooter hire schemes, considering the high expected demand in this location. However, there is a lack of space on the public highway to facilitate additional cycle parking. Consideration should be given to the feasibility of providing publicly accessible secure cycle parking and / or docking areas for cycle or scooter hire schemes on this site at ground level, either as part of any development or if development does not take place.
4. The site is within Flood Zone 2; however, it is noted that when considering the impact of climate change, the site is shown to be at risk of flooding from the River Wandle.
5. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engages with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the development's phasing. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site as part of the planning process.
4. The site is close to the A24 which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN). Transport for London advise that no new access or servicing should take place from the A24.

The site location**Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets**

Opposite Colliers Wood underground station building which is Grade II listed

Impacts a Conservation Area

Wandle Valley Conservation Area

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area

Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument
No
Impacts flooding on flood from all sources
Flood zone 2 and in an area of critical drainage issues.
Is in a Town Centre
Yes
Is in an Opportunity Area
Yes
Impacts on a designated open space
Site is within the Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer area. The site is close to Wandle Park, a designated Open Space, Metropolitan Open Land and within the Wandle Valley Regional Park.
Impacts ecology designation
Site is close to a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINC) and Green Corridor at Wandle Park.
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL)
PTAL 6A excellent access to public transport

Site Cw2: Car Park South of Britannia Point, 125 High Street Colliers Wood, SW19 2JG



Ward: Colliers Wood

Site description:

1. A prominent site within the Colliers Wood Town Centre boundary, to the south of the existing Britannia Point, as the second phase of the same development. The council has proposed the site allocation, to give certainty to the delivery of this site for town centre type uses on the ground floor with residential development on upper floors.
2. The site was a multi-storey car park and formerly a small retail shed, now both demolished. The site lies due south of Britannia Point (formerly Brown and Root), a development of c170 apartments with commercial on the ground floor. To the south lies Priory Road with Priory Retail Park at the other side. To the east lies Christchurch Road with a church and homes facing the site. To the west, across the A24, lies the Wandle Park.
3. The site is within 100m of Colliers Wood underground station and served by a variety of bus routes. The site is within c50m of London Underground subsurface tunnels and infrastructure; therefore, London Underground Infrastructure Protection must be consulted.
4. Significant investment has been made in the public realm for walking and cycling in and around the site by the landowners of the adjacent Britannia Point, Merton Council and TfL (Transport for London) as part of the [Connecting Colliers Wood](#) regeneration project.

Site owner: Criterion Capital

Site area: 0.43ha

Existing uses: Vacant

Site allocation: Delivery of new homes as part of a mixed-use development. Residential on upper floors with any of the following on the ground floor (financial and professional services, food and drink, office, assembly, health/day centre) or other sui generis use that is a suitable mix right for a town centre.

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 150- 220 new homes.

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The Opportunity Area's indicative capacity for new homes and jobs, is 5,000 new homes and 6,000 new jobs. This site is expected to contribute to the OA (Opportunity Area) and future growth in Merton that is socially and economically inclusive and environmentally green and sustainable.
2. Delivery of new homes within the Wimbledon/ South Wimbledon / Colliers Wood Opportunity Area, in a universally accessible sustainable location, on an unused brownfield site.
3. Development will need to be of a scale, layout and design to minimise harm to the residential amenity of the existing residents in Britannia Point and on Christchurch Road. Development must be based on the principle of forming a coherent cluster that enhances the wider Colliers Wood area.
4. Development will need to continue and contribute to the public realm improvements delivered via Connecting Colliers Wood with Britannia Point landowners, Merton Council and Transport for London.
5. TfL's strategic cycling analysis has identified a need for significant additional secured cycle parking provision for commuters in Colliers Wood, which should include the provision of a cycle hub facility to enable the long stay secure cycle storage required for commuter trips. However, there is a lack of space on the public highway to facilitate this, so this site may be required to make provision for an appropriate amount and type of publicly accessible cycle storage for commuters. There is also an anticipated requirement for space to accommodate docking areas to facilitate future cycle or scooter hire schemes considering the high expected demand in this location so, where appropriate, development may be required to make some provision for docking stations for cycle/scooter hire schemes in proximity to the public highway.
6. Development must enhance pedestrian and cycle access routes around the site to improve the wider cycle and pedestrian network.
7. In a mixed-use development, residential uses should be on the upper floors.
8. Development should optimise the use of the site and compliment the surrounding area, including the existing building at Britannia Point and the views from the Metropolitan Open Land.
9. Development will need to create and provide an active street frontage along Christchurch Road, Priory Road and High Street Colliers Wood, on the ground floors, adding natural surveillance.
10. Development will need to complement the surrounding area, including Britannia Point and the views from the Metropolitan Open Land at Wandle Park.
11. The potential impact of any proposed development on archaeological heritage needs to be investigated.

12. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Any development proposal for this site, is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. This site is in close proximity to National Grid infrastructure YYU route 275Kv two circuit route from Beddington substation in Sutton to Wimbledon substation in Merton. The statutory safety clearances between overhead lines, the ground, and built structures must not be infringed. To comply with statutory safety clearances, the live electricity conductors of National Grid's overhead power lines are designed to be a minimum height above ground. Where changes are proposed to ground levels beneath an existing line then it is important that changes in ground levels do not result in safety clearances being infringed. National Grid can, on request, provide to developers detailed line profile drawings that detail the height of conductors, above ordnance datum, at a specific site. It is recommended that the developer liaise with National Grid at the earliest opportunity to discuss the infrastructure on site. The council will require evidence of liaising with National Grid with any submitted planning application.
5. Thames Water have indicated that the scale of development for this site indicates that upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure and wastewater network and sewage treatment infrastructure are likely. It is recommended that the developer with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment.
6. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council requires as part of any submitted planning application, evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site as part of the planning process.
7. The site is close to the A24, which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (LTRN). Transport for London advise that no new access or servicing should take place from the A24.
8. The site is within c50m of London Underground subsurface tunnels and infrastructure; therefore, London Underground Infrastructure Protection must be consulted. The council will require evidence that the developer has engaged with London Underground as part of the planning application. The council will engage with London Underground Infrastructure Protection as part of the planning process.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings

A mixed-use redevelopment within the site could include tall buildings forming a coherent cluster of buildings that enhances the wider Colliers Wood area. The Merton Character Study 2021 indicates that buildings of around 52m (approximately 15 storeys) may be appropriate on this site. However, appropriate design-led height parameters for this site should be informed by a Design Guide or Design Code which could be prepared either by applicants or the council. The Design Guide or Design Code should be based on effective community engagement, reflect local aspirations for the development of the area and should take into account the guidance contained in the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code. In the absence of a Design Guide or Design Code the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code will be used to guide decisions on future applications.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Site is 100m away from the Colliers Wood Station listed building

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes, Wandle Valley/Colliers Wood Archaeological Priority Area Tier 2

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact on flooding from all sources: Yes, Flood Zone 2 and within an area susceptible to surface water flooding in a critical drainage area

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: Yes, within Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer zone. Wandle Valley Regional Park and Metropolitan Open Land and designated Open Space at Wandle Park, are nearby.

Impacts on an ecology designation: Site within 500m of a Sites of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINCs) and Green Corridor

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 5 Very good access to public transport

Site Cw3: Colliers Wood Community Centre, 66-72 High Street Colliers Wood, Colliers Wood, SW19 2BY



Ward: Colliers Wood

Site description: Colliers Wood Community Centre is a detached two storey building with a hexagonal rear car park. It is found on the west side of High Street Colliers Wood and is surrounded by, terraced housing adjoining the site to the rear and mixed use residential and commercial buildings of two or three storeys in height along the High Street. Immediately next to the site is a new development with small supermarket on the ground floor and apartments above. The site is close to the A24, which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN).

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.13ha

Existing uses: Community Centre

Site allocation: Mixed-use community and residential

Site deliverability: Between 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 6-10 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The site is within an Opportunity Area (OA designated in the London Plan). The OA has an indicative capacity of 5,000 new homes and 6,000 new jobs. This site is expected to contribute to the OA and future growth in Merton that is socially and economically inclusive and environmentally green and sustainable.

2. Development needs to supply active frontages on the ground floor, a mix of uses, including community uses, on the lower floor and residential on the upper floors or to the rear of the site, creating a more secure environment.
3. Development will need to appropriately manage access arrangements, parking demand, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.
4. Development proposals will need to protect the residential amenity of those properties next to, and in the vicinity of the site.
5. Investigation of the potential impact of any proposed development on archaeological heritage will be needed.
6. The proposed use of the site is compatible with the flood zone, therefore the Exception Test is not needed. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Any development proposal for this site, is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engages with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site as part of the planning process.
5. The site is close to the A24, which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (LTRN). Transport for London requests no new access or servicing take place from the A24. The site is within c50m of London Underground subsurface tunnels and infrastructure; therefore, the developer must consult London Underground Infrastructure Protection. The council will require evidence that the developer has engaged with London Underground as part of any submitted planning application. The council will engage with London Underground Infrastructure as part of the planning process.

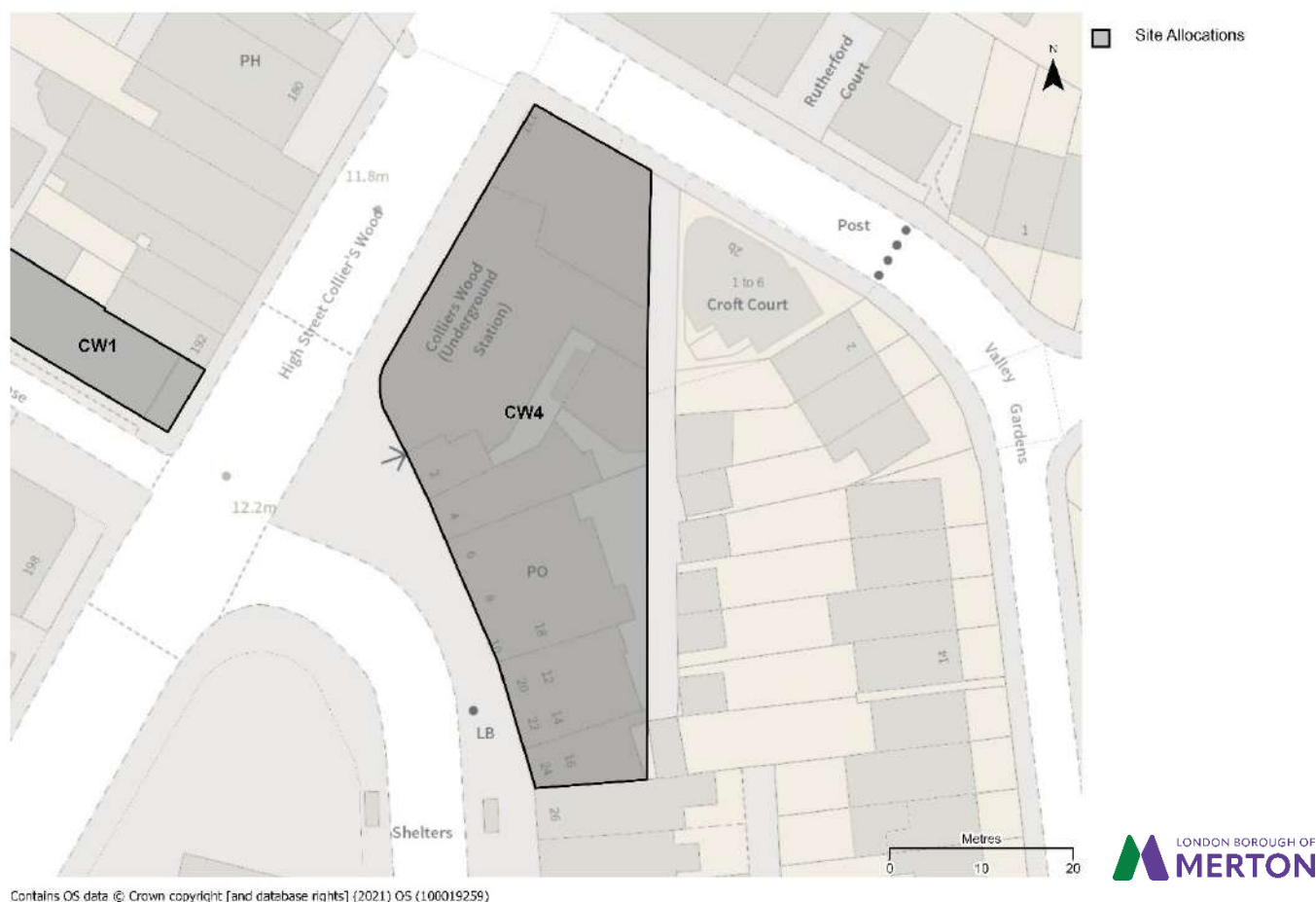
The site location

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts flooding from all sources: Yes, Flood Zone 2 (eastern side of the site – running north to south)
Is in a Town Centre: The site is within Colliers Wood town centre
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes
Impacts a designated open space: Located within the 400m buffer of the Wandle Valley Regional Park
Impact an ecology designation: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 5, good access to public transport services

Site Cw4: Colliers Wood Station, 2-24 Christchurch Road, Colliers Wood, SW19 2HR**Ward:** Colliers Wood**Site description:**

1. Site CW4 is owned by Transport for London as a freeholder and includes Colliers Wood underground station made of Portland stone and adjacent commercial premises, numbers 2-24 Christchurch Road. The commercial premises are occupied by a wide variety of uses including a Post Office, shops, bar / restaurant, estate agent, laundrette and takeaway.
2. The site faces Britannia Point (former Brown and Root building), a 19-storey residential development with commercial units on the ground floor. To the east of the site, on the other side of High Street Colliers Wood are the Charles Holden public house, the Baltic Close entrance to the Wandle Park and a terrace of three storey shops. To the north of the site is Valley Road and beyond is a single storey commercial building and then the new Colliers Wood Library with apartments above, which extends to 6 storeys. To the west of the site are the rear gardens of terraced houses in Valley Road.
3. Significant investment has been made in the public realm for walking and cycling in and around this site by the landowners of the adjacent Britannia Point, Merton Council and Transport for London as part of Connecting Colliers Wood. The site is close to the A24 which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN).

Site owner: Transport for London (TfL)**Site area:** 0.15ha

Existing uses: Underground station (Northern Line) and commercial premises
Site allocation: Any of the following or a suitable mix of retail, financial and professional restaurant or café, hot food takeaway, drinking establishment, leisure/health centre, offices and residential on uppers floors. The Post Office should be retained.
Site deliverability: 10 – 15 years
Indicative site capacity (new homes): 25-35 new homes
Design and accessibility guidance: 1. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The Opportunity Area's indicative capacity for new homes and jobs is 5,000 new homes and 6,000 new jobs. This site is expected to contribute to the OA (Opportunity Area) and future growth in Merton that is socially and economically inclusive and environmentally green and sustainable. 2. TfL's strategic cycling analysis has identified a need for significant additional secured cycle parking provision for commuters in Colliers Wood, which should include the provision of a cycle hub facility to enable the long stay secure cycle storage required for commuter trips. There is also an anticipated requirement for space to accommodate docking areas for cycle/scooter hire schemes considering the high expected demand in this location. However, there is a lack of space on the public highway to facilitate additional cycle parking. Redevelopment of the station should make provision for an appropriate amount and type of cycle storage for commuters and/or provision of docking stations for cycle/scooter hire schemes in proximity to the public highway. 3. A variety of town centre uses and retail should be accommodated at ground floor to supply active frontage along High Street and Christchurch Road. 4. Development proposals must be of a suitable density and design that responds positively to its context. 5. Development proposals will need to compliment the Charles Holden designed listed Underground station. 6. Development must optimise the use of the site and compliment the surrounding area, including the existing building at Britannia Point and the views from Baltic Close and the amenity of the residents in Valley Road. 7. The site is within 50m of London Underground subsurface tunnels and infrastructure, therefore London Underground Infrastructure Protection must be consulted. 8. The station is classified as critical infrastructure therefore development proposals must incorporate sustainable drainage measures. The proposed use for the site is mixed-use including residential which is defined as More Vulnerable (which is allowed in Flood Zone 2). The Exception Test is not needed; however, development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.
Infrastructure Requirements: 1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal. 2. Any development proposal for this site is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.

3. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engages with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site as part of the planning process.
6. The site is close to the A24, which forms part of the Transport of London Road Network. Transport for London requests no new access or servicing take place from the A24. As noted, it is within the consultation zone for the Northern Line tunnels and so London Underground Infrastructure Protection should be fully consulted about any sub surface works. The council will require evidence that the developer has engaged with London Underground submitted with any planning application for the site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Yes, station building is Grade II listed

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area

Yes, the Wandle Valley/Colliers Wood Archaeological Priority Tier 2, within the Wandle Valley Regional Park

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

In on flooding from all sources: Yes, flood zone 2 (75% of the site) and within an area that is susceptible to surface water and groundwater flooding

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: Yes

Impacts an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 5, very good access to public transport

Site Cw5: Priory Retail Park, Colliers Wood, Christchurch Road, Colliers Wood, SW19 2PP



Ward: Colliers Wood

Site description:

1. Priory Retail Park is a large purpose-built single storey retail warehouse with dedicated car park, divided into five retail units. Within the north of the site is a low-rise single storey drive thru' Burger King restaurant. The site is bounded by Priory Road to the north and at the other side of the road is a cleared site, proposed for allocation as CW2 in this plan, then the 19 storey Britannia Point.
2. In the north-western corner of the site lies a two-storey building with a bar/restaurant on the ground floor and a children's soft play area on the upper floor. The site is bounded by Merton High Street and beyond, views from Wandle Park.
3. The Pickle Ditch, a tributary of the River Wandle, a riparian green space and remnants of the historic Merton Priory Wall, forms the western boundary of the site. Sainsbury's and Marks and Spencer are found beyond that in a single purpose-built podium supermarket with car parking underneath.
4. The centre of the site is occupied by a large surface car park. The site is accessible by car from Merton High Street to the north. The A24 (Transport for London Road Network) sets the eastern and northern boundary, which includes a substantial amount of landscaping along the eastern boundary,

on which advertising hoardings sit. Electricity wires cross the site and a pylon lies within the site boundary.

Site owner: RDI REIT

Site area: 2.1ha

Existing uses: Retail sheds and a surface car park

Site allocation: Creation of streets - a suitable mix of town centre uses on the ground and lower floors (shops financial and professional services, food and drink, office, assembly, health/day centre or other sui generis use appropriate for a town centre), residential on upper floors and public space

Site deliverability: 10- 15 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 80-120 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The Opportunity Area has an indicative capacity of 5,000 new homes and 6,000 new jobs. This site is expected to contribute to the OA and future growth in Merton that is socially and economically inclusive and environmentally green and sustainable.
2. Significant investment has been made via Connecting Colliers Wood to the public realm and street scene, including the Wandle Park. Development proposals will need to contribute to and compliment Connecting Colliers Wood in its design, layout and public realm, creating a recognisable street pattern.
3. Development should fully protect and enhance publicly accessible pedestrian and cycle access routes through the site and explore options for providing new links through and around the site to improve the wider cycle and pedestrian network. We will protect the existing cycle route which runs across the site, from the A24 near the Tandem Centre, alongside the Pickle Ditch to Merton High Street, as this allows pedestrians and cyclists to bypass the busy road network. We will also seek to incorporate a new cycle route alongside the A24 to the eastern side of the site.
4. Proposals will need to maximise the accessibility of the site by sustainable travel modes and demonstrate that proposals will minimise the impact of vehicle trips through appropriately managed car parking, deliveries and servicing.
5. Opportunity to improve connectivity across Colliers Wood and improve the condition of the Pickle Ditch. Development proposals must protect and enhance the Wandle Valley Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) along the western boundary of the site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies set out in Chapter 15.
6. Development proposals must optimise the site's use for Town Centre Type Uses in a more resilient, adaptable, greener and attractive layout, reducing the dominance of car parking.
7. Active frontages must be provided on the ground floor, including along Colliers Wood High Street and the River Wandle, to enhance Colliers Wood's attractiveness as a town centre.
8. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A. In line with the Environment Agency requirements, development proposals must enhance the Pickle Stream corridor, including the removal of concrete banks, restoration of ecology to the watercourse and inclusion of a 10m wide riverside buffer strip.

9. The impact of development on archaeological heritage must be investigated and development proposals must respect the historic setting, including the remnants of the Merton Priory Walls.
10. The overhead power lines supported by electricity pylons will influence the layout, massing and potential uses on parts of the site.

Infrastructure Requirements:

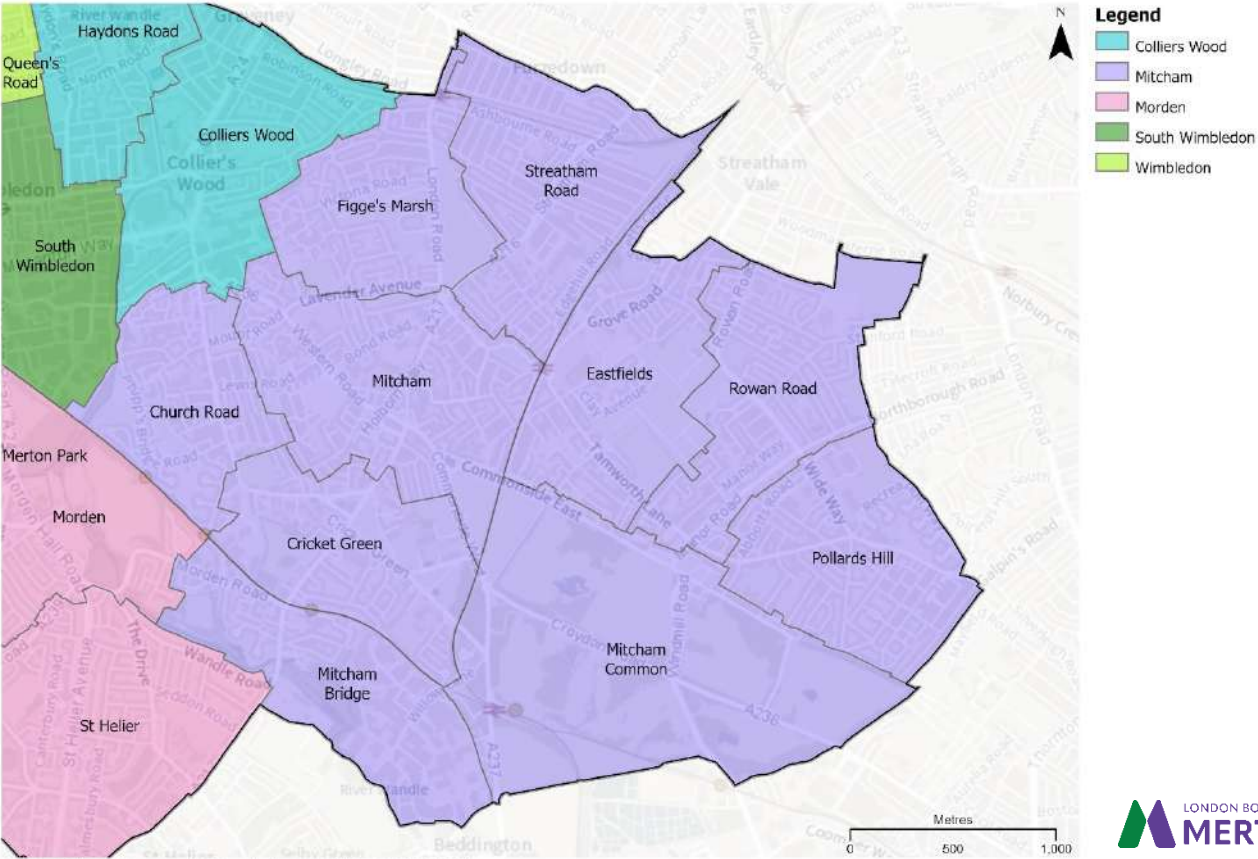
1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Any development proposal for this site, is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water have indicated that the scale of development for this site is likely to require upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network and wastewater treatment infrastructure capability. It is recommended that the developer engage, with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>)
6. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. The council will also, engage with Thames Water and seek their advice about the development of this site, as part of the planning process.
7. The site is close to the A24 which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN). Transport for London advise that no new access or servicing should take place from the A24.
8. This site contains National Grid infrastructure in the form of YYU route 275Kv two circuit route from Beddington substation in Sutton to Wimbledon substation in Merton and underground cable 264681. The statutory safety clearances between overhead lines, the ground, and built structures must not be infringed. To comply with statutory safety clearances, the live electricity conductors of National Grid's overhead power lines are designed to be a minimum height above ground. Where changes are proposed to ground levels beneath an existing line then it is important that changes in ground levels do not result in safety clearances being infringed. National Grid can, on request, provide to developers detailed line profile drawings that detail the height of conductors, above ordnance datum, at a specific site. It is recommended that the developer liaise with National Grid at the earliest opportunity to discuss the infrastructure on site. The council will require evidence of liaising with National Grid with any submitted planning application.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Yes
Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes
Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Parts of the site hold a listed structure of Merton Priory wall remnants and are within Archaeological Priority Area Tier 2
Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, site is within Flood Zones 2 and 3
Is in a Town Centre: Yes
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes
Impacts a designated open space: Yes, the western edge of the site is Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) and Priory Wall Open Space Walk. The site sits within the Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer. Refer to Appendices for further information on MOL.
Impacts on ecology designation: Parts of the site to the south are Green Corridor and a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 5, very good access to public transport



Chapter 04. **Mitcham**



Place profile: Mitcham

As part of the borough’s Character Study, 415 Merton residents took part in an online public survey, of which 98 people lived in Mitcham. The diagram below highlights how people felt about their neighbourhood based on a series of questions asked. This work was also used to inform [Merton’s Borough Character Study 2021](#).



Key objectives: Mitcham

The following objectives provide an overarching vision for Mitcham. More detail can be found in the Policy and Supporting Text sections that follow.



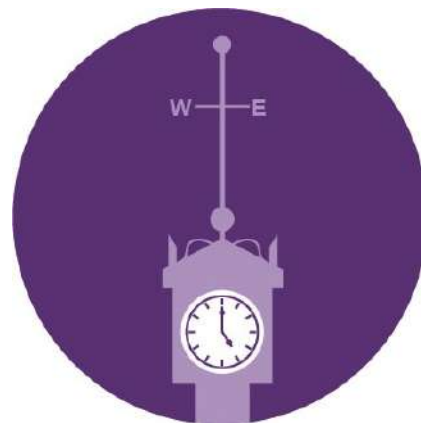
A stronger Mitcham town centre

Improve the environment of Mitcham Town Centre and surrounding areas through high quality design improvements to shop fronts and public spaces and increasing footfall and spend. Improve walking and cycling to and from Mitcham Town Centre.



Supporting community

Mitcham comprises many local parades and open spaces that serve the whole community. Improving Mitcham Town Centre, local parades, open spaces and the historic environment will help to support communities and reduce inequalities.



Celebrating heritage

Ensuring that development conserves and enhances the historic environment. For example, around Cricket Green, Canons House and Mitcham Common.

Character: Mitcham

These photos illustrate the diverse character found across Mitcham.





Policy N4.1 Mitcham

Introduction

1. Leading the way with providing award-winning sustainable forms of development such as Brenley Park, Rowan Park and the Y:Cube, and with public realm improvements to the District Centre and the Canyons, the future of Mitcham focusses on improving wellbeing, supporting local economy and creating sustainable neighbourhoods.
2. The policies are split into two areas, Mitcham District Centre and the surrounding areas of Mitcham District Centre.

Mitcham District Centre

3. To improve the vitality and overall quality of Mitcham District Centre, we will:
 - a. Increase the footfall and spend in the town centre by improving the quality and diversity of shops and services.
 - b. Create healthier streets and spaces that continue to enhance the public realm through high quality streetscape and design improvements using Healthy Streets Approaches.
 - c. Improve access to, and movement through, Mitcham District centre by encouraging walking, cycling and public transport that improves links to surrounding neighbourhoods and supports the vision of a 20-minute neighbourhood and improving air quality.
 - d. Deliver high quality mixed tenure homes that adds to the vitality of the District Centre, in particular supporting mixed use developments with homes above shops in the District Centre
 - e. Support local and independent businesses, leisure, community and retail outlets that are attractive to and used by the whole community.
 - f. Celebrate Mitcham District Centre's unique character by enhancing the setting of heritage assets with high quality design and character led developments.
 - g. Improve Mitcham District Centre's unique connection with Mitcham Common, the surrounding green open spaces and public leisure uses.

- h.** Champion sustainable design in future developments to contribute to Merton's net-zero carbon target by 2050.

Surrounding area of Mitcham District Centre

- 4.** Mitcham is one of Merton's larger neighbourhoods. Beyond the District Centre, Mitcham has a rich mix of uses and character that span from Phipps Bridge, Figge's Marsh, the Cricket Green and Pollards Hill. To improve the overall environment of Mitcham's surrounding areas by providing quality shopping, housing, community facilities and good transport links, we will:
 - a.** Support North Mitcham Local Centre around Tooting rail station: only supporting development that complements or improves the local or wider public realm.
 - b.** Improve the quality and mix of homes, including affordable homes.
 - c.** Ensure that development conserves and enhances the historic environment and green spaces, encouraging greater usage, for example, around Cricket Green, Canons House and Mitcham Common.
 - d.** Enhance the public realm through high quality urban design and architecture and allowing development that makes a positive visual impact to the overall surroundings and connectivity to the District Centre.
 - e.** Support the regeneration at Eastfields, Ravensbury and Pollards Hill to provide good quality new homes and services and refurbish existing homes in a landscaped setting.
 - f.** Enhance the connections between Mitcham and surrounding neighbourhoods such as Colliers Wood, Morden and Tooting by improving the public realm and boosting opportunities to walk and cycle through the streets and open spaces around Church Road, Phipps Bridge and Figge's Marsh supporting the vision of a 20-minute neighbourhood.
 - g.** Make more of underused spaces and places around Mitcham, encouraging investment to improve public access and support greater and more diverse usage, particularly for leisure and recreation.

- h.** Support and improve the quality of local Neighbourhood Parades.
- i.** Strongly encourage and support sustainable improvements to new and existing developments, in particular to Mitcham's industrial estates and homes.

Supporting text

- 4.1.1. The focus for the next 10 years for Mitcham will be to encourage more people to use the District Centre for socialising, leisure and shopping. Greater footfall will lead to greater spend, which will help boost local businesses.
- 4.1.2. Although vacancy rates in Mitcham have generally been low for the past 10 years (lower than the average in England and in London), existing businesses report lower spend and therefore less scope to expand, employ more staff, provide new services or refresh their shop front. In addition, businesses and town centres across the borough need greater trade and more spend to help recover from COVID-19.
- 4.1.3. To boost jobs in Mitcham, the council has been working to make the District Centre more attractive and easier to get to and to get around, particularly for people walking, cycling and travelling by public transport. The Mayor and Merton Council's £6million investment in Rediscover Mitcham has transformed the public realm, restored the iconic clock tower, opened the bus lane and helped drive extra footfall to businesses around the Fair Green.
- 4.1.4. One of the issues identified for the edges of Mitcham District Centre is that existing buildings and roads present a barrier to people being able to find their way around the area, particularly by walking and cycling. The 1980s bypass that is now Holborn Way is a clear example, splitting off homes to the west of the town centre from easily accessing it. Other examples include buildings such as Sadler's Close with a built form and site layout that create a physical barrier between the town centre and surrounds. We will require new developments to be laid out to make it easier for people to find their way around and to move around, helping to create attractive streetscapes, places to dwell and walking and cycling links to the town centre and through the wider area.
- 4.1.5. Mitcham District Centre has a small proportion of multiple retailers and primarily serves the retail needs of residents living within the east of the borough. The high number of independent retailers and low vacancy rates is one of Mitcham's strengths. However, there

are also views of a lack of variety in Mitcham's offer, particularly for people wanting to socialise and the night-time economy.

- 4.1.6. As set out in policies on town centres, many of us visit and use town centres to meet friends and socialise in cafes and restaurants, leisure and entertainment spaces rather than only shopping. Given that the pace and scale of change in how we shop and socialise over the last 10 years has been accelerated by COVID-19, it is impossible to predict all the changes we might welcome in the next 10 years. This means that the ground floors of commercial developments need to be flexible to accommodate anything from a soft play area for children to food stalls to flexible offices, while having active, attractive and accessible frontages. The council will support non-residential developments that provide opportunities for people from a wide range of ages, cultures and other characteristics to enjoy.
- 4.1.7. Mitcham is home to a number of ethnic groups who bring energy and entrepreneurial flair to the community as well as a variety of specialist cultural shops and services which collectively enrich the distinct cultural identities of Mitcham.
- 4.1.8. Mitcham is located to the east of the borough and is served and connected by rail, tram and bus links; however, the tram stops and train stations are situated at a distance away from the District Centre. The council will continue to campaign for increased rail services, particularly at Mitcham Eastfields, and will continue to support the Merton-Sutton Tramlink.
- 4.1.9. Mitcham is projected to accommodate a range of new homes throughout the plan period. Major development sites include the regeneration of Eastfields and Ravensbury estates. New homes are also proposed at Benedict's Wharf on Hallowfield Way, at Tamworth Lane and a variety of smaller sites across the neighbourhood. In line with the London Plan which prioritises residential development above shops in Town Centres, the District Centre sites will be able to accommodate apartments, providing a contrast to the surrounding terraces and semi-detached houses.
- 4.1.10. Good quality housing could encourage young professionals into Mitcham bringing increased spending power. More people using the District Centre will have knock on social and environmental effects, including greater support for existing local businesses, allowing them to expand and create new jobs. It will also make the centre more attractive to new businesses, providing a wider range of services for residents and workers. Improvements to the business offer, leisure opportunities, shops and services will reduce the need for surrounding residents to travel further afield.

- 4.1.11. To accommodate the significant increase in new housing in Mitcham and the surrounding neighbourhood, in particular from large key development sites, we will also ensure that community services such as education and health meet the needs of existing and new residents. The council has sufficient primary and secondary school places locally and is expanding provision for children with additional needs at Cricket Green School. We will continue to work with the NHS (National Health Service) and other partners to protecting and improving the healthcare capacity of the borough currently serviced by Wilson Clinic.

Surrounding neighbourhoods

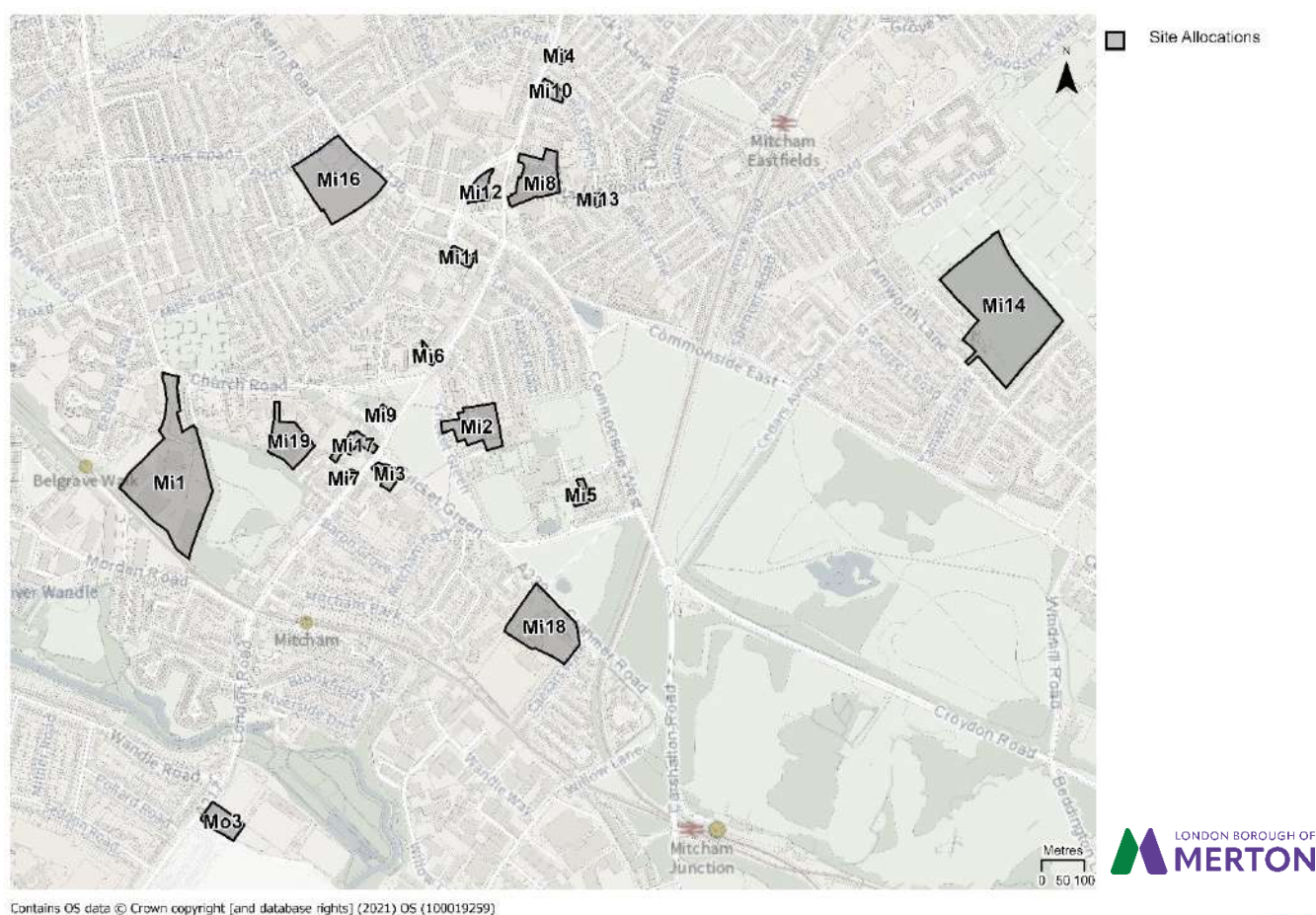
- 4.1.12. North Mitcham is a reasonably large Local Centre, about 1km north of Mitcham town centre and 1km east of Tooting Broadway underground station. The linear centre has developed around Tooting rail station at its heart and is bisected by the railway line. It is a key location for residents on the Tooting borders and in the homes surrounding the open spaces at Figge's Marsh to avail of shops and services and travel to work. Despite this, the range of shops and the quality of buildings is relatively poor. The council will support proposals that improve the look and feel of the area and provide new services and homes. In particular, the council would support a well-designed redevelopment of the single storey buildings on land lying between Mitcham Road and Links Way to provide homes on upper floors.
- 4.1.13. Mitcham Cricket Green is an attractive neighbourhood with a wealth of historic assets surrounding Cricket Green, a site used for cricket for more than 300 years. Both historically and today the area has contained a significant number of civic functions, often in purpose-built buildings. There are a number of key sites within or on the borders of Cricket Green that are proposed for redevelopment to provide new homes; these should be laid out to improve legibility and permeability within the area and sensitively designed to complement the heritage assets.
- 4.1.14. The Canons House and Grounds is an attractive historic landscape but has not been well used or much known outside the Mitcham Cricket Green area. The Canons National Heritage Lottery Fund and National Lottery Community Fund "Parks for People" project is to shine a spotlight on this underplayed and underused landscape. The project will increase footfall and visibility of the Canons House and Grounds to be a better used asset for Mitcham.
- 4.1.15. Homes and businesses at Church Road and Phipps Bridge lie between the town centres of Mitcham, Colliers Wood and Morden. Local roads can be congested and there is potential to

improve the look and feel of these areas and at the same time improve the experience for walkers and cyclists. Wherever possible developments should support public realm improvements. Large development sites should be permeable to help improve public access for walking and cycling, helping to link the green spaces along the Wandle Trail, between Morden Hall Park, Ravensbury Park, London Road Playing Fields, Cricket Green, The Canons, Mitcham Common through to Rowan Park and Pollards Hill. This will help make it easier for people to get around, whether for work, leisure, or recreation, and will have associated wellbeing benefits. Additional footfall could help support local businesses.

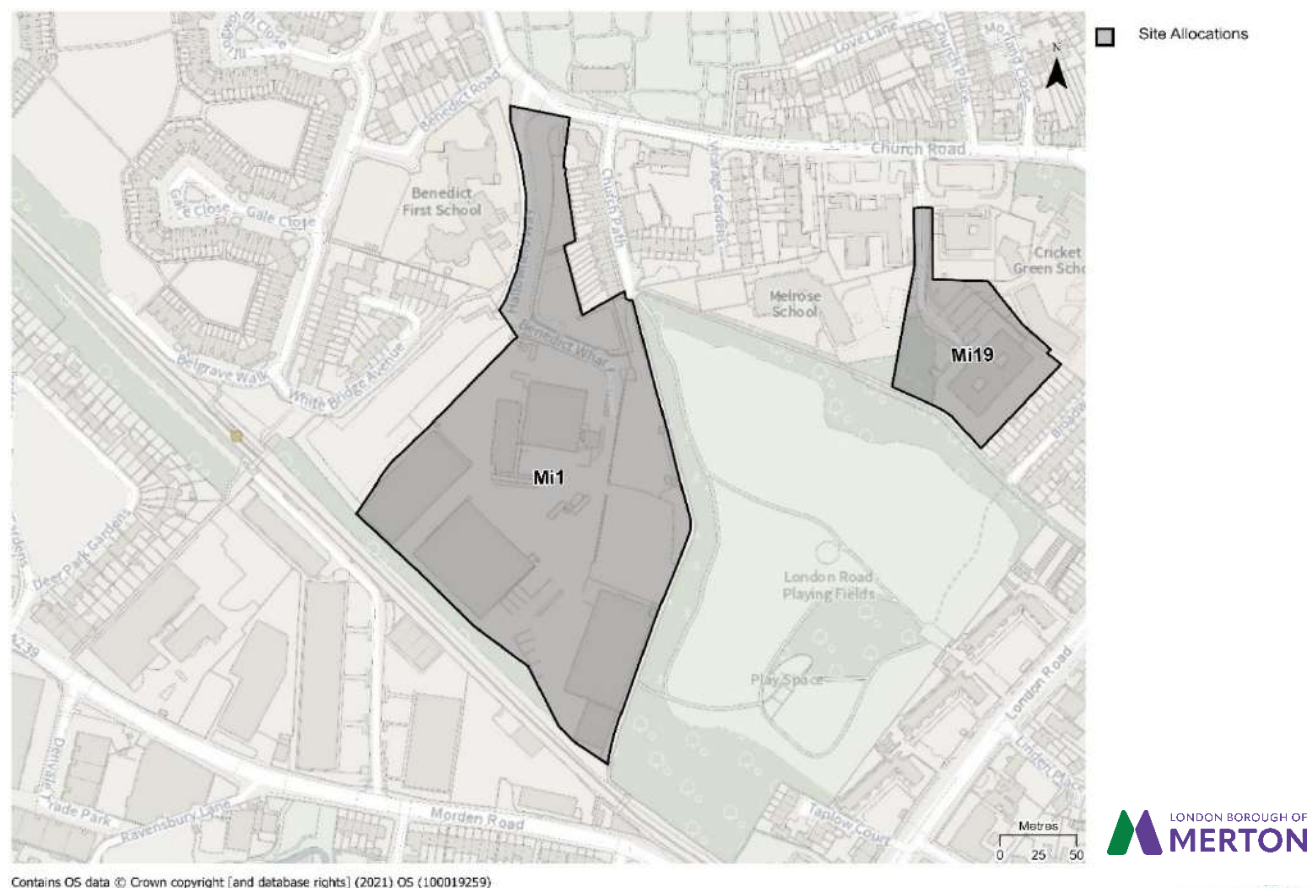
- 4.1.16. Like Wimbledon, Mitcham also has a rich sporting environment and recreational opportunities although these are unfortunately less well known. The Canons Running Track, Mitcham Cricket Club, Tooting and Mitcham Hub, the Merton Mile and green gym at Figge's Marsh are just some of the sporting opportunities locally. We will support proposals that provide long term, resilient investment in sports and recreation for the benefit of local communities, opening up private land to public access for sport and recreation, providing local job and training opportunities and supporting all of Mitcham's diverse communities.
- 4.1.17. The London Plan 2021 identifies Mitcham as an area with potential for housing growth. Merton's Borough Character Study 2021 analyses the existing character of Mitcham's neighbourhoods which are generally lower density and low rise. We will continue to support the development of new homes and associated infrastructure in Mitcham in site allocations, in incremental development and via estate regeneration. Merton's Estates Local Plan 2018 guides the regeneration of Eastfields and Ravensbury estates, which are underway and will provide a substantial number of new homes and considerably improve the housing stock over the next 15 years. Regeneration plans have also been developed for Pollards Hill to provide new homes to the south east of the borough.

Site Allocations

- 4.1.18. Site allocations are planning policies which apply to key potential development sites of strategic importance. Site allocations are needed to ensure that when a strategic site comes forward for redevelopment it integrates well into its surroundings and contributes towards meeting strategic needs for new homes, jobs, public open space, public access routes, transport infrastructure and social infrastructure, such as health or education facilities.
- 4.1.19. Site allocations set out the land uses that must be provided as part of any redevelopment alongside other acceptable land uses that may be provided in addition to the required land uses. Any development proposal for site allocations will be determined against planning policies (including the London Plan).



Site Mi1: Benedict Wharf, Hallowfield Way, Mitcham, CR4 3BT



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Ward: Cricket Green

Site description:

1. Most of the site is used for waste management purposes by the owner occupier Suez. A small part of the site (rectangle in the north-western corner) is owned by Cappagh and is used as the car pound for Wandsworth and Lambeth traffic enforcement.
2. The single operational site entrance is from the north down a short wide single access road, Hallowfield Way, off Church Road. Vehicles entering the site must pass Benedict Primary school, St Peter and St Paul's church and graveyard and residential properties, all of which are found at the junction of Hallowfield Way and Church Road. There is also a secondary road access down Church Path, a narrow residential street lined with historic two-storey cottages, but this is currently closed off by Suez while the site is in waste management use.
3. To the north of the site, beyond Cappagh's car pound boundary, lies White Bridge Avenue, a residential road and Benedict Primary School. Morden Hall Park, a historic park owned by the National Trust, lies circa 200m to the north west of the site boundary. To the east of the site boundary lies Baron Walk, a fenced off path and beyond lies London Road Playing Fields.
4. The Wimbledon-Croydon tramline lies adjacent to the southwestern boundary of the site. Belgrave Walk tram stop is within five minutes' walk (300m) of the site's northeast corner with services between Wimbledon and Croydon; At the other side of the tramline are large industrial sheds.
5. Large electricity pylons lie just beyond the site boundary, with electricity wires running circa 30 metres above ground parallel with the tram tracks.

Site owner: Suez (site 3.8ha), Cappagh (site 0.6 ha), to the north of the site is a strip of land owned by

the London Borough of Merton.

Site area: 4.4 hectares (main Suez owned site 3.8ha; rectangular Cappagh site 0.6 hectares)

Existing uses: Waste facility with planning permission for expansion (majority of site); car pound for Wandsworth and Lambeth councils (rectangular northern part of site)

Site allocation:

1. Residential with some non-residential uses that are commensurate with a residential setting (for example small workshops, community uses etc.) and deliverable. Reallocation is dependent on there being no loss of waste management capacity within the South London Waste Plan area.
2. Merton Council will only support reallocation where the waste management capacity and function are moved within the South London Waste Plan area.
3. Development of the site is an opportunity to provide much needed new homes and other compatible uses in a largely residential setting with surrounding infrastructure and minimise HGV (Heavy Goods Vehicle) and other heavy traffic attributed to the waste management use of the site and minimise the associated road-based noise and air pollution.

Site deliverability: 10-15 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 650-850 new homes

Further information:

1. The site was safeguarded as an existing waste management site in Schedule 1 of the adopted (2012) [South London Waste Plan unless](#) replacement compensatory provision is provided.
2. Suez has acquired a site in Sutton, a South London Waste Plan partner borough, and has secured planning permission for a replacement waste management facility that will exceed the required replacement compensatory provision.
3. The [South London Waste Plan](#) 2022-2037, does not propose the safeguarding of the Benedict Wharf site for waste management purposes.
4. On 25 March 2022 outline planning permission ([19/P2383](#)) was granted for the development of 850 dwellings and 750sqm of commercial floor space and associated matters on the site.

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development proposals for any use would be required to address the national and local planning policies relating to heritage assets, environmental protection and nearby sensitive development. In this case, the council supports the removal of SIL capacity from this site to elsewhere in the South London Waste Plan area as the proximity of so many sensitive land uses, directly adjacent or near the site is not compatible with viable long-term strategic industrial development. Decontamination will be required due to the site's historic uses.
2. The overhead power lines supported by electricity pylons influence the layout, scale, massing and potential uses of new development on parts of the site.
3. Development proposals must mitigate potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.
4. Development proposals must protect the amenity of the adjacent properties, including the nearby homes and schools.
5. The site must provide sustainable drainage measures throughout the development.

Neighbourhood and heritage considerations

1. Development proposals must enhance the design and streetscape in the setting of the Wandle Valley Regional Park and Mitcham Cricket Green conservation area.

2. Development proposals must provide public realm improvements along Hallowfield Way, reducing the width and improving the frontage, enhancing the setting of the Grade II* St Peter and St Paul's Church and Benedict Academy, thus delivering some of the actions from the Mitcham Cricket Green conservation area character appraisal and action plan.
3. Development proposals must preserve and enhance and not cause significant harm to heritage assets including the character of Mitcham Cricket Green Conservation Area, the nationally and locally listed buildings and the historic park and garden.
4. Development proposals must be sensitive to the following:
 - a. Benedict Primary School lies opposite the church adjoining the site entrance at Hallowfield Way. Melrose School (for secondary school aged children with social, emotional and behavioural difficulties) and Cricket Green School (a special educational needs school for 4-19 year olds) are both within 300m of the site, adjacent the London Road Playing Fields.
 - b. Residential streets within 100m of the site include Church Path, White Bridge Avenue, Belgrave Walk and the nearby Cherry Trees estate.
 - c. Respect and not cause significant harm to heritage assets including the character of Mitcham Cricket Green Conservation Area, the nationally and locally listed buildings and the historic park and garden.

Improving walking, cycling and access:

1. Development proposals must improve public access through the area and increase permeability, including via Baron Walk and between London Road Playing Fields and the site.
2. The site is bounded by Baron Walk to the east and Ravensbury Path to the west (both Public Rights of Way) that provides access to Belgrave Walk tram stop and over the tram tracks to Morden Road. Development proposals must fully protect and enhance these routes and maximise the permeability of the site for pedestrians and cyclists by providing and contributing to new routes and connections including into London Road Playing Fields.
3. Development proposals must support walking and cycling links between the green spaces at Morden Hall Park, London Road Playing Fields and enhance the Wandle Valley Regional Park.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal, including contributing to access improvements with London Road Playing Fields.
2. Any development proposal for this site is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. Development proposals must consider the existing Wimbledon-Croydon tramline on the western boundary of the site, mitigation of any safety and security impacts and improve access from the site to the tram stop.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. The scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply and wastewater network infrastructure and sewage treatment infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan.

The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>) Merton Council will engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about any development proposals on this site.

6. The site is adjacent to tram tracks, the developer must consult with London Trams. The council will require evidence of engagement with London Trams with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also consult with and seek advice from London Trams about the development of this site.
7. Electricity cables, supported by two pylons just beyond the site boundaries, run parallel with the tramlines. This is National Grid infrastructure in the form of YYU route 275Kv two circuit route from Beddington substation in Sutton to Wimbledon substation in Merton. The statutory safety clearances between overhead lines, the ground, and built structures must not be infringed. To comply with statutory safety clearances, the live electricity conductors of National Grid's overhead power lines are designed to be a minimum height above ground. Where changes are proposed to ground levels beneath an existing line then it is important that changes in ground levels do not result in safety clearances being infringed. National Grid can, on request, provide to developers detailed line profile drawings that detail the height of conductors, above ordnance datum, at a specific site. It is recommended that the developer engage with National Grid at the earliest opportunity to discuss the infrastructure on site. The council will require evidence of engagement with National Grid with any submitted planning application.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings:

The size of the site allows for a masterplanned approach which could contain taller buildings. Evidence supporting the planning permission relating to the site indicates that buildings of around 33m (approximately 10 storeys) may be appropriate. However, appropriate design-led height parameters for this site should be informed by a Design Guide or Design Code, which could be prepared either by applicants or the council. The Design Guide or Design Code should be based on effective community engagement, reflect local aspirations for the development of the area and should take into account the guidance contained in the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code. In the absence of a Design Guide or Design Code, the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code will be used to guide decisions on future applications.

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources

Site is susceptible to surface flooding

Is in a Town Centre: No

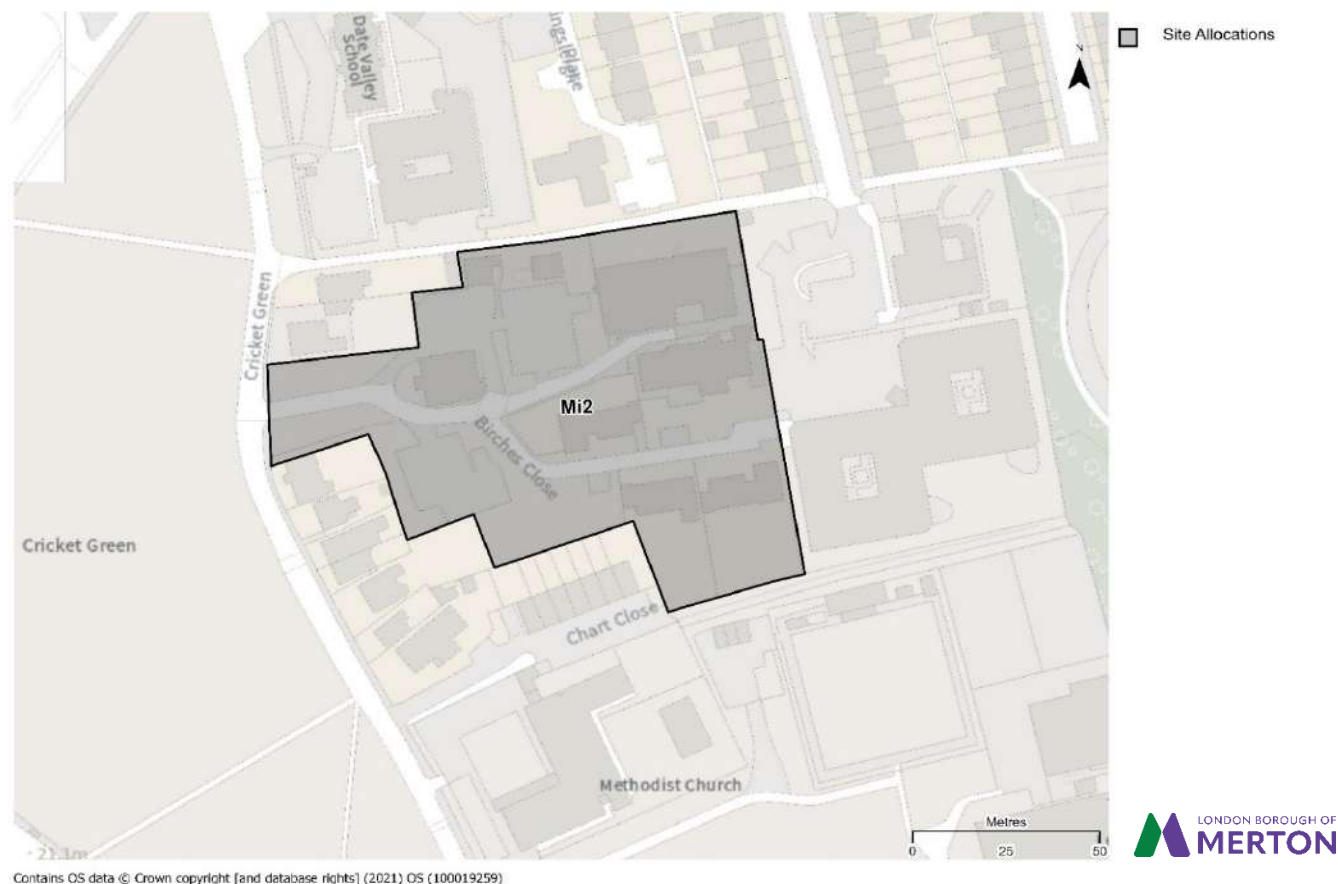
Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: The site is within the Wandle Valley Regional Park and is adjacent to London Road Playing Fields, designated as open space.

Impacts on ecology designations: London Road Playing Fields running along the entire eastern side of the site, is designated as a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation and as a Green Corridor for wildlife protection.

1. Nearby Morden Hall Park is designated as Metropolitan Open Land, a Site for Importance for Nature Conservation, as green corridor.

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Mi2: Birches Close, Mitcham, CR4 4LA**Ward:** Cricket Green

Site description: The site, which takes access from Cricket Green, consists of various single and two-storey buildings accommodating specialist NHS clinics and supported accommodation units. To the north, on the opposite side of the Cold Blows footpath is a three-storey former office since converted into flats and three-storey blocks of flats. To the east of the site is a single storey nursing home and to the south is a bowling green, the Methodist Church and a row of two-storey terraced houses. To the west is a row of two and three-storey detached and semi-detached houses.

Site owner: NHS Property Service (NHSPS)

Site area: 0.97ha

Existing uses: Healthcare

Site allocation: Healthcare with community and enabling residential development or residential if the existing services are relocated within an alternative healthcare facility in Mitcham.

Site deliverability: Delivery: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 35-54 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Opportunities arising from the site size and location for exemplary urban design delivering either healthcare or sustainable homes, complimenting the heritage assets and historic character of the area, while protecting the residential amenity or the adjacent properties.
2. Development proposals must improve walking and cycling links to, from and around the site. Access to the nearby green spaces and heritage assets should be promoted through a development proposal.
3. Development proposals must preserve and enhance the Cold Blows footpath along the northern boundary.

4. Investigating the potential impact of any proposed development on archaeological heritage. Locally listed Birches House to be retained as part of any development proposal.
5. Development proposals must improve the connectivity of the site - ensuring the layout of buildings and spaces within the site provides accessibility to London Road and the town centre and The Canons House and its grounds.
6. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the Critical Drainage Area.

Infrastructure requirements

1. To ensure that healthcare provision is delivered in this area and that there is no loss of potential NHS sites until this happens, the new Mitcham healthcare facility must be built and operational before redevelopment can progress on either the Wilson Hospital or Birches Close sites.
2. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
3. Any development proposal for this site is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets:

1. Yes, 'The White House', Cricket Green, and 'Chestnut Cottage', Cricket Green, both Grade II listed buildings, are to be preserved
2. The Birches (a.k.a. 'Birches House') is a Locally Listed building

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact from flooding from all sources: Portions of the north, east and west of the site are within a Critical Drainage Area

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes. The site is within the Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer. Opposite the site is Metropolitan Open Land and Mitcham Cricket Green Open Space which also forms part of the Wandle Valley Regional Park

Impacts on ecology designation: Yes. Mitcham Cricket Green is a Green Corridor

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 4, good access to public transport

Site Mi3: Burn Bullock and Mitcham Cricket Pavilion 315 London Road, Mitcham, CR4 4LA



Ward: Cricket Green

Site description:

1. The site is occupied by two distinct uses. On the junction of London Road and Cricket Green sits the two-storey Burn Bullock public house (currently closed) with associated car park. On the part of the site that faces Cricket Green is a two-storey red brick and wood building, in use as a cricket pavilion serving the cricket club on Cricket Green.
2. The site faces the open space at Mitcham Cricket Green to the northeast. The adjacent property to the Burn Bullock fronting London Road to the west is the three-storey Jobcentre Plus. Next to the cricket pavilion on Cricket Green is a two-storey dwelling house.
3. The cricket pavilion opened in 1904 and the associated land and building is the only dedicated facility supporting the playing of cricket on Mitcham Cricket Green.
4. Mitcham Cricket Green is recognised as one of the oldest cricket grounds in the world where cricket has been consistently played since at least 1685.

Site owner: Private ownership - (Site allocation suggested by Mitcham Cricket Green Community and Heritage)

Site area: 0.24ha

Existing uses: Public house (currently closed) car park, cricket pavilion

Site allocation:

1. Secure community ownership and management of the land and buildings associated with Mitcham Cricket Pavilion and restoration of the Burn Bullock supported by enabling development.
2. Use of the cricket pavilion and associated shed in perpetuity as a cricket pavilion serving Mitcham Cricket Green.
3. Use of the Burn Bullock building in non-residential uses with public access on the ground floor which could include business, service or community uses. Residential development may be acceptable on upper floors as enabling development.
4. Residential development on the car park to the rear of the site to enable community ownership and management of Mitcham Cricket Pavilion associated land and buildings.

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 5-12 new homes - on parts of the site not including the cricket pavilion, storage shed and lower floor of the Burn Bullock

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The cricket pavilion is registered as an Asset of Community Value.
2. The council is looking to secure the long-term future community ownership and management of the land and buildings associated with Mitcham Cricket Pavilion to help the continuation of cricket being played on the Green. This would be helped by enabling development on the former car park within the site.
3. Opportunity to secure ownership and improvements to Mitcham Cricket Pavilion directly associated with the active operation of cricket playing on the historic town green at Mitcham Cricket Green.
4. Development of the site is an opportunity for enabling development to support restoration of Burn Bullock.
5. Opportunity to bring an underused site at the Burn Bullock back into use.
6. Opportunity to secure long term community ownership and management of the land and buildings associated with Mitcham Cricket Pavilion and restoration of the Burn Bullock supported by enabling development.
7. Development proposals will be required to secure the restoration of the listed Burn Bullock public house and its removal from the "Heritage at Risk" register.
8. Development appropriate to the residential setting that supports public access to the ground floor of the Grade II listed Burn Bullock would be supported.
9. Development on the car park to the rear of the site to enable community ownership and management of Mitcham Cricket Pavilion associated land and buildings. Use of the cricket pavilion and associated shed in perpetuity as a cricket pavilion serving Mitcham Cricket Green.
10. Development proposals must be delicately designed to conserve and enhance the significance of the heritage assets and the views from Metropolitan Open Land.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and Playing Pitch Strategy 2019 and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.

2. Any development proposal for this site is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
5. The developer must consult and engage with the Metropolitan Police Service (MPS) on any development proposals to prevent future development from adversely affecting the MPS's operational facilities. The council will also engage with MPS to seek advice during any pre or planning application processes.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets:

1. Burn Bullock Public House is a Grade II listed building and is on the national "Heritage at Risk" list.
2. The cricket pavilion is locally listed.
3. Other historic assets in the vicinity of the site include the White Hart (Grade II listed), drinking fountain & horse trough (Grade II listed), 346-348 London Road (Grade II listed).
4. The cricket pavilion opened in 1904, and associated land / building is the only dedicated facility supporting cricket playing on Mitcham Cricket Green.
5. The cricket pavilion is registered as an Asset of Community Value.

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes. The site is within the 400m buffer of Wandle Valley Regional Park. Registered town green hosting an operational cricket pitch. Mitcham Cricket Green is Metropolitan Open Land, designed Open Space and within the Wandle Valley Regional Park.

Impacts on ecology designation: Yes. Mitcham Cricket Green is a Green Corridor

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Mi4: Elm Nursery Car Park 210 London Road, Mitcham, CR4 3TA**Ward:** Figge's Marsh

Site description: This site is a publicly accessible surface car park. Adjacent to the northern boundary is a single storey commercial unit; a public access footpath lies between the commercial unit and the car park. Adjacent to the southern boundary are flats ranging from three to five storeys, to the west (on the opposite side of London Road) are four-storey flats and to the east are two-storey terraced houses. The site is not within the Mitcham town centre boundary. The site is accessed from London Road with pedestrian access also to Feltham Road.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.1ha

Existing uses: Car park

Site allocation: Residential

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 10-21 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. On 16 July 2020 planning permission (19/P4047) was resolved to be granted for residential development on this site subject to the completion of any enabling agreement and conditions.
2. Development of the site is an opportunity to deliver new homes in an accessible setting and to provided connections to the streets lying to the east of the site.
3. Development proposals must mitigate potential parking, traffic and road safety impact on neighbouring streets and amenity.

4. Development proposals must protect the residential amenity of those properties adjacent to or in the vicinity of the site.

5. The public access footpath should be protected and enhanced.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.

2. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

3. This site is located in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.

4. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

5. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, area is susceptible to surface water flooding

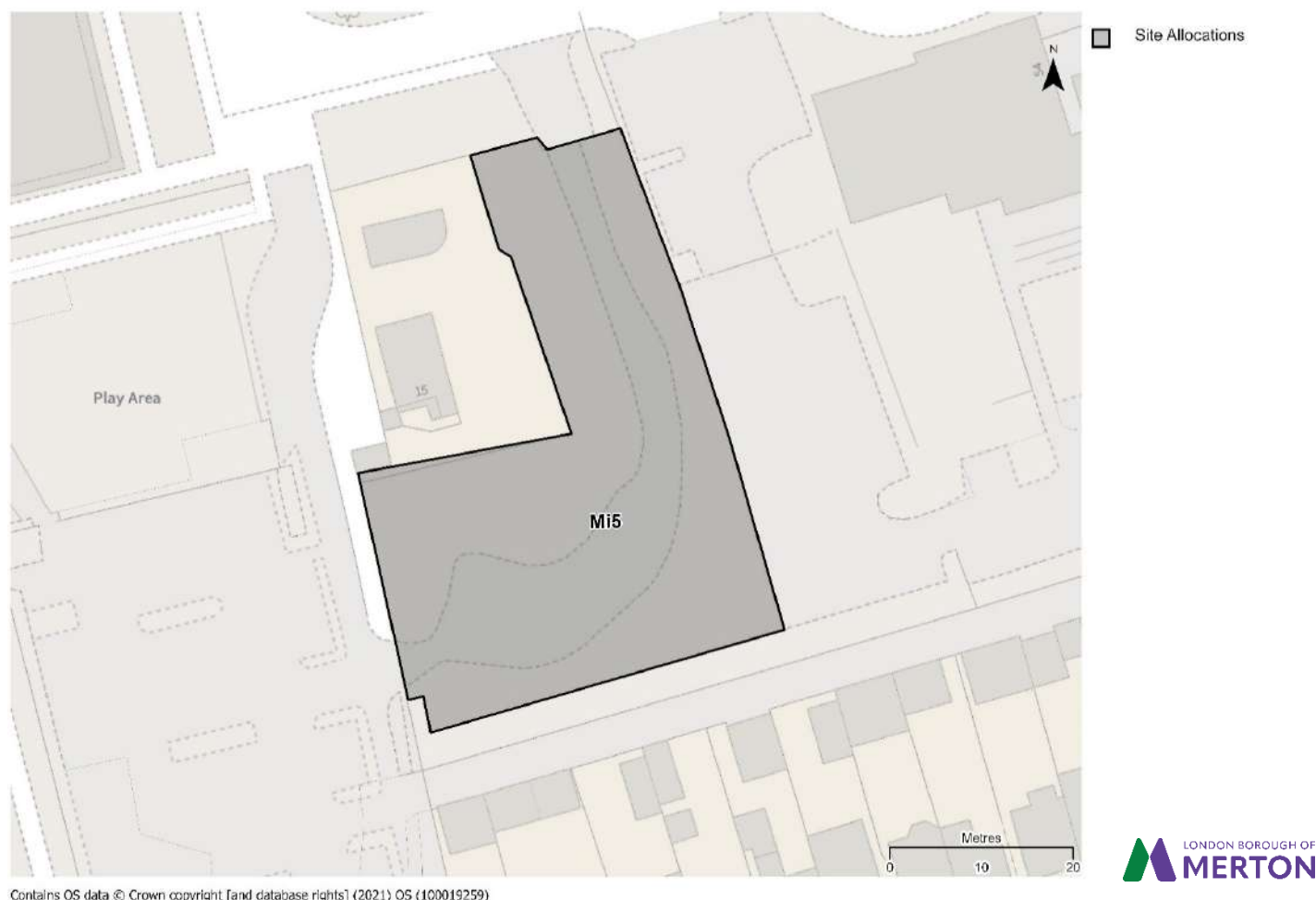
Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impact on ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 4, good access to public transport

Site Mi5: Land at Canons Madeira Road, Mitcham, CR4 4HD**Ward:** Cricket Green**Site description:**

1. The site is vacant, vegetated land surrounding a residential dwelling set back circa 50 metres from the public highway and not visible from it. A high wall surrounds much of the site to the west, with boundary fencing on all other sides.
2. To the west of the site is the car park associated with Canons Leisure Centre, Canons House and its grounds. To the northwest of the site is Canons Leisure Centre. Canons Recreation Ground, including a children's playground is visible to the northern boundary of the site. To the east of the site is a restaurant behind residential properties, which front Commonside West. Beyond that is Mitcham Common.
3. The rear gardens of semi-detached properties fronting Madeira Road bound the site to the south.

Site owner: Merton Council**Site area:** 0.16ha**Existing uses:** Vacant**Site allocation:** Residential**Site deliverability:** 0-5 years**Indicative site capacity (new homes):** 5-12 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. On 16 July 2020 planning permission (19/P4050) was resolved to be granted for residential development on this site subject to the completion of any enabling agreement and conditions.
2. Development proposals need to be sympathetic to the historic setting, particularly of Canons House and the views from the nearby Metropolitan Open Land and have regard to The Canons Conservation Management Plan.
3. Development proposals must protect the amenity of adjacent residential occupiers.
4. Access to the site is limited to the existing access from the north of the site via Commonside West and in front of Park Place.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Development proposals for this site, are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets:: Yes, historic assets within the surrounding area include the Grade II* listed Canons House, the adjacent Grade II* listed wall and the Grade II listed Dovecote.

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes, Canon Recreation Ground and the site is within Wandle Valley Regional Park

Impacts on ecology designation: Metropolitan Open Land, Site of Importance for Nature Conservation and several Green Corridors close to the site

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL)

PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

Site Mi6: 326 and 328 London Road, Mitcham CR4**Ward:** Cricket Green

Site description: At 326 London Road is a three-storey double fronted Victorian building with parking spaces in front and a garden to the rear. The neighbouring 328 London Road is a single storey, pitch roofed, office building with parking spaces in front. Both buildings are set back from the road and have significant natural barriers from large trees on the London Road boundary. The area is characterised by mansion blocks of apartments such as Glebe Court. The site is currently in use as Mitcham Citizens Advice Bureau and community meeting space.

Site owner: Merton Council**Site area:** 0.13ha**Existing uses:** Offices (Mitcham Citizens Advice Bureau (CAB) and community meeting space

Site allocation: Residential if the office and community functions are provided elsewhere locally. Residential use would be dependent on the office and community use being re-provided locally.

Site deliverability: 5-10 years**Indicative site capacity (new homes):** 5-12 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. Site provides an opportunity to provide new homes sensitive to the local heritage assets.

2. Development proposals must recognise the site's close proximity to Grade II Elm Lodge and structures, Grade II milestone and heritage assets near the site and must consider the setting of heritage assets. 326 London Road was added to Merton's Local List in 2020.
3. Development proposals must enhance the frontage on London Road, respecting the character of this part of the conservation area and the setting of the listed buildings and protect the residential amenity of the adjacent properties.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Any development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandale Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Yes. Grade II Elm Lodge and structures, Grade II milestone. 326 London Road was added to Merton's Local List in 2020.

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area

Yes. Mitcham Archaeological Priority Area (APA) Tier 2

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Site adjacent to open space

Impacts on ecology designation: Site of Interest for Nature Conservation (SINC) and green corridors

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport, however 5 – 8 minutes' walk to the town centre

Site Mi7: 370 London Road Mitcham, Mitcham, CR4 3ND**Ward:** Cricket Green

Site description: Area of vacant land facing London Road, currently used as outdoor car wash. Parade of shops with flats above adjacent to the southwest of the site and residential street with two-storey houses to the north of the site

Site owner: Private owner**Site area:** 0.04ha**Existing uses:** Outdoor car wash

Site allocation: Mixed used non-residential (shops, services, offices, community on the ground floor and residential on upper floors.

Site deliverability: The site was not proposed by the landowner, which could delay the delivery of the site)

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 5 -8 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. To provide new homes sensitive to the heritage assets and historic setting and character.
2. Development proposal will need to enhance the frontage on London Road, while enhancing the character of this part of the conservation area and the setting of the listed buildings.
3. Development proposals will need to protect the residential amenity of the adjacent properties.

4. Positive use of empty site with active frontage to London Road strengthening and extending local retail parade. Height to be guided by context of buildings over shops running along London Road to southwest and the proposed development at 360-364 London Road. Opportunity for small site provision of new homes.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
4. There is a bus stop fronting the site which should be protected or appropriately relocated in discussion with Transport for London.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Adjacent to designated open space, setting of listed building (Grade II Elm Lodge) and structures (Grade II milestone)

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes, the Mitcham Cricket Green Conservation Area

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area

1. Yes. Mitcham Archaeological Priority Area (APA) Tier 2
2. The site is in an archaeological priority area and within the Wandle Valley Regional Park boundary.

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

In a Flood Zone: No

Is in a Town Centre: No

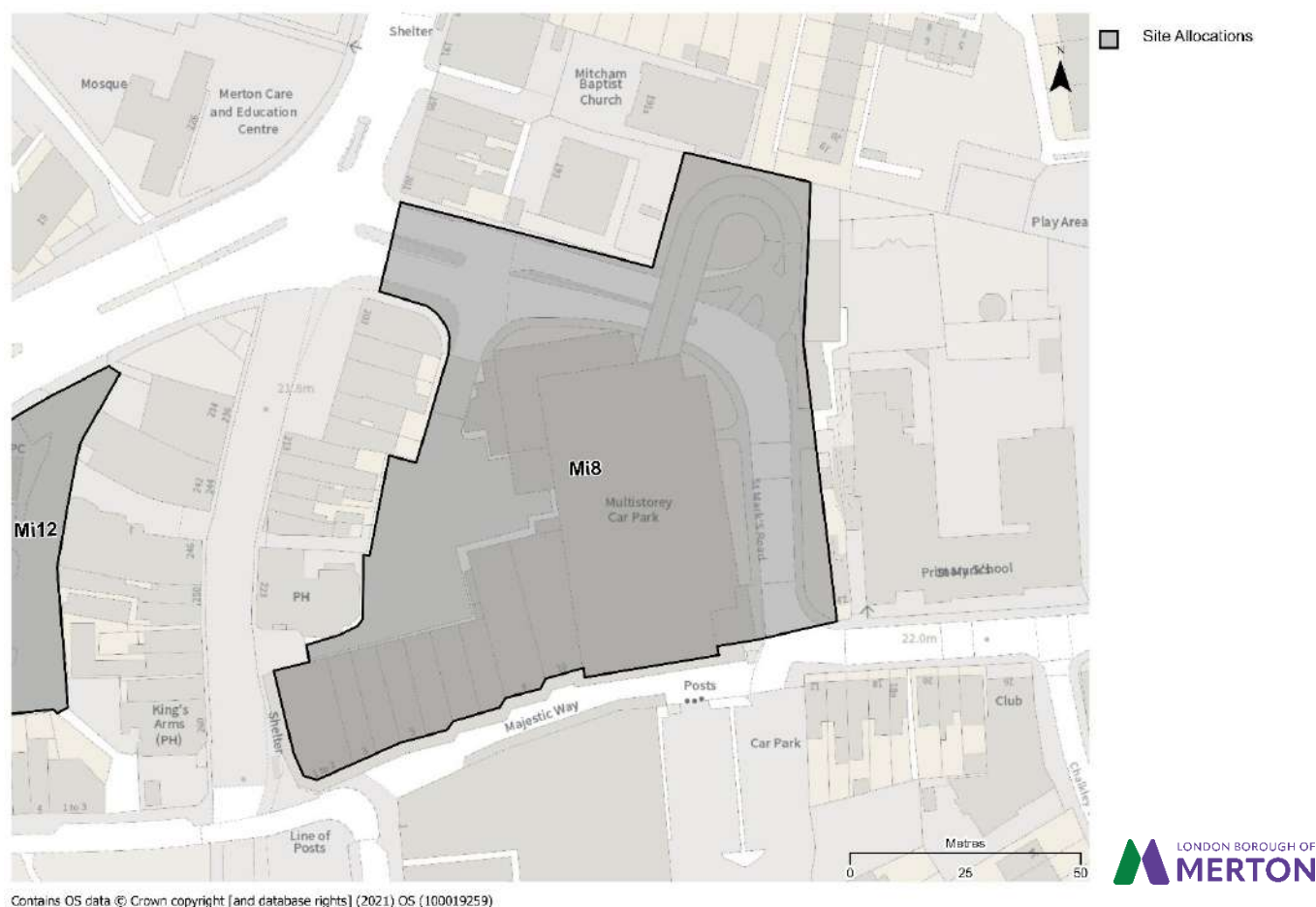
Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts ecological designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport however, within 5 minutes' walk of Mitcham town centre

Site Mi8: 1 to 12 Majestic Way, Mitcham, CR4 2JS



Ward: Figge's Marsh

Site description:

1. The site lies within Mitcham town centre and consists of a series of 11 purpose built commercial units with their main frontage onto Majestic Way and access for deliveries from St Mark's Road to the rear.
2. These units include Poundland, Lloyds bank, Scope and the largest of these is Morrison's supermarket.
3. A multi-storey car park accessed from St Mark's Road is leased to Merton Council. A part of the site currently used as the ramp for access to the multi-storey car park lies to the north of St Mark's Road.
4. The site has road frontage on three sides but currently only active shop frontage on Majestic Way aside from Unit 1 which has dual aspect frontage onto Majestic Way and London Road bus lane.
5. The site is 8 – 10 minutes' walk to Mitcham Eastfields station and trains to London Victoria and Blackfriars, Sutton and Epsom.
6. The landowner says that the existing retail accommodation is let on short leases. The multi-storey car park is let to Merton Council. During construction, a significant and prominent element of commercial floorspace at the heart of Mitcham town centre would not be available.

Site owner: Centrica Combined Common Investment Fund
Site area: 1ha
Existing uses: Mixed uses: residential, retail, office community and car park
Site allocation: Mixed use: Town Centre Type Uses including retail, businesses, food and drink, leisure and community services (health centres, crèches, day nurseries, day centre) on the ground floors, residential on upper floors
Site deliverability: 5-10 years
Indicative site capacity (new homes): 60-160 new homes
Design and accessibility guidance: 1. The site provides an opportunity to modernise and revitalise the town centre by supplying new homes and increase business floorspace in an accessible area. 2. Proposals must contribute to increasing the footfall, the local economy and support the vitality and sustainability of Mitcham town centre. 3. Mitigation measures are needed during the construction phase to minimise disruption to Mitcham Fair Green, London Road bus lane, Mitcham market, St Mark's Road and nearby school and the surrounding businesses. 4. Development proposals' design and building must make an attractive and significant contribution to improving the look and feel of the whole town centre and Fair Green. In addition, be sensitive to Mitcham town centre landmark, namely the clock tower. 5. Development proposals must provide an active frontage along St Marks's Road, adding to the vitality and safety of the area. 6. Development must give careful consideration to the impact on all transport modes in the surrounding area. The development should be designed in accordance with the Healthy Streets Approach and should enhance active travel and public transport connections in the area. During the construction phase for this site negative transport, delivery and servicing impacts should be minimised and mitigated, giving priority to active modes and bus operations. 7. Development may be required to include a secure cycle storage facility (hub) for wider public access. 8. The site is adjacent to the London Road bus lane, any negative impacts on bus operations, including during construction, should be minimised and mitigation provided.
Infrastructure Requirements: 1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal. 2. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application. 3. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
6. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: The clock tower on Fair Green Grade II listed

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes, Mitcham Archaeological Priority Area Tier 2

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes, within the Wandle Valley Regional Park and designated open space to the north of the site

Impacts on an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 5, very good access to public transport

Site Mi9: Former Mitcham Fire Station 30 Lower Green West, Mitcham, CR4 3AF**Ward:** Cricket Green**Site description:**

1. This site is a two to three-storey building (fire station) set in a group of buildings, including three to four-storey Vestry Hall next to the rear of the site (northeast) and the new homes on the former Cricketers pub site adjacent southeast of the site. Next to the northwest of the site is a triangular open space known as Lower Green. The site fronts Lower Green Road. Cricket Green (recreational open space) lies to the southeast of the group of buildings, across London Road from Vestry Hall and is close to a Grade II listed war memorial. On 25th November 2021 planning permission was granted for nine homes (reference 20/P0801)

Site owner: London Fire Brigade**Site area:** 0.04ha**Existing uses:** Former fire station

Site allocation: A mix of uses which could include any of the following: community uses (clinics, health centres, crèches, day nurseries, day centre), other community uses such as a cinema, gallery, theatre; residential, restaurant/café, office, drinking establishment or non-food retail

Site deliverability: 0-5 years**Indicative site capacity (new homes):** 1-4 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Any redevelopment or change of use should keep the building and design should be sensitive to its form and function. Recognise physical and functional relationship with neighbouring Vestry Hall.
2. Mitcham Cricket Green Conservation Area Character Assessment and management plan should also inform any design considerations. The size, layout and location of the building would merit its consideration for community uses, subject to delivery.
3. Mitigate potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring street and amenity. Investigating the potential impact of any proposed development on archaeological heritage.
4. Development should improve the cycle and pedestrian connections to this island site, which could be through enhancing access to Public Right of Way 187 to the rear of Vestry Hall.

Infrastructure Requirements

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Yes, Mitcham Parish Rooms, to the west of the site is a Grade II statutory listed building. The war memorial adjacent the site and the Burn Bullock public house across the junction to the south of the site is Grade II listed.

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts flooding from all sources: Yes, area is susceptible to surface water flooding

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes

Impacts on ecology designation: Yes, the triangular open space to the northeast of the site is designated as Metropolitan Open Land, Green Corridor and Green Chain

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 4, good access to public transport

Site Mi10: Mitcham Library, London Road, Mitcham, CR4 2YR



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Ward: Figge's Marsh

Site description: This site holds a two-storey library and community facility with a car park found to the east of the building. The site is surrounded by buildings ranging between two and five storeys in height that consist of blocks of flats and retail parades. The site fronts London Road.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.18ha

Existing uses: Library

Site allocation: Library to be kept and improved (either on site or closer to Mitcham town centre). The rest of the site considered for a suitable mix or any of community uses, office or residential.

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 20-30 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. A library to be kept either on site or closer to Mitcham town centre. If residential elements are considered, these should be found on upper floors or set back from the frontage with London Road. Access to a library and the services it provides for the local community is an important asset which helps to address income, education and training inequalities.
2. Development proposals must increase the customer service area to increase Mitcham library facility and service, provide more adaptable and suitable modern space for the local community.
3. Development proposals must respect the character of the locally listed building.

4. Development proposals must mitigate potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.
5. Investigation of the potential impact of any proposed development on archaeological heritage must be carried out.
6. Development proposals must incorporate sustainable drainage measure within the design and layout.

Infrastructure Requirements

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
4. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
5. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Yes. The original pitched roof library building is locally listed but not the more modern flat roofed side and rear extensions.

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Area is susceptible to surface water flooding

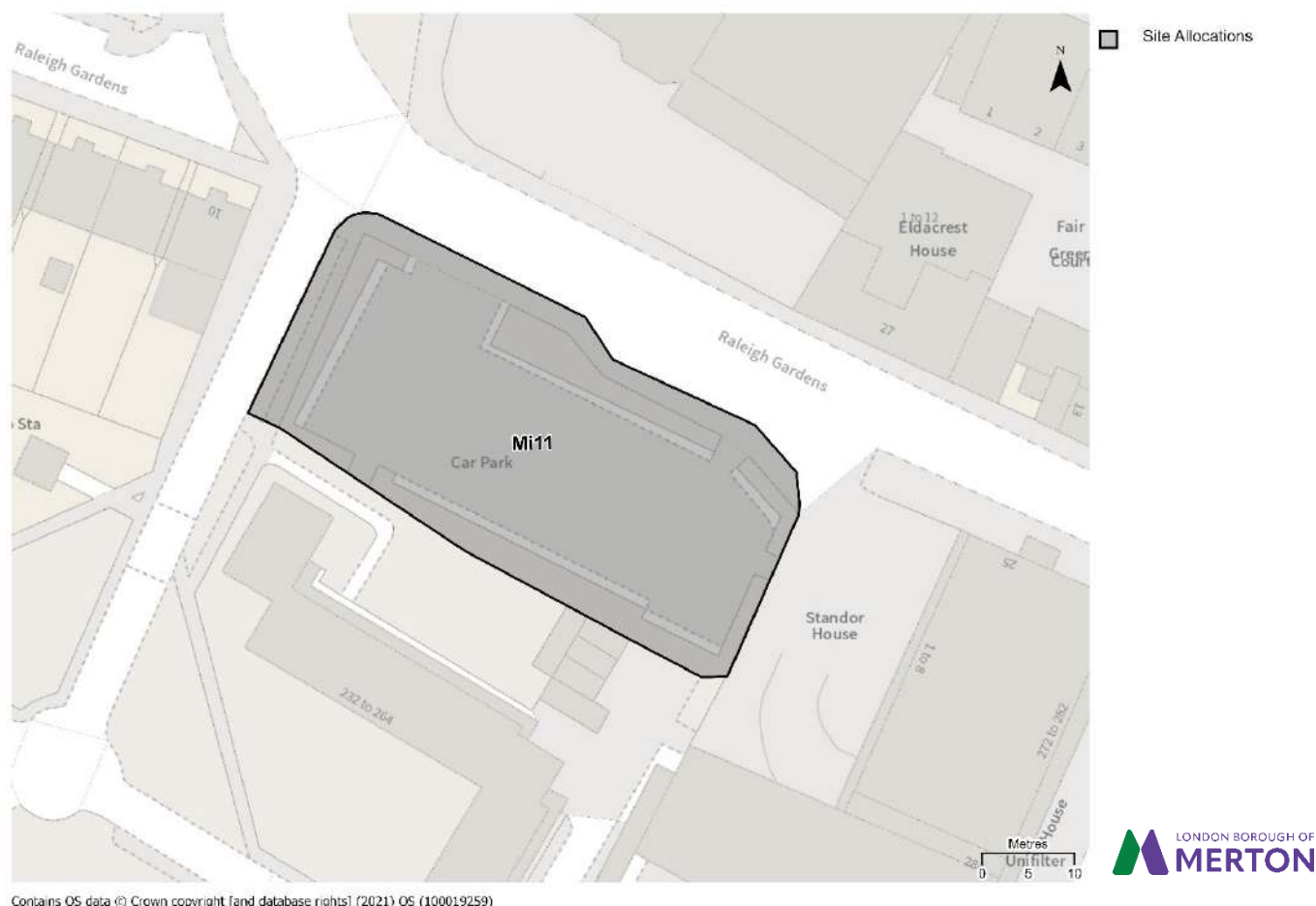
Is in a Town Centre: No. The site is a 5 minute walk away from the Town Centre boundary

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Figge's Marsh open space is approx. 5-10 minutes' walk from the library

Impacts on ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 4, good access to public transport

Site Mi11: Raleigh Gardens car park, Raleigh Gardens, Mitcham, CR4 3NS**Ward:** Cricket Green**Site description:**

1. The site is a small surface public car park.
2. To the southeast of the site is the parking and services area of Standor House, a two to four-storey building with retail uses at ground level and offices above.
3. To the south of the site is a five-storey block of flats and beyond the access road to the west of the site is the flank wall of a two-storey end of terrace house.
4. To the north of the site, on the opposite side of Raleigh Gardens, is the parking and services area for the three-storey buildings that face Upper Green West. To the northwest of the site is a two-storey retail building. Residential terraces continue along Raleigh Gardens to the west.

Site owner: Merton Council**Site area:** 0.11ha**Existing uses:** Car park**Site allocation:** Residential**Deliverability:** 0-5 years**Indicative site capacity (new homes):** 30–40 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. On 16 July 2020 planning permission (19/P4048) was granted for residential development on this site subject to the completion of any enabling agreement and conditions.
2. Development proposals must supply new homes on an accessible brownfield site and provide active ground level and with front doors opening onto the street wherever possible.
3. Development proposals must mitigate parking/servicing impacts on neighbouring streets.
4. Development proposals must incorporate sustainable drainage measures.
5. Development proposals should explore the potential to supply site access via adjacent side road.
6. Development will need to protect the residential amenity of adjoining properties to the rear.
7. Development must respond positively to keeping established building lines on Raleigh Gardens.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes

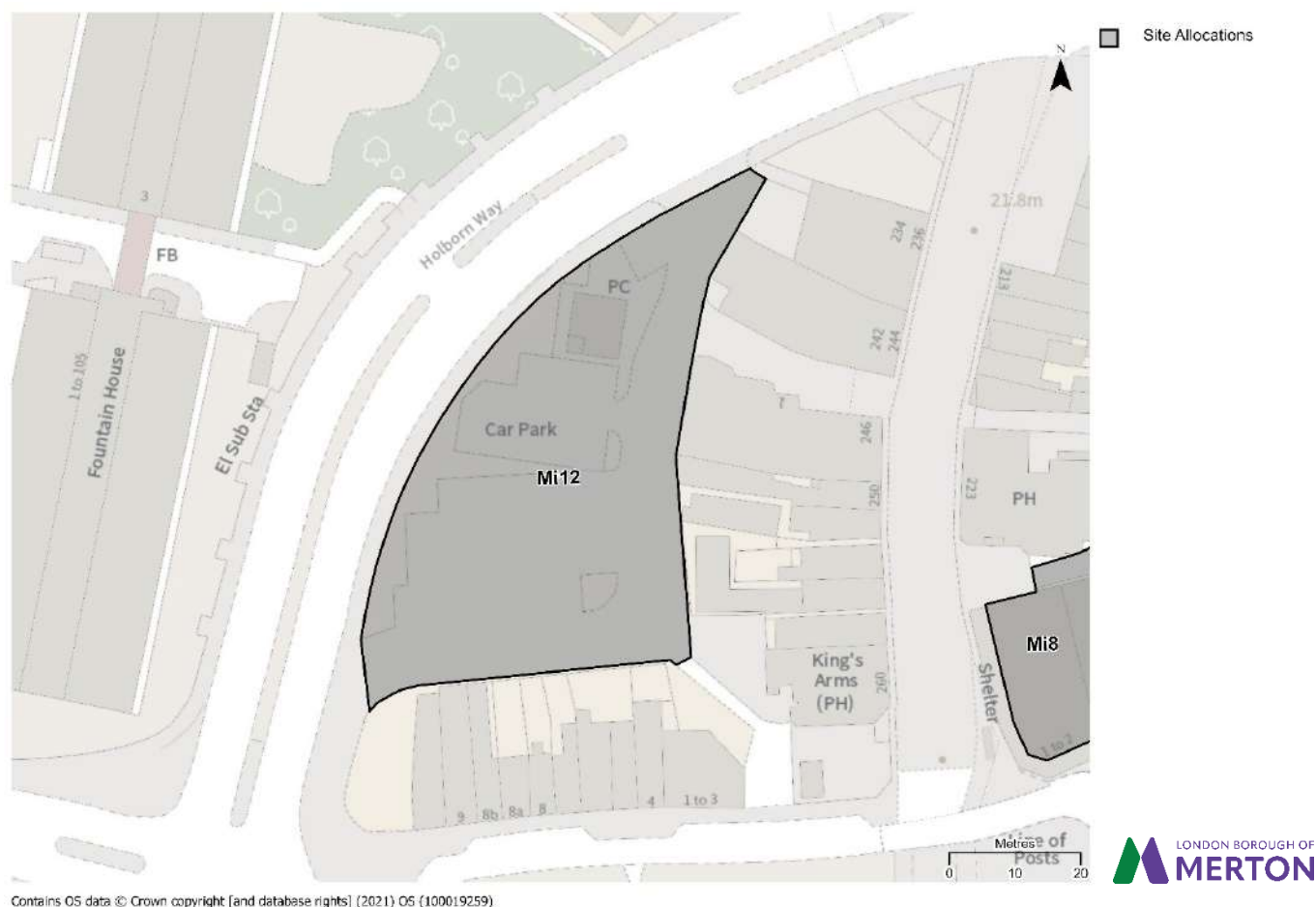
Is in a Town Centre: Yes, found in the town centre boundary and within proximity to the primary shopping area

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impact on ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL levels 4 to 5, good to very good access to public transport

Site Mi12: Sibthorpe Road Car Park, Mitcham, CR4 3NN**Ward: Figge's Marsh****Site description:**

1. The site is an irregular quadrant shape, is adjacent to a busy main road and is occupied by parking spaces for approximately 50 vehicles, redundant public conveniences, London Buses drivers' facilities and a community recycling area.
2. Access to the site is via an entry from Holborn Way (a heavy vehicular traffic route) at the northeast boundary with egress along the southwest boundary. There are two points of pedestrian access to the site from London Road via Sibthorpe Road and from the Mitcham Fair Green via a passage adjacent the King's Arms public house.
3. The site is surrounded by business uses which front the London Road bus lane to the east or Upper Green West to the south, however there are also several businesses which have shop fronts orientated toward the car park. To the west of the site on the opposite side of Holborn Road are large four to five-storey residential apartment buildings at Sadler Close. The developable part of the site is constrained by the dual frontage businesses addressing the site along the eastern side.
4. The potential loss or relocation of town centre car parking spaces will need to be considered in line with other site proposals at Raleigh Gardens and Majestic Way.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.26ha
Existing uses: Car park
Site allocation: Town centre type uses including retail, food and drink, offices, work spaces, leisure, community services and residential on upper floors.
Site deliverability: 5-10 years
Indicative site capacity (new homes): 20-40 new homes
Design and accessibility guidance: 1. Development proposals provide an opportunity to continue the enhancements started by Rediscover Mitcham and improve the look and feel of this central site. 2. Development proposals must be well designed to enhance Holborn Way, mitigate traffic noise for its future occupiers as well as mitigating parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets an amenity. The site is close to the London Road bus lane and any negative impacts on bus operations including during construction should be minimised and mitigation provided. 3. Development should retain and enhance access for pedestrians and cyclists through the site. Any negative transport, delivery and servicing impacts on pedestrian and cycle access and bus operations including during construction should be minimised and mitigation provided. The site provides bus drivers' facilities which must be retained and ideally enhanced as part of any redevelopment of the site. Site may be required to include a secure cycle storage facility (hub) for wider public access. Development of the site must create an attractive streetscape along the eastern side of the site (opposite side to Holborn Way). 4. Respecting and enhancing the character and the views into and from neighbouring Mitcham Fair Green. 5. Development proposals must adopt sustainable drainage measures as part of the design and layout.
Infrastructure Requirements: 1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal. 2. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application. 3. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan. 4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network. 5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

6. The site provides bus drivers' facilities which Transport for London require to be retained and ideally enhanced as part of any redevelopment of the site. The council recommends discussions with London Buses prior to the submission of a planning application.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: The site is within the wider setting of a grade I listed building (Eagle House)

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Southeast of the site is susceptible to surface water flooding.

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impact on an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 4, good access to public transport

Site Mi13: 30 St Mark's Road, Mitcham, CR4 2LF**Ward:** Figge's Marsh

Site description: The site is occupied by a long-term vacant single storey building in poor condition. The site is located on the edge of Mitcham town centre on the main walking route between the town centre and Mitcham Eastfields rail station. To the northwest of the site is St Mark's Primary School. To the north of the site is the Armfield Crescent Estate which has five to six-storey buildings.

Site owner: Private ownership site allocation suggested by Merton Council

Site area: 0.04ha

Existing uses: Vacant

Site allocation: Residential

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 1-2 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development proposals would provide an excellent opportunity to enhance this run-down site and bring it back into use.
2. Development should be of an appropriate density and design that responds positively to the character of the area and its setting.

3. Development proposal must not harm the amenity of the adjacent properties.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise and seek advice from Thames Water regarding the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer

Impacts on ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport (adjacent to town centre PTAL 5 - very good)

Site Mi14: United Westminster Schools site, Tamworth Lane, Mitcham, CR4 1DH



Ward: Longthornton
Site description: This large irregularly shaped site is accessible from Tamworth Lane. It was formerly used as playing fields. To the southwest and southeast lie detached, semi-detached and terraced residential properties fronting Crossways Road and Cambridge Road with rear gardens facing the site. The site boundary to the north and east is with Streatham Park Cemetery (privately owned).
Site owner: Private ownership
Site area: 5.14ha
Existing uses: Vacant former playing field
Site allocation: Creation of new publicly accessible sporting facilities enabled by residential development
Site deliverability: 5-10 years
Additional site information: The consultee has provided evidence of the operation of this site for community uses via rental by local sports clubs for several years, the associated local demand for such uses and the associated financial viability on this site. Since work began on Merton's Playing Pitch Strategy (PPS) in 2017, this site has been part on ongoing discussions between the landowner, the council, Sport England and a variety of national sporting governing bodies, to consider the options for the site and help determine how sporting facilities could be brought forward on the site (refer to Recommendation G1 of the PPS).

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. If the entire site cannot viably be used for sports and recreation, the council will consider the creation of publicly accessible and viable sporting or recreation facilities on part of the site enabled by residential development on the rest of the site.
2. Development of the site is an opportunity to bring back an unviable site into use for sporting activities enabled by much needed new homes.
3. Opportunity to masterplan the site to provide publicly accessible open space, new homes and associated facilities necessary to support residential development (such as children's play space).
4. Development proposals must improve public access between existing public areas and open space through the creation of new and more direct footpaths and cycle paths links.
5. Development proposals must protect the amenity of neighbouring occupiers.
6. Development proposals must mitigate parking, transport and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and Playing Pitch Strategy and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is located in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
4. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 5-11 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
5. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
6. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
7. The developer will need to contact Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to discuss the water supply network, wastewater network and wastewater treatment infrastructure capability for this site, including details of the proposed development phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise and seek advice from Thames Water regarding the development of this site.

The site location**Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets:** No**Impacts a Conservation Area:** No**Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area:** No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts on flooding from all sources: Site is susceptible to surface water flooding
Is in a Town Centre: No
Is in an Opportunity Area: No
Impacts a designated open space: The site is designated as former Westminster City Schools Open Space and is adjacent to Streatham Park Cemetery designated Open Space. Part of the site is within the Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer area.
Impacts an ecology designation: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

Site Mi15 Taylor Road Day Centre, Wakefield Hall, Taylor Road, Mitcham CR4 3JR

Ward: Colliers Wood

Site description: The site consists of a single pitched roof building that is surrounded by two-storey houses.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.08ha

Existing uses: Day care centre

Site allocation: Mixed use community (clinics, health centres, crèches, day nurseries, day centre) and residential or solely residential if the community service is provided elsewhere.

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity: 2-6 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Facilitate the provision of a modern community facility on the lower floors and create a more secure environment, helping to minimise vandalism and design out crime.
2. Improve parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity or, if a mixed-use development, residential uses should be on upper floors.
3. Development proposals will need to mitigate the potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.

4. Development of the site must protect the residential amenity of those properties adjacent to and in the vicinity of the site.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise and seek advice from Thames Water regarding the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

Site Mi16: Mitcham Gasworks Western Road, Mitcham, CR4**Ward:** Lavender Fields

Site description: The site has been cleared. Access to the site is via a driveway entrance from Western Road, a busy road which connects the site to Mitcham town centre. To the northeast, at the other side of Western Road is a large Asda supermarket and surface car park. To the west and east are two-storey homes. To the south of the site lies a recent development that was formerly part of the same site and is now a series of three-storey residential apartments and a medical centre.

Site owner: National Grid Property (owners). Allocation suggested by St William Homes LLP (a partnership between Berkley Homes and National Grid Property)

Site area: 2.4 ha

Existing uses: The site is currently vacant

Site allocation: Residential led mixed-use development with open space and community use (clinics, health centres, crèches, day nurseries, day centre)

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity: 500-650 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The site had outline planning permission for a major residential and employment scheme. The residential element has been delivered over 5 years ago (Hay Drive etc). However, the employment part of the permission (which extended on to the site surrounded by the red line, reaching Western Road) lapsed in July 2012. The circa 33 metre high gasholder that stood on the corner of Western Road and Portland Road was demolished in early 2022.
2. The site accommodates two electricity sub stations, an operational gas Pressure Reduction Station (PRS) and above ground gas mains stemming from the historic installation use. A 65 metre telecoms mast is found to the north of the site on the SGN owned land. The site would require decontamination due to its earlier use.
3. Development of the site provides an excellent opportunity to enhance the public realm through high quality urban design and architecture and allowing development that makes a positive visual impact to the overall surroundings and connectivity to the town centre.
4. Development proposals will need to demonstrate that the scale and type of development is appropriate to the accessibility of the site by sustainable modes and will not result in a reliance on car journeys.
5. Development proposals must be laid out to be permeable and legible with full public access through the site, making it easier for people living locally to walk and cycle through the site to access Mitcham town centre or towards Church Road beyond.
6. The existing “Field Gate Lane” public footpath to the south-east of the site must be protected and enhanced to provide a high-quality link between Western Road and Miles Road.
7. Development proposals must deliver much needed new homes, play space, open space and community uses within a landscaped setting on a large brownfield site. The site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children’s play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Thames Water have indicated that the scale of development for this site is likely to require upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure, but there are no infrastructure concerns for the wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water

Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. The council will be liaising with Thames Water and will seek their advice as part of the planning process. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water regarding the development of this site.

5. This site contains National Grid infrastructure in the form of underground cable 264685. The statutory safety clearances between overhead lines, the ground, and built structures must not be infringed. To comply with statutory safety clearances, the live electricity conductors of National Grid's overhead power lines are designed to be a minimum height above ground. Where changes are proposed to ground levels beneath an existing line then it is important that changes in ground levels do not result in safety clearances being infringed. National Grid can, on request, provide to developers detailed line profile drawings that detail the height of conductors, above ordnance datum, at a specific site. It is recommended that the developer liaise with National Grid at the earliest opportunity to discuss the infrastructure on site. The council will require evidence of liaising with National Grid with any submitted planning application.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings

A mixed-use redevelopment of the site could include tall buildings. Initial analysis of the site indicates that its character, appearance and size could provide opportunities for buildings of a range of heights that would allow for a greater variety in building types and forms, which could enhance visual interest whilst ensuring that optimal use would be made of this previously developed land. The analysis indicates that an upper limit of around 33m (10 storeys) may be appropriate on this site, alongside the provision of a replacement telecoms mast.

Appropriate design-led height parameters for this site should be informed by a Design Guide or Design Code which could be prepared either by applicants or the council. The Design Guide or Design Code should be based on effective community engagement and reflect local aspirations for the development of the area and should take into account the guidance contained in the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code. In the absence of a Design Guide or Design Code the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code will be used to guide decisions on future applications.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: No, adjacent to Mitcham Archaeological Priority Area Tier 2

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: No, however, the site is very close to Mitcham town centre

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer. Adjacent to open space

Impact an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Mi17: White Hart Pub and back land London Road, Mitcham, CR4 3ND**Ward:** Cricket Green**Site description:**

1. Former White Hart public house and land to rear of properties on London Road, part of which is a car park for the White Hart pub. Access from London Road and Broadway Gardens. The playground for Cricket Green School bounds the site to the northwest.
2. Planning permission 18/P2216 was resolved to be granted for 15 homes and retention of ground floor non-residential on this site on 28 April 2021.

Site owner: Private owner**Site area:** 0.31ha**Existing uses:** Public House (currently closed) and private car park**Site allocation:** Restaurant /cafe or public house or drinking establishment with potential for residential development to enable the restoration and viable function of the White Hart**Site deliverability:** 5-10 years**Indicative site capacity:** 10-15 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development proposals must be sensitive to heritage assets in the surrounding area including the White Hart pub and Cricket Green.
2. Development will need to improve the condition of Grade II listed White Hart public house and support a viable use of the White Hart pub.
3. Development proposal must be sensitive to the school playground in design and layout.

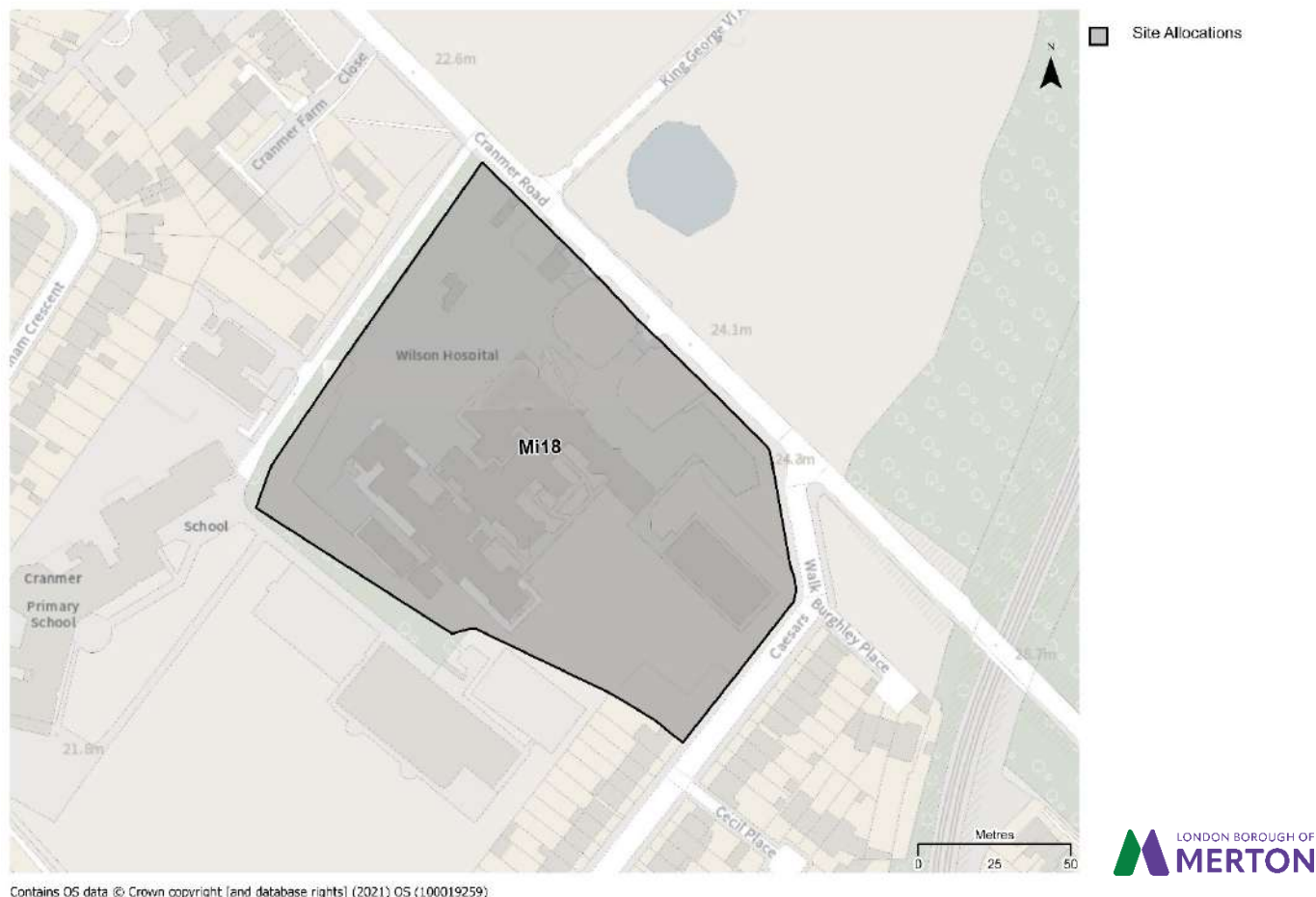
Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water regarding the development of this site.

The site location**Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets**

Grade II listed public house (The White Hart currently closed)

Impacts a Conservation Area: Mitcham Cricket Green Conservation Area**Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area:** Yes**Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument:** No**Impacts on flooding from all sources:** No**Is in a Town Centre:** No**Is in an Opportunity Area:** No**Impacts a designated open space:** Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer zone**Impact on an ecology designation:** Yes, Green Corridors**Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL):** PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Mi18: Wilson Hospital Cranmer Road, Mitcham, CR4 4LD**Ward:** Cricket Green

Site description: The site consists of a large part single and part two-storey hospital building fronting Cranmer Road. Along the southeastern boundary is Caesars Walk and two-storey terraced houses. To the south and southeast of the site is Cranmer Primary School and its playing fields. The access road to Cranmer Primary School runs along the northwestern boundary with a row of two-storey terraced houses beyond. On the opposite side of Cranmer Road is a large open space known as Cranmer Green.

Site owner: National Health Service (NHS)**Site area:** 1.81ha**Existing uses:** Health centre

Site allocation: Healthcare with community and enabling residential development, or residential if the existing services are relocated within an alternative healthcare facility in a suitable location in Mitcham

Site deliverability: 5-10 years**Indicative site capacity (new homes):** Dependent on relocation of health care facilities

Design and accessibility guidance:

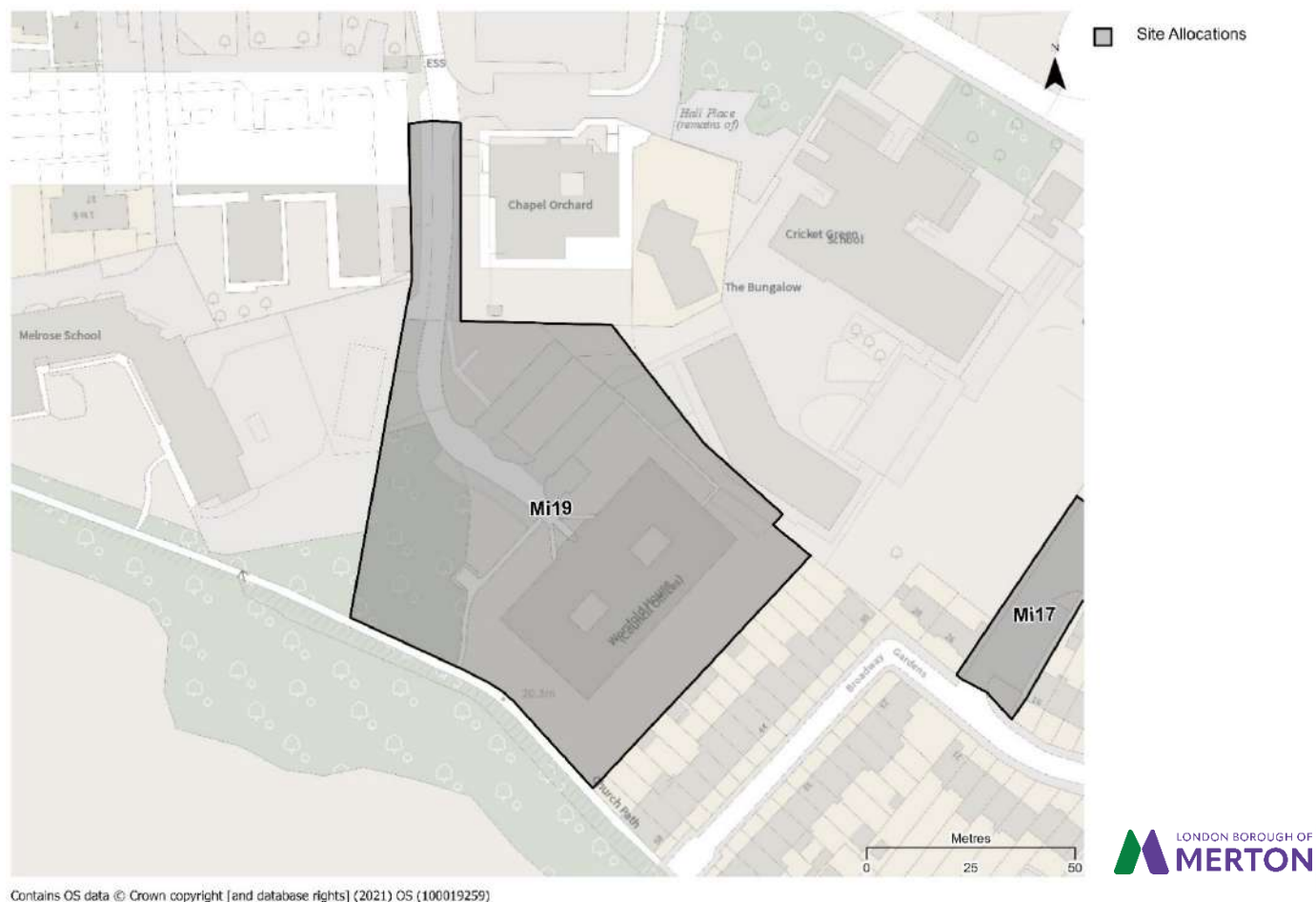
1. Residential, following the relocation of existing services, completion and opening of a healthcare facility in the Mitcham area.
2. Development of the site is an opportunity to either provide a health centre/community health centre in a neighbourhood with health inequalities/ poor health or to provide new homes in an area of housing needs (if the existing services are relocated within an alternative healthcare facility in a suitable location in Mitcham).
3. Development proposals will need to demonstrate that the scale and type of development is appropriate to the accessibility of the site by sustainable transport modes and will not result in a reliance on car journeys.
4. Development proposals must keep the positive feature of the Local Listed building and preserve and enhance the Conservation Area.
5. An investigation of the potential impact of any proposed development on an archaeological heritage must be carried out.
6. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the Critical Drainage Area.
7. Development proposals must protect the residential amenity of the adjacent properties.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. To ensure that healthcare provision is delivered in this area and that there is no loss of potential NHS sites until this happens, the new Mitcham healthcare facility must be built and operational before redevelopment can progress on either the Wilson Hospital or Birches Close sites.
2. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
3. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
4. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. Should residential development be included on site, we will require on-site play space provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
5. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
6. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek from advice from Thames Water regarding the development of this site.

The site location
Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Part of the frontage of the building (facing Cranmer Road) is locally listed
Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes, Mitcham Cricket Green Conservation Area
Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes
Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, some surface water flooding and site is in a critical drainage area
Is in a Town Centre: No
Is in an Opportunity Area: No
Impacts a designated open space: Yes, the site is adjacent to Open Space to the south and north. Site is within the Wandle Valley Regional Park. Site is adjacent to Mitcham Common to the north which is Metropolitan Open Land
Impacts an ecology designation: Yes, the site is part of a Green Corridor and is adjacent to Cranmer Green Local Nature Reserve
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

Site Mi19: Worsfold House Church Road, Mitcham, CR4 3FA



Ward: Cricket Green

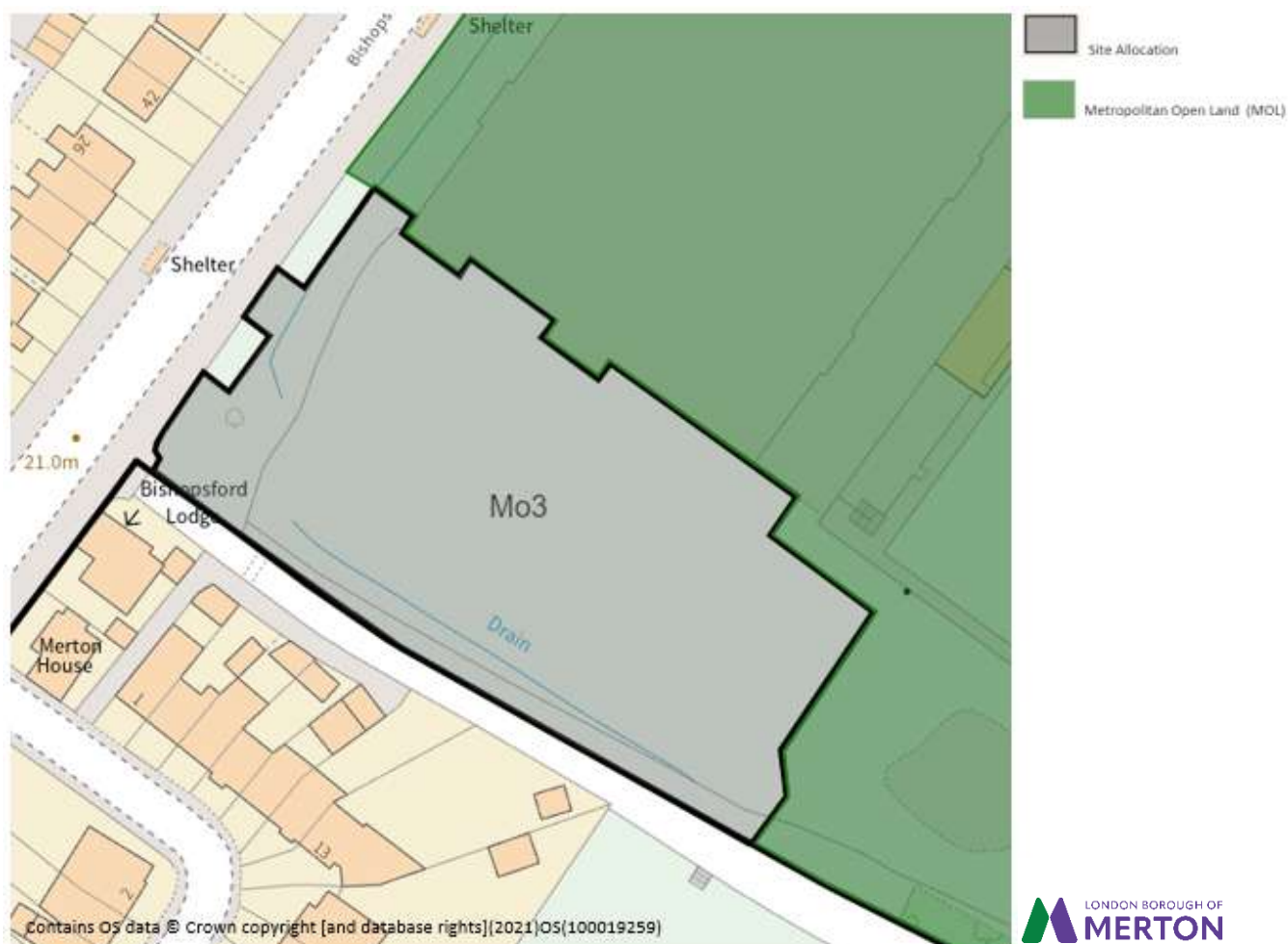
Site description:

1. Worsfold House is a single storey council office building served by an 80m long access way from Church Road. Fronting Church Road, separating the site from the road, is Chapel Orchard, a single storey former office building and a single storey former surgery building being used as part of Cricket Green School. The site is surrounded by sensitive land uses, including the two special needs schools at Melrose and Cricket Green, and nearby residential properties including Hall Place.
2. The surrounding area is characterised by large low-rise buildings with generous spaces between them and many large trees and shrubs. At the southwest boundary is a footpath (Church Path) with a large publicly accessible park (London Road Playing Fields) beyond. To the west is a single storey special needs secondary school (Melrose School) and a two-storey hostel building (Hall Place).
3. To the east of the site is a part one and two-storey special needs school (Cricket Green School) and to the southeast is a row of two-storey terraced houses that front on to Broadway Gardens.

Site owner: Merton Council
Site area: 0.81ha
Existing uses: Wandle Valley Resource Centre – office
Site allocation: A suitable mix of school and/or residential
Site deliverability: 0-5 years
Indicative site capacity (new homes): 45-65 new homes
Design and accessibility guidance: 1. The site is an opportunity to provide new homes which are sympathetic and embrace the historic setting of Mitcham Cricket Green. 2. Development proposals will have to be delicately designed to respect the amenity of the adjacent properties and respect the character of this part of the conservation area. 3. Development proposal must keep the functional green corridor that will allow for species migration. 4. Investigate the potential impact of any proposed development on archaeological heritage. 5. Development proposals will need to demonstrate that the scale and type of development is appropriate to the accessibility of the site by sustainable modes and will not result in a reliance on car journeys. 6. Development proposals should provide links across the site to the existing footpath (Church Path) along the southern boundary.
Infrastructure requirements: 1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal. 2. This site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan. 3. Development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links ensuring that the development enhances access to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
The site location
Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Near to but not visible from Vestry Hall and St Peter's Church
Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes, Within Mitcham Cricket Green Conservation Area
Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts on flooding from all sources: Site is susceptible to surface water flooding and drainage issues
Is in a Town Centre: No
Is in an Opportunity Area: No
Impacts a designated open space: Site is within the Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer and adjacent to Open Space
Impacts on an ecology designation: Yes, Green Corridor and adjacent to a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINC)
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Mo3: Imperial Sports Ground Tooting and Mitcham Hub, Bishopsford Road, Morden, SM4 6BF



Ward: Ravensbury

Site description:

The site is a slightly raised field with road frontage onto Bishopsford Road (A217). To the northeast of the site are the artificial grass pitches associated with the Tooting and Mitcham Football Club and other associated pitches and sports buildings. South of the site is Poulter Park and along the southwest boundary of the site, which is also the borough boundary with the London Borough of Sutton, is a vehicle access road to Poulter Park and the dwellings within Bishopsford House, and beyond the road are the rear gardens of dwellings on Hillfield Avenue.

Site owner: Tooting and Mitcham Sports and Leisure Ltd.

Site area: 0.47ha

Existing uses: Field

Site allocation: Intensification of sporting activity on the wider Tooting and Mitcham Hub site may be supported by enabling development on this site subject to meeting planning policy, evidence and consultation. Any enabling development would be expected to directly fund long-term capital investment in sporting facilities on Tooting and Mitcham Hub.

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 60-77 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. To be considered as enabling development for the Tooting and Mitcham Hub, any proposals for residential development would be expected to clearly prove how and when they would directly deliver capital investment in Tooting and Mitcham Hub's sporting provision. This could be by considering both in a single planning application with a single legal agreement to secure the enabling investment.
2. Due to the nature of this site, a high-quality design will be needed to complement the sensitive setting. Development proposals need to be designed to minimise their impact on the openness of the Metropolitan Open Land and to enhance the nature conservation value of the green corridor.
3. As an Agent of Change, the enabling residential development needs to be designed and built to minimise the impact for new occupiers, and to ensure that the established noise generating sporting venues are still viable and can continue and/or grow without unreasonable restrictions being placed on them.
4. Potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity, will need to be mitigated.
5. Proposals that include residential dwellings, which is defined as More Vulnerable development, would only be allowed in Flood Zone 3 (along the northern edge of the site) where it can be demonstrated that the Exception Test is satisfied:
 1. that the proposed development will provide wider sustainability benefits to the community that outweigh flood risk,
 2. that it will be safe for its lifetime, without increasing flood risk elsewhere and where possible reduce flood risk overall.
6. To satisfy the requirements of the Exception Test and to mitigate the flood risk, development proposals need to incorporate the recommendations in Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment.
7. On 22nd December 2021 planning permission was granted ([19/P4094](#)) for the development of 77 homes on the site.

Infrastructure Requirements:

8. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
9. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
10. Any development proposal for this site is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. We will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement and accompanying plans submitted with any planning application.
11. In accordance with NPPF 142, proposals for this site must also include compensatory improvements to the environmental quality and accessibility of the Wandle Valley MOL, to mitigate

against the loss of the MOL on site. The Merton Green Infrastructure Study can be used to identify appropriate landscape, visual and biodiversity enhancements, new green infrastructure and improvements to access to existing recreational and sporting facilities for this site.

12. Thames Water has identified that the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the wastewater network infrastructure but does not envisage any infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). We will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts on Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, northern edge of the site in Flood Zone 3a. The centre of the site is susceptible to surface water flooding

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

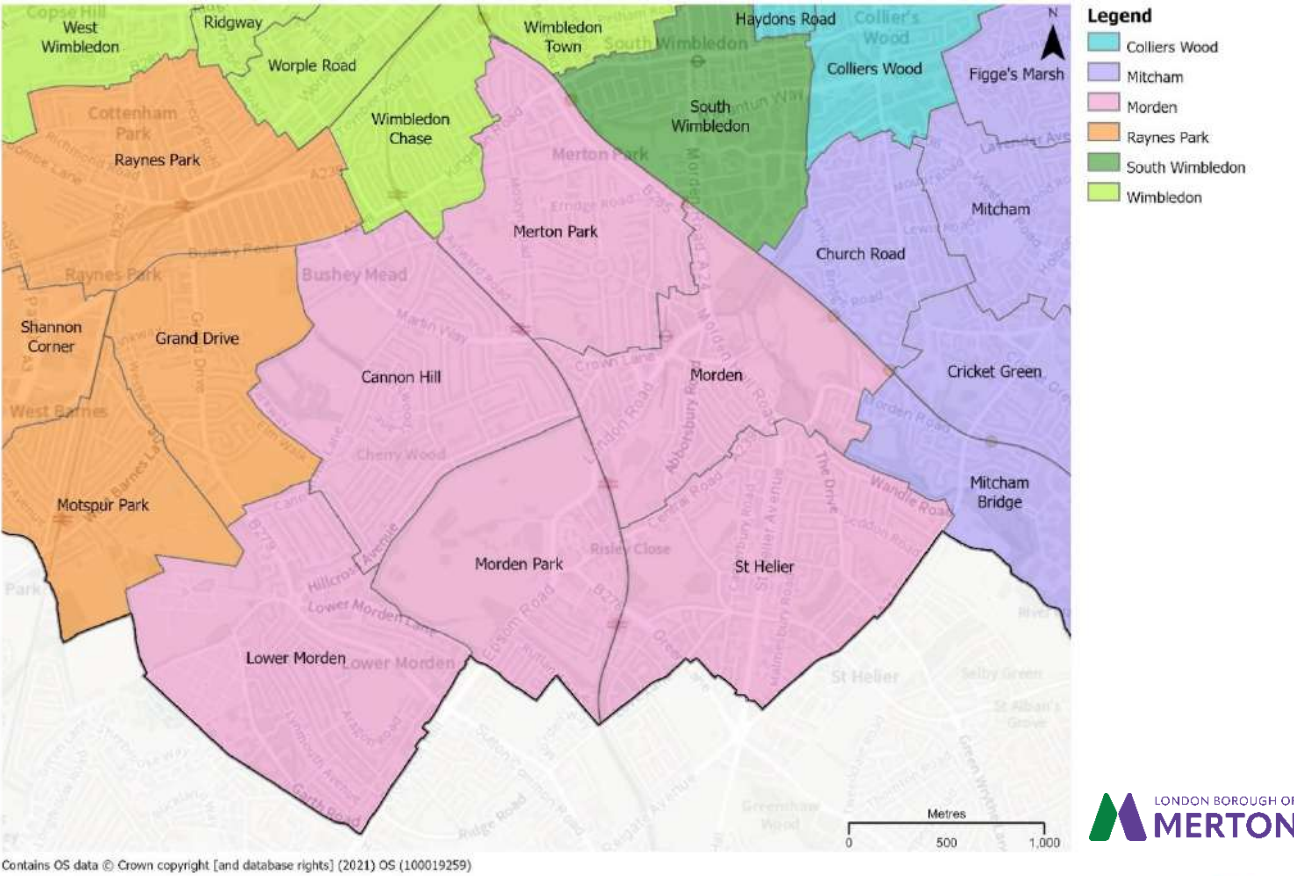
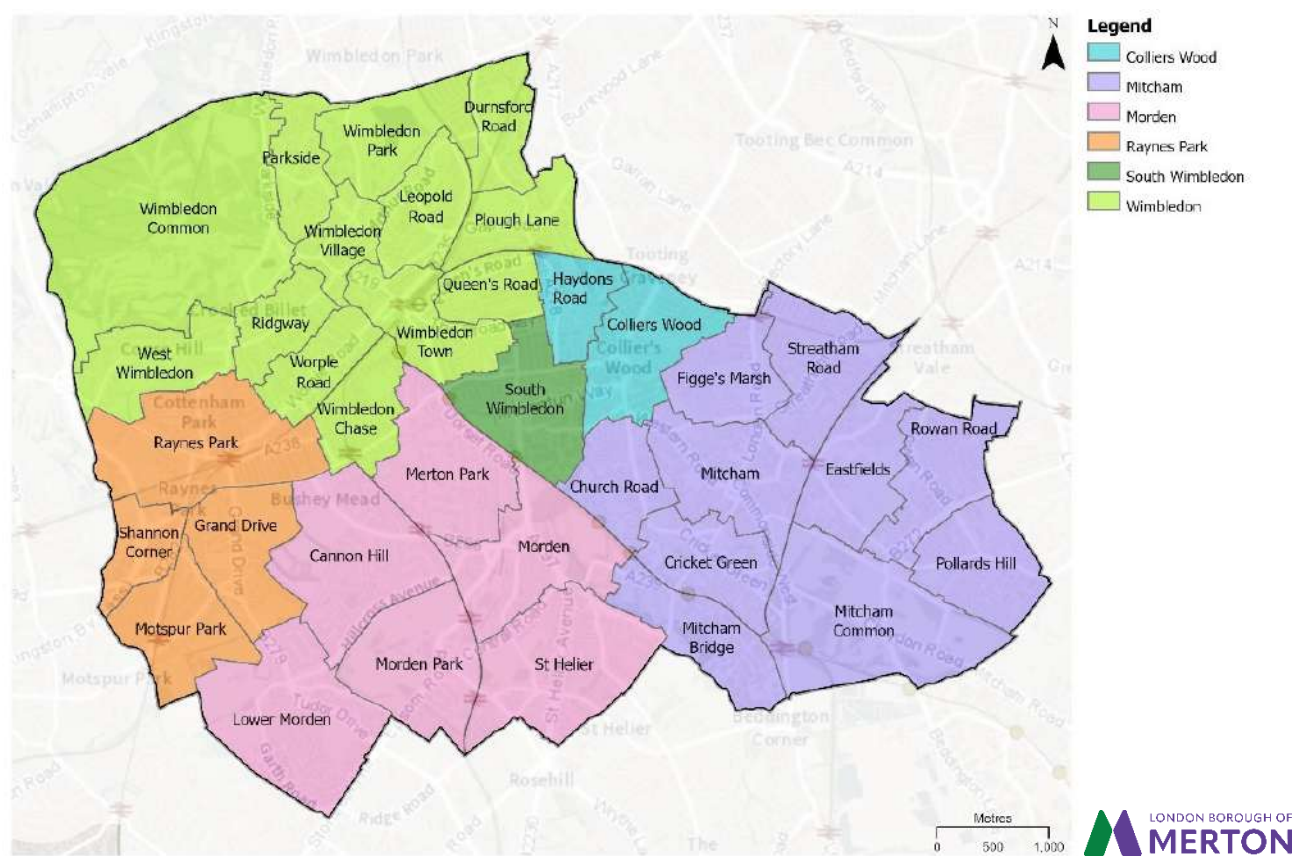
Impacts a designated open space: Poulter Park, to the south of the site, is designated as MOL in Sutton's Local Plan. The site is within the Wandle Valley Regional Park and the 400m buffer area. The site will be removed from Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) in this Plan, to align with the approved Planning Application boundary 19/P4094. Refer to the Appendices and Policies Map for further information on MOL.

Impacts on ecology designation: Yes, within a designated Green Corridor and near to a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINC)

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

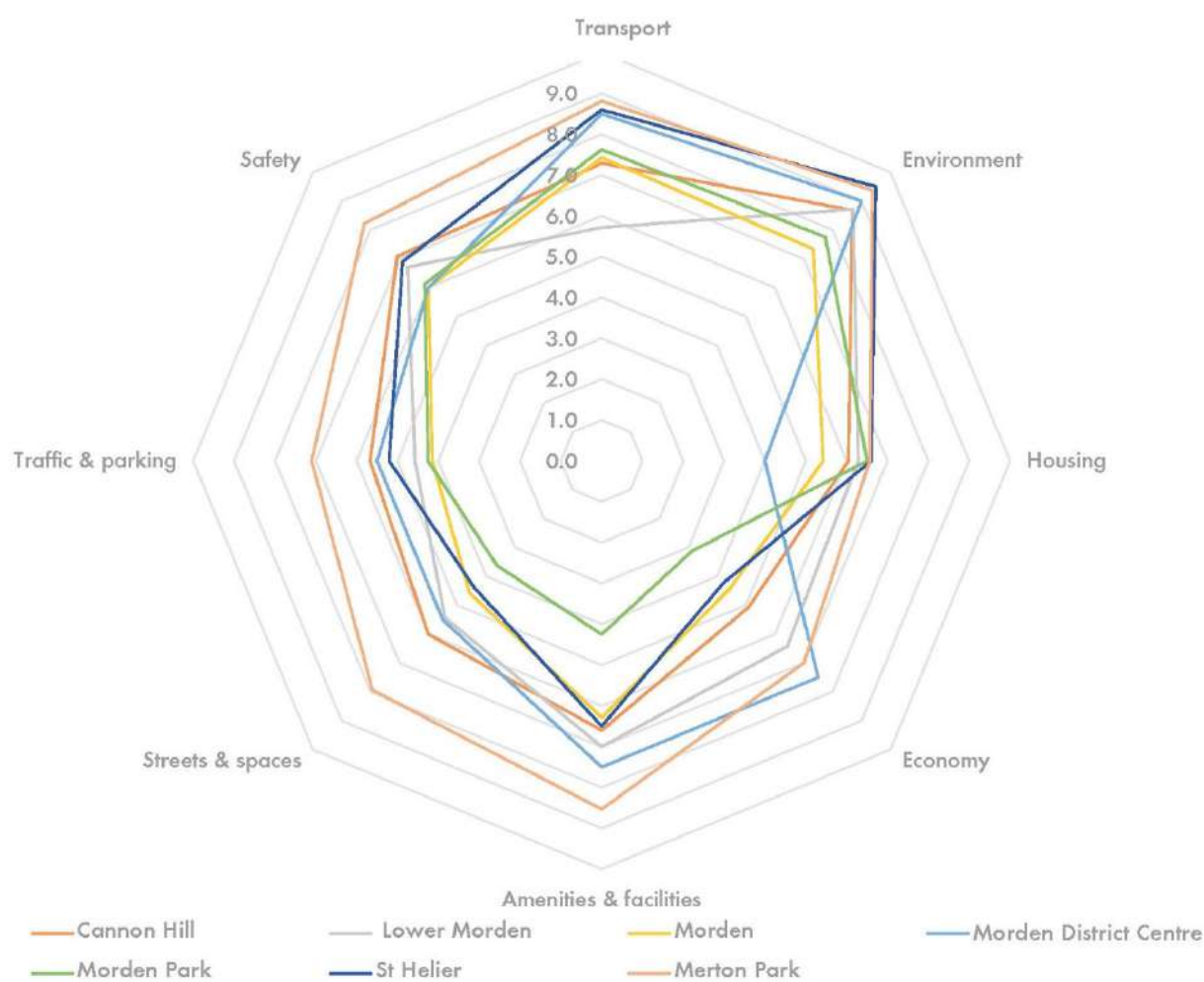


Chapter 05. **Morden**



Place profile: Morden

As part of the Merton Character Study SPD 2021, 415 Merton residents took part in an online public survey, of which 91 people live in Morden. The diagram below highlights how people felt about their neighbourhood based on a series of questions asked.



Results from residents of Morden rating their neighbourhood

Key objectives: Morden

The following objectives provide an overarching vision for Morden.



Providing more high quality homes

Provide new homes in Morden and in particular, within the Morden Regeneration Zone, creating a diverse mix of housing sizes and tenures.



Diversifying and supporting retailers

Support an appropriate and diverse mix of retail, office, community and leisure uses, including night-time uses.



Improving public space

Prioritise pedestrians and cyclists in the regeneration of public spaces and streets in Morden.

Character: Morden

These photos illustrate the diverse character found across Morden.





Policy N5.1 Morden

1. This policy supports the regeneration of Morden Town Centre to create a modern, attractive and vibrant destination that meets the needs of the current and future residents, businesses and visitors, and provides economic, social and environmental benefits. This will include intensification and comprehensive regeneration within the Morden Regeneration Zone (Site Mo1).
2. We will achieve this through:
 - a. The comprehensive regeneration of the Morden Regeneration Zone (Site Mo1), to optimise the delivery of new homes (including affordable homes), improve the street scene and public realm, make it easier for all to get around, and support businesses and other appropriate uses within the Morden Regeneration Zone. Development proposals for large sites (0.25 hectares and above) that contribute to the delivery of comprehensive regeneration as described in this policy and Site Allocation Mo1, will be supported.
 - b. Improving the appearance, user experience and air quality of Morden Town Centre by relocating the bus stands outside Morden underground station away from their current location to help create healthier streets and a welcoming public space outside the Morden underground station entrance.
 - c. Incorporating a range of appropriate public spaces and streets within the Morden Regeneration Zone that enhance accessibility to the surrounding area, with pedestrians and cyclists as the priority.
 - d. Incorporating green infrastructure that contributes to improved drainage, air quality and the creation of green links through the Morden Regeneration Zone, connecting to the open spaces in the surrounding Morden Neighbourhood.
 - e. Supporting tall buildings within the Morden Regeneration Zone in accordance with the details in the Strategic Heights Diagram for the Morden Regeneration Zone and in Policy D12.6 Tall Buildings.
 - f. Supporting an appropriate mix of retail, office, community and leisure uses, including night-time uses, within the Morden Regeneration Zone, which provide an appropriate level of active frontage and do not have an undue impact on neighbouring amenity.

- g.** Supporting incremental site-by-site development outside the Morden Regeneration Zone but within Morden Town Centre, where it:
 - i. is of a high-quality design,
 - ii. complements and co-ordinates with the surrounding built form and public realm,
 - iii. supports the delivery of new homes and complementary town centre uses, and
 - iv. makes it easier for all to get around and in particular, encourages walking and cycling.

Surrounding Morden Neighbourhood

3. In the surrounding Morden Neighbourhood we will:

- a.** Ensure that development conserves and enhances its suburban character of terraced and semi-detached homes and abundant green infrastructure.
- b.** Support transport improvements that enable sustainable and active travel choices.

Supporting text

Character

- 5.1.1. The character of Morden Town Centre has eroded over time, but it still clearly has inter-war characteristics with an Art Deco theme; the underground station building being a significant building from that era and the theme evident in the white rendered shop facades and stone corner buildings of the shopping parades. The scale and comprehensive nature of the regeneration within the Morden Regeneration Zone provides the opportunity to reimagine the town centre and to create new character areas and features. It is important that new development celebrates, develops and strengthens the existing physical character, but without necessarily copying it unimaginatively.
- 5.1.2. In terms of activity, Morden Town Centre is a busy transport interchange and the civic focus of the borough. The Town Centre also has a broad range of shops, cafes and restaurants. Although this adds to its diversity and distinctiveness, it is undermined by the intrusive road layout, busy traffic and visual dominance of buses. These issues need to be addressed in order to enable the town centre to develop and flourish as a modern centre, and to re-energise it as a distinct District Centre.

Background

- 5.1.3. In 2009 the 'moreMorden' vision was endorsed by the council following the first of numerous subsequent rounds of public consultation. The aim of this document was to support Morden in becoming a more sustainable town centre, including an emphasis on Morden as an important transport node and supporting a renewed sense of civic pride. This aim has been captured in Local Plan documents thereafter.
- 5.1.4. Significant progress was made in 2015 when Transport for London (TfL), a major landowner within Morden town centre, identified the Morden underground station site as one of its priority development sites and when the Mayor of London announced Morden as one of the GLA's Housing Zones.

Strategic Development Framework

- 5.1.5. In 2018 Merton Council and Transport for London jointly appointed consultants to carry out all the necessary due diligence studies, including architects Hawkins Brown, to develop a Strategic Development Framework (SDF) for the regeneration of the Morden Regeneration Zone.
- 5.1.6. The Strategic Development Framework defines:
- Why the regeneration of Morden Regeneration Zone is necessary and important (the 'Vision').
 - What the project should seek to deliver (the 'Project Objectives').
 - How the project should be delivered in terms of methods and approaches (the 'Delivery Principles'); and
 - Where various elements of the regeneration scheme should be located and connected as part of a broader master plan (the 'Spatial Principles').
- 5.1.7. These elements are not meant to be prescriptive, but they set out a framework for project delivery at a high strategic level in order to provide a clear but flexible way forward and ensure that the regeneration is delivered in line with stakeholder expectations.
- 5.1.8. The SDF will inform the procurement of a development partner(s) who will help to deliver the regeneration within the Morden Regeneration Zone.
- 5.1.9. Development proposals for large sites (0.25 hectares and above) that come forward to contribute to the delivery of comprehensive regeneration, as stated in Policy N5.1 part 2.a.,

should have regard to the vision, objectives and principles set out in the SDF.

Opportunity Area

- 5.1.10. Morden town centre is within an Opportunity Area as designated in the London Plan 2021 and identified in Figure 2: Opportunity Area, in Chapter 1B 'Good Growth'. We will work with the GLA to produce an Opportunity Area Planning Framework, subject to GLA priorities and resources, which will include the significant contribution that the Morden Regeneration Zone will make towards the Opportunity Area's potential to accommodate 5,000 new homes and 6,000 new jobs.

The need for comprehensive regeneration

- 5.1.11. One of the aims of this policy is to improve the experience for the current and future users of Morden Town Centre, making it a destination and not simply a thoroughfare. This will be facilitated by improving the quantity, quality and mix of housing offer through optimising residential development at the heart of Morden, alongside the delivery of a range of associated improvements to the public realm, transport and Town Centre Type Uses.
- 5.1.12. Within the Morden Neighbourhood there is a variety of family sized homes, with a limited number of smaller dwellings and flats, particularly within close walking distance to the underground station. The Morden Regeneration Zone provides the opportunity to respond to this need and create a broader range of housing types and tenures. This will also have a significant effect on the types of shops and businesses that will be attracted to the area and is important in enhancing the vibrancy, vitality and economic success of the Town Centre – helping it to rejuvenate in a sustainable manner that is robust enough to deal with future change.
- 5.1.13. The housing policies in this Local Plan provide details on Merton's housing targets for the plan period. As illustrated in the SDF, the Morden Regeneration Zone represents an ideal opportunity to provide circa 2,000 residential units towards meeting this target, the largest single development opportunity in Merton. This is in addition to a number of other small sites identified as Site Allocations within the surrounding Morden Neighbourhood.
- 5.1.14. As Merton Council and TfL both own a significant portion of land within the Morden town centre, they both have a major role to play in enabling and delivering change within the town centre, particularly within the Morden Regeneration Zone. There are also multiple other land ownership interests within the Morden Regeneration Zone and landowners are strongly

encouraged to work together. Land assembly will be required to ensure that the comprehensive regeneration of Site Allocation Mo1 can be achieved by the end of this Local Plan period and to avoid fragmented development and suboptimal densities in this highly accessible location. References to comprehensive regeneration in this policy refer to the nature and scale of the regeneration and not a delivery method and, in accordance with London Plan policies H1 and H2, references to large sites in this policy refer to sites of 0.25 hectares and above.

- 5.1.15. A plan-led approach, as set out in the SDF, is required to enable the delivery of a regenerated Town Centre with circa 2,000 homes and to ensure that the Morden Regeneration Zone provides the economic, environmental and social benefits for the local community. This plan-led approach may take the form of a masterplan, supplementary planning document or an outline planning application.
- 5.1.16. The part of Morden Town Centre that is outside the Morden Regeneration Zone is the area for incremental change, where the design and layout of public realm and streetscape is to be actively co-ordinated by the council, so that the Morden Regeneration Zone sits well within the local context.

Healthy Streets Approach: transport, accessibility and public realm

- 5.1.17. The Mayor's aim for 2041 is for 80 per cent of Londoners' trips to be on foot, by cycle or by using public transport and for all Londoners to be able to undertake at least the 20 minutes of active travel each day required to stay healthy. High quality public spaces can support this and the SDF demonstrates how the Healthy Streets Approach could be delivered within a regenerated Morden town centre.
- 5.1.18. TfL has identified their land around Morden underground station as one of their major potential development opportunity sites, recognising the benefits that such a development can bring through improvements to the existing transport infrastructure, to help meet the Mayor's Healthy Streets Approach.
- 5.1.19. The current location of the bus standing facilities directly outside the underground station creates a poor user experience and has a negative impact on air quality in Morden. One of the key aims of the comprehensive regeneration of the Morden Regeneration Zone is to relocate the bus standing facilities away from their current location. Suitable alternative bus standing and stopping facilities will need to be agreed and provided as part of the plan-led approach to the regeneration of the town centre. The new bus standing facilities are identified

as a medium to long term requirement in the Infrastructure Delivery Plan 2021 and in accordance with Policy IN14.1 Infrastructure, developments may be required to make planning contributions towards the provision of these facilities.

- 5.1.20. The dominance of the road and traffic network throughout Morden Town Centre results in a poor experience for pedestrians and cyclists and negatively impacts on public realm. As such, there is a need for improvements to ensure that pedestrians are given a greater priority, including a legible station forecourt that facilitates improved movement. Creating a safer, more attractive pedestrian environment to encourage the high levels of commuter footfall to linger, is also key to invigorating the local economy. These matters, including the opportunity to review the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN) and potential removal of the gyratory, have been captured in the SDF, which incorporates the Healthy Streets Approach.
- 5.1.21. TfL's Sutton-Link project, which proposes the extension of the tram network between Merton and Sutton, has been paused as it has not proved possible to identify the funding needed to deliver the scheme. If circumstances change and new funding opportunities emerge then the case for taking the scheme forward will be reviewed. The preferred route runs within 400m from the Morden Regeneration Zone (i.e. at the Central Road roundabout). We will continue to work with Transport for London and others to provide good links between Morden Town Centre, the tram and the underground.
- 5.1.22. Urban layouts should be based on a permeable and easily navigable network of recognisable streets, routes and spaces that link in seamlessly with surrounding development and facilitate walking, cycling and use of public transport. Streets that are easy to navigate are easy to understand and remember and make places comfortable and attractive. A network of connected streets with clear wayfinding usually enables shorter journeys and more convenient routes that are realistic to walk or cycle.
- 5.1.23. This has important implications for the design, appearance and use of buildings and where they are located in relation to each other. Morden station is a key landmark building and should remain a visual focal point in the town centre. The current office building above it could be greatly enhanced to improve its relationship to this locally listed building.
- 5.1.24. Potential solutions to these urban design matters and indicative details of a potential hierarchy of streetscapes for the Morden Regeneration Zone are set out in the SDF.

Incorporating Green Infrastructure

- 5.1.25. Morden Town Centre already benefits from a number of large green spaces on its periphery. Connectivity can be improved between the Town Centre and the surrounding neighbourhoods and local parks, through establishing a network of green spaces that range in scale and form, to incorporate a variety of uses that cater for people of all ages.
- 5.1.26. The consultation responses indicate that while residents appreciate and frequently use the nearby parks, additional wayfinding features would help to promote these spaces to visitors. The addition of spaces, which include features such as benches and public seating areas, to enable rest and relaxation throughout the Town Centre, was also identified as a necessity.
- 5.1.27. Combined with a reduction in vehicular through traffic, green spaces can reawaken the garden city principles which inspired the initial growth of Morden and prioritise people before the road network. Appropriate planting can enhance biodiversity, reduce noise, provide urban microclimate enhancements, improve air quality and provide delightful routes and soft landscaped areas. The orientation of buildings should maximise daylighting on these areas and reduce wind levels to encourage active travel and outdoor activities.

Tall buildings and sensitive edges

- 5.1.28. The introduction of higher density development and tall buildings within the Morden Regeneration Zone, will optimise residential development and help to meet the need for additional and mixed housing in the area and will promote a more balanced and cohesive community. The additional population within the Town Centre will make existing businesses and services more viable and help sustain more facilities in the future, including the potential to develop a night-time economy.
- 5.1.29. Tall buildings that meet the requirements in Policy D12.6, are considered appropriate as part of the regeneration to deliver optimised residential development on the highly accessible land within the Morden Regeneration Zone. In appropriate locations, tall buildings can assist with reimagining the Town Centre and the creation of new character areas and features, creating gateways to the Town Centre and landmarks in key locations that add character and legibility.
- 5.1.30. The Strategic Heights Diagram for the Morden Regeneration Zone indicatively illustrates a composition of appropriate building heights that locate the tallest buildings on and around Morden underground station. To avoid inappropriate abrupt transitions of building heights, the redevelopment of sites immediately adjacent to the tall building boundary and indicative

clusters identified in the Strategic Heights Diagram, should be supported by a local Design Guide or Design Code, as set out in Policy D12.6 'Tall buildings'. The proposed height for each building within the Morden Regeneration Zone will need to be justified in accordance with the criteria in policies D12.3 'Ensuring high quality design for all developments', D12.5 'Managing heritage assets' and D12.6 'Tall buildings'. The scale of existing buildings within the suburban Morden Neighbourhood is predominantly two storeys in height and therefore the distribution of new height and density should be located to respond to the height of the existing properties and to minimise undue impact on these properties.

- 5.1.31. The Morden Town Centre Visual Impact Assessment (2020) and the Morden Town Centre Heritage Review (2020) use an indicative 3D model of the SDF to respectively assess potential height, massing and bulk impacts, and potential impacts on the settings of Heritage Assets, from a selection of viewpoints. Where appropriate, these documents also propose mitigation measures for future detailed development proposals.
- 5.1.32. In accordance with policies D12.6 'Tall buildings' and D12.5 Managing heritage assets', development proposals will be required to provide comprehensive townscape appraisals and visual assessments to ensure that any tall buildings are located appropriately and relate well to the surrounding context and public realm, particularly at street level, and conserve and where appropriate enhance the local Heritage Assets. A plan-led approach will ensure that any tall buildings within the Morden Regeneration Zone are sensitively designed and appropriately located.

Creating a vibrant town centre

- 5.1.33. Town centres are by definition where a range of different activities come together, which bring in a large number of people to work, live, shop and be entertained. In this policy, when the term 'town centre' is used, it is generically referring to the town centre as a location or area but when the term is written as 'Town Centre', it is referring to the glossary definition and the area designated as 'Town Centre' on the Policies Map and the related matters addressed in Policy TC13.5.
- 5.1.34. Future development proposals in Morden Town Centre and the Morden Regeneration Zone should respond to the needs of the residents, the daily users of the town centre, and those who pass through as commuters. This is essential to ensure that Morden town centre transforms into a place that people will want to visit as a destination. Proposed development in Morden Town Centre and the Morden Regeneration Zone should be of a flexible design to

adapt to change over time and buildings should be designed for a long lifespan - being suitable for a number of uses over time. This is particularly relevant for commercial and retail premises in town centres.

- 5.1.35. The creation of a resilient and exciting high street is key and it should be flexible enough to accommodate change in approaches to retail, leisure and working. With the traditional high street retailers affected by online trading, Morden Town Centre and the Morden Regeneration Zone must look to new uses that will enliven the high street and help to create a vibrant night-time economy.
- 5.1.36. The provision of new employment opportunities in Morden Town Centre and the Morden Regeneration Zone will also contribute to the economic sustainability of the Morden area as a whole, aligning with the Economic Development Policy EC13.1.
- 5.1.37. As detailed in Policy TC 13.5, the regeneration within the Morden Regeneration Zone will introduce changes with regards to the range of shops and other town centre and leisure uses but is unlikely to have a significant increase in the quantum of retail space to be provided.
- 5.1.38. The new Morden Leisure Centre that opened in November 2018 is located less than one mile to the south of the Morden Regeneration Zone and provides modern leisure facilities for those who live and work in Morden. Morden Hall Park, to the east of the town centre, also provides a variety of leisure, community and cultural facilities. The regeneration of the town centre provides an opportunity for improved linkages between the transport facilities and the parks and leisure facilities.

Decentralised energy

- 5.1.39. As detailed in Policy CC2.4, the Morden Regeneration Zone has been identified as a district heat network opportunity area and therefore further investigative work will be required as part of the plan-led approach to deliver the comprehensive regeneration within the Morden Regeneration Zone, to fully explore the technical and financial viability of a potential decentralised energy network. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 Infrastructure.

The surrounding Morden Neighbourhood

- 5.1.40. It is important to enhance the suburban character of the surrounding Morden Neighbourhood whilst also encouraging development and regeneration in appropriate and highly accessible locations in the borough. While the Morden Regeneration Zone has been identified as an

appropriate location for intensified development, it is also essential to ensure that the surrounding suburban areas that lie within the Morden Neighbourhood are respected for their low density, local suburban character and green spaces. Development at the perimeter of the Morden Regeneration Zone are to be respectful of these sensitive edges, to ensure neighbouring occupiers are not unduly adversely affected, and that green and blue infrastructure links and active travel links are enhanced.

- 5.1.41. Morden underground is the start of the Northern Line underground service that provides a direct link into central London and to the rail network locally and beyond via connections at Balham, Battersea and London Waterloo and London Kings Cross. Morden underground already attracts, and has further potential to attract, users from a wide catchment area, particularly from the surrounding suburban residential areas to the south, such as Cannon Hill, Lower Morden, St Helier and Sutton that are poorly served by public transport.
- 5.1.42. It is therefore vital that Morden Town Centre is well connected to the surrounding neighbourhoods and beyond by a network of safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle routes.
- 5.1.43. The on-street cycle stands in Morden Town Centre are already well used and it is important that these facilities are retained and enhanced as part of any public realm improvement. There is also a requirement for a covered, secure and high-quality cycle parking hub as part of the delivery of the Morden Regeneration Zone that will better support commuters and travellers to park their bicycles for longer periods.
- 5.1.44. Within the Morden Neighbourhood, areas such as Cannon Hill, St Helier and Lower Morden have parts that have poorer public transport accessibility and car dominance, which contributes to local congestion and air pollution. Where possible, and considering government's permitted development changes, we will work to protect and enhance local shopping facilities and key services and provide a good network of cycle and pedestrian routes in line with the 20-minute neighbourhood approach to ensure that householders have access to shops and services without the need to drive.
- 5.1.45. Residents value the verdant character of areas such as Merton Park, Cannon Hill, St Helier and Lower Morden that benefit from features such as grass verges, front gardens and street trees, which need to be protected and enhanced.

- 5.1.46. Improvements will be sought for the transition from residential to the predominantly industrial uses within the Garth Road Industrial Estate, to ensure that the suburban character of the Lower Morden area is conserved and enhanced.

Delivering the Morden Regeneration Zone (Site Mo1)

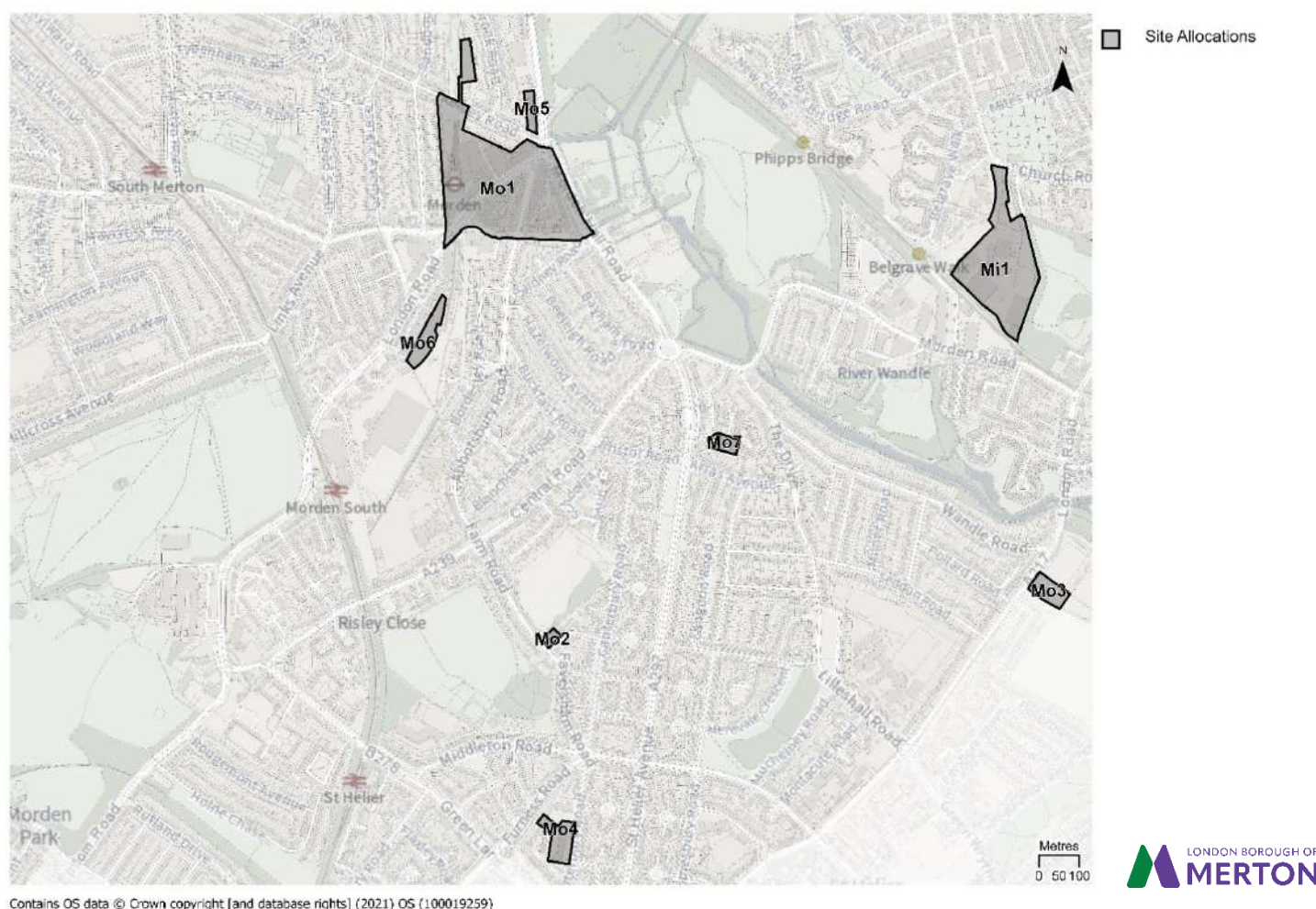
- 5.1.47. There is an opportunity to regenerate a part of Morden town centre, with Merton Council and TfL together owning, controlling and managing a large portion of land, properties and the public realm within the Morden Regeneration Zone.
- 5.1.48. Extensive due diligence has been jointly undertaken by Merton Council and TfL, including viability assessments, soft market testing, engineering and technical constraints, a Strategic Development Framework with associated capacity testing, a retail impact assessment and rights of light analysis. This work has tested a variety of development options to demonstrate that, with the assistance of grant and investment funding, the Morden Regeneration Zone Site Allocation (Mo1) can be delivered. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 (Infrastructure).
- 5.1.49. Land assembly will be needed to facilitate the delivery of the comprehensive regeneration of the Morden Regeneration Zone, which includes the possible use of compulsory purchase powers if considered necessary and appropriate.
- 5.1.50. The Morden regeneration scheme has long received cross party support within Merton Council and has been a key development aspiration for a number of years. The partnership between the council and TfL (since 2015) has strengthened the potential for Morden to be regenerated comprehensively. This is to ensure that widespread change occurs to provide additional benefits that would otherwise not transpire if development came forward on a fragmented basis.
- 5.1.51. Following on from the initial support by the GLA (Greater London Authority) in 2015, with the identification of Morden as one of London's Housing Zones and the inclusion of Morden town centre in an Opportunity Area in the London Plan 2021, the GLA continues to recognise its significance as a development opportunity that can assist Merton in delivering its housing targets.
- 5.1.52. Merton Council and TfL have agreed to procure a development partner(s) to help deliver the comprehensive regeneration of the Morden Regeneration Zone in accordance with a plan-led approach.
- 5.1.53. Comprehensive regeneration is expected to be delivered in a staged process to enable the

town centre to function during any construction periods, to aid viability and to minimise the impact on the surrounding areas.

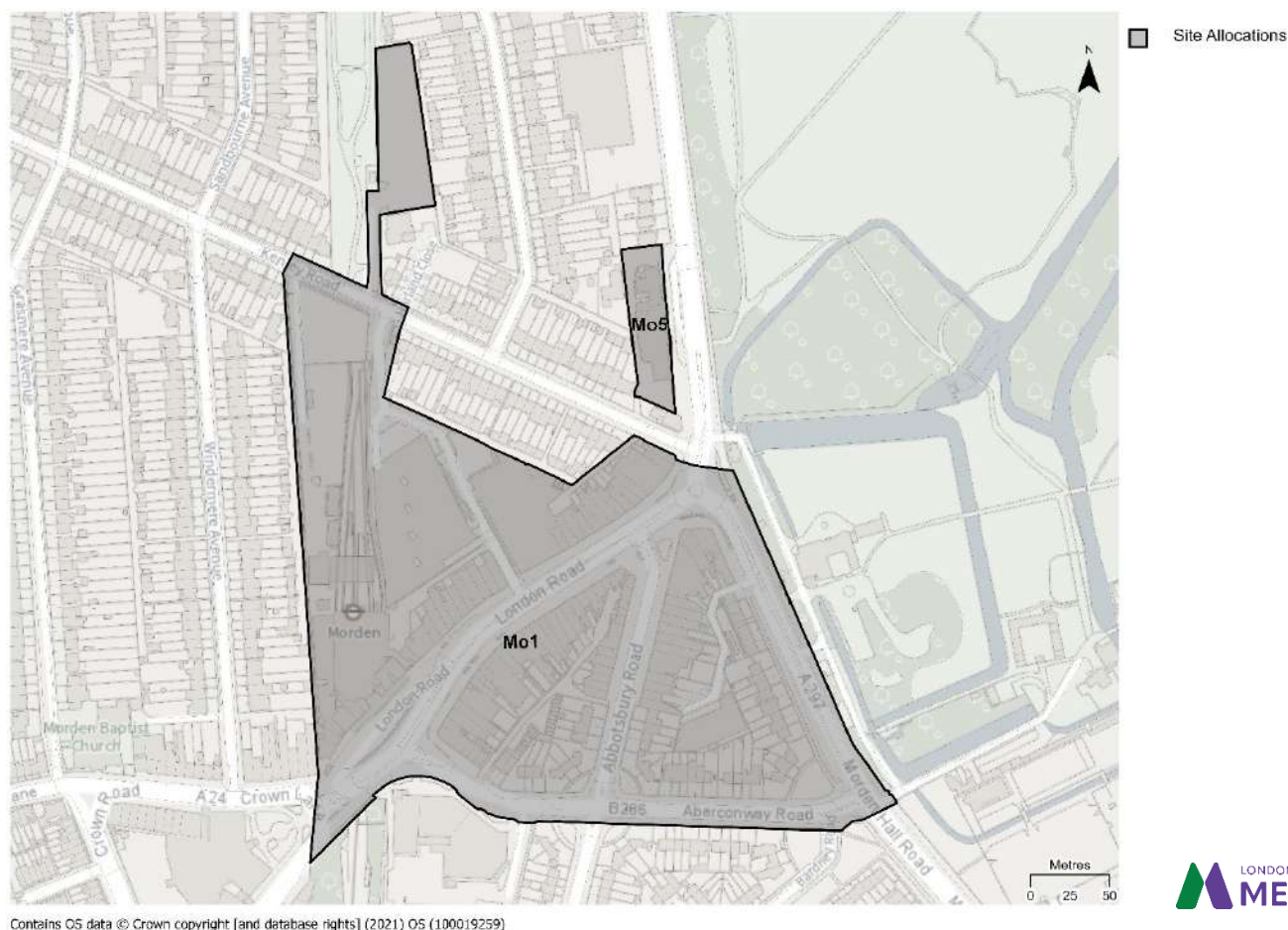
- 5.1.54. There are large sites that could come forward with development proposals during the lifetime of this Local Plan that can help to achieve the comprehensive regeneration of Site Mo1. Unlike smaller sites, large sites (of 0.25 hectares or more) are of a size that can optimise capacity for Town Centre Type Uses, new homes, and support improvements to the public realm and local infrastructure in line with the requirements in this policy.
- 5.1.55. As identified in the Infrastructure Delivery Plan 2021, the comprehensive regeneration of the Morden Regeneration Zone is likely to trigger the need for additional health infrastructure to meet local needs. Morden Road Clinic has also been identified by the NHS (National Health Service) as a site allocation (Mo5). There may be an opportunity to relocate the health centre elsewhere within the Morden Regeneration Zone to provide a modern, fit for purpose facility that meets the needs of the future population.
- 5.1.56. Planning obligations (also known as Section 106 agreements) and Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL) will be used to mitigate the impact of development and to ensure the delivery of key infrastructure.

Site allocations

- 5.1.57. Site allocations are planning policies which apply to key potential development sites of strategic importance. Site allocations are needed to ensure that when a strategic site comes forward for redevelopment it integrates well into its surroundings and contributes towards meeting strategic needs for new homes, jobs, public open space, public access routes, transport infrastructure and social infrastructure, such as health or education facilities.
- 5.1.58. Site allocations set out the land uses that must be provided as part of any redevelopment alongside other acceptable land uses that may be provided in addition to the required land uses. Any development proposal for a site allocation will be determined against planning policies (including the London Plan).



Site Mo1: Morden Regeneration Zone



Ward: Merton Park and St Helier

Site description:

- The site (regeneration zone) includes:
 - Kenley Road carpark;
 - Morden underground station and bus interchange;
 - London Underground Limited (LUL) staff car park and operating facilities to the rear of the underground station;
 - Morden station car park;
 - Sainsbury's food store with offices above at 34-44 London Road;
 - Other retail, office, commercial and community uses along London Road, Aberconway Road and Abbotsbury Road;
 - Residential flats and houses along London Road, Aberconway Road, Abbotsbury Road and Morden Hall Road;
 - Public and adopted highway; public realm, footways and public access ways; and
 - Light industrial uses off Morden Hall Road.
- The ground floor of the Morden underground station is a locally listed building.
- The proposed site is surrounded by the open spaces of Morden Hall Park to the east and Kendor Gardens to the north, two-storey residential and commercial uses to the south, north and west and the 15-storey Merton Civic Centre to the south-west.

Site owner: Multiple landowners including Transport for London, Merton Council, the Verity Trustees Ltd and other private owners

Site area: 8.4ha

Existing uses: A mixture of Town Centre Type Uses, including retail, office, light industrial, transport infrastructure, public realm, residential, community and leisure and sui generis uses

Site allocation: Mixed retail, office, commercial (including restaurants/cafes), community use (including health centre), transport infrastructure, public realm and residential

Site deliverability: 5-15 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): circa 2000 new homes

Morden Regeneration Zone site vision:

1. The regeneration vision seeks to take the opportunity to enable large-scale development in the Morden Regeneration Zone, which will secure economic, environmental, and social benefits in accordance with the London Plan. The following are opportunities that could be brought forward on the site through comprehensive regeneration:
 - a. The delivery of an appropriate mix of retail, office, commercial, community and leisure use, including night-time uses, improved transport infrastructure and public realm, and a significant quantity of new residential development (circa 2,000 units).
 - b. Comprehensive regeneration of the site, to optimise the delivery of new homes, improve the street scene and public realm, make it easier to get around, and support businesses and other appropriate town centre uses.
 - c. Transforming the appearance, user experience and air quality of Morden Town Centre by relocating the bus stands outside the Morden underground station away from their current location to help create healthier streets and a welcoming public space outside the Morden underground station entrance.
 - d. A range of appropriate public spaces and streets within the Morden Regeneration Zone that enhance accessibility to the surrounding area, with pedestrians and cyclists as the priority.
 - e. Incorporating green infrastructure that contributes to improved drainage, air quality and the creation of green links through the Morden Regeneration Zone, connecting to the open spaces in the surrounding Morden Neighbourhood.
 - f. The use of tall buildings where appropriate and in accordance with the Strategic Heights Diagram for the Morden Regeneration Zone and Policy D12.6 'Tall Buildings', in order to optimise development that relates well to the surrounding context and public realm, particularly at street level.
 - g. The provision of an appropriate mix of retail, office, community and leisure uses, including night-time uses, which provide an appropriate level of active frontage and do not have an unacceptable impact on the living conditions of neighbouring occupiers.
 - h. The delivery of low carbon district heating within the Morden Regeneration Zone and opportunities to link to the wider area.
2. While the Morden Regeneration Zone is an individual site allocation, there are also other development opportunities within its proximity, including the following site allocations: Morden Road Clinic (Mo5) and York Close Car Park (Mo6). The Morden Regeneration Zone could be considered for redevelopment in conjunction with other sites in Morden.

Design and accessibility guidance: *Please note this is not a definitive list of issues for this site.*

1. All proposals within the Morden Regeneration Zone are expected to support the above vision and to assist with the delivery of comprehensive regeneration, which realises the full potential of this highly accessible town centre site.
2. Development proposals for large sites (0.25 hectares and above) such as 34-44 London Road, that contribute to the delivery of comprehensive regeneration, could be brought forward at any time in the plan period.

3. Due to the fragmented nature of the ownership of the land, some proposals will need to include a land assembly strategy to facilitate the optimal development at this site, which may involve the use of CPO (Compulsory Purchase Order) powers if considered necessary and appropriate.
4. A vibrant and functional new town centre, during and after the construction period, with built-in flexibility to respond to changing town centre use patterns, will have to be an essential feature of any proposal.
5. In accordance with the Strategic Heights Diagram for the Morden Regeneration Zone and Policy D12.6 'Tall Buildings', tall buildings would be acceptable in this town centre site, to ensure the best use of this land that benefits from excellent public transport accessibility. Tall buildings must however relate well to the surrounding context and public realm, particularly at street level and must be informed by a Design Guide or Design Code to demonstrate the appropriate stepping up of heights above or below those stated and avoid abrupt transitions in building heights.
6. The development needs to consider the residential amenity of the properties within the vicinity of the site and not cause undue harm to these amenities, both during construction and thereafter.
7. Development proposals will have to conserve and, where appropriate, enhance the local Heritage Assets, and promote or reinforce the local distinctive character of the surrounding areas.
8. Development proposals need to include a healthy, accessible public realm that will also deliver air quality improvements. Proposals need to include:
 - a. high-quality public realm outside the underground station;
 - b. suitable alternative bus standing and stopping facilities;
 - c. high quality pedestrian and cycle routes that link to the suburban surrounding Morden Neighbourhood;
 - d. cycle storage including a high quality, conveniently located and publicly accessible cycle hub that provides secure, covered cycle storage for travellers and commuters; and
 - e. appropriately managed and sustainable car parking, freight delivery and traffic flow solutions.
9. The comprehensive regeneration of this site will allow for innovative large-scale energy saving approaches and technologies to deliver a net-zero carbon development.
10. We will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies. Part of this site is located in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space.
11. We will require on-site provision of play space in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan. This site is an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Developers should engage at an early stage with the owners of the Morden Road Clinic and Morden Hall Medical Centre (Site Mo5), as the Morden Regeneration Zone development is likely to trigger a need for a health infrastructure contribution whilst also presenting an opportunity for the delivery of a modern replacement medical facility within the Morden Regeneration Zone boundary.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.

4. Any development proposal for this site is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. We will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement and accompanying plans submitted with any planning application.
5. Thames Water has identified that the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply, water treatment and wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development in order to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). We will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development (s) of this site.
6. The site is close to the A24 which forms part of the Transport of London Road Network. Transport for London requests no new access or servicing take place from the A24. The London Underground operational assets will need to be safeguarded, with scope for the potential consolidation of uses/facilities to allow for a more efficient use of the site. We will require evidence that the developer has engaged with London Underground, to be submitted with any planning application for the site.
7. The developer will need to engage with TfL to provide suitable alternative bus stand and bus stop facilities. Where appropriate, development proposals may be required to make financial contributions towards the delivery of these facilities, in the form of planning obligations.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Merton Character Study 2021 and other supporting design evidence has informed the range of appropriate heights set out in Policy D12.6 'Tall Buildings' and the Strategic Heights Diagram for the Morden Regeneration Zone. However, appropriate design-led height parameters for this site should be informed by a Design Guide or Design Code, which could be prepared either by applicants or the council. The Design Guide or Design Code should be based on effective community engagement, reflect local aspirations for the development of the area and should take into account the guidance contained in the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code. In the absence of a Design Guide or Design Code the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code will be used to guide decisions on future applications.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Yes. The original ground level element of the Morden underground station building is locally listed and along the eastern boundary of the site is Morden Hall Park, which is a registered Historic Park and Garden and holds many locally and statutory listed buildings, walls and other structures.

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes, parts of Morden Hall Road and Aberconway Road that are within the site boundary, are within the Wandle Valley Conservation Area and Morden Park is the nearest part (~600m) of the Upper Morden Conservation Area

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: Yes, a part of the site is within the Stane Street Tier 2 Archaeological Priority Area

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, some parts of the site are susceptible for groundwater and surface water flooding

Is in a Town Centre: Yes, a substantial part of the site is within Morden District Town Centre
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes
Impacts a designated open space: Adjacent to Open Space, Metropolitan Open Land, Site of Importance for Nature Conservation, Green Corridor and is within 400m of the Wandle Valley Regional Park. Yes, north western boundary, the site adjoins the Kendor Gardens Open Space and the Morden Regeneration Zone is in the Wandle Valley Regional Park.
Impact on an ecology designation: Morden Hall Park to the east of the site, is designated as: Metropolitan Open Land (MOL), Site of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINC), Green Corridor
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): Most of the site is PTAL 6a and a small part at the northern end of the site is rated PTAL 5

Site Mo2: Farm Road Church, Farm Road, Morden, SM4 6RA



Ward: St Helier

Site description: The site is located on the corner of Combermere Road and Farm Road, with frontage onto both streets. To the northwest of the site is Merton College Playing Fields and The Cottage associated with it. To the northeast of the site are the terraced houses at Combermere Road. The surrounding area consists of two-storey terraced housing built in the 1920s and 1930s.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.12ha

Existing uses: Former church (unused for approx. 7-8 years) and associated building: vacant

Site allocation: Residential

Site Deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 14-18 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development of the site provides an opportunity to supply new homes by bringing back this under used brownfield site and create new active frontages along Farm Road and Combermere Road.
2. Development proposals will need to protect and not unduly harm the amenity of neighbouring residential occupiers and the character of the area.
3. Proposals must mitigate and manage the impacts of parking on the neighbourhood and the amenity.

4. On 16 July 2020 Merton's Planning Applications Committee resolved to grant planning permission for the development of 18 homes on the site, subject to the completion of an enabling agreement and conditions.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. SES (Sutton and East Surrey) Water has not identified any concerns about the water supply network infrastructure in relation to the development of the site. However, we strongly recommend that the developer liaise with SES Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. We will need evidence of liaising with SES Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise and seek advice from SES Water about the development of this site.
5. Thames Water has identified that the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). We will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: No

Is in a Town Centre: No

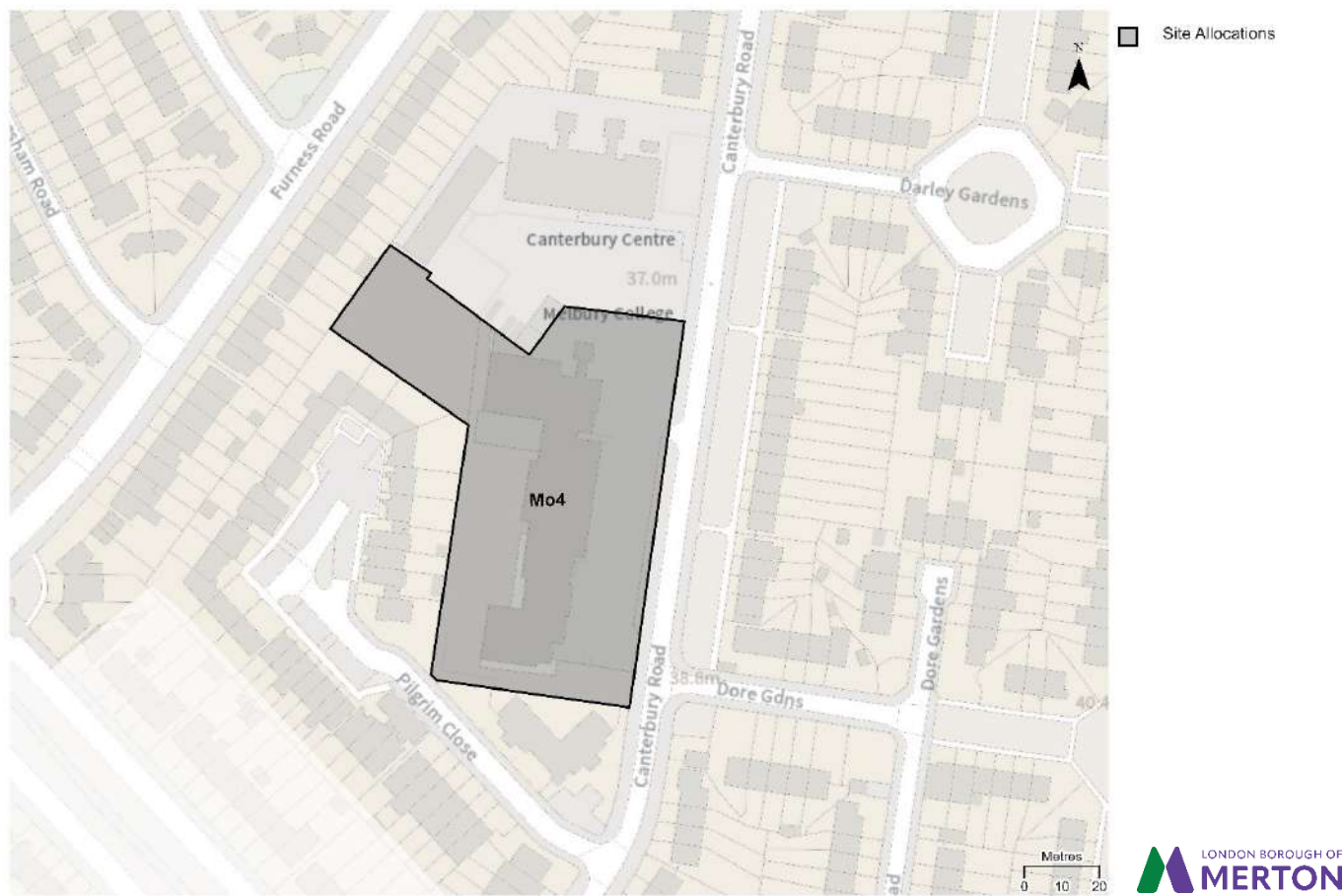
Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes. The site adjoins the former Merton College Playing Fields and is near to the Morden Recreation Ground.

Impact on ecology designation: Yes. The southern part of the site is close to a Site of Natural Conservation (SINC) and a Green Corridor.

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 1a to 2, poor access to public transport

Site Mo4: Chaucer Centre Canterbury Road, Morden, SM4 6PX



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Ward: St Helier
Site description: The Chaucer Centre is a two-storey building used as a venue for training, meetings and conferences, for council staff and the Merton Music Foundation. North of the site is the Smart Centre, which is an education facility and a former nursery school building. The site is surrounded by two-storey terraced houses. Access to the site is obtained from Canterbury Road.
Site owner: Merton Council
Site area: 0.63 ha
Existing uses: Training, meeting and conference centre
Site allocation: Mixed-use residential and community uses such as clinics, health centres, crèches, day nurseries, day centre or solely residential, subject to the existing training facility being provided on a suitable site elsewhere within the borough.
Site deliverability: 5-10 years
Indicative site capacity (new homes): 35-65 new homes
Design and accessibility guidance: 1. In a mixed-use development, residential uses should be on upper floors. A mix of uses including residential will help the provision of modern community facilities on lower floors and create a more secure environment helping to minimise vandalism and crime.

2. We will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies. The site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space.
3. We will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan. This site is an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years.
4. Development proposals will need to demonstrate that the scale and type of development is appropriate to the accessibility of the site by sustainable modes and will not result in a reliance on car journeys. Development proposals will need to maximise the potential to access the site by sustainable travel modes and mitigate potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.
5. Development proposals must protect and not unduly harm the residential amenity of those properties next to or in the vicinity of the site.
6. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the Critical Drainage Area on portions of the north and west of the site.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. SES Water has not identified any concerns about the water supply network infrastructure in relation to the development of the site. However, we strongly recommend that the developer engage with SES Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. We will need evidence of engagement with SES Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, engage with and seek advice from SES Water about the development of this site.
4. Thames Water has identified that the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). We will need evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

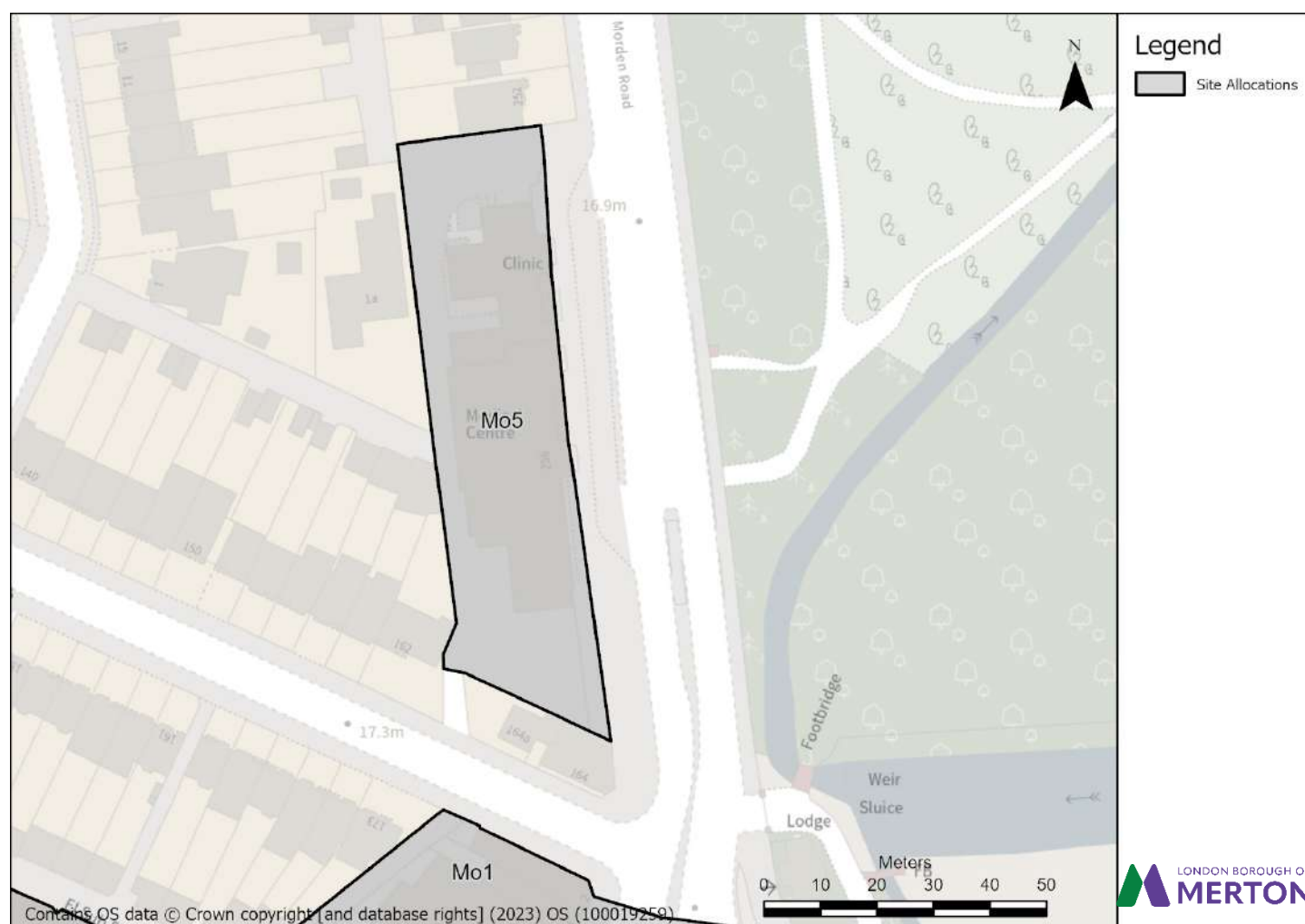
Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, susceptible to surface water flooding
Is in a Town Centre: No
Is in an Opportunity Area: No
Impacts a designated open space: No
Impacts on ecology designation: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Mo5: Morden Road Clinic and Morden Hall Medical Centre Morden Road, Morden, SW19 3DA



Ward: Merton Park

Site description: The site, occupied by a GP practice and pharmacy, consists of a part single and part two-storey building fronting Morden Road (A24) and is surrounded to the north, south and west by single and two-storey houses. To the south of the site is also a two-storey building consisting of a commercial unit and a dwelling. To the east, on the opposite side of Morden Road, is Morden Hall Park.

Site owner: NHS Property Services and private ownership

Site area: 0.24ha

Existing uses: Primary NHS healthcare including pharmacy

Site allocation: Healthcare led mixed-use scheme with residential or solely residential if an NHS primary healthcare facility with similar or greater capacity is provided within Morden town centre.

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 38-54 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The development of this site to provide additional healthcare capacity and/or housing would depend on the additional needs assessed and funding provided from the redevelopment of other sites within Morden town centre. Its redevelopment is therefore linked with the regeneration of Morden town centre.
2. Development proposals must be sensitive to the residential properties next to and in the vicinity of the site and the potential impact on the local Heritage Assets, i.e., the Wandle Valley Conservation Area, Morden Hall Park and the Stane Street Tier II Archaeological Priority Area.
3. Mitigation measures for potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity, must be part of any development proposal.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Development proposals will need to demonstrate that clinical capacity will be maintained for residents during the redevelopment of this site.
3. Any development proposal for this site is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. We will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, we strongly recommend that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. We will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
6. The site is close to the A24 which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (LTRN) - no new access or servicing should take place from the A24.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: Morden Hall Park, which includes historic buildings to the east of the site, is also a registered Historic Park and Garden (Grade II)

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes, adjacent to the Wandle Valley Conservation Area

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact on flooding from all sources: Surrounding area is susceptible to surface water flooding

Is in a Town Centre: No

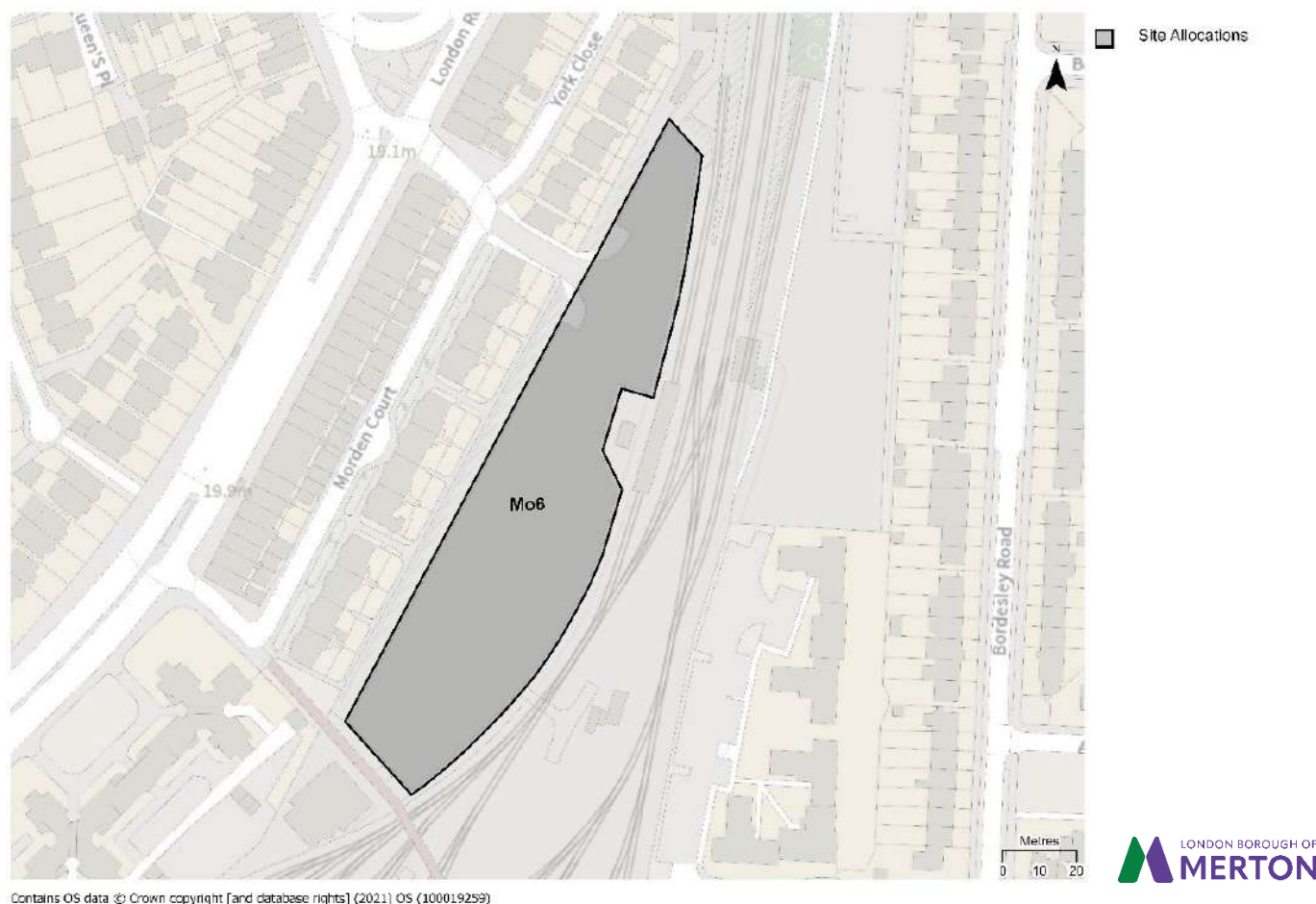
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts on ecology designation: Yes, the nearby Morden Hall Park is also designated as Metropolitan Open Land, Green Corridor and a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation.

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL ranging from 5 – 6a very good to excellent access to public transport

Site Mo6: York Close Car Park Morden, SM4



Ward: Merton Park

Site description:

This site is an open surface level pay and display car park with a single access point via Morden Court. To the west of the site are two-storey residential buildings along Morden Court and York Close and to the east is the Morden underground railway depot.

Site owner: Transport for London (London Borough of Merton Leasehold).

Site area: 0.66ha

Existing uses: Car Park

Site allocation: Parking and residential or solely residential, if not needed for parking

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 35–45 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The site is to contribute to the vision of Morden Town centre regeneration plan.
2. The potential impacts of displaced commuter parking on neighbouring streets and amenity need to be addressed as part of any development proposals.
3. Development proposals will need to be sensitive to the residential amenity of the existing neighbouring dwellings and the occupiers of any new dwellings, (as in line with the Agent of Change principles set out

in the London Plan), not harm the viability and growth of the adjacent train depot and must incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the critical drainage issues.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. SES Water has not identified any concerns about the water supply network infrastructure in relation to the development of the site. However, we strongly recommend that the developer engage with SES Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. We will need evidence of engagement with SES Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from SES Water about the development of this site.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, we strongly recommend that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. We will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
5. Any development proposal for this site, is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. We will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
6. We will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies. This site is an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space.
7. We will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan. The site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 5-11 years and 0-4 years.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact on flooding from all sources: A small part of the site, at the north eastern boundary, is within a Critical Drainage Area

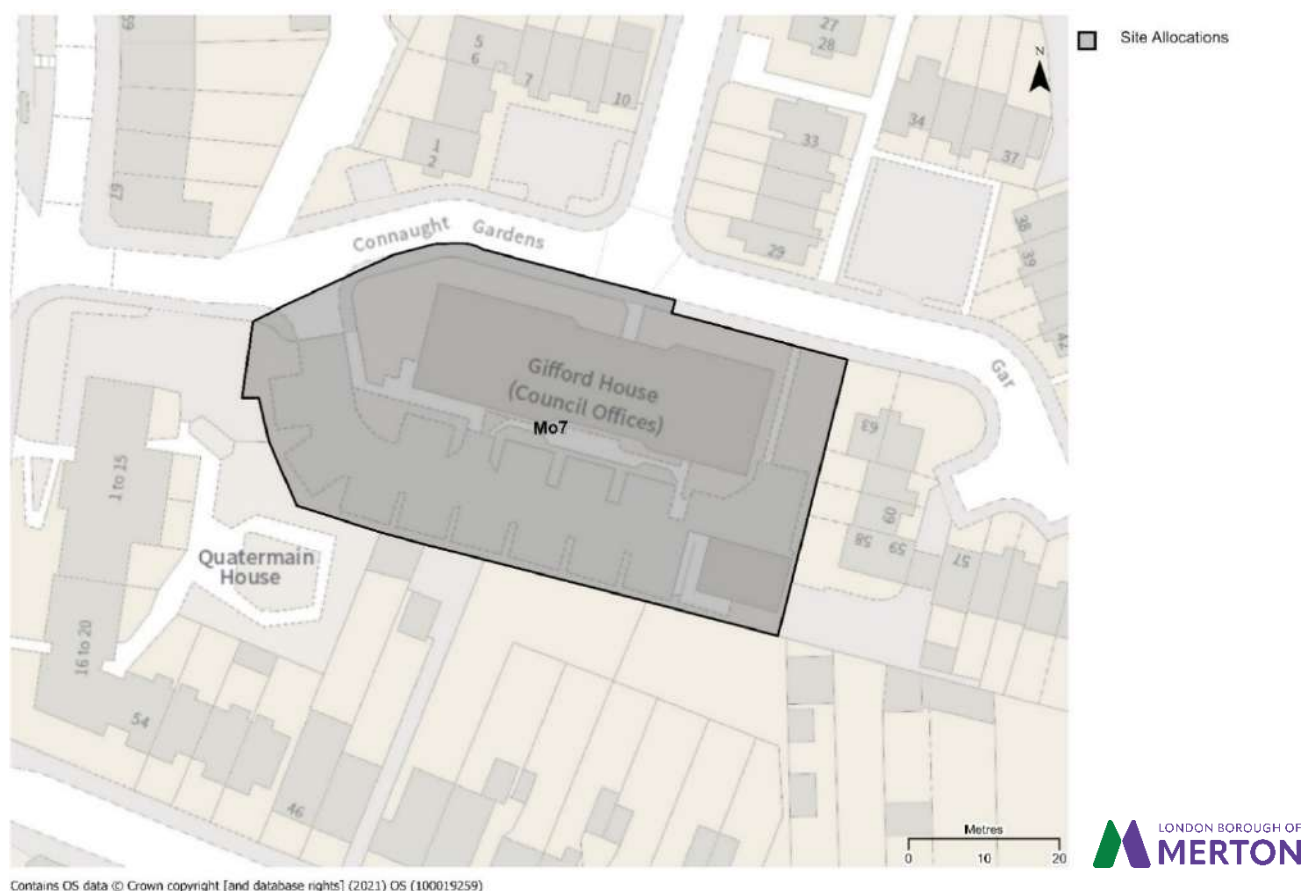
Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impact on ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 5 very good access to public transport

Site Mo7: Gifford House, 67c St Helier Ave, Morden SM4 6HY**Ward:** Ravensbury

Site description: A part-one and part-two storey office building that is set behind (to the east) of the part-three and four storey buildings fronting St Helier Avenue. All the neighbouring properties, to the north, east and south, consist of two-storey residential buildings. The site gains access from Connaught Gardens.

Site owner: Merton Council**Site area:** 0.27ha**Existing uses:** Office**Site allocation:** Residential**Site deliverability:** 5-10 years**Indicative site capacity (new homes):** 20- 25 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. Development proposals must protect and not unduly harm the residential amenity of the neighbouring properties.
2. Development proposals will need to demonstrate that the scale and type of development is appropriate to the accessibility of the site by sustainable modes and will not result in a reliance on car journeys. Development proposals will need to maximise the potential to access the site by sustainable travel modes and mitigate potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.

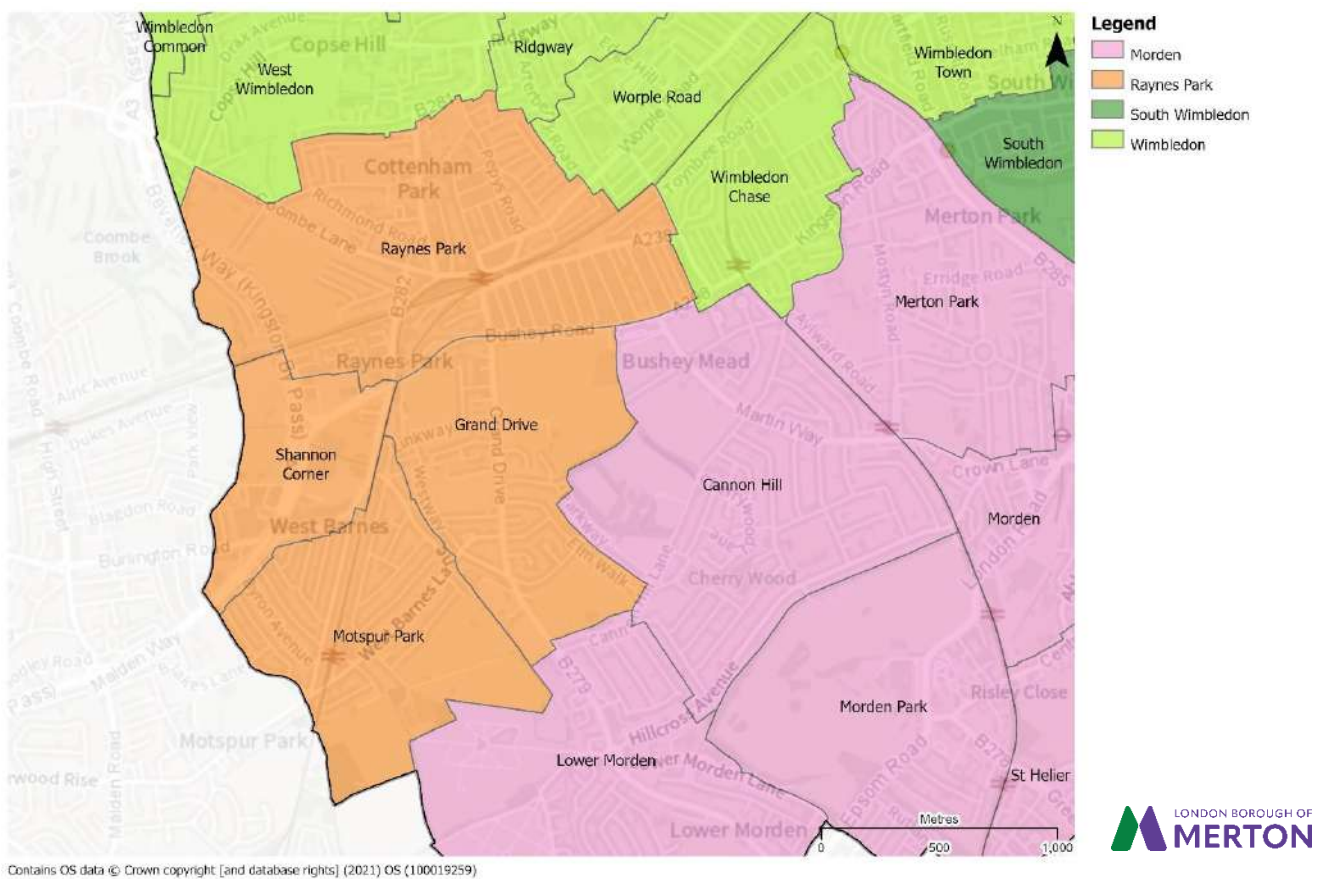
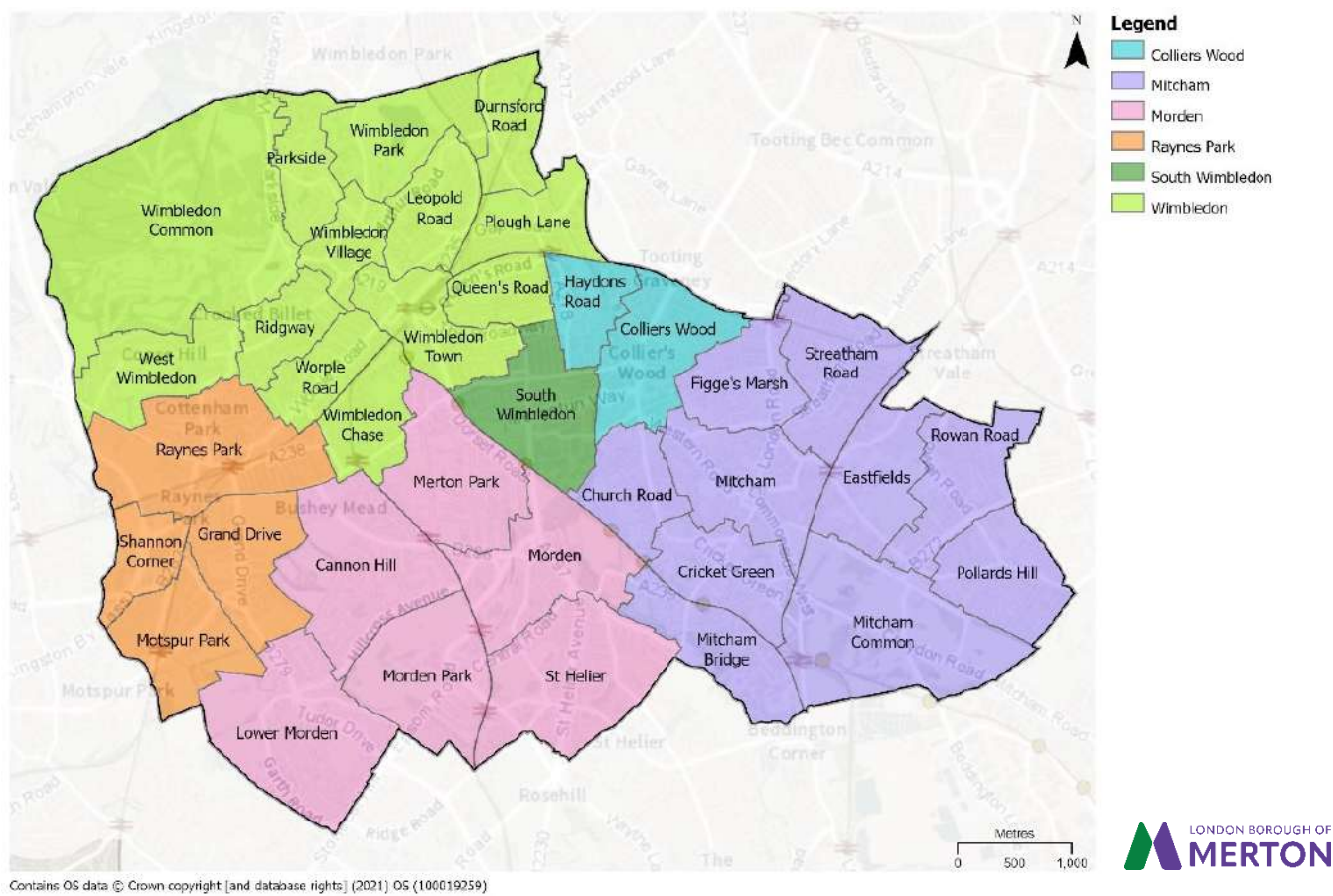
Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Any development proposal for this site, is expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandle Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. We will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. SES Water has not identified any concerns about the water supply network infrastructure in relation to the development of the site. However, we strongly recommend that the developer engage with SES Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. We will need evidence of engagement with SES Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, engage with and seek advice from SES Water about the development of this site.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, we strongly recommend that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. We will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
6. The site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. We will require on site playspace provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

The site location**Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets:** No**Impacts a Conservation Area:** No**Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area:** No**Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument:** No**Impacts on flooding from sources:** No**Is in a Town Centre:** No**Is in an Opportunity Area:** No**Impacts a designated open space:** No**Impacts on an ecology designation:** No**Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL):** PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

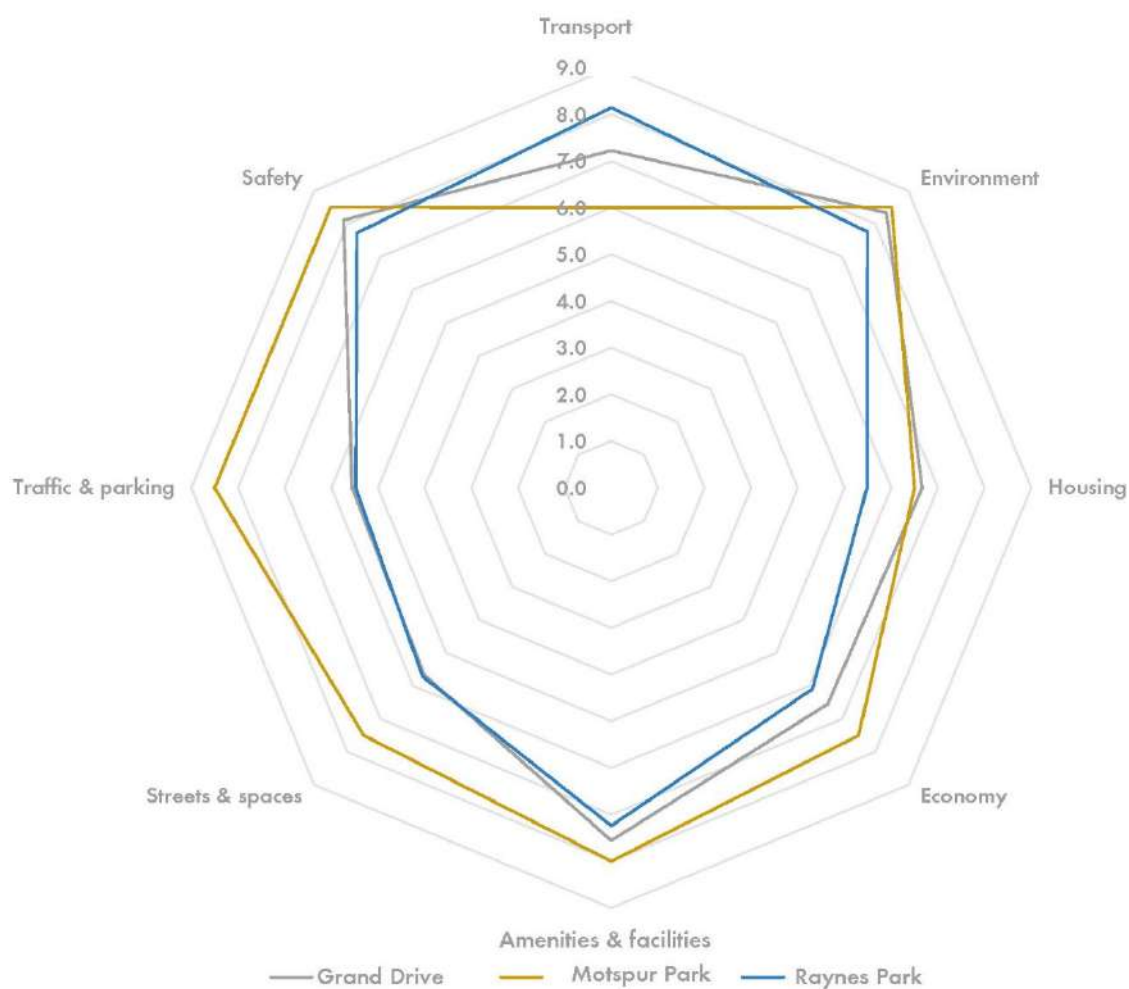


Chapter 06. Raynes Park



Place profile: Raynes Park

As part of the borough's ongoing Character Study, 415 Merton residents took part in an online public survey, of which 34 people lived in Raynes Park. The diagram below highlights how people felt about their neighbourhood based on a series of questions asked. This work was also used to inform [Merton's Borough Character Study 2021](#).



Results from residents of Raynes Park rating their neighbourhood

Key objectives: Raynes Park

The following objectives provide an overarching vision for Raynes Park.



Celebrating Raynes Park's unique character

Future developments will respect the local character and amenity.



Improving active travel

Securing transport improvements for pedestrians and cyclists and improve public transport facilities and connections.



Complement the Town Centre

Create a complementary offer at Shannon Corner where new residents can boost spending power in Raynes Park Town Centre and new businesses can benefit from the proximity to the strategic road network.

Character: Raynes Park

These photos illustrate the diverse character found across Raynes Park.





Policy N6.1 Raynes Park

1. This policy supports investment in Raynes Park to maintain its position as an attractive and interesting destination that meets the needs of the current and future residents, businesses and visitors, and provides economic, social and environmental benefits.

Raynes Park Local Centre

2. To improve the quality of the environment and make it easier for people to move around Raynes Park Local Centre and around the wider neighbourhood.
3. We will do this by:
 - a. Supporting development in Raynes Park Local Centre that provides for the needs of the local community, including a wide range of businesses and services commensurate to the town centre.
 - b. Supporting the 20-minute neighbourhood approach by resisting the loss of shops and services within Raynes Park Local Centre.
 - c. Ensuring that Raynes Park is maintained as a viable, attractive Town Centre for businesses to locate and residents to visit; supporting shop front improvements and parking for bikes and scooter deliveries that is designed well into the street scene while meeting the needs of businesses.
 - d. Requiring development within and around the centre to address flooding issues particularly from surface water, prioritising sustainable drainage systems that are both effective and attractive.
 - e. Securing well-designed and well linked improvements for pedestrians and cyclists and improved access to public transport facilities, including support for step-free access and improved secure cycle parking facilities at Raynes Park station.
 - f. In the long term, work with Network Rail and the local community to ensure the benefits arising from its investment are realised, that new structures are sensitively designed and compliment the wider residential area and that disruption is kept to a minimum.

Surrounding area of Raynes Park Local Centre

- g.** Taking the Healthy Streets Approach by supporting better pedestrian and cycle links between Raynes Park Town Centre and the surrounding areas including Shannon Corner and, between the shops and services around Shannon Corner.
- h.** Optimise land use by providing new homes above shops and other business premises, for example at Shannon Corner, where these can be sited and designed to minimise air and noise pollution for new residents.
- i.** Businesses will be encouraged to locate at Shannon Corner where they could benefit from proximity to the strategic road network, not compete with nearby town centres or generate significant private car trips.
- j.** Supporting the 20-minute neighbourhood approach by supporting shopfront, public realm and street scene improvements and maintaining the day-to-day shopping and other services at Motspur Park.
- k.** Integrating improvements within the public realm: ensuring developments and streets are designed to improve walking and cycling, provide attractive raingardens, pocket parks and other attractive and effective sustainable drainage systems to mitigate the risk of surface water flooding.
- l.** Supporting attractive, accessible local parades and neighbourhoods including step-free access at Motspur Park and Raynes Park stations.
- m.** Requiring development to respect local character, heritage and amenity in surrounding residential neighbourhoods.

Supporting text

- 6.1.1. Raynes Park is an attractive Local Town Centre well served by a mainline train station set within a relatively affluent high quality suburban neighbourhood immediately surrounding the town centre. To the south lies Motspur Park, a smaller Local Town Centre also served by a mainline station and set within the largely residential

neighbourhood of West Barnes. Kingston Road and Bushey Road lead from the shops and services adjacent to Wimbledon Chase station bisecting Raynes Park and West Barnes and onto the A3 road.

- 6.1.2. Raynes Park Local Centre will be maintained to ensure it continues to be an attractive and viable location for shops and services commensurate with its status as a Local Centre.
- 6.1.3. To help support local shops, restaurants and cafés during the day we will ensure that some business function is maintained in the Local Centre, such as small and medium offices and other activities, and resist the loss of existing employment uses. A reliance on the commuter trade is not enough to maintain a variety of quality services.
- 6.1.4. We will complement initiatives started by the Raynes Park Local Centre Enhancement Plan. The enhancement plan guides short to medium term investment in the physical environment that residents and businesses have said are important to Raynes Park. It focuses on:
 - a. improving access and circulation for pedestrians, cyclists, road traffic and public transport users.
 - b. strengthening Raynes Park's retail offer, making it a more attractive destination for local shopping needs; and,
 - c. improving the physical environment, appearance and maintenance of the public realm.
- 6.1.5. The enhancement plan also identifies the development opportunities and planning status of sites within the Town Centre. Although the centre has a high PTAL, and the redevelopment of redundant sites is welcome, there is a desire to protect the scale and local character of Raynes Park. New development coming forward within and around the centre must reinforce the character of the centre, respect the low scale residential hinterland including Conservation Areas to the north and acknowledge the strategic views across the borough from higher land to the north.
- 6.1.6. The changing nature of the way we access shops and services has led to a far greater demand for – and greater business reliance on – home deliveries by bike and scooter.

Delivery drivers need to park close to high street shops, restaurants, cafes and other services for the apps to recognise that they are available for the business to deliver their produce, which is increasingly important if the restaurant or shop is to remain viable. We will seek to provide well-designed parking for delivery bikes and scooters on the high street to boost business viability while also meeting the needs of pedestrians and other town centre users.

- 6.1.7. Raynes Park's share of Merton's new homes will be provided on some larger sites closer to Shannon Corner and incremental residential development within surrounding neighbourhoods, such as intensification of existing sites through redevelopment and/or conversion of existing single dwellings into multiple units.
- 6.1.8. The Strategic Flood Risk Assessment identified the potential for flooding over parts of Raynes Park Local Centre and more so to the south around Shannon Corner/Beverley Way. Flooding in Raynes Park Local Centre itself is attributed to surface water. Flooding at Shannon Corner/Beverley Way is attributed to fluvial flooding of Beverley Brook. Development in these areas should comply with the most recent Environment Agency advice and flood risk management policies. In particular, development should incorporate sustainable drainage solutions to help manage surface water flood risk. Where sustainable drainage systems are visible to the public, those that are attractive and have other environmental benefits should be prioritised.
- 6.1.9. The area around Shannon corner has a large out-of-centre retail presence on many sites, including a large supermarket and bulky goods warehouse. The area is very poorly served by public transport, has large amounts of on-site free car parking, excellent links to the road network and a retail offer focused on bulky goods. As a result, it displays an extremely unattractive local environment and attracts shoppers almost exclusively by car.
- 6.1.10. The changing nature of consumer behaviour has reduced the demand for retail sheds and the council does not support further significant out -of-centre retail development at Shannon Corner. Many of these large sites will be suitable for new homes where these are sensitively designed to improve the setting and public realm, improve links to the Town Centre and transport hubs and mitigate the impacts of flood risk, poor air quality and traffic noise and provide the necessary infrastructure to support new homes.

- 6.1.11. Motspur Park Local Centre has a mainline train station, surrounded by residential neighbourhoods which merge into the neighbouring boroughs of Sutton and Kingston-upon-Thames. It provides grocery and other facilities that cater for the day-to-day needs of residents. We will continue to support environmental improvements and the convenience nature of the centre.
- 6.1.12. As set out in the Good Growth chapter of this Local Plan, Raynes Park and Motspur Park will be supported to be 20-minute neighbourhoods. Transport improvements for the Motspur Park area has already been identified, including provision of better facilities for buses, pedestrians and cyclists, with planting to improve the quality of the environment. We will continue to lobby for step free access to Motspur Park and Raynes Park train stations so that all residents can make equal and effective use of their local station.
- 6.1.13. The suburban neighbourhoods within the neighbourhoods will be enhanced by ensuring that new development respects local character and amenity, and where appropriate conserves historic value.
- 6.1.14. Outside this Local Plan period, in the long term, investment in Crossrail 2 could transform Raynes Park and Motspur Park Local Town Centres. However, at this stage Crossrail 2 will not be completed prior to 2040, outside the lifetime of this Local Plan. In their consultation response to this Local Plan, Transport for London confirmed that Crossrail 2 safeguarding directions will be revised to safeguard the latest proposed route. At the time of writing (2024) no safeguarding directions exist for the Crossrail 2 route for Raynes Park and Motspur Park.
- 6.1.15. In the event that planning for Crossrail 2 continues, we will work with Transport for London, Network Rail and others to ensure the best outcome from Crossrail 2 for Raynes Park and Motspur Park stations and that the potential disruption and severance at level crossings in the surrounding area is minimised as far as possible. As with Wimbledon, we want to ensure that Raynes Park, Mostpur Park and West Barnes remain open for business and disruption is minimised during Crossrail 2's development. While Crossrail 2 remains at the planning stage, we will continue to seek greater investment in all stations and surrounds, particularly step-free access which will remove the barrier that currently exists for public transport access to all sections of the community.

SITE ALLOCATIONS

- 6.1.16. Site allocations are planning policies which apply to key potential development sites of strategic importance. Site allocations are needed to ensure that when a strategic site comes forward for redevelopment it integrates well into its surroundings and contributes towards meeting strategic needs for new homes, jobs, public open space, public access routes, transport infrastructure and social infrastructure, such as health or education facilities.
- 6.1.17. Site allocations set out the land uses that must be provided as part of any redevelopment alongside other acceptable land uses that may be provided in addition to the required land uses. Any development proposal for a site allocation will be determined against planning policies (including the London Plan).



Site Rp1: Amity Grove Clinic, Amity Grove, Raynes Park, SW20

0LQ

**Ward:** Raynes Park

Site description: The site consists of a part single and part two-storey building, which is surrounded by two and three-storey houses. Along the northern boundary is a narrow public access footpath linking Amity Grove and Durham Road.

Site owner:**Site area:** 0.09ha**Existing uses:** Former medical clinic, day nursery**Site allocation:** Residential (former health services have now re-located to Nelson Medical Centre)**Site deliverability:** 5-10 years**Indicative site capacity:** 5-10 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. Development proposals should protect and improve the public footpath which borders the site to the north.

2. Mitigate potential parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity.
3. Protect the residential amenity of those properties next to, or in the vicinity of the site.
4. Development proposals must have regard to the recommendations in Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
4. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Site is in a critical drainage area

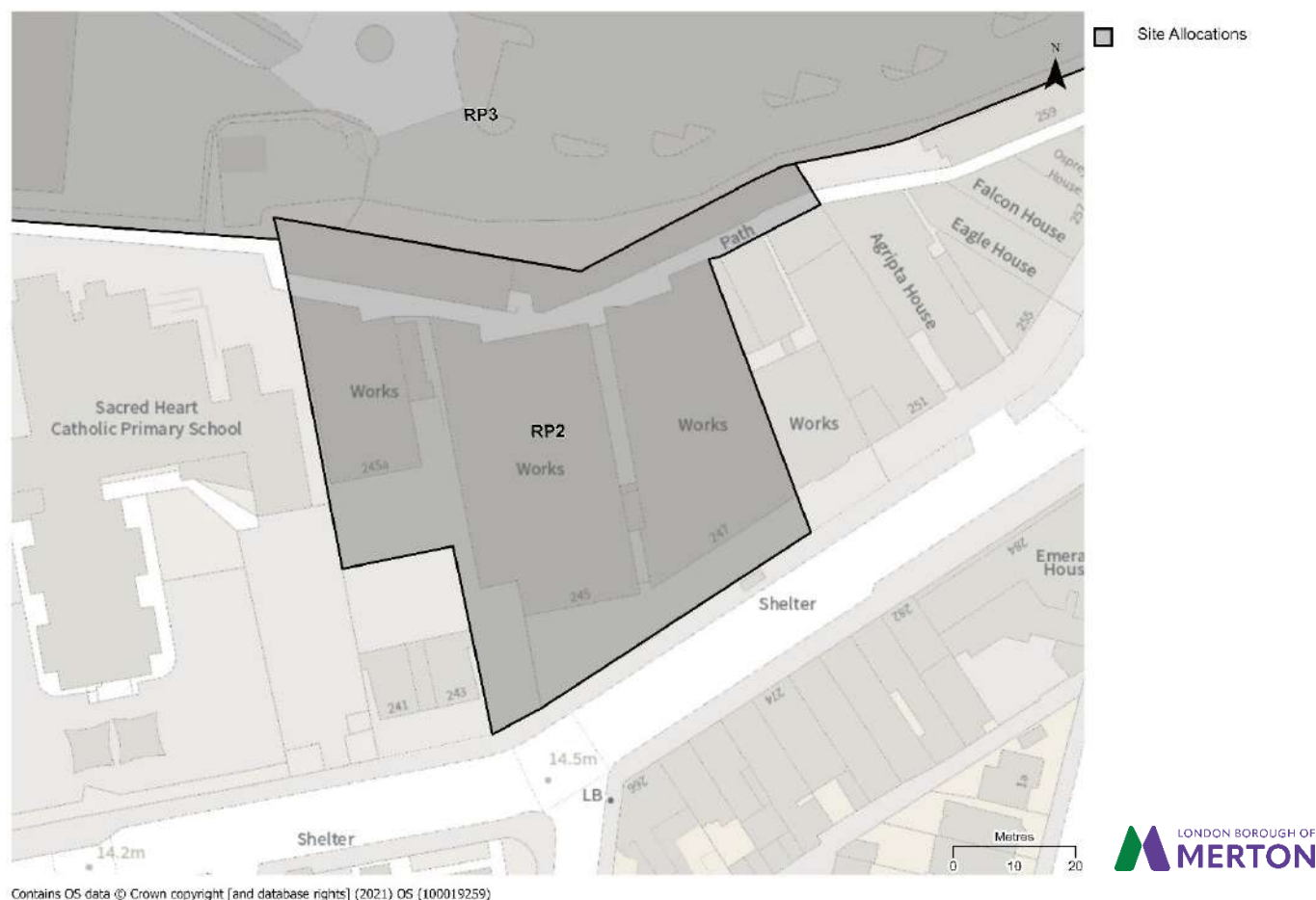
Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impact on ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 5, very good access to public transport

Site Rp2: 245 -247 Burlington Road, New Malden, KT3 4NE**Ward: West Barnes****Site description:**

1. The site has several vacant industrial buildings fronting Burlington Road to the south. A range of shops and services are found at the other side of Burlington Road. To the north is the surface car park associated with the substantial Tesco supermarket (part of which is proposed for allocation in this plan as site RP.3).
2. There is a path running east/west along the north boundary of the site providing pedestrian/cycle access from Burlington Road to Beverley Way. To the west of the site lies Sacred Heart Catholic Primary School and a two-storey building for Enterprise car rental.
3. To the east of the site are several commercial buildings ranging from one to two storeys, currently occupied by a car wash and bathroom showroom.
4. Burlington Road is a Locally Significant Industrial Site and is next to a primary school.

Site owner: Tesco Stores Ltd**Site area:** 1.3 ha**Existing uses:** Former light industrial use; now largely run-down**Site allocation:** Commercial, business, service and community use appropriate to a residential area

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Indicative site capacity: 65- 90 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development proposals must take the opportunity to improve this part of the Locally Significant Industrial Site and provided a more vibrant, attractive setting for the nearby school, shops and services.
2. Development proposals must optimise the delivery of new homes in this highly accessible location.
3. Development proposals will need to maximise the accessibility of the site by sustainable travel modes and demonstrate that proposals will minimise the impact of vehicle trips, through appropriately managed car parking, deliveries and servicing.
4. Development proposals should protect and improve access for pedestrians and cyclists along the public footpath which runs along the north boundary of the site.
5. Development proposals must improve the public realm including pedestrian safety and be compatible with the amenity of neighbouring occupiers of buildings.
6. Development proposals will need to protect the amenity and safety of the users of the primary school on the western boundary of the site.
7. An investigation on the potential impact of development on the Archaeological Priority Area is needed.
8. The Exception Test is not needed, however development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
4. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years and 5-11 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
5. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
6. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will

require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also, liaise and seek from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: The northern part of the site is within the Archaeological Priority Area for West Barnes Farm

Impact on flooding from all sources: Flood Zone 2 – close proximity to 3a

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts on an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Rp3: Tesco, Burlington Road, New Malden, KT3 4N**Ward:** West Barnes**Site description:**

1. The site includes a Tesco Extra, car parks and an office building. The site is accessed from West Barnes Lane to the east and Beverley Way to the west. The Pyl Brook is the boundary for the north of the site and beyond that lies Raynes Park High School. The railway line from Raynes Park to Motspur Park and a level crossing lie adjacent to West Barnes Lane. The area to the east is characterised by inter-war suburban residential development. There is good access by road from the A3 to the west of the site and a shopping parade and light industrial uses continue along Burlington Road to the south.
2. Part of the site was subject of a Planning Appeal in 2020-21 (19/P2387) On 29th June 2021 the Planning Inspectorate issued a decision to allow the appeal and grant planning permission.

Site owner: Tesco Stores Ltd**Site area:** 5.26ha**Existing uses:** Tesco superstore, vacant office warehouse site**Site allocation:** Comprehensive redevelopment of the site to keep the supermarket with the same floorspace as exists in a new, purpose-built unit and to optimise the rest of the site for delivering new homes, landscaping and access**Site deliverability:** 5-10 years**Indicative site capacity:** 300-460 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. Development of the site provides an opportunity to deliver a considerable number of new homes including affordable homes and a mix of types, sizes and tenures.
2. Development proposals must substantially improve the street environment and enable cycling and walking through the provision of improved access routes through the site including directly to Burlington Road and to enable a connection with the public footpath to the south.
3. Development proposals will need to maximise the accessibility of the site by sustainable travel modes and demonstrate that proposals will minimise the impact of vehicle trips, including for deliveries and servicing.
4. Development proposal must not have an impact on the vehicular access / egress (24 hour) to the Tesco store (car park and service yard).
5. Development of the site presents an opportunity to improve the currently overgrown and inaccessible Pyl Brook area on the northern boundary of the site and provide public access for pedestrians and cyclists.
6. The residential development at the site must complement both the existing retail use and existing residential in the immediate and surrounding area.
7. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. Development proposals should aim to restore the Pyl Brook, with natural banks and buffer habitat to create a wide corridor, facilitating biodiversity net gain and providing a significant improvement to the Green Corridor.
4. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
5. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years and 5-11 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
6. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
7. The site is close to the A3 which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN). TfL recommends no new access or servicing take place from the A3.
8. Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure, but do not have concerns relating to the and

wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The site could include a range of tall buildings up to an appropriate upper limit of circa 52m (approx. 15 storeys). However, appropriate design-led height parameters for this site should be informed by a Design Guide or Design Code, which could be prepared either by applicants or the council. The Design Guide or Design Code should be based on effective community engagement, reflect local aspirations for the development of the area and should take into account the guidance contained in the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code. In the absence of a Design Guide or Design Code the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code will be used to guide decisions on future applications.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No. To the north is a Tier 2 Archaeological Priority Area

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: The site is within fluvial flood zones 2 and 3 and is at risk of surface water flooding

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes

Impacts an ecology designation: Yes, the northern part of the site is adjacent to a Site of Interest for Nature Conservation (SINC) and a Green Corridor

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL ranges from 2–3, poor to moderate access to public transport

Site Rp4: 80-86 Bushey Road, Raynes Park. SW20 0JQ**Ward:** Raynes Park**Site description:**

1. The site consists of large-scale retail sheds ranging between two and five storeys in height and open parking areas. Part of the site (the former Thales building) has been demolished. To the west is a new Next at Home store and the A3 'Beverly Way' dual carriageway and to the south is Bushey Road (A298). To the east of the site is West Wimbledon primary school. To the north, on the opposite side of Bodnant Gardens, are two-storey houses.
2. One of the largest brownfield, underutilised, single ownership sites in Merton with significant redevelopment potential.

Site owner: Friends Life Ltd (c/o Aviva Investors)**Site area:** 2.7ha**Existing uses:** Part vacant, part retail, office and employment use (light industrial)

Site allocation: Commercial (including retail subject to the relevant tests being met), business and industrial uses where such uses are appropriate to a residential area. Long term this site has potential for residential-led mixed use development which could include, business, services and local community uses appropriate to a residential area.

Site deliverability: 0-5 for commercial, business and industrial uses; 10-15 years for mixed use residential

Indicative site capacity: 400-550 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The area to the west of the site was delivered in 2017 with a new Next at Home store. Planning permission was previously granted on 4 December 2017 (16/P1317) for the redevelopment of the site for a substantial purpose-built retail floorspace (13,736 square metres), with cafe/restaurants (1,193 square metres), landscaping, associated car parking (334 spaces), cycle parking (100 spaces) and new pedestrian access from Bodnant Gardens.
2. Development of the site provides a significant opportunity for exemplary design to optimise the potential of this large site.
3. Development proposals will need to improve walking and cycling and access to public transport between the site and Raynes Park Town Centre. Cycling and walking routes must be created through the site which would also provide direct access from Raynes Park High School and homes to the south of Bushey Road to shops and services in Raynes Park Town Centre via Bodnant Gardens. Contributions may be sought towards improvements on the cycle and pedestrian network that connects to the site.
4. Development proposals will need to maximise the accessibility of the site by sustainable travel modes and demonstrate that proposals will minimise the impact of vehicle trips, through appropriately managed car parking, deliveries and servicing.
5. Development proposals must protect the amenity of the adjacent homes and school.
6. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the critical drainage area.
7. Due to the site's location relative to the A3 road, the layout, scale and land uses must protect future occupiers from the noise and air pollution arising from the road. This section of the A3 is identified on the Department for Transport noise map.
8. Access to the site is shared with the existing retailers at Next at Home. Careful scrutiny of access and junction arrangements is needed to minimise impacts on movement, congestion and road safety, in particular wider impacts on Transport for London route network.
9. Transport assessments must consider the potential effects of the whole site to avoid ad hoc proposals, assessment and consideration.
10. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.

4. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
5. Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site. The developer should contact SGN and Thames Water to discuss requirements for any improvements to the water, wastewater and gas infrastructure network from non-residential development.
6. The site is close to the A3 which forms part of the Transport for London Road Network (TLRN). TfL recommends no new access or servicing take place from the A3.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, critical drainage area

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impact an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): The site ranges from PTAL 1, very poor access to public transport to PTAL 3, moderate access to public transport

Site Rp5: All England Lawn Tennis Club Community Sports Ground 216 Grand Drive, Raynes Park, SW20



Ward: West Barnes

Site description:

This large site is privately owned and run by the All England Lawn Tennis Club (AELTC). The site hosts tennis facilities including 16 grass courts, nine synthetic surface tennis courts (six of which are covered by two air domes), a clubhouse, changing rooms and parking. The site is part of the AELTC estate and is essential to supporting a successful Wimbledon Championships which is held on the AELTC site on Church Road. As well as supporting the Wimbledon Championships it is used by schoolchildren in Merton and Wandsworth via the Wimbledon Junior Tennis Initiative. It also has provision for residents to play tennis. The site is surrounded on all sides by semi-detached and short terraces of houses. The site currently has single access from Grand Drive restricting vehicle access to the site.

Site owner: All England Lawn Tennis and Croquet Club (AELTC)

Site area: 7.9ha

Existing uses: Tennis facilities connected with AELTC's operation of The Wimbledon Championships and community and charitable activities

Site allocation:

1. Tennis facilities connected with AELTC's operation of The Wimbledon Championships, the Wimbledon Junior Tennis Initiative, community tennis programmes with support for continued and long-term investment in the same. The site is designated as open space and contains sport and recreation use that are compatible with its open space designation.
2. This site provides an opportunity for significant, sustained and long-term investment in sporting facilities in Merton to support The Championships and to provide access to the local community to aid in tackling health inequalities. Development of the site provides opportunities to optimise the use of an underutilised site for uses compatible with its current designation as playing fields.

Site deliverability: 0-5 years**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. In 2018 planning permission was granted for a second tennis air dome containing three acrylic courts, 16 external grass courts, associated landscaping and drainage and an outline planning application for a replacement clubhouse. In total the site hosts tennis facilities including 16 grass courts, nine synthetic surface tennis courts (six of which are covered by two air domes), a clubhouse, changing rooms and parking.
2. Opportunity to upgrade and improve AELTC's facilities to continue the prominence of The Championships and the opportunity to host more of the pre-Championship activities within Merton.
3. Development proposals should explore alternative access arrangements which could improve the site's resilience.
4. Development proposals will need to maximise the accessibility of the site by sustainable travel modes and demonstrate that proposals will minimise the impact of vehicle trips.
5. Development proposals will need to continue to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues with the site and incorporate the recommendations in Merton Strategic Flood Risk Assessment.
6. Development proposals must protect the residential amenity of adjacent properties.
7. Opportunities for investment in sporting facilities that can be accessed by local people and support and create new jobs.
8. Opportunities to recognise The Wimbledon Championships significant economic and social benefits to Merton.
9. Opportunity in combination with the AELTC Church Road main site, to support the capacity of the Wimbledon Junior Tennis Initiative by providing better facilities for the free tennis coaching programme for primary school children in Merton and the neighbouring borough of Wandsworth.
10. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.

11. The developer should contact SGN and Thames Water to discuss requirements for any improvements to the water, wastewater and gas infrastructure network from non-residential development.
12. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require Major Development proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site where this is suitable and viable, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact flooding from all sources: Yes. The site has historically suffered from surface water drainage issues

Is in a Town Centre: No

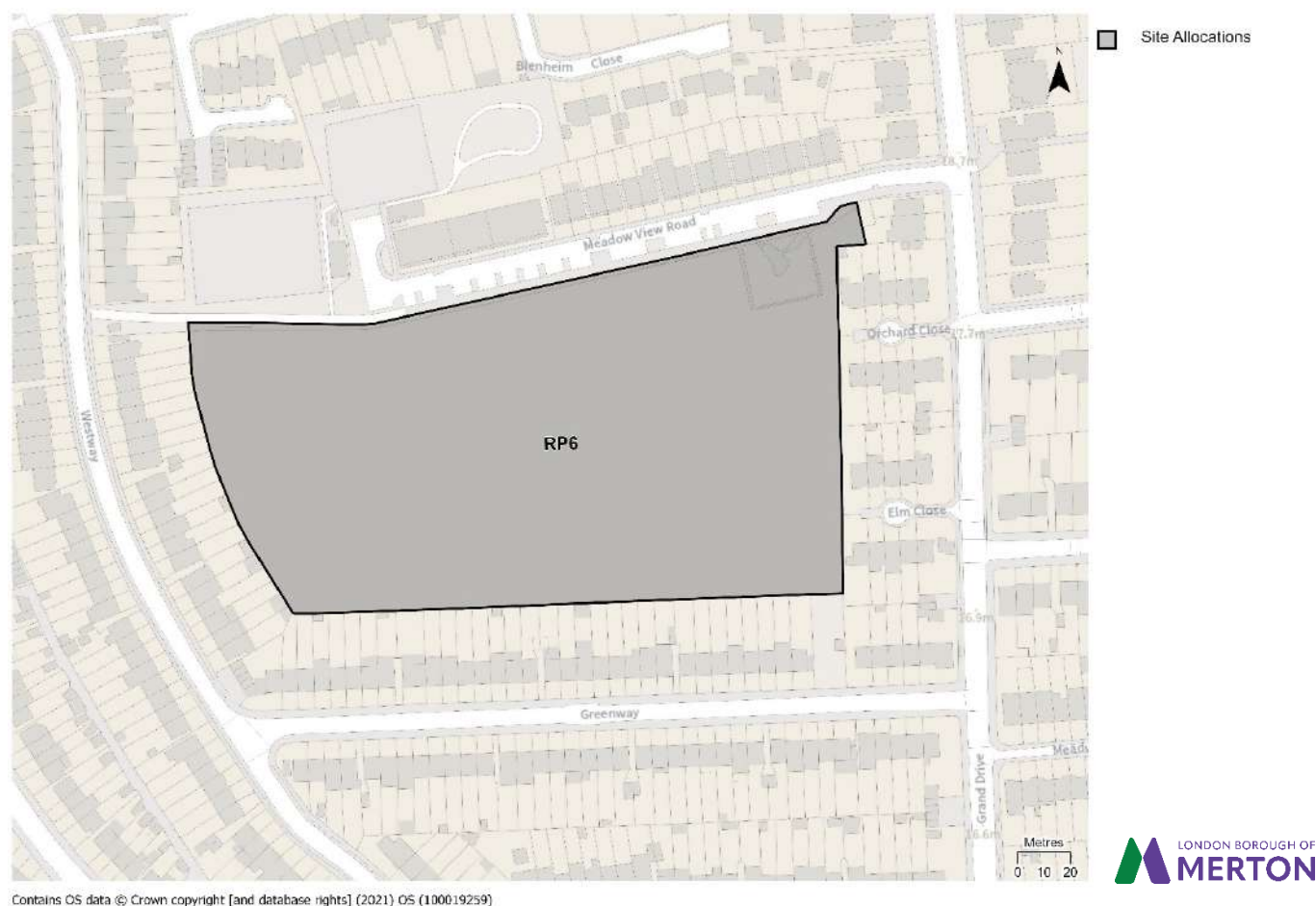
Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes, the site is designated as Open Space and is near to Metropolitan Open Land (MOL)

Impacts on ecology designation: Yes. The site is near to a Local Nature Reserve, Green Corridor and Site of Interest for Nature Conservation (SINC)

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

Site Rp6: Land at the former LESSA Sports Ground, Grand Drive, Raynes Park, SW20 9EB



Ward: West Barnes

Site description:

1. The site includes a fenced off field, accessible from Meadowview Road. Within the northeast corner of the site lies a small playground that is closed off to general the public use and described as only being available for the use of the residents living on Meadowview Road
2. To the north of the site are 44 homes along Meadowview Road and Raynes Park Tennis Club, built by 2013 as part of a single scheme which allowed the redevelopment of homes on open space if the development funded sports facilities. The site is surrounded by short terraces of formal street layout with some grass verges and street trees.
3. The rear windows and gardens of terraced houses or flats overlook the site on the eastern, southern and western boundaries.

Site owner: Bellway Homes

Site area: 2.8ha

Existing uses: The site is currently fenced off and a vacant field. The consultee's submission states that the field has been secured to prevent it falling into disrepair, that there is no interest in the site being used solely as sports fields and that the legal obligations relating to the previous planning permission (2009) which required the field to be offered as a sporting facility, maintained or provided

as open space have all expired

Site allocation: Sporting or community use of the entire site will have to be proven as undeliverable before any other uses can be considered

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The landowner submitted a planning application for a mixture of new homes and tennis facilities to Merton Council in October 2020 (reference 20/P3237).
2. The site has an extensive planning history. It was part of a larger site that was granted planning permission on appeal in 2009 for the redevelopment of the site to provide:
 - 44 homes (along what is now Meadowview Road).
 - new tennis courts and clubhouse for the relocated Raynes Park Tennis Club – sports provision (on this site proposal) offered to Merton Council or Kings College School.
3. Development of the site may provide opportunities for entire site sports use.
4. Development proposals will need to maximise the accessibility of the site by sustainable travel modes and demonstrate that proposals will minimise the impact of vehicle trips.
5. Development proposals should maximise opportunities to provide publicly accessible cycle and pedestrian routes across the site including protecting and enhancing the existing route that runs along the northern boundary of the site.
6. Development proposals for sports use or other uses compatible with the designated open space should be actively demonstrated prior to any alternatives being taken forward.
7. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.
8. Development proposals must ensure that the drainage on the site will have to be improved and addressing the likelihood of fluvial flooding and the critical drainage area.
9. Development proposals should protect the amenity of surrounding residents.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure; however, the scale of development/s is likely to require upgrades to the wastewater network. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure

by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

4. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
5. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years and 5-11 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, part of the site is within flood zone 3 and within a critical drainage area

Is in a Town Centre: No

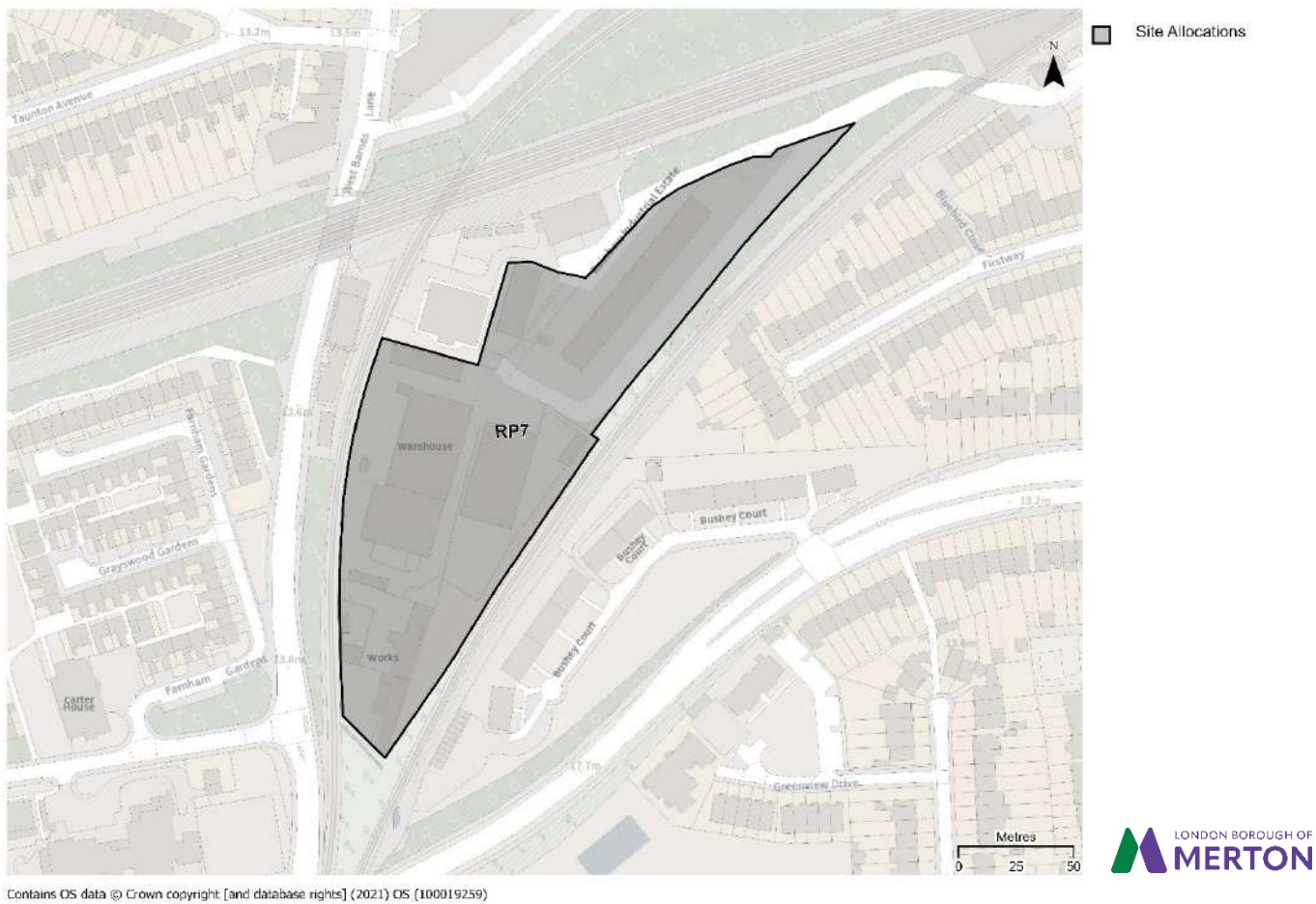
Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes, the site is designated as open space

Impacts an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 1, very poor access to public transport

Site Rp7: Rainbow Estate Grand Drive, Raynes Park, SW20 0JY



Ward: Raynes Park
Site description: The site is an industrial estate to the south of Raynes Park Town Centre. It is bounded on all sides by railway lines originating from Raynes Park station. There is some residential development at the other side of the railway lines to the west of the site of an office building (now a church) and a residential development of four storeys. To the east are inter-war terraces and towards the south is Bushey Court, a residential block of four storeys.
Site owner: Workspace 12 Ltd
Site area: 1.88ha
Existing uses: Industrial sheds, storage, car/van hire, coach parking, car repairs, skip hire etc.
Site allocation: 1. Employment led regeneration in line Rainbow Estate planning brief, including public realm improvements close to Raynes Park station. 2. Proposed allocation to clarify the existing planning approach.
Deliverability: 10-15 years
Indicative site capacity: 200-225 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

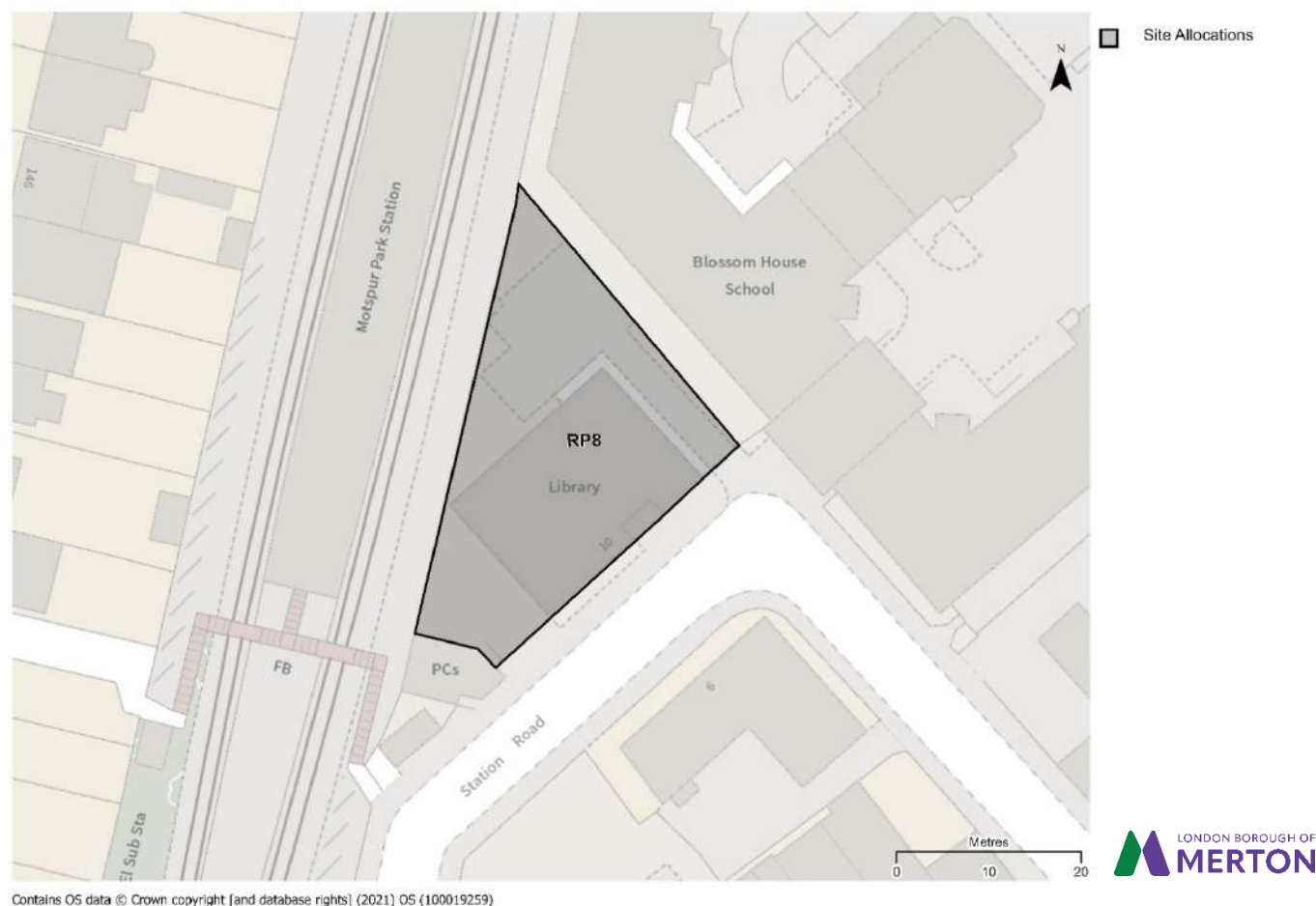
1. The Rainbow Estate planning brief is a design and planning framework to guide the redevelopment of the Rainbow Estate. The brief's general requirements for the redevelopment of the site is to provide approximately 3400sqm of business floorspace for Small and Medium sized enterprises (SME's), a publicly accessible drop off point ('Kiss and Ride') for Raynes Park railway station, and the provision of up to 250 new homes.
2. Planning permission was granted in 2015 (refs: 14/P4287 and 14/P4188) for 224 residential units and 3,449sqm of commercial floorspace and for the provision of a 'kiss and ride'. The scheme is now being phased and the business floorspace and 'kiss and ride' have commenced.
3. Opportunity to create a sense of place and identity out of this almost invisible site and opportunities set out in the planning brief and addressed in planning permission (14/P4287).

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. The site is next to a proposed Crossrail 2 station and rail tracks proposed for upgrade by Crossrail 2, (should Crossrail 2 be fully funded). The council and TfL require engagement and cooperation with the Crossrail 2 safeguarding team on the delivery development proposals for this site.
4. Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s is likely to require upgrades to the water supply and wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
5. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
6. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
7. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

The site location**Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated heritage assets:** No**Impacts a Conservation Area:** Yes

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No
Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, site is in a critical drainage area
Is in a Town Centre: Very close to Raynes Park Town Centre
Is in an Opportunity Area: No
Impacts a designated open space: No
Impacts an ecology designation: Yes, Site of Interest for Nature Conservation (SINC) and Green Corridors
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 4-5, good to very good access to public transport

Site Rp8: West Barnes Library 10 Station Road, Motspur Park, KT3 6JF**Ward:** West Barnes**Site description:** The site has a single storey building tucked away behind Motspur Park Station. To the west the site is bounded by railway line. To the east there is a two to three storey office building.**Site owner:** Merton Council**Site area:** 0.1ha**Existing uses:** Library**Site allocation:** Library with residential on upper floors**Site deliverability:** 5-10 years**Indicative site capacity:** 10-15 new homes**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. A library service/function is to be kept.
2. Cabinet agreed to progress with development of the site with a new and improved library presence in 2014. Plans were paused whilst consultation took place about the impact of the Crossrail 2 development on the local area. Further feasibility work is currently being progressed.
3. A mixed-use development of the site provides an opportunity to facilitate the provision of an upgraded community uses on lower floors and create a more secure, safe and active environment.

4. Development proposals will need to increase customer floor area, provide an adaptable suitable modern space with added space for community use and provide housing on the upper floors.
5. Development proposals will need to be sensitive to the railway lines and mitigate parking, traffic and road safety impacts on neighbouring residents.
6. Development proposals should contribute towards improving the public realm around the station for cyclists and pedestrians including the provision of improved publicly accessible cycle parking facilities for users of the library and station.
7. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.
8. The railway embankment acts as a barrier to surface water flow through the centre of the critical drainage area. Historic surface water flooding records identify drainage network capacity issues which cause water flooding in this area during heavy rainfall.

Infrastructure requirements:

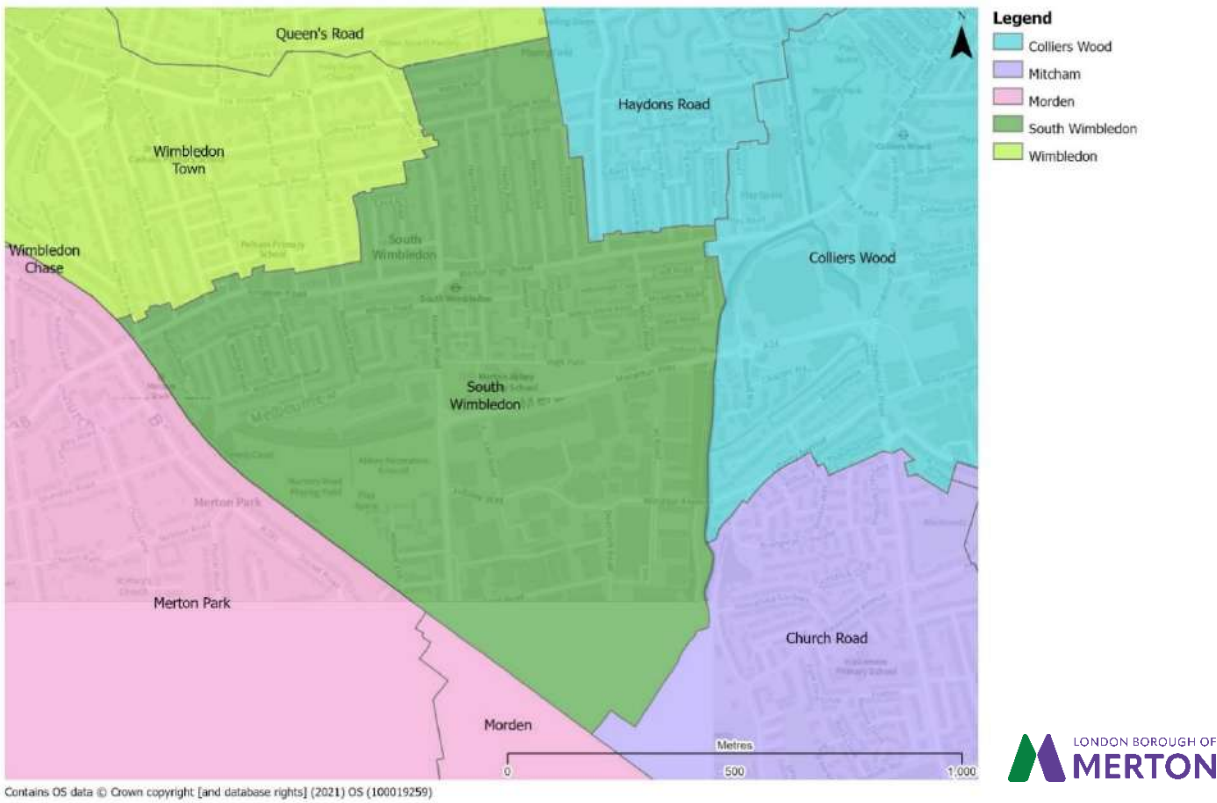
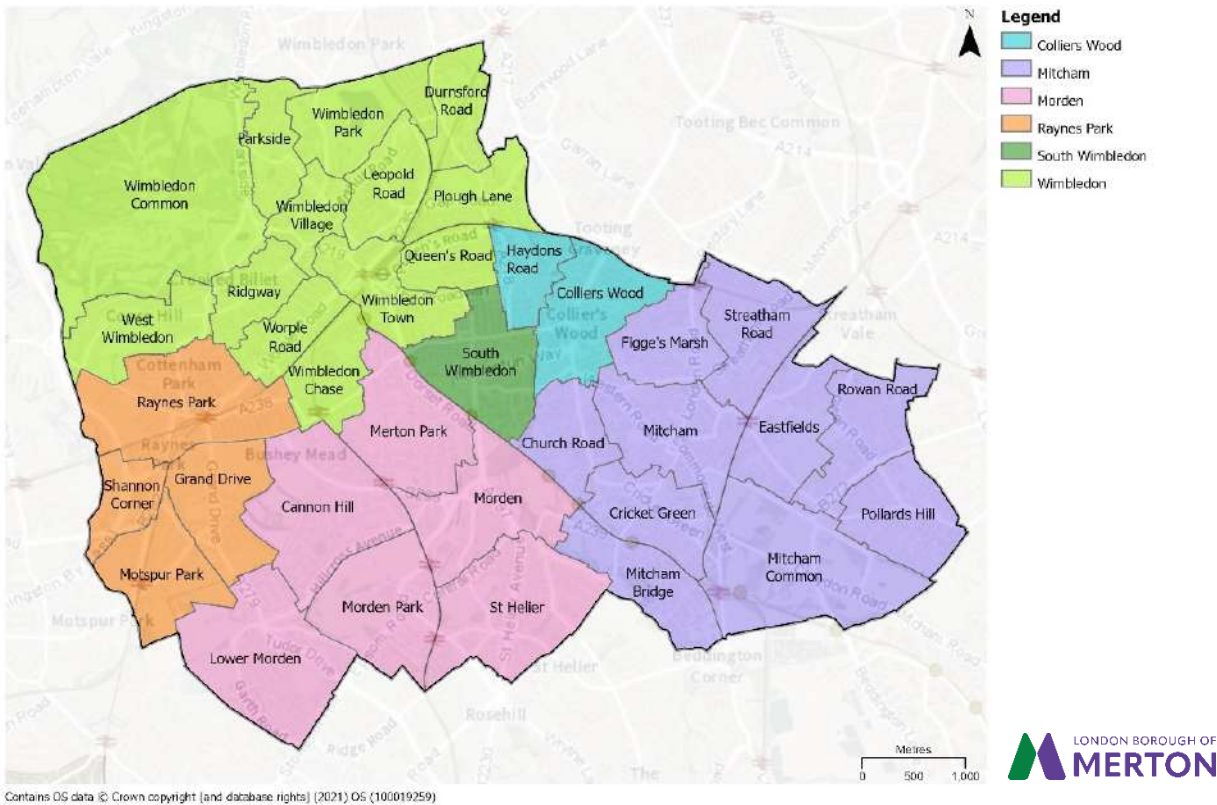
1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. The site is next to a proposed Crossrail 2 station and rail tracks proposed for upgrade by Crossrail 2, (should Crossrail be fully funded). The council and TfL require engagement and cooperation with the Crossrail 2 safeguarding team on any development proposals for this site.
4. A project to implement step-free access at Motspur Park station would likely impact land directly to the rear of the site and there is a requirement for consultation and cooperation with Network Rail in relation to this.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns for the water supply network. However, Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s is likely to require upgrades to the wastewater network and sewage treatment infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan.
6. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water [Developer Services](https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers) website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of liaising with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also liaise with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
7. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.

The site location

Impacts a Conservation Area: No
Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No
Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, site is in flood zone 2 and within a critical drainage area
Is in a Town Centre: Yes
Is in an Opportunity Area: No
Impacts a designated open space: No
Impacts on ecology designation: Yes, Green Corridor
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

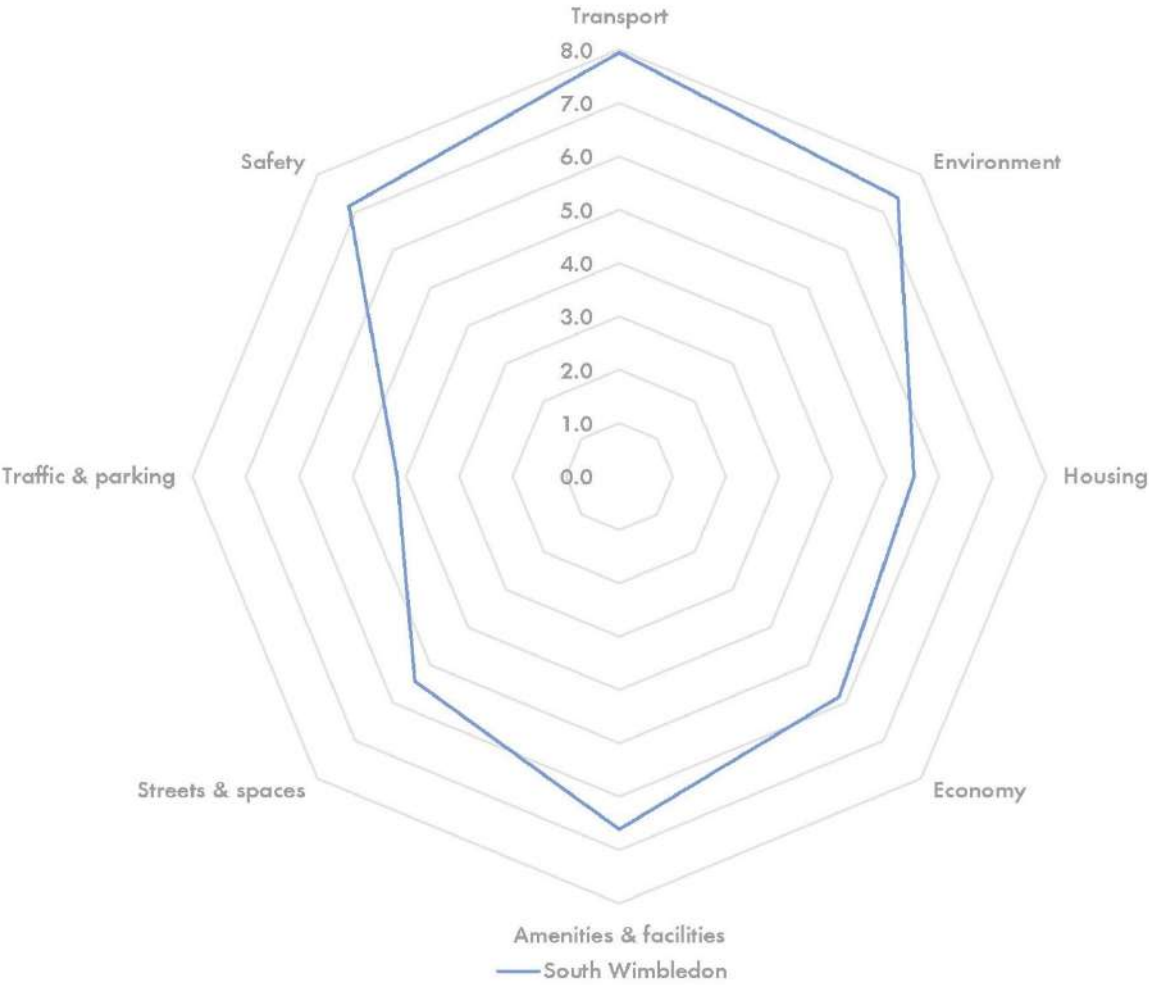


Chapter 07. **South Wimbledon**



Place profile: South Wimbledon

In 2020, as part of the borough’s ongoing Character Study, 415 Merton residents took part in this survey, of which 19 people told us they lived in South Wimbledon. The diagram below highlights how people felt about their neighbourhood based on a series of questions asked. This work was also used to inform [Merton’s Borough Character Study 2021](#).



Results from residents of South Wimbledon rating their neighbourhood

Key objectives: South Wimbledon

The following objectives provide an overarching vision for South Wimbledon.



Improving public realm and public space

Support improvements to streetscene and shopfronts, improving the public realm, particularly for pedestrians and cyclists.



Improving the environment

Encouraging measures that help to minimise and mitigate pollutants associated with the busy road network, including planting and green cover.



Promoting the **T**own Centre

Proposing a new Local Centre at the heart of the South Wimbledon, focussed around the underground station and junction.

Character: South Wimbledon

These photos illustrate the diverse character found across South Wimbledon.





Policy N7.1 South Wimbledon

1. Recognising South Wimbledon as a distinctive neighbourhood in its own right
2. We will do this by:
 - a. Proposing a new Local Centre at the heart of South Wimbledon, focussed around the underground station and the junction where Morden Road, Merton Road, Kingston Road and Merton High Street meet;
 - b. Supporting shops, services and businesses commensurate with a local centre, particularly those that serve the day-to-day needs of local residents;
 - c. Supporting developments and occupiers that help improve or strengthen local character, reflecting the area's rich architectural history or providing a modern interpretation which respects Heritage Assets;
 - d. Support developments in the Local Centre that create a well-designed shopfront and encouraging landowners and businesses fronting Merton High Street, Kingston Road, Morden Road and Merton Road to improve their shopfronts and building facades;
 - e. Supporting measures to enhance the streetscene and public realm in South Wimbledon, particularly along the main roads where most travel takes place;
 - f. Encouraging measures that help to minimise and mitigate pollutants associated with the busy road network, including planting and green cover, measures to encourage walking and cycling and, electric vehicle charging points;
 - g. Protecting and enhancing the public open space at Nelson Gardens and Haydons Road Recreation Ground, and improving links to Abbey Recreation Ground, Wandle Park and other nearby open spaces;
 - h. Support well designed development commensurate with the excellent public transport access of the area;

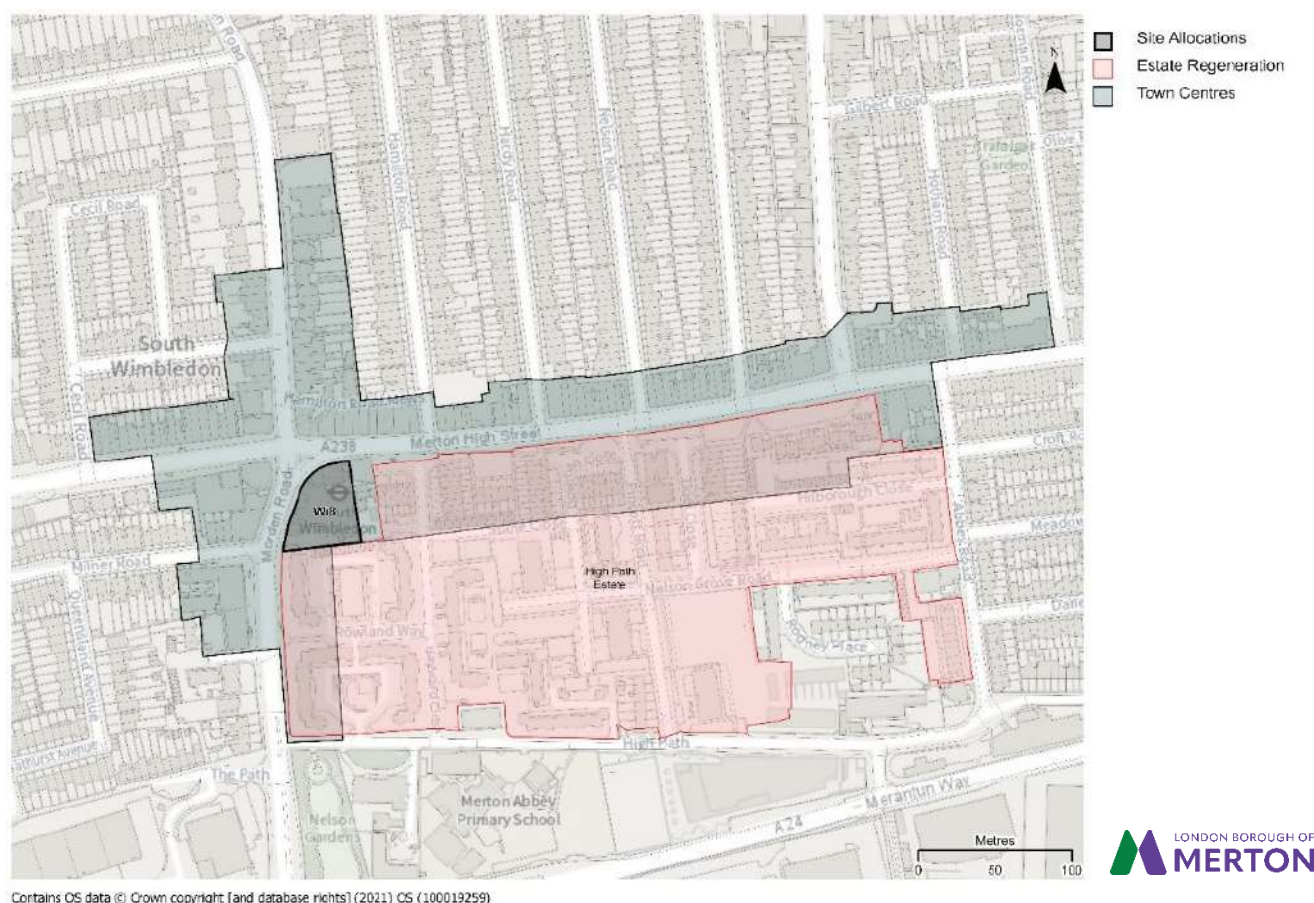
- i. Support improvements to the transport infrastructure that will help to reduce road congestion and improve the public realm, particularly for pedestrians and cyclists;
- j. Integrate the regeneration phases being delivered on the High Path estate over the next 10-15 years, guided by the Estates Local Plan to ensure the development enhances the local environment; this includes the proposed public park at High Path;
- k. Supporting the redevelopment at South Wimbledon station (Site Allocation Wi8) which respects and enhances the Grade II listed building and other Heritage Assets within the area, delivers a range of benefits including a public space, cycle parking, improved station facilities and secondary pedestrian entrance to the underground station off the busy main roads.

Supporting text

- 7.1.1. South Wimbledon lies at the centre of Merton; in previous Local Plans the area has been subsumed into Colliers Wood or Wimbledon. However, there are now a number of factors that support South Wimbledon being considered a defined Local Centre in its own right and the council proposes to take this forward through this new Local Plan. These factors are set out below.
- 7.1.2. It is clear from the responses to the consultation and the work started by the community-led South Wimbledon Enhancement plan that residents consider South Wimbledon as a neighbourhood with its own distinctive character.
- 7.1.3. The area has a very strong historical context. Although there are limited remnants that are easily visible above ground, there are many distinctive historical references to be found in structures, buildings and local gardens in the area. Admiral Lord Nelson's "Paradise Merton" estate was located where High Path now stands and St John the Divine Church and Nelson Gardens were both created to commemorate the anniversary of Nelson's death. South Wimbledon station building and Rodney Place cottages are both Heritage Assets directly connected to the advent of London Underground. The surrounding residential areas have distinctive characters and built form in themselves (e.g. the "Battles" roads of Victorian / Edwardian terraces, the "Australias" to the west, the High Path estate itself) and these design standards are occasionally reflected on Merton High Street and Kingston Road. These residential neighbourhoods are, in appearance, distinct islands of development except where they meet the main road frontage. We therefore support residents in trying to create a more

cohesive, integrated South Wimbledon local centre, based around the South Wimbledon junction.

- 7.1.4. Like other Local Centres, the function of South Wimbledon is to provide local shops and services for people that live nearby so that households can access these by walking or cycling, reducing the need to travel far or to travel by vehicle. We recognise that the way we shop is changing, and rapidly. The increase in online shopping, the recent rise of food delivery apps and changes to national rules to allow small shops throughout England to convert to flats without planning permission is changing the economic viability and occupation of shopfronts.
- 7.1.5. Across London there has been a contraction in the numbers of shops along main road arteries, slightly offset by a rise in cafes and restaurants around transport hubs which can serve both passing customers and the wider area via online food delivery apps. Kingston Road in particular has seen several small shops convert to flats outside the planning system; there are some good examples and some extremely poor examples of the resultant shopfronts.
- 7.1.6. The Local Centre boundary focusses on the South Wimbledon junction encompassing shopping parades in all directions where shops and services are most likely to be viable due to the higher footfall and is informed by feedback from people who live and work there. The map below illustrates the policies map designations: the new Local Centre boundary for South Wimbledon, the site allocation Wi8 South Wimbledon Station and the High Path estate regeneration boundary as defined in Merton's Estates Local Boundary 2018.



- 7.1.7. There are a wide variety of different businesses fronting the main roads around South Wimbledon. Many are small supermarkets or food shops, cafes, restaurants and hot food takeaways. We will continue to support businesses commensurate with the Local Centre. We recognise the larger number of hot food takeaways in South Wimbledon and the links to childhood obesity; in accordance with other policies in the plan, we will not support further takeaways where there is already an over-concentration.
- 7.1.8. People are more likely to use local shops and services if they are in an attractive setting, if the walking or cycling route to reach them looks good and feels safe. While many of the surrounding local streets are attractive with properties that are generally well cared for and maintained by their occupants, the busy arterial roads are noisy, heavily trafficked and don't have the same sense of place as exists in the surrounding neighbourhoods.
- 7.1.9. To help create a better sense of place at the junction around South Wimbledon underground station junction, we will support development and public realm improvements that soften the look and feel of the Local Centre, reference the historic and local character of the surrounding areas, provide development standards (e.g. building orientation, insulation, winter gardens etc. that help mitigate the road issues). We recognise that in the long term the South Wimbledon junction needs active travel improvements and a reduction of traffic

dominance on Merton High Street. However, South Wimbledon does benefit from several long standing successful low traffic neighbourhood schemes, that create a pleasant walking and cycling environment away from Merton High Street. There are alternative links on quiet streets with permeable connections through to cycle route CS7 and the Wandle Trail.

- 7.1.10. The council will also encourage businesses and residents to restore or redevelop building facades to a high standard. South Wimbledon is rich in architectural history, such as the Victorian detailing found on many buildings which give the area a distinct character; development proposals should reflect existing elements or interpret them in a modern way. Merton's shopfront design guide provides practical information about how to assess, design, and maintain a successful shopfront and can be used regardless of the occupier of the building.
- 7.1.11. Consultation responses to the Local Plan and prior to the Local Plan have called for more public space to be created around South Wimbledon. Nelson Gardens along Morden Road is perhaps too far away from the station and the areas of highest footfall to be well used. Proposals for the High Path estate, as guided by [Merton's Estates Local Plan](#) and set out in the approved Outline Planning Application (ref 17/P1721) will provide a new public park as well as smaller pockets of landscaped space within the estate. However aside from the regeneration of High Path there are no large sites in the immediate South Wimbledon area adjoining the main roads and so there is more limited opportunity for the creation of new public space with close proximity to where most people use the underground station, shops and services and would benefit the most.
- 7.1.12. The council therefore supports the creation of small pockets of well-designed public space close to South Wimbledon underground station where they are most likely to provide opportunities for pause away from the busy main roads.
- 7.1.13. Although a third of Merton is made up of parks, commons and other open spaces, South Wimbledon has more limited open space provision than most of the rest of Merton. Some of the nearest public open spaces for South Wimbledon residents are at Nelson Gardens, Abbey Recreation Ground and Haydons Road Recreation Ground and parts of South Wimbledon are in easy walking distance of the Wandle Trail. Where development proposals cannot provide sufficient open space on site, they may be expected to contribute to improvements at nearby open spaces.
- 7.1.14. The regeneration of the High Path estate will take place in phases over the next 15 years. This investment will result in the most substantial change to the layout, function and

character of High Path. While [Merton's Estates Local Plan 2018](#) provides the planning framework to guide this regeneration, it will also deliver key proposals that South Wimbledon respondents have called for, including a public park fronting Merton High Street, a new layout fronting Merton High Street with new shopfronts and business space; investment in landscaping and the public realm.

- 7.1.15. As set out in Merton's Estates Local Plan 2018, the detailed design of the regeneration at High Path must create a strong character, particularly fronting Merton High Street and provide high quality landscaping and urban greening. New development proposals must also have regard to the proposed regeneration at High Path as well as this plan, to ensure that South Wimbledon is developed as a cohesive, attractive and legible neighbourhood. Before designing new schemes, potential applicants for schemes within the vicinity of the High Path estate are advised to refer to the High Path section of Merton's adopted Estates Local Plan 2018 and to contact the applicants of the outline planning application 17/P1721 (Clarion Housing Group) to ensure co-ordination of site designs, uses, materials and movement.
- 7.1.16. South Wimbledon Business Area (also known as Morden Industrial Area) to the south forms part of Merton's Strategic Industrial Locations and is one of Merton's most popular and best occupied estates for businesses throughout south London. Developments will be supported that retain or improve the area for employment purposes, especially those catering for modern business accommodation. Development that could locate in town centres such as retail or offices that are not ancillary to other development will be resisted, in order to minimise potential conflict with the HGVs and extended business operational hours required in a modern economy.

Site Wi8: South Wimbledon Station, Morden Road, South Wimbledon, SW19 3DB**Ward:** Abbey**Site description:**

1. The site is an important, highly visible landmark within the proposed new South Wimbledon Local Centre. The site is a part single storey / part two-storey Northern line underground station, with pedestrian access from the corner of South Wimbledon junction. The façade of the building is clad in Portland stone and the building is of the distinctive Charles Holden design. The building is two storeys to the rear and built with London brick. The site has Transport for London operational offices and shop units, found on the corner of two strategic roads Morden Road and Merton High Street.
2. To the south of the main building within part of the curtilage of the site there is a small car park and shed, that is currently occupied by a car hire firm. The Horse and Groom pub lies to the east of the site, fronting Merton High Street. Beyond this the sites are surrounded to the south and east by the High Path estate which is part of a regeneration programme being led by the freeholder Clarion Housing Group.
3. The site is surrounded by proposals for the regeneration of High Path estate, guided by the Estates Local Plan and with an Outline Planning Application 17/P1721 resolved for approval in March 2018. (The site lies outside but next to both the Local Plan and the Outline Planning Application).

Site owner: Transport for London**Site area:** 0.21ha**Existing uses:** Underground Station and commercial premises (coffee shop and local convenience store)**Site allocation:** Retaining the underground station and residential or residential mixed-use retail,

financial services and professional, cafes and restaurants, public house and offices

Site deliverability: 10-15 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): TBC

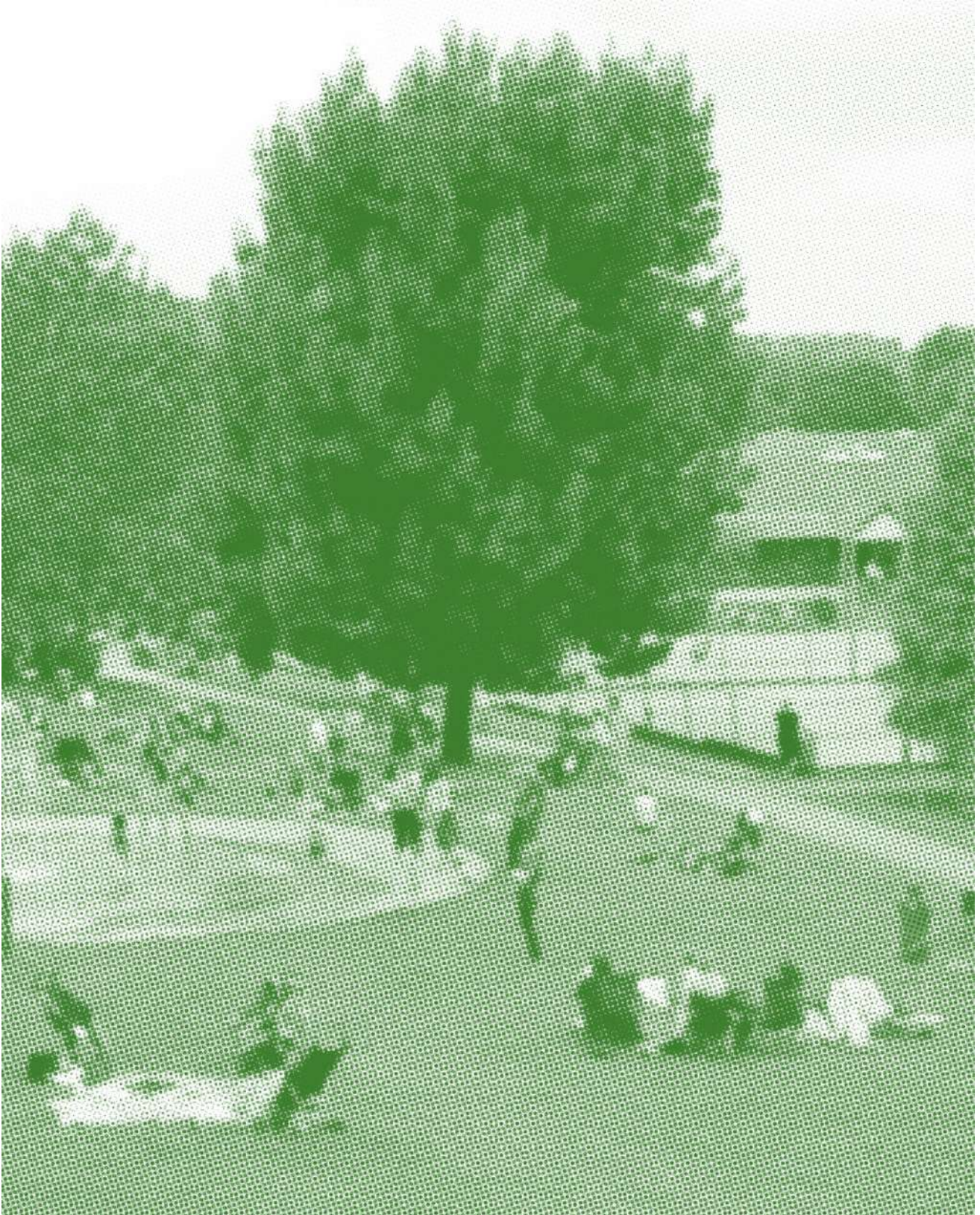
Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development of the site provides several opportunities to deliver new homes in an accessible sustainable location, providing new services and homes at a landmark location in the new South Wimbledon local centre.
2. Development proposals must respect and enhance the Grade II listed Heritage Asset of South Wimbledon Station and other local Heritage Assets within the area. There is an opportunity to compliment the Charles Holden designed listed London Underground station.
3. Development proposals should explore the opportunity to create a secondary entrance to the underground station and a small public space to the rear of the site, both situated away from the busy South Wimbledon junction. This would help improve the resilience of the station, provide greater permeability and movement options for people travelling to and from the station and create a small space to pause away from the busy junction. There is an opportunity to engage with neighbouring landowners, (Clarion Housing Group) to coordinate on design, streetscape and optimise both sites for the delivery of new homes.
4. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.
5. An investigation of the potential impact of any development on archaeological heritage is needed.
6. The site is within 50m of London Underground subsurface tunnels and infrastructure therefore London Underground Infrastructure Protection must be consulted.
7. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our Opportunity Area is to deliver 5000 new homes and 6000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the Opportunity Area is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site playspace provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
3. Development proposals should provide high quality secure cycle storage for commuters in addition to and separate from residential cycle parking provision.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton

Council will also, engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
The site location
Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: South Wimbledon station building is Grade II listed, one of several Charles Holden designed purpose-built London Underground station buildings.
Impacts a Conservation Area: No
Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No
Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts on flooding from all sources: Site partially in Flood Zone 2 and in a critical drainage area
Is in a Town Centre: Yes
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes
Impacts a designated open space: No
Impacts on an ecology designation: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6, excellent access to public transport



Chapter 08. **Wimbledon Park**

WIMBLEDON PARK – POLICY N8.1

- 1.** To address the reasons why the Grade II* Wimbledon Park is on Historic England's Heritage at Risk Register and to recognise and support its sporting, recreation, ecological and amenity functions.
- 2.** We will do this by:
 - a.** Supporting, the park's sport, recreation, play and amenity uses and enhancing access to them, ensuring their successful integration with historic and biodiversity designations.
 - b.** Preparing a landscape management plan to help all landowners co-ordinate the long-term management and maintenance of Wimbledon Park.
 - c.** Securing investment in the former golf course to conserve and enhance the historic landscape, biodiversity, sport and recreation and secure public access.
 - d.** Improving public access around the whole lake, alongside biodiversity, sporting, public safety, flood risk, while ensuring compliance for reservoir safety.
 - e.** Addressing the lake's poor condition and seeking restoration of its historic shape and form.
 - f.** Ensuring the lake continues to operate safely and in line with the national requirements for a large raised Reservoir, while managing flood risk.
 - g.** Identifying and protecting historic trees and other trees of significant amenity value and considering a programme for their renewal.
 - h.** Considering the removal of insensitive tree and other non-native planting, particularly on the former golf course and around the athletics track.
 - i.** Protecting and enhancing biodiversity, increasing the ecological interest of the park and its waterbodies.
 - j.** Respect the site's historic setting, enhance historic and new views to and across the lake, and to St Mary's Church, and support greater public access to these views.



Supporting text

- 8.1.1. Wimbledon Park is a Grade II* Historic Park and Garden, lying to the north of the borough and crossing the borough boundary between Merton and Wandsworth. The majority (c48ha) of the park lies within the London Borough of Merton; a smaller proportion (c12ha) lies within the London Borough of Wandsworth.
- 8.1.2. Wimbledon Park is the remnants of a larger Lancelot “Capability” Brown landscape, designed in the late 1700s originally for a nearby Manor House (since demolished). The Wimbledon Park Conservation Area Character Appraisal for Wimbledon Park contains details of the successive Manor Houses and the evolution of Wimbledon Park to what it is today.
- 8.1.3. Wimbledon Park is in three ownerships: Merton Council, the All England Lawn Tennis Club (AELTC) and the Wimbledon Club. About a third of Wimbledon Park, owned by Merton Council, is currently publicly accessible. The All England Lawn Tennis Club’s main grounds lie to the west of Wimbledon Park across Church Road and the whole park has been used for many years to support the successful functioning of the Wimbledon Tennis Championships each summer. Planning application 21/P2900 relating to the former golf

course within Wimbledon Park has been considered by the London Boroughs of Merton and Wandsworth and is now with the Mayor of London for determination.

- 8.1.4. The whole of Wimbledon Park is designated as Metropolitan Open Land, designated Open Space and Green Corridor. Wimbledon Park lies within Wimbledon North Conservation Area and a Tier 2 Archaeological Priority Area. Except for the public park, the site lies within a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINC) Borough Grade 1. These designations are addressed by other policies in the Development Plan.
- 8.1.5. Wimbledon Park lake is the clearest surviving feature of Capability Brown's original design. Other surviving landscape features over 200 years old include veteran trees and the presence of woodland at Horse Close Wood and Ashen Grove. The lake is also a registered 'large raised' Reservoir under the Reservoir Act 1975, an active watersports destination and a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation, containing protected species and their habitats. The Lake connects via the Wimbledon Park Brook and surface water sewer network into the River Wandle downstream in Earlsfield.
- 8.1.6. In addition to the historic and natural environment designations, Wimbledon Park is an intensively used sporting venue across all three land ownerships, hosting watersports, tennis, beach volleyball, cricket, hockey and golf until 2023. The public part of the park is also important for recreation, play and amenity. Wimbledon Park meets multiple priorities for green and blue infrastructure and associated amenity, education, health and wellbeing benefits as set out in [Merton's Green Infrastructure Study 2020](#).

Sports, recreation and play

- 8.1.7. NPPF 2023 para 98 *"Access to a network of high-quality open spaces and opportunities for sport and physical activity is important for the health and well-being of communities and can deliver wider benefits for nature and support efforts to address climate change."* The London Plan supports retaining and enhancing formal and informal sporting and recreational facilities to encourage physical activity and deliver a range of social, health and wellbeing benefits. The London Plan also recognises that the co-location of sporting facilities can increase participation.
- 8.1.8. Wimbledon Park supports a wide range of sports and recreational uses including angling, watersports, athletics, bowls, hockey, cricket, mini-golf, tennis and beach volleyball. It also provides open space for informal sports and recreation, particularly on the Great Field in the public park, walking around the park and parts of the lakeshore, the recently deculverted brook and in the children's playgrounds and splash play. In line with policy IN14.3 we will

safeguard existing sport and recreation facilities, encourage further opportunities for sport, recreation and play, encourage co-location of services and improve community access.

- 8.1.9. The public park is intensively used and this policy seeks to maintain this and improve public access to private land ownership where possible. This policy supports the provision of well-maintained and adequately sized paths, bridges, toilets, drainage and other ancillary services to support access to and enjoyment of more of the park for people of all ages and abilities.

Enhancing biodiversity and access to nature

- 8.1.10. Wimbledon Park, including the lake, has multiple land use designations to support biodiversity and nature conservation. Protected species including different species of bat and birds, stag beetle, common frog and toad, European eel, veteran trees and other flora. There is also potential to improve biodiversity resilience by better habitat management, for example addressing the poor condition of the lake, removing recent planting located too close to veteran trees, replacing non-native with native species, and reducing pollutants in grassland management. In line with policy O15.3 biodiversity and access to nature we will protect and enhance biodiversity and improve accessibility to nature.

The historic environment

- 8.1.11. Paragraph 190 of the NPPF 2023 state *“Plans should set out a positive strategy for the conservation and enjoyment of the historic environment, including heritage assets most at risk through neglect, decay or other threats. This strategy should take into account:*
- a) the desirability of sustaining and enhancing the significance of heritage assets, and putting them to viable uses consistent with their conservation.*
 - b) the wider social, cultural, economic and environmental benefits that conservation of the historic environment can bring.*
 - c) the desirability of new development making a positive contribution to local character and distinctiveness; and*
 - d) opportunities to draw on the contribution made by the historic environment to the character of a place.*
- 8.1.12. In 2016 the Wimbledon Park Registered Park and Garden was added to Historic England’s Heritage at Risk Register due to the following issues:
- a. Uncertainty around the future [of the entire historic landscape].
 - b. The impacts of divided ownership on landscape management.

- c. Obscured views.
- d. The deterioration of the lake.

Addressing the future of the historic landscape and landscape management

- 8.1.13. Wimbledon Park is currently owned by three freeholders. The 9 hectare lake and c18 hectares of Wimbledon Park is owned by the London Borough of Merton and used as a public park, including part that lies within the London Borough of Wandsworth.
- 8.1.14. The remainder is privately owned and is not publicly accessible. 29 hectares is the freehold of the All England Lawn Tennis Club. In 2016, when Wimbledon Park was added to Historic England's Heritage at Risk Register, Wimbledon Park Golf Club was the leaseholder of this land which was used as a golf course for many decades until January 2023. The remaining c4 hectares is owned by the Wimbledon Club.
- 8.1.15. Wimbledon North Conservation Area Character Appraisal 2006 (sub-area 2) describes the remnants of the Capability Brown landscape at Wimbledon Park, and positive and detrimental features. For many decades landscape management has been divided across four organisations (the council, the Wimbledon Club, AELTC and their leaseholder, the Wimbledon Park Golf Club). The sites were being managed intensively and largely independently in accordance with their main purpose: either as a public park including sporting and recreational uses, a private sporting venue or a golf course.
- 8.1.16. Wimbledon north conservation area character appraisal 2006 identifies positive and negative landscape features within and just beyond Wimbledon Park. Addressing the negative features in Wimbledon Park's landscape, enhancing the positive features and, where possible, better co-ordinating landscape management across the whole site will help to address the reasons that Wimbledon Park is on the Heritage at Risk Register.
- 8.1.17. To this end we will secure the production of a landscape management and maintenance plan as part of any development proposals that may come forward. This will provide a comprehensive plan for the conservation, enhancement and ongoing management of the entire registered park and garden that takes full account of the site's historic development and significance, acting as a common agreed baseline for all parties to work from.

Addressing obscured views

- 8.1.18. In the eighteenth century the original Capability Brown landscape was curated across a larger area in the "English Landscape" style, using the existing topography and man-made features including the creation of the lake with spurs to resemble river entrances, open parkland interspersed by carefully placed trees and woodland all giving rise to curated

views, including of St Mary's Church spire. Veteran trees, particularly oak and some dating or pre-dating the 1800s, remain across the former golf course and within the council-owned public park. The woodland belts at Horse Close Wood and Ashen Grove were also part of the Brownian layout.

- 8.1.19. Younger, faster growing trees have been planted to create fairways as part of the former golf course operations; sometimes obscuring the views and parkland setting and sometimes in too close proximity to veteran trees. Faster growing conifers and polars planted to screen the athletics track also dominate the landscape negatively.
- 8.1.20. Due in part to the reservoir dam face, trees, and C20th buildings and structures built within the park, the parkland and lake are difficult to see from key publicly accessible points, including Home Park Road, the closest entrance to Wimbledon Park Station. The topography (rising at either end and including the lake's dam face) both helps and hinders views across the area. Buildings on or adjacent the lakeshore in the public park and the Wimbledon Club site obscure views across the lake.
- 8.1.21. The following measures should be considered for addressing obscured views, including those derived from Wimbledon North Conservation Area Character Appraisal 2006:
- 8.1.22. To improve the historic view lines across the lake:
 - a. Removing insensitive tree planting, particularly around the athletics track and on the former golf course.
 - b. Improving the appearance of buildings or removing them and to co-locating their services within other facilities while maintaining easy access to the lakeshore for watersports equipment and people.
- 8.1.23. To improve views across the whole park and lake, improving historic views and creating new views:
 - a. Removing insensitive fairway tree and other planting on the former golf course and anywhere else it is found,
 - b. Improving public access to currently private land and particularly around the whole lake.
 - c. Ensuring that viewing points are accessible to people of all abilities by creating or maintaining paths, fences and planting so as not to create a barrier to access or views.
 - d. Ensuring that buildings or development are co-located wherever possible and designed to minimise their impact on the landscape.

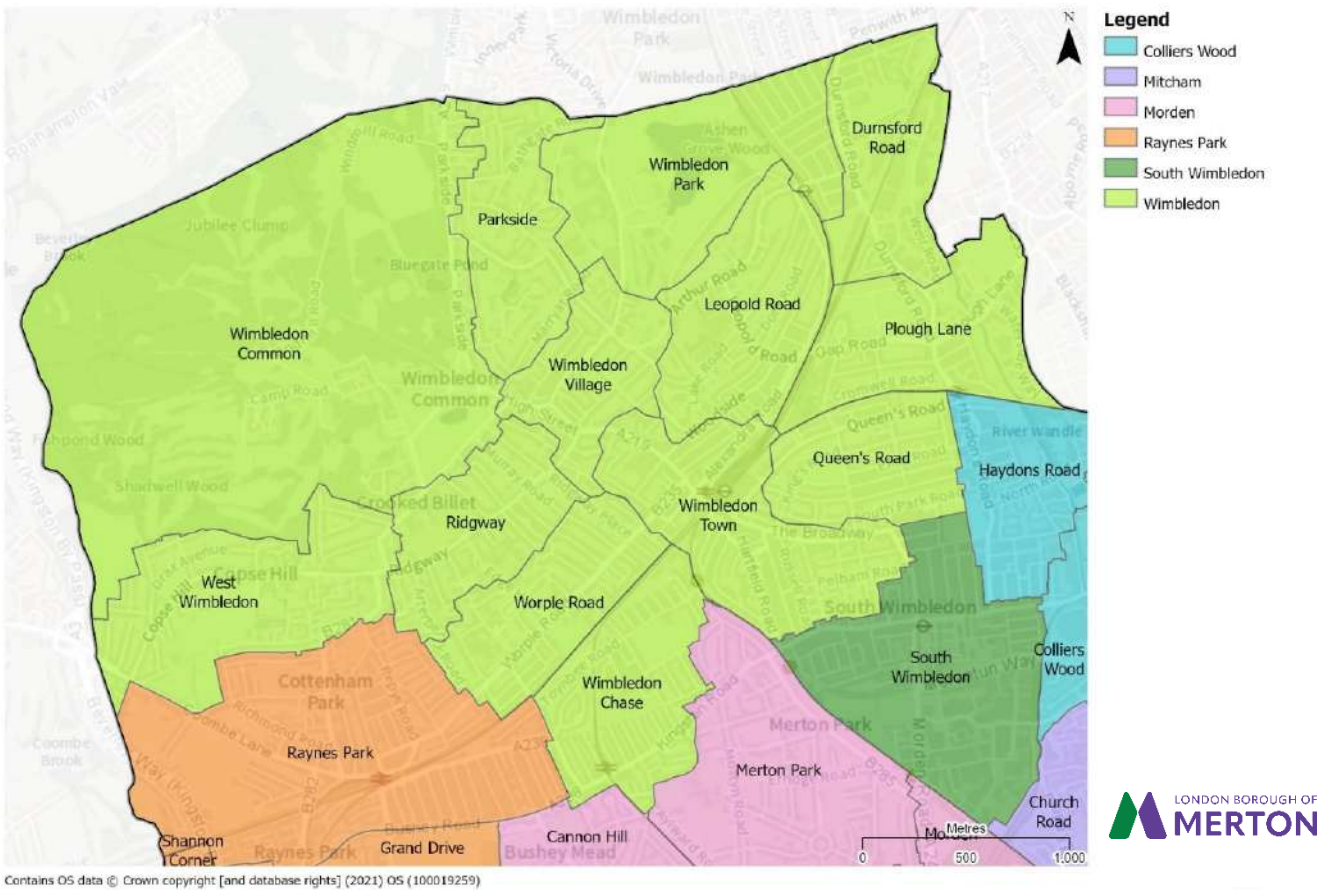
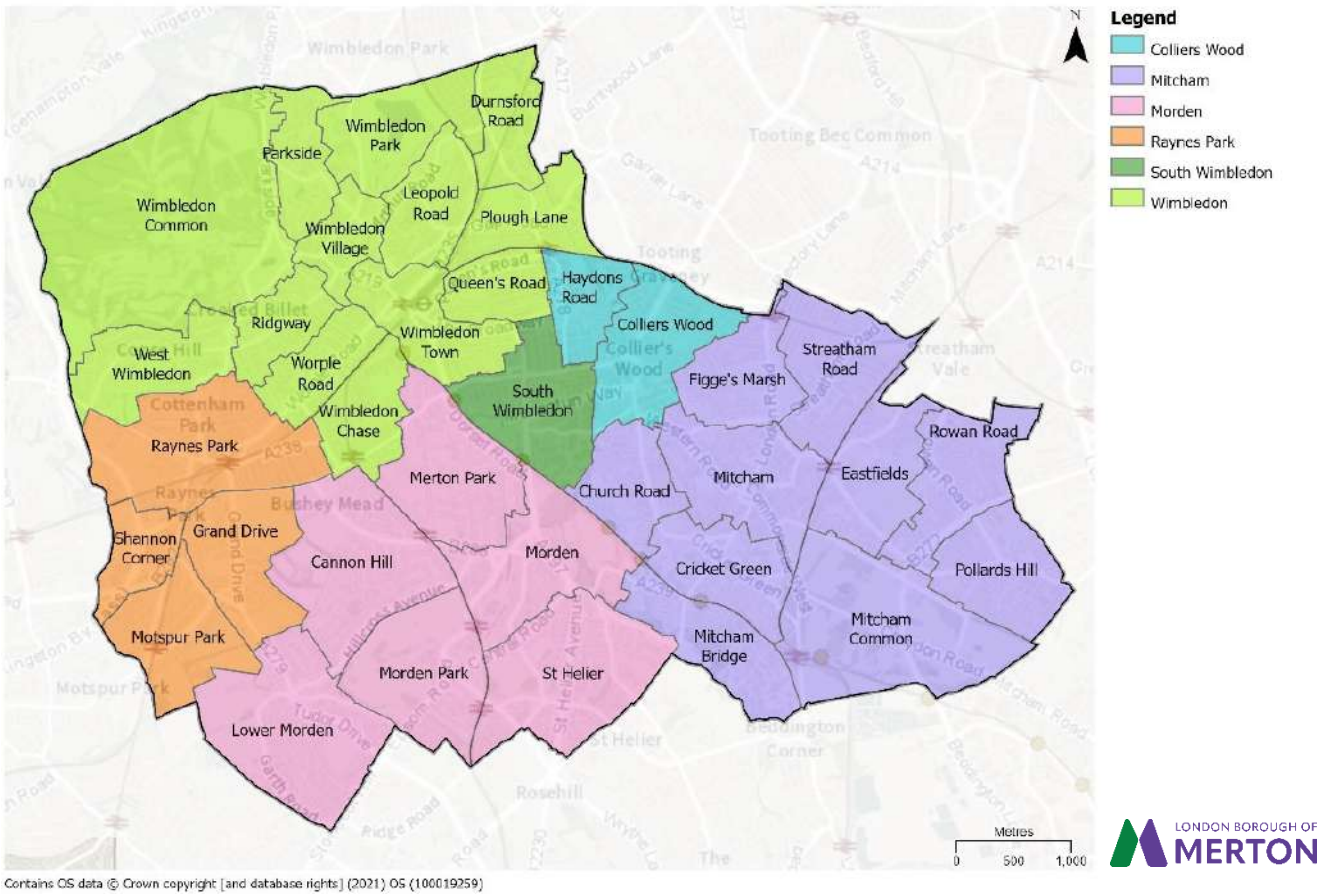
Addressing the deterioration of the lake

- 8.1.24. Wimbledon Park lake is the largest and most visible remaining feature of Capability Brown's man-made landscape. The spurs that feed into the lake have been partially filled in, reducing the lakes size, form and shape. The Lake is fed by overland flow paths and the surface water sewer network, principally by two large surface water sewers and outfalls both of which are currently adopted by Thames Water. The total catchment area which feeds the lake is approximately 230ha of which 40ha is direct catchment and 190ha is indirect catchment from urbanised areas, including highway runoff.
- 8.1.25. It is a registered as a Grade A large raised reservoir, regulated under the Reservoir Act 1975. The reservoir is retained by an earthfill embankment, some 320m long. The height of the embankment varies from approximately 1m to a maximum of about 4m. The Lake flows into the River Wandle downstream in Earlfield via the Wimbledon Park Brook and the surface water sewer network.
- 8.1.26. The Lake is not used for drinking water supply purposes. The current poor quality of the Lake and its setting is one of the reasons that Wimbledon Park is on the "heritage at risk" register.
- 8.1.27. As well as being a large raised reservoir, the lake is intensively used for a variety of activities including angling, watersports and by wildfowl (including visitors feeding the birds) and has high localised amenity value. Over the years, the lake has suffered from pollution incidents, as a result of flytipping waste into drains or via drainage misconnections from private properties which inadvertently connects household foul drains to the surface water sewer network which ultimately feeds into the lake. Several of these pollution incidents have resulted in fish kills, particularly in summer when oxygen levels in the lake are low and water depths are shallow.
- 8.1.28. The lake is generally shallow in depth, sited in an urban area and in terms of water quality it is nutrient rich. During summer, when the water heats up and oxygen levels are low and nutrient levels are high, the suffers from algal blooms, some of which can be hazardous to wildlife, pets and the public. Since its formation, the Lake has over time silted up quite considerably. This siltation is in part due to detritus ingress through the outfalls into the Lake, vegetation (leaf fall) and wildfowl habitat, combined with a relatively stagnant water passage through the lake being artificially dammed over hundreds of years.

- 8.1.29. A Section 10 Reservoir Act inspection report was carried out in 2014 which included statutory requirements that needed to be actioned to ensure compliance with the Act for Reservoir Safety. The council carried out a bathymetric survey of the silt levels in 2015. The council completed the Wimbledon Park Lake Reservoir Safety scheme in 2022, which has addressed reservoir safety requirements and made some improvements to the landscape and lake edge. As part of the wider opportunities of this project, the Council were able to deculvert an open section of the Wimbledon Park Brook in the public park to help create additional flood storage and improve the landscape and biodiversity. However the lake needs de-silting to ensure its amenity and historic value, to ensure water quality is not compromised, as the climate changes and hotter summers become more frequent. De-silting will be likely to help to reduce the number and length of algal blooms, improve its ecological capacity, increase oxygenation and continue to use the Lake safely and fully for watersports, angling, heritage, biodiversity and amenity.
- 8.1.30. Given the size of this historic asset and its London location, the lake shoreline currently has very limited public access. We will work with all landowners to improve public access around the whole lake, taking into account biodiversity habitats, sporting, safety and reservoir management considerations.

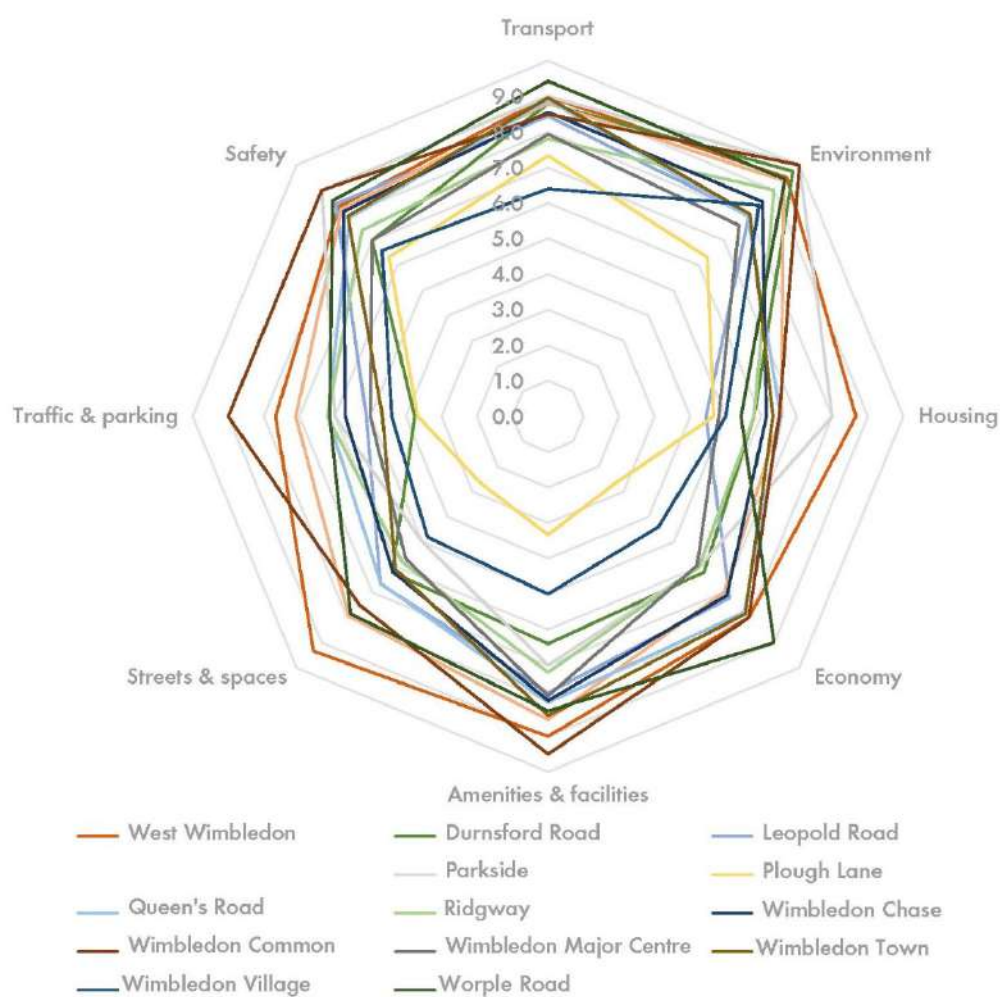


Chapter 09. **Wimbledon**



Place profile: Wimbledon

As part of the borough's ongoing Character Study, 415 Merton residents took part in this survey, of which 136 people lived in Wimbledon. The diagram below highlights how people felt about their neighbourhood based on a series of questions asked. This work was also used to inform [Merton's Borough Character Study 2021](#).



Results from residents of Wimbledon rating their neighbourhood

Key objectives: Wimbledon

The following objectives provide an overarching vision for Wimbledon.



A vibrant town centre

Encourage appropriate development to support businesses and attract visitors and tourism to the area all year round.



Greening Wimbledon

Enhance the experience of Wimbledon by requiring exemplary design and landscaping, street scene and public realm investment.



Conserving character

Maintain the unique character and built form of the areas surrounding the Town Centre by supporting development of high quality that is commensurate with the scale.

Character: Wimbledon

These photos illustrate the diverse character found across Wimbledon.





Policy N9.1 Wimbledon

Wimbledon Town Centre

- 1.** To ensure that Wimbledon continues to be a thriving destination for businesses, residents and visitors.
- 2.** We will do this by:
 - a.** Promoting Wimbledon as southwest London's premier location for business, leisure, living and culture: an exemplar for good quality and sustainable placemaking.
 - b.** Driving investment and innovation in workspaces to support the local economy and jobs in the town centre commensurate with Wimbledon's role as a Major Centre. Encourage development that attracts residents, businesses, visitors and tourism to the area all year round, including high quality hotels, conference facilities and cultural activities.
 - c.** Enhancing the experience for people coming to Wimbledon commensurate to its international reputation by requiring exemplary design and landscaping, street scene and public realm investment, taking the Healthy Streets Approach including opportunities to green Wimbledon.
 - d.** Supporting high quality architecture and design with traditional urban blocks with active frontages.
 - e.** Supporting tall buildings within Wimbledon Town Centre in accordance with the details in the Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre and the requirements in Policy D12.6 Tall Buildings.
 - f.** Respecting views from Wimbledon Hill through the Town Centre and beyond, with taller developments at St George's Road, away from the historic core, located around the station.
 - g.** Strengthening the position of Wimbledon as a Major Centre in south London through the redevelopment of key sites within the centre.
 - h.** Promoting a vibrant daytime, evening and night-time economy through a mix of commercial and community uses.

- i. Promoting good placemaking by providing places for people to meet, relax, enjoy events and participate in the Town Centre.
- j. Improving health and wellbeing by promoting walking and cycling: making the Town Centre more attractive, greener, safer, easier to get around for pedestrians and cyclists.
- k. Securing improvements to public transport and investment in Wimbledon station to improve the passenger experience. Any proposals for Wimbledon Station should provide links to neighbouring sites and enable the creation of new public realm, including an enhanced station forecourt/town square.
- l. Creating a more pleasant environment for shopping and leisure activities by reducing traffic dominance and managing delivery and servicing needs in a safe, efficient and sustainable way, including through exploring the use of freight consolidation and last mile delivery solutions.

Surrounding neighbourhoods of Wimbledon

- m. Maintaining the unique character and built form character of Wimbledon Village, supporting development that is commensurate with the scale and the significant quality of this Local Centre.
- n. Supporting development that attracts greater footfall and boosts the visitor experience to Wimbledon Village and Arthur Road Local Centre.
- o. Supporting environmental improvements and maintaining the day-to-day shopping and other services at Wimbledon Chase and Arthur Road Local Centre.
- p. Supporting improvements to business premises and the public realm in Haydons Road to bolster local high street offer.
- q. Conserving and enhancing the quality of neighbourhoods through Conservation Area character protection, and by supporting development that respects the character and Heritage Assets within the area.
- r. Supporting proposals to improve walking and cycling between the neighbourhoods of South Wimbledon, Colliers Wood, Wimbledon, Wimbledon Village, Raynes Park, Wimbledon Chase

and outside the borough to Tooting, Southfields and Kingston.

- s. Recognising the importance of Wimbledon Tennis Championships, support the continued upgrade and improvement of the AELTC's facilities in Wimbledon and at Raynes Park to maintain its global position as a world-class sporting venue of national and international significance and to provide economic, community and sporting benefits locally.
- t. Supporting accessible local services including step-free access at Haydons Road and Wimbledon Chase stations.

Supporting text

9.1.1. Wimbledon is southwest London's best known town centre, with a reputation for quality recognised internationally due to the 150-year-old Wimbledon Tennis Championships. Wimbledon is also Merton's only Major Town Centre, and the heart of its successful economy. The area is served by tube, train, tram and bus, is surrounded by high quality homes set in attractive streets and well served by local infrastructure.

9.1.2. The [Future Wimbledon Supplementary Planning Document \(SPD\) 2020](#) outlines the priorities for Wimbledon Town Centre:

- **Design quality** - Design quality underpins good growth. The future of Wimbledon should draw inspiration from its past. With many existing high quality listed buildings, future development should enhance their character and setting. Buildings should respond to the principles and materials from their context. Careful consideration to building heights and scale must be given, in particular when relating with Heritage Assets and views from neighbouring conservation areas.
- **Public realm** - Spaces to dwell, socialise and relax are vital for the life of a town centre and the wellbeing of people. Wimbledon does not currently have many public spaces. The piazza is the main focus for outdoor events and markets. Feedback from the public suggested spaces such as a new town square and multiple smaller spaces are desirable.
- **Urban greening and sustainability** - Creating a sustainable and environmentally focused town centre was highlighted as a key priority during consultation. The redevelopment of the town centre gives Wimbledon the opportunity to be a leader in

sustainable design. Sustainable drainage systems should be used where possible and planting species that improve air quality and biodiversity should be integrated into the design of the public realm.

- **Future of the high street** - Wimbledon already has a variety of uses spread across the Town Centre. However, feedback from the consultation suggested that the public would welcome more uses that compliment what is already existing. Suggestions such as spaces that provide opportunities for independent shops and affordable workspaces were mentioned as uses that would add to the vibrancy and vitality of the Town Centre and in the shorter-term assist with post COVID-19 recovery.
- **The station and railway** - There are long-term ambitions to overcome the severance caused by the railway tracks, therefore creating a more accessible and connected Town Centre. Consultees highlighted the need to reduce traffic dominance throughout the Town Centre and to humanise the public realm. A world-class station that has a sense of arrival with access to rail, underground, tram and buses was desired.

- 9.1.3. A fundamental theme throughout the engagement on the Future Wimbledon SPD, workshops, landowners' forums and responses to planning applications, community feedback and general participation in civic life has been the desire to improve the look and feel of Wimbledon Town Centre and the quality of the experience people have there, commensurate with the Wimbledon / SW19's international reputation. The Wimbledon area has a rich historical significance with high quality neighbourhoods and open spaces including Wimbledon Common. The Town Centre itself has pockets of well-loved and well-designed buildings but also parts that do not reflect the quality of the surrounding area.
- 9.1.4. Improvements to the public realm, street scene with more business and professional services and quality shops, balanced with community, leisure, arts, culture and associated facilities including tourism will achieve a noticeable uplift in the quality of the centre.
- 9.1.5. Greening Wimbledon, whether by creating new landscaped pocket parks within a new development or by adding planters, street trees or climbers to existing spaces, is a key priority. Greening has multiple benefits: it can improve the attractiveness and sense of calm and safety of a place, particularly for pedestrians, it adds to visual interest and it can benefit air quality. The council will encourage all developments in Wimbledon to optimise the greening of their site and the creation of parklets and other human-scale spaces for people

to enjoy. We will support measures outside the planning system that help make Wimbledon more attractive and foster a sense of community ownership, such as the re-use of planters and community planting of street trees.

- 9.1.6. We need growth in Wimbledon, and we need to plan it to secure the best quality we can for our town centre. Wimbledon is a long, linear Town Centre set at the bottom of Wimbledon Hill and tightly bound by attractive, established residential terraces, some of which are within conservation areas. With the exception of development sites at Dundonald Yards and Gap Road that will only be unlocked by Crossrail 2, Wimbledon has no scope to accommodate growth by expanding outwards. The local topography and quality townscape mean that Wimbledon is not suitable for high rise towers: therefore, to accommodate growth in keeping with the area, sites within Wimbledon Town Centre need to become denser and accept a moderate increase in heights.
- 9.1.7. We encourage dense mid-rise urban blocks similar to those of Bloomsbury where Heritage Assets are complemented by new buildings of quality design.
- 9.1.8. Views through the Town Centre and beyond from Wimbledon Hill will be respected, with taller developments set away from the historic core, located at the station.
- 9.1.9. New developments should contribute to creating great streets and spaces. We experience cities at ground level and street activation is key to a successful place. Interpreting Victorian detailing is important for shop fronts, whatever the end occupier. More advice on designing a quality shop front can be found in Merton's shop front guidance 2017.
- 9.1.10. Developers who look to build in Wimbledon must demonstrate a commitment to quality and design. Great contemporary design and materials that reflect, respect and enhance the historic buildings is encouraged.
- 9.1.11. Growth can be achieved by occupying more of the site and adding floors. The council will also support the redevelopment or refurbishment of offices and other buildings, usually built since the 1960s that are nearing the end of their useful life.
- 9.1.12. In the future, Crossrail 2 may be a key driver of change in Wimbledon. In particular, it will open up new opportunities for creating new public space around the station and improving links across the railway lines, helping to create more space for cycling and walking and alleviating congestion currently on and around Wimbledon Bridge.
- 9.1.13. However, at this stage Crossrail 2 is unfunded and will not be completed prior to 2040, outside the lifetime of this Local Plan. Should Crossrail 2 preparation progress during the

lifetime of this Local Plan, we will work with everyone in Wimbledon, including Love Wimbledon, residents, the Crossrail 2 team, Network Rail and others to ensure that the solution for Crossrail 2 at Wimbledon station is the best result for Wimbledon and Crossrail 2, not only the train service.

- 9.1.14. Passengers using Wimbledon station experience congestion and it is not easy to navigate, particularly at peak times, and the look and feel of the station has not been improved even though it serves a vast number of passengers through train, tram and underground. While Crossrail 2 remains at the planning stage, we will seek greater investment in Wimbledon station and its surrounds, helping to improve the attractiveness, movement and services within the station for the increasing number of visitors.
- 9.1.15. As set out in Policy N3.1 Colliers Wood, the London Plan proposes an Opportunity Area at *Wimbledon / South Wimbledon / Colliers Wood* with an indicative aim to provide 5,000 homes and 6,000 jobs. Prior to Crossrail 2's opening, for the lifetime of this Local Plan it is likely that many of the opportunities for delivering new homes will be realised through the regeneration of Morden and on sites within Colliers Wood and the wider Wimbledon area.
- 9.1.16. Wimbledon offers a range of shop types and sizes that enhance its character and distinctiveness, from smaller shop fronts that are part of South Park Gardens conservation area, fronting the Broadway to purpose built spaces such as Centre Court and Victoria Crescent. Although planning policies can't specify the brand, quality or ownership of any retailer, having a range of different sized and types of premises helps to support a greater variety of town centre offers.
- 9.1.17. We will maintain and enhance the retail core of the centre, especially within the Primary Shopping Area around the Wimbledon Station and Centre Court Shopping Centre to ensure that the centre remains competitive and meets the needs of visitors.
- 9.1.18. However, we recognise that consumer behaviour is changing rapidly. While this is having a seismic impact on the traditional high street retailers, improvements in the speed and management of servicing and deliveries are increasing the viability of niche stores and smaller restaurants.
- 9.1.19. To ensure Wimbledon remains competitive and is resilient in this challenging environment, we will continue to support development which enhances the shopping offer and retail experience in Wimbledon while working with landowners to ensure that eventually all shop fronts can support a range of different activities inside the premises, whether shops,

restaurants, leisure, cultural or a mix of all the above. As set out in the transport policies, we will also plan for the changes to pick-up, delivery and servicing that has come with multi-channel shopping, such as motorbike collection and drop off space.

- 9.1.20. Wimbledon Town Centre accommodates the majority of major office development in the borough, presenting as an attractive location for investment in southwest London. There are two distinct clusters of office development around Wimbledon Bridge and Worple Road, and a developing cluster east of the station along The Broadway. We will continue to support the development or refurbishment of major offices in these locations, including for flexible working. Due to its location with easy access by public transport, strong, recognisable name and attractive surroundings for homes, schools, recreation and leisure, Wimbledon is expected to be a more resilient location for offices than central London should the trend be for greater flexible working.
- 9.1.21. Despite its proximity to central London, the tennis championships and its significant leisure and cultural pursuits and associated valued status Wimbledon lacks quality hotel accommodation. Quality hotel and conference space is encouraged as a means to boost the business and tourist trade in the area and attract visitors to Wimbledon all year round.
- 9.1.22. Evening night-time activity, including leisure, entertainment and cultural activities can play a significant role in supporting the local economy in Wimbledon and ensuring that the centre serves a wide range of users.
- 9.1.23. A balanced approach is however needed to ensure that the competitive advantage that the night-time economy offers the centre is recognised, as well as ensuring that the potential negative impacts in relation to noise, disturbance and anti-social behaviour are addressed.

Surrounding neighbourhoods

- 9.1.24. Wimbledon Village is a Local Centre with a unique and attractive environment: high quality physical fabric and landscaping, protected by conservation area designations. It has a rich heritage and period buildings, with Wimbledon Common.
- 9.1.25. Unlike other Local Centres it has few grocery stores but several high end 'chic' comparison retailers, cafés and restaurants, with business, legal and other commercial firms operating from upper floors. Wimbledon Village is not directly served by rail but is close to Wimbledon Town Centre.
- 9.1.26. It attracts high quality comparison brands however, in the long term, it also needs to be economically resilient and adaptable to changing consumer habits. While households in the

surrounding residential areas have very high spending power, these beautiful neighbourhoods are relatively low density so there are fewer consumers living locally than in other parts of southwest London.

- 9.1.27. Businesses in the Village attract additional footfall from visitors to the nearby attractions of Wimbledon Common and the All England Lawn Tennis Club (museum and Championships) all year round, higher during the championships. The Wimbledon Village Business Association's priorities are to promote Wimbledon Village as a commercial centre and as a visitor destination and to enhance the environment and amenity of the Village.
- 9.1.28. The approach for Wimbledon Village is to maintain the uniqueness of the centre by supporting development that is commensurate to the scale and quality of the Local Centre.
- 9.1.29. Arthur Road is a smaller, more compact Local Centre than Wimbledon Village, serviced by Wimbledon Park Tube station on the District Line. It provides grocery and other facilities that cater for the day-to-day needs of residents. We will continue to support environmental improvements and the convenience nature of the centre.
- 9.1.30. Haydons Road runs from South Wimbledon to Plough Lane and is generally characterised by late Victorian terraces with later infill development. Haydons Road rail station gives access to Wimbledon, Sutton and central London. There are designated neighbourhood parades along Haydons Road but like many London arterial roads, many former shop fronts have been converted into residential uses. Merton's Shop Front Guidance 2017 provides useful information for applicants to improve the restoration or design of their shop front. Chapter 8 of the guide can be used to help design an attractive frontage at street level if the owner is converting the property into residential use. We will support planning applications that improve shop fronts and business premises along Haydons Road and improve the public realm.
- 9.1.31. The attractive terraces immediately surrounding Wimbledon Town Centre, some of which are within conservation areas, will be protected for residential amenity by focusing town centre activity within its boundaries, and by partnership working on public protection measures including community safety and public realm improvements.
- 9.1.32. The high-quality residential areas to the north and west of the Town Centre will continue to be conserved and enhanced by enforcing conservation area designations, and ensuring that new development responds to the scale, historic value and distinctive character of these neighbourhoods.

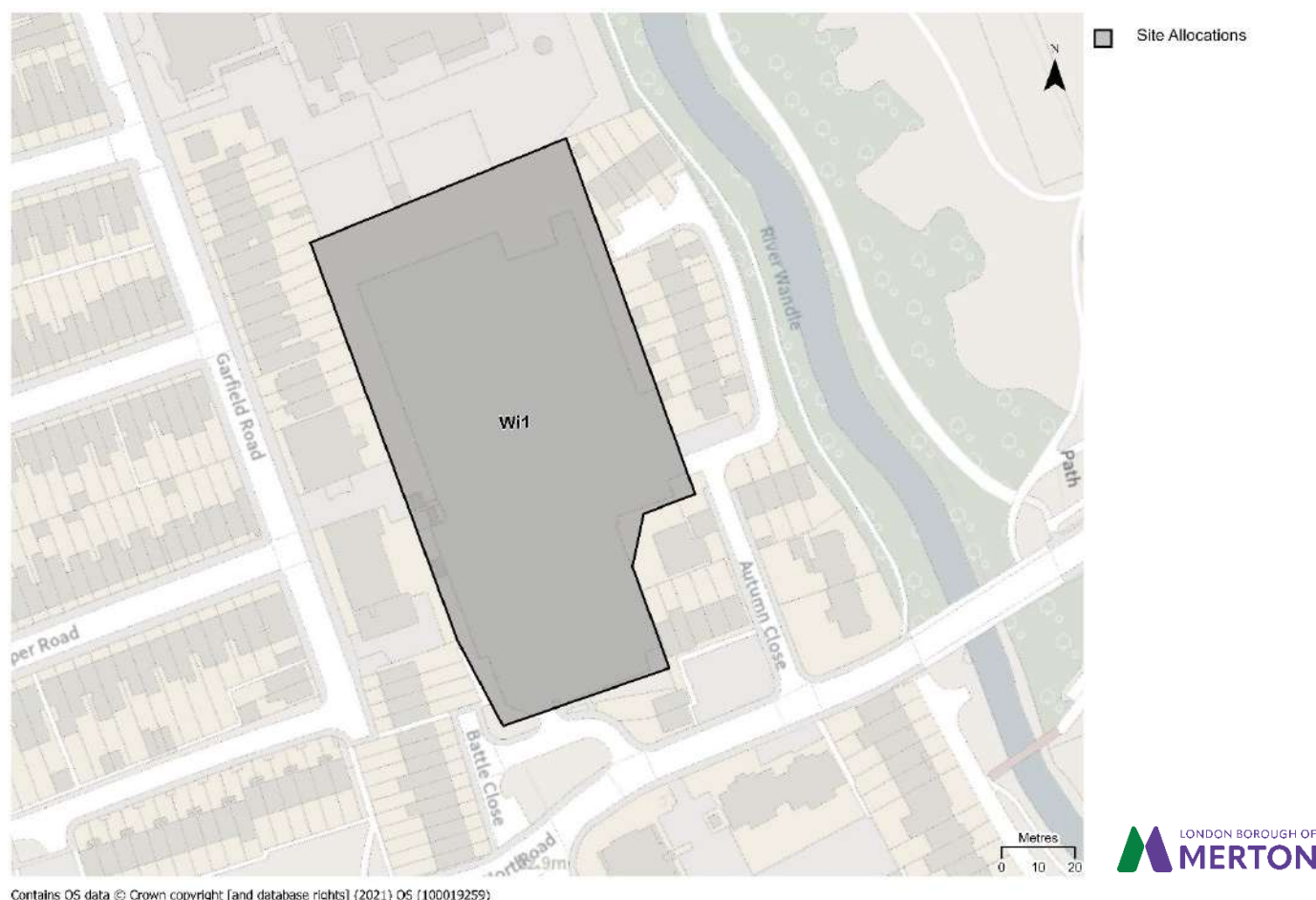
- 9.1.33. The wider Wimbledon area is relatively compact and close to other neighbourhoods in Colliers Wood, South Wimbledon, Wimbledon Chase, Southfields, Tooting, Raynes Park, Morden, Kingston and beyond. We will encourage proposals that enhance walking and cycling across south London, requiring large sites to be permeable and support public access.
- 9.1.34. Wimbledon Chase Neighbourhood Parade is served by a rail station but could benefit from environmental improvements. Transport improvements for the Wimbledon Chase area have already been identified, including provision of better facilities for buses, pedestrians and cyclists, with planting to improve the quality of the environment. We will continue to lobby for step-free access to Wimbledon Chase train station so that all residents can make equal and effective use of their local station.
- 9.1.35. The Wimbledon Tennis Championships is a world-class sporting event and is important to Wimbledon, Merton and the UK (United Kingdom). The AELTC activities not only provide a significant economic benefit and jobs boost to Merton, London and the UK in the weeks around the Wimbledon fortnight but has benefits throughout the year. The main site acts as a draw for the 100,000 visitors to the Wimbledon tennis museum, some of whom will spend in the nearby Wimbledon Town Centre, Wimbledon Village and in the businesses at Arthur Road. The Raynes Park site supports free tennis coaching for Merton and Wandsworth schoolchildren and community access for residents to pay and play outside the Championships.
- 9.1.36. We will support the continued upgrade and improvement of AELTC's facilities to maintain its global position as a world-class sporting venue of national and international significance.

Site allocations

9.1.37. Identifying sites for a specific land use or type of development helps give certainty to what is likely to happen in that neighbourhood and helps provide homes, business space, town centre type uses, infrastructure, community facilities, sports, parks and open spaces and other types of development to help meet the borough's and London's needs. These sites are contained in the development plan as site allocations.



Site Wi1: Battle Close, North Road, Wimbledon, SW19 1AQ



Ward: Wandle

Site description:

1. The site is a large, regular shaped vacant site in a residential area, with Garfield primary school and its playground to the north. The site is situated within a residential area, characterised by terraced housing, dating from between the early 20th century to the early 2000s. The former use of the site was a purpose-built gym (now demolished) and a large car park.
- To the east, south and west are two to three-storey homes. The River Wandle and Wandle Park lie beyond the eastern boundary. The only site entrance lies to the south of the site with a small, vegetated traffic island partly obscuring the site entrance from the road. Until 2017 Virgin Active were the site's leaseholders and ran the site as a private gym and fitness club. Virgin Active looked to return their leasehold to the council as freeholder and closed the facility in December 2017. The site is approx. 10 minutes' walk (0.4) miles from Colliers Wood underground station.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.97

Existing uses: Vacant

Site allocation: any of the following uses or a suitable mix of community (including education) sport / leisure facilities and residential

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 70–103 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The size of the site gives rise to a variety of opportunities for different layouts of new buildings.
2. The site provides an excellent opportunity for the planned redevelopment of a substantial brownfield site in a

residential area.

3. Redevelopment should protect the amenity of the adjacent residential occupiers and the primary school.
4. The site is classified as at risk of medium contamination from its former use for laundries and dry cleaning, however the risk will be reduced as contamination issues will have been addressed for the development of the site as a leisure centre.
5. Investigate the potential impact of any development on archaeological heritage. Vehicle access on to the site is restricted by the traffic island and the residential location.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. Despite a poor PTAL rating, the site is within easy walking distance of Haydons Road and Colliers Wood stations and vehicle access is through residential streets from a single access point, so parking provision could be reduced below maximum standards. The site is also located in close proximity to key routes on the cycle network including the Wandle trail and Cycle Superhighway 7, so development proposals should maximise opportunities for cycling through the provision of exemplary cycle parking provision and any required contribution towards local network improvements.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: Within the Wandle Valley/Colliers Wood Archaeological Priority Area Tier 2, and the 400m buffer of the Wandle Valley Regional Park boundary

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Fluvial Flood zone 1. All sites require sustainable drainage measures

Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: No. The homes at Autumn Close act as a barrier between the site and the nearby designated open space

Impacts an ecological designation: Not on site. Within 100m of Metropolitan Open Land and a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation at Wandle Park

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

Site Wi2: Broadway Car Park, Land Adjoining New Wimbledon Theatre, 111-127 The Broadway, Wimbledon, SW19



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Ward: Abbey

Site description: This site is a surface car park found off The Broadway in Wimbledon town centre. Adjoining the site boundary to the west is the New Wimbledon Theatre (Grade II listed). The South Wimbledon Club and St Mary's Primary RC School lie to the south of the site. Facing the site on the northern side of The Broadway is a shopping frontage with a series of small units. The site is surrounded by four-storey buildings.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.21ha

Existing uses: Car park

Site allocation: a suitable mix of Town Centre Type Uses such as retail, café and restaurants, community, cultural, leisure and entertainment, offices and hotel

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development proposals must have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD (Supplementary Planning Document) 2020.
2. The site boundary is adjoined to the west by the Grade II listed building, New Wimbledon Theatre. Development proposals will need to be sensitively designed to show how they conserve and enhance the significant landmark of the New Wimbledon Theatre.
3. Development proposals must create an active frontage to enhance the Town Centre.

4. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the critical drainage area.
5. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA (Opportunity Area) is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN and Thames Water to discuss requirements for any improvements to the water, wastewater and gas infrastructure network from non-residential development.
3. A cycle hanger for use by local residents is located on the eastern boundary of the site. Development proposals should protect and enhance publicly available cycle parking provision.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site.

All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with the chapter on Places and Spaces for a Growing Borough and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

Impacts on Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: Adjacent Grade II listed building New Wimbledon Theatre

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

In a Flood Zone: No

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6a, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi3: All England Lawn Tennis Club - Church Road, Wimbledon, SW19 5AE**Ward: Village****Site description:**

1. The All England Lawn Tennis and Croquet Club site, and specifically the Wimbledon Championships has long been internationally recognised as the premier tennis tournament in the world on grass. This long-established competitive tennis venue is the reason that “Wimbledon” is an internationally recognised and valued brand.
2. The site is the All England Lawn Tennis Club (AELTC), an internationally recognised tennis venue with 18 Championship courts, 14 grass practice courts, 10 clay courts, 10 acrylic courts and 3 croquet lawns and supporting hospitality, offices, catering, press, players, security etc in a series of buildings and structures across the site.
3. The site is occupied all year around but is used intensively and in its entirety during the two weeks of the Wimbledon Championships when it employs more than 10,000 people on site, is visited by more than 500,000 spectators and broadcasts to more than a billion people in +200 countries. The combined annual economic activity associated with The Championships and the activities of the AELTC was estimated in 2015 to be £180m for London and £280m for the UK (based on figures provided by AELTC).
4. The main site is approximately 14ha containing 18 Championship courts, 14 practice grass courts and 8 acrylic / clay courts. A smaller site of approximately 3ha is situated across Somerset Road to the west, housing 6 acrylic covered courts and 6 outdoor clay courts. Three croquet lawns are located to the north adjoining Bathgate Road; all of which are part of the AELTC site. The topography of the site and the surrounding area undulates, rising to the north-west and the site is overlooked by tall buildings located mainly in the London Borough of Wandsworth.

5. Wimbledon Park, including Wimbledon Park Lake, lies at the other side of Church Road to the east of the site. The remaining surrounding area is made up of detached, semi-detached and terraced homes, many set in large plots in tree-lined streets. The topography of the site and the surrounding area undulates, rising to the north-west and the site is overlooked by tall buildings located mainly in the London Borough of Wandsworth.

Site owner: All England Lawn Tennis and Croquet Club

Site area: 17.83 hectares

Existing uses:

1. Part of the AELTC estate used mainly between May to September and intensively during the two weeks of the internationally recognised Wimbledon Championships.
2. Outside The Championships period the site remains in use for member, club and charitable activities and includes the AELTC's Wimbledon Lawn Tennis Museum which attracts 100,000 visitors per year.

Site allocation: World-class sporting venue of national and international significance with support for continued and long-term investment in this site.

Site deliverability: 0-15 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development of the site provides an opportunity to create environmental, social and economic benefits to the wider area, to host more sporting activities, upgrade and improve AELTC's facilities to continue the prominence of The Championships. Other benefits are:
 - a. Make the most of the substantial economic benefits (directly and indirectly) of the site for the borough and for London.
 - b. In combination with the AELTC Raynes Park site, to support the capacity of the Wimbledon Junior Tennis Initiative, in providing better facilities for the free tennis coaching programme for primary school aged children in Merton and Wandsworth schools.
2. Development proposals must respect the site's historic setting including the views to St Mary's Church and the surrounding area and the views from the Grade II* listed Wimbledon Park, from Bathgate Road conservation area and those views identified in the Wimbledon North conservation area appraisal.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. The AELTC site is used in a highly intensive manner, usually for less than two months per year, and relatively little outside the tennis grass court season given its size, scale and bespoke use. Any assessments relating to buildings or structures (e.g. transport assessments, carbon savings etc) should take account of any unusual usage patterns prevalent at the time and predicted for its future use.
2. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
3. A travel plan will be required to incorporate all the AELTC's landholdings and The Championships, which should support how people access the site in a sustainable way.
4. The developer should contact Thames Water and SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the water, wastewater and gas infrastructure network.
5. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
6. To assess any potential environmental impacts to Wimbledon Common (Special Area of

Conservation), any substantial development proposal must be supported by measures set out in planning policies for on-site and off-site environmental monitoring proportionate to the scale of development proposed. Such proposals will be required to submit a full Construction Logistics Plan - outlining all phases of construction and proposals must support the installation of air quality monitoring devices along the A219 (Parkside) during the construction of the site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: Various listed buildings and structures including Grade II* listed St Mary's Church and Wimbledon Park, a Grade II* listed Historic Park on the "Heritage at Risk Register" are also visible from the site.

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes. The north end of the site sits within Bathgate Road conservation area. Wimbledon North conservation area lies to the west and the south of the site

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

In a Flood Zone: No

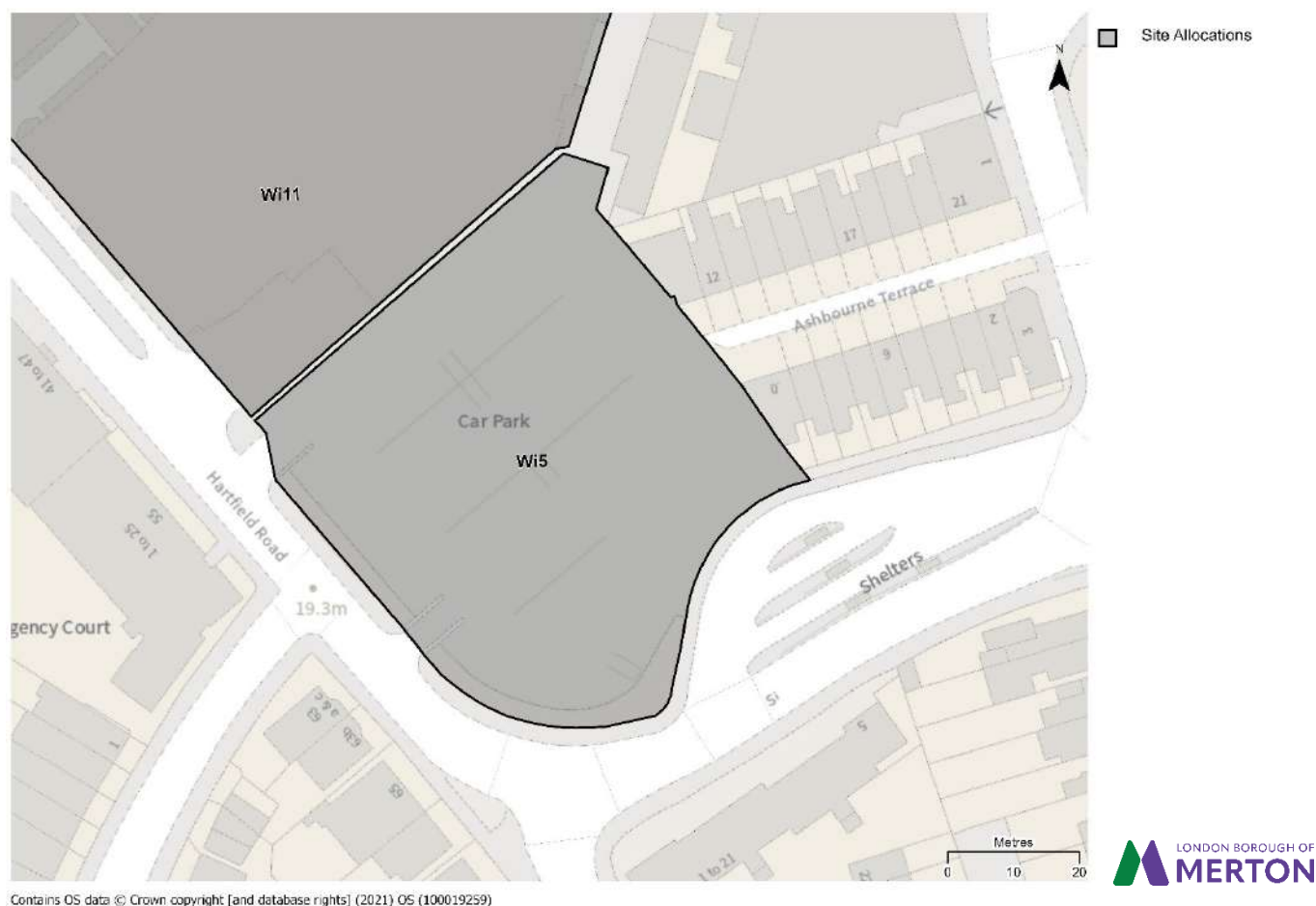
Is in a Town Centre: No

Is in an Opportunity Area: No

Impacts a designated open space: Yes, part of the site to the north and north-west is designated as Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) and open space

Impacts ecology designations: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2, poor access to public transport

Site Wi5: Hartfield Road Car Park, 42-64 Hartfield Road, Wimbledon, SW19 3RG**Ward:** Wimbledon Town and Dundonald**Site description:**

1. This site forms a surface car park and is next to the Sir Cyril Black Way bus interchange. There is dual pedestrian access to the car park from The Broadway and Sir Cyril Black Way and vehicular access is obtained from Hartfield Road. To the north is Victoria Crescent (also proposed as a site allocation Wi11 in this Local Plan) containing purpose-built retail units fronting Wimbledon Broadway (including Morrison's supermarket, Uniqlo). Nearby are a wide range of Town Centre Type Uses including shops, offices, café and restaurants, leisure, recreation and residential uses.
2. The site is found within the Wimbledon Town Centre boundary and the surrounding buildings have a range of building heights, from tall commercial premises to the north to the two-storey residential houses in Ashbourne Terrace to the east. The site is close to, although not wholly visible from, The Broadway and Wimbledon station (c100m). The south of the site faces residential properties at the other side of Hartfield Road.
3. There are a range of building heights and differing built character next to the site and the adjacent site is allocated for redevelopment as Site Wi11 in this Local Plan.

Site owner: Merton Council**Site area:** 0.45ha**Existing uses:** Surface car park**Site allocation:** A mix of uses appropriate to a Town Centre including retail, offices, assembly and

leisure and hotel. There may be some scope for residential on upper floors facing Hartfield Road where this improves viability.

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development proposals need to have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD (Supplementary Planning Document) 2020.
2. The site to the north (Victoria Crescent) is also proposed for allocation by its freeholder in this Local Plan as site Wi11). A comprehensive redevelopment of this site and site Wi11 together could optimise development on both sites and provide much-needed public space in the heart of Wimbledon Town Centre.
3. The pedestrian route from the car park and The Broadway is found within the Wimbledon Broadway conservation area.
4. Hartfield Road and Sir Cyril Black Way suffer from congestion at peak times. A small part of the southern corner of the site is within a critical drainage area.
5. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the critical drainage area.
6. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social, and economic growth.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years and 5-11 years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. A connection for pedestrians and cyclists between The Broadway and Hartfield Road should be maintained through the site.
5. TfL (Transport for London) requests that redevelopment of this site does not prejudice access to or the operational efficiency of the adjoining bus interchange. The council recommends the developer engages with TfL Buses prior to the submission of a planning application. The council will need evidence of engagement with TfL as part of any submitted planning application.
6. Thames Water have indicated that the scale of development for this site is likely to require upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure, but they do not have concerns about the wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability. It is recommended that the developer engages with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also

engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
The site location
Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in Policy D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site. All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with chapter 12 on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough, and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.
Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: New Wimbledon Theatre on Wimbledon Broadway is a Grade II listed building
Impacts a Conservation Area: No
Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No
Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
In a Flood Zone: No
Is in a Town Centre: Yes
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes
Impacts a designated open space: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6a, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi6; Highlands House, 165-171 The Broadway, Wimbledon, SW19 1NE**Ward:** Abbey**Site description:**

1. The site is occupied by a mix of retail and offices within a 1960s style building that has a maximum height of seven storeys. The upper floors of the building are currently set back from the street line in a podium-block format. The site is a corner site between the Broadway and Southey Road.
2. To the south of the site are residential terraces. On the opposite side of The Broadway are similar mixed-use developments with a range of building heights from three to six storeys. The site is found within Wimbledon Town Centre and is next to mixed-use developments of retail, offices and residential uses.
3. This is a significant corner site with an active frontage facing on to The Broadway.

Site owner: ORION and BFL Management Ltd**Site area:** 0.16ha**Existing uses:** Retail, commercial and flexi office use**Site allocation:** A suitable mix of retail, financial and professional services, restaurants, cafes, drinking establishments, offices, community (including health/day centre), sporting/leisure use, residential and hotel.**Site deliverability:** Private ownership. 10-15 years**Design and accessibility guidance:**

1. Development proposals must have regard to the Future Wimbledon Supplementary Planning Document (SPD).

2. Development of this site must be of exemplary design providing a high-quality office space on upper floors. In a mixed-use development, residential uses should be on the upper floors. The ground floor should have an active frontage, respecting the dual aspect and the corner site.
3. Development of the site provides an opportunity to make better use of this site in a well-connected Town Centre location, including upgrading the commercial space and public realm/frontage to The Broadway and Southey Road.
4. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the critical drainage area.
5. Servicing facilities should be provided on site to minimise impacts on traffic movement, congestion and road safety. Mitigate and manage impacts of parking on neighbourhood and amenity.
6. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site. All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with Chapter 12 on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: Grade II listed Wimbledon Theatre is visible further up The Broadway

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Area susceptible to surface water flooding

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts on an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi7: Rufus Business Centre, Ravensbury Terrace, Wimbledon Park, SW18 4RL**Ward: Wimbledon Park****Site description:**

1. The Rufus business estate is a small site with residential neighbours in close proximity and a shared single access point for vehicles and pedestrians via Ravensbury Terrace through a site known as Haslemere Estate, which has been redeveloped for 139 homes, 1,100sqm of office floorspace and associated servicing, laid out on either side of the site (permission reference 16/P2672).
2. The site is situated near the northern boundary of Merton and is close to Wandsworth boundary. The site is adjacent to the railway lines to the east and residential to the west. The west of the site is bounded mostly by the gardens of short residential terraces on Dawlish Avenue with one existing residential property abutting the site. To the south is a strip of private land and then Durnsford Road Recreation Grounds although access to these recreation grounds is via Ravensbury Terrace to the north.
3. The site is occupied by several businesses and has capacity for circa 17 workshop and light industrial businesses.
4. There is a single access from Ravensbury Terrace which runs through Haslemere estate.
5. The site has moderate access to public transport and lies within 10 minutes' walk of Earlsfield train station. However, pedestrian and vehicle access to the site is down a single passageway off Ravensbury Terrace, shared with the development at 12a Ravensbury Terrace and through Haslemere estate.

6. In May 2020 a planning application ([reference 21/P1780](#)) was submitted for the redevelopment of the site to provide 96 homes and 880 square metres of commercial floorspace. In June 2022 the application was approved by Merton's Planning Application Committee, subject to a Section 106 Agreement.

Site owner: Astranta General Partner Ltd

Site area: 0.2ha

Existing uses: Commercial uses, predominantly storage

Site allocation: allocated as a mixed-use development consisting of both employment (business/light industrial and residential uses

Deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 90-106 new homes

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development of the site must be co-ordinated with the adjacent planning permission on the Haslemere estate (reference 16/P2672); construction of Haslemere will be complete prior to planning permission on this site W17.
2. Development proposals will need to have regard to the Crossrail 2 safeguarding on the eastern side of the site.
3. Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the functional floodplain to minimise flood risk for future occupiers and the potential for water pollution from this site. Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.
4. To ensure safe and secure access for pedestrians, vehicles and emergency vehicles in perpetuity, access must be co-ordinated in perpetuity with the adjoining site at Haslemere estate (ref 16/P2672).
5. Due to the heavily restricted access, particularly for emergency vehicles, development proposals involving residential will need to be brought forward and closely co-ordinated with the redevelopment of Haslemere estate. This would also address access and egress issues associated with the functional floodplain covering much of the site.
6. Mitigating potential access, parking, traffic and safety impacts on neighbouring streets and amenity, particularly the adjacent residential development.
7. The site's restricted access and location beside railway lines and within a residential area will require a detailed Construction and Environmental Management Plan and construction methods that minimise noise, disturbance and traffic movements to be used.
8. The site may be contaminated due to its previous industrial uses; however, risk will have been reduced as the site has already been redeveloped for business space.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in

accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies. Proposals will be required to explore the opportunity to improve pedestrian and cycle access between the Wandle Trail and Durnsford Recreation Ground, in accordance with the active travel policies.

3. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
4. The site is adjacent to rail tracks used by the South West Main line and land safeguarded for Crossrail 2. Transport for London requires that London Underground Infrastructure Protection, Network Rail and the Crossrail 2 team must be fully consulted about any works or development proposals that may impact on rail infrastructure. The council will need evidence that the developer has engaged with London Underground and Network Rail as part of a planning application.
5. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing.
6. The council will need evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: A small part of the site to the north site in an Archaeological Priority Area

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, flood zone 2 and 3

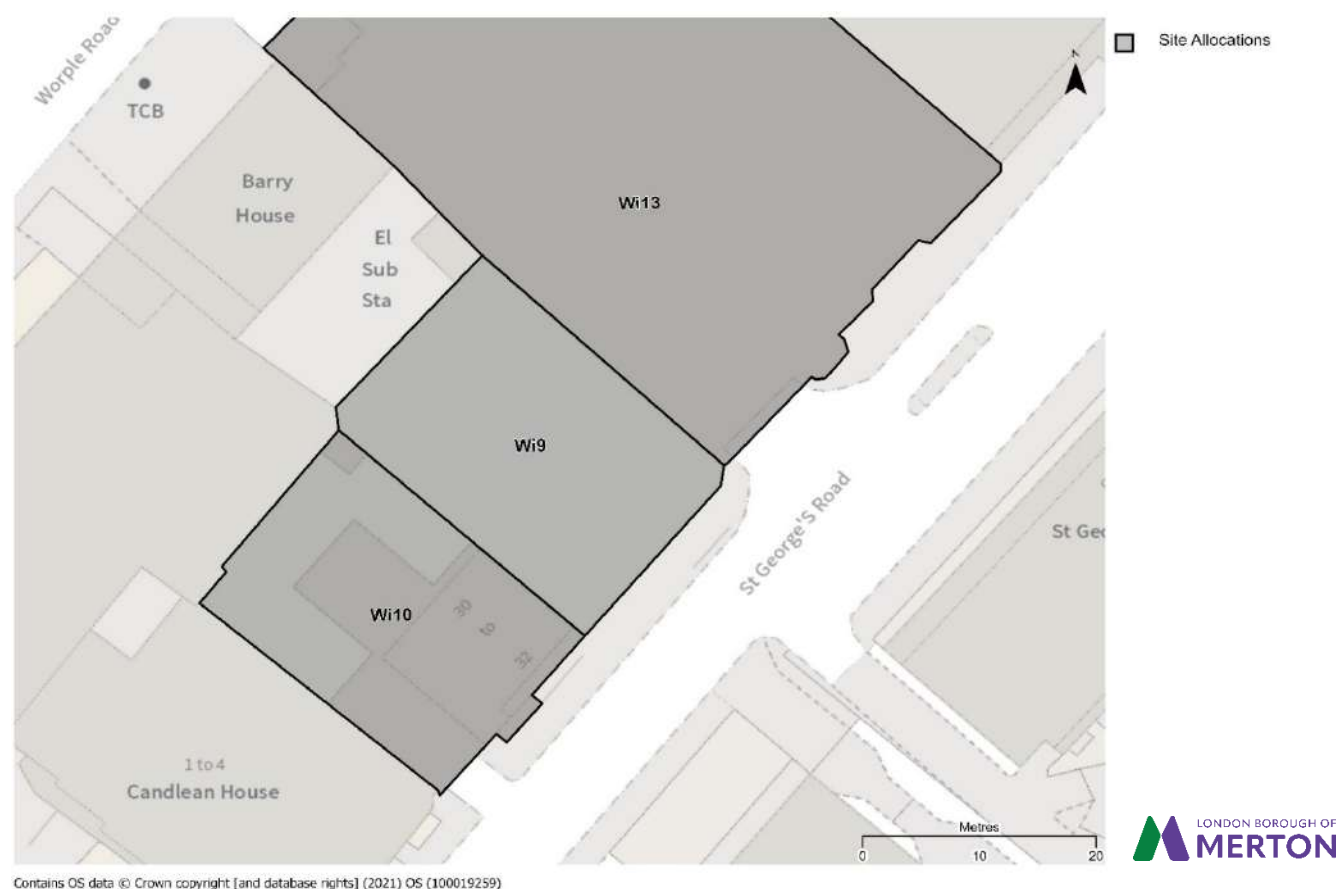
Is in a Town Centre: No

Impacts a designated open space: No, however the site is within 400m of the Wandle Valley Regional Park.

Impacts on an ecology designation: Yes. The eastern boundary of the site (against the railway sidings) is designated as a Site of Importance for Nature Conservation and Green Corridor.

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 4, moderate access to public transport

Site Wi9: 28 St George's Road, Wimbledon, SW19 4DP



Ward: Hillside

Site description: This site is currently vacant. It held the former Wimbledon community centre, which was vacated during 2012 and demolished in summer 2013. It is surrounded to the east by four to five-storey mixed use buildings (commercial/offices), to the west by four-storey offices and to the south by office buildings ranging from five to nine storeys in height.

Site owner: Merton Council

Site area: 0.06ha

Existing uses: This site has been vacant since 2013. It is surrounded to the east by four to five-storey mixed use buildings (commercial/offices), to the west by four-storey offices and to the south by office buildings ranging from five to nine storeys in height.

Site allocation: a suitable mix of Town Centre Type Uses such as community use, retail, financial and professional services, offices, hotel and residential.

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development of the site provides an opportunity for a co-ordinated approach to design and delivery from three sites proposed in this plan: Wi9, Wi10, and Wi13.
2. Development proposals must have regard to the Future Wimbledon Supplementary Planning Document (SPD).
3. Development of the site provides an opportunity to provide modern floorspace for businesses, complementing the surrounding area and provide an active street frontage to contribute towards the

vibrancy and vitality of Wimbledon Town Centre.

4. Development proposals must protect the amenity of occupiers next to the site.
5. Development proposals will need to provide an active street frontage to contribute towards the vibrancy and vitality of the Town Centre. In a mixed-use development, residential uses should be on upper floors.
6. The development proposal must manage and mitigate the parking and servicing impacts on traffic movement, congestion and road safety.
7. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.
8. Development proposals must address issues associated with localised surface water flooding and the critical drainage area.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years and 5-11 years. The council will require on site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
4. Proposals should improve the public realm and pedestrian and cycling facilities around the site.
5. The developer should contact Thames Water and SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the water, wastewater and gas infrastructure network arising from their proposals.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site. All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with Chapter 12 on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough, and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: Yes

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: Yes

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact on flooding from all sources: Yes, site is within a critical drainage area

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts on an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6b, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi10: Prospect House, 30 St George's Road, Wimbledon, SW19 4BD**Ward:** Hillside

Site description: The four-storey office building is part of a large block of commercial development between Worple Road and St George's Road, with varying building heights, uses, designs and land ownership. It is surrounded to the west and north by other four-storey office blocks and to the south by offices ranging from five to nine storeys in height. To the northeast of the site lies the vacant site at 28 St George's Road, also proposed for redevelopment in this plan. The site lies in a commercial area of Wimbledon Town Centre. Opposite is Tuition House, a substantial office block housing many businesses. The adjacent site 1-4 Francis Grove has a planning proposal for office redevelopment (planning reference 19/P3814).

Site owner: Henderson UK (United Kingdom) Property PAIF and T H Real Estate

Site area: 0.05ha

Existing uses: Offices

Site allocation: Offices or hotel

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Opportunity for a co-ordinated approach to design and development delivery with the following site allocations - Wi9, Wi10, and Wi13 as set out in the London Plan.
2. Development proposals must have regard to the design led Future Wimbledon Supplementary Planning Document (SPD).
3. Development proposals will need to provide an active street frontage along St George's Road to

contribute towards the vibrancy and vitality of the Town Centre.

4. Provide well-designed modern commercial floorspace to support businesses and create jobs in Wimbledon.
5. Development proposals must address issues associated with localised surface water flooding and the critical drainage area.
6. The site is within an Opportunity Area (OA) (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. The developer should contact Thames Water and SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the water, wastewater and gas infrastructure network arising from their proposals.
4. Proposals should improve the public realm and pedestrian and cycling facilities around the site.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site.

All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with chapter 12 on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impact on flooding from all sources: Site within a critical drainage area

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

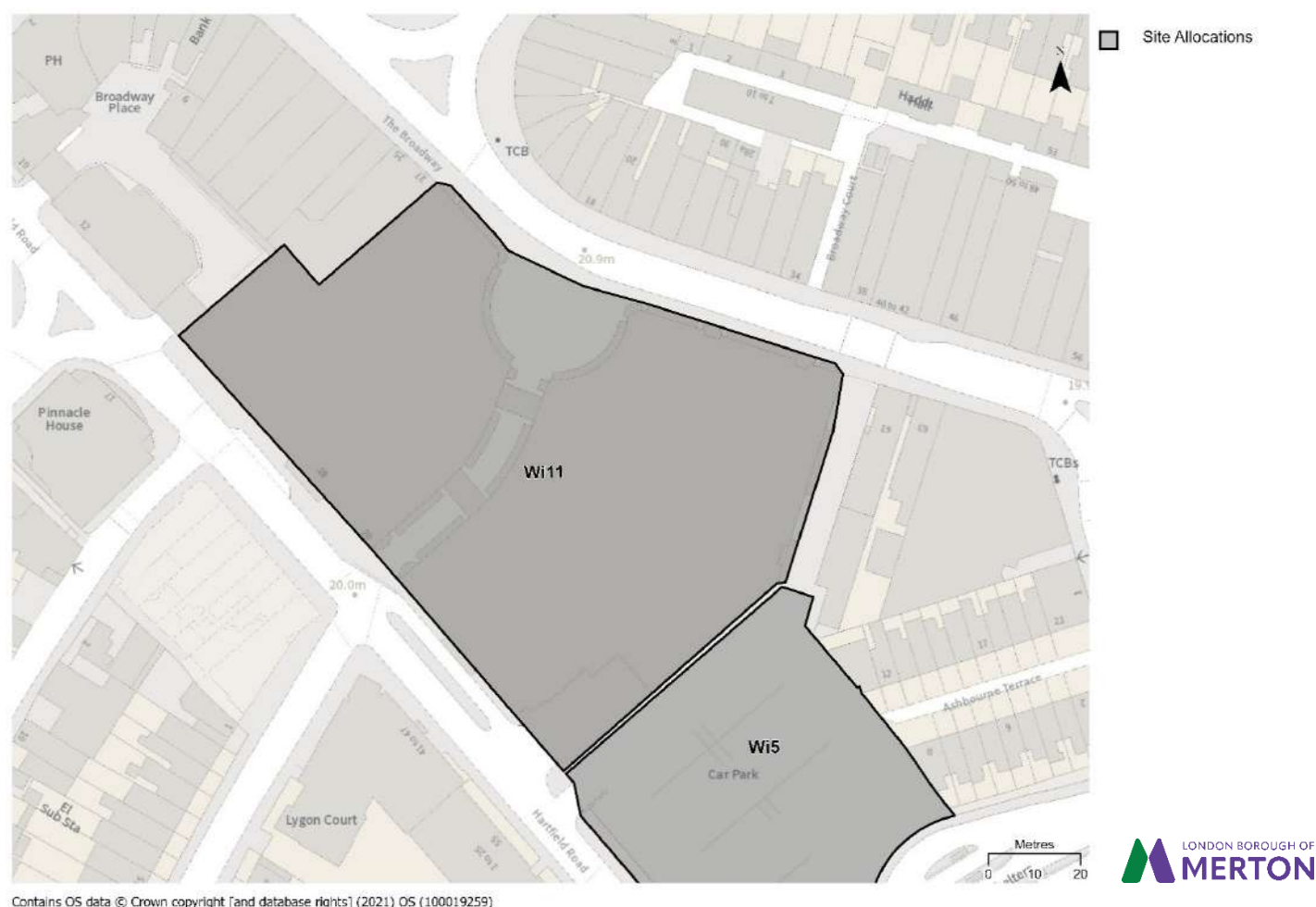
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts on an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6a, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi11: Victoria Crescent, 39-59 The Broadway, 1-11 Victoria Crescent, Wimbledon, SW19 3RG



Ward: Wimbledon Town and Dundonald

Site description:

1. The site sits in the heart of Wimbledon Town Centre with core shopping frontage facing The Broadway and Wimbledon station. It is prominent within the Town Centre and is highly visible from the eastern exit of Wimbledon station.
2. Together with Wimbledon Bridge House, it is one of the few purpose-built premises having street frontage space of a standard size for larger retailers. It holds a significant amount of retail and leisure floorspace. The Piazza is one of the few public spaces in Wimbledon Town Centre and is periodically used by food markets and for events such as Love Wimbledon summer tennis screenings and Winter Wonderland.
3. To the north of the site and on the other side of The Broadway lies The Broadway conservation area with multiple small shopping frontages occupied by a range of shops and services.
4. The site is divided into two main buildings, laid out in a crescent shape with a piazza fronting The Broadway and residential walkway running from The Broadway through to Hartfield Road. Both parts of the site consist of commercial units on the ground and upper floors. The south-eastern side of the crescent is occupied by Morrison's supermarket on the ground floor and purpose-built large shop fronts

leading west, occupied by brand retailers and ancillary offices and storage above. Hartfield Road and Sir Cyril Black Way (the back of the site) suffers from congestion at peak times.

5. This unit backs on to a council-owned car park off Hartfield Road, known as P3, which is also proposed for redevelopment. The western side of the crescent is occupied by Odeon cinema on the upper floors with a variety of shop fronts on the ground floor, occupied by food and drink uses.
6. The site is within an Opportunity Area (OA) (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Site owner: Owned by F&C Commercial Property Holdings Ltd and asset managed on their behalf by BMO Real Estate Partners

Site area: 1 hectare (approx.)

Existing uses: Mixed use retail and leisure

Site allocation: A mix of Town Centre Type Uses including retail, cafes and restaurants, pub or drinking establishment, financial and professional services, assembly and leisure, hotels and offices with the re-provision of public realm. The priority for the site should be Town Centre Type Uses. There may be some scope for residential on upper floors facing Hartfield Road where this improves viability.

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The development is subject to occupational leases and as these come up for renewal, the landowners have identified the opportunity for phased mixed-use redevelopment of the site.
2. Development proposals must have regard to the design-led Future Wimbledon Supplementary Planning Document (SPD).
3. Development of the site provides an opportunity to deliver a comprehensive redevelopment together with the council-owned adjacent Hartfield Road car park to optimise the site layout, access, design and use.
4. Development proposals must recognise the sites proximity to nearby site allocations (Hartfield Road and Victoria Crescent) and provide new purpose-built Town Centre uses to support businesses, jobs and cultural activities, and re-provide much needed public space.
5. Development proposals must recognise the site's proximity to, and must consider the setting of, nearby Heritage Assets.
6. Development proposals must provide enhanced accessibility to bus stops and links to cycle routes.
7. Any servicing facilities must be provided on site to minimise impacts on traffic movement, congestion and safety.
8. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The new layout of the site must facilitate pedestrian access from The Broadway to Hartfield Road including to consider accommodating cyclists and to link better to the surrounding cycle and pedestrian networks particularly by supporting a north-south link through the Town Centre.
3. There is an opportunity to provide enhanced public cycle parking facilities, including a secure hub for

commuters and make provision to accommodate cycle/ scooter hire schemes.

4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply and wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>).
6. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site.

All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with Chapter 12 on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: The frontage of the site is within the setting of listed former town hall and Grade II listed Wimbledon Theatre

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts from flooding from all sources: Yes, site is within a critical drainage area

Is in a Town Centre: Yes, Wimbledon Town Centre

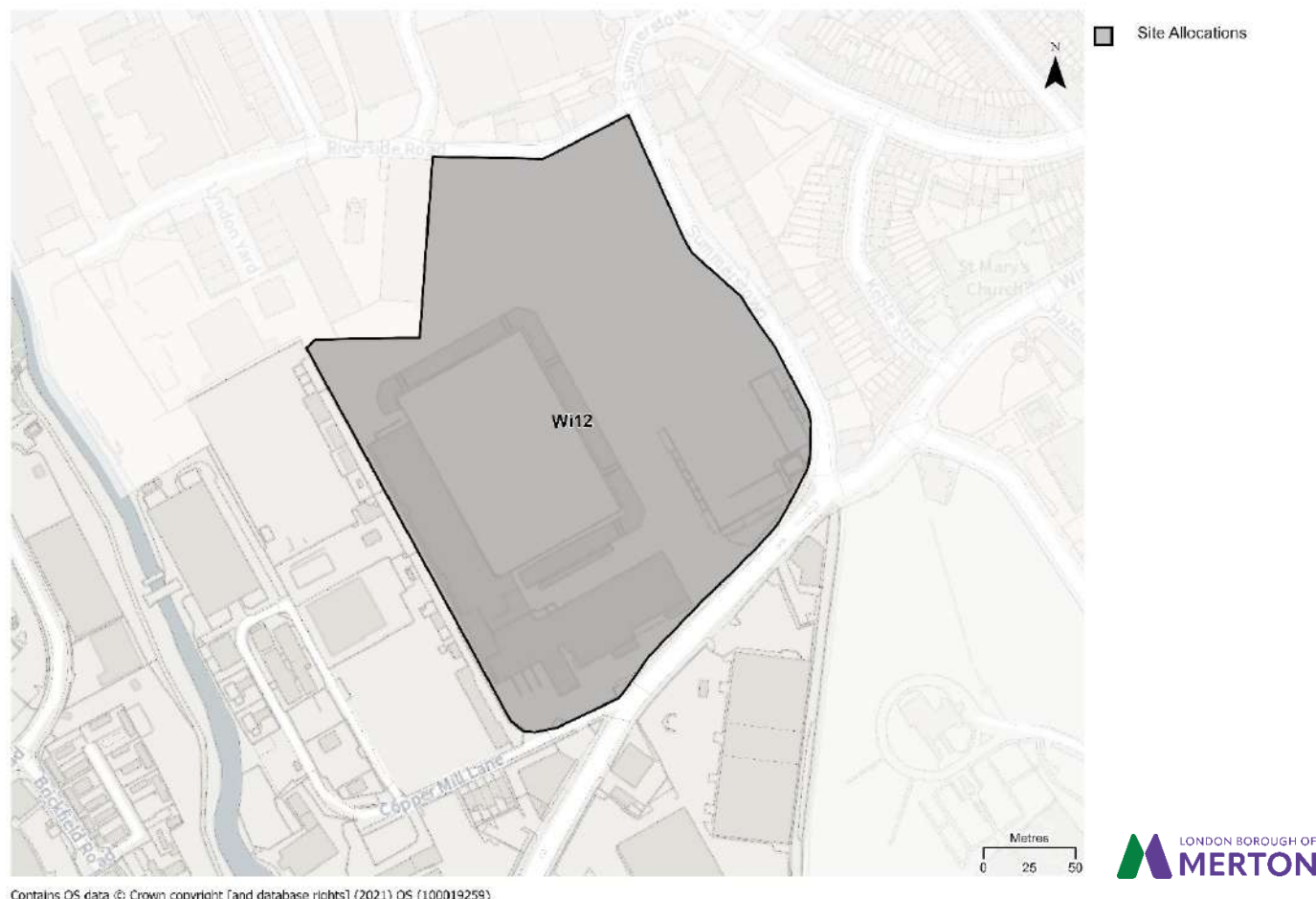
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes, designated in the London Plan

Impacts a designated open space: No

Impacts on an ecology designation: No

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6b, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi12: Wimbledon Stadium and Volante Site - Plough Lane and Summerstown Road, Wimbledon Park, SW17 OBH



Ward: Wandle

Site description:

1. The site is surrounded by strategic industrial locations (all sides). To the north and east of the site is Summerstown Road strategic industrial location (London Borough of Wandsworth), which includes a waste management site to the northwest. To the south and west is part of Durnsford Road/Plough Lane Strategic Industrial Location (London Borough of Merton).
2. Most of the site (stadium, squash and fitness, shop and homes) was completed in 2021/22 (main planning permission references 14/P4381 and 18/P3354). Planning permission 15/P4798 applies to the portion of the site formerly known as the Volante land fronting Summerstown Road.
3. The site and buildings on the eastern boundary are in separate ownership fronting Summerstown road in Wandsworth with planning permission including residential development (reference 15/P4798).
4. The site adjoins businesses along the northern and eastern boundary within the London Borough of Wandsworth. To the south of the site in Merton on the other side of Plough Lane is an industrial estate (Garrett Park) which is part of a Business Improvement District.

- Running along the western boundary of the site is a large operational electricity substation owned by National Grid. National Grid has also advised that this is unlikely to extend into the boundary of this site.

Site owners: Privately owned – various landowners

Site area: 5.29ha

Site allocation:

- Intensification of sporting activity with enabling development. Developments that facilitate more sporting activity may be enabled by more viable uses, subject to meeting planning policy, evidence and consultation (same allocation as Merton's Sites and Policies Plan 2014 site 37). The council proposes to continue with the site allocation to give certainty to the multiple landowners and surrounding business and residential occupiers that it continues to support the allocated use.
- Most of the site (stadium, squash and fitness, shop and homes) was completed in 2021/22 (main planning permission references 14/P4381 and 18/P3354). Planning permission 15/P4798 applies to the portion of the site formerly known as the Volante land fronting Summerstown Road.

Indicative site capacity (new homes): 700-750 new homes across all ownerships

Site deliverability: 0-5 years (the majority of the site – 634 homes - due to be completed by the end of 2021). Approximately two thirds of the site is due to complete construction in 2021 associated with the delivery of planning permission reference 14/P4381, 18/P3354 and associated applications for a variety of uses including a football stadium for AFC Wimbledon, over 600 homes and other facilities.

Design and accessibility guidance:

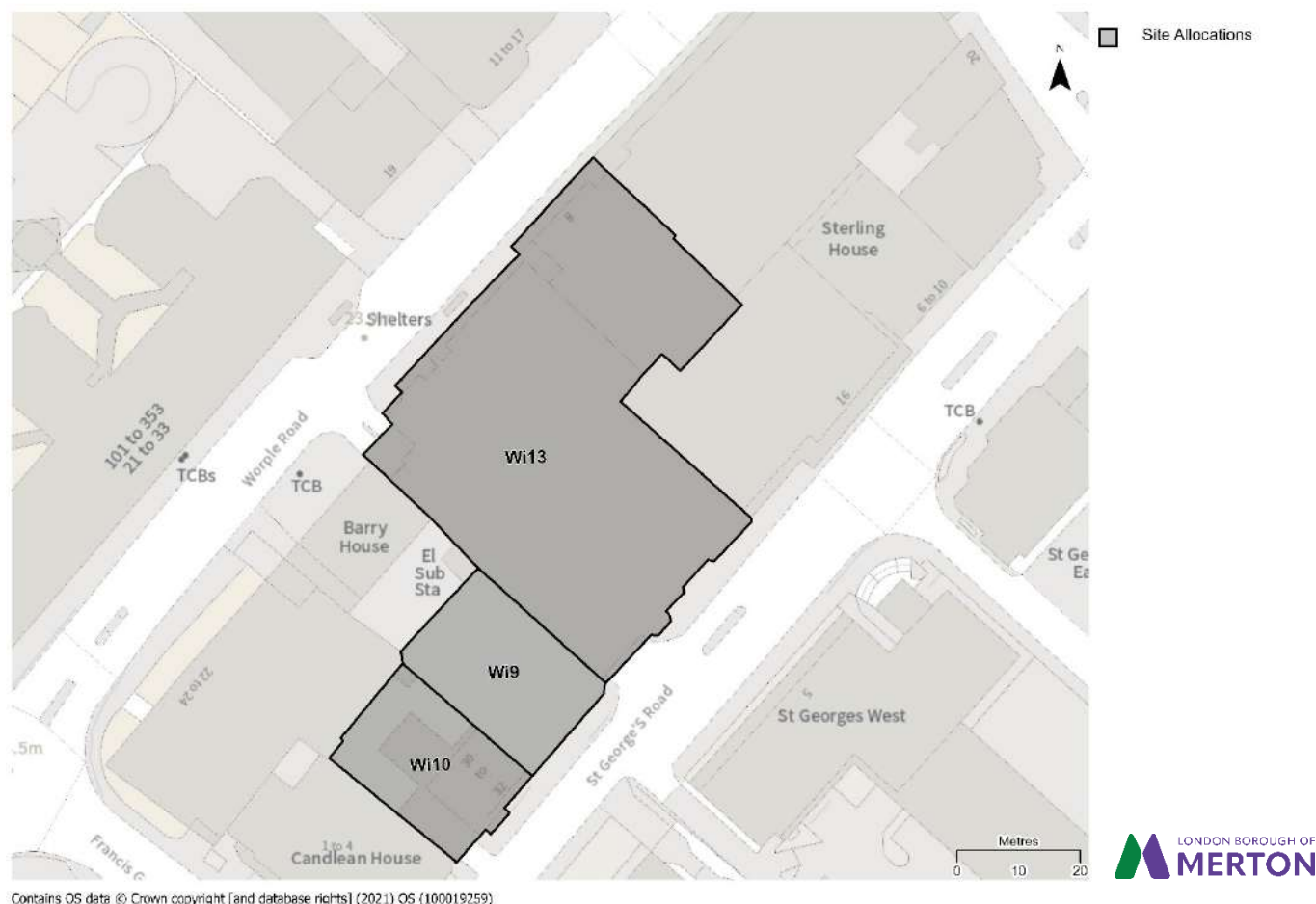
- Development proposals for this site must have regard to Merton's Infrastructure Delivery Plan and Green Infrastructure Study 2020.
- Development of the site provides an opportunity to deliver sporting intensification with enabling development on a large brownfield site is being exercised by the landowners.
- Development proposals should seek to improve the accessibility opportunities to improve bus infrastructure, walking and cycling facilities to and from the site and provide improved links to Wimbledon Town Centre.
- Development proposals will need to incorporate suitable mitigation measures to address the issues associated with the functional floodplain and with the critical drainage area to minimise flood risk for future occupiers and the potential for water pollution from the site. A flood risk assessment will be required as set out in the NPPF and should also have considered the treatment of the non-main rivers that pass through the site and incorporate sustainable drainage systems into development proposals.
- Development proposals must have regard to both level 1 and level 2 of Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). For this site allocation, development proposals must incorporate the site-specific recommendations on managing and mitigating flood risk from all sources, including the suitability of sustainable drainage systems (SuDS). These can be found in the SFRA level 2 in Appendix A.
- Development proposal should seek to resolve and improve the road network capacity, movement and local safety concerns.
- Redevelopment proposals should take account of the electricity substation to the west of the site to minimise the effects on amenity of future occupiers.
- Development proposals must investigate the potential impact of any proposed development on archaeological heritage.

9. Facilitating improved accessibility including improving bus infrastructure, walking and cycling facilities. Resolving road network capacity, movement and safety concerns. Site access arrangements require careful scrutiny/improvement.
10. A squash and fitness club existed on the site. Proposals should include the provision for an equivalent or enhanced squash and fitness club as part of sporting intensification.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to public open space. The council will require proposals to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site, in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
3. This site is in an area identified as being deficient in access to children's play space for ages 0-4 years, 5-11 years and 12+ years. The council will require on-site provision in accordance with the infrastructure policies and London Plan.
4. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
5. This site is in close proximity to National Grid infrastructure 33Kv Underground Cable route Earlsfield Rail Feeders 427, 440 & 443 Section 3 and 33Kv Underground Cable route Wimbledon 33Kv D S/S Electrical Substation Wimbledon 132KV. The statutory safety clearances between overhead lines, the ground, and built structures must not be infringed. To comply with statutory safety clearances, the live electricity conductors of National Grid's overhead power lines are designed to be a minimum height above ground. Where changes are proposed to ground levels beneath an existing line then it is important that changes in ground levels do not result in safety clearances being infringed. National Grid can, on request, provide to developers detailed line profile drawings that detail the height of conductors, above ordnance datum, at a specific site. It is recommended that the developer liaise with National Grid at the earliest opportunity to discuss the infrastructure on site. The council will require evidence of liaising with National Grid with any submitted planning application.
6. Any development proposals for this site are expected to provide urban greening on site and consider its relationship with the Wandale Valley Regional Park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, ensuring that the development positively enhances accessibility to the park. The council will require these details to be shown in a Design and Access Statement or Landscaping Plan submitted with any planning application.
7. Thames Water have indicated that, given the scale of development for this site, upgrades of the water supply network infrastructure and wastewater network are likely. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be needed to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council needs evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site as part of the planning process.

The site location
Approach to tall buildings: Development of the site could include tall buildings (circa 36m, approx. 10 storeys, could be appropriate), subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with the chapter on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough, and taking into account the council's Future Wimbledon SPD.
Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: No
Impacts a Conservation Area: No
Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: Yes, the entire site
Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impacts from flooding from all sources: Yes, the site and its surrounds are within the functional floodplain of the River Wandle (Flood Zone 3a). The majority of the site is within a critical drainage area for surface water flooding
Is in a Town Centre: No
Is in an Opportunity Area: No
Impacts a designated open space: Yes, within Wandle Valley Regional Park 400m buffer zone
Impacts on an ecology designation: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 2/3 poor/moderate access to public transport

Site Wi13: 8-20 Worple Road and 20-26 St George's Road Wimbledon SW19 4DD**Ward:** Hillside

Site description: The site is a Sainsbury's supermarket with car park. The site is part of a large block of commercial development sites between Worple Road and St George's Road, with varying building heights, uses, designs and land ownership. The site has frontage on to both Worple Road and St George's Road, Elys department store adjoins the northeast boundary of the site, fronting Wimbledon Hill Road and Worple Road. Offices in Barry House connect the northeast of the site fronting St George's Road. Offices, a gym and shops lie opposite the site.

Site owner: Eskmuir Group

Site area: 0.22ha

Existing uses: Supermarket with ancillary car parking, and offices

Site allocation: A mix of Town Centre Types Uses such as retail, financial and professional services, offices, hotel or community (including health/day centre), residential on upper floors to enable commercial led development

Site deliverability: 5-10 years

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Opportunity for a co-ordinated approach to design and delivery from three sites proposed in this plan: Wi9, Wi10 and Wi13.
2. Development proposals must have regard to design-led Future Wimbledon Supplementary Planning Document.

3. The site provides an opportunity to deliver a well-designed modern commercial floorspace to support businesses and create job opportunities within Wimbledon Town Centre.
4. Development proposals must provide an active street frontage along either Worple Road or St George's Road to contribute towards the vibrancy and vitality of the Town Centre.
5. Development proposals must address and manage parking, improve road safety, traffic movement, reduce or minimise congestion around the site and nearby roads.
6. Provide a new pedestrian route to improve permeability in this area that connects Worple Road and St George's Road, breaking up the existing large block.
7. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Proposals should improve the public realm and pedestrian and cycling facilities around the site.
4. Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply and wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to engage with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
5. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site.

All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with the chapter on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

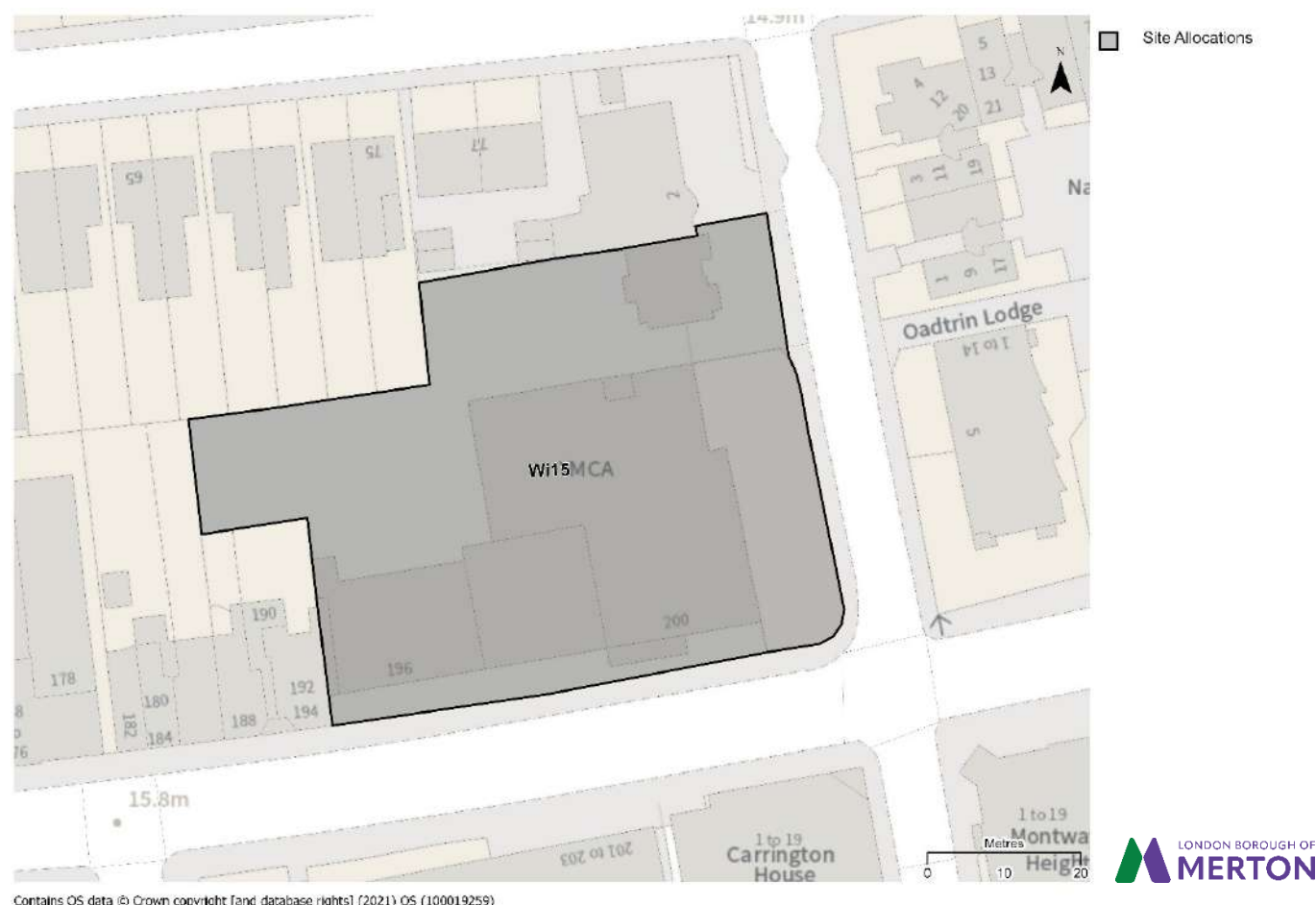
Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No

Impacts on flooding from all sources: Yes, site is in a critical drainage area

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes
Impacts a designated open space: No
Impacts an ecology designation: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6a, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi15: YMCA Wimbledon 196-200 The Broadway, Wimbledon, SW19 1RY**Ward:** Wimbledon Town and Dundonald**Site description:**

1. The site is in use as a YMCA with a wide range of uses, including a youth advice centre with hostel space and a café. The buildings on site range up to eight storeys with seven storeys fronting The Broadway.
2. The site is a prominent corner site with an active frontage facing on to The Broadway and acts as the eastern gateway to Wimbledon Town Centre.
3. The site is found within Wimbledon Town Centre. To the east the site adjoins mixed-use developments including retail, offices and residential uses. The southern side of The Broadway opposite the site has a range of building heights, up to six storeys. The site is bounded on the east by Trinity Road. To the north of the site is the former Conservative Club (recently sold) and residential properties (two to three-storey semi-detached homes).
4. A planning application (ref: 20/P1738) was granted permission for a 121-room hostel, 135 apartments, gym, café and other ancillary uses.

Site owner: YMCA London South West**Site area:** 0.21ha**Existing uses:** YMCA with hostel space, gym, sports hall and café**Site allocation:** A suitable mix of retail, financial and professional services, restaurants /cafes, drinking

establishments, offices, community use and residential (including hostel or hotel)

Site deliverability: 0-5 years

Indicative site capacity: 135 new homes plus 121 bed hostel space (A planning application (ref: 20/P1738) was granted permission for a 121-room hostel, 135 apartments, gym, café and other ancillary uses

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. Development proposals will need to consider the amenity of neighbouring residential uses to the north of the site.
2. Any servicing facilities should be provided on site to minimise impacts on traffic movement, congestion and road safety. Mitigating and managing the impacts of parking on neighbourhood and amenity will need to be addressed.
3. Due to the site prominence (active frontage facing on to The Broadway and gateway to the Town Centre) redevelopment must be of exemplary design.
4. The site provides an opportunity to provide modern, well-designed hostel type accommodation and support services for vulnerable people in an accessible location.
5. Public space would be welcomed as part of any development proposal.
6. Development proposals must have regard to the design-led Future Wimbledon SPD (Supplementary Planning Document).
7. Development proposals must ensure links and access to the nearby bus stops.
8. The site is within an Opportunity Area (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure Requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.
3. Thames Water does not envisage infrastructure concerns about the water supply network infrastructure, wastewater network or wastewater treatment infrastructure capability in relation to the development of the site. However, the council strongly recommends that the developer engage with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to advise the developments phasing. The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site.

All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with the chapter on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

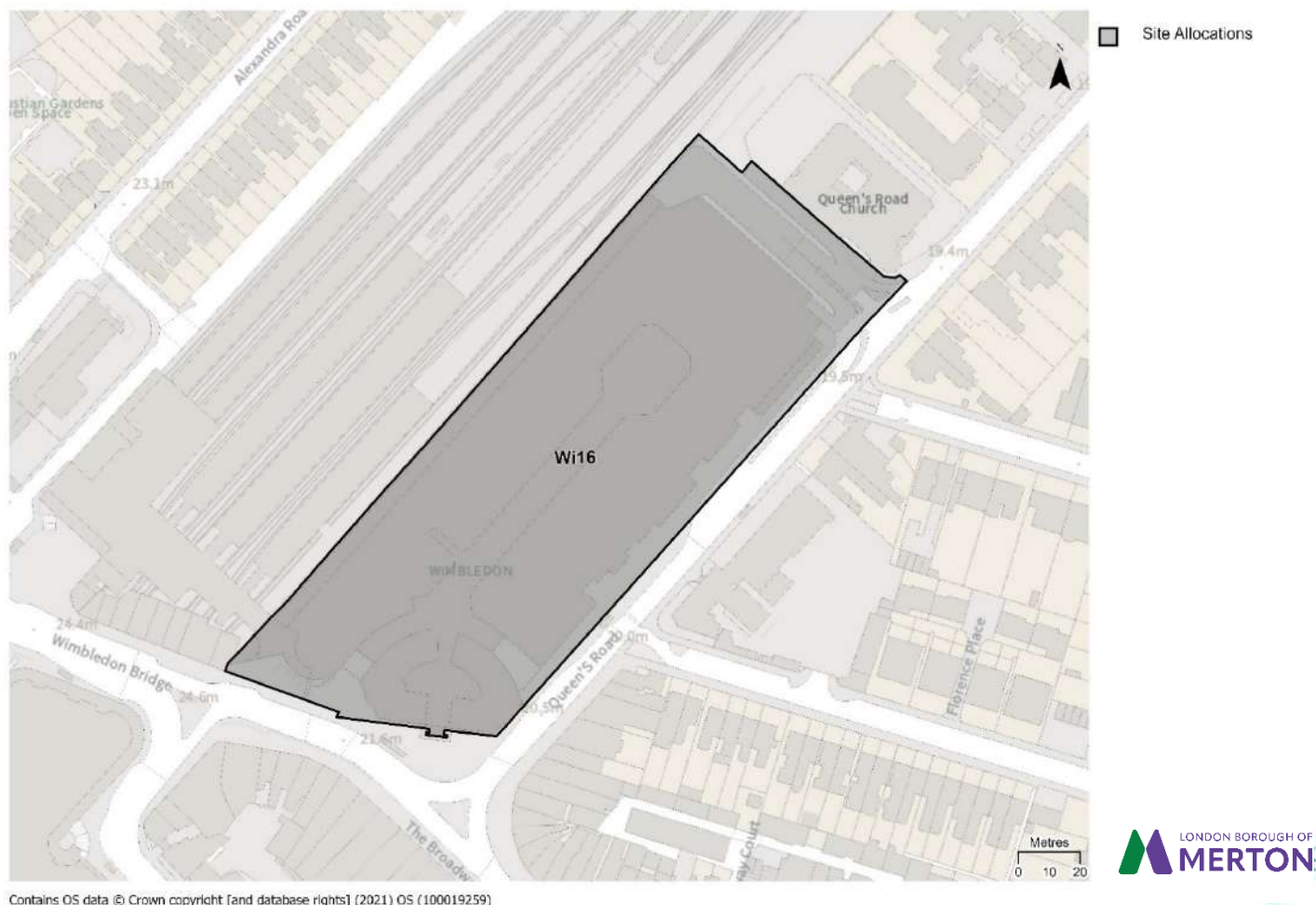
Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: No

Impacts a Conservation Area: No

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: No
Impact from flooding from all sources: No
Is in a Town Centre: Yes
Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes
Impacts a designated open space: No
Impact on an ecology designation: No
Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6a, excellent access to public transport

Site Wi16: Wimbledon Quarter, The Broadway, Wimbledon SW19



Ward: Wimbledon Town and Dundonald

Site description:

1. Centre Court is a purpose-built shopping centre in Wimbledon Town Centre. The shopping centre runs along a major transport infrastructure - Wimbledon Station (underground, tram and railway services). The railway lines and platforms run along the western side of the shopping centre.
2. The main site entrance is found to the southwest of the site along The Broadway. Secondary accesses are found along Queen's Road. The site is surrounded by several building types ranging in height from two to four storeys.
3. The east of the site is Queen's Road which provides access to nearby residential roads, to the shopping centre car park, a church and residential shelter home. Nearby residential roads are made up of a mixture of semi-detached, two to three-storey homes and detached homes.
4. The corner of Queen's Road and The Broadway is made up of retail and financial services businesses with either office or homes on upper floors.
5. To the south of the site is the Broadway, the main road that runs through the centre of the Town Centre. The Broadway is a mixture of retail uses and mixed-use buildings, typically retail at street level with either residential or offices on upper floors.

6. The site includes two Grade II listed buildings (Old Town Hall facing The Broadway and the frontage of the Old Fire Station facing Queens Road) and falls within the Broadway conservation area.

Site owner: Romulus

Site area: 1.8ha (approx.)

Existing uses: a mixture of town centre uses – retail, restaurants, financial and professional services and ancillary offices

Site allocation: A mixture of Town Centre Type Uses such as community (including health and wellbeing), retail, restaurants and cafes, financial and professional services, leisure, offices, hotel, residential and last mile distribution.

Site deliverability: 0-5 years (phase 1) 5-10 years (phase 2)

Design and accessibility guidance:

1. The site provides an excellent opportunity for the repurposing and redevelopment of a substantial brownfield site within the heart of the Town Centre.
2. The site provides an excellent opportunity to contribute towards a significant improvement to the public realm on Queens Road with priority for pedestrians and cyclists and less traffic dominated.
3. Development proposals must have regard to the design-led Future Wimbledon SPD (Supplementary Planning Document), the Broadway conservation area design guide and design considerations relating to the two Grade II listed buildings on site.
4. Development proposals must provide links and access to Wimbledon Station and nearby bus stops, which surround the site.
5. Development proposals must be sensitive, protect and enhance listed buildings on the site and improve their setting.
6. The site is within an Opportunity Area (OA) (designated in the London Plan). The London Plan ambition for our OA is to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figures) up to 2041. Any site within the OA is expected to positively contribute to its environmental, social and economic growth.

Infrastructure requirements:

1. Development proposals for this site must refer to the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan and ensure infrastructure requirements have been addressed by the proposal.
2. Enhance and expand existing public realm around the site, particularly at Queens Road and on part of The Broadway. Provide enhanced public cycle parking facilities, including a secure hub for commuters and make provision to accommodate cycle/ scooter hire schemes. The site also provides opportunities to explore options to incorporate “last mile” sustainable consolidation delivery solutions serving the site as well as the wider town centre and area.
3. This site is in an area of deficiency in access to nature. The council will expect proposals to address this deficiency in accordance with the Green Infrastructure policies.
4. The developer and Merton Council must engage with the Metropolitan Police Service (MPS) as part of any pre-application and planning application for this site, due to the proximity of the site to the Wimbledon Police Station.
5. The developer should contact SGN to discuss requirements for any improvements to the gas infrastructure network.

6. The site is adjacent to rail tracks which are used by National Rail and District Line services and will also form part of Crossrail 2. The developer will have to consult and engage with Transport for London, Network Rail and Crossrail 2 as part of any emerging proposals on this site.
7. Thames Water has identified the scale of development/s in this catchment is likely to require upgrades of the water supply and wastewater network infrastructure. It is recommended that the developer liaise with Thames Water at the earliest opportunity to agree a housing phasing plan. Failure to liaise with Thames Water will increase the risk of planning conditions being sought at the application stage to control the phasing of development to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of development. The housing phasing plan should determine what phasing may be required to ensure development does not outpace delivery of essential network upgrades to accommodate future development/s in this catchment. The developer can request information on network infrastructure by visiting the Thames Water Developer Services website (<https://www.thameswater.co.uk/developers>). The council will require evidence of engagement with Thames Water with any submitted planning application. Merton Council will also engage with and seek advice from Thames Water about the development of this site.
8. The developer must consult and engage with the Metropolitan Police Service (MPS) on any development proposals to prevent future development from adversely affecting the MPS's operational facilities. The council will also engage to seek advice from the MPS during any pre or planning application processes.

The site location

Approach to tall buildings: The Strategic Heights Diagram for Wimbledon Town Centre, in D12.6 'Tall buildings', sets out the appropriate height for this site.

All building heights will be subject to their impact on existing character, townscape and heritage in accordance with the chapter on Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough and have regard to the Future Wimbledon SPD.

Impacts Listed Buildings or undesignated Heritage Assets: Yes

Impacts a Conservation Area: Yes

Impacts an Archaeological Priority Area: No

Impacts a Scheduled Ancient Monument: Yes

In a Flood Zone: No

Is in a Town Centre: Yes

Is in an Opportunity Area: Yes

Impacts a designated open space: Yes

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL): PTAL 6a, excellent access to public transport



Chapter 10. **Health and wellbeing**

Strategic policy HW10.1 Health (including mental health) and Wellbeing

1. We will continue to improve and promote a more active and healthier lifestyle of our residents, tackle the causes of ill health (physical and mental), and health inequalities in Merton. This will be achieved by:
 - a. Working with strategic partners such as NHS (National Health Service) England, as part of the Integrated Care System and Merton's Health and Wellbeing Boards in improving health and wellbeing, tackling health inequalities, public health safety (for example during pandemics and other health emergencies), promoting and encouraging healthy lifestyles and creating healthy environments in Merton for all.
 - b. Improving access to healthcare, voluntary organisations and community health facilities.
 - c. Addressing and reducing the health inequalities in Merton as identified in Merton's Health and Wellbeing Strategy and the Joint Strategic Needs Assessment.
 - d. Tackling Merton's childhood obesity as identified by Merton's Child Healthy Weight Action Plan especially in areas of deprivation.
 - e. Working with Alzheimer's Society, Merton Dementia Action Alliance and other partners to make Merton a Dementia Friendly borough, helping all those living with dementia in the borough in line with the Mayor's ambition to make London a Dementia Friendly city.
 - f. Ensuring that 20-minute neighbourhoods are planned and designed well in accordance with 20 Minutes approaches which promote and enable healthier and active living, adopt active aging approaches and improve access to ¹green infrastructure.
 - g. Improving air quality, reducing public exposure to poor air quality and minimising inequalities in levels of exposure to air pollution.
 - h. Improving the public realm in accordance with Transport for London (TfL), Healthy Streets Approach and Sport England/Public Health England, Active Design 10 principles and guides. To provide safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle routes that enable healthy and active travel choices, especially in areas identified as Air Quality Focus Areas in Merton's Air Quality Action Plan.
 - i. Ensuring that our neighbourhoods are inclusive and accessible for all (including disabled people²) and encouraging social interaction.
 - j. Taking an integrated approach through a number of policies in the Local Plan, for example infrastructure, green and blue infrastructure, air quality, climate change, transport and design policies to improve health (including mental health) and wellbeing.

¹ Including parks, open spaces, playing fields, woodlands – and also street trees, allotments, private gardens, green roofs

² Definition of disability under the Equality Act 2010

Supporting text

Coronavirus (COVID-19 pandemic)

- 10.1.1. The coronavirus (COVID-19) pandemic is described as a watershed moment for inequalities. COVID-19 has put the national focus on inequalities, especially the link between health and income. It has exposed known inequalities and will no doubt further compound them. The impact on mental health could lead to a longer-term erosion of people's physical health, affecting people who have not previously experienced poor mental health.
- 10.1.2. The way we use our homes has changed; more people are working from home. This has brought to light the importance of excellent quality and adaptable housing including personal, work and outdoor space.
- 10.1.3. During the early months of the pandemic visits to parks and public green spaces increased across London. The pandemic has exposed the benefit of access to green spaces and nature for physical activity and play, mental wellbeing and mental resilience. Several surveys carried out on people with lung conditions found that around 20% reported improvement to their conditions. This contributes to the short-term reductions in levels and exposure of air pollution (for example PM25 and NO2) during lockdown and social distancing measures.
- 10.1.4. The pandemic highlighted that behaviour change is possible. This behaviour change has been direct and implemented by government and legislation. Behaviour change at a local level may not be able to be that direct but, if done in an integrated way, we can create healthier and greener environments, which will encourage and enable behaviour change such as walking and cycling.
- 10.1.5. The recovery after COVID-19 is a priority for Merton Council, not just economic but also health and wellbeing recovery. Our response to this health crisis will shape how we will deal with population health in the next decades. The COVID-19 pandemic will offer lessons and opportunities leading to action.

Health (including mental health) and wellbeing integrated approach

- 10.1.6. The environment in which we live is a major determinant of human health and wellbeing. Town planning in Britain originated in a series of public health and housing reforms in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, focusing upon basic human living conditions. Today, the health and wellbeing agenda is much broader, with determinants considered to influence health and wellbeing encompassing the physical, social and economic environments.
- 10.1.7. Merton Council has taken an integrated approach to health and wellbeing in the Local Plan and the expectation is for development to respond positively. Many measures set out in other parts of this Local Plan play a part in promoting health and wellbeing, seeking to address health inequalities, and must be addressed where appropriate.

Table 10.1 Table cross referencing health and wellbeing in Merton's Local Plan

Health (including mental health) and wellbeing issue.	Related Local Plan policy
Healthy homes and quality	Strategic Policy No. H11.1 Housing choice Strategic Policy No. H11.2 Housing Provision Policy D12.3 Ensuring high quality design for all developments
Access to healthcare services and other social infrastructure	Policy TC13.7 Protecting corner / local shops Strategic policy IN14.1 Infrastructure Policy IN14.2 Social and Community Infrastructure
Access to open space and nature	Strategic Policy O15.1 Open Space, Green Infrastructure and Nature Conservation Policy O15.2 Open Space and Green Infrastructure Policy O15.3 Biodiversity and Access to Nature Policy O15.4 Protection of Trees, Hedges and Other Landscape Features Policy O15.6 Wandle Valley Regional Park
Air quality and environmental impacts	Policy D12.11 Basements and subterranean design Policy P15.10 Air Quality, Pollution and Land Stability
Supporting walking and cycling	Policy IN14.3 Sport and Recreation Policy T16.2 Prioritising active travel choices
Access to work and training	Strategic policy EC13.1 Promoting economic growth and successful high streets Policy EC.13.4 Local Employment Opportunities
Social cohesion and healthy neighbourhoods	Colliers Wood: Policy N3.1 Mitcham: Policy N4.1 Morden: Policy N5.1 Raynes Park Policy N6.1 Wimbledon Policy N9.1 Policy HW10.2 Delivering healthy places

	Policy H11.4 Supported care housing for vulnerable people or secure residential institutions for people housed as part of the criminal justice system. Policy No. H11.5 Student Housing, other housing with shared facilities such as HMOs and bedsits Policy No. H11.6 Accommodation for Gypsies and Travellers Strategic Policy D12.1 Delivering well designed and resilient neighbourhoods.
Climate change	Strategic Policy CC2.1 Promoting Sustainable Design to Mitigate and Adapt to Climate Change Policy CC2.3 Minimising Energy Use Policy O15.5 Urban Greening

- 10.1.8. Health and wellbeing should not be seen as an isolated topic when assessing planning applications, rather it must be integrated as per the areas noted above. This approach has been adopted in this Plan where we have considered the impact of our policies upon the physical and mental health and wellbeing of those living, working and visiting the borough.

Wider determinants of health

- 10.1.9. Planning for health involves thinking about the interrelated factors that affect health, including social and psychological elements, such as wellbeing. The wider determinants of health are the conditions in which people are born, grow, work, live and age, and the wider set of forces and systems shaping the conditions of daily life. A healthy place is one that can contribute to the prevention of ill health and provide the environmental conditions to support positive health and wellbeing.
- 10.1.10. The creation of healthy environments for people of all ages in Merton will be a key consideration when the council is determining planning applications. A healthy environment can promote and encourage healthy lifestyles by way of good design, green open spaces and opportunities to promote walking and cycling.
- 10.1.11. The Mayor's Transport Strategy sets a target for the percentage of residents doing at least 20 minutes of active travel a day, which for Merton is 70% by 2041. Almost 60% of Merton adults are overweight and diabetes cases are increasing by about 2% per year. One in five children entering reception are currently overweight or obese, a figure which increases to one in three leaving primary school in Year 6.
- 10.1.12. Planning can play a pivotal role in influencing key health determinants, especially towards improving long-term outcomes and addressing health inequalities. Delivering health

outcomes will be important for our recovery following the pandemic. A model developed by Dahlgren and Whitehead highlights the relationship between individual lifestyle behaviours, social networks, working and living conditions, general socioeconomic, cultural and environmental conditions. While the interaction between these different layers and factors can have both positive and protective influences on our lives, they can also undermine health and wellbeing, both for individuals and communities. The determinants of health shown in the diagram below include:

- Social and economic environment,
- Physical environment, and
- Individual characteristics and behaviours.

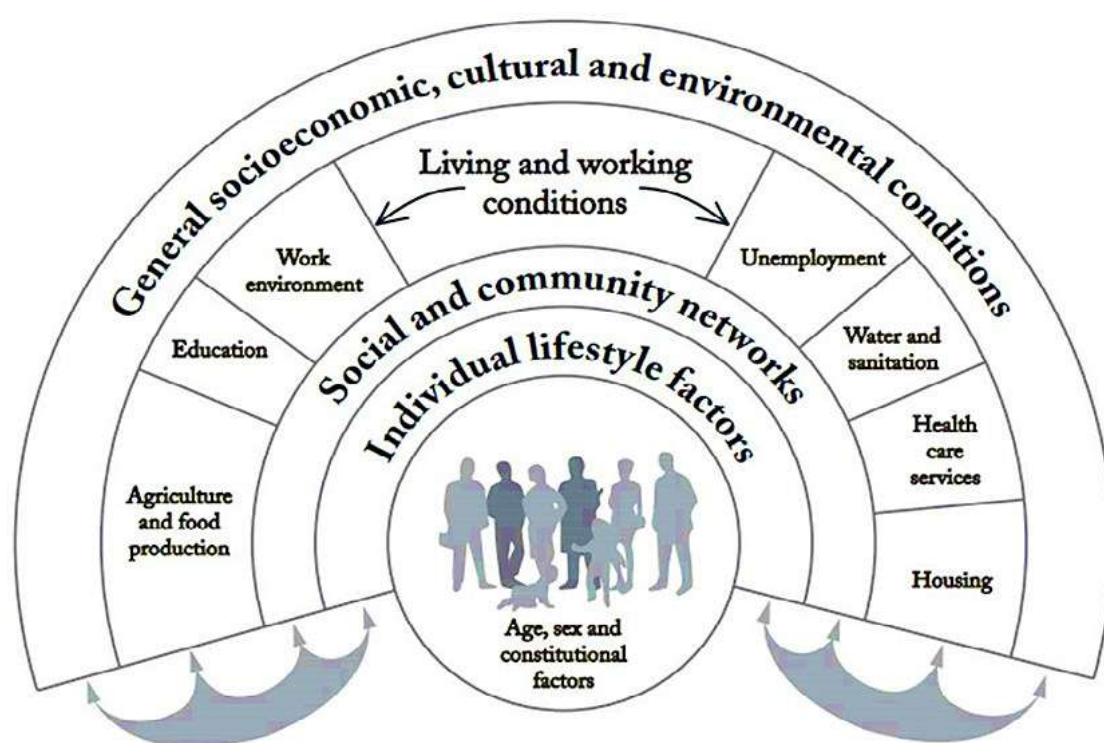


Figure 10.1a - Determinants of health and wellbeing in our neighbourhoods
(Barton and Grant, based on Dahlgren and Whitehead).

- 10.1.13. The World Health Organisation defines health as ‘a state of social, physical and mental wellbeing and not merely the absence of disease. We understand that it is possible to make the health and wellbeing outcomes of an area better and recognise that planning has a vital role to play. We will ensure that development proposals in Merton help to promote active travel choices, physical activity and active aging, enhancing the feeling of safety and security, creation of permeable attractive street frontages and creating spaces where people can come together to relax and socialise.
- 10.1.14. The recently released Royal Town Planning Institute (RTPI) report, Enabling Healthy Placemaking, called for a greater level of cooperation and collaboration between health,

social care and planning professionals to ensure people's health needs are integrated into the conceptualisation, design and planning stages of new development in the future.

- 10.1.15. Following a call for evidence from the Royal Town Planning Institute (RTPI) in September 2019, this research explores local, national and international planning practices enabling the creation and delivery of healthy places. The report highlights cooperation between public health, social care and the planning profession is essential. Innovative partnerships, communication and adequate resourcing often underpin effective models of cooperation, which in turn leads to successful project implementation.

Health and climate change

- 10.1.16. Climate change is also a public health emergency – climate change impacts health directly through extreme weather conditions such as floods and heatwaves, indirectly through disruption to natural systems (changing patterns of disease), social systems (forced migration) and the interaction between the two systems. In the UK, the effects of climate change will not be felt equally and are likely to increase health inequalities. However, there are significant health opportunities in the response to climate change. Many of the solutions to address climate change, such as promoting more active travel (walking, cycling and other sustainable travel modes) and healthy sustainable diets (good eating habit/growing our own food) are inventions that also bring benefits to health.

20-Minute neighbourhoods – health and wellbeing benefits

- 10.1.17. Planning Practice Guidance (PPG) highlights the importance of promoting access for the whole community. The NPPF recommends that local authorities should consider opportunities to support people to live healthy lifestyles including planning for an environment that helps promote active travel and physical activity. Good quality infrastructure encourages walking, cycling and the use of public transport, which makes it easier for people to choose more active travel, supports individual health choices, and helps prevent weight related illnesses, including diabetes and cardiovascular disease.
- 10.1.18. There is widespread recognition that the places where people live are major influences on their wellbeing. There are economic, environmental, health and social benefits of 20-minute neighbourhoods. The Town Country Planning Association (TCPA) has produced '[20 Minute Neighbourhood, Creating Healthier, Active, Prosperous Communities: An Introduction for Council Planners in England](#)' a guide in creating and transforming areas into these neighbourhoods.
- 10.1.19. A 20-minute neighbourhood is about creating attractive, interesting, safe and walkable environments in which people of all ages and levels of fitness are happy to travel actively for short distances from home to the destinations that they visit and the services they need to use day to day; shopping, school, community and healthcare facilities, places of work, green spaces and more.
- 10.1.20. Every community has its own context and aspirations for the future. Any plans to create a

20-minute neighbourhood will be based on what the local diverse community (including children and young people, ethnic minorities and disabled people) wants. However, the following characteristics, or 'ingredients', are likely to be part of the mix:

- Diverse and affordable homes.
- Well-connected paths, streets and spaces.
- Schools at the heart of communities.
- Good green spaces in the right places.
- Local food growing.
- Keeping jobs and money local.
- Community health and wellbeing facilities.
- A place for all.



Figure 10.1b - Town and Country Planning Association (TCPA) 20 Minutes Neighbourhood features

Active Design 10 principles and guides

- 10.1.21. [Active Design](#) principles support the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF). Many Active Design principles are already embedded within overlapping disciplines related to open space and landscape, transport, access and design.
- 10.1.22. Embedding Active Design principles into the design and layout of a development at an early stage will meet a number of planning, transport and health objectives in an integrated and co-ordinated manner. This can assist in providing a smoother and quicker route through the planning application process and can help build support from neighbours and local communities for proposals resulting in more positive outcomes for applications. Our local plan design policies have embedded Active Design and other recognised design principles.

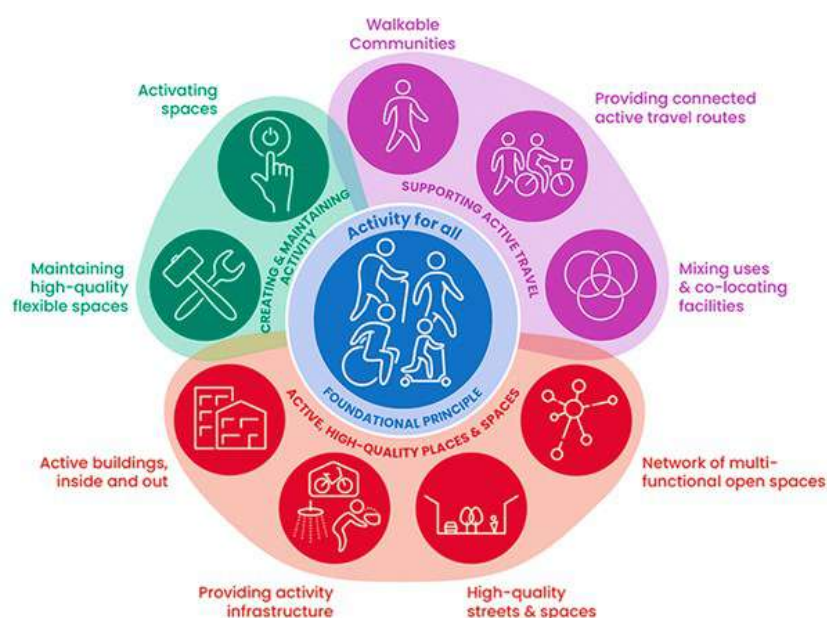


Figure 10.1c - Sport England Active Design

Healthy Streets Approach

10.1.23. The aim of [Transport for London Healthy Streets Approach](#) is to help create a vibrant, successful city where people can live active, healthy lives. The Healthy Streets Approach seeks to make our neighbourhoods healthier, more sustainable, safer and more connected. The easiest way for most of us to stay active is by walking or cycling as part of our daily travel. Several policies in the Local Plan seek to deliver and have incorporated, the Healthy Streets Approach such as the transport, design and green infrastructure policies. Our Local Plan has embedded Healthy Streets Approach throughout.



Figure 10.1d - Transport for London: Healthy Streets Approach indicators

Health and improving air quality

10.1.24. The government's [Clean Air Strategy \(2019\)](#) highlights that active travel such as cycling and walking creates less pollution. It says that there are well-understood health co-benefits from active travel including greater fitness and improved mental health, as well as lower risk of obesity, heart disease and lung disease. In addition, active travel reduces traffic congestion, itself a major cause of air pollution. The Mayor of London's Health Inequalities Strategy states that the Mayor wants London to be a place where our surroundings, the places we live, work and play support good health. The Mayor's key ambition is for London to have the best air quality of any major global city.

10.1.25. [Merton's Air Quality Action Plan \(AQAP\)](#) has been produced as part of our duty under the London Local Air Quality Management statutory process and outlines the action we will take to improve air quality in the London Borough of Merton between 2018 and 2023, for example:

- To provide guidance to developers on the impact of development on air quality and ensure that approved schemes include effective mitigation and maximise the opportunity to improve infrastructure for sustainable transport options.
- To continue to work with schools, parents and students to improve awareness of air quality and to optimise parents' and children's desire and opportunity to adopt sustainable travel options.

10.1.26. The Local Plan seeks to reduce the impacts of poor air quality in an integrated way, through a number of policies including P15.10 Air Quality, Pollution and Land Stability. It seeks to ensure that local environmental impacts of all development proposals do not lead to detrimental effects on the health, safety and the amenity of existing and new users or occupiers of the development site or the surrounding land.

Dementia Friendly Merton

10.1.27. Since the G8 dementia summit 'Global action against dementia' in 2013, there has been a national movement toward developing dementia friendly environments. Over the years, there have been several pilot projects across the United Kingdom (UK) with the aim to make towns and cities more accessible and understandable, to enable people with dementia to live more independently for longer.

10.1.28. According to Merton's Strategic Housing Needs Assessment 2019 and based on population projections by 2035 the number of people aged over 85 is predicted to increase by 52% in Merton. With more people living longer there is also an increase in older people living alone and people living at home with long-term physical and mental conditions such as dementia. There are an estimated 72,000 people living with dementia in London (850,000 people in the UK). If current trends continue, there will be a 40% increase in the number of people living with this condition by 2025. It is estimated that circa 2,000 people are living with dementia in Merton.

- 10.1.29. Merton Council is an active member of [Merton's Dementia Action Alliance \(MDAA\)](#). The MDAA partners includes shops and other businesses, banks, Public Health professionals, the London Fire Brigade, Metropolitan Police Service (MPS) and the leisure industry. Merton Council has been recognised for the work we are doing in our aim to be a dementia friendly borough and has been awarded the status of 'Working towards Dementia Friendly' status by the Alzheimer's Society and is fully committed to creating Dementia Friendly communities.
- 10.1.30. A Dementia Friendly borough will consider transport, housing, health services, culture, and social integration through the lens of dementia, with the aim that all those living with dementia in Merton must be empowered and supported to live well. It is recognised that well-designed local environments can have a substantial positive impact on the quality of life and on health and wellbeing. Well-designed and well-planned environments and buildings can also help someone living with dementia live well for longer. More importantly, incorporating dementia friendly approaches into development proposals does not just help people living with dementia but is also beneficial to Merton's growing ageing population, people with disabilities and families with small children.
- 10.1.31. Dementia friendly design approaches take existing design best practices and either adapt or strengthen them with a focus on the needs of people living with dementia. These approaches aim to create inclusive environments/neighbourhoods which will help reduce stigma and support people living with dementia and many other impairments including people with physical and sensory impairments, neurodiverse people (including autism), people with learning disabilities and mental health service users. Inclusive neighbourhoods go beyond providing physical access and create solutions that work better for everyone; ensuring that everyone can equally and confidently use buildings, transport and public spaces. An inclusive environment is one which can be used safely, easily and with dignity by all. It is convenient and welcoming with no disabling barriers and provides independent access without added undue effort, separation or special treatment for any group of people.
- 10.1.32. Several practical guides help developers to incorporate dementia friendly approaches. We recommend that developers have consideration to the Royal Town Planning Institute (RTPI) practice guide '[Creating better environments for people living with dementia](#)'. This guidance provides practical advice on how to incorporate dementia friendly approaches in development proposals. The guidance also provides case studies of development schemes and how developers worked with the Alzheimer Society; Age UK and other organisations.
- 10.1.33. Another useful tool for developers is '[The Place Standard](#)' toolkit. The Scottish Government, NHS (National Health Service), Health Scotland and Architecture and Design Scotland developed this tool. Many local authorities use it as a framework for consultation on development; however, it can be used by developers to assist proposals.
- 10.1.34. Halsall Lloyd Partnership, architects and designers, have produced two guides promoting action research into design for dementia, working in partnership with Liverpool John Moores

University, the Building Research Establishment (BRE) and other partners. [Volume 1: Design for Dementia](#), is a guide with helpful guidance in the design of exterior and interior environments. [Volume 2: Design for Dementia, Research Projects](#), outlines the research projects and describes the participating approach.

- 10.1.35. We recommend that developers consider the above and other guidance produced by the architectural, urban design and health organisations that provide guidance on creating dementia friendly homes and environments. We would also recommend that developers seek advice from the Alzheimer's Society and Merton's Dementia Hub on incorporating dementia friendly approaches in their development proposals at an early stage.
- 10.1.36. Developers will be expected to demonstrate how they have incorporated dementia friendly approaches in submitted planning applications and, where relevant, at Design Review Panel.

Policy HW10.2: Delivering healthy places

- 1.** We require development proposals to improve and promote strong, vibrant and healthy communities.
- 2.** We will require development proposals to:
 - a.** Contribute towards the health priorities of Merton's Health and Wellbeing Strategy to help reduce inequalities, including health, across Merton.
 - b.** Incorporate the Transport for London (TfL) Healthy Streets Approach as part of development proposals in accordance with the design, housing, environment, economy and other policies in this Plan that address the wider determinants of health and improve quality of life.
 - c.** Encourage opportunities for food growing such as allotments, community gardens and orchards and other innovative food growing spaces as part of development proposals.
 - d.** Incorporate Sport England and Public Health Active Design principles as part of development proposals.
- 3.** We will use the Healthy Streets Approach to prioritise health and wellbeing in planning decisions.
- 4.** We will require a Health Impact Assessment for the following:
 - a.** All developments in Merton of 100+ residential units or over 10,000m² non-residential development.
 - b.** Developments of 50 homes or more in areas identified by the government's Indices of Deprivation located in an Index Multiple Deprivation decile 5 or less or identified in Merton's Joint Strategic Needs Assessment (JSNA).
 - c.** Where deemed necessary, the cumulative impact of a proposed Major Development that is in an area with two or more other Major Developments planned or started.
 - d.** Significant developments in areas of poor air quality, for example Air Quality Focus Areas
 - e.** Developments where new educational, health facilities or publicly accessible open space are proposed.
- 5.** In line with the London Plan and policy TC13.8 in this plan, not permit proposals for new hot food takeaways found within 400 metres of the boundaries of a primary or secondary school to promote the availability of healthy food. Where any development proposals involving hot food takeaways are permitted, the council will encourage the operator to achieve and operate in compliance with the Healthier Catering Commitment standard.

Supporting text

10.2.1. Merton is considered a healthy borough when compared to other London boroughs regarding health and wellbeing. However, as identified in [Merton's Health and Wellbeing Strategy](#), a different picture emerges especially when it comes to health inequalities of residents. Residents living in the west of the borough (Wimbledon and Raynes Park) in general tends to be healthier, more physically active, have higher levels of educational achievement and earn more money. While residents living in neighbourhoods in the east (Mitcham, Colliers Wood and Morden) have higher levels of health inequalities, less physically active, have lower educational achievement and tend to earn less money. There is evidence that creating healthy environments could create economically thriving spaces that would add value to development proposals for example:

- Increase trade by 40% when places are made more attractive for walking.
- Commercially: 80% increase in retail sales when places are easier and more attractive to walk around.

Merton's Health and Wellbeing Strategy

10.2.2. [Merton's Health and Wellbeing Strategy \(2019-2024\)](#) has four main themes for Merton residents to *Start Well*, *Live Well* and *Age Well* in a *Healthy Place*. The strategy has a number of priorities for example:

- Tackling health inequalities: especially the east/west health divide in the borough
- Health in All Policies approach: maximising the positive health impacts across all policies and challenging negative impacts.

10.2.3. All development proposals are encouraged to positively contribute to, and are not to detract from, the council's health priorities as set out in the Health and Wellbeing Strategy.

Hot food takeaways

10.2.4. According to the [Joint Strategic Needs Assessment \(JSNA\)](#); The Merton Story produced by Public Health Merton and Public Health England, the percentage of Year 6 (aged 11) children in Merton identified as obese is 21%; this figure is higher than the national average (19%). Access to fast food takeaways may influence the ability of our children to adopt healthy lifestyles and may potentially undermine healthy eating initiatives which are in place in several schools in Merton.

10.2.5. We will look to create and promote healthy food environment in Merton by increasing the availability of healthy food and limiting unhealthy options. In line with Policy DM TC 13.8 we will not permit new development proposals for fast food takeaways located 400 metres from the exit and entrance of an existing or proposed school. The council will have regard to the nature of the proposal, its contribution to healthy food availability and its relationship to the existing provision of hot food takeaway outlets and healthy eating initiatives taking place at the school. We fully support the Mayor of London's Healthier Catering Commitment (HCC) and with Merton Public Health will working with businesses (including new businesses) that serve and/or sell food to

help improve their food offer. We will encourage all new food establishments in Merton to sign up to the HCC.

Health Impact Assessments (HIA)

- 10.2.6. We recommend that a Health Impact Assessment (HIA) is carried out at an early stage of a development proposal. HIAs are designed to consider whether a development proposal might reinforce health inequalities and inadvertently damage people's health or have positive health outcomes for the local community. Ensuring issues are considered at an early stage in developing planning proposals can help improve both the physical and mental health of the population. Carrying out a HIA during the implementation stage is technically possible but it brings a risk of retrofitting health sensitive solutions to the proposal and is likely to generate more development costs, which could adversely affect the financial viability of the development. Please also refer to *Policy IN 14.1 (Infrastructure)*.
- 10.2.7. HIAs promote sustainable developments that support the creation of strong, vibrant and healthy communities by:
- Considering both positive and negative health impacts when preparing development proposals and must identify actions to enhance the positive impacts and mitigate the negative impacts. The outcome of these actions must be clearly identifiable within the planning application.
 - Identifying the actions needed to minimise any negative impacts on health and wellbeing of a particular development scheme.
 - Demonstrating that developers have worked closely with communities directly affected by their proposals to evolve designs that take account of the views of the community.
 - Considering the cumulative impact of development i.e. where several developments are in progress within the local area, especially where this relates to construction, as well as the potential overconcentration of uses in a local area. The combination of several large residential schemes may also have a material impact on access to services and amenities.

Indices of Multiple Deprivation

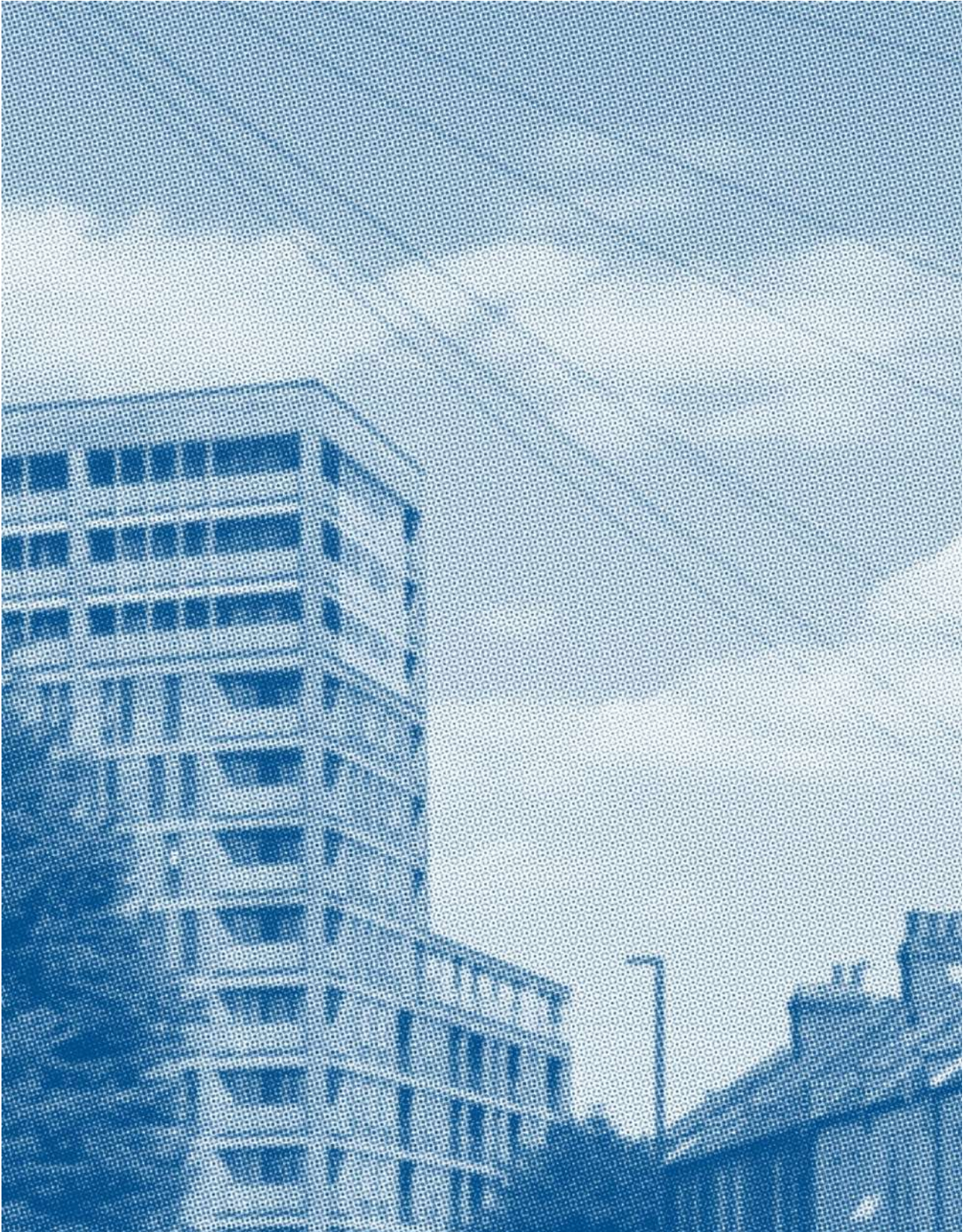
- 10.2.8. The Indices of Deprivation provide a set of relative measures of deprivation at a small local area level (Lower-layer Super Output Areas) across England, based on seven different domains, or facets, of deprivation:
- Income.
 - Employment.
 - Education, Skills and Training.
 - Health and Disability.
 - Crime.
 - Barriers to Housing and Services.
 - Living Environment.
- 10.2.9. Combining information from the seven domains produces an overall relative measure of deprivation, the Index of Multiple Deprivation (IMD). The Index of Multiple Deprivation (IMD)

ranks every small area in England from 1 (most deprived area) to 32,844 (least deprived area).

- 10.2.10. Merton ranks as the 214th least deprived local authority district in terms of average IMD (2019) (out of a total of 317), and the 5th least deprived borough in London (out of a total of 32 boroughs). However, there are pocket of deprivation across Merton with more in the east of the borough. Developers are expected to refer to the government's [IMD reports mapping sources](#) and demonstrate how the information has informed proposals by way of the HIA.

Cumulative impact

- 10.2.11. Proposed development within 800 metres of two or more other Major Developments planned or started may be required to carry out a HIA. This will depend on location, health and wellbeing needs and the wider determinates of health. HIAs must have regard to other development proposals planned or started and demonstrate that the cumulative impact is positive and will contribute to a healthy neighbourhood.



Chapter 11. **Housing provision**

Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing choice

1. To ensure that Merton's existing and future residents have a choice of different types, sizes and costs of homes, we will:
 - a. Require proposals for new homes including new build schemes and redevelopment proposals to be well designed and located to create socially mixed, inclusive and sustainable neighbourhoods.
 - b. Seek the provision of a mix of housing types, sizes and tenures at a local level to meet the needs of all sectors of the community and at all stages of people's lives. This includes the provision of family sized and smaller homes and provision for those unable to compete financially in the housing market sector and those with special needs.
 - c. Incorporate the re-provision of at least one family sized home where the loss of an existing family sized home is proposed.
 - d. Provide step-free, accessible and adapted housing in accordance with London Plan Policy D7 (Accessible housing), Building Regulation Requirement M4(2) and M(4.3) and this Local Plan's policy D12.3 Ensuring high quality designs in all developments.
 - e. Aim for the strategic target of 50% of new homes built in Merton between 2021/22 -2037/38 to be affordable.
 - f. Expect the following level of affordable housing (gross) to be provided on individual sites as follows:

Threshold (gross)	Affordable housing level	Affordable housing tenure split	Required provision
i. 10 or more homes	¹Threshold level to be eligible for the Fast-Track Route as set out in the London Plan provided all provision accords with the tenure mix requirements of Strategic policy H11.1 and is on-site without public subsidy: 50% for public sector land or on industrial land where redevelopment would result in a loss of industrial capacity. For all other sites up to 50% with a minimum provision of 35%.	70% Low-cost rent 30% Intermediate (Including a minimum of 25% First Homes)	On-Site Only in exceptional circumstances will the provision of affordable housing off-site or financial contribution in lieu of provision on-site be considered by the council, and this must be justified and such schemes will be required to provide a detailed viability assessment and contribute to the objective of creating mixed and balanced communities.
ii. 2 – 9 homes	Financial contribution equivalent to 20% affordable housing provision.	70% Low-cost rent 30% Intermediate (Including a minimum of 25% First Homes)	Financial contribution

g. Require applicants to demonstrate that they have taken account of the strategic 50% target and have sought a grant where required to increase the level of affordable housing beyond 35%.

h. Require applicants to present data for all housing tenures proposed in their scheme as a percentage of total residential provision in three ways: as the number of homes (units), habitable rooms, and floorspace.

¹ In the London Plan the 35 per cent threshold level will be monitored and reviewed in 2021 to determine whether this threshold should be increased and proposals will need to have regard to this.

- i. For schemes of 10 homes and above, require affordable housing to be provided on-site. In exceptional circumstances, where the applicant has robustly demonstrated to the council that on-site provision is not feasible, we may consider a financial contribution equivalent. This justification must include the provision of a detailed financial appraisal. For these schemes, off-site and cash in lieu schemes must accord with the requirements set out in The London Plan and have regard to the Mayor's Affordable Housing and Viability SPG (Supplementary Planning Guidance) (2017) or subsequent updates to these.
- j. Require all affordable housing provided by the scheme to be affordable in perpetuity and secured via planning obligation (Section 106 agreement or appropriate legal deed).

Supporting text

Access to decent homes

- 11.1.1. National and regional guidance acknowledges that being able to access decent affordable accommodation is a major factor in improving health and wellbeing (including mental health). Accommodation standards and affordability have a strong influence on other issues which contribute to quality of life, including health (including mental health) and wellbeing, crime, education and skills. Merton's Strategic Housing Needs assessment (SHNA) (July 2019), identified a notable and pressing need for affordable homes.
- 11.1.2. There are marked differences in quality of life between different communities within Merton. The wards in the east of the borough (Abbey, Colliers Wood, Cricket Green, Figges Marsh, Lavender Fields, Pollards Hill and St Helier wards) have long-standing issues of multiple deprivation and income deprivation, when compared to the wards in the more affluent west of the borough. There are some pockets of deprivation in the west. The COVID-19 pandemic has not only highlighted these issues but has widened the gap between the west and east of the borough.
- 11.1.3. Merton is one of the most diverse boroughs in terms of house prices as it has both more affluent neighbourhoods in the west of the borough (e.g. Wimbledon) and respectively more affordable east of the borough (e.g. Mitcham). Merton's median housing value reached £460,000. This is above both the national (£222,000) and the regional (£450,000) equivalents. It is also higher than the Outer London equivalent of £397,500. Over the last 5, 10 and 15 years Merton's house prices have grown quicker than England and the Outer London Region.

Affordable housing tenure

- 11.1.4. **Low cost rented tenure** consists of Social Rented homes and London Affordable Rent. **Intermediate tenure** includes Intermediate Rent and Affordable Home Ownership products

such as London Living Rent. All affordable tenures are as defined in the London Plan or any subsequent updates to it. We are committed to ensuring delivery of genuinely affordable housing and rents for both Social Rent homes and London Affordable Rent that are significantly less than 80% of market rents, which is the maximum for Affordable Rent permitted by the NPPF (National Planning Policy Framework) 2023.

- 11.1.5. We expect the low cost rented tenure requirement of Strategic Policy H 11.1 to be delivered primarily as social rented housing to better address the overwhelming housing need in Merton. We support affordable housing which genuinely addresses those in housing need in Merton – that is at household income levels below £38,400, or concerning low cost/intermediate rent and affordable homeownership that meet the rent levels and prices set out in figs 11.1.1, 11.1.2 and 11.1.3 or subsequent updates to these.

Low cost and intermediate rent levels

- 11.1.6. [Merton's Strategic Housing Needs Assessment \(SHNA\) \(2019\)](#) identified that any household with an income below £38,400 would not be able to afford a lower quartile rent without some degree of subsidy. It also identified a need for around 878 - 1,084 homes per annum – this is for subsidised housing at a cost below that to access the private rented sector (i.e. for households unable to access any form of market housing without some form of subsidy and at a household income below £38,400).
- 11.1.7. Merton's SHNA analysis sets out appropriate affordable rent (termed as living rents in the SHNA) for different sizes of accommodation in different locations based on local incomes and housing costs in Merton. The analysis shows rents starting at about £400 for a one-bedroom home (in Mitcham) and rising to over £800 for homes with three bedrooms. None of these figures have been capped by Local Housing Allowance (LHA) as the maximum LHA is higher than the affordable rent levels for all sizes and locations in Merton. Rents above LHA should be avoided to ensure housing is affordable to those needing to claim Housing Benefit.

	1-bedroom	2-bedroom	3-bedrooms
Mitcham	£401	£522	£642
Morden	£422	£548	£675
Raynes Park	£467	£607	£747
SW/CW	£474	£616	£758
Wimbledon	£514	£669	£823
Total	£449	£583	£718

Source: ASHE and Living Rents methodology

Figure 11.1.1 Living rents (per month)

- 11.1.8. For the purposes of testing potential levels of affordable housing to inform Merton's Local Plan, [Merton's Local Plan Viability Study \(2020\)](#) assumed affordable rents that do not exceed

London Affordable rents as shown in Fig 11.1.2. These rents are broadly equivalent to social/ target rents. In the study London Living Rent tenure was based on the lower end GLA benchmark rents for Merton for that tenure. For schemes proposing London Living Rent we will have regard to these benchmark rents.

Rent type	1 bed	2 bed	3 bed	4 bed
London Affordable Rent (2020/21)	£159.32	£168.67	£178.05	£187.05
London Living Rent (intermediate tenure) ¹⁶	£182.51	£202.79	£223.07	£243.35

Figure 11.1.2 Affordable housing rents (per week)

Affordable home ownership

- 11.1.9. We seek 10% of all housing on sites of 10 homes and above to be affordable home ownership (as set out in the NPPF 2023).
- 11.1.10. We will expect affordable home ownership to meet local incomes and local housing costs. Merton's SHNA recommends that prices should be set at a level which (in income terms) are equivalent to the levels needed to access private rented housing in Merton.
- 11.1.11. Figure 11.1.3 from Merton's SHNA analysis, sets out a suggested purchase price for affordable home ownership in the borough. The figures are based on trying to roughly equate a sale price with an equivalent access point to the private rental market. This shows across the borough a one-bedroom 'affordable' price of about £149,000 rising to almost £300,000 for homes with four or more bedrooms.

	1-bedroom	2-bedroom	3-bedroom	4+-bedroom
Mitcham	£129,000	£162,000	£195,000	£229,000
Morden	£129,000	£165,000	£195,000	£229,000
Raynes Park	£160,000	£178,000	£227,000	£330,000
SW/CW	£149,000	£184,000	£233,000	£280,000
Wimbledon	£170,000	£204,700	£263,000	£413,000
Borough-wide	£149,000	£184,900	£220,000	£299,000

Source: Derived from Valuation Office Agency data

Figure 11.1.3 Affordable housing home ownership prices (aligned with the cost of accessing private rented sector) – data for the year to March 2018)

- 11.1.12. For First Homes the affordable home ownership prices will differ from those set out in supporting paragraph 11.1.11 and Figure 11.1.3 in accordance with government

requirements. First Homes must be discounted by a minimum of 30% against the market value and after the discount is applied the first sale must be at a price no higher than £420,000 in Greater London.

- 11.1.13. Merton's SHNA recommends that given the high level of need shown, based on households unable to buy or rent in the market, the council should consider London Living Rents (which can provide a route into home ownership) ahead of shared ownership as a preferred form of intermediate housing. Merton's SHNA also recommends that if, for viability purposes, shared ownership is included this should not make up more than 10% of homes on any individual site. Whilst London Shared Ownership is classed as an affordable tenure (in line with both the London Plan and the NPPF) it is likely to be the tenure that is available to the fewest number of households with a need due to having higher housing costs.
- 11.1.14. We will have regard to the purchase prices for affordable home ownership, intermediate and low-cost rent levels set out in Merton's SHNA, and subsequent updates to this information, in its assessment of submitted schemes aimed at achieving provision of genuinely affordable homes that more appropriately address affordable housing needs in Merton.

First Homes

- 11.1.15. First Homes are a form of discounted market sales housing and to be considered as such must meet the requirements set out in the MHCLG Ministerial Statement published on 24 May 2021: [Written statements - Written questions, answers and statements - UK Parliament](#) and the definition and eligibility requirements set out in NPPG Guidance [First Homes - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#). These national policies and guidance, in addition to paragraph 64 of the NPPF [\(National Planning Policy Framework\)](#) 2023 also set out specific exceptions to the general requirements for First Homes and low-cost home ownership dwellings which we will have regard to as appropriate in the determination of submitted planning applications.
- 11.1.16. As set out in the NPPF 2023, First Homes are the government's preferred discounted market tenure and are required to account for at least 25% of all affordable housing homes delivered by developers through planning obligations. First Homes are an intermediate tenure therefore in accordance with government requirements, proposals for new homes will be considered against the intermediate tenure split element of Policy H11.1 (Housing Choice). On schemes where policy-compliant provision of First Homes does not result in 10% of the overall housing yield of the site being available for affordable home ownership, any shortfall in this respect would need to be made up from the rest of the intermediate contribution before other types of intermediate affordable housing would be considered.

Delivery of affordable homes

- 11.1.17. Merton is a borough of small sites. On average over the last 12 years more than 90% of the planning applications for new homes submitted to Merton Council were for sites of less than

10 homes. As the London Plan and Merton's previous policy only applied to developments of 10 homes or more, this means that very few developments were eligible to provide affordable housing through the planning system.

- 11.1.18. For example, Merton's Annual Monitor Report 2018/19 indicates that in 2018/19 only one development was built in Merton that was greater than 10 homes, and this development was for 11 homes. From this one development five affordable homes were built which totalled a 45% contribution towards affordable housing from the site, above the borough's 40% target. The delivery of affordable housing has been affected by the introduction of Prior Approval rights to convert office, retail and storage premises to residential use without the need for full planning permission. This is particularly evident in the financial years 2015/16 and 2016/17 where 47% and 36% of the total number of homes built in those years was via prior approval.
- 11.1.19. Merton is experiencing an increasing number of schemes proposing 100% intermediate housing, as the affordable housing proportion of the scheme, which is contrary to Merton's policy requirement. The reasons provided by proposers is that this is what can be viably delivered and that there is a lack of interest from Registered Providers in managing low cost rented homes in preference to shared ownership homes which they consider a more attractive product. This is evidenced by the fact that Registered Providers in Merton are willing to purchase additional shared ownership homes than what the GLA can offer grant for. However, this situation poses a deliverability mismatch as there is an overwhelming need in Merton for low-cost affordable housing. This illustrates a tension that exists between viability and addressing housing needs.
- 11.1.20. Merton's SHNA supports the introduction of a 70 / 30 split between low cost rented and intermediate which better benefits people most in need and reflects the unmet affordable housing need to be addressed. This tension is acknowledged in the London Plan which advises at paragraph 4.6.1 that the 2017 SHMA [Strategic Housing Market Assessment] shows London's significant need for low-cost rental housing. However, the current national funding programme reflected in the Mayor's current Affordable Homes Programme (2016-2021) is focused on intermediate products which limits the Mayor's ability to require higher levels of low-cost rented accommodation. It is however noted that the Mayor's new Affordable Homes Programme (2021-2026) which runs concurrently to the current one, makes funding available for social rent products which should help alleviate this issue.
- 11.1.21. Merton's SHNA identifies a notable and pressing need for affordable housing in all parts of Merton for between 878 to 1,084 affordable homes per year and that the demand for affordable housing significantly outstrips supply. Merton's Local Plan Viability Study (2020) notes that where viability is already on the margins, other policy requirements may need to be reduced to compensate for these costs. In such instances Policy IN14.1 (Infrastructure) would apply which, in accordance with London Plan Policy DF1, requires that where it has been demonstrated that planning obligations cannot viably be supported, priority should be given to affordable housing and necessary public transport improvements.

- 11.1.22. Where the developer contends the policy requirements in relation to viability of a particular proposal, the onus would lie with the developer to demonstrate what can viably be achieved through the submission of a viability assessment. We may seek payments from applicants for the cost of independent viability assessment(s).

Financial contributions in lieu of affordable housing provision

- 11.1.23. Off-site provision or in lieu financial contributions secured via legal agreements should provide no financial benefit to the applicant relative to on-site provision and review mechanisms will be included in accordance with the Viability Test Route (VTR) as set out in paragraph 4.4.13 of the London Plan and / or via any guidance provided on Merton's website or subsequent updates to these. Provision of affordable housing on all small sites of 2 to 9 homes (gross), will be as a financial in lieu payment. For schemes proposing 10 or more homes (gross), viability alone is insufficient justification for off-site affordable housing provision or a cash in lieu payment. Only in exceptional circumstances for schemes proposing 10 or more homes (gross) will the provision of affordable housing off-site or as a financial contribution in lieu of provision on-site be considered subject to demonstrating to our satisfaction that this exception is justified and such schemes should contribute to the objective of creating mixed and balanced communities and accord with the London Plan supporting paragraphs 4.4.9 to 4.4.13 (inclusive).
- 11.1.24. Schemes which propose off-site affordable housing or cash in lieu payments are required to provide a detailed viability assessment as part of the justification that these proposals are acceptable, in accordance with the London Plan and Merton's Local Plan policies. Following adoption of this Plan, we will publish guidance to assist in the delivery of the affordable housing requirements set out in Strategic Policy H11.1 for schemes of 2 to 9 units, including how development appraisals or other methods agreed in writing with the council will be used in calculating financial contributions for these schemes.
- 11.1.25. The value of the payment in lieu should be based on the relevant threshold as a percentage of on-site homes. The payment in lieu should be calculated through two appraisals – one with the level of affordable housing required by policy and the other with 100% market housing: The payment in lieu will equate to the difference between the two residual values. Applicants should use the methodology set out in paragraph 11.1.26 below.

- 11.1.26. Affordable housing monetary contributions in lieu of on-site provision will be calculated on a case-by-case basis according to the following formula:

$$A-B=C$$

Where:

A= residual value of the proposed development assuming 100% of the residential homes are provided as private housing established through a development appraisal or other method agreed in writing with the council.

B= the residual value that would otherwise have been achieved by the proposed development incorporating affordable housing in accordance with the affordable housing policy requirement established through a development appraisal or other method agreed in writing with the council.

C= payment in lieu.

- 11.1.27. We hold cash in lieu in a separate affordable housing ringfenced pot to enable resources to be pooled to provide greater or more appropriate new affordable housing provision to be made off-site, either on an identified site or as part of an agreed programme in compliance with the statutory tests for use of planning obligations. In accordance with the NPPF (National Planning Policy Framework) 2023 and London Plan Policy H7 (Monitoring of affordable housing) the information on off-site and cash in lieu delivery is monitored and published annually as part of Merton's Infrastructure Funding Statement and Merton's Authority Monitoring Report (AMR).

Dwelling conversions

- 11.1.28. Merton's Authority Monitoring Report 2018/19 indicates that in the past five years the number of conversion schemes of family sized homes to smaller sized homes has increased. The supply of one- and two-bedroom homes significantly exceed the number of three or more bedrooms. In 2018/19, 11% of new housing consisted of studios, 33% one bedroom, 33% were two bedrooms and only 20% were three or more bedrooms. On this basis it is evident that the anticipated number of three-bedroom homes has not been achieved whilst the number of one- and two-bedroom homes were significantly exceeded.
- 11.1.29. The conversion of existing single dwellings into two or more smaller homes typically involves the intensification of Merton's suburban housing stock, resulting in the loss of larger homes. Given the identified need for three-bedroom homes and the historical provision of smaller homes, we are seeking to retain the existing stock of family sized homes in Merton. Applications for conversion of existing family sized homes into two or more smaller homes must include the re-provision of at least one family sized home. A family sized home is defined as having three or more bedrooms.

- 11.1.30. It is considered that the requirement for proposals involving the loss of a family sized home to include the re-provision of a new family sized home strikes a suitable balance between increasing housing density in appropriate areas, but not at the expense of a net loss in much needed existing family sized homes or achieving well-designed development that provides acceptable living conditions.
- 11.1.31. Some single properties within the borough are too small to convert, as it is not physically possible to provide two or more homes with rooms of an adequate size, or with sufficient internal circulation space. To ensure that dwelling conversions produce residential homes of a high quality, all new dwellings including dwelling conversions must comply with the most appropriate minimum space standards.

Projected population

- 11.1.32. We encourage the provision of a range of housing tenures, sizes and types to meet the needs of Merton's communities at all stages of life. Merton's SHNA indicates for the period 2017- 2035, the largest growth will be people aged 65 and over.
- 11.1.33. In 2035 it is projected that the number of residents aged over 65 across Merton is projected to increase by a minimum of 46%. The population aged 85 and over is projected to increase by an even greater proportion, 52%. The London Plan 2021 suggests an annual need for 105 homes in Merton that are specifically designed for the needs of older people (sheltered and extra-care housing). Local research supports the view that the need set out in the London Plan 2021 for older person homes is appropriate for Merton.
- 11.1.34. Looking at the earlier stages of life, Merton's SHNA shows that there is projected to be little change in the number of people aged under 15, compared with increases or decreases shown for other age groups. Focussing on the population aged 18-23 (student-age) the analysis below shows that there is projected to be some modest rise in the age group. In total it is projected that the number of people aged 18-23 will increase from 11,300 in 2017 up to 12,800 by 2035, an increase for around 1,500, or 13%.

Maximising affordable housing provision

- 11.1.35. New homes built under "prior approval" (i.e. without the need for planning permission) are exempt from affordable housing requirements and this further increases these challenging circumstances. Merton is also a borough of small sites due to historically fragmented land ownership. Over the last 10 years to 2017, over 90% of the planning applications Merton has received to build new homes, have been for sites of less than 10 homes, as the table below indicates (please note that the figures in the table below exclude prior approval applications).

2007-2017	Number of Schemes	%	Number of homes proposed	%	Net gain	%
1-10 homes	1,101	94%	2,388	38%	1,551	30%
11+ homes	71	6%	3,887	62%	3621	70%
Total	1172	100%	6275	100%	5172	100%

11.1.36. Therefore, in order to optimise every possibility for providing new affordable homes taking into account the specific circumstances of Merton, it is considered essential to continue to maximise affordable housing provision opportunities, including from small sites, subject to viability.

11.1.37. We will pursue requirements from small sites as financial contributions, as in practice it is our experience that this is what can be delivered. Feedback from affordable housing providers and developers demonstrates that it is difficult to find affordable housing registered providers willing to take small affordable housing schemes due to the additional costs of managing such sites.

11.1.38. All affordable housing provided within the borough will be subject to nomination agreements with Merton's Partner Registered Providers to ensure that they are occupied by persons nominated by the council. Agreements (currently s106 Agreements) used to secure affordable housing homes must include provisions for those homes to remain at an affordable price for future eligible households or for the subsidy to be recycled for alternative affordable provision.

Measuring affordable housing

11.1.39. Assessment of affordable housing proposals against our planning policy requirements will be measured as habitable rooms as defined by the London Plan. Habitable rooms in affordable and market elements of such schemes should be of a comparable size when averaged across the whole development. If this is not the case, it may be more appropriate to measure the provision of affordable housing using habitable floorspace as defined by the London Plan. Applicants should present affordable housing figures and all other housing types and tenures proposed as a percentage of total residential provision in habitable rooms, units and floorspace (both gross [GIA (Gross Internal Area)] and net internal area [NIA]) to enable comparison.

Fast track route

- 11.1.40. Planning applications that meet or exceed the relevant threshold level of affordable housing as set out in Local Plan Policy H4.1, on site within their development as affordable housing without government grants will not be required to submit a viability appraisal. This is known as the fast-track route.
- 11.1.41. In seeking affordable housing provision, we will have regard to site characteristics such as site size, site suitability and economics of provision such as financial viability issues and other planning contributions.
- 11.1.42. In Merton's experience introduction of the Mayor's 'fast track route' has resulted in an unchanged position concerning the number of schemes submitted with viability appraisals. we will expect public subsidy / grant to be sought to increase the provision of affordable housing above the stated minimum threshold requirements of Policy H11.1 (Housing choice).
- 11.1.43. Estate regeneration that involves the loss and replacement of affordable housing should deliver an uplift in the quantity and quality of affordable housing wherever possible. Therefore, all such estate regeneration schemes must go through the Viability Tested Route to demonstrate they have maximised the delivery of any additional affordable housing. In accordance with London Plan Policy H8 demolition of affordable housing as part of estate regeneration must be replaced by an equivalent amount of existing affordable housing floorspace. Existing affordable housing floorspace includes both occupied and vacant floorspace regardless of the current condition of the stock. More information and guidance can also be found in the Mayor's Good Practice Guide to Estate Regeneration.

Securing M4(2) and M4(3) dwellings

- 11.1.44. There may be site specific factors and viability issues which may warrant flexibility in the application of the accessible housing standards M4(2) and M4(3) requirements set out in Policy 11.1(d) for specific developments. The council will have regard to the exceptional circumstances detailed in [PPG \(Housing for Older and Disabled People\)](#); Government Housing: optional technical standards and paragraph 3.7.6 of the London Plan or subsequent updates to these in determining where the application of flexibility is warranted.
- 11.1.45. M4(2) and M4(3) dwellings should be secured via planning conditions to allow the Building Control body to check compliance of a development against the optional Building Regulations standards.

Strategic Policy H11.2 Housing Provision

1. We will aim to deliver a minimum of **12,084** additional homes for the period 2021/22 - 2037/38 via a stepped housing target, set out as follows:

Year	Target
<u>2021/22</u>	<u>918</u>
<u>2022/23</u>	<u>500</u>
<u>2023/24</u>	<u>450</u>
<u>2024/25</u>	<u>700</u>
<u>2025/26</u>	<u>725</u>
<u>2026/27</u>	<u>775</u>
<u>2027/28</u>	<u>775</u>
<u>2028/29</u>	<u>775</u>
<u>2029/30</u>	<u>1120</u>
<u>2030/31</u>	<u>1200</u>
<u>2031/32</u>	<u>780</u>
<u>2032/33</u>	<u>700</u>
<u>2033/34</u>	<u>474</u>
<u>2034/35</u>	<u>548</u>
<u>2035/36</u>	<u>548</u>
<u>2036/37</u>	<u>548</u>
<u>2037/38</u>	<u>548</u>
Total	12,084

2. This will be achieved by:
- Working with housing providers to optimise housing.
 - Supporting the provision of well-designed new homes that create socially mixed and sustainable neighbourhoods.
 - Supporting the delivery of well-designed new homes on large and small sites (a site area below 0.25 hectares in size), which optimise levels of residential density in accordance with the design-led approach set out in the London Plan Policy D6 and Merton's design code guidance; having regard to site context; connectivity and accessibility by walking and cycling and existing and planned public transport (including PTAL (Public Transport Accessibility Level)); and the capacity and provision of supporting infrastructure.
 - Supporting the delivery of the small sites target of 261 new homes per year.
 - Supporting the redevelopment of poor quality existing housing and proposals to improve the quality of existing homes that does not result in a net loss of residential homes, or net loss of affordable housing homes or net loss resulting from the change of use of any type of permanent housing to non-permanent accommodation, such as temporary sleeping accommodation for a cumulative period of more than 90 days a year.

- f. Supporting proposals for custom, self-build and community-led housing which optimise the use of land and meet all relevant policy requirements, such as those for affordable housing.

Supporting text

11.2.1. We will encourage housing in sustainable brownfield locations. The 12,084 additional homes for the period 2021/22 - 2037/38 will come forward in Merton by:

- Bringing forward housing capacity through regeneration, including in Morden town centre and the Merton Opportunity Area.
- Prioritising the development of previously developed land and ensuring it is used efficiently.
- Development of sites identified in Merton's Housing Trajectory.
- Development of windfall sites.
- Intensification of housing as part of estate regeneration proposals.
- Enabling mixed use development within the town centres.
- Bringing vacant properties back into use through Merton's empty homes strategy.
- Resisting the loss of housing to other uses.
- Preparing masterplans, development briefs and design guidance for larger housing sites.
- Demonstrating a continuous delivery of housing for at least 15 years as the Housing Trajectory sets out below.
- Setting out a 5-year supply of identified sites as shown in the Authority Monitoring Report.
- Monitoring housing provision levels through the Housing Trajectory within the Authority Monitoring Report.

11.2.2. Merton is a pro-growth borough and has substantial experience in delivering small sites over a long timeframe and throughout different economic and political cycles. Every year, between 85% to 95% of Merton's planning applications for new homes are for small sites (sites of 10 homes or less). However, as each small site delivers fewer than 10 homes, small sites contribute about 50% of the overall number of homes built each year in Merton, with large sites (which make up usually less than 10% of the planning applications received) contributing the other 50% of homes built.

11.2.3. Merton's housing target, which is set out in the London Plan 2021, is 9,180 homes for the ten-year period 2019/20 to 2028/29 or 918 homes per annum. This is based on a detailed analysis of land availability and capacity across London that Merton worked on with the GLA and all other London boroughs. The London Plan expects 261 homes of the 918 homes per annum to come forward on small sites. All housing development proposals will be required to meet the requirements of all relevant Local Plan policies including those contained in the following chapters: *Climate Change; Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough; Health and Well Being; Transport and Urban Mobility and Infrastructure*.

11.2.4. In recognition of the significant increase in housing delivery required by these targets, the London Plan states at paragraph 4.1.10, that these may be achieved gradually and

encourages boroughs to set a realistic and, where appropriate, stepped housing delivery target over a ten-year period. London Plan paragraph 4.1.11 states that if a target is needed beyond the ten-year period (2019/20 to 2028/29), boroughs should draw on the 2017 SHLAA findings which cover the period to 2041 and any local evidence of identified capacity, in consultation with the GLA, and should take into account any additional capacity that could be delivered as a result of any committed transport infrastructure improvements, and roll forward the housing capacity assumptions applied in the London Plan for small sites. Figure 11.2.1 sets out Merton's Housing Trajectory.

- 11.2.5. Merton supports high quality development, which meets identified needs. Merton faces constrained supply as it is characterised by a very large number of small sites and green spaces. These characteristics are replicated in several of the surrounding and adjacent boroughs.
- 11.2.6. The SHLAA 2017 findings indicate that for Merton the target for the period 2029/30 to 2033/34 is 474 homes per annum then for the remaining period 2034/35 to 2037/38 it increases to 548 homes per annum.
- 11.2.7. Merton can confirm that there are no committed transport infrastructure improvements which can be considered to provide additional capacity for new homes beyond 2028/2029 as per Merton's Infrastructure Needs Assessment 2021 and Transport for London's representations on Merton's Local Plan. Merton will continue to work proactively and collaboratively with the Mayor in contributing to addressing much needed additional homes for London.
- 11.2.8. In accordance with the London Plan requirements and in consultation with, and endorsed by the GLA, the housing trajectory set out in Figure 11.2.1 demonstrates how Merton's housing target will be met for the Local Plan period until 2037/ 38 using a stepped housing delivery target.
- 11.2.9. Merton's housing trajectory set out in Figure 11.2.1 is considered an appropriate approach for Merton as it sets out a realistic picture of housing delivery over the Local Plan period. A stepped housing delivery target is appropriate in Merton as there is a significant uplift in the level of housing target between emerging and previous policies, and several large sites will be delivered in phases. The estate regeneration programme of Eastfields, High Path and Ravensbury estates proposes the building of over 3,200 new homes, providing more than 2,000 additional homes from 2020-2037. Approximately 1,180 homes will be demolished as part of the estates regeneration programme, of which 748 demolitions will occur between 2019/20 and 2028/29.
- 11.2.10. Merton's housing trajectory is supported by Merton's Housing Delivery Test Action Plan which includes details on the actions we can take in the event of under delivery to increase the rate and number of homes built in Merton. These actions include proactive engagement with developers, registered providers and delivery partners to investigate housing delivery constraints and investigation on whether the use of our Compulsory Purchase Orders should

be considered as a measure to unlock stalled housing sites. The delivery of sites will be monitored in Merton's Authority Monitoring Report (AMR) and Merton's Housing Delivery Test Action Plan.

- 11.2.11. The London Plan envisages that key town centres in the borough – Wimbledon, Mitcham, Morden and Colliers Wood – offer 'high' potential for residential growth (Table A1.1), with Wimbledon, Colliers Wood and South Wimbledon identified as an Opportunity Area which indicatively is expected to contribute 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs. The Opportunity Area homes figure is based on the 2017 SHLAA capacity from 2019 to 2041.
- 11.2.12. Assessment of projected housing over the Local Plan period by locality indicates as set out in Fig. 11.2.2 that the majority of residential growth and associated infrastructure and social facilities will take place in Morden, Mitcham and Wimbledon which are characterised with good public transport access.

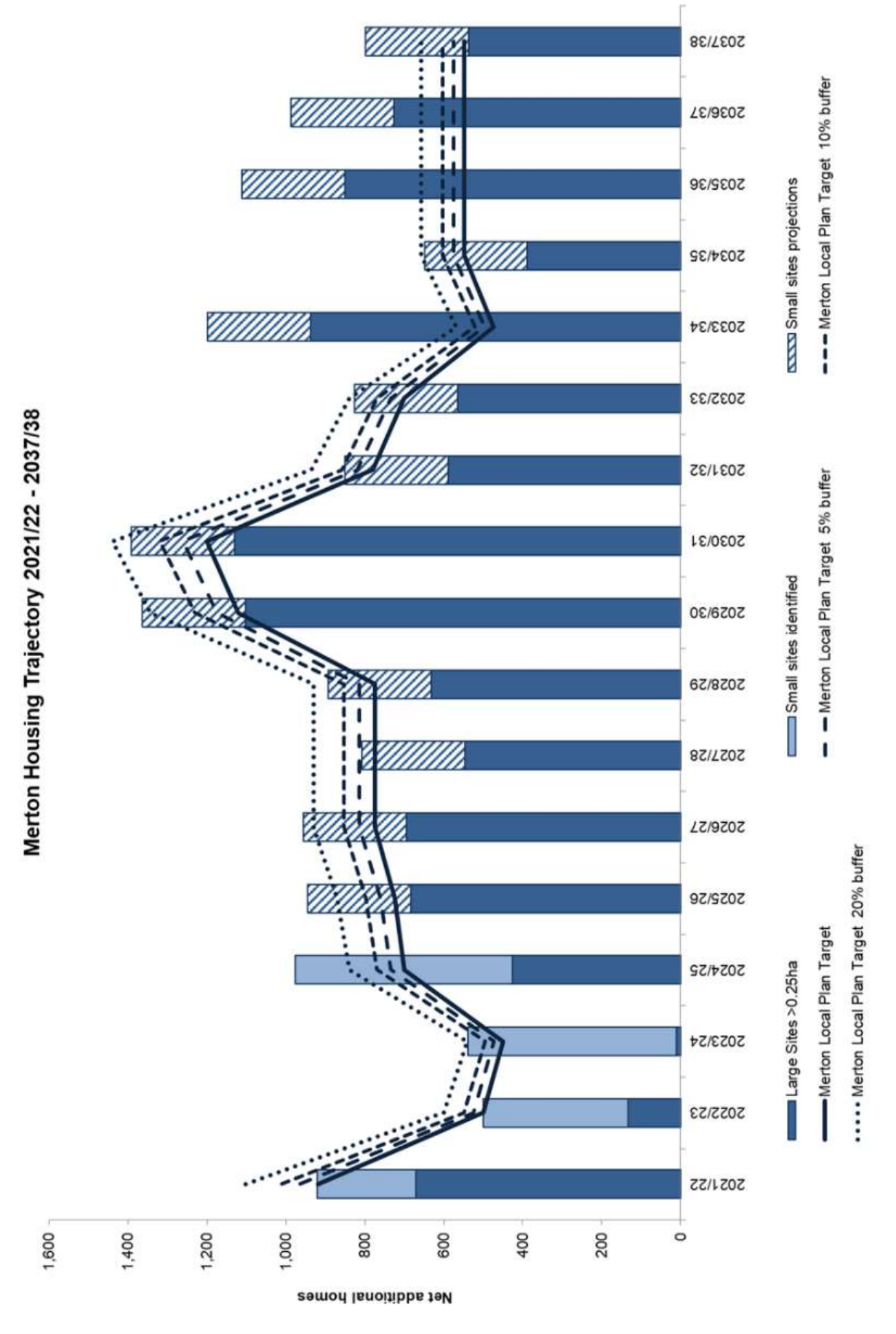
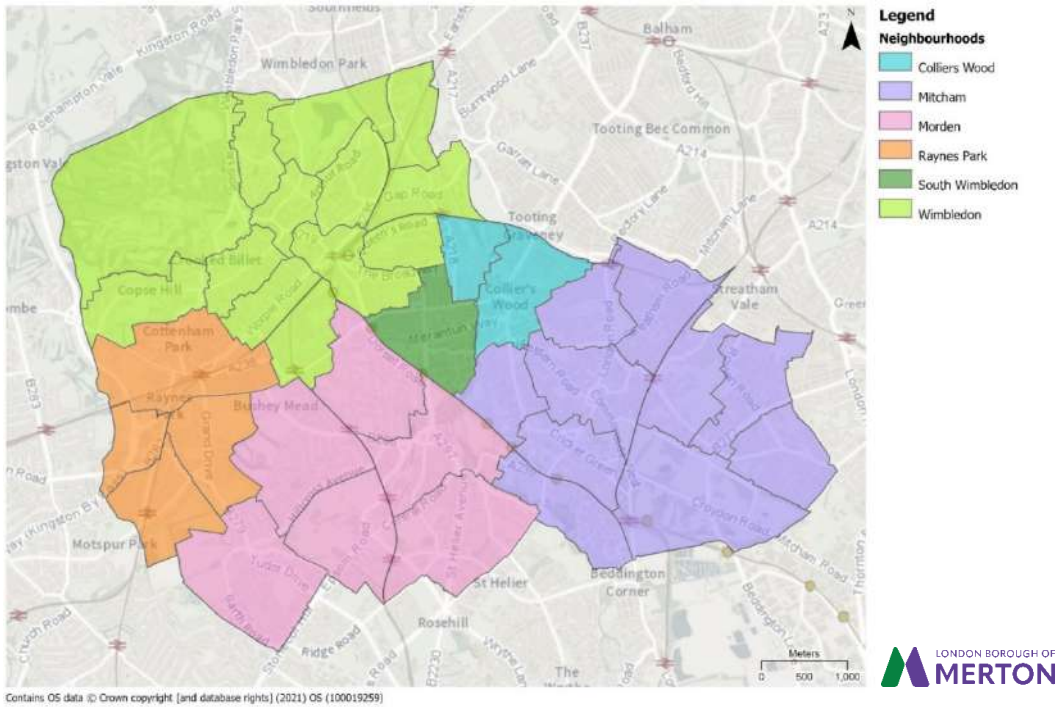


Figure 11.2.1 Merton's Housing Trajectory for the Plan period 2021/22 to 2037/38



Delivery of new homes on identified sites in each neighbourhood 2021/22-2037/38

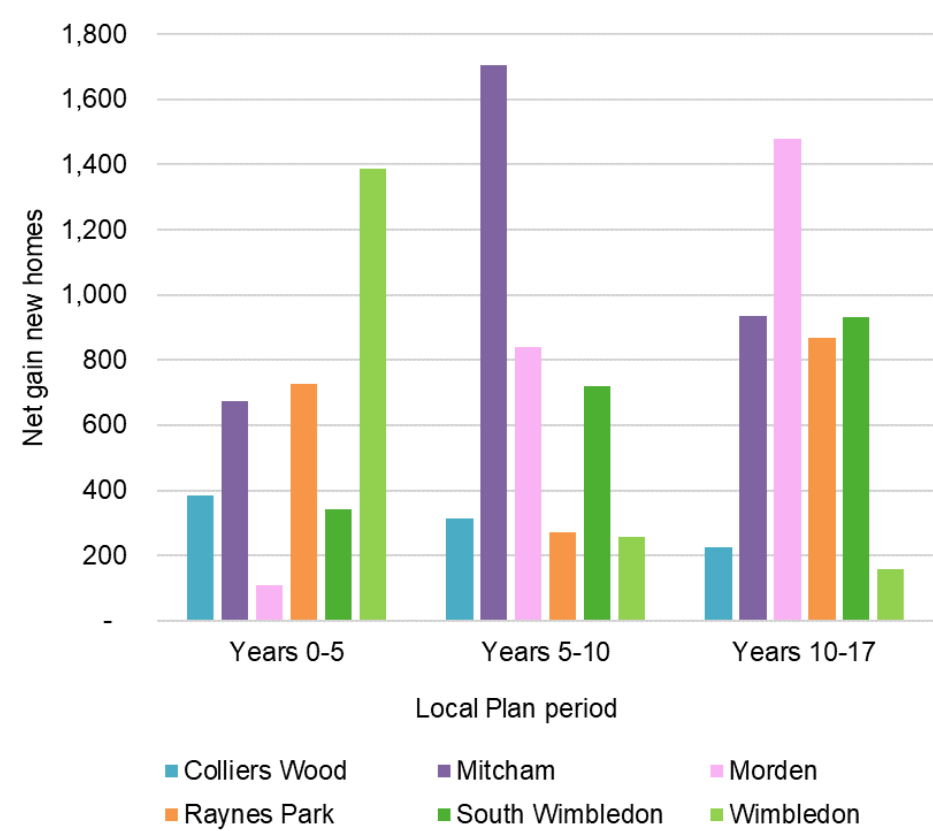


Figure 11.2.2 Delivery plan of new homes by neighbourhood

- 11.2.13. The regeneration of Morden town centre is a key priority for the council and the emerging Local Plan by means of Policy N5.1 and site allocation Mo1 which seek to enable delivery of around 2,000 homes within the Morden Regeneration Zone.
- 11.2.14. Mitcham is proposed to accommodate a range of new homes, including major development sites of Eastfields and Ravensbury estates. For Raynes Park larger sites close to Shannon Corner and incremental development within the surrounding neighbourhood will contribute to providing new homes. These are set out in more detail in the area-based policies within this Plan.
- 11.2.15. Wimbledon is similarly proposed to accommodate a range of new homes, including major development sites of Wimbledon Stadium, Wimbledon YMCA, and High Path estate regeneration.
- 11.2.16. Merton's Local Plan and accompanying proactive strategies that support future housing delivery, such as [Merton's Borough Character Study](#) and [Small Sites Toolkit](#), are pro-growth and geared towards optimising the provision of good quality and design-led housing to meet this ambition. For a decade Merton has been allocating sites of any size, i.e. no minimum small sites threshold, and has taken forward initiatives including town centre regeneration, estate regeneration and modular construction of affordable homes. Merton will continue to bring forward and support these initiatives.
- 11.2.17. [Merton's Borough Character Study SPD \(2021\)](#) identifies appropriate areas where there is potential for a range of sensitive and extensive character-led growth. At the heart of the study is to ensure that future shaping of the borough is informed by Merton's existing and unique character.
- 11.2.18. [Merton's Small Sites Toolkit SPD \(2021\)](#) is designed to give designers and developers a clearer picture of what would be considered acceptable development on sites up to 0.25 hectares in the borough. The toolkit will comprise of guidance notes, case studies and a design and access statement template. The guidance in the toolkit builds on the findings of the Character Study in providing contextual advice to applicants and their design teams. The guidance aims to encourage more development by giving a greater certainty of approval in addition to improving overall design quality.
- 11.2.19. There are a number of factors outside of local planning authority control that influence housing delivery including macroeconomics, economic effects of COVID-19 house prices, land values, investment confidence and finance availability and unsecured funding for Crossrail 2. However, it is considered that our proactive strategies will contribute to support future housing delivery despite these factors.
- 11.2.20. In accordance with London Plan Policy H9 (ensuring the best use of stock), boroughs are required to take account of the impact on housing stock and local housing need in considering applications for changes of use from permanent homes to non-permanent

homes. Paragraph 4.9.3 of the London Plan states that it is unlawful for homes in greater London to be used as short-term holiday rented accommodation for a cumulative period of more than 90 days a year without seeking planning permission. Due to the overwhelming need for permanent homes and the limited availability of suitable sites to address this need, we do not support the change of use of permanent homes to non-permanent accommodation (such as temporary sleeping accommodation and short term rental residential accommodation) for a cumulative period of more than 90 days a year without seeking planning permission. In accordance with the Greater London (General Powers) Act 1973 (as amended), the use of residential premises in London as temporary sleeping accommodation involves a material change of use requiring planning permission, unless it benefits from the exceptions introduced by the Deregulation Act 2015 which sets out the conditions which need to be met including that the sum of (a) the number of nights of use and (b) the number of nights of any previous use of the same premises as temporary sleeping accommodation in the same calendar year, does not exceed 90 nights. Strategic Policy H11.2 protects existing permanent homes from change of use to non-permanent accommodation (including timeshare, short-term lets, and temporary sleeping accommodation, as well as C1 uses which include hotels, guest houses and boarding houses, and hostels and bed and breakfast premises). Demand for non-permanent accommodation in the borough should be met from appropriate sites in non-residential use, rather than sites used for permanent housing.

- 11.2.21. In accordance with government requirements, we maintain a self-build register. As of June 2021 there were 104 individuals and 9 groups on the part 1 Self-Build Register (meets local connection criteria) and 132 individuals and 1 group on the part 2 Self-Build Register (without a local connection). 17 homes were granted self-build exemption from a Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL) in the financial year 2019/20.
- 11.2.22. Whilst self and custom build homes form part of the overall mix of housing, high demand for sites result in high land values making it challenging for self and custom builders to compete against other house builders to acquire available sites. As self and custom build homes are regarded by mortgage lenders as non-standard homes, obtaining a mortgage for these can be challenging and therefore this type of development is more reliant on self-financing.
- 11.2.23. As supported by the London Plan, Houses in Multiple Occupation (HMOs) contribute towards addressing needs. As with all homes, HMOs will be expected to meet high standards of amenity both for the occupiers and neighbours.

Policy H11.3 Housing mix

1. Residential development proposals must contribute to meeting the needs of different households such as families with children, single person households and older people by providing a mix of dwelling sizes, taking account of the following borough level housing mix:

	1 bed	2 bed	3+ bed
Borough wide	33%	33%	34%

2. The borough level housing mix will be applied having regard to relevant factors, including individual site circumstances, site location, identified local needs and economics of provision.

Supporting text

- 11.3.1. Policy H11.3 applies to all residential development proposals, irrespective of tenure type, for self-contained purpose-built flats, maisonettes, and houses. Research in London and in Merton shows that there is an overwhelming need in London and in Merton for all types and sizes of new homes. Like much of London, overcrowding exists in Merton which needs to be eliminated. The 2011 Census indicated that 9.2% of Merton's households are in overcrowded accommodation. Assessment of housing delivery in the borough over the past 15 years indicates a disproportionately greater delivery of smaller homes compared to larger homes.
- 11.3.2. In 2018/19 11% of the new homes built were studio homes; 33% one bedroom, 33% were two bedrooms, 13% three bedrooms; 7% four bedrooms and 3% were unknown.
- 11.3.3. Merton's SHNA sets out the size of housing required by tenure.

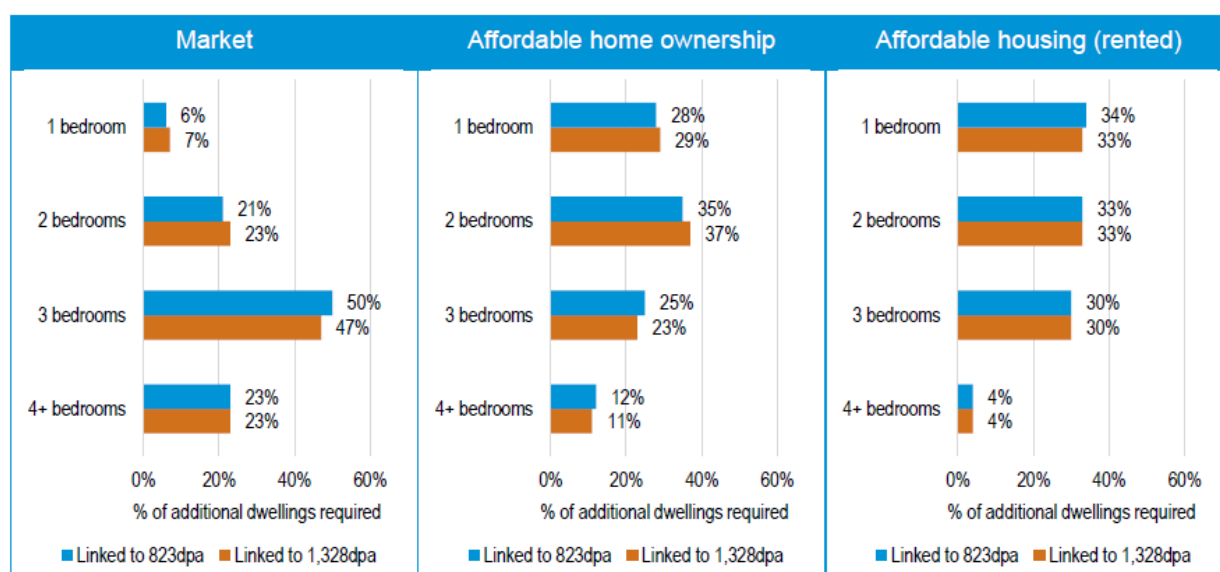


Figure 11.3.1 Size of housing required 2017 – 2035 by tenure

- 11.3.4. It indicates that for affordable housing need is more heavily skewed towards smaller dwellings, and affordable home ownership sits somewhere in between the market and affordable (rented) housing but closer to the affordable rented sector. For market housing the need is skewed more heavily towards three and four bedroomed homes. Studio apartments do not adequately meet the housing needs of most households.
- 11.3.5. Analysis linked to the demographic change in the period to 2035 set out in Merton's SHNA supports the housing mix set out in this Policy H11.3 as an appropriate mix. In the affordable sector it is recognised the role which delivery of family sized homes can play in releasing supply of smaller properties for other households; together with the limited flexibility which one-bedroom properties offer to changing household circumstances which feed through into higher turnover and management issues.
- 11.3.6. Based on Merton's SHNA evidence it is expected that the focus of new market housing provision will be on two and three bedroom properties. Continued demand for family sized housing can be expected from newly forming households. There may also be some demand for medium-sized properties (two and three bedrooms) from older households downsizing and looking to release equity in existing homes, but still retain flexibility for friends and family to come and stay.
- 11.3.7. We are keen to encourage socially mixed, sustainable communities with a greater choice and mix in the size, type and location of housing. Schemes should seek to reflect the diversity of the local population, local needs and provide an appropriate mix of smaller and larger homes including houses and flats to meet a mix of different households such as single households, families with children and older people.
- 11.3.8. In assessing development proposals, we will take account of the housing mix proportions set out above.
- 11.3.9. The borough level housing mix proportions will be applied having regard to relevant factors including individual site circumstances, site location, identified local needs, economics of provision such as financial viability and other planning contributions. Where a developer considers a site unsuitable to apply the borough level housing mix set out in this Policy H 11.3, the developer will be responsible for demonstrating why this is the case. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 (Infrastructure).

Policy H11.4 Supported care housing for vulnerable people or secure residential institutions for people housed as part of the criminal justice system

1. The suitability of proposals for supported care housing will be assessed having regard to the following criteria:
 - a. Meeting an identified local need.
 - b. The proximity of the site to public transport facilities.
 - c. The provision of a safe and secure environment.
 - d. The provision of an adequate level of amenity space which is safe and suitable.
 - e. The provision of adequate parking facilities for residents, staff and visitors.
 - f. The convenience of the site's location in relation to local shops, services and community facilities.
2. Generally, proposals for supported care housing will be expected to provide affordable housing in accordance with Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing Choice, unless nominations for people in housing need can be made available through the council.
3. We will resist development which results in the net loss of supported care housing for vulnerable people or secure residential institutions for people housed as part of the criminal justice system unless either:
 - a. adequate replacement accommodation satisfies criteria H11.4 (1) (a) to (f) inclusive above; or,
 - b. it can be demonstrated there is a surplus of the existing accommodation in the area; or,
 - c. it can be demonstrated that the existing accommodation is incapable of meeting relevant standards for accommodation of this type.
4. Where we are satisfied that the requirements of criterion (3) of this policy have been met, we will require that an equivalent amount of residential floorspace (Use Class C3) be provided to help meet Merton's need for permanent homes. These proposals will be considered in respect to Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing Choice.

Supporting text

- 11.4.1. Policy H11.4 relates to any form of housing if it has been designated for use by vulnerable people or people being housed as part of the criminal justice system (bail / probation hostel) and commonly accommodates residents who get support from designated members of staff. It includes the following forms:
- a. Self-contained homes where vulnerable people, or people being housed as part of the criminal justice system live individually or as part of a family (usually in Use Class C3).
 - b. Shared homes occupied by no more than 6 people (usually in Use Class C3 but where no care is provided on-site some fall within Use Class C4).
 - c. Clusters of self-contained homes or self-contained homes / bedsits within a scheme designated for vulnerable people, where low intensity support is available, sometimes on site (usually in Use Class C3, depending on the nature of the support).
 - d. Hostels for a number of households or individuals. The occupiers are usually linked in terms of circumstances or age group. There is usually a common management regime and some shared facilities. Hostels are outside any use class.
 - e. Care homes and other supported accommodation where care is provided 24 hours a day (usually in Use Class C2).
 - f. Secure residential institutions (usually under Use Class C2A).
- 11.4.2. This Policy H11.4 does not relate to:
- a. Self-contained homes that are suitable to meet general needs.
 - b. Hostel accommodation aimed at other non-vulnerable groups such as students and backpackers; or,
 - c. Other types of accommodation in Use Class C2 but not specifically for vulnerable people, such as hospitals, boarding schools, residential colleges and training centres.
- 11.4.3. Vulnerable people include those with physical and sensory impairment, a disability, drug and alcohol dependency or people who have experienced or are at risk of violence (e.g. domestic or hate crime).
- 11.4.4. Care for the elderly, the vulnerable or disadvantaged groups and for persons with health problems, learning difficulties, mental illness or physical disabilities are becoming increasingly community-based. People are increasingly choosing to live in their own homes with some supported care and assistance, or in supported communities.

- 11.4.5. Client groups living in supported accommodation include older people, homeless people with support needs; people with mental health problems; ex-offenders; people with physical disabilities and sensory impairment; people with learning disabilities; people with alcohol problems or HIV/AIDS, and people experiencing domestic violence or victims of hate crime.
- 11.4.6. A variety of supported care accommodation is required for persons who require different levels of assistance, support or care in order to live independently. We encourage the provision of non-institutionalised supported care housing with self-contained facilities which meet an identified local need. Supported care housing may include sheltered accommodation, extra care housing, and other types of care homes, on-site accommodation for care workers, rehabilitation facilities, crisis response, as well as respite for carers.
- 11.4.7. Generally, supported care housing will be located within easy access to shopping facilities and services in locations with good access to public transport, or with adequate on-site facilities, because of low car ownership and in some instances reduced mobility of the client group. This would be considered on a case-by-case basis having regard to a number of factors including the number of clients, staff and visitors and the likely mobility of the clients. Residential locations may be appropriate. Town or local centres may also provide suitable opportunities for provision, given the proximity of such locations to good public transport and local amenities, but this needs to be balanced against other relevant suitability factors e.g. noise.
- 11.4.8. High quality design can help to provide design solutions (e.g. ramps and levelled changes) that overcome topological issues and provide accommodation that is fit for purpose.
- 11.4.9. Supported care housing should incorporate designed security features that create a safe place to reside where opportunities for criminal behaviour are reduced. Design should consider the principles contained in government guidance on Safer Places Secured by Design guidance and Royal Town Planning Institute (RTPI) Dementia and Town Planning: Creating better environments for people living with dementia and other publications mentioned in the health and wellbeing policies in this plan.
- 11.4.10. Housing sites that have a lower market value than those available for general market housing are rare. To help meet Merton's housing needs as identified in the London Plan, we will resist development that would involve the net loss of residential floorspace.
- 11.4.11. Generally, proposals for supported care housing will be expected to provide affordable housing in accordance with this Local Plan's *Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing Choice*, unless nominations for people in housing need with a reasonable preference on Merton's council housing waiting list, or people in housing need referred by one of our nomination panels for vulnerable people can be made available through the council.
- 11.4.12. Where self-contained housing (e.g. sheltered housing categories 1, 2 and 2.5, and extra care housing) is proposed for occupants to buy, rent or lease we will seek affordable housing in

accordance with *Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing Choice*. By contrast residential care institutions (usually in Use Class C2 / C2A) operate on a fee charging basis, with occupants not given a tenancy, and often moving in and out of these institutions depending on their care needs. Local authorities do refer people to care institutions, via adult social care services rather than from the Housing Register. As such it is unlikely that care institutions will be considered in respect to *Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing Choice* concerning affordable housing provision. However, we will assess all proposals on a case-by-case basis.

- 11.4.13. Proposals must meet local needs identified in a Local Housing Market Assessment or in an appropriate needs assessment such as that of a recognised public body. There is a recognition that the private sector also caters for those in housing need and that this role in partnership with the council is continuing to grow as this sector responds to the falling levels of public expenditure.

Policy H11.5 Student Housing, other housing with shared facilities such as HMOs and bedsits

1. The development of student housing, other housing with shared facilities such as HMOs and bedsits is supported provided that the development:
 - a. will not involve the loss of permanent housing;
 - b. will not compromise capacity to meet the supply of land for additional self-contained homes;
 - c. meets an identified local need;
 - d. is well designed and positively contributes to residential character and amenity, with a high standard of amenity for existing and future users in accordance with NPPF paragraph 130(f);
 - e. and is fully integrated into the residential surroundings.

Additionally, with regards to student housing:

- f. is supported by evidence of a linkage with one or more higher education providers (HEP) in Merton or within a reasonable travelling distance of Merton. This evidence must include confirmation that the proposed rental levels for the student accommodation are supported by the linked HEP(s) and that the majority of the bedrooms in the development including all of the affordable student accommodation will be secured through a nominations agreement for occupation by students of one or more HEP, for the lifetime of the scheme, as required by London Plan Policy H15;
- g. during term-time, it is available exclusively to students;
- h. includes a range of layouts including those with shared facilities;
- i. is located in an area well served by public transport links with the higher education providers (HEP) that the student housing serves;
- j. provides high quality cycle parking facilities;
- k. is operated directly by a higher education provider or has a management arrangement in place from its initial occupation secured in accordance with London Plan Policy H15 by nomination agreement with one or more higher education providers (HEP), which the student housing serves; and,
- l. Ensures that at least 35% of the accommodation is secured as affordable student accommodation or 50% where the development is on public sector land or where redevelopment would result in a loss of industrial capacity as defined through the London Plan

and associated guidance.

2. Where requirements in this policy H11.5 from (f) to (l) inclusive cannot be demonstrated the proposal will be considered under Policy 11.1 Housing Choice in respect of affordable housing provision.
3. We will resist development which results in the net loss of student housing and other housing with shared facilities such as HMOs and bedsits unless either it can be demonstrated that:
 - a. there is a surplus of the existing accommodation in the area; or,
 - b. the existing accommodation is incapable of meeting relevant standards for accommodation of this type or,
 - c. the proposed development would provide permanent residential accommodation.
4. Where we are satisfied that development resulting in the net loss of student housing, other housing with shared facilities such as HMOs or bedsits, is justified, we will require that an equivalent amount of residential floorspace or permanent self-contained housing in Use Class C3 be provided and these proposals will be considered in respect to Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing Choice.

Supporting text

- 11.5.1. This policy relates to student housing and housing with shared facilities and bedsits other than that to which Policy H11.4 applies (supported care housing for vulnerable people or people housed in secure residential institutions as part of the criminal justice system).
- 11.5.2. Students' place of study linked with one or more higher education providers (HEP) include Wimbledon College of Art, Wimbledon which is located within Merton. Additionally, there are several others found wholly or partly within neighbouring south London boroughs which are Kingston University, Roehampton University, St George's Medical School and St Mary's University College Twickenham. Requiring proposals for student accommodation to have ownership or management agreements in place with students' place of study linked with one or more higher education providers (HEP) helps demonstrate there is a need for the proposal and ensure that it supports London Higher Education Providers (HEPs) as defined in London Plan footnote 77.
- 11.5.3. Student accommodation is both a local and strategic issue. The provision of student housing, other housing with shared facilities and bedsits can make a useful contribution to creating mixed and inclusive communities and meeting London's housing need. However, addressing these demands should not compromise the borough's capacity to meet the relatively more pressing need for conventional permanent self-contained homes, affordable homes and family sized homes.

- 11.5.4. Merton is currently meeting its share of London's general housing needs and can demonstrate a 5-year supply of deliverable housing sites. However, Merton is characterised by small sites for delivering new homes, which limits the opportunities to actively promote housing delivery.
- 11.5.5. The need for more housing in the borough and the paucity of sites, particularly large sites, means that the provision of student housing could further worsen the challenge meeting the need for permanent homes.
- 11.5.6. There is an overwhelming need to provide additional conventional housing in Merton. It is considered that set within this challenging context, the requirement for student accommodation to cater for students' place of study linked with one or more higher education providers (HEP) within Merton or neighbouring south London boroughs of Croydon, Lambeth, Kingston-upon-Thames, Richmond, Sutton and Wandsworth strikes a suitable balance towards meeting the Mayor's strategic and local requirements for student housing, whilst minimising the compromise on Merton's capacity for conventional homes. It is also important that the provision of new student accommodation is located close to their places of study, as inadequate provision would result in students having to travel long distances to attend their place of study contrary to sustainable development principles.
- 11.5.7. When considering whether a proposal for student accommodation would compromise capacity to meet the need for conventional dwellings in the borough the council will have regard to the following factors:
- a. whether the proposal would displace C3 residential accommodation;
 - b. whether the proposal site has been allocated for housing;
 - c. whether a site has been identified in the London SHLAA and/or Local Plan housing trajectory as having capacity for conventional housing or
 - d. has an extant or historic planning permission for C3 housing.
- 11.5.8. We consider the most appropriate sites for student accommodation proposals to be well connected locations with good levels of access to public transport (PTAL 4 or higher) including those supported by good walking and cycling infrastructure and where student residents have access to a wide range of services and facilities within a 15-minute walking distance. Such proposals are also supported where the development is capable of having good access to public transport, and facilities as a result of proposed transport improvements. It is considered that applicants should give priority during the site selection process to locations in proximity to the institutions that the development will serve.

- 11.5.9. Housing with shared facilities such as HMOs form a significant part of the private rented stock in Merton. The precise definition of housing with shared facilities and bedsits is complex but includes the following groups:
- a. A bedsit where the bathroom is shared with tenants of other bedsits.
 - b. A flat in a house whether bathroom facilities may or may not be shared with other tenants.
 - c. A room in a shared house such as HMOs where the bathroom and kitchen facilities are shared with the tenants of the other rooms, but the tenants do not live with the other tenants as part of a 'household', for example don't cook for one another and eat together like a family would.
 - d. Rented rooms provided by a resident landlord.
 - e. Bed and breakfast hostels.
- 11.5.10. Student housing, other housing with shared facilities such as HMOs and bedsits are often associated with a concentration of relatively short-term residents. We will assess these having regard to any existing concentrations in the area, the impact of new occupiers on local services and facilities and the wider housing mix. Possible concerns such as noise disturbance and increased demand on local facilities and public transport need to be carefully considered and addressed in relation to these proposals to ensure that adverse impacts on existing longer-term residents are minimised.
- 11.5.11. Schemes will be considered on a scheme-by-scheme basis having regard to census information, Merton's Authority Monitoring Report (AMR) and permissions for student housing schemes in the area.
- 11.5.12. Student housing can positively contribute to mitigating pressure on the stock of private rented homes in Merton provided that it is genuinely aimed at higher education establishments. We will use design mechanisms, planning conditions and / or legal agreements as appropriate to prevent lease, sale, use or occupation of the student accommodation as general market housing and to limit their term time occupation to students registered at higher education establishments that are based in Merton or the adjoining boroughs and supported by the Higher Education Funding Council for England.

Policy H11.6 Accommodation for Gypsies and Travellers

1. Assessment of Need:

- a.** Following adoption of this Local Plan, the council will, as a priority, produce an updated assessment of the need for traveller accommodation using the up-to-date definitions for planning purposes included in the National Planning Policy for Traveller Sites. This assessment may be produced with other local planning authorities and/or the Mayor of London.
- b.** The assessment is to be completed before or during 2025. Should any accommodation needs be identified, this may trigger the need to review this aspect of the Local Plan to inform whether any updates to it would be necessary.

2. Assessment of Proposals:

- a.** Existing legally established Gypsy and Traveller accommodation sites will be retained and protected from redevelopment except where the same number of pitches is provided on an alternative site in the borough.
- b.** Proposals for additional, alternative or new traveller sites will be assessed having regard to the following criteria:
 - i.** The provision of on-site landscaping, which seeks to enhance the amenity of the site and which facilitates the integration of the site with the surrounding environment and amenity of occupiers of adjoining land.
 - ii.** Access, proximity to a main road, parking and area to allow turning and manoeuvring.
 - iii.** Proximity to shops, schools, health services and other community facilities.
 - iv.** Provision of appropriate on-site facilities such as children's play facilities.
 - v.** The suitability of ground conditions, particularly in respect to the potential to flooding. Please also refer to policies contained in Chapter 15 (Green and Blue Infrastructure) including policies F15.7; F15.8 and F15.9.
- 3.** The provision of a high standard of amenity for future occupants of traveller sites particularly in terms of residential amenity, noise and air quality. Please also refer to policies contained in Chapter 12 (Places and Spaces in a Growing Borough) and Chapter 15 (Green and Blue Infrastructure) including policies F15.7 to F15.10.

Supporting text

- 11.6.1. The council's Gypsies and Travellers' site is located on Brickfield Road and is managed by Clarion Housing. Merton's Accommodation Needs Assessment of Gypsies and Travellers Research (2013), indicated that for the period of 2014 - 2019 re-letting of vacant pitches would address identified needs. There are no known Travelling Showpeople residing in Merton and no identified accommodation need for Travelling Showpeople plots within Merton.
- 11.6.2. In 2019 Merton's Gypsy and Traveller Accommodation Assessment (GTAA) was prepared to update the needs identified in the 2013 Study and how this will be addressed over the Local Plan period. The 2019 Study identified future accommodation need for the period 2019-2034 summarised in the following table below:

Table S.1: Summary of Gypsy and Traveller pitch needs 2019-34				
Period	2019-2024	2024-2029	2029-2034	Total
DLP	6	0	0	6
PPTS	0	0	0	0
Work	0	0	0	0

Source: GTAA 2019

DLP = assessment of needs based on the 2017 Draft London Plan definition, now out of date and replaced by 2021 London Plan

PPTS = assessment of need in Merton based on government's 2015 Planning Policy for Travellers

Work = assessment of needs in Merton based on travellers working in Merton (still in date)

- 11.6.3. The 2019 Study identified that in relation to Gypsies and Travellers, the main drivers of need, based upon the then 2017 Draft London Plan definition (DLP), were from 'hidden' (or 'concealed' families) and psychological aversion of households living in bricks and mortar accommodation.
- 11.6.4. With the exception of the 2017 Draft London Plan (DLP) based need within the first five years, the accommodation need arising over the 15 years is all counterbalanced by additional supply emerging over the 15 years (including vacant pitches and pitches becoming vacant over time). With the exception of the need of 6 based on the 2017 Draft London Plan definition, there is no additional need for the local authority to address.
- 11.6.5. The 2019 Study identified no known Travelling Showpeople residing in Merton and as such no need for plots within the borough for them. For transit provision it recommended that a corporate policy be established to address negotiated stopping

places for small scale transient encampments, and that it continues to work with local authorities across the sub-region to provide new transit provision.

- 11.6.6. The 2019 Study findings identified the need for 6 additional pitches in Merton, which were assessed to fall outside of the planning definition of travellers included in the version of PPTS in place at the time of its publication. However, the government made changes to the planning definition of these terms in December 2023, and as a result, the needs assessment will now need to be updated to take this into account. In line with Policy H11.6, the production of an up-to-date assessment will be a priority action for the council and will inform monitoring and review activity of the Plan in line with Policy M17.1 and the 2023 NPPF (paragraph 33). The council will consider the impact on the Local Plan of the Mayor of London's Gypsy and Traveller Accommodation Needs Assessment which is scheduled for publication in 2024 and any further locally specific assessment that may be required as a result of Policy H11.6. In advance of the production of a refreshed needs assessment, and in the context of the needs identified in the 2019 GTAA, Policy H11.6 provides a positively prepared basis for the assessment of proposals, and applies to all travellers regardless of whether they meet the PPTS definition or not.
- 11.6.7. The extent of provision of appropriate on-site facilities will be determined on a site-by-site basis proportionate to the size of the proposed site to ensure that any extra provision meets their needs and takes account of the size of the site and the needs and demographics of the families' resident on them.

Policy H11.7 Build to rent

1. Built to Rent schemes must provide:
 - a. A minimum of 50 homes.
 - b. A mix of housing sizes to reflect local need for rented property.
 - c. Up to three-year tenancies with longer tenancies (three years or more) being available to all tenants. Tenancies should have a six-month break clause in the tenants' favour and pre-agreed structured and limited in-tenancy rent increases.
 - d. Homes secured as Build to Rent under a covenant for a minimum period of 15 years.
 - e. Security and professional management of the homes.
2. Development of Build to Rent schemes must meet the requirements of London Plan Policy H11 and the Mayor of London's Affordable Housing and Viability SPG (2017), with the intention of maximising the viable supply of affordable homes (known as the affordable housing requirement). In Merton, Build to Rent schemes must meet the following affordable housing requirements:
3. To follow the Fast-Track Route, Build to Rent schemes must deliver a minimum of 35% affordable housing provision or 50% where the development is on public sector land or where redevelopment would result in a loss of industrial capacity, comprising of a tenure of at least 30% affordable housing provision at London Living rent equivalent level with the remainder at a range of genuinely affordable rents to meet priority housing need in Merton. If these requirements are not met, the scheme must follow the Viability Tested Route.
4. All affordable housing elements of the scheme must be affordable in perpetuity and secured via planning obligation or any other appropriate mechanism.
5. Those proposing Build to Rent schemes are encouraged to work with the council in order to make proposed affordable housing available for households on the council's housing list.
6. A clawback mechanism must be in place that ensures that where any of the Build to Rent homes are sold within the 15 years this will trigger a penalty charge towards affordable housing provision in accordance with Policy H11.7(3)
7. Where the requirements of H11.7(3) above are not met, schemes must follow the Viability Tested Route requirements set out in London Plan Policy H5 and The Mayor of London's Affordable Housing and Viability SPG (2017). Viability Assessments should include taking account of the differences between development value of the Build to Rent scheme and Build for Sale scheme and be undertaken in line with the Mayor of London's Affordable Housing and Viability SPG (2017).

Supporting text

- 11.7.1. Build to Rent schemes contribute to increasing the range and offer of homes available to Londoners which is supported. Build to Rent schemes must provide at least 50 homes in accordance with the requirements of London Plan Policy H11.
- 11.7.2. Build to Rent schemes may be attractive to potential tenants given the longer tenancies and on-site maintenance teams. However, these unique features of Build to Rent can result in higher than average rental costs, worsening an already critical issue for many renters, especially in London.
- 11.7.3. Given the borough's limited land availability and the significant need for more housing, and in particular the pressing need for affordable housing that genuinely addresses those in housing need in Merton, we support the incentives and approach set out in London Plan Policy H11 to encourage affordable housing provision as part of Build to Rent schemes.
- 11.7.4. A clawback mechanism will be applied in accordance with London Plan policy and national Planning Practice Guidance (PPG) on Build to Rent to protect the value of affordable housing provision that is withdrawn if housing units in Build to Rent blocks are converted to another tenure after the expiry of the covenant period.



Chapter 12. Places and spaces in a growing borough

Introduction

12.1 How our streets, town centres, public spaces and neighbourhoods look, feel and function is important for our sense of wellbeing and safety. Merton is made up of a number of distinct and diverse places that collectively form the unique character and identity of Merton.

12.2 The need to deliver more than 10,000 homes in Merton by 2037/38 does not outweigh the need for developments to be design-led. The council will require all development to be of the highest design quality and contribute to Merton's long-term economic prosperity, quality of life and a net-zero carbon future.

12.3 The policies in this chapter aim to ensure that all future development is well-designed, functional and contributes positively to the borough.

Strategic Policy D12.1 Delivering well-designed and resilient neighbourhoods

1. Developments in the borough are required to meet the highest standards of design, function and construction and help contribute to a net-zero carbon and climate-resilient future. They must respect and positively respond to their context, townscape, landscape and public realm to strengthen Merton's character. Successful neighbourhoods are much more than just buildings. Historic environments, mature vegetation and existing communities all contribute to successful places, and as such must be considered when designing. Delivering sustainable neighbourhoods is as important as delivering the homes themselves.
2. To achieve this, development will be supported if it:
 - a. Is designed according to well established principles of good design as referred to in the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) and practice guidance, development plan policies and has regard to policy guidance.
 - b. Champions sustainable design and construction principles, in order to minimise greenhouse gas emissions by considering energy efficiency, re-use of materials and buildings, waste and water management, biodiversity and the use of low carbon and renewable energy sources early in the design process, as set out in policies elsewhere in this plan. Development should be fully adaptable and resilient to the impacts of a changing climate, including overheating, flooding, water shortages/drought and subsidence, and will not exacerbate any climate change impacts elsewhere.
 - c. Encourages and enables sustainable and healthy lifestyle choices through effective public realm that facilitates active modes of transport, as set out in the chapters on Health and Wellbeing and Transport.
 - d. Ensures that the site of the development is appropriate for its proposed function and use through the analysis of site constraints such as air quality, noise pollution, land contamination, flooding (from all sources) and daylight and sunlight.
 - e. Seeks to appropriately engage with the local communities and stakeholders and that the design has been informed by this, as set out in the London Plan, Policy GG1.
 - f. Enhances social cohesion and mental and physical wellbeing and supports the needs of all of Merton's communities through creating sustainable buildings, spaces and environments that are well-managed, accessible, inclusive, child friendly and intergenerational in line with the chapter on Health and Wellbeing.
 - g. Conserves and enhances Merton's Heritage Assets and distinctive character.

h. Is well-designed, from the large scale to the detailed level, being well thought out internally and considers essential practical details early on in the process so they do not undermine quality or cost more at the construction stage.

Supporting text

- 12.1.1. The character, distinctiveness and viability of a successful area often lie in the quality of its built environment and public realm. High quality design of buildings, places and spaces can create a high quality and attractive environment which sets a positive context for the development of successful places and sustainable communities. To help deliver the principles of good design throughout the borough, Merton Council has produced a variety of Supplementary Planning Documents that provide good practice approaches to design, such as Merton's Borough Character Study, Conservation Area character appraisals and Small Sites Toolkit.
- 12.1.2. Similar to Merton's Supplementary Planning Documents, many statutory bodies, such as the Greater London Authority, Historic England and Sport England produce policy guidance, such as the London Plan guidance and Good Practice Advice notes. These provide detailed guidance and advice on a wide range of issues that support the implementation of relevant legislation and national and regional planning policy. These guidance documents can help inform the design of development proposals.
- 12.1.3. Designing with sustainable construction principles from the start can help minimise costly changes later on in the process. Buildings that are designed with sustainability at the fore can also be more cost effective in their operation and their delivery.
- 12.1.4. Principles of good urban design are not just applicable to the quality of individual buildings, but to the arrangement of buildings and public spaces in their environment, how they relate to their context, the spaces they create and also to the way an area functions. These principles need to be applied not just to the physical appearance of a building, but also to its functions and the way it relates to the surrounding area and wider public realm. Good urban design creates buildings and environments that are long lasting and strengthen communities.
- 12.1.5. Development in the borough must consider all sections of the community, in particular disabled people. An inclusive environment is one which can be used safely, easily and with dignity by all. It is convenient and welcoming with no disabling barriers, and provides independent access without added undue effort, separation or special treatment for any group of people as set out in the chapter Health and Wellbeing.
- 12.1.6. Development should pro-actively plan for health and wellbeing through sport and activity. Developers should consider following Sport England and Public Health England's Active Design 10 principles, guides and checklist to help ensure their development's layout and design helps to promote active lifestyles.

- 12.1.7. The creation of high quality buildings and places is fundamental to what the planning and development process should achieve. Good design is a key aspect of sustainable development, resulting in better places in which to live and work.
- 12.1.8. The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF), provides national policy guidance on design. This policy is a strategic policy, produced in accordance with para 20.d) of the NPPF. It looks to create sustainable neighbourhoods that will last well beyond the plan period and not require future public or private sector intervention to address future strategic or structural issues.
- 12.1.9. The production of design guides and codes can provide maximum clarity about design expectations at an early stage and should be consistent with the principles set out in the National Design Guide and National Model Design Code. This is highlighted in the NPPF para 128 and 129.
- 12.1.10. The draft NPPF states that good design is a fundamental part of the purpose of the planning and development process; and that plans should set out clearly the council's design vision and expectations. More specifically, the NPPF (para 130) states that planning policies and decisions should ensure that developments:
- Will function well and add to the overall quality of the area, not just for the short term but over the lifetime of the development, taking into account the impacts of climate change;
 - Are visually attractive as a result of good architecture, layout and appropriate and effective landscaping;
 - Are sympathetic to local character and history, including the surrounding built environment and landscape setting, while not preventing or discouraging appropriate innovation or change (such as increased densities);
 - Establish or maintain a strong sense of place, using the arrangement of streets, spaces, building types and materials to create attractive, welcoming and distinctive places to live, work and visit;
 - Optimise the potential of the site to accommodate and sustain an appropriate amount and mix of development (including green and other public space) and support local facilities and transport networks; and
 - Create places that are safe, inclusive and accessible and which promote health and well-being, with a high standard of amenity for existing and future users; and where crime and disorder, and the fear of crime, do not undermine the quality of life or community cohesion and resilience.

- 12.1.11. Merton's target of becoming a carbon neutral borough by 2050, as set out in Merton's Climate Strategy and Action Plan, means that future development must contribute to achieving this target.

Policy D12.2 Urban design

1. Successful places are about people. The spaces between buildings are as important as the buildings themselves. Developments (small and large) must be based on sound and established principles of good urban design. Well-designed places create a strong sense of community and improve the social and emotional wellbeing of those who use it and ensure local resilience to the impacts of climate change such as flooding (from all sources), overheating and subsidence. This policy drives for the creation of inclusive, sustainable, efficient and high quality design and layout of the urban and suburban environment found in Merton.

2. To achieve this, development will be required to:

Shaping places

- a. Be of the highest standard and take into account the most up to date and relevant national guidance and London Plan and council policies and guidance.
- b. Have an appropriate street level presence and roofscape that creates a positive relationship to neighbouring buildings and spaces, enhances the townscape and landscape of the area and is informed by bespoke analysis of the site context, including the area's character, identity and topography.
- c. Ensure that the form and layout of new development is street-based with clearly identifiable publicly accessible streets and spaces, defined by buildings that actively front the street, which maximise the number of entrances onto the street and create defensible space and facilitate natural surveillance.
- d. Ensure that scale, height, mass, bulk and form in its site and context is appropriate and has explored its visual impact from short, mid and longer views where applicable.
- e. If proposing changes to the highway and/or public realm, be designed according to best practice, minimising clutter and, depending on their scale and impact, may be subject to a design review process. Proposals should include sustainable drainage measures (SUDS), urban greening features and tree planting where possible and appropriate.
- f. Be economically and socially sustainable, by offering variety and choice, and by being able to adapt to changing climatic, social, technological and economic conditions minimising the need for future remedial intervention.
- g. Consider the maintenance and enhancement of views, panoramas and prospects and their settings and, where appropriate, create new views.

- h.** If located in Town Centres, high streets and other shopping areas: interact positively with the public realm by creating active and attractive frontages that promote natural surveillance through visibility between the street and the interior of the building. Street frontages should not create dead frontage through lack of windows or provision of advertising, shelves or screening which prevents easy visibility between the ground floor and the street.
- i.** Positively contribute to the amenity of designated open space or Metropolitan Open Land that is in close proximity, if applicable.
- j.** Achieve high quality design from the outset and is not undermined by variations that individually or collectively devalue design quality, particularly those variations that are sought after the grant of planning permission.
- k.** Consider on sites within Town Centre boundaries, the benefits of temporary uses before and during construction stages.
- l.** Support the council's vision for a net-zero carbon and climate-resilient future by taking a sustainable approach to design and delivery in line with the chapter on Climate Change.

Public realm

- m.** Ensure it is accessible, inclusive, child friendly and intergenerational. It must enable an active lifestyle by designing walkable and attractive public realm and encouraging active modes of transport in line with the chapters on Health and Wellbeing and Sustainable Travel.
- n.** Contribute to a safe, attractive, uncluttered, co-ordinated public realm that enhances the site's setting and connection with the surrounding neighbourhood.
- o.** Prioritise pedestrians and cyclists and encourage greater walking and cycling for all around the area.
- p.** Use permeable paving, good-quality construction materials, appropriate tree planting (including shrubs) and landscape design which responds positively to the character of the area and is easy to maintain.
- q.** At the earliest stage of planning the public realm, and depending on the location, scale and setting of the development proposed, actively consider measures such as designing out crime, anti-terrorism, dementia friendliness, green and blue infrastructure and features to manage flood risk.
- r.** Consider the benefits of inclusive and diverse site specific temporary and long-term public art works that enhance local character and develop a sense of place.

- s.** Consider the management of the public realm to provide access needs of all of Merton's communities, including the particular needs of people with disabilities.
- t.** Ensure that car parking is provided in accordance with the London Plan maximum standards and does not dominate the street or provide a barrier to walking or cycling or enjoying space safely.
- u.** Ensure that any proposed public realm is well-managed and maintained. Maintenance and management arrangements will be secured through planning obligations.

Sustainable neighbourhoods

- v.** Consider the orientation and form of buildings to inform their energy performance early in the design process.
- w.** Mitigate the risk of flooding, subsidence, overheating and adverse impacts on the urban heat island, through appropriate design, orientation, layout, materials and use of green and blue infrastructure.
- x.** Maximise the opportunity to increase green infrastructure through urban greening such as mature trees and vegetation and demonstrate that appropriate measures have been taken to protect and enhance the natural environment to strengthen the green infrastructure of the borough in accordance with the chapter on 'Green and Blue Infrastructure'.

Supporting text

Good urban design

- 12.2.1. As recognised in Policy D3 of the London Plan, developments must take a design-led approach that responds to a site's context and capacity for growth, and existing and planned supporting infrastructure capacity. Merton's Borough Character Study provides an analysis of character borough wide and should be used to supplement bespoke site analysis.
- 12.2.2. Building places based on sound and established principles of good urban design is a fundamental element of successful place-making. It is a holistic approach to the physical arrangement of our environment. It encompasses issues of layout, land use, security, economic development, regeneration, community and social life and the general appearance and attractiveness of places. It is also key to achieving the sustainability of our environments by building places that have inherent longevity and an ability to adapt to changing circumstances inexpensively.

- 12.2.3. It is important that our urban environments are inclusive, publicly accessible, inviting and easy to understand. This is the form of most of our urban townscape and what works best. It enables places to function efficiently and adapt well to change over time. Changing poor design in the future almost always requires huge upheaval and public expense. Places that work well tend to look after themselves and adapt gradually over time.
- 12.2.4. The basis for this urban environment is the traditional street, which can accommodate all types of use in a flexible manner. This is recognised in Policy D3 of the London Plan, which states that the form and layout of a place should be street-based with clearly defined public and private environments. A street has a number of essential characteristics. It primarily has a movement function which can be adapted for use by a range of different modes; it is therefore predominantly linear in character and should be designed to indicate that it links one place to another as part of a wider network of streets.
- 12.2.5. The design of new buildings, particularly tall buildings, on sites in close proximity to designated open spaces and MOL needs to consider the amenity, quality and use of the open space. People use open spaces for a variety of reasons including exercise, play, socialising and relaxing and the visual amenity provided by these open spaces holds a lot of public value. Development in these locations should not have an undue harm to the amenity of the open space and the council may require a Visual Impact Assessment to be undertaken and provided as part of a planning application, if deemed necessary to assess the impact. See policy D12.6 for further details on tall buildings.
- 12.2.6. Sustainable design principles will help Merton achieve the target of a net-zero carbon by 2050. Developments that think about sustainability early in the design process can often avoid significant and costly changes that may occur later in the process. See the chapter on Climate Change for more details.

Public realm

- 12.2.7. A vital part of how we perceive our environment comes from the design, layout and appearance of our streets and spaces – the public realm. New, larger developments create new streets and spaces. Smaller, individual developments affect the appearance and perception of the existing public realm. Careful urban design consideration needs to be given to the impacts on the public realm by all development, from small scale safety and parking schemes to major town centre enhancement projects.
- 12.2.8. Local streets can take on a stronger ‘place’ character. Streets are physically defined by the buildings that front them and it is therefore important that they do so in a way that reinforces their linear form. Streets are, and should be, public places. The fronts of buildings and their main access points should be directly from the street. This creates a layout that defines the street as a public place and the land further to the rear more private.

- 12.2.9. The council will seek to improve the quality of street furniture, lighting, landscape treatments, surfacing materials and signage in the borough either as part of the development of sites or through environmental improvement schemes.
- 12.2.10. Transport for London's (TfL) Healthy Streets Approach provides information and guidance on how best to prioritise walking and cycling.
- 12.2.11. The existence of poor public realm should be no justification for average or mediocre proposals for the public realm. The NPPF states that it is important to plan positively for the achievement of high quality and inclusive design for all development including individual buildings, public and private spaces and wider area development schemes. Developments are expected to ensure the establishment of a strong sense of place, using streetscapes and buildings to create attractive and comfortable places to live, work and visit.
- 12.2.12. As recognised in Policy D8 in the London Plan, the public realm can encourage active travel and ensure its design discourages travel by car and excessive on-street parking, which can obstruct people's safe enjoyment of the space.
- 12.2.13. During construction, the public realm may temporarily be affected as agreed with the council. However, it is unacceptable for development work to permanently damage the public realm, including roads, footways and other infrastructural items. During construction, measures to protect the public realm must be taken. Section 133 of the Highways Act 1980, amended by Section 6 of the London Local Authorities and Transport for London Act 2013, allows councils to make good any damage caused by works on land adjacent to a publicly maintainable footpath or highway and recover the expenses incurred from the landowner, the person carrying out the works or the person on whose behalf the works were carried out. The council may require photographs to be provided by the site owner to prove the condition of the public realm prior to work commencing.
- 12.2.14. The long-term maintenance and management of public realm should be considered from the start of the design process.

Defensible space

- 12.2.15. Well-designed streets feel safe if they have 'natural surveillance' and an appropriate transition from public street to private building – or 'defensible space'. Natural surveillance is created by ensuring there is an appropriate and complementary mix of uses, particularly at ground floor; by maximising the number of entrances and having clear views between the interior of non-residential buildings and the street – rather than being obscured by blinds, shutters or internal advertising.
- 12.2.16. Defensible space is important in providing a clear buffer between public and private realm. This helps create a sense of security for residents and can deter opportunistic crime. Defensible space allows for a graduation from public and private by means of landscaped

amenity or garden space. This can be effectively utilised for facilities such as bin and cycle storage. Clear boundary treatments such as hedges, walls and railings are important in providing effective defensible spaces. For residential areas natural surveillance is best created by maximising entrances and having good views from habitable rooms directly from the dwelling into the street.

Safety and security

12.2.17. Well-designed places feel safe because they have built-in natural surveillance through the design of buildings and spaces, as well as having complementary mixes of uses and activities. Places that work well and look good also help engender a sense of belonging and local pride, which in itself encourages community participation and helps keep a place safe. Excessive and overt manifestations of security features often have the opposite effect.

Gated development

12.2.18. An example of this is gated developments which may address security concerns, however they restrict public access and therefore choice. This is considered divisive as it reduces social, visual and physical permeability and actively works against engendering community and social cohesion. It is therefore likely that most types of gated developments will be contrary to this policy and are therefore discouraged by the council.

Policy D12.3 Ensuring high quality design for all developments

1. Whether the development is for businesses, community services or homes, all buildings in Merton must be of high quality. They must consider their impact on the environment, how people experience the development and how the development responds to its context.
2. All planning applications must be accompanied by a Design and Access Statement (DAS) to demonstrate how the design has developed and to justify an applicant's design decisions.
3. Proposals for all development will be required to:

Responding to context

- a. Take a design-led approach that responds positively to the site's context and character.
- b. Ensure that the proposed uses are appropriate for the site and are not located in locations that could have adverse effects on the physical and mental wellbeing of its users.
- c. Enhance local distinctiveness by responding positively to the siting, rhythm, scale, density, proportions, height, materials and massing of surrounding buildings and existing street patterns, historic context, urban layout and landscape features of the surrounding area.
- d. Demonstrate they do not unduly prejudice development opportunities on neighbouring sites, including across borough boundaries.
- e. Ensure that the landscape forms an integral part of any new development where appropriate.
- f. If located on a backland site, be subservient in scale, massing and bulk to its host where applicable.

People focussed

- g. Demonstrate that impacts of proposals in terms of noise, vibrations, odour and/or pollution are minimised, and that acceptable light, privacy and outlook would be available to existing and future occupants of the proposed development and its surroundings so that a high standard of amenity is provided.
- h. Ensure the highest practical standards of access and inclusion and be accessible to people with disabilities. In residential developments, provide a mix of tenure and unit types with at least 10% of homes that meet Building Regulation Requirement M4(3) for 'wheelchair user dwellings' and all other dwellings meeting Building Regulations Requirement M4(2) 'accessible and adaptable dwellings' as set out in London Plan Policy D7 'Accessible Housing'

- i. Ensure that the design and management of shared spaces, such as lobbies, corridors and communal amenity, have a positive impact on physical and mental wellbeing through good quality design.
- j. In residential developments, provide a minimum finished floor to ceiling height of 2.5m for at least 75% of the Gross Internal Area.

Fit for purpose

- k. Provide layouts that are safe, secure and take account of crime prevention and are developed in accordance with Secured by Design principles.
- l. Provide outdoor amenity space that meets, or exceeds, the standards set out in the London Plan and, is efficiently laid out and is compatible with the character of surrounding areas. In exceptional circumstances where it is not possible to meet the minimum private amenity standards, the remainder should be supplied in the form of communal amenity space.
- m. Meet, or exceed, the minimum space standards set out in the London Plan, or appropriate space standards, and are of functional size and proportions demonstrating efficient layouts.
- n. Ensure that materials used in their construction are well-detailed, safe and robust.
- o. Ensure that the traffic and construction activity do not adversely impact or cause significant inconvenience in the day to day lives of those living and working nearby, and do not harm road safety or significantly increase traffic congestion.
- p. Where developments propose houses and/or ground floor maisonettes/duplex units, a minimum area of 50m² as a single useable regular shaped private amenity space is required. Flexibility may be applied where applicants can demonstrate the site is constrained.
- q. Improve biodiversity levels and minimise water run-off. If providing car parking on forecourts and front gardens, applicants must maximise the amount of soft landscaping, use permeable materials and incorporate sustainable drainage measures, using a landscape-led approach to design and not be detrimental to the character of the street or highway safety.
- r. Provide well-designed cycle parking in accordance with London Plan minimum standards that is well integrated with the overall design approach of the development and does not negatively impact on the primary street elevation.

- s. Where cycle and refuse storage is located in front gardens and forecourts, storage units must demonstrate that they are of an appropriate scale and bulk and are located to minimise their visual impact on the street-scene and do not negatively impact the quality of amenity spaces.
- t. Ensure that the design and management of facilities for recycling, storage and disposal of household waste provides for efficient and effective waste collection and is considered as part of the overall design approach and does not adversely affect the primary building function, appearance of the building and character of the street.
- u. Ensure refuse facilities are convenient, allowing bins to be manoeuvred easily and include sufficient capacity to accommodate increased recycling requirements. Refuse bins should not obstruct footways, so for sites with restricted access, suitable hardstanding should be provided for bins to be relocated to on collection days. The council will support underground waste collection systems for major redevelopment schemes where proposed systems are accepted by the council's appointed waste contractor and do not compromise highway safety.

Tackling the climate emergency

- v. Incorporate sustainable design principles early in the design process to make effective use of resources and materials, and minimise water use and CO2 emissions during the construction and operation of the development as set out in the chapter on Climate Change.
- w. Ensure resilience to the impacts of climate change by mitigating the risk of flooding, subsidence, overheating and adverse impacts on the urban heat island, through appropriate design, orientation, layout, materials and use of green and blue infrastructure as set out in the chapter on Green and Blue Infrastructure.
- x. Mitigate overheating through good design, such as orientation, shading, high-albedo materials, fenestration, insulation, appropriate ventilation systems and the provision of green infrastructure.
- y. In residential developments, maximise the provision of dual aspect homes. Single aspect homes are strongly discouraged and will only be accepted where they demonstrate they have adequate passive ventilation, daylight and privacy and avoid overheating and are necessary to optimise site capacity through a design-led approach, in line with the London Plan.
- z. Minimise construction waste and promote sustainable management of construction waste on-site by managing each type of waste as high up the waste hierarchy as practically possible as set out in the chapter on waste management in this plan.

- aa.** Provide appropriate energy efficient external lighting that provides safe and secure environments while not causing light pollution that adversely affects neighbouring occupiers or biodiversity.
- bb.** Conserve and enhance the natural environment, particularly in relation to biodiversity, wildlife habitats and gardens as set out in the chapter on Green and Blue Infrastructure.
- cc.** In addition to Tree Preservation Orders, retain and protect mature trees and vegetation where applicable as set out in the chapter on Green and Blue Infrastructure.

Supporting text

High quality design

- 12.3.1. London Plan guidance and Merton supplementary planning documents set out best practice design approaches to development and should be used to inform the design process.
- 12.3.2. Design and Access Statements (DAS) are short reports that accompanies a planning application. They must explain the design principles and concepts that have informed the development and also demonstrate how the development's context has influenced the design. The level of detail in a DAS should be proportionate to the scale and type of the application. Merton's Small Sites Toolkit SPD contains a DAS template that applicants may use to assist applications on small sites.
- 12.3.3. Amenity refers to the elements of a location or neighbourhood that helps make it attractive or enjoyable for residents and visitors. Residential amenity refers to the elements that are particularly relevant to the living conditions of a home, such as privacy, outlook, natural light and other environmental factors in both indoor and outdoor spaces. Proposals are expected to demonstrate how the development provides a high standard of amenity and that they will not have an undue impact on existing neighbouring amenity.
- 12.3.4. Neighbouring sites are considered as sites that are adjacent, adjoining or in close proximity to the proposed site where the development is likely to have an impact. Site layout, building orientation, location of uses and materials should be considered early in the design process to mitigate and minimise potential issues. The DAS should provide an adequate amount of evidence to demonstrate this using 3D representations and drawings. Technical assessments may be required and should be carried out by a suitably qualified consultant.
- 12.3.5. Well sized and proportioned rooms contribute to designing successful homes. Housing developments should consider accommodating Building Regulations Approved Document Part M, Appendix D: Furniture Schedule in their layouts. To ensure homes are accessible to everyone regardless of their mobility or age, housing developments should also be step

free, accessible and adaptable in line with London Plan Policy D7 “accessible housing” and Approved Document M; flexibility may apply within blocks of 4 storeys or less in certain exceptional circumstances as outlined in London Plan Policy D7.

- 12.3.6. The council will expect development to promote or reinforce local distinctiveness and encourage high quality innovative, contemporary and sustainable design. Development proposals will be welcomed that respect the character of the wider area and reinforce a “sense of place” by recognising the local distinctiveness of areas.
- 12.3.7. What defines a site and area’s characteristics should be set out in each individual proposal by means of a bespoke analysis. This should form part of the Design and Access Statement where one is required, but a similar analysis will be required for smaller developments as well. The analysis should identify positive aspects of local character and how this will be used to inform the design of the proposal.
- 12.3.8. Merton’s Borough Character Study, Conservation Area appraisals and Management Plans, Masterplans, site specific Local Plans and other available existing analysis should be used to inform the design of the proposal. Applications and Design and Access Statements should demonstrate how this has been done.
- 12.3.9. Landscaping proposals can be key to knitting buildings, streets and spaces together and should be planned from the start. However, it is not a substitute for good building design and site layout. A poor design cannot be held together by attractive landscaping that does not perform an appropriate landscape function. Landscape design should support principles of good urban design such as natural surveillance, defensible space and community engagement.
- 12.3.10. Historically, planning guidance has provided clear parameters on separation distances from habitable rooms of neighbouring properties. Adhering rigidly to these parameters can lead to an arrangement of buildings that do not reflect the character of the neighbourhoods where they are located, such as more urban settings or tighter mews settings. As such, separation distances used must demonstrate they provide adequate privacy for occupiers and ensure they provide good levels of daylight into the dwellings.
- 12.3.11. TfL’s London Cycle Design Standards and LTN1/20 Cycle Infrastructure Design provides guidance for the design of dedicated cycle infrastructure.
- 12.3.12. Communal amenity should be multifunctional; designed for playing, socialising and relaxing and if outdoors, be green and biodiverse. It should provide sufficient space to meet the requirements of the number of residents and be inviting and easily accessible for its intended users. There may be cases where the optimisation of sites may impact the quantum of communal amenity achievable. This will be considered on a case-by-case basis. Flexibility may be applied if developers successfully demonstrate that the amount of amenity space provided is acceptable, taking into account factors such as the character of the area, access to public open spaces and the quantity and quality of private amenity spaces. In these cases, the quality of any communal space will need to be high.

Gardens and internal space standards

- 12.3.13. The council will assess planning applications based on the London Plan to set the internal space standards for new homes, hostels, hotels and other residential accommodation. This includes the standards required for a proportion of units to be wheelchair accessible.
- 12.3.14. For all new houses, the council will seek a minimum garden area of 50 sqm as a single usable regular shaped amenity space. This requirement may be applied flexibly for higher density developments or constrained sites but this would have to be fully justified in the planning application. For flatted dwellings, a minimum of 5sqm of private outdoor space should be provided for 1-2 person flatted dwellings and an extra 1 sqm space should be provided for each additional occupant.
- 12.3.15. Meeting space standards alone does not ensure a design is high quality or fit for purpose. Regular shaped layouts are likely to be most efficient and these are the basis of minimum space standards. Irregular and awkward shaped spaces are likely to be inefficient in their use of space and may severely limit a room's usability and fitness for purpose, despite meeting or even exceeding space standards. This is made clear in the London Plan Policy D6.
- 12.3.16. External amenity space is an important element in achieving high quality design and pleasant and attractive places to live. Policy D6 of the London Plan prescribes minimum standards for private amenity space for flats.
- 12.3.17. External amenity space of all kinds must also be fit for purpose, have sufficient privacy, preferably be of a regular shape and receive as much as daylight and sunlight as possible. Communal amenity space provides breathing space between buildings and an opportunity for neighbours to meet and socialise.
- 12.3.18. Proposals to park in front gardens should use Merton's Vehicle Crossover Information Pack that sets out the required measurements criteria and requirement to use permeable materials and soft landscape to provide adequate drainage.

Refuse and storage facilities

- 12.3.19. New development must provide appropriate, well-managed and easy to access storage and refuse facilities that integrate with the adjoining public realm. To help alleviate servicing concerns developers are required to provide storage and collection solutions, which are safe, attractive and well-designed and to reduce delivery and collection movements.
- 12.3.20. Merton's Waste and Recycling Storage Requirements sets out guidance on the siting and design of waste and recycling facilities so that waste collection services in Merton can efficiently collect and dispose of household and other waste and recycling.

- 12.3.21. Developments that face onto streets greatly contribute to the character of a place. Maximising active street frontages provide more opportunity for natural surveillance and animation facing onto the street. Bicycle, refuse and other back of house uses must consider how they address the street to positively contribute to its character.
- 12.3.22. Refuse and bicycle stores in front gardens are becoming a popular solution to store bins and bicycles and provide easier access to bicycle use and help organise bins. It is crucial that these structures do not have a significant impact on the street scene, and as such must be located appropriately in the front garden.
- 12.3.23. Storage structures should be designed in sensitive materials and be the minimum size necessary to reasonably accommodate bicycles and bins. They also provide an opportunity to contribute positively to biodiversity levels with the use of small green roof.
- 12.3.24. It is difficult to modify a building post design; therefore, it is essential that this process is undertaken at an early design stage. Similarly, development should not rely on the public highway for this purpose. Where potential overspill can reasonably be anticipated the council will introduce parking and loading controls to manage kerb space.
- 12.3.25. With the on-going push to increase recycling rates and minimise the amount of household waste going to landfill sites, bi-weekly collection of bins and a variety of other bins, bags and boxes for recycling present households with a number of problems in accommodating these requirements. These include providing sufficient off-street storage and ensuring that bins are accessible and do not obstruct footways, especially for people with health difficulties, including mobility, sensory and mental health problems that make it difficult to navigate obstacles. Blocking accesses or carriageways on collection days will cause major problems.

Safety

- 12.3.26. Personal safety and security are important concerns for people in the borough. It is therefore important that the design of development must take account of these requirements, by providing well-designed public areas and routes and facilitating the natural surveillance of the public realm from adjacent buildings.

Lighting

- 12.3.27. Good quality lighting at its basic level is required to provide an appropriate level of safety and security. Beyond this, lighting has a legitimate role to play as a part of landscape design and influencing the character of the public realm. Lighting can contribute towards improving the safety and security of areas. Careful consideration is needed to ensure that places and spaces are appropriately lit and there is an appropriate balance between issues of safety and security and reducing light pollution. Lighting can extend the hours of use of outdoor sporting facilities, especially in the winter months, and can be used to advertise or exhibit particular buildings, landscapes or features. Innovative lighting

solutions will be encouraged that maintain a basic safety function, relate well to the function of the street and space and take into account the needs of people with different visual acuity.

- 12.3.28. However, inappropriate and unnecessary lighting or lighting which is insensitively used can adversely affect amenity in terms of light pollution to neighbouring occupiers and to the night sky. When considering light proposals the council will seek to ensure that levels of illumination are controlled by conditions.

Species, habitats and landscape

- 12.3.29. Developments should not cause significant adverse impacts on species, habitats and landscape. Back gardens are an important element in the borough's wildlife habitat provision and biodiversity. New developments should provide for sufficient space for new planting or existing planting to grow. They should incorporate opportunities including green roofs, roof gardens, terraces, permeable surfaces, window boxes, food growing and climbing plants.
- 12.3.30. In considering applications for development, good use of all intrinsic site features will be sought. Existing site characteristics prior to the commencement of development will be evaluated. The council will normally impose planning conditions requiring any landscape scheme to be implemented within a specified period following completion of the main building works.

Climate change

- 12.3.31. The impacts of climate change mean that London is likely to experience more frequent and severe extreme weather events; including higher average temperatures, more prolonged spells of intensely hot weather and higher seasonal and extreme rainfall.
- 12.3.32. In line with other policies in this plan, applicants will need to demonstrate how their development proposal makes effective use of resources and materials, and minimises water use and CO2 emissions. This is most effectively and efficiently done by considering these matters at the start of the design process. Considering these issues at the end of the design process can result in unnecessary technological solutions being added to buildings that cost more and do not make most effective use of resources.
- 12.3.33. The management of waste on construction sites can save costs and result in waste being treated in the most sustainable manner, thereby contributing to the development's attainment of the applicable sustainable design and construction standard and promoting a circular economy.
- 12.3.34. Dual aspect homes with opening windows on at least two sides have many benefits that can add to the development's success. These include better access to daylight with

greater chance of direct sunlight for longer periods, natural cross-ventilation, a greater capacity to address overheating, pollution mitigation and more views out.

- 12.3.35. Single aspect homes are acceptable where they are required to optimise site capacity in a well-designed scheme and where they are laid out and designed to allow for good passive ventilation, daylight, privacy and to avoid overheating. Poorly located, designed and laid out single aspect homes are more likely to overheat as they are more difficult to ventilate, creating undesirable living conditions that can have adverse impacts on health and wellbeing.

Overheating

- 12.3.36. 20% of homes in England currently overheat even in cool summers and annual UK heat-related mortality is projected to increase from a current baseline of 2,000 heat-related deaths per year to 5,000 per year by 2050. Within London, the challenges of overheating are intensified by the urban heat island effect – caused by the absorption and retention of heat in built-up urban areas.

- 12.3.37. With our predicted population, the council therefore requires all development to demonstrate that the risk of overheating has been mitigated in any proposed buildings, and to incorporate green infrastructure in line with Policy O15.5 Urban Greening (in Chapter 15 Green & Blue Infrastructure) to help mitigate the urban heat island effect.

- 12.3.38. Development must prioritise passive design measures to promote cooling (e.g. design, layout, fenestration and orientation) ahead of active forms of ventilation (e.g. air conditioning) so as to limit intensive energy use and waste heat production. However, passive ventilation strategies cannot be considered in isolation of potentially negative external factors such as air quality, security or noise. Energy strategies that rely on passive ventilation must clearly demonstrate that occupants will not be adversely affected by air and noise pollution, or security risks, during periods of warmer weather. Any proposals to use Mechanical Ventilation with Heat Recovery (MVHR) should include summer bypass modes so that heat is not recirculated during warmer months.

- 12.3.39. Single aspect dwellings can be more difficult to ventilate naturally and may be more likely to overheat. Any single aspect home must be located, laid out and designed to have adequate passive ventilation, daylight and privacy, and avoid overheating without reliance on energy intensive mechanical cooling systems.

Subsidence

- 12.3.40. Prolonged periods of hot and dry weather and prolonged periods of rainfall have the potential to result in ground movement which in turn can lead to subsidence. This is due to increased shrinking and expanding of the cohesive London Clay soils which are found in the borough.

- 12.3.41. All development should look to mitigate and reduce the risk of subsidence through building siting, orientation, proximity to natural hazards such as water courses and mature vegetation. The impacts of climate change mean that London is likely to experience more frequent and severe extreme weather events; including higher average temperatures, more prolonged spells of intensely hot weather and higher seasonal and extreme rainfall.
- 12.3.42. On sites where ground has a high risk of susceptibility to movement, and if the choice of location for the development is limited, then appropriate structural foundation options should be considered to mitigate against the risk of subsidence.
- 12.3.43. All development should ensure that appropriate projections for temperature changes are considered for the full design life of any proposed buildings and that the risk of future subsidence is mitigated through best practice foundation design, considering the potential for ground movement.
- 12.3.44. Where tree planting is proposed, species selection and location should be carefully considered to mitigate the risk of subsidence.

Policy D12.4 Alterations and extensions to existing buildings

- 1.** Most of the development that takes place in Merton is alterations and extensions to existing buildings. This policy ensures that inclusive, sustainable, efficient and high quality design is also maintained for existing buildings across the urban and suburban environment found in Merton.
- 2.** To achieve high quality design and protection of amenity within the borough, alterations or extensions to buildings will be expected to:
 - a.** Be of high quality design that responds to local character.
 - b.** Respect the form, scale, bulk, and proportions of the original building.
 - c.** Use robust external materials that will be appropriate to the original building and to its surroundings.
 - d.** Be sympathetic to the built form pattern of the area and avoid the creation of long conjoined facades where this would be of detriment to the character and appearance of the area.
 - e.** Ensure that noise, vibrations or visual disturbance resulting from the development do not diminish the living conditions of existing and future residents.
 - f.** Seek to minimise carbon emissions in accordance with the chapter on Climate Change.
 - g.** Ensure that roof forms, including dormer windows, are of an appropriate size, type, form and material for the existing building and surrounding context, such that they are not unduly dominant, and respect the prevailing positive characteristics of the area.
 - h.** Demonstrate that the proposal does not significantly impact the quality of neighbouring buildings and amenity through overshadowing and overlooking.
 - i.** Seek to improve levels of biodiversity through interventions such as green roofs, sustainable drainage or soft landscape.
 - j.** Ensure that there is no increase in risk of flooding to surrounding area, either due to displacement of floodwater or diversion of flood flowpaths.

Supporting text

Well-designed buildings

- 12.4.1. Well-designed buildings make an important contribution to the character and quality of an area. Extensions must be as well-designed and architecturally competent as new buildings. Whether visible from the street or not, all extensions should be of a high quality design. Generally, extensions should be sited to the rear of the building and have a minimal impact on the street scene. Side extensions and those on street corners which will be visible must exhibit particular care in their design and how they relate to both the host building and the street scene. High quality contemporary extensions in a contrasting architectural style to the original may in some cases be appropriate. The council will welcome these on a case-by-case basis. They must be of the highest architectural quality and thoroughly reasoned in relation to the host property and immediate context.
- 12.4.2. The applicant should demonstrate the impact their proposal has on the street scene and neighbouring buildings through drawings that include contextual information and their Design and Access Statement.
- 12.4.3. Spaces between buildings should generally be respected. The conjoining of buildings, particularly in areas where a clear rhythm exists such as a street of semi-detached homes, should be avoided as this could have a negative impact on the local character.
- 12.4.4. The council's Borough Character Study SPD, Conservation Area Character Appraisals SPD's and Small Sites Toolkit SPD should be used to provide applicants with design guidance.
- 12.4.5. The borough has a few examples of high quality contemporary infill development and wishes to promote this further in the right context. It will therefore encourage new extensions to be contemporary in form where the architectural quality is exceptional and the building and context can sustain this without having a negative impact on the host building or adversely affecting a positive prevailing street character.

Design and Access Statements

- 12.4.6. Development proposals should be based on an assessment of character and recognise the local distinctiveness of areas and emphasise a positive local sense of place. Planning applications shall be accompanied by a Design and Access Statement (DAS) to demonstrate how the design has been arrived at.

Policy D12.5 Managing Heritage Assets

1. Merton has a wealth of Heritage Assets including conservation areas, listed buildings and structures and scheduled monuments. This policy aims to conserve and enhance Merton's Heritage Assets, their significance, settings and distinctive local character.
2. Development proposals affecting a Heritage Asset or its setting will be assessed against the principles set out in national policy and the London Plan, and should take into account detailed guidance set out in the accompanying Historic Environment Planning Practice Guide.
3. All development proposals with the potential to impact the significance or setting of the borough's Heritage Assets will be expected to demonstrate, within a Heritage Statement, how the proposal conserves, and where possible enhances the significance of the asset in terms of its architectural or historic interest and its setting.
4. In accordance with the NPPF, any alteration or destruction of a Heritage Asset, or development that has an impact on the significance and/or setting of a Heritage Asset will require clear and convincing justification. Substantial harm to or loss of:
 - a. Grade II listed buildings or registered parks or gardens, should be exceptional
 - b. Assets of the highest significance, notably scheduled monuments, protected wreck sites, registered battlefields, grade I and II* listed buildings, grade I and II* registered parks and gardens, and World Heritage Sites, should be wholly exceptional.
5. Proposals that will lead to substantial harm to the significance of, or the total loss of, Heritage Assets will only be granted in exceptional circumstances where substantial public benefits outweigh the harm or loss in accordance with the NPPF or that all of the following apply:
 - a. the nature of the Heritage Asset prevents all reasonable uses of the site;
 - b. no viable use of the Heritage Asset itself can be found that will enable its conservation; and,
 - c. conservation by grant funding or some form of charitable or public ownership is not possible; and,
 - d. the harm or loss is substantially outweighed by the benefit of bringing the site back into use.
6. The loss of a building that makes a positive contribution to a conservation area or the setting and/or significance of a Heritage Asset should be avoided. Proposals involving the loss of such buildings will not be supported unless any harm caused is clearly and convincingly

justified and satisfies the requirements of national policy relating to the conservation of Heritage Assets.

7. Proposals affecting the layout, design, character, use and function of both designated and non-designated Heritage Assets or their settings should conserve and look for opportunities to enhance their significance and have regard to the following:
 - a. The conservation, or reinstatement of lost features that contribute to the asset or its setting. This may include original chimneys, windows and doors, boundary treatments and garden layouts, roof coverings or shop fronts. In listed buildings, internal features such as fireplaces, panelling, ceilings, doors and architraves as well as surface treatments, the proportion of individual rooms and historic layout may also be of significance.
 - b. The removal of harmful alterations such as inappropriate additions, non-original windows and doors and the removal of paint or pebbledash from brickwork.
 - c. Where there is evidence of deliberate neglect or damage to a Heritage Asset, the current condition of the Heritage Asset will not be taken into account in any decision.
 - d. Proposals should not prejudice the future restoration of designated historic parks and gardens.
8. Proposals relating to existing Heritage Assets should seek to improve energy efficiency effectively and sensitively and without detrimental visual impact on the Heritage Asset, or the wider significance and setting of the Heritage Asset.

Supporting text

- 12.5.1. The London Plan is clear that Heritage Assets should be seen as an integral part of the urban fabric with a key role in place-making and contributing to economic viability, accessibility, environmental quality and social well-being.
- 12.5.2. Heritage significance should be used positively in the planning and design process and Heritage Assets should be sensitively integrated with their setting with creative and innovative solutions that contribute to their significance and sense of place. The council will pay particular attention to assets on the 'at risk' register and actively seek to find viable and long-term sustainable uses that enable them to be removed from the list.
- 12.5.3. Historic England provides detailed guidance on best practice approaches when working with Heritage Assets. Merton's published Conservation Area character appraisals and management plans and the guidance statements set out in the Borough Character Study SPD also provide borough specific guidance when working with Heritage Assets.

Heritage Assets

- 12.5.4. Merton has a rich and varied heritage ranging from designated Heritage Assets of national importance (such as the remains of Merton Priory founded in 1117, a scheduled monument) to the suburban heritage of the 1930s. The council has a duty to consider the significance of all these areas that are positively identified as having heritage significance when carrying out its statutory functions and through the planning system. Conservation and enhancement of Heritage Assets, and where appropriate, associated development, can contribute towards reinforcing local distinctiveness and character in the borough.
- 12.5.5. Heritage assets are the valued components of the historic environment. They are defined as any building, site, place, area or landscape, positively identified as having a degree of significance meriting consideration in planning decisions. The term embraces all manner of features, whether standing, buried or submerged, whether designated or not and whether or not they are capable of designation.

Identification of Heritage Assets

- 12.5.6. The identification of a Heritage Asset could be through a range of means. This could include formal designation such as conservation area or listed, or locally listed building status. Buildings in a conservation area identified as having a positive contribution to its character will be considered as non-designated Heritage Assets in their own right, if they meet Merton's local listing selection criteria. Heritage Assets may also be identified in any updates to the Borough Character Study SPD, during the update on the local list, or during the development control process itself.

Types of Heritage Assets

- 12.5.7. Heritage assets (HA) covered by this policy include:
- a. Listed buildings (designated HA)
 - b. Conservation Areas (designated HA)
 - c. Registered parks and gardens (designated HA)
 - d. Scheduled monuments (designated HA)
 - e. Archaeological Priority Areas (designated HA)
 - f. Locally listed buildings, monuments, sites, places, areas, historic parks and gardens or other design landscape (non-designated HA)
 - g. Any other building, monument, site, area, streetscape or landscape that is positively identified as having a degree of heritage or historic significance

Heritage statements

- 12.5.8. Heritage statements will be required to set out how proposals conserve, enhance or restore the significance of Heritage Assets and where appropriate, conservation management plans should be prepared for the future maintenance and management of the asset. Special attention should be paid to the conservation or reinstatement of individual details of the asset that contribute towards its particular character, for example; chimneys, windows, doors, roof coverings, boundary treatments and the individual elements of shop fronts. The loss or alteration of individual features can cause substantial harm to the significance of Heritage Assets.
- 12.5.9. The level of detail provided in the heritage statement should be proportionate to the asset's importance in terms of the significance of the asset affected and the impact of the proposal and should be carried out by a suitably qualified historic environment consultant. Historic England Advice Note 12 'Statements of Heritage Significance' provides further information.
- 12.5.10. Where the Heritage Statement identifies the potential of archaeological remains within an archaeological priority area, an Archaeological Evaluation Report (and where necessary a field evaluation) will also be required.
- 12.5.11. All development affecting Heritage Assets or their setting will need to be in accordance with the detailed guidance set out in the Historic Environment Planning Practice Guide. The guidance covers issues such as recording of information relating to Heritage Assets, guidance on repairs and restoration, change of use and improving energy performance etc.
- 12.5.12. Historic England keeps and maintains a Heritage at Risk register and developers are encouraged to check the register at the earliest stage of development and for Heritage Statements.

Environmental performance of Heritage Assets

- 12.5.13. Proposals to existing Heritage Asset buildings should seek to improve the proposals' energy efficiency effectively and sensitively and without detrimental visual impact on the Heritage Asset, or setting of the Heritage Asset.
- 12.5.14. As set out in Merton's Climate Strategy & Action Plan (2020), retrofitting the c86,000 homes and other buildings in Merton will be essential to enable Merton to reach net-zero carbon by 2050; and some of these buildings will be or will be located within Heritage Assets.
- 12.5.15. The council is supportive of efforts to tackle the climate emergency and will positively consider proposals for retrofitting Heritage Assets, including structures within Conservation Areas, where the proposals will not cause harm to the significance of the Heritage Asset.

Where proposals would cause harm to the significance of a Heritage Asset or its setting, applications will be assessed against national policy and guidance.

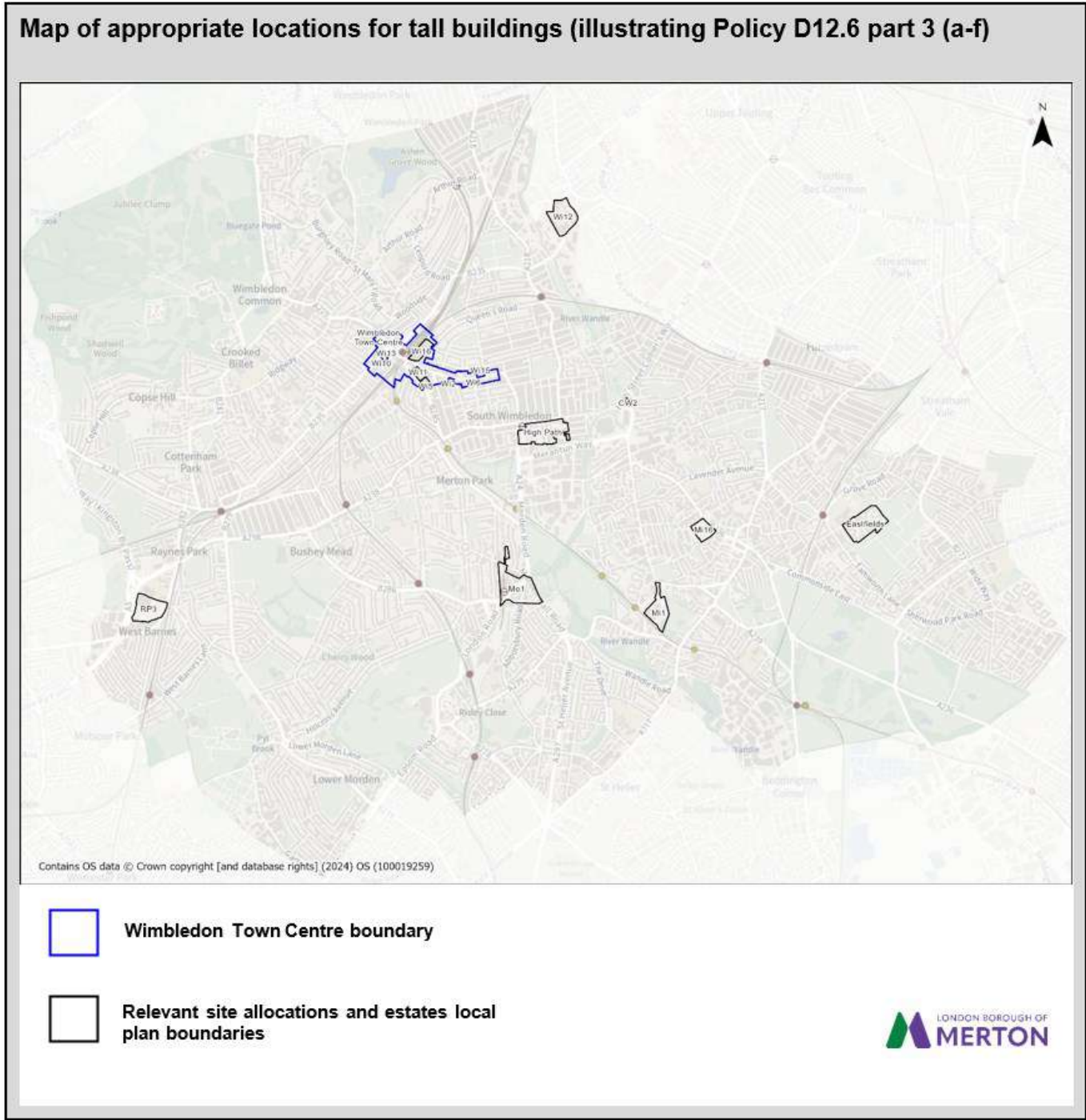
Information on Heritage Assets

12.5.16. Details of the borough's Heritage Assets including Conservation Areas (design guidance, appraisals and management plans) as well as details of listed and locally listed buildings, Registered parks and gardens and Scheduled monuments are available on the council's website: www.merton.gov.uk/planning-and-buildings/conservation-heritage

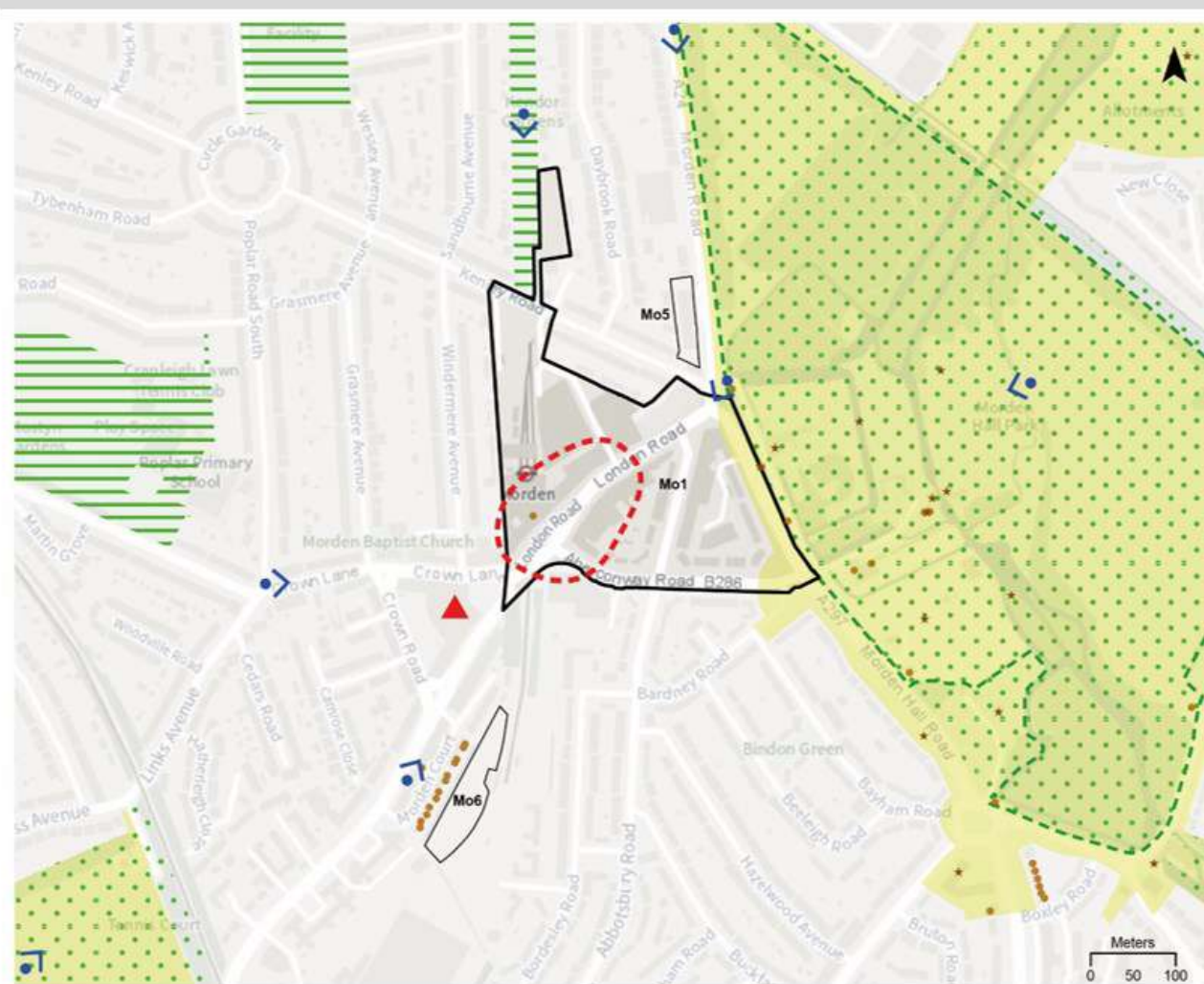
Policy D12.6 Tall buildings

1. Tall buildings in the borough are defined as a minimum of 21m from the ground level to the top of the uppermost storey.
2. In the right locations, tall buildings can make important contributions towards delivering new homes, economic growth and sense of place. They can act as visual markers, such as the redeveloped Britannia Point in Colliers Wood, provide architectural variety, such as Glebe Court in Mitcham, and optimise a site's potential for homes and jobs such as the future of High Path in South Wimbledon. It is crucial that tall buildings are of the highest quality of design and construction.
3. Tall buildings are only acceptable in the following locations:
 - a. As indicated in the Strategic Heights Diagrams for Morden Regeneration Zone and Wimbledon Town Centre.
 - b. Wimbledon Town Centre, as set out within the chapter on Wimbledon.
 - c. Morden Regeneration Zone, as set out within the chapter on Morden.
 - d. As set out within Merton's adopted Estates Local Plan 2018 for Eastfields and High Path estates.
 - e. Where they are identified in the following site allocations, CW2, Mi1, Mi16, Mo1, RP3, Wi2, Wi5, Wi6, Wi9, Wi10, Wi11, Wi12, Wi13, Wi15 and Wi16.
 - f. On sites immediately adjacent to the above locations, where they would provide design-led opportunities for appropriate transitional elements between differing building scales.
4. The council will support tall buildings in those locations set out in part 3 of this policy where they meet all of the following criteria:
 - a. They accord to the most up to date and relevant national guidance and London Plan and council policies, guidance and relevant site allocations.
 - b. Their massing, bulk and height are appropriately sized and located, and demonstrate they take into account local character and Heritage Assets and their settings through townscape analysis of short, mid and long views.
 - c. They avoid harm to the setting and significance of neighbouring Heritage Assets.
 - d. They are of exemplary design and architectural quality.

- e. They respond to the council's Design Review Panel, which provides independent design scrutiny from a panel of industry experts.
 - f. They ensure the ground and lower levels are designed for a human scale, maximise the amount of active frontage and natural surveillance and create a positive contribution to the public realm.
 - g. They are designed to mitigate against any micro climatic effects such as sun, reflection and wind, and internal spaces are designed to mitigate overheating.
 - h. They create minimal negative harm to the quality of neighbouring public spaces and open spaces.
 - i. Where appropriate, they provide a mix of tenure and home sizes in accordance with policies on Housing.
 - j. They incorporate mitigation measures to help prevent suicide and accidental falls for example anti-climb methods, fences, barriers and rails; these will be well-designed and should be integrated into the overall design of the building.
 - k. Appropriate provision for waste and bicycle storage is provided and is integrated into the overall design of the building.
 - l. Their shared spaces, such as lobbies, communal gardens and corridors are designed to enhance social cohesion and mental and physical wellbeing.
- 5. Development proposals for tall buildings should be supported by:**
- a. Adequate information demonstrating how the proposals comply with all the criteria within part 4 of this policy, and within the London Plan policy on tall buildings to ensure that the proposals have considered visual, townscape and heritage impacts.
 - b. A detailed townscape analysis that includes short, mid and long views and analysis of its impact on their setting. In particular their impact on Heritage Assets such as parks or buildings and open spaces.
 - c. A digital 3D model in agreement with the council that can be used to evaluate its visual impact across the borough and beyond.



Strategic Heights Diagram, Morden Regeneration Zone

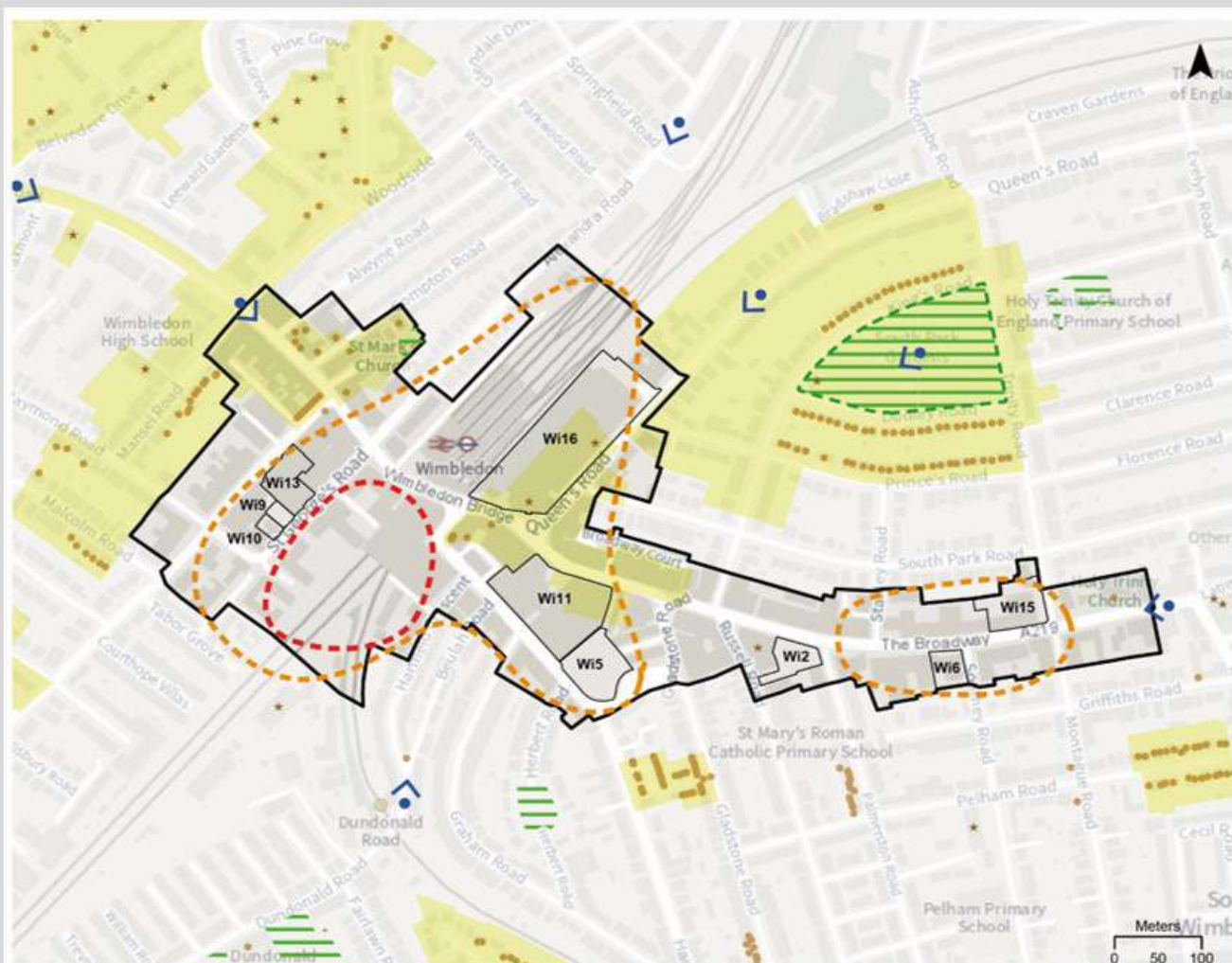


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- | | | | |
|---|---|---|------------------------------|
|  | Morden Regeneration Zone where buildings of circa 39m* could be appropriate, subject to all other policy requirements |  | Site allocations |
|  | Indicative location of tall building cluster where buildings of circa 71m* could be appropriate, subject to all other policy requirements |  | Metropolitan Open Land [MOL] |
|  | Morden Civic Centre approx height: 58m* |  | Open space |
|  | Townscape views into town centre |  | Conservation area |
| | |  | Registered parks and gardens |
| | |  | Listed buildings |
| | |  | Locally listed buildings |

* Heights from ground level.
More information on building heights can be found in the supporting text.

Strategic Heights Diagram, Wimbledon Town Centre



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- | | | | |
|---|---|---|------------------------------|
|  | Wimbledon town centre where buildings of circa 24m* could be appropriate, subject to all other policy requirements |  | Site allocations |
|  | Indicative location of all building cluster where buildings of circa 48m* could be appropriate, subject to all other policy requirements |  | Metropolitan Open Land [MOL] |
|  | Indicative location of tall building cluster where buildings of circa 40m* could be appropriate, subject to all other policy requirements |  | Open space |
|  | Townscape views into town centre |  | Conservation area |
| | |  | Registered parks and gardens |
| | |  | Listed buildings |
| | |  | Locally listed buildings |

* Heights from ground level.
More information on building heights can be found in the supporting text.

Supporting text

- 12.6.1. Tall buildings can form part of a masterplan approach to help manage future growth and regeneration opportunities by contributing to new homes and economic growth.
- 12.6.2. Merton's definition of '*a minimum of 21m from the ground level to the top of the uppermost storey*' provides further clarity and is equivalent to the London Plan definition of '*tall buildings should not be less than 6 storeys or 18 metres measured from ground to the floor level of the uppermost storey*'.
- 12.6.3. Storey heights will differ across different land uses as well as different methods of construction. The table below provides indicative building heights based on residential and commercial uses.

Building storeys	Indicative residential building height (metres)	Indicative commercial building height (metres)
	(3.2m floor to floor)	(4.0m floor to floor)
1	3.2	4.0
2	6.4	8.0
3	9.6	12.0
4	12.8	16.0
5	16.0	20.0
6	19.2	24.0
7	22.4	28.0
8	25.6	32.0
9	28.8	36.0
10	32.0	40.0

- 12.6.4. Tall and high density buildings can offer a range of benefits. For example, they can reduce the carbon footprint per dwelling by using district energy systems; they can help people live closer to local centres, reducing sprawl and retaining vital open land. When situated close to transport links, such buildings can reduce the reliance on cars and encourage healthier ways of getting around.
- 12.6.5. Tall buildings can also improve wayfinding and add to the visual intricacy of neighbourhoods. However, perhaps more than any other housing typology, tall buildings must balance the needs of individual homes with broader townscape considerations.
- 12.6.6. Exemplary tall buildings located in the right place can make positive contributions to Merton's townscape. However, if poorly designed and located inappropriately they can have a negative functional, environmental and visual impact and as such tall buildings will undergo a high level of design scrutiny.

- 12.6.7. Merton's Borough Character Study SPD provides more detail of different character areas within the borough and a framework for character-led tall buildings that highlights good practice design approaches.
- 12.6.8. Not all tall buildings need to be iconic landmarks. If tall buildings form a cluster or are in close proximity to others, they should not compete and their composition must be considered.
- 12.6.9. Design Guides and/or Codes are useful tools to assist in the creation of beautiful and distinctive places with a consistent and high-quality standard of design. They deliver a design-led approach that can help optimise the capacity of a site while ensuring that its final design reflects local character and design principles.
- 12.6.10. The National Design Guide and National Model Design Code provide a series of tests for assessing whether a place is well-designed or not and will be used to guide the determination of planning applications.
- 12.6.11. This policy requires exemplary design for proposals containing tall buildings. To demonstrate this, Design Guides and/or Design Codes should be prepared for these sites, either by applicants or the council. All Design Guides or Design Codes should be based on effective community engagement and reflect local aspirations for the development of the area and should take into account the guidance contained in the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code.
- 12.6.12. In instances where an applicant is proposing the redevelopment of a site immediately adjacent to the tall building boundaries and clusters identified in the Strategic Height Diagrams, local Design Guides or Design Codes may be used as part of a robust design-led approach to demonstrate the appropriate stepping up of heights above or below those stated and avoid abrupt transitions in building heights.
- 12.6.13. Tall buildings should be part of a positive strategy for the historic environment and seek to avoid harm to the significance of Heritage Assets and their settings. In line with the London Plan, proposals resulting in harm will require clear and convincing justification, including what alternatives were explored and what public benefits outweigh the harm.
- 12.6.14. Applicants should be prepared to provide 3D digital models to analyse how their tall buildings are placed within the context of the borough and beyond, assessing cumulative impacts of both existing and permitted, but not yet completed, schemes.
- 12.6.15. Consideration must be given to ensure the development is inclusive for all sections of the community, in accordance with policies on Health and Wellbeing.

Policy D12.7 Advertisements

1. Policies on advertisements, shop front design and signage aim to ensure these regular features of our urban environment enhance and do not detract from people's experience of the public realm in Merton.
2. Express consent will only be granted for advertisements where they do not harm amenity or public safety. When assessing proposals for new advertisements, cumulative impacts will be taken into account.
3. The council will ensure that:
 - a. The quality, character and amenity of the borough is not diluted or undermined by inappropriate or excessive advertising on buildings, in the street or on shop fronts.
 - b. Advertisements and signage are designed so that their size, scale, type and illumination are unobtrusive, taking into account site context and local character.
 - c. They do not compromise safety and security or obscure highway sightlines and allow free movement along the public highway by all users, including people with disabilities, especially the visually impaired.
 - d. Advertisements do not adversely impact on trees that have a significant amenity value on or in close proximity to the proposed site, especially those protected by Tree Protection Orders (TPOs) or within conservation areas.
 - e. Amenity is not harmed by the restriction of visual permeability and natural surveillance between the street and inside non-residential buildings is not compromised by internally applied artwork, blinds or advertising, where the local planning authority's permission or consent for such items is required.

Supporting text

- 12.7.1. Advertisements are a regular feature of our urban environment and, when well-designed and located sensitively, can play a positive role in creating a vibrant and interesting place. However, it is important that advertising material (including advertisements that may be considered individually acceptable) does not proliferate to an extent to undermine the appearance of individual buildings, the street or the wider public realm. The council will be vigilant in using its powers to prevent such an excess. When assessing the impact of an advertisement proposal, the cumulative impacts of advertisements on the streetscape and public realm will be taken into account.

Safety and security

- 12.7.2. Advertisements should not represent a safety or security hazard to pedestrians or motorists by impeding views, unduly distracting attention, creating opportunities for concealment or otherwise undermining perceptions of safety.
- 12.7.3. The erection of advertisements can block views and vistas along streets – important for orientation and understanding the public realm – or deflect attention inappropriately from the general townscape or important local landmarks, local established views and historic buildings and areas. Potential losses of views will be taken into consideration when determining applications. Inappropriately designed, sized or sited advertisements can detract from the visual appearance of individual buildings and the wider townscape. This can be the case in any part of the borough, but particularly sensitive are Conservation Areas, Metropolitan Open Land or in the vicinity of Listed Buildings. The council will use its Discontinuance Notice Powers to remove advertisements that substantially injure amenity and the environment.

Policy D12.8 Digital infrastructure

1. This policy aims to ensure digital infrastructure is deployed to support better digital connectivity across all of Merton and does not detract from a healthy environment or people's experience of the public realm.
2. Proposals for telecommunications apparatus and equipment will be considered in accordance with International Commission guidelines and relevant Government guidance. Proposals should demonstrate that the equipment will not cause interference with other electrical equipment, air traffic services or instrumentation operated in the national interest.
3. Proposals will be expected to demonstrate that the equipment will meet International Commission on Non-Ionising Radiation Protection (ICNIRP) guidelines on the limitation of exposure of the general public to electromagnetic fields.
4. Proposals for telecommunications apparatus and equipment should be designed and located such that they do not detract from the visual quality, enjoyment and useability of the public realm or detract from the setting and context of buildings and the street scene. Proposals will be expected to:
 - a. Ensure equipment is placed to the back edge of the footway;
 - b. Maintain an adequate width of footway consistent with its existing and likely future intensity of use;
 - c. Group equipment in a neat and orderly fashion;
 - d. Ensure there is not a proliferation of numerous items of infrastructure that will cumulatively adversely be detrimental to the public realm;
 - e. Construct bespoke enclosures to accommodate equipment as a means of managing the need to provide a number of items of equipment in a single location;
 - f. In particularly sensitive areas, notably where Heritage Assets are affected, locate equipment in underground chambers, or demonstrate a design-led solution that does not harm the significance of the Heritage Assets.
 - g. Ensure that the design and siting of equipment and infrastructure does not undermine the safe enjoyment of the public realm or relevant policies promoting active travel and sustainable means of travel.

Supporting text

- 12.8.1. The council recognises the benefits of up-to-date digital infrastructure and the needs of telecommunications companies in providing and maintaining this. This needs to be balanced with minimising the environmental impact and ensuring a high quality urban environment.
- 12.8.2. The council is therefore keen to minimise the adverse impacts on visual and environmental amenity and public safety of proposals for telecommunications, particularly in residential areas, on sensitive skylines and in other sensitive locations. Telecommunications apparatus should be sited unobtrusively and the council will have regard to all relevant development plan policies in assessment of development proposals for this apparatus.

Policy D12.9 Shop front design and signage

- 1.** Policies on advertisements, shop front design and signage aim to ensure these regular features of our urban environment enhance and do not detract from people's experience of the public realm in Merton.
- 2.** Proposals for new shop fronts or alteration to existing shop fronts should relate to the scale and character of the building and enhance the street scene. Proposals for alteration or removal of existing shop fronts shall:
 - a.** Retain and restore quality original shop fronts where they exist, to contribute to and enhance the established character of their shopping centre or parade;
 - b.** Retain and restore original features and details where they are of historic value, contribute to the character or appearance of the building or street scene;
 - c.** Retain separate access to upper floors and create or restore such access where this is practical;
 - d.** Provide for satisfactory access for people with disabilities, special sensory and mobility needs within the building, retaining the full width of the effective footway, irrespective of ownership, keeping it free of ramps, railings or any other obstructions.
- 3.** Proposals for shop fascias will be expected to enhance the street scene and form an integral and appropriately proportioned part of the whole shop front and building. They should:
 - a.** Relate to the appearance, scale and character of the shop front and its associated features;
 - b.** Relate to the shopping parade within which it is located;
 - c.** Ensure the depth of fascias are consistent with neighbouring shops where they were designed as a whole and relate appropriately to the pilasters and console brackets;
 - d.** Ensure pilasters and console brackets are designed as a unifying element to a group of shops and form a consistent design and paint colour.
- 4.** Signage design and lighting should be of a high quality, relating well to the original building and the business of the shop front. In order to achieve this:
 - a.** Illumination should be subtle and avoid plain, internally or box-lit fascias or lettering;
 - b.** Signs should be applied to an original fascia board and not be overlaid onto earlier signs;

- c. Projecting signs should be of a scale and size that is proportionate to the size and depth of the main fascia;
 - d. Projecting signs should be attached to one end of the main fascia and not between shops on the pilaster, console bracket or above it on the upper floor elevation.
5. Proposals for shop fronts should strike the right balance between security and a positive interface and relationship with the street. They must ensure there is visual permeability and natural surveillance between the street and inside the building, whatever their use. To this end:
- a. Proposals for security shutters will only be allowed if a legitimate security need for them is identified;
 - b. Where security shutters are considered necessary, they must be installed on the inside of the shop front and allow clear views into the shop. Unless it can be demonstrated that they are required for specific security reasons, solid, near solid shutters and shutters on the outside of a shop front are not acceptable;
 - c. Artwork, glass frosting, blinds or any internally applied advertising or screening will only be permitted where they do not detract from visual permeability and natural surveillance between the street and inside the building.
6. Shop fronts must be of a high quality design.
7. Proposals for new buildings where there is a proposed retail or non-residential ground floor, must demonstrate that future shop fronts and advertising has been planned for, and can be accommodated in the building design in a manner that does not undermine the building design and architectural integrity.

Supporting text

- 12.9.1. Shop fronts have a huge impact on the appearance of individual buildings and parades of shops. Merton's Shop front SPD provides best practice design approaches for design and should be used when designing shop fronts.
- 12.9.2. The council recognises the importance of attractive, high quality shop fronts in well maintained buildings in enhancing the quality of the retail and business offer in the borough's Town and Local Centres. As a result, the council is embarking on a selective programme of shop front enhancements and façade restorations in order to address this issue.

- 12.9.3. Outside these areas the council has produced a Supplementary Planning Document on shop fronts to guide applicants planning to install new shop fronts. Applications should show that they have used this guide to inform their work.

Policy D12.10 Dwelling Conversions

1. This policy will ensure that dwelling conversions are of high quality standard for future occupiers and support housing choice.
2. Proposals to convert an existing single family sized (3-bed or more) home into two or more smaller units of accommodation must incorporate the re-provision of at least one family sized (3-bed or more) home.
3. Dwelling conversions proposals should seek to minimise carbon emissions in accordance with policies on Climate Change.
4. In accordance with policies on managing local flood risk dwelling conversions in Flood Zone 3b must ensure no increase in building footprint and no increase in the number of units or bedrooms. Proposals for the change of use or conversion to a use with a higher vulnerability will not be allowed. In Flood Zone 3a, self-contained residential basements and bedrooms at basement level are not permitted.

Supporting text

- 12.10.1. Local housing research demonstrates the need for all sizes of new homes in Merton, including family sized homes.
- 12.10.2. The conversion of existing single homes into two or more smaller dwellings contributes to the provision of Merton's share of London's new homes. Whilst this does not normally create problems with larger houses, the conversion of single dwellings into two or more smaller homes is also prevalent in certain parts of Merton, the "gridiron" terraces of Abbey, Colliers Wood, Dundonald, Graveney, Hillside Trinity and Wimbledon Park. Loss of 3-bed or more homes in these locations reduces housing choice in these areas.
- 12.10.3. To ensure that dwelling conversions produce new homes of a high design quality and support housing choice, all new dwellings including dwelling conversions must comply with the most appropriate minimum space standards in place at the time of the planning application. Applications for the conversion of existing family sized homes into two or more smaller units must include the re-provision of one family sized home. As set out in London Plan 2021 paragraph 4.2.8, a family sized unit is defined as having three or more bedrooms.
- 12.10.4. To ensure negative effects are mitigated, the council will expect any proposed conversions to retain a family sized home where one previously existed. All dwelling conversions, regardless of size must rigorously apply the spaces standards in Policy D6 in the London Plan. This will ensure conversions do not take place in unsuitable dwellings that are too small, cannot provide adequate circulation and are in any other way considered sub-standard.

- 12.10.5. In line with the London Plan, homes located on the ground floor in dwelling conversions and other forms of minor residential development should meet the requirements of Policy D7 Accessible Housing. Homes that are not on the ground floor on minor developments can comply with the M4(1) standard, which does not require step-free access, where provision of step-free access would be unfeasible.
- 12.10.6. Often many larger (and some smaller) houses have been subdivided into self-contained flats and/or houses in multiple occupation in the past, when today's space standards did not apply. These are likely to be considered sub-standard in terms of space, circulation, access and provision for people with disabilities. Conversion, reconfiguration and extension of such properties can improve the quality of housing stock and bring it up to modern standards.
- 12.10.7. Conversions should take account of Policy F15.8 Managing Local Flooding, to ensure that people and property are not placed at increased risk of flooding from all sources.

Policy D12.11 Basements and subterranean design

- 1.** The Council will only permit basement and subterranean developments that do not cause harm to the built and natural environment, amenity and does not result in increasing flooding (from all sources including surface water flooding) or ground instability issues. Guidance on delivering this policy can be found in Merton's Basement and Subterranean Development Supplementary Planning Document.
- 2.** All basement or subterranean development applications must be accompanied by
 - a.** A Basement Impact Assessment.
 - b.** A Drainage Strategy.
 - c.** An outline Construction Method Statement. The CMS is required to demonstrate that the development will be designed and constructed to minimise its impact on the environment and neighbouring sites during construction.
 - d.** A Construction Traffic Management Plan to ensure that traffic and construction activity does not cause any unacceptable harm to pedestrian, cyclist, and vehicular and road safety.
- 3.** The development must not result in an unacceptable impact on the amenity of adjoining properties, or on the natural and historic environment during and post construction.
- 4.** Where a basement or subterranean development is added to, or adjacent to, a listed building and all other Heritage Assets, it must safeguard all significant archaeological deposits and, in the case of listed buildings, not unbalance the building's original hierarchy of spaces, where this contributes to significance.
- 5.** Proposals must not cause loss, damage or adverse impact to trees, shrubs, biodiversity, nature and amenity value.
- 6.** Any basements proposed as alterations to existing buildings must not comprise more than one storey and not extend beyond the outer walls of the original property (prior to alterations) to more than 50% of the original dwelling's footprint.
- 7.** Any basements proposed as part of new build or redevelopments must not comprise of more than one storey and not exceed 50% of either the front, rear or side garden of the property.
- 8.** All basement proposals should ensure that garden areas relating to the site provide an acceptable standard of amenity.

9. Any basements or subterranean development must be appropriate to the character and appearance of its surroundings, have regard to the health and wellbeing of its occupants and provide access to natural light and ventilation.
10. Ensure that any externally visible elements such as light wells, roof lights and fire escapes are sensitively designed and sited to avoid any harmful visual impact on neighbours or visual amenity.
11. Basements or subterranean development must be designed to minimise the risk of internal flooding and must not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere. Proposals must include a sustainable urban drainage scheme to reduce runoff rates and implement proposals to conserve and re-use water through rainwater harvesting. Where basements discharge to the sewer network, they must install suitable positively pumped devices to protect basements from the risk of sewer flooding.
12. Developers of basement or subterranean developments are required to sign up to Considerate Constructors Scheme.
13. No new basements or subterranean development will be permitted under the public highway.

Supporting text

- 12.11.1. This policy applies to all new basement or subterranean developments, including the construction or extension below the prevailing ground level of a site or property. Subterranean and other basement developments are 'development' as defined by the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 as amended. This policy focuses on the design element of basement developments. The flooding policy F15.8 should also be read to ensure that all basement developments do not result in an increase in flood risk either to or from the basement.
- 12.11.2. Basement and subterranean developments can help to make efficient use of the borough's limited developable land. However, in some cases they may have the potential to cause harm to the amenity of neighbours, affect the stability of buildings, cause drainage or flooding problems or damage the character of areas and the natural environment. Therefore, limiting the size and extent of a basement will ensure that the special character of Merton is preserved and, importantly, proposals do not lead to over development or inappropriate intensification of existing properties.
- 12.11.3. Basement and subterranean developments affect the existing building, neighbouring building and neighbourhood amenities. Building Regulations and the Party Wall Act control the structural integrity of the development itself, but these regulations do not concern themselves with the impact on neighbourhood amenity of the construction process or the finished development.

12.11.4. In some cases of higher potential risk, the council may require applicants to fund an independent assessment of the basement structural assessments. This is particularly likely where proposals will affect listed buildings of high significance or with particularly sensitive historic fabric, or those in high risk locations where basements are in proximity of environmentally sensitive features, such as culverted rivers/watercourses.

Basement and Subterranean Supplementary Planning Document (SPD) and the Sustainable Drainage (SUDS) SPD

12.11.5. Merton's Basement and Subterranean Supplementary Planning Document and the Sustainable Drainage (SUDS) SPD provide further guidance on the council's requirements for additional assessments to be submitted with a basement/subterranean planning application. Both supplementary planning documents can be found online via Merton council's website www.merton.gov.uk/planning-and-buildings/planning/supplementary-planning-documents.

Construction Method Statement (CMS)

12.11.6. The impact of basement and subterranean construction, including issues relating to noise, dust, disturbance and structural stability of surrounding properties as well as the management of traffic, plant and equipment, is a growing concern in the borough, particularly in residential streets. It can affect the quality of life, amenity and living conditions as well as traffic and parking of nearby residents and local communities. In some instances, multiple excavations in a residential street can lead to detrimental impacts during the excavation and construction processes. While planning has limited powers to control the construction processes, it does have an important role in protecting amenity and living conditions.

12.11.7. The council will seek to ensure that the amenity, living conditions and the health and wellbeing of nearby residents are protected by reducing the impacts from construction works, such as noise, vibration, soil removal and associated plant, machinery and heavy vehicles. In addition, to ensure that structural stability is safeguarded at each of the development proposal, planning applications for basement developments must demonstrate how all construction work will be carried out. Guidance on CMS can be found in Merton's Basement and Subterranean SPD.

Sustainability

12.11.8. The environmental impact of basement and subterranean developments is arguably greater than the equivalent above ground development due to the increased energy and resource requirements in their construction and use (e.g. heating and lighting). The council will expect all basement development proposals to demonstrate that they have sought to

minimise their environmental impact in accordance with sustainable design and construction and circular economy policies.

Heritage Assets, Conservation and Listed buildings

- 12.11.9. Any application for a basement to a designated or non-designated Heritage Asset should be accompanied by a detailed method statement which demonstrates how the development can be achieved without causing harm to the significance and structural integrity of the asset. Where a level of harm is identified the acceptability of such schemes will be assessed on a case-by-case basis and in line with Policy D12.5 Managing Heritage Assets, national policy and guidance.
- 12.11.10. The link between the listed building and the basement should be discreet and of an appropriate design and location that does not adversely impact on the significance of the listed building. Where these are allowed, there should be no extensive modification to the foundations of the listed building or any destabilisation of the listed structure and account will be taken for the individual features of the building and its special interest.
- 12.11.11. Similarly, development proposals involving excavation nearby or adjacent to a listed building will be required to demonstrate that the integrity of the listed building will be unaffected. The council will consult with Historic England (this includes the Greater London Archaeology Advisory Service (GLAAS) and any other appropriate bodies regarding listed building developments.
- 12.11.12. In conservation areas, basements will be supported where they conserve or enhance the character, appearance and overall significance of the conservation area. This is particularly relevant in relation to external visible features e.g. light wells and railings which may impact on the character of conservation areas. Further guidance and advice can be found in Merton's Basement and Subterranean, Design and Sustainable Drainage SPDs. Proposals which impact statutory listed and locally listed buildings will be assessed according to national policy and Policy D12.5 Managing Heritage Assets.



Chapter 13. **Economy and town centres**

Strategic Policy EC13.1 Promoting economic growth and successful high streets

1. We will support economic recovery, business investment and jobs growth through support for a diverse local economic base in Merton by encouraging developments that provide a greater number and range of jobs and services and add to the vibrancy of the borough.
2. We will focus on encouraging business investment and jobs growth to support a diverse and resilient economy based on a wide range of sectors. We will do this by:
 - a. Supporting development that raises and sustains the number and range of jobs, increases the diversity of businesses and reduces carbon emissions where it meets other policies in this plan;
 - b. Considering the full economic potential of all of Merton's sectors when determining planning applications, including social and community infrastructure, industrial and waste services, business, leisure, sports, town centre services and shops, creative, cultural, tech and green sector jobs;
 - c. Promoting resource efficiency and the principles of the circular and sharing economy; supporting developments and encouraging businesses to take advantage of the new economic opportunities associated with reducing carbon emissions and transitioning to a low carbon economy. Safeguarding employment and community floorspace and sites for business and jobs, including for shared workspace;
 - d. Defining Merton's hierarchy of Town Centres, high streets and neighbourhood parades in Policy TC.13.3 and supporting these by encouraging a broad range of occupiers suitable for each area that support jobs and local vibrancy;
 - e. Strengthening the pathways through education and learning into jobs and careers for residents, supporting employment and training schemes to maximise local employment opportunities and help address skills deficits, including in green skills;
 - f. Encouraging employer participation and investment in skills;
 - g. Aligning the skills offer to our growth and strategic sectors through the Skills for South Londoners Strategy and the South London Skills and Employment Board; and
 - h. Requiring developers and applicants on Major Development sites to support the recruitment of local residents and businesses as part of the construction and end life of their development.
3. We will seek to ensure a supply of viable and appropriate sites and premises for businesses, jobs and other enterprises in locations which optimise the needs of business while minimising disruption to amenity. We will do this by:

- a.** Strengthening the NPPF’s “town centre first approach” by encouraging a range of appropriate town centre uses, not limited to retail, that generate a larger number of journeys towards Wimbledon (Major Town Centre), Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Morden (District Town Centres);
- b.** Supporting Local Town Centres and neighbourhood parades for businesses commensurate with the character of the area and providing services to local residents;
- c.** Encouraging complementary businesses, services and activities in our Town Centres that will enhance their vitality and vibrancy, including uses that will add to the attraction of the Town Centres for all users and meet the changing needs and desires of all high street users;
- d.** Protecting and managing the designated Strategic Industrial Locations and Locally Significant Industrial Sites, ensuring that they are prioritised for industrial and distribution uses that could operate 24-hours and are not compatible with homes, schools and other sensitive uses;
- e.** Facilitating new employment by protecting and improving scattered employment sites for small and growing businesses or community uses;
- f.** Supporting the provision of well managed co-working space close to good public transport links;
- g.** Seeking to ensure that there is a strong supply of appropriate space for small businesses, including move on space;
- h.** Supporting opportunities to use vacant buildings and land for flexible and temporary meanwhile uses or pop ups; and
- i.** Supporting the redevelopment of purpose built retail units into other uses.

Supporting text

- 13.1.1. The NPPF states that planning policies and decisions should help create the conditions in which businesses can invest, expand and adapt. Significant weight should be placed on the need to support economic growth and productivity, taking into account both local business needs and wider opportunities for development. The approach taken should allow each area to build on its strengths, counter any weaknesses and address the challenges of the future.
- 13.1.2. The COVID-19 pandemic had a devastating impact on the global economy, on unemployment, business closures and structural economic changes across the world. The UK, London and Merton were affected by the profound decline in jobs and rise in business closures.

- 13.1.3. Economic and social recovery from the effects of COVID-19 is a priority for the UK, for London and for Merton for the short to medium term. There are already a variety of predictions as to how COVID-19 has changed the supply and demand for businesses and jobs. It is not yet known which of these will become a longer term reality and which might fall away as we start to recover from the impacts of the pandemic. This Local Plan continues to plan for space for businesses, jobs, apprenticeships and training in order to boost wages and local employment opportunities within the borough.
- 13.1.4. What is known is that a global and local transition to a low carbon economy is essential to address climate change and its impacts, and will be important in Merton to achieve a net-zero carbon borough by 2050. Through this Local Plan and through other initiatives we support the green recovery and the London-wide aim to tackle the climate and ecological emergencies and improve air quality by doubling the size of London's green economy by 2030 to accelerate job creation.
- 13.1.5. Merton is characterised by being the gateway between inner and outer south west London. There is a relatively limited amount of land and floorspace available for business and jobs, relative to the space available for homes, parks and open spaces. This is why, in Merton, our plans for sustainable economic development cover all types of businesses, services and jobs from high value financial services through to restaurants, theatres and other town centre activities, manufacturing, sports, logistics, leisure, culture, schools and community uses.
- 13.1.6. One of the council's main aims is to be open for business and invest in the quality of life of our residents by providing suitable and well-located spaces for a wide variety of businesses and services that enable residents to work and run businesses locally, reducing the need for excessive commuting. This approach helps to deliver the council's five objectives that are within the Local Plan:
- Tackling climate change
 - Supporting resilience
 - Places for people
 - Good growth
 - Place plans and the 20-minute neighbourhood.
- 13.1.7. The relationship between the number of jobs and employment floorspace is not straightforward and is becoming harder to quantify given ongoing advances in technology and changes in working practices. For example, a decline in heavy manufacturing in Merton is not leading to a permanent reduction in demand for industrial premises, as growth areas such as food production, creative industries, advanced manufacturing, research and development, recycling and waste management, construction, printing and publishing and logistics are utilising such sites.

- 13.1.8. In 2020 the Government introduced successive statutory instruments and changes to the Use Class Order. Merton is supportive of the principle of greater flexibility in what business or community space can be used for and this may help to accelerate opportunities for new enterprises, jobs and different ways of working, thus helping with the COVID-19 recovery and providing new services to residents. However, we will also seek to minimise unintended harm from implementing flexible proposals that might occur to local amenity of existing businesses, residents or future users.

Industrial land

- 13.1.9. Successive London Plans from 2004 to the current 2021 London Plan have consistently identified Merton as having low levels of industrial land relative to demand, identifying that a more restrictive approach should be adopted to the transfer of designated industrial sites to non-employment uses. This is common across all south London boroughs.
- 13.1.10. To help support and strengthen the local economy during this time of continued uncertainty and in order to provide the borough with a strong foundation for future business growth, competition, employment and the transition to the low carbon economy, it is our intention to substantially protect and wherever possible, improve the quality of the borough's Strategic Industrial Locations, Locally Significant Industrial Sites and scattered employment sites.
- 13.1.11. However, the council wants to support established business sites that can continue to safely accommodate modern business operations in an urban setting without requiring restrictions being placed on the business to protect nearby amenity, such as opening hours and vehicle movements. Therefore, the council has made some amendments to Merton's Strategic Industrial Locations and Locally Significant Industrial Sites to ensure that Merton's SILs and LSISs are fit for purpose. Merton's SILs and LSISs are set out in Policy EC13.2. We will also use the "agent of change" principle, putting the onus on new, more sensitive development to address potential harm arising from its location where sensitive uses are seeking to establish themselves within or near established active business areas.
- 13.1.12. To tackle the loss of scarce business space and reduce the potential for conflict between established business operations and new residents, the council has introduced an Article 4 Direction to remove permitted development rights from offices in designated industrial areas and Wimbledon Town Centre that want to convert into residential use.
- 13.1.13. Some employment uses do not provide or increase the number of job opportunities in the borough, for instance, storage facilities, particularly self-storage. The council wishes to both increase the number of employment opportunities in the borough and will support new business floorspace that provides a higher number of jobs.

Town centres and high streets

- 13.1.14. The rapid changes in consumer behaviour, accelerated by the pandemic, are changing the nature of high streets across England. Large standard-format “big box” retail is proving less viable as consumers shop online with deliveries on the same day or within 24 hours and demand an experience to attract them to visit high streets or town centres.
- 13.1.15. Even before COVID-19, department stores, clothes stores, electronics and other comparison goods were most at risk from these changes and it seems likely that consumer behaviour will adapt further and faster within the 15-year lifetime of this Local Plan. There is likely to be less demand for standard sized purpose-built premises which attract high rents and business rates but have not been designed to support different types of enterprises or to be subdivided into smaller units. The council will support the redevelopment of purpose-built retail units into other uses appropriate to their location, and will encourage new non-residential premises to take reasonable steps in their design to accommodate subdivision or expansion. This approach will be more cost effective in the long run for the landowner and will create viable space for start-ups and other businesses to grow, flex and change with changing demands and consumer behaviour.

Pop ups and meanwhile uses

- 13.1.16. To create resilient, safe, diverse and vibrant Town Centres, high streets and other areas in Merton, we will support opportunities to use vacant buildings and land for flexible and temporary meanwhile uses or pop ups. The use of temporary buildings and spaces can help stimulate vibrancy, vitality, viability and security by creating social and economic value from vacant properties and provide services locally that reduce the need to travel. Meanwhile uses can also help to prevent blight, reduce the risk of arson, vandalism and anti-social behaviour.
- 13.1.17. The benefits of meanwhile uses also include short-term affordable accommodation for SMEs and individuals, generating a short-term source of revenue for the local economy and providing new and interesting shops, cultural and other events and spaces, which can attract longer-term business investment.
- 13.1.18. London Plan Policy HC5 supports meanwhile uses for culture and creative industries; the council believes that this should be extended more widely to encompass property guardians and any non-residential use.
- 13.1.19. In considering these developments, the council’s priorities will be:
- a. The enhancement or protection of amenity in the surrounding area. This includes the vitality and viability of Town Centres and high streets, the business priorities for established and designated business areas and residential amenity of local neighbourhoods and scattered employment sites;

- b. The provision of jobs, with emphasis on a wide range of salaries and skills and a high number of jobs; and
- c. Ensuring that parameters for any meanwhile use, particularly its longevity and associated obligations, should be established from the outset and agreed by all parties.

Boosting skills

- 13.1.20. Planning to support well paid jobs that offer career progression and meet the needs of future employers must be considered to ensure a sustainable economic model. Merton will work with partners, including the London Mayor and the South London Partnership to facilitate stronger links between businesses and education and training providers in south London. We will work together to ensure that the London Recovery Programme, the Green New Deal mission and the Skills Devolution programme meets the needs of Merton residents. In doing so we will identify skills needs and gaps, recognise the need to respond to changing work patterns, the rise of technology and the demand for suitable workspace.
- 13.1.21. Urban farming, food growing, car / bike shares, clubs, last mile delivery, recycling and reuse of materials are all emerging parts of the circular and sharing economy. In line with the London Plan, we recognise and promote the benefits of a transition to a low carbon circular economy to strengthen London's economic success. There is a gap in green skills in London and we want to support this. The sharing and circular economy enables the efficient use of space and resources while contributing to facilitating social interaction.
- 13.1.22. Currently healthcare, education and the public sector are major employers of our residents, both within the borough and beyond its boundaries (for example at St George's and St Helier hospitals). This is expected to continue with the planned increase in housebuilding across London.
- 13.1.23. It is recognised that the COVID-19 recovery, artificial intelligence (AI) and the tech sector will generate new types of employment, working patterns and in some cases roles that currently do not exist. We want to enable this policy to support employment growth by providing flexible workspace and infrastructure that will facilitate employment space.
- 13.1.24. Development trends in Merton over the past 15 years, as in other urban areas, demonstrate that live/work developments have reverted quickly to a single use and any retention of the mixed use function is unachievable. This results in a loss of either employment or residential space. However, there are currently substantial changes in working practices arising from COVID-19 and it is not known which of these will be permanently established. We will support purpose-built live/work developments outside designated industrial areas and scattered employment sites where there is no harm caused to established businesses or residential areas. Planning obligations will be used to establish purpose-built live/work developments. The "agent of change" principle will be used to protect existing amenity.

13.1.25. We will use planning obligations to ensure that job opportunities and apprenticeships are notified to the council or appropriate nominated agencies so that suitable local people can be given the opportunity to fill these vacancies.

Policy EC13.2 Business locations in Merton

1. Proposals relating to employment sites will be supported where they:

- a. Retain existing employment land and floorspace. The council will support proposals for the redevelopment of vacant and underused existing employment land and floorspace for employment uses.
- b. Are well designed. All proposals for developments should:
 - i) Be flexible and adaptable to the changing needs of different types of potential users over the lifetime of the development;
 - ii) Support the transition to a low carbon economy wherever possible;
 - iii) Have layout, access, parking, landscaping and facilities that are secure and appropriate to the site and its surroundings;
 - iv) Ensure the design of non-residential space protects neighbouring amenity;
 - v) Not unacceptably affect the operation of neighbouring businesses; and,
 - vi) Not adversely affect pedestrian, cycle or traffic movement, road safety or amenity.
- c. Have good access to public transport. Proposals for offices and business space should be easily accessible by walking and cycling and wherever possible have facilities such as showers and secure cycle parking to support this. Measures to support the Healthy Streets Approach and reduce reliance on car travel such as parking restrictions, travel plans and other appropriate measures will also be required.

Offices

- d. Provide larger offices and businesses that generate a lot of trips in Major and District Town Centres or in areas with good access to public transport (PTAL 4 and above) and within close proximity to additional services for employees and workers.
- e. Provide small (generally floorspace below 280 sqm) offices and businesses throughout the borough.
- f. Encourage the refurbishment / redevelopment of existing offices for office use including shared space and flexible working.
- g. Proposals relating to employment sites will be supported where they demonstrate full and proper marketing. Where planning permission is required, proposals will only be supported for the change of use on upper floors in Wimbledon Town Centre from office floorspace to

residential if it can be demonstrated to the council's satisfaction that there is no demand for the office use. Marketing of the site will need to be demonstrated at reasonable prices for a period of 18 months (1 ½ years).

Industrial land

- h.** Provide general industry and storage and distribution in Merton's Strategic Industrial Locations and Locally Significant Industrial Sites.
- i.** Protect and manage the designated Strategic Industrial Locations and Locally Significant Industrial Sites. The council will ensure that these sites are prioritised for industrial and distribution uses that could operate 24-hours and are not compatible with homes, schools and other sensitive uses.

Shared workspace and flexible business space

- j.** Provide shared workspace, flexible or co-working space which is well-designed and well-managed to optimise its success. Where flexible working/co-working space is proposed in conjunction with a reduction in employment floorspace on the site, the council will seek planning obligations to secure that the flexible working/co-working space will be designed and actively managed for flexible working/co-working for a period of at least two years from the date of opening.

Supporting text

- 13.2.1. The NPPF, London Plan and Merton's strategic economic development policy seeks to optimise employment opportunities for Merton's residents assisted by supporting new development of business premises and protecting employment land. These policies also direct new employment opportunities to the most appropriate and sustainable locations. This policy will contribute towards delivering these policies by setting out how proposals for employment will be considered.
- 13.2.2. Merton's main employment areas are the designated Town Centres and designated industrial sites (both the Strategic Industrial Locations [SILs] and Locally Significant Industrial Sites [LSIS]) as designated on Merton's Policies Map.
- 13.2.3. Merton's Town Centres are highly suitable for commercial, business and services (Use Class E and F). These locations are considered the most appropriate and sustainable for these uses as they:
 - a. are highly accessible by different forms of transport;
 - b. allow for the expansion of business;

- c. allow for similar businesses to locate together and for neighbouring uses to be compatible with each other;
- d. offer alternative complimentary services/uses to Town Centres visitors; and
- e. support the night-time and tourist economy.

Businesses and offices

- 13.2.4. The council aims to increase the borough's capacity for attracting and accommodating a range of jobs in Merton, including offices, to increase employment opportunities and to provide good quality employment in Merton.
- 13.2.5. The London Plan and Merton's Local Plan encourage office development in Wimbledon Town Centre including large offices designed and managed for flexible working. Flexible working supports the economy, helps support collaboration and socialising while reducing the need to travel. The Mayor's London Office Review has consistently identified Wimbledon Town Centre as one of the few outer London locations capable of attracting office-based businesses and jobs that might otherwise have premises in central London. This is reflected in planning applications and development activity in Wimbledon to modernise existing offices and provide new speculative offices. Post COVID-19, Wimbledon is well positioned to act as a hub for offices that are managed specifically for flexible working due to the Town Centre's excellent transport links, proximity to residential areas, opportunities for socialising and strong brand name.
- 13.2.6. Over the past 10 years Wimbledon Town Centre has shown market demand for new and refurbished office development which is not evident in the rest of Merton. Wimbledon is a relatively small major centre, tightly bound by high quality residential areas with very little room for expansion. There is very limited demand for new build offices in the rest of Merton and as such Merton has a constrained office supply.
- 13.2.7. The council will work with landowners to meet market demand for high-quality, well-designed offices commensurate with Wimbledon's status as a major centre with metropolitan characteristics and in recognition of Wimbledon's excellent transport links and as an internationally recognised name. Across the borough, smaller offices will be supported in Local Town Centres or in areas with good access to public transport (PTAL 4 and above).
- 13.2.8. As stated in the NPPF and NPPG and detailed in the policy in this plan on out-of-centre commercial development, proposals for new large office developments located edge-of-centre and out-of-centre will be required to submit a sequential test and may be required to submit an impact assessment. This is to strike a balance between Merton's aspirations for economic growth whilst protecting the vitality and viability of Merton's designated Town Centres and minimising harm to residential areas. For the purposes of this policy, small offices are defined as being below 280sqm floorspace.

- 13.2.9. PTAL informs geographical area levels of access to public transport; the higher PTAL levels are concentrated around the Town Centres and transport interchanges of Wimbledon, Colliers Wood, Mitcham, Morden, and Raynes Park. Areas to the south east and south west of the borough have the lowest accessibility levels. As set out in the transport policies, applicants should use the latest and most up to date PTAL calculator from Transport for London.
- 13.2.10. We seek to optimise employment opportunities in Merton by supporting the development of offices and directing new office space towards the most appropriate and sustainable locations. This policy will contribute towards delivering these policies by protecting offices for which there is demand. We will encourage the redevelopment/refurbishment of existing vacant offices to modernise the space for businesses. Changes to the Use Class Order in 2020 permit offices to change use (either by permitted development or prior approval) to a wide range of commercial, business and service occupiers.
- 13.2.11. To protect space for businesses and jobs, in 2015 the council introduced an Article 4 Direction to remove these permitted development rights for offices in Wimbledon Town Centre and Merton's designated industrial estates to change to residential.
- 13.2.12. In instances where planning permission is required, proposals for change of use from offices to other uses will be considered, where it can be demonstrated that there is no need for office uses. Applicants will need to provide Marketing and Vacancy evidence in accordance with the criteria set out in the Appendices, for a minimum of 18 months (1.5 years).
- 13.2.13. Proposals for change of use from offices to alternative uses on the ground floor located in Town Centres should be dealt with under policies elsewhere in this plan including policies on design. Also outside of Town Centres, change of use from offices to alternative uses should be in accordance with policy EC13.3 Protection of scattered employment sites.

Designated business and industrial sites

- 13.2.14. Over the past five years Merton has seen high levels of demand for space in its industrial areas from businesses that need to be close to the London economy, with very low vacancy rates and strong rental yields. Successive London Plans have recognised that industrial space in Merton and south London is limited and is in high demand.
- 13.2.15. Merton has a wide range of key businesses that support jobs and provide services to London's population. These include food production, waste management, industrial laundrettes serving hotels and hospitals, printers, theatre stage engineering and other activities.
- 13.2.16. What these businesses have in common is the need to operate without the restrictions that would be placed on them in more residential areas. HGV movements, additional noise and smells, early morning starts or 24-hour operations are essential operational requirements for

many businesses. The council protects its designated industrial areas for these reasons and has implemented an Article 4 Direction to prevent the further conversion of offices to residential within designated industrial areas and Wimbledon Town Centre via prior approval in order to protect space for business uses. The council will also use its powers to ensure that established noise-generating businesses (e.g. industrial uses, rail infrastructure) remain viable and can continue to grow without unreasonable restrictions being placed on them, in line with the “agent of change” approach in the NPPF and in the London Plan.

13.2.17. Merton’s Strategic Industrial Locations are recorded on Merton’s Policies Map and set out below:

Table 13.2a Merton’s Strategic Industrial Locations

Strategic Industrial Locations	Size (hectares)	Characteristics
South Wimbledon Business Area	32ha	One of the largest, most occupied strategic industrial locations in south west London with highest rental yields. Wide range of different types of industrial businesses
Willow Lane	414ha	Large industrial area with focus on heavy industry, recycling and waste management
Durnsford Road / Weir Road	20ha	Range of different businesses
Plough Lane	14ha	Range of businesses
Hallowfield Way / Benedicts Wharf - southern half (amended)	4ha	SIL area with frontage to the A24 (west of tram line) being retained as Strategic Industrial Location Area.
Prince George’s Road	6ha	Industrial area behind Colliers Wood town centre. Several trade counters

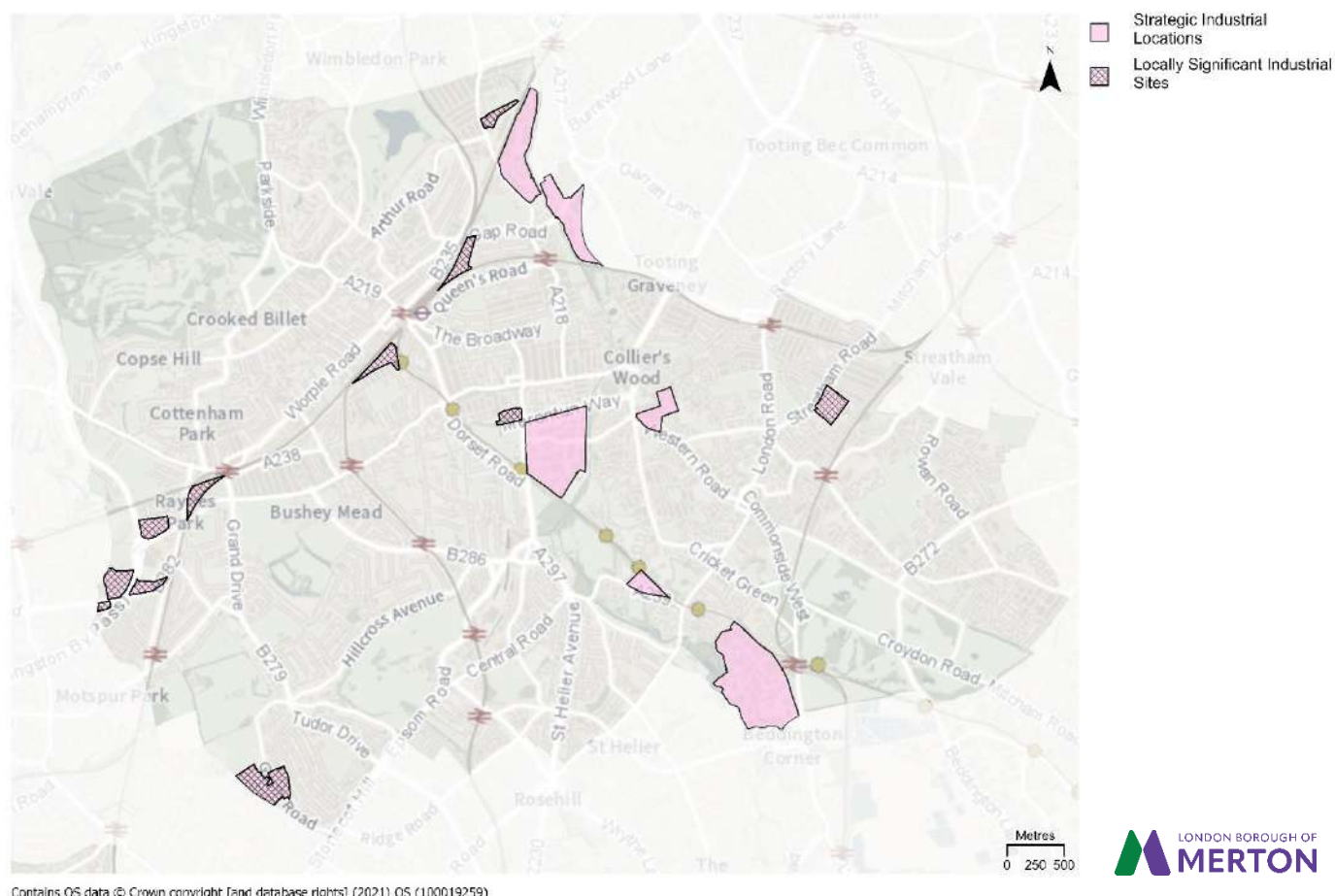


Figure 13.2b Industrial areas in Merton

13.2.18. To allow for businesses to operate without excessive constraints from nearby homes (such as restrictions on opening hours, heavy vehicle movements, noise etc) the council will support proposals for manufacturing (B2 Use Class) and storage and distribution (B8 Use Class) within the designated industrial areas. Proposals for research and development light industrial or particular sui generis uses may be supported where the nature of the development requires an industrial (as opposed to a high street or scattered employment site) location and where the scheme is willing to accept restrictions on its conversion to other uses that would not be compatible with an industrial area. In line with the “agent of change” principle, the council will not support proposals in designated industrial areas that would curtail the industrial operations of existing businesses.

13.2.19. In designated industrial areas in Merton, higher density trip-generating developments such as offices, shops or places of worship can interfere with the operations of surrounding businesses through increased traffic congestion, parking and pedestrian movements. Planning permission will not be granted for the development of offices in the designated industrial areas unless these are ancillary to the principal use of the premises or site.

- 13.2.20. Logistics and other employment activities that generate frequent vehicle movements to and from the site/premises (excluding retail warehousing or any type of retail activity), will be encouraged to locate within the main industrial areas that are adjacent to the Strategic Road Network and have good vehicular access to the site.
- 13.2.21. Proposals for new development or change of use should be compatible with the effectiveness of the SIL in accommodating the 24-hour operation of industrial type activities including the amenity of neighbouring occupiers of buildings. If proposals are likely to conflict with the successful operation of existing businesses nearby or cause harm to the amenities of occupants of neighbouring buildings without any way of mitigation, planning permission will not be granted. Mitigation measures through design conditions or planning obligations may be sought to improve site access or minimise disruption to neighbouring businesses where necessary. In line with the “agent of change” principle set out in the London Plan, the council will not support proposals in designated industrial areas that would curtail the industrial operations of existing businesses.

Shared workspace and flexible business space

- 13.2.22. The council supports co-working and other forms of flexible working space in Merton which can support a greater number of jobs within the same office floorspace. Advice from organisations that have experience in managing co-working office and business space in London is that a number of factors are critical to its success including the location, size, presence of other ancillary facilities and the management / rental structures.
- 13.2.23. There are many examples of flexible managed co-working spaces in London and an increase in companies such as Central Working, Workspace, Co-working and Techhub who specialise in providing this space. Managed correctly, these spaces can support a much higher number of jobs and small businesses than more traditional business floorspace. These spaces can also provide an excellent opportunity for all sizes of office-based businesses to work flexibly; reducing their rental commitments while benefitting from occasional office and meeting space as and when required. The council wants to ensure that development that proposes co-working is managed and run effectively so as to genuinely result in the extra jobs density that is cited at the planning application stage.
- 13.2.24. Shared, flexible working and co-working business spaces are characterised by:
- a. Providing desks or small workspaces within a fully serviced office that can be used by individuals or businesses;
 - b. Monthly rents or less, making the space more affordable and flexible, rent being inclusive of services;

- c. The rent is inclusive of other services such as utilities, telecoms, post, meeting spaces etc.,
- d. Space for lots of people and businesses to come together, not just one or two, to create a vibrant business community and increase the chances of business collaboration;
- e. No long leases or large financial commitments required to join;
- f. Having a range of premises on one site or by having several sites so businesses can grow either by moving to a bigger space within the site or by moving to a flexible working area with larger premises within the same contract;
- g. Access to other services such as a nearby café or with a café on site;
- h. Having a dedicated, expert company to manage and curate the co-working offer who knows business needs and can tap into the relevant business and SME market and retain jobs, ensuring that they are being advertised and managed to maximise jobs and business retention and satisfaction;
- i. Being easily accessible for the individuals, businesses and clients they are trying to attract and not located in areas that will disturb residential neighbours with travel to and from the site; and
- j. Having a successful brand name and image commensurate to the SME / tech / creative / business market that they are trying to attract.

13.2.25. We want to ensure that proposals for flexible working are successfully delivered in Merton for the benefit of their users and that the provision of flexible working is not simply being cited at planning application stage to claim a higher jobs density when providing less employment floorspace. Therefore, where flexible working is proposed in conjunction with a reduction in employment floorspace on the site, the council will seek planning obligations to secure that the flexible working / co-working space is designed with regard to the attributes listed above and be actively managed for flexible working / co-working for a period of at least two years from the date of opening by a flexible working specialist company with a track record in this.

Policy EC13.3 Protection of scattered employment sites

1. Proposals that result in the loss of scattered employment sites to residential uses will be resisted except where:
 - a. The site is located in a predominantly residential area and it can be demonstrated that its operation has had a significant adverse effect on local residential amenity;
 - b. The size, configuration, access arrangements and other characteristics of the site make it unsuitable and financially unviable for whole-site employment use; and
 - c. It has been demonstrated to the council's satisfaction that there is no realistic prospect of employment or community use on this site in the future. This may be demonstrated by full and proper marketing of the site at reasonable prices for a period of 18 months (1½ years).
2. If proposals do not meet policy requirements of E13.3 1c. above, the council will seek measures to mitigate against the loss of employment land. Such measures may include providing employment, as part of a mixed use scheme on site.

Supporting text

- 13.3.1. Employment sites outside the designated Town Centre and designated employment areas (i.e. those not shown on the Policies Map) are referred to as 'scattered employment sites'. For the purposes of this policy, 'employment' and 'business' refers to premises or land that operates within the Use Classes E(g), B2 and B8 under the Town and Country Planning Use Classes Order (as amended). 'Community' uses refer to premises or land that operate within the use class E(e-f) and F1. It is intended for Policy EC13.3 to protect other uses located on scattered employment sites such as leisure and entertainment E(d) and F2(c) and uses identified as sui generis uses where appropriate.
- 13.3.2. The NPPF, the London Plan and Merton's strategic policy on economic development all seek to optimise job opportunities for Merton's residents by supporting the development of employment uses to the most appropriate locations. This policy aims to deliver economic growth by setting out a detailed approach to the protection of employment land for which there is need.
- 13.3.3. Business, commercial, service and local community uses will be supported on scattered employment sites throughout Merton. Employment on scattered employment sites contributes towards Merton's existing and growing diverse economy.
- 13.3.4. There is constant pressure on scattered employment sites to be redeveloped for residential uses that will bring high values to the developer. Throughout the years, Merton has completed a number of viability studies to support our policies. These studies demonstrate

that in Merton over the past 15 years, residential uses have a significantly higher land value than other land uses. Therefore the 'hope value' that speculative developers can pay for such sites in the expectation of planning permission for housing displaces existing jobs as well as outbidding potential investors in premises for business and community uses.

- 13.3.5. A delicate balance needs to be struck between delivering new homes and business/job growth. Based on Merton's characteristics, a sustainable future for the borough relies on maximising opportunities for employment and local businesses, in some cases by prioritising business and jobs over high value alternative uses. Without this approach, Merton would not be able to support a diverse local economy and promote a commercially viable, thriving mix of employment, which increases jobs and services to local people in line with the NPPF. Scattered employment sites are valuable to local communities in providing services and local jobs whilst reducing the need to travel, helping create and maintain a robust local economy and achieving sustainable, mixed use communities.
- 13.3.6. However, where the employment use is not compatible with a residential environment because of noise, smell or other pollutants then the council will encourage redevelopment to community or other employment uses that do not harm the amenity of residential neighbours. The appropriateness and lack of financial viability of the site for employment and community purposes have to be demonstrated before the loss of employment land to residential will be permitted. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1.
- 13.3.7. Proposals for sui generis use on scattered employment sites, not least because by their nature, must be treated on their individual merits and considered on a site-by-site basis.
- 13.3.8. In these instances, the applicant would need to demonstrate, to the council's satisfaction, that they have undertaken full and proper marketing of the site as well as evidence that the site is no longer appropriate to accommodate employment or community uses. To demonstrate that full and proper marketing has been undertaken to justify that the employment and community uses are no longer viable, the council requires the applicant to provide Marketing and Vacancy evidence in accordance with the criteria set out in the Appendices, for a minimum of 18 months (1.5 years).
- 13.3.9. If proposals do not meet the terms of this policy, the council may also seek measures to mitigate against the loss of employment or community use.
- 13.3.10. In circumstances where proposals for mixed use development are considered, proposals must be designed to optimise the likelihood of successful occupation and function of employment uses once built. In line with the "Agent of Change" principle set out in the London Plan and the NPPF the council will not support proposals on scattered employment sites where these would prevent the successful operation of non-residential uses. The premises/sites retained for employment uses must:

- a. Be of an attractive size and character for occupation by employment and community uses and flexible to accommodate alternative uses;
- b. Be compatible with the character and appearance of the area;
- c. Be designed to accommodate the proposed use (and other uses);
- d. Not be harmed by way of noise, disturbance, loss of light or privacy;
- e. Allow adequate safe vehicle access to and from the highway, prioritise access by active travel and public transport, provide adequate high quality cycle parking and minimise car parking in accordance with London Plan standards; and
- f. Be built out in full before proposals for change of use from employment to alternative uses will be considered by the council.

13.3.11. We may require other measures to support the local economy. Such measures may include the applicant providing alternative sites for employment use and community uses for which there is need, (for instance 'land swaps') or providing equivalent employment in jobs or floorspace, as part of a mixed use scheme on-site.

Policy EC.13.4 Local Employment Opportunities

1. Merton want to ensure that residents and local businesses are supported within the borough through local employment, business retention and inward investment opportunities which will lead to greater local economic growth and the transition to the low carbon economy. This can be achieved in part, by enabling skills, jobs creation, the circular economy and local procurement during new development.
2. With this in mind the council will:
 - a. Work with developers to increase skills and employment opportunities in Merton by requiring all Major Development to provide opportunities for local residents and businesses to apply for employment and other opportunities during the construction of developments and in the resultant end use. Opportunities for employment and skills training will be considered by means of planning obligations for Major Developments:
 - i. residential developments of 10 homes or more
 - ii. non-residential developments exceeding 1,000m².
 - b. Seek to secure a minimum of 10% of the total jobs created by the construction of new development and 20% end use job opportunities and apprenticeships to be advertised exclusively to local residents through the council's economic development officer or appropriate nominated agencies for a minimum period so that local people can be given the opportunity to fill these vacancies. A local employment strategy may be required for very large development schemes.
 - c. Work with local training providers to aim to ensure that local residents are given access to the right skills training so that they can take advantage of opportunities created by new development and help address skills deficits in the local population.
 - d. Require the local employment strategy for Major Developments to cover procedures to ensure small and medium sized local enterprises have access to supply chain tender opportunities for the procurement of goods and services generated by the development both during and after construction.

Supporting text

- 13.4.1. We seek to maximise employment, business and other economic development opportunities for Merton's residents and supporting the transition to a low carbon economy. This policy will contribute towards addressing the climate emergency and delivering these policies by encouraging Major Developments to contribute towards increasing employment opportunities in Merton.

- 13.4.2. In accordance with the London Plan, we are committed to training, work placements and apprenticeships and view them as being a sustainable way to improve employment prospects for local people, particularly those to deliver low carbon skills. The council is determined to ensure that the use of S106 obligations helps to secure placements for local people both during the construction phase of building projects and in the resultant end use.
- 13.4.3. Merton is a relatively affluent borough and overall, Merton is one of the less deprived areas in the country. However, parts of the borough have pockets of deprivation, higher rates of unemployment and lower levels of skills/qualifications. We want to address this imbalance by providing employment opportunities for all residents.
- 13.4.4. Reducing deprivation, sourcing local labour and reducing the need to travel is a fundamental part of creating sustainable communities.
- 13.4.5. The Mayor's London Plan requires strategic development to support local employment, skills and training including those that support low carbon jobs and skills. Strategic developments are those defined as schemes of over 150 homes for residential use and development over 15,000 sqm for commercial uses. However, Merton is a small borough and it is highlighted in the Authority Monitoring Reports throughout the years that Merton rarely sees development of this quantum and size. Therefore, to increase employment opportunities for Merton's residents and for new developments to benefit the whole community, this policy proposes that Major Developments contribute towards increasing residents' employment opportunities and skills, where viable. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 Infrastructure. For this policy, Major Developments include proposals for:
- a. Residential development comprising of 10 homes or more;
 - b. Non-residential developments where the floor space is 1,000 square metres or more.
- 13.4.6. 'Other opportunities' includes applicants procuring local companies in the supply-chain and may include offering local residents' apprenticeships or work experience to improve skills. Apprenticeships/work experience opportunities would be particularly relevant for the larger Major Developments.
- 13.4.7. For applicants to demonstrate to the council that they have met this policy, applicants should advertise employment and business procurement opportunities including jobs, work experience and apprenticeships for residents for a reasonable length of time agreed with the council's economic development officer or appropriate nominated agencies.
- 13.4.8. We currently work in partnership with a number of agencies to secure places for apprenticeships and other employment opportunities throughout Merton.
- 13.4.9. For Major Development, planning conditions may be used to require the submission of a local employment strategy. This local employment strategy should outline measures to

demonstrate that training and employment opportunities could be accessed by local people during the construction phase and resultant end use of the scheme.

- 13.4.10. We realise that it may not be feasible for all Major Developments to meet this policy requirement particularly developments that are close to the size thresholds detailed above. In circumstances where applicants, due to feasibility issues, find it difficult to meet this policy, this would need to be demonstrated to the council.
- 13.4.11. We wish to encourage use of existing local businesses to support new development and will do this by encouraging local supply chain procurement. Not only does this support local businesses, it also has an environmental and social benefit for businesses and residents.

Policy TC 13.5 Merton's Town Centre and Neighbourhood Parades

1. This policy contributes towards maintaining and enhancing the attractiveness of Town Centres by encouraging more people to use these locations and promoting a sharing and circular economy wherever possible. To maintain and improve the overall vitality and viability of Merton's Town Centres, the council will support new development in Merton's Town Centres and Neighbourhood Parades commensurate with their scale and function, providing it respects or improves the character and local environment.

All frontages in Merton's Town Centres and Neighbourhood Parades

2. Supporting proposals for developments where:
 - a. The proposed use is compatible with a shopping frontage and provides a direct service to the general public;
 - b. The proposal will result in an active street frontage;
 - c. The vitality and viability of the Town Centre or Neighbourhood Parade is not likely to be significantly harmed;
 - d. A window display is provided; and
 - e. No significant adverse effects on the amenities of nearby residents, road safety, car parking or traffic flows would result from the proposal.

Within Wimbledon, Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Morden Town Centres

3. In addition to 2., supporting proposals for developments that:
 - a. Provide a range of commercial unit sizes;
 - b. Provide a wide range of Town Centre Type Uses which contribute towards the vitality and viability of town centres including shopping, leisure, entertainment, cultural, community and offices.
 - c. Betting shops (use identified as sui generis), are not compatible with the main retail or social function of the Town Centres and are not considered appropriate new uses within the Primary Shopping Area.

Within Local Town Centres

4. Supporting proposals:
 - a. for development up to 1,000sqm per unit of floorspace for Town Centre Type Uses in the designated Local Town Centre of Arthur Road, Motspur Park, North Mitcham, Raynes Park and South Wimbledon. The council will resist major increases (above 1,000sqm) in town centre type

use floorspace in local centres unless it contributes to the council’s Good Growth objectives.

- b. that do not amalgamate existing ground floor shopping frontages in Wimbledon Village local centre so as to result in a large unit (with a floorspace of 280sqm or more).
- c. that do not provide betting shops within the Primary Shopping Area.

Within Neighbourhood Parades

- 5. Maintaining Neighbourhood Parades to provide convenience shopping and other services within walking distance of local residents.

Supporting text

- 13.5.1. The council aims to maintain, enhance and protect Merton’s Town Centres as focal points for residents and visitors that provide civic, retail and other commercial services and facilities. Policy TC13.5 contributes towards delivering this by setting out how proposals relating to the scale and function of proposed development in Merton’s Town Centres and Neighbourhood Parades will be considered.
- 13.5.2. The location of similar businesses, such as shops, cafes, restaurants, theatres and cinemas together makes town centres more attractive and sociable, increasing the footfall which helps support businesses and helps to create an identity and a sense of place for the community. The NPPF makes clear that local authorities should define the extent of the Primary Shopping Area and the Town Centre boundary. These are available on Merton’s Policies Map for each Town Centre.
- 13.5.3. As detailed in the London Plan, the definition of Town Centre includes Major, District and Local Centres. This term will be used throughout this document to provide policies or guidance that is relevant to all of these types of Town Centre. The boundaries of these centres and neighbourhood parades are shown on Merton’s Policies Map.

Table 13.5a: Merton’s town centre designations

Merton’s Town Centres	Designations
Wimbledon	Major Town Centre
Colliers Wood; Mitcham; Morden	District Town Centre
Arthur Road; Motspur Park; North Mitcham; Raynes Park; South Wimbledon; Wimbledon Village	Local Town Centre

- 13.5.4. The NPPF and associated NPPG promotes the vitality and viability of Town Centres. These provide a sense of place for Merton’s residents and are important areas for communities. The aim is to focus a wide range of shops, leisure and similar trip-generating uses to locate in

Merton's Town Centres, to encourage people to use our Town Centres to socialise, to shop and to support local businesses and jobs. However, growth needs to be considered alongside the need to conserve the local heritage and character, as well as providing a focus for community and civic activity.

- 13.5.5. Due to changes in consumer behaviour, including the increase of on-line shopping and home shopping, town centres are no longer only retail-focused but provide a social environment for residents, workers and visitors to meet and visit. Pre COVID-19 our evidence showed that vacancies in Merton's Town Centres were lower than both the regional and national average, and over the next 10 years the council wants to ensure that Merton's Town Centre premises remain occupied and the Town Centres continue to thrive.
- 13.5.6. In order to ensure that Merton's Town Centres remain a focal point for social activity, providing services and facilities as well as employment to residents and attract visitors, the council proposes that Merton's shop front designations are more flexible to deal with changes to the economy and shopping habits.
- 13.5.7. To ensure Merton's Town Centres can continue to offer an attractive environment for its users and remain relevant and vibrant to respond to changing consumer behaviour, the council will permit commercial, business, services, local community and learning activities (use classes E and F) cinemas, concert halls, pubs and bars, nightclubs, tourist hostels, theatres, laundrettes and taxi services (sui generis use class). This is to ensure that Merton's residents and workers can meet and enjoy activities with friends and family. These uses would also attract visitors to the area. The proposed use will need to have an active frontage and applicants should use Merton's supplementary planning document on Shop Fronts (2017) to enable high quality design, regardless of the nature of the interior of the premises.
- 13.5.8. Betting shops (use identified as sui generis), are not compatible with the main retail or social function of the Town Centres and thus are not considered appropriate new uses within the Primary Shopping Area of Merton's Town Centres.
- 13.5.9. Changes to the Use Class Order in 2020 support greater flexibility (either by permitted development or prior approval) to a wide range of commercial, business and services, local community and education. We are supportive of the principle of greater flexibility in what business or community space can be used for and may help to accelerate opportunities for new enterprises, jobs and different ways of working, thus helping with the COVID-19 recovery and providing new services to residents. However, we also want to avoid unintended consequences of greater flexibility, such as the loss of small shops or other vital businesses that provide local services and support a thriving Town Centre.
- 13.5.10. We will support development in Merton's Town Centres and Neighbourhood Parades commensurate with their scale and function and where it respects or improves the character and local environment of the area.

13.5.11. Merton's Town Centres and Neighbourhood Parades provide shops and services that meet different needs of residents. But these Town Centres and Neighbourhood Parades also have different characteristics and levels of capacity to grow in the future. The council encourages shops and services, cafes, restaurants, leisure and entertainment facilities, offices and community uses to locate in Merton and will support growth that is appropriate to designated Town Centres, Neighbourhood Parades and the surrounding area. This will also ensure that development that attracts a large number of trips is located in places which are accessible by a range of transport choices.

Merton's Major and District Town Centres

13.5.12. Attractive to residents, tourists, businesses and their staff, as Merton's Major Town Centre, Wimbledon has a variety of shops, services, cafes, restaurants, cinemas, theatres and offices. By capitalising on Wimbledon's international and national reputation for quality, the council hopes to further enhance the character and vibrancy of the area to create a sense of place and ensure that there is continual activity throughout the day and at the weekend for residents, workers and visitors whilst protecting its heritage assets. The Future Wimbledon supplementary planning document should be used to guide development proposals in Wimbledon.

13.5.13. As District Town Centres, Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Morden provide shops, services, cafes/restaurants and local businesses to meet the everyday needs of the local community.

13.5.14. Colliers Wood's retail offer is on a par with many major centres in London. Over the past 10 years the enhancement through Connecting Colliers Wood, redevelopment of the Tower and enhancement of the Town Centre offer with restaurants, cafes, a new library and other services has created a far greater diversity of offer to its visitors.

13.5.15. Mitcham has a unique cultural identity and character, reinforced through Rediscover Mitcham, and supports a daily street market which operates in the main shopping area of Mitcham.

13.5.16. Merton's Civic Centre and local businesses generally serving day-to-day needs are located in Morden. Morden sees higher footfall passing through the centre than other town centres of its size, as people connect between the buses, underground, car parking and nearby train and tram. In terms of the type of shops and services provided, recent consultation undertaken has clarified that Morden does not currently have the types of uses that its residents are looking for. Through the regeneration of Morden Town Centre, a greater range of shops and other town centre and leisure uses such as cafes and restaurants, will be provided alongside a significant amount of new and affordable housing and substantial improvements to the public realm. Morden will retain its designation as a District Centre, with no overall increase to the scale of retail space provided.

13.5.17. Wimbledon, Colliers Wood, Mitcham, and Morden are suitable for a wide range of commercial unit sizes. To avoid adverse impacts on existing Town Centres, floorspace over 1,000 square metres for Town Centre Type Uses will not be supported outside Wimbledon, Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Morden. Small units will be welcomed, particularly in Wimbledon and Colliers Wood, where smaller units will help to attract and retain a diverse town centre offer and give more options to independents and start-ups.

Local Town Centres

13.5.18. Arthur Road, Motspur Park, North Mitcham, Raynes Park, South Wimbledon and Wimbledon Village are designated as Local Centres. Except for Wimbledon Village, these Local Centres provide shops and services to meet the everyday needs of the local community and are places for small and local business. These Local Centres serve small catchments and are within walking distance of local residents.

13.5.19. South Wimbledon is a newly proposed Local Centre in this Local Plan with specific details available in policy N7.1.

13.5.20. Wimbledon Village has more of a niche/specialist role and a unique character. To retain and reinforce its character and offer, it is considered that the amalgamation of existing ground floor unit frontages facing Wimbledon High Street, Church Road and Ridgway that would result in a large unit (with a gross floorspace of 280 sqm or more) would be inappropriate, having regard to the existing scale and character of the area. Merton's Annual Shopping Survey shows that the average ground floor unit size of existing Town Centre Types Uses in Wimbledon Village is less than 100sqm gross floorspace, thus the amalgamation of existing units that would result in a ground floorspace over 280 sqm would be quite large for this area. While amalgamation of unit frontages would be inappropriate, use of upper floors within the same frontage or use of the rear of the premises may be acceptable to deliver town centre type uses above 280sqm.

13.5.21. Local Centres complement Merton's main Town Centres, providing local services and enhance the area's character. Development that provides a major increase (over 1,000 sqm) of town centre type uses will not be supported in the Local Centres of Arthur Road, Motspur Park, North Mitcham, Raynes Park South Wimbledon and Wimbledon Village unless it contributes to the council's Good Growth objectives.

Small commercial units

13.5.22. The availability of small units provides improved choice for business location and affordability. In turn, having a variety of businesses provides choice for consumers and this contributes significantly towards maintaining and enhancing the attractiveness and viability of Merton's town centres. Small units are often more affordable, thereby encouraging more specialist or independent retailers.

- 13.5.23. The need to maintain and to provide additional small units is particularly relevant to supporting business retention and diversity in the Town Centres of Wimbledon, Colliers Wood, South Wimbledon and Wimbledon Village.
- 13.5.24. For retail proposals, Merton's definition of small, large and major developments refers to net floorspace. For all other town centre type uses the definition of small, large and major developments refer to gross floorspace.

Other frontages within Town Centres

- 13.5.25. All Town Centre development proposals must have active street frontages to contribute towards their vibrancy and to promote a positive identity within Merton's Town Centres. Activities should complement each other and the centre and should be of a use, design and scale proportionate to the area.

Vacancies in frontages in Town Centres

- 13.5.26. In Town Centres temporary planning permission may be granted for meanwhile and temporary uses in vacant shopping frontages until these units are re-occupied by uses that are appropriate to that retail frontage. Temporary planning permission will be considered based on the proposal(s) put forward. These proposals must complement surrounding uses in the area and must not harm nearby business and residential amenity.

Neighbourhood Parades

- 13.5.27. To meet the day-to-day needs of local communities and to reduce the need to travel, essential local shops such as small supermarkets, pharmacies and post offices should be retained within 5 minutes' walk (400 metres) of residential areas.
- 13.5.28. Neighbourhood Parades, located throughout the borough, have been designated to ensure that residents and workers continue to have access to a range of important local shops available for their day-to-day needs, which are easily accessible to people without a car or with restricted mobility. An unintended consequence of the greater flexibility afforded by government's 2020 changes to the Use Class Order could be the loss of such small shops to other non-retail uses where these lie within a kilometre of another shop. Merton is a fairly compact borough, less than 5km wide in places, and we want to retain small shops and services within walking distance of its residents.
- 13.5.29. Neighbourhood Parades complement the local shopping facilities provided in Merton's Town Centres and ensure that local convenience shopping facilities are within 5 minutes' walk (400 metres) of residential areas in Merton.

- 13.5.30. Neighbourhood Parades are identified to ensure that local shopping facilities are retained within walking distance of residents to meet their day-to-day needs. As set out in the Table 13.5a “Merton’s Town Centres”, Neighbourhood Parades are not designated Town Centres and as such, large increases in commercial floorspace will be resisted in line with policy TC13.6.
- 13.5.31. To ensure that convenience shops are retained, local research supports a minimum of 30% of units in a designated Neighbourhood Parade to remain in retail use, taking into account unimplemented planning permissions for changes of use.
- 13.5.32. When a change of use is proposed, the new use must provide a local service, such as shops, small offices, estate agents or banks, restaurant, café, pub, bars and health, indoor sports and community uses (e.g. a crèche) which:
- a. supports the vitality of the parade;
 - b. provides a window display; and
 - c. has no significant adverse effects on the amenities of residents, other businesses, road safety or traffic flows.

Table 13.5b Neighbourhood Parades in Merton

Parade Name
Cannon Hill Lane and Martin Way; 141-145 Cannon Hill Lane and 244- 262 Martin Way (Cannon Hill Ward)
Central Road: 44 – 60 Central Road, Morden (St. Helier Ward)
Chestnut Grove and South Lodge Avenue; 158-174 Chestnut Grove, Pollards Hill and 10-32 South Lodge Avenue, Pollards Hill (Pollards Hill ward)
Church Road: 55-59 Church Road, Mitcham (Cricket Green)
Coombe Lane, West Wimbledon; 253 – 271 Coombe Lane, Raynes Park and 348-364 Coombe Lane, Raynes Park (Raynes Park and Village wards)
Durnsford Road: 373-413 Durnsford Road, SW19, north of Arthur Road town centre (Wimbledon Park ward)
Epsom Road: 41-53 Epsom Road, Morden (Lower Morden ward)
Grand Drive (north): 244 – 264 Grand Drive, Morden (Lower Morden ward)
Grand Drive: 300-372 Grand Drive, Lower Morden (Lower Morden ward)
Green Lane: 99-137 Green Lane, St. Helier (St. Helier ward)

Grove Road: 36-378 Grove Road, Mitcham (Longthornton ward)
Haydons Road: 284-298 Haydons Road and 319 – 335 Haydons Road, South Wimbledon (Wimbledon Park and Wandle wards)
High Street: 29 -43 High Street and 46 – 62 High Street, Colliers Wood (Colliers Wood ward)
Kingston Road: 92 - 112 Kingston Road (Abbey ward)
Leopold Road; 1-27 Leopold Road, 2 – 32 Leopold Road and 1a Strathearn Road SW19 (Wimbledon Park and Hillside wards)
London Road, Mitcham 323 – 337 London Road CR4
Manor Road and Northborough Road; 211-219 Manor Road and 291a – 307 Northborough Road, Pollards Hill, Mitcham (Longthornton ward)
Martin Way: 43-55 Martin Way, Morden (Cannon Hill ward)
The Rush: 1-12 (cons) Merton Park Parade (The Rush), near Wimbledon Chase (Merton Park ward)
Ridgway: 65-89 Ridgway, SW19, Wimbledon (Hillside ward)
St. Helier Avenue: 41-67 St.Helier Avenue (Ravensbury ward)
Streatham Road; 172b - 196 Streatham Road and 173 – 221 Streatham Road, Streatham (Graveney ward)
Tamworth Lane: 299- 301 Tamworth Lane Mitcham (Longthornton ward)
Tudor Drive: 11-27 Tudor Drive, Morden (Lower Morden ward)
Wimbledon Chase: 288 – 312 Kingston Road, Wimbledon Chase Railway Station and 353-373 Kingston Road, Wimbledon Chase (Merton Park and Wimbledon Town and Dundonald wards)

Active street frontages

13.5.33. Active street frontages contribute significantly to the vibrancy, sense of place and safety of town centres. Allowing people to access and view inside and outside of the buildings provides natural surveillance, activity and contributes towards the vibrancy of town centres. Shop fronts should provide clear visibility between the inside of the premises and the street. Conditions may be placed on planning applications to ensure that proposals do not result in dead frontages, for instance, restricting internal advertising. Applicants should use Merton's supplementary planning document on Shop Fronts (2017) to enable the high quality design of shop fronts, regardless of the internal use.

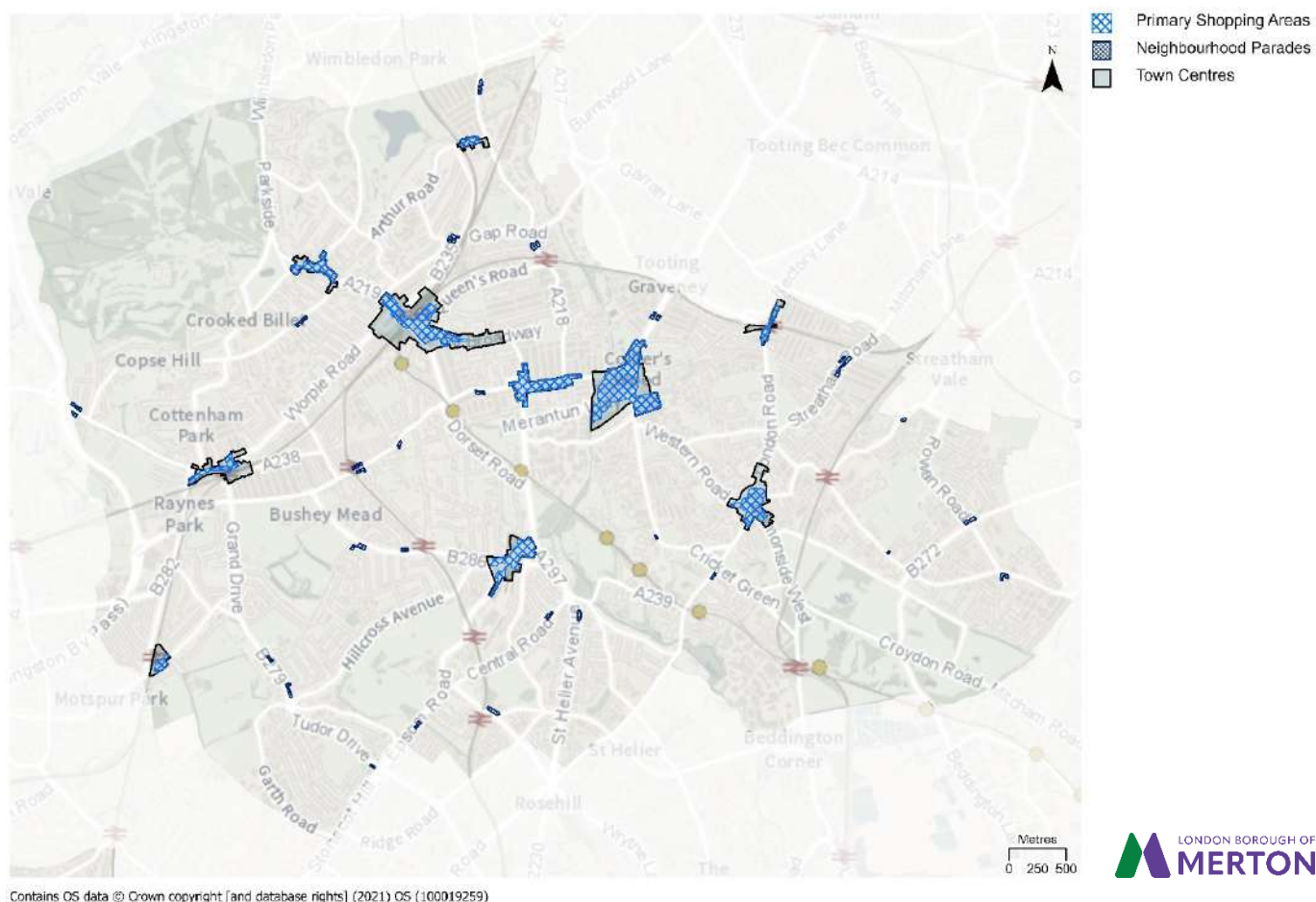


Figure 13.5c Town Centres, Primary Shopping Areas and Neighbourhood Parades in Merton – Policies Map extract

Policy TC 13.6 Development of Town Centre Type Uses outside Town Centres

1. To maintain and enhance the vitality and viability of Merton's Town Centres, proposals for the development of Town Centre Type Uses at the 'edge-of-centre' and 'out-of-centre' will be permitted only where it can be demonstrated that:
 - a. The scope of the sequential test and impact assessment (required over 280sqm net new floorspace) submitted is proportionate to the scale of the development proposed and satisfies the council's requirements.
 - b. Local convenience development outside Town Centres meets all of the following criteria:
 - i. The proposal will be a replacement for an existing convenience shop; or,
 - ii. The proposal will meet local needs in an area identified as deficient in local convenience shopping (including convenience retail activity in petrol stations); and
 - iii. The overall floorspace of the local convenience shop (including petrol stations) would not exceed 280 sqm net retail floorspace.
 - c. Vitality and viability of Merton's existing Town Centres would not be harmed. Planning conditions may be imposed on applications, to ensure that proposals do not have an adverse impact on the vitality and viability of existing Town Centres. Such conditions may:
 - i. Prevent the amalgamation of small units to create large out-of-centre units;
 - ii. Limit internal development to specify the maximum amount of floorspace permitted; or,
 - iii. Control the type of goods sold or type of activity.

Supporting text

- 13.6.1. This policy will contribute towards delivering the "town centre first" approach set out in the NPPF, planning practice guidance and the London Plan by setting how proposals for Town Centre Type Uses outside of Merton's Town Centres will be considered. In developing this proposal, the 2020 Use Class Order changes have also been considered.
- 13.6.2. The NPPF and the London Plan support the "town centres first" approach: focusing growth of retail and leisure activities, businesses and other town centre type uses within town centres. This helps create an attractive destination, increasing footfall with advantages for both businesses and consumers and also creates a sense of place for Merton's residents. This

also reduces the need for residents, workers and tourists to travel to a variety of different places to access shops, services and activities.

- 13.6.3. As Merton is one of the smaller boroughs in London, proposals for new Town Centre Type Uses located at the edge-of-centre and out-of-centre will need to demonstrate that the sequential approach has been appropriately applied. In line with national guidance for retail developments, edge-of-centre is defined as being within 300 metres from the Primary Shopping Area.
- 13.6.4. As set out in the NPPF, the Primary Shopping Area is where the council would expect to see a large concentration of convenience, comparison and service retail shops (E Use Class) to locate. For all other Town Centre Type Uses, edge-of-centre is defined as being within 300 metres from the town centre boundary. For office development this includes locations outside the Town Centre but within 500 metres of a public transport interchange.
- 13.6.5. Impact assessments may be required for any retail proposals located edge-of-centre or out-of-centre where the net floor area of the new proposal exceeds 280sqm. In accordance with the NPPF, impact assessments will be required for leisure and office development above 2,500 sqm gross located outside Town Centres and not in accordance with the development plan.
- 13.6.6. Applicants are encouraged to contact the council at the early stages of the application process to discuss the scope of the sequential test and impact assessment required.
- 13.6.7. Where planning permission is required, we are continuing with the approach to protect small (c280sqm or smaller) food and convenience shops within 5 minutes' walk (400m) of residential areas to reduce the need to travel and support residents' day-to-day needs, complimenting the offer in Town Centres.
- 13.6.8. There is a decline in the number of petrol stations nationally and regionally, due to increasing competition between multiple and more independent retailers. Although the council seeks to encourage more sustainable methods of travelling other than the private car, it is recognised that some residents in Merton rely on private vehicles as their preferred mode of transport. Rather than residents in Merton travelling to neighbouring boroughs to access petrol stations, which is unsustainable overall, the council supports the retail convenience activity allowed in petrol stations to 280 sqm net floorspace. This measure provides landowners with more flexibility and will contribute towards increasing the financial viability of new and existing petrol stations. However, retail floorspace extensions above 280 sqm net will not be supported to ensure that such developments would not have an adverse impact on the retail vitality and viability of Merton's designated Town Centres.

Table 13.6 Merton's Primary Shopping Areas – the extent is shown on the Policies Map

Primary Shopping Area	Designations
Arthur Road	Local Town Centre
Colliers Wood	District Town Centre
North Mitcham	Local Town Centre
Mitcham	District Town Centre
Morden	District Town Centre
Motspur Park	Local Town Centre
Raynes Park	Local Town Centre
South Wimbledon	Local Town Centre
Wimbledon	Major Town Centre
Wimbledon Village	Local Town Centre

Policy TC13.7 Protecting corner / local shops

1. In predominantly residential areas, outside Town Centres and Neighbourhood Parades, to ensure that there are convenience shopping facilities and other services located within walking distance of all residents in Merton, the council will seek to protect corner/local shops for which there is need, by:
 - a. Permitting the change of use of a corner/local convenience shop to a wider range of uses including other shops, businesses, cafes and restaurants public houses, health and community uses where:
 - i. There are alternative convenience shops located within 400 metres;
 - ii. The proposal will have no significant adverse effects on the amenities of nearby residents, road safety, traffic movements or car parking impacts; and
 - iii. Independent access to upper floors is ensured.
 - b. Where there are no alternative convenience shops located within 400m, only permitting changes of use of a corner/local convenience shop to a wider range of uses including other shops, businesses, cafes and restaurants, public houses, health and community where criterion (a)(ii) and (iii) can be met and where:
 - i. It can be demonstrated by full and proper marketing of the site for convenience use at reasonable prices for at least 12 months (1 year) and to the council's satisfaction that there is no realistic prospect of convenience use in the future.
 - c. Only permitting the change of use of a corner/local convenience shop to residential where criteria (a) can be met and where:
 - i. It can be demonstrated by full and proper marketing of the site for convenience use at reasonable prices for at least 12 months (1 year) and to the council's satisfaction that there is no realistic prospect of convenience use in the future; and
 - ii. An active frontage is provided.

Supporting text

- 13.7.1. This policy helps to set out how proposals for the change of use of Town Centre Type Uses outside of Merton's Town Centres will be considered.
- 13.7.2. To support sustainable development, small convenience shops are encouraged to locate within five minutes' walking distance (400 metres radius) of residential areas in Merton, to

reduce the need to travel for day-to-day convenience items.

- 13.7.3. It may not be possible to retain retail use, especially if there is a lack of customer demand and/or alternative facilities are available nearby.
- 13.7.4. Government changes to the Use Class Order introduced in 2020 allows any shops with floorspace above 280 sqm (i.e. bigger than a Sainsburys Local or Tesco Metro) to change to other business, service and community uses without the need for planning permission. The same national Use Class Order allows small shops to change to other uses (below 280 sqm) but only if there is another small shop within 1km.
- 13.7.5. In Merton, we consider that sustainable development in line with the NPPF includes supporting residents' access to essential food within five minutes' walk of their homes. This is particularly important for residents who, for whatever reason, would struggle with a 2km walk round trip to bring food shopping home.
- 13.7.6. In circumstances where there are no alternative convenience shops located within five minutes' walking distance (400 metre radius), proposals for change of use from convenience shops to those detailed in part (a) will be permitted where it can be demonstrated to the council's satisfaction that as a result of full and proper marketing at reasonable prices for at least 12 months (1 year), convenience retail uses are not viable. The applicant will be required to provide Marketing and Vacancy evidence in accordance with the criteria set out in the Appendices.

Policy TC13.8 Food and drink / leisure and entertainment

1. Proposals for restaurants and cafes, public houses, hot food takeaways and leisure and entertainment uses will be supported, provided all of the following criteria have been met:
 - a. The proposals would not have an unacceptable impact on amenity and the general environment, car parking, traffic congestion and road safety. Proposals would need to take into account the:
 - i. Size of unit;
 - ii. Characteristics and type of use proposed;
 - iii. The nature of the area;
 - iv. The likely cumulative effect of food and drink, leisure and entertainment uses in the area, including combined and cumulative effects at different times of the day and night; and
 - v. Whether the location is well served by public transport.
 - b. Adequate noise containment measures are included and sound insulation is provided, where appropriate, to safeguard the amenity of adjoining residential and business uses;
 - c. They would not have an unacceptable effect on amenity through noise, disturbance or fumes;
 - d. The proposed opening hours would be acceptable; and
 - e. Adequate ventilation, waste disposal, litter management and crime prevention arrangements appropriate to the use and location can be provided.

Hot food takeaways

- f. Proposals which result in the development of more than three hot food takeaways in a shopping parade of 10 consecutive shops will not normally be permitted as this would detract from the viability and vitality of high streets and Town Centres and the ability to adopt healthy lifestyles.
- g. The council will not normally permit proposals for new hot food takeaways found within 400 metres walking distance from the entrance or exit of an existing or proposed primary or secondary school to promote the availability of healthy food.
- h. Where any development proposal involving hot food takeaways are permitted, the Council will require the operator to achieve and operate in compliance with the Healthier Catering Commitment standard.

Protection of public houses

- i. Proposals that will result in the loss of a public house will only be permitted where all the following criteria are met:
 - i. the applicant can demonstrate to the council's satisfaction that the public house is no longer economically viable; and
 - ii. there are alternative public houses located within the local area.

Protection of leisure and entertainment

- j. Proposals for the loss of entertainment and leisure facilities will be supported where the applicant can demonstrate to the council's satisfaction that the leisure and entertainment uses are no longer viable.

Supporting text

- 13.8.1. The NPPF, the London Plan and Merton's strategic policies encourage a range and mix of Town Centre Type Uses to Merton's Town Centres which contributes to their vitality and viability. This policy will contribute towards delivering this by setting out how proposals for new or the change of use from food and drink/ leisure and entertainment uses will be considered in Merton.
- 13.8.2. The scale of new food and drink/leisure and entertainment uses must meet the requirements of Policy TC13.5 Merton's town centres and neighbourhood parades.
- 13.8.3. As detailed in Policy TC13.6 Development of town centre uses outside town centres, to strike a balance between Merton's aspirations for economic growth whilst protecting the vitality and viability of Merton's designated Town Centres, proposals for large food and drink/leisure and entertainment uses will be required to submit a sequential test and may be required to submit an impact assessment.
- 13.8.4. Changes to the national Use Class Order in 2020 allow some premises to change uses without the need for planning permission (e.g. restaurants to shops or gyms, all within the Use Class E). However, in the 2020 Use Class Order most leisure and entertainment premises will now be classed as "sui generis" (e.g. theatres, pubs and bars, cinemas, live music venues, nightclubs etc) which will require planning permission to open or change to another use.

Food and drink / leisure and entertainment uses

- 13.8.5. The food and drink sector and leisure and entertainment sector is very dynamic and increasingly diverse. This sector includes cafés, restaurants, pubs, cinemas and bowling

alleys. These facilities reflect changing population structures, lifestyles and expectations, and are now a regular part of many people's lives rather than a special event.

- 13.8.6. Merton's Town Centres have above average representation of cafes and restaurants, in particular hot food takeaways, and there are no specific areas of deficiency. Although Merton's residents have relatively good access to a range of commercial leisure and entertainment facilities in neighbouring boroughs and central London, there may be potential for additional health club facilities in line with population growth.
- 13.8.7. The range of restaurants and the evening economy are poor in some centres, including Mitcham, Morden and Colliers Wood. Therefore, the council encourages restaurants, cafes, leisure and entertainment uses in these centres which contributes towards supporting shops and other businesses. Improving existing and encouraging more evening economy uses in these areas will extend the centres' use beyond shop opening hours.
- 13.8.8. However, such uses can sometimes cause problems to nearby residents and businesses because of noise, fumes, traffic and other disturbances, especially at night. The council will therefore seek to control the size and location of such premises, particularly where there is residential accommodation adjacent, close to, or above premises. In addition, these amenity problems are exaggerated when groups of these facilities are located close together, and their cumulative and combined impact becomes significant.
- 13.8.9. Merton Council's Licensing Policy imposed a cumulative impact area in Wimbledon Village and Wimbledon Town Centre which restricts the number of licences available for cafes, restaurants, public houses, hot food take-away, leisure and entertainment uses, if licences are required.
- 13.8.10. Where appropriate, conditions and legal agreements will be applied to ensure these developments meet the council's standards, and to protect residential amenity. Conditions may be applied to control the hours of opening, and type of use. Agreements may also include financial contributions for CCTV and other crime prevention and road safety measures.

Hot food takeaways

- 13.8.11. As set out in the London Plan and Policy HW10.2 Delivering healthy places, the council will look to create and promote a healthy environment in Merton. As such, the council will not normally permit new development proposals for fast food takeaways located 400 metres from the exit and entrance of an existing or proposed school, having regard to the nature of the proposal, its contribution to healthy food availability and its relationship to the existing provision of hot food takeaway outlets and healthy eating initiatives taking place at the school. As set out in Policy HW10.2 Delivering healthy places, the council will encourage all new food establishments in Merton to sign up to the Healthier Catering Commitment.

- 13.8.12. Local research in Merton shows that there is a concern with impacts of the over concentration of hot food takeaways, particularly on Merton High Street, London Road (Mitcham) and Streatham Road. Planning permission will not be permitted for hot food takeaways where there is an 'over-concentration'. Generally, an 'over-concentration' of hot food takeaways would be the development of more than three hot food takeaways in a shopping parade of 10 consecutive shops.
- 13.8.13. By helping to prevent the over-concentration of hot food takeaways in Merton's high streets, this policy helps ensure that residents have access to and choice between a wide range of retail services and facilities including access to healthier food options.
- 13.8.14. This policy is part of a holistic approach that Merton Council, together with other organisations, is taking to improve opportunities for healthy lifestyles and to tackle obesity issues in the borough. Other projects in Merton include the "Healthier Catering Commitment" to help food outlets offer healthier options. National policy, including the NPPF, the London Plan and Merton's Policy HW10.1 Health (including mental health) and wellbeing, strongly support this approach.
- 13.8.15. When considering proposals for change of use to hot food takeaways, the first unit in each parade of shops (where possible) should be used as the starting point to ascertain if the proposal meets policy. A 'unit' refers to individual shops.

Protection of public houses

- 13.8.16. In instances where planning permission is required, the council will resist the loss of public houses as they serve a community role (for example, by providing space for clubs, meetings or performances) unless:
- a. alternative provision is available nearby (within 800 metres); and,
 - b. it can be demonstrated to the council's satisfaction that the public house is no longer economically viable.
- 13.8.17. To demonstrate a public house is no longer economically viable, the applicants:
- a. Would need evidence to demonstrate that the public house as a business is no longer economically viable; and
 - b. To demonstrate that full and proper marketing of the site at reasonable prices for a period of 18 months (1 ½ years) confirms the non-viability for these purposes. Applicants will be required to provide marketing evidence in line with the Marketing and Vacancy criteria set out in the Appendices.

Protection of leisure and entertainment facilities

- 13.8.18. Wimbledon Town Centre is identified as a 'night-time economy cluster of regional/ sub-regional importance' in the London Plan. A cultural quarter has emerged to the east end of The Broadway, with two theatres, leisure, entertainment and community facilities and a selection of restaurants. Combined with the cinemas, wine bars and restaurants these leisure and entertainment facilities makes Wimbledon vibrant and active throughout the day and evening therefore attracting residents, workers and visitors to the benefit of all businesses.
- 13.8.19. In terms of shopping floorspace, Colliers Wood competes directly with Wimbledon Town Centre by attracting many high street and multiple retailers. However, Colliers Wood does not have the same range and choice of evening activities nor does it have the Wimbledon 'brand' which is internationally recognised. To ensure that Wimbledon remains vibrant despite competition from other town centres, the council will seek to attract and retain leisure and entertainment facilities in Wimbledon Town Centre.
- 13.8.20. Currently the choice and quality of the evening economy is poor in Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Morden Town Centres. Therefore, the council aims to maintain existing leisure and entertainment facilities in these areas, where viable.
- 13.8.21. In instances where planning permission is required for proposals for change of use from leisure and entertainment uses to alternative Town Centre Type Uses in Merton's Town Centres, the council will require full and proper marketing of the property for its permitted use at reasonable prices for a period of 18 months (1½ years). However, for proposals outside of Town Centres, where proposals for change of use from leisure and entertainment to alternative uses except employment and community and cultural uses the council would require full and proper marketing of the property for its permitted use at reasonable prices for a period of 18 months (1½ years). Applicants will be required to provide marketing evidence in line with the Marketing and Vacancy criteria set out in the Appendices.

Policy TC13.9 Culture, arts and tourism development

1. The council will maintain, improve and encourage culture, arts and tourism in Merton by:

a. Supporting:

- i. All proposals for cultural and tourism development which are likely to generate a large number of visitors in either Merton's Major and District Town Centres or other areas of the borough which have good levels of accessibility (PTAL level 3 or above) and are within close proximity to additional services for employees and visitors.
- ii. Small (generally floorspace below 280 sqm) proposals for culture, arts and tourism development throughout the borough.

b. Encouraging improvements or expansion to existing culture, arts and tourism in Merton, where this complements Merton's strategic objectives for the areas in which they are located.

c. Ensuring proposals for culture, arts and tourism developments are well designed, by requiring that:

- i. The size and character of the site or building are suitable for the proposed use;
- ii. The development will be compatible with the character and appearance of the area;
- iii. The amenities of local residents and businesses will not be harmed by way of noise, disturbance, loss of light or privacy;
- iv. There will be good access and links to modes of transport other than the private vehicle; and
- v. Vehicular access to and from the highway will be safe.

d. Balancing the benefits of the submitted proposals opportunity to provide employment and other contributions to the local economy against the above criteria.

e. Supporting proposals for the change of use from culture, arts and tourist accommodation to alternative uses only if it can be demonstrated to the council's satisfaction:

- i. that full and proper marketing of the site at reasonable prices for a period of 18 months (1.5 years) confirms the financial non-viability for these purposes, unless a suitable replacement site for the culture and arts use which is of better standard and quality is provided locally; or,
- ii. where it can be demonstrated that the existing tourist accommodation is no longer viable and does not provide facilities for the local community.

- f.** Subject to the policy protection of scattered employment sites, protecting, maintaining and encouraging the workspace needed to support creative and cultural industries across the borough.

Supporting text

- 13.9.1. Culture, arts and tourism development creates economic and social benefits by attracting and entertaining residents, business visitors and tourists. These uses provide employment and complement the shops, services, cafes, restaurants, public houses and leisure and entertainment facilities in Merton's Town Centres, contributing towards their overall vibrancy.
- 13.9.2. Arts and cultural uses include theatres, museums, galleries and concert halls. For this policy, tourist accommodation includes hotels, hostels [sui generis], accommodation such as AirBnB and guesthouses and other tourist accommodation.
- 13.9.3. We welcome new proposals for culture, arts and visitor developments. To strike a balance between Merton's aspirations for economic growth whilst protecting the vitality and viability of Merton's designated Town Centres, proposals for new large culture, arts and tourist developments located edge-of-centre and out-of-centre, will be required to submit a sequential test.
- 13.9.4. Public Transport Accessibility Levels (PTAL) inform geographical area level access to public transport. Higher PTAL levels are concentrated around the Town Centres and transport interchanges of Wimbledon, Morden, Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Raynes Park. Areas to the south east and southwest of the borough have the lowest accessibility levels. As set out in the transport policies in this Local Plan, applicants should use Transport for London's WebCAT free online tool to get the most up to date assessment of public transport accessibility for their site.

Arts and culture

- 13.9.5. In Merton there are a number of arts and cultural uses that the council wishes to protect and enhance including theatres in Wimbledon Town Centre and Merton Abbey Mills, handcrafts, creative industries, cultural activities (Abbeyfest, Cannizaro Festival, Mitcham Carnival), museums, sports arenas (such as the All England Lawn Tennis Club, Tooting and Mitcham Hub, the AFC Wimbledon stadium), Deen City Farm and the Wimbledon School of Art. There are recording and film studios scattered throughout the borough and many businesses in Merton support the cultural, creative, arts and tourism sector (e.g. providing stage lighting, production props etc.) across London and beyond.
- 13.9.6. In Merton, the creative sector comprises a range of activities including publishing books, newspapers and software, printing, TV, radio and film production, and photography.

- 13.9.7. Proposals will be supported that build upon the borough's strength in creative and cultural information, particularly proposals that improve Merton's existing offer.

Tourism

- 13.9.8. There is a need for a variety of tourist accommodation and facilities to cater for leisure tourism and business visitors, to make Merton's tourism and culture sector more viable and sustainable all year round.
- 13.9.9. Although there is uncertainty around the aftermath of COVID-19 and its impact on business and tourism, there remains a need for high quality hotels with conference facilities in Merton, particularly in Wimbledon Town Centre, to support business visitors and to provide space for local functions. Merton is conveniently situated to help provide additional tourist facilities with good public transport links to central London. The borough also has its own tourist attractions, although those outside the Wimbledon area generally have a lower profile and consequently lower visitor interest. Where possible, facilities provided to guests at larger hotels should also be made available to the local community to help improve the quality of life for local businesses and residents.
- 13.9.10. In determining the location of hotel, hostel, guest house and B&B facilities, good public transport services to central London and to other Merton tourist attractions are an important factor.
- 13.9.11. Tourist accommodation should generally be situated in areas of good public transport accessibility and adjacent to the secondary road network to minimise traffic congestion for residents. The capacity and proximity of similar existing facilities should also be considered. The council will not support tourist accommodation (such as apart-hotels) where this displaces capacity for residential accommodation (Use Class C3).

Protection of arts, culture and tourism

- 13.9.12. Existing arts, culture and tourist attractions and accommodation will be protected in order to maintain the benefits of arts, culture and tourism to the local community. This will benefit the community by providing jobs, attracting visitors, contributing to the overall economy and to local educational resources, and providing a variety of facilities for both residents, businesses, students and visitors.
- 13.9.13. Since May 2013 Government has made a variety of changes to the General Permitted Development Order to allow development to take place without the need for planning permission. In instances where planning permission is required, redevelopment or change of use from arts, culture and tourism development will be permitted only if the current use is proved to be unviable or unless it meets the policy exemptions detailed in this policy above.

13.9.14. To demonstrate that full and proper marketing has been undertaken, the council requires the applicant to demonstrate that:

- c. The site has been marketed for the time period detailed in policy unless otherwise agreed with the council;
- d. All opportunities to re-let the site have been fully explored (including more flexible use of the space);
- e. The site has been marketed using new (on the internet) and traditional marketing tools available; and,
- f. The site has been marketed at a price which is considered reasonable (based on recent and similar deals or transactions).



Chapter 14. Infrastructure

Strategic policy IN14.1 Infrastructure

1. We support the provision and improvement of Infrastructure across the borough and will work with relevant providers to ensure that the necessary Infrastructure is secured to support growth in the borough over the plan period. We will:
 - a. Expect new development to identify, plan for and provide any necessary Infrastructure and require that, where necessary, Infrastructure should be completed prior to occupation.
 - b. Require new development to comply with London Plan Policy DF1 (Delivery of the Plan and Planning Obligations) which, amongst other things, sets out the approach to viability testing, decision making and infrastructure prioritisation (Parts B, C and D) that the council will take where it has been demonstrated that planning obligations cannot viably be supported. On a site-specific basis this shall include consideration of the council's published Viability Study, the Mayor's Affordable Housing and Viability SPG and that priority be given to affordable housing and necessary public transport improvements.
 - c. Work with service providers and partners to enable them to deliver the provision of services and facilities for the projected population growth, especially in areas of significant new homes and areas of deficiency.
 - d. Encourage dialogue between service providers and developers. Where appropriate opportunities arise, the co-location of services and joint delivery of Infrastructure by service providers will be supported.
 - e. Support the delivery of high-quality, high-speed and reliable Digital Infrastructure to enable the expansion of electronic communications networks, which include full fibre broadband connections and next generation mobile technology. Development proposals will be expected to provide digital connectivity infrastructure in accordance with London Plan Policy SI6.
 - f. Support the provision of emergency services and facilities as required by emergency service providers.
 - g. Work with partners to facilitate the delivery of sport, recreation and play facilities and to encourage the shared use of sites and spaces.
 - h. Expect Infrastructure provision to be in keeping with the council's net-zero carbon targets.

Supporting text

- 14.1.1 The infrastructure needs for Merton will be primarily to support the additional housing required over the Local Plan period. We have identified strategic priorities for health

provision, education, transport infrastructure, Digital Infrastructure, water, wastewater and sewerage provision and supporting future needs of the emergency services. Where there is an Infrastructure capacity problem, we will require developers to fund appropriate improvements and where necessary, ensure improvements are completed prior to occupation.

- 14.1.2 We will continue to encourage service providers and developers to interact with each other – pre, during and post planning application stage. This is to ensure that all necessary infrastructure can be identified and planned for and that where an opportunity arises for services to be co-located and jointly delivered, this can be done with minimal interruption to local residents and businesses.
- 14.1.3 In accordance with national guidance on planning obligations, we will require new development to provide or fund local infrastructure improvements. All planning obligations for any development must meet the three statutory tests set out in Reg 122 of the Community Infrastructure Levy Regulations 2010 as amended. The Community Infrastructure Levy will be applied as appropriate, alongside other investment, to help deliver infrastructure. Site-specific planning obligations will also be used to secure delivery of infrastructure needs arising from development. Where the developer contends the policy requirements in relation to viability of a particular proposal, the onus would lie with the developer to demonstrate what can viably be achieved through the submission of a viability assessment. We may seek payments from applications for the cost of independent viability assessment(s).
- 14.1.4 In order to support growth in the borough, the council will safeguard and improve essential social, physical and green infrastructure and work in partnership with service providers to ensure the delivery of the additional infrastructure. The planned and predicted infrastructure requirements for the Local Plan are identified in the Infrastructure Delivery Plan 2021 (IDP).
- 14.1.5 The IDP sets out the infrastructure needs for Merton over the lifetime of the Local Plan, through an analysis of current provision and the consideration of anticipated population and housing growth. The Infrastructure Delivery Schedule provides a list of infrastructure projects that have been identified for delivery within the first five years of the Local Plan, in addition to a number of longer-term projects. The council will continue to work with infrastructure partners, providers, stakeholders and the community to identify and update requirements for the provision of infrastructure and services throughout the borough. The council will also seek to coordinate infrastructure delivery where it is appropriate to do so, while protecting local amenities and environmental quality.
- 14.1.6 In line with the London Plan, the relationship between green and social infrastructure is considered to be important in Merton, particularly given the ambition to create healthier

places for all. We are committed to ensuring that there is adequate provision of community, social and open space facilities to improve the quality of life for residents. Further policies on Social and Community Infrastructure and sports and recreation facilities are provided in Policy IN14.2 and IN14.3 and policies on Open Space and Green Infrastructure are considered in Chapter 15 Green and Blue Infrastructure.

- 14.1.7 Ambitious net-zero carbon targets have been set, 2030 for the council and 2050 for the borough, which are designed to achieve a step-change in our actions to reduce emissions and adapt to the impacts of climate change. The Merton Climate Strategy and Action Plan recognises that the three major transitions; to the economy, to building and energy and to transport, all require substantial changes to infrastructure to be in keeping with emerging national and regional policies such as the London Mayor's 1.5 degree Action Plan, the National Government's Clean Growth Strategy and the views of the [National Infrastructure Commission](#).

Digital infrastructure

- 14.1.8 Advanced, high-quality, high-speed and reliable communications infrastructure is essential for economic growth and social wellbeing. As such, the council supports the promotion and delivery of full-fibre or equivalent Digital Infrastructure. Future digital connections should be provided with a focus on affordability, security and resilience and should provide access to services from a range of providers.
- 14.1.9 Ofcom currently defines superfast broadband as being a minimum download speed of 30 megabits per second (Mbit/s), which is a measure of data transfer speed. High speed broadband can help businesses, through increased efficiencies, helping to drive jobs and economic growth. It can also help residents to access information, products and services more easily.
- 14.1.10 Merton has some areas with low or poor digital connectivity. According to Ofcom's Connected Nations Update: Summer 2020, 2% of premises in Merton are unable to receive a minimum download speed of 30 Mbit/s. We seek to improve this, and make Merton a digitally inclusive borough, by encouraging the expansion of Digital Infrastructure into areas where there are currently gaps in connectivity. This includes industrial areas across Merton, which historically have had poor connectivity. Applicants should work with the council and broadband delivery partners to find appropriate solutions to deliver broadband to new and existing residents and businesses.
- 14.1.11 We are also supportive of the provision of free publicly owned and available wifi in public realm areas. Fast and reliable Digital Infrastructure should be accessible to all; it helps support the way that people live and work, helps digital and creative industries to thrive and promotes innovation.

- 14.1.12 Operators should demonstrate through the planning process that equipment will operate within the International Commission on Non-Ionizing Radiation Protection guidelines for public exposure.
- 14.1.13 It is important to ensure that the installation of Digital Infrastructure, together with any necessary enabling works, will not result in unacceptable damage to visual amenity or harm to environmentally sensitive features or locations. Specific design requirements for Digital Infrastructure are set out in Chapter 12 Places and spaces in a growing borough.

Water and wastewater infrastructure

- 14.1.14 To accommodate the expected population and housing growth across the borough, the council is supportive of improvements and upgrades to water supply and wastewater services, to contribute to security of supply.
- 14.1.15 The council will work with the water and wastewater companies to help them develop and implement their plans, to ensure that there is adequate water and wastewater infrastructure to serve all new developments. Developers will also need to agree details with water and wastewater companies for adequate water supply, surface water, foul drainage and sewerage treatment capacity.
- 14.1.16 Developers will be required to demonstrate as part of the planning application process that there is adequate capacity both on and off-site to serve the development and that the development would not lead to problems for existing users. In some circumstances this may make it necessary for developers to carry out appropriate studies to ascertain the effect proposed development will have on the existing infrastructure. Overloading of the system will not be permitted.
- 14.1.17 Where there is a capacity problem the developer will be required to fund appropriate improvements to be completed prior to completion of the development. An exception to this may be where the water company has improvement works programmed in, that align with the completion time of the development. The council will, where appropriate, apply phasing conditions to any approval to ensure that any necessary infrastructure upgrades are delivered ahead of the occupation of the relevant phase of development.
- 14.1.18 We are supportive of improvements to water supply or wastewater facilities, to ensure adequate long term water supply and wastewater management throughout the borough.

Gas and electricity

- 14.1.19 We will continue to work with utility suppliers, and expect developers to do the same, to ensure that the safe and secure supply of utilities such as electricity and gas is not compromised, as we transition towards a low carbon energy supply.

- 14.1.20 It is estimated that gas is currently responsible for around 40% of greenhouse gas emissions in Merton, mostly from heating residential properties. Whilst greenhouse gas emissions from electricity production are predicted to fall substantially, there are limited options to reduce emissions from gas. Until a national strategy to decarbonise the gas grid has been developed, the council will support activities to move away from natural gas and towards electrification and other forms of low carbon heating and cooking. This is likely to result in a reduction in demand of up to 1TWh gas per year by 2050, in accordance with GLA zero carbon pathway modelling.
- 14.1.21 Demand for electricity is likely to increase over time, mainly due to a transition away from gas heating and cooking towards electric heating, and an increase in uptake of electric vehicles. The additional demand is estimated to be around 50GWh/year by 2050 (GLA zero carbon pathway modelling), but is uncertain and is influenced by the extent to which local renewable energy and energy storage is installed (e.g. solar PV and battery technology), and the roll out of smart technologies which serve to actively manage the peaks in electricity supply.
- 14.1.22 National Grid Electricity Transmission (NGET) owns and maintains the electricity transmission system in England and UK Power Networks owns the electricity distribution network. National Grid Gas (NNG) owns and operates the high pressure gas transmission system across the UK, whereby gas leaves the transmission system and enters the distribution networks at high pressure.
- 14.1.23 SGN owns and operates the local gas distribution network in Merton. New gas transmission infrastructure developments (pipelines and associated installations) are periodically required to meet increases in demand and changes in patterns of supply.
- 14.1.24 National Grid's underground electricity transmission cables cross through Colliers Wood and Mitcham. In addition, the National Grid's high voltage overhead electricity transmission lines run through the borough along the River Wandle through the Colliers Wood, Wimbledon and Mitcham neighbourhoods. Five of the proposed Site Allocations (CW2, CW5, Wi12, Mi1 and Mi16) contain or are within close proximity to the National Grid Infrastructure. Potential developers of sites with overhead lines should be aware that it is National Grid policy to retain existing overhead lines in-situ. The relocation of existing high voltage overhead lines will only be considered for projects of national or regional importance.
- 14.1.25 We are supportive of working with UK Power Networks to explore the extent to which the electricity distribution network requires upgrading; and the approach needed to minimise cost and disruption.
- 14.1.26 Developers must take into account the location and nature of the existing electricity transmission equipment when planning developments. The following guidance should be referenced prior to submitting a planning application: [Working near our assets](#),

[Linesearch BeforeUdig](#) and [Guidelines for development near pylons and high voltage overhead power lines](#).

Travel and transport

- 14.1.27 Merton's Climate Strategy and Action Plan recognises that a wholesale change in the way we travel in Merton is required to reduce greenhouse gas emissions from petrol and diesel vehicles, which are estimated to account for 19% of greenhouse gas emissions in the borough. By 2050 virtually no petrol and diesel vehicles will use Merton's roads. To support a major increase in cycling and walking, a reduction in the use of private vehicles and a shift to electric vehicles and an integrated cycling, walking and electric vehicle charging network will take place.
- 14.1.28 Public transport accessibility is not evenly spread across the borough and more deprived areas such as parts of Mitcham and Morden neighbourhoods currently have lower levels than some of the western areas of the borough. We will continue to work with the relevant public transport partners, including Transport for London and Network Rail to deliver better transport services, as identified in the Infrastructure Delivery Plan and improve accessibility and connectivity. Refer to the Transport policies in Chapter 16 for further details.

Sport, recreation and play

- 14.1.29 The following evidence base documents have been published on [Merton Council's "Local Plan Research" webpage](#) relating to the sporting and recreation infrastructure needs in the borough. These documents support the Local Plan and should be referenced for all relevant planning applications.
- The Merton Green Infrastructure, Biodiversity and Open Space Study 2020.
 - The Merton Playing Pitch Strategy 2019.
 - The Merton Indoor Sports Facility Study 2020.

Policy IN14.2 Social and Community Infrastructure

1. Taken as a whole, Social and Community Infrastructure covers a wide variety of uses. These include community and affordable meeting spaces, libraries, places of worship, education, youth services, childcare and early years, health and social care, services for the elderly or disabled, sport, recreation, informal play spaces, emergency services and other criminal justice or community safety facilities. This list is not intended to be exhaustive and other uses can be included as Social and Community Infrastructure.
2. We place a high priority on the provision and improvement of Social and Community Infrastructure. It is essential to support those currently living, working and visiting Merton and to ensure future changes can be accommodated. These places can be the heart of local communities and they are important to ensure residents have a high quality of life. We will:
 - a. Support and encourage the most effective use of Social and Community Infrastructure, to support the changing priorities and needs in the borough.
 - b. Require any proposals involving the loss of Social and Community Infrastructure to clearly demonstrate:
 - i. that the loss would not create, or add to, a shortfall in provision for the specific use, through providing a Community Needs Statement and
 - ii. that there is no viable demand for any other social and community infrastructure use on the site, through providing marketing and vacancy evidence for a period of at least 12 months, unless it forms part of a wider public service transformation plan.
 - c. Consider other uses through redevelopment, where the council is satisfied that the evidence in **2.b.** has been provided and the change of use away from the social and community infrastructure use has been justified.
 - d. Support and encourage the multi-use of social and community infrastructure.
 - e. Support proposals for new, or extensions to existing, social and community infrastructure where:
 - i. it is of a high quality and inclusive design providing access for all
 - ii. it is provided in multi-use, flexible and adaptable buildings or is co-located with other social infrastructure uses, where practicable
 - iii. it is accessible by a range of transport modes including walking, cycling and public transport

- iv. appropriate access, parking and cycling facilities are provided, relative to the location and scale of the development and
- v. the use(s), including hours of operation, would not unacceptably harm the amenities of the surrounding area.

Health

- f. Support the provision of new or improved healthcare facilities in the borough, working in partnership with the South West London Integrated Care System (ICS) and NHS England to meet the needs of Merton's projected population growth, especially in areas of regeneration or areas of deficiency.
- g. Support the aim of improved access to primary health care facilities, which could extend GP surgery hours and support the re-use of social infrastructure and the re-location of services, wherever possible.
- h. Support the principle of a new Health and Wellbeing Community Hub in Mitcham.

Education

- i. Support proposals for new primary and secondary schools, or for the extension or expansion of existing schools including Special Educational Needs (SEN), where they help to deliver the council's agreed strategy for provision of additional state-funded school places in the borough and where they meet the requirements set out in the London Plan education policy S3B.
- j. Resist proposals involving the loss of a state-funded school either in use, or previously in use, unless the council's agreed strategy for school places has identified the site as surplus and its development for other uses would contribute to improvements in the delivery of school places in the borough.

Supporting text

- 14.2.1 Taken as a whole, Social and Community Infrastructure covers a wide variety of uses. These include community and affordable meeting spaces, libraries, places of worship, education, youth services, childcare and early years, health and social care, services for the elderly or disabled, sport, recreation, informal play spaces, emergency services and other criminal justice or community safety facilities. This list is not intended to be exhaustive and other uses can be included as social and community infrastructure.
- 14.2.2 These places can be publicly or privately funded or run by charities, free at the point of delivery or paid for. There are a variety of different needs for social and community infrastructure at different stages of people's lives. These types of infrastructure also play

an important role in developing strong and inclusive communities by providing opportunities to bring together different groups of people.

- 14.2.3 Many of these services are also a major source of employment in Merton; civic and government functions such as schools, the NHS, the fire brigade and other local government sectors are large employers in Merton with a range of jobs in terms of salaries and skills.
- 14.2.4 The coronavirus (COVID-19) pandemic has highlighted just how important social and community infrastructure is to the local community. The impact of the lockdown on mental health could lead to a longer-term erosion of people's physical health and affect people who have previously not experienced poor mental health. While we do not yet know the full impact that COVID-19 has had on our local communities, it is essential that all new and existing residents in Merton have access to social and community infrastructure, to ensure a good quality of life. The council will continue to work closely with its partners, such as the NHS, to ensure that the recovery after COVID-19 is prioritised for the health and wellbeing of our residents.
- 14.2.5 Sports and leisure facilities (including Playing Pitches), should be tested against paragraph 97 of the NPPF and considered against the requirements of London Plan Policy S5. Further policies on these facilities are provided later in this chapter in Policy IN14.3.
- 14.2.6 Where appropriate, the use of S106 or planning conditions will be used to ensure delivery of required infrastructure in the borough.

Use classes order

- 14.2.7 In 2020, Government introduced successive statutory instruments and changes to the Use Classes Order. These changes include the creation of new Use Classes for Class E (Commercial, Business and Service), Class F.1 (Learning and Non-residential institutions) and Class F.2 (Local community), and changes to the list of Sui Generis uses (uses that cannot be included in a specific class).
- 14.2.8 The Government's Explanatory Memorandum states that these changes were *"primarily aimed at creating vibrant, mixed use town centres by allowing businesses greater freedom to change to a broader range of compatible uses which communities expect to find on modern high streets, as well as more generally in town and city centres."*
- 14.2.9 The recent changes to the Use Classes Order allow some premises to change uses without planning permission e.g. nursery or health centre to a shop, café, restaurant. Merton is supportive of the principle of greater flexibility for what business and community spaces can be used for; however, we will also seek to minimise any

unintended harm that flexible proposals could bring to the amenity of existing residents and future users.

- 14.2.10 We will assess planning applications in line with this policy for any proposals that involve changes to, or a loss of Social and Community Infrastructure. Planning conditions or obligations may be used to ensure no harm to the amenity of existing residents and future users.

Protect existing uses

- 14.2.11 We will safeguard existing social and community uses unless there is adequate justification for the loss, or provision for a replacement.

- 14.2.12 Applications proposing a loss will have to demonstrate that the Social and Community Infrastructure use is no longer viable on the site. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 (Infrastructure). For the purpose of Policy IN14.2 2.b. and 2.c., a social or community infrastructure use refers to clinics, health centres, crèches, day nurseries, day centres, schools, art galleries (other than for sale or hire), museums, libraries, halls, places of worship, church halls, law courts, and non-residential education and training centres. Applicants will have to provide the following information:

1. A Community Needs Statement

- 14.2.13 This is required to clearly set out the reasons why the site is unable to support social and community uses and why the existing use is no longer required on site. Where there is a proposal for a replacement, relocation or consolidation of a use, this document will also need to demonstrate that the needs of the current users of the site have been considered and an appropriate facility can be provided elsewhere.

- 14.2.14 Applicants are encouraged to discuss the scope and content of the Community Needs Statement with the council at an early stage, preferably through the Pre-Application process, to ensure that the information provided is proportionate to the scale and significance of the proposed change or loss.

- 14.2.15 The following should be covered by a Community Needs Statement:

- a. The reasons why there is no longer an identified community need for the facility. This may include reasons why a facility no longer meets the needs of its users.
- b. Details of the current/former service provided on site and if relevant, information on how a better service would be provided elsewhere. This may include information on physical constraints such as access or user requirements.
- c. Evidence showing that consultation with current/former users of the use on the site has taken place, including feedback on the proposed changes.

- d. Details on all engagement with the relevant stakeholders that are involved in providing services on site, or that rely on the provision of services on site, for example, the South West London ICS and NHS; and
- e. Details of any alternative locations that have been identified and assessed as being suitable for co-location.

14.2.16 Additional information may be requested by the council, where required.

2. Marketing and Vacancy Evidence

14.2.17 This is required to provide an assessment of the continued demand for the existing use and all other suitable social and community uses that could be accommodated on the site. The Marketing and Vacancy Evidence will need to be provided for a minimum period of 12 months and should be carried out in accordance with the criteria set out in the Appendices.

Support co-location

14.2.18 In line with the London Plan, the council supports proposals that make the best use of land, including the co-location of uses such as schools, colleges, sports and community providers for the wider community. This is particularly relevant where these are located in areas that are highly accessible.

14.2.19 We strongly encourage the shared use and co-location of sites, which allows for land to be used more efficiently, assists service providers to work collaboratively and provides for the sharing of maintenance and management costs. Shared facilities that adopt principles from the Healthy Streets Approach and are easily accessible by public transport, cycling and walking will enable greater community inclusion and participation.

14.2.20 We will also support the shared use of community sites by different service providers across the public, private and voluntary sector, for example as is being planned at the Mitcham Health and Wellbeing Community Hub.

The provision of new social and community uses

14.2.21 We will support the development of new social and community infrastructure uses where they address a local or strategic need, in line with London Plan Policy S1(C).

14.2.22 The location and layout of social and community infrastructure is often determined by the type and use of the site, for example the area reached by a local fire station can be far wider than the area needs of a primary school. We will require new development proposals to ensure that these places are easily accessible and well connected; they

should be easily reached on foot, bicycle or by public transport and fully accessible to all parts of the community, including people with a disability and older people.

- 14.2.23 Social and community infrastructure provides opportunities to develop strong and inclusive communities, contributing to social integration and the desirability of a place. New social and community infrastructure provided as part of Major Developments should be made available to all residents, irrespective of tenure. Proposals should also include a plan for the management and maintenance of new developments, which may be formalised through the use of planning conditions or obligations. We will also support new proposals which promote and incorporate a circular economy.

Health

- 14.2.24 A key aim for the council is to encourage healthier communities by improving health outcomes and reducing health inequalities. Appropriate infrastructure needs to be in place to support health and wellbeing, encourage the provision of sport and leisure facilities and support the health and housing services for our community, particularly the vulnerable members of the community.
- 14.2.25 An ageing and changing population and an increase in long term and complex health conditions places additional demands on health and social care and has implications for the accessibility of services and importance of preventing social isolation. We will continue to work closely with partners including the South West London ICS and NHS England to ensure that primary healthcare will be provided to meet the needs of the changing population.
- 14.2.26 The Merton Borough Health and Care Estates Strategy 2021 sets out the vision and priorities for healthcare in Merton, to align with the new Local Plan. The Strategy looks to support independence, good health, wellbeing and accessible person-centred care, through a partnership approach across the borough. Although Merton does not have an Acute or Mental Health hospital within its boundaries, the strategic priorities of key partners have been included in the Strategy because they impact on Merton residents who attend those services.
- 14.2.27 The Strategy includes an up-to-date assessment of the following sites in the borough and sets out the future health priorities based on the projected population and housing growth and it has informed the Merton Infrastructure Delivery Plan 2021:
- GP surgeries.
 - Primary Care Networks.
 - Properties owned by NHS Property Services, Community Health Partnerships, Private landlords and other providers.

Vacant and underutilised health spaces.

- 14.2.28 One of the key priority areas identified in the strategy is a new Mitcham Health and Wellbeing Community Hub, which is supported by the council. The Merton Borough Estates Group has been working to bring forward plans for a new health and wellbeing space in Mitcham, as part of the priority to bring vacant and underutilised sites back into use.

Education

- 14.2.29 The council will continue to support new and improved childcare and education facilities in response to population changes and borough migration patterns and will work closely with partners and neighbouring boroughs where necessary to ensure that all children in Merton have access to good quality education.
- 14.2.30 The need for school places in Merton for children aged 0-19 years and for Special Educational Needs (SEN) is set out in the council's annual assessment of needs for state-funded school places. These needs have been set out in the Infrastructure Delivery Plan and are updated every year to maintain accuracy.
- 14.2.31 State-funded schools include local authority-maintained schools (community, foundation and voluntary aided and controlled schools), Academies and free schools.
- 14.2.32 The shared use of education facilities is strongly encouraged, to ensure the effective use of a variety of community, social, educational and leisure facilities. The sharing of facilities can help to minimise travel distances for users and can provide greater overall social benefits to the local community.
- 14.2.33 Proposals for new or improved education facilities will be expected to be designed to incorporate elements that can be shared or accessed by the wider community, outside of main school operating hours, or demonstrate why this has not been possible. Such uses can include sports and community halls, training and meeting facilities, play spaces, nurseries, children's centres, cultural or youth facilities and sports pitches and multi-use games areas.
- 14.2.34 Community use agreements may be necessary to ensure community access is properly managed and maintained. Shared access must be safe and adaptable.
- 14.2.35 Proposals for nurseries and childcare facilities should include access to an outdoor play area of sufficient size and quality to meet the needs of the facility. This should be located away from, or be screened from, roads and other areas with poor air quality.

Policy IN14.3 Sport and Recreation

1. We are committed to helping our residents lead healthy and active lifestyles and improve mental well-being, through sport and recreation. We will:
 - a. Encourage opportunities for sport, recreation and play.
 - b. Safeguard existing sport and recreation facilities, based on assessments of need and capacity.
 - c. Support proposals for new, and refurbishment and replacement of existing, sport and recreation facilities on sites that are designated as Open Space in the Policies Map, where the proposal meets Policies O15.2, O15.3 and O15.4.
 - d. Require all residential Major Developments likely to be used by children and young people to provide on-site good quality, free-to-use, safe and accessible play spaces for all ages. The amount of play space provided is to be proportionate to the anticipated increase in child population as a result of the proposed development.
 - e. Recognise the All England Lawn Tennis Club as being an internationally significant sporting venue.
 - f. Ensure that all development proposals that include indoor and outdoor sports and recreation facilities maximise the multiple use of these facilities and encourage the co-location of services for the local community. This should be formalised through Community Use Agreements.

Supporting text

- 14.3.1 This policy should be considered alongside London Plan Policy S4 Play and informal recreation and S5 Sports and recreation facilities, in addition to the Green Infrastructure policies in Chapter 15 of this Local Plan.
- 14.3.2 The provision of parks, play areas, leisure, recreation and cultural facilities helps to encourage healthier, more active lifestyles and improve mental well-being and social interaction. The council is supportive of both formal and informal facilities, to encourage physical activity and deliver a range of social, health and wellbeing benefits to the local community.
- 14.3.3 We will continue to encourage regular participation in sport and recreation activities, including active travel through well designed public spaces which enable greater pedestrian and cycling movements.

- 14.3.4 The [Merton Playing Pitch Strategy \(PPS\)](#) published in 2019 provides a strategic assessment of the future demand for playing pitches and sets out the future requirements for sporting needs in the borough. The PPS was carried out in line with national guidance and in collaboration with Sport England and the National Governing Bodies of Sport (NGBs).
- 14.3.5 The PPS sets out a number of overall recommendations, including a number of sport-specific recommendations for football, rugby, cricket, hockey, tennis, bowls, athletics and water sports, which were agreed in collaboration with Sport England and the NGBs. It also includes an action plan, which is intended to guide the delivery of sports provision over the next 10 years, setting out priority projects, key actions, timescales for delivery and indicative costs by site.
- 14.3.6 The [Merton Indoor Sports Facility Study](#) (ISFS) published in 2020 provides a strategic assessment of indoor sports facilities in Merton, setting out the supply, quality and location of current facilities and considering the future needs.
- 14.3.7 Both the PPS and the ISFS should be referenced for any proposed development that includes indoor or outdoor sports facilities.
- 14.3.8 While sport and recreation facilities are generally considered to be appropriate uses on designated open spaces, these can sometimes result in conflict between users of these spaces and there are a number of considerations that need to be assessed. Proposed development will need to be well designed. Applicants must demonstrate that the location of a proposed facility has been fully considered from the beginning of the design process, makes the best use of the land and does not adversely harm any areas of nature conservation or biodiversity.
- 14.3.9 Sport and recreation facilities must adopt inclusive and accessible design standards to ensure that everyone has the opportunity to take part in sporting activity, in line with relevant best practice and guidance issued by Sport England and other relevant bodies/organisations. The council is supportive of facilities that are inclusive and use accessible design, for example those that enable participation by deaf and disabled people.
- 14.3.10 In line with the Transport policies in this plan, proposed development should incorporate Healthy Streets principles through encouraging walking and cycling, to help achieve active lifestyles and improving mental well-being.

Play space

- 14.3.11 Safe and stimulating play is essential for children and young people's mental and physical health. In order to facilitate greater physical activity, it is important that children

and young people have safe access to good quality, well designed, secure and stimulating play and informal recreation provision.

- 14.3.12 Residential Major Developments will be required to provide an appropriate amount of play space on site. In determining the amount of play space required, consideration will be given to the type of development, amount, quality, and use of existing accessible provision of play space, as well as the anticipated child yield of the development. The London Plan child yield calculator is to be used to determine the amount of play space required. The council also supports the Mayor's supplementary planning guidance 'Providing for Children and Young People's Play and Informal Recreation (2008)', which emphasises the importance of providing spaces for children's play.
- 14.3.13 The Merton Green Infrastructure Study 2020 includes an assessment of publicly accessible play spaces in the borough, providing maps which illustrate areas of deficiency in access to children's play spaces, broken down for ages 0-4, 5-11 and 12 and over. Applicants are advised to refer to these maps in the early stages of the design process to determine whether a site is considered to be deficient in access to play space.
- 14.3.14 There are a variety of different types of play spaces that can be provided through new development. Communal gardens and other outdoor spaces suitable for play, including communal amenity space, may be considered to contribute towards play space provision where they have distinct playable elements. However, publicly accessible play space will be preferred where possible, rather than provision being entirely from private space.
- 14.3.15 Where formal play space is provided it must be free, accessible, and integrated into any wider networks of open space. Where possible, minor developments are also required to provide informal play space.
- 14.3.16 In line with London Plan Policy S4, the council will not support play spaces that are segregated by tenure, as play areas should be accessible to all children.
- 14.3.17 New play spaces should provide an appropriate range of facilities for different age groups, including young children, older children and teenagers. Other elements such as benches and seating areas should also be provided, to enable adult supervision where necessary. Play and informal recreation areas should incorporate trees and greenery wherever possible, to create a welcoming and enjoyable environment for all.
- 14.3.18 Formal and informal play spaces are encouraged in all developments.

All England Lawn Tennis Club

- 14.3.19 The All England Lawn Tennis Club (AELTC) which is the home of the Wimbledon Championships, is a world class sporting venue of national and international significance. The council is supportive of the role that the Championships plays as a tourist, leisure, entertainment and sporting destination in the borough and will continue to support this role and the continued provision of tennis facilities in Merton.
- 14.3.20 Policy S5 of the London Plan recognises that specialist sporting venues and stadiums, such as the AELTC venue, have a vital role to play in enabling wider access to sport, as well as having an important cultural value.
- 14.3.21 Further details on the AELTC sites can be found in the Raynes Park and Wimbledon chapters.

Community Use Agreements

- 14.3.22 We work with many partners in the delivery of shared services across the borough, including schools, colleges, sports providers and other social and community facilities. The council is supportive of maximising the multiple use of facilities to ensure that residents in all areas of Merton can access good quality sports and recreation facilities.
- 14.3.23 The Merton PPS 2019 identifies that Community Use Agreements are an important tool in helping to secure tenure for sporting clubs and associations, which can often be problematic without formal agreements in place. The PPS recommends that educational establishments with playing pitches should be encouraged to secure formal community use of pitches and ancillary facilities through Community Use Agreements.
- 14.3.24 The Merton ISFS 2020 identifies that residents in all areas of Merton should have pay and play access to good quality, local, accessible and affordable provision, whether it is a formal sports hall, a community hall or other informal provision. The ISFS recommends that partnership working be used to facilitate increased access to indoor sports facilities across the borough. All new sports facilities on education sites should provide a balance of pay and play and club opportunities that are available for community access. These should be formalised through Community Use Agreements.
- 14.3.25 Development proposals that include indoor and outdoor sport and recreation facilities will be expected to provide details showing how the facility will be made available to the wider community. This will be formalised through Community Use Agreements, using conditions or planning obligations, where necessary.
- 14.3.26 This is particularly relevant for schools and other social and community facilities but can also apply to commercial schemes. This is to allow and promote access to affordable sports and recreation facilities for all members of the wider local community.

Strategic Policy W14.4 Waste Management

1. We support the objectives of sustainable waste management set out by the government in the National Planning Policy for Waste and the Mayor's London Plan.
2. We will continue to work in collaboration with the neighbouring south London boroughs of Croydon, Kingston-upon-Thames and Sutton to maximise self-sufficiency and meet the apportionment tonnages required by the London Plan for south London. The South London Waste Plan sets out the long-term vision, spatial strategy, policies and sites for the sustainable management of waste, and a monitoring framework to assess the success of the policies.
3. We will increase recycling rates and address waste as a resource, looking to disposal as the last option, in line with the waste hierarchy. To support recycling, the council will require integrated, well designed waste storage facilities that will include recycling facilities for all new developments where appropriate.

Supporting text

- 14.4.1 In November and December 2022, the London boroughs of Croydon, Kingston, Merton and Sutton adopted the South London Waste Plan as part of each borough's Local Plan.
- 14.4.2 The South London Waste Plan (2022-2037) provides the essential infrastructure to support housing growth in south London by safeguarding existing waste treatment sites and includes planning policies that both ensure that waste arising in the boroughs are managed within the South London Waste Plan area and that new or redeveloped waste treatment facilities have the least impact on nearby uses and the environment.
- 14.4.3 Waste treatment is a strategic planning issue across London and a challenge for all successful urban areas. There is a significant need for new homes in south London which generates the requirement for essential waste treatment infrastructure to support this growth. More than a million people already live in south London and there is a significant challenge in providing such essential infrastructure within a heavily urbanised area.
- 14.4.4 South London is seeking to meet this challenge by delivering its share of the London Plan's waste policies while meeting the ambitious targets for new homes in the same geographic area. The London Plan sets the target of managing 100% of London's waste within Greater London by 2026 and having zero biodegradable or recyclable waste going to landfill by 2026. It also sets targets for municipal waste, commercial and industrial waste, construction and demolition waste and excavation waste (London Plan Policy SI8).

- 14.4.5 With significant need for new homes and consequent commercial activity planned across London, the need to provide essential infrastructure such as waste facilities to meet this growth is therefore a regional strategic priority.
- 14.4.6 Details regarding the provision of suitable waste storage facilities are set out in Policy D12.3 'Ensuring high quality design for all developments'.



Chapter 15.

Green and blue infrastructure

Strategic Policy O15.1 Open Space, Green Infrastructure and Nature Conservation

1. Access to open spaces and green infrastructure plays an important role in the physical and mental health and wellbeing of all people. We aim to ensure Merton remains an attractive and green borough, through the protection and enhancement of open spaces, green infrastructure and the natural environment. We will do this by:
 - a. Protecting and enhancing open spaces in the borough including Metropolitan Open Land, Open Space and Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest to provide high quality environments for all residents;
 - b. Protecting and seeking improvements to walking and cycling routes to and through Open Spaces;
 - c. Enhancing existing Open Spaces, Green Corridors and the natural environment, providing habitats for biodiversity to flourish and expand;
 - d. Protecting and enhancing the borough's Biodiversity, particularly on Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest, and supporting the objectives of the Mayor's Environment Strategy;
 - e. Increasing Green Infrastructure across the borough through Urban Greening;
 - f. Enhancing accessibility to our waterways, including the River Wandle and its banks, for leisure and recreational use, while protecting its Biodiversity value;
 - g. Improving opportunities for our residents and visitors to experience nature; and
 - h. Promoting healthy lifestyles to encourage physical education and well-being through the use of our leisure centres, schools, open spaces, playing pitches and recreational spaces.

Supporting text

- 15.1.1. The policies in this chapter should be read alongside the London Plan policies on Green infrastructure and natural environment (Chapter 8) and Sports and recreation facilities (Policy S5) and the Infrastructure policies in Chapter 5 of this Local Plan. These policies are intended to work together to ensure that Merton's green and open spaces remain a valued asset of the borough and are protected and enhanced.
- 15.1.2. Merton is lucky to be one of the greenest boroughs in London, with over 1,300 hectares of open space, which makes up 35% of the borough. To ensure there continues to be good quality green spaces for everyone to enjoy, it will be important to protect and enhance the existing open spaces and green infrastructure in Merton. Emphasis will be placed on the

protection and long-term management of open spaces and areas of nature conservation and encouraging improved accessibility to these spaces. Pedestrian and cycle routes across open spaces often form a strategically important part of the borough's cycling and walking networks and many are designated as public rights of way. These routes enable active travel choices by connecting key destinations in the borough via convenient shortcuts and quiet routes away from busy roads. Pedestrian and cycle routes through open spaces should be protected and wherever possible provided to a high standard in accordance with best practice guidance.

- 15.1.3. There are nine areas of Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) designated in Merton, which are of great importance to the green character of the borough. Through the green infrastructure reviews undertaken for this Plan, the MOL boundaries have been reviewed and the council does not consider that major changes are needed to accommodate growth. The MOL sites illustrated on the Policies Map and listed in the Appendices will continue to be protected from inappropriate development in accordance with London Plan Policy G3 and NPPF paragraph 147. Further information is set out in Policy O15.2 Green Infrastructure and Open Space.
- 15.1.4. Some minor boundary amendments have been made to MOL sites on the Policies Map through this Local Plan. These include corrections to mapping irregularities, and inconsistencies, changes to reflect the built form on site that has come forward through approved planning applications, which no longer protects the spatial or visual openness of the MOL, and some exceptional circumstances. These boundary changes to the Policies Map help to create strong, defensible and permanent boundaries and ensure consistency with the NPPF and London Plan. With reference to NPPF para 140, further information on these boundary changes is provided in the Appendices.
- 15.1.5. The following evidence base documents have been published, which support the Local Plan and should be referenced for all relevant planning applications:
- The Merton Green Infrastructure, Biodiversity and Open Space Study (2020);
 - The Merton Playing Pitch Strategy (2019); and
 - The Merton Indoor Sports Facility Study (2020).

Policy O15.2 Open Space and Green Infrastructure

1. We place a high value on green infrastructure and open spaces, as they make a significant contribution to the health (including mental health) and wellbeing of Merton residents, contribute to social cohesion and mitigate some of the impacts of climate change. We aim to protect and enhance our open spaces and to improve accessibility to open space. We will:
 - a. Protect and enhance the borough's public and private open space network including protecting Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) and designated Open Spaces from inappropriate development in accordance with the London Plan and government guidance.
 - b. Ensure that, in accordance with the NPPF, existing open space, sports and recreational buildings and land, including playing fields, should not be built on unless:
 - i. an assessment has been undertaken which has clearly shown the open space, buildings or land to be surplus to requirements; or
 - ii. the loss resulting from the proposed development would be replaced by equivalent or better provision in terms of quantity and quality in a suitable location; or
 - iii. the development is for alternative sports and recreational provision, the benefits of which clearly outweigh the loss of the current or former use.
 - c. Ensure that development proposals within designated Open Spaces (which have met the conditions set in part b) above, meet all the following criteria:
 - i. the proposals are of a high quality design and do not harm the character, appearance or function of the open space and;
 - ii. the proposals retain and/or improve public access between existing public areas and open spaces through the creation of new and more direct footpath and cycle path links; and,
 - iii. the character and function of leisure walks are preserved or enhanced.
 - d. Require the creation of new publicly accessible open space as part of Major Development proposals in locations that are deficient in access to public Open Space and support the creation of new publicly accessible open space in all developments, where suitable and viable.
 - e. Expect development to incorporate and maintain appropriate elements of Green infrastructure which makes a positive contribution to the wider network of Open Spaces.
 - f. Safeguard existing allotments and encourage and support opportunities for community run and managed food growing spaces in new developments.

- g.** Expect all development to make provision for the long-term management and maintenance of Open Space and green infrastructure on site.

Supporting text

- 15.2.1. Open Space can be multi-functional; people use green and open spaces for many purposes including exercise, play, food growing, socialising and leisure. Visual accessibility is equally as important as physical access. The protection and enhancement of open spaces enables the provision of areas for active and passive leisure activities, has a positive impact on health and wellbeing, provides opportunities for social cohesion between members of Merton's diverse communities, provides safe pedestrian and cycle routes, provides areas for nature within urban areas and can provide areas for flood mitigation measures. Open Spaces and Green Infrastructure can also play a role in enhancing and conserving the historic environment. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 (Infrastructure).
- 15.2.2. The 2020 Merton Green Infrastructure, Biodiversity and Open Space Study (referred to as the Green Infrastructure Study) provides an assessment of open space quality, quantity and accessibility throughout Merton, including an audit of existing open spaces to determine the likely demand and need for facilities over the lifetime of the Local Plan.
- 15.2.3. The Green Infrastructure Study identifies that Merton is one of the greenest boroughs in London, with over 1,300 hectares of open spaces, accounting for 35% of the borough. 21% of this is public open space, slightly more than the 18% in London.
- 15.2.4. The coronavirus (COVID-19) pandemic has highlighted the importance of having access to green spaces within walking distance of homes. During the pandemic, visits to parks and other green spaces increased across London. It is important to protect and enhance the existing areas of open space in Merton, to ensure that as the population grows, there are good quality green spaces for everyone to enjoy.

Metropolitan Open Land

- 15.2.5. Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) is strategic open land that contributes to the structure of London. It is afforded the same status and protection as Green Belt land. As shown on the Policies Map, there are 9 designated areas of MOL in Merton, covering over 950 hectares, or 26% of the borough. MOL will continue to be protected from inappropriate development, in accordance with the London Plan and government guidance.

Designated Open Spaces

- 15.2.6. The Open Spaces relevant to this policy are designated on the Policies Map. These typically consist of parks, commons, playing fields, play areas, cemeteries and churchyards,

woodlands and allotments. We are committed to ensuring the protection and enhancement of designated Open Space.

- 15.2.7. Many designated Open Spaces have existing buildings within them, particularly when associated with leisure and sports facilities. Proposals for new or improvements to existing buildings on Open Space that meet the criteria in the policy should be of high quality design, and of a scale, height and massing that is appropriate to their setting. Proposals should show how uses are required and linked to the function of the open space and all proposed uses should complement and enhance the function of the open space (e.g. pavilions and changing rooms that are required for playing pitches).
- 15.2.8. For clarity, the assessment that is referred to in part 1.b.i. of this policy is a strategic borough-wide assessment such as the Merton Green Infrastructure Study 2020, the Merton Playing Pitch Strategy 2019, or the Merton Indoor Sports Facility Study 2020, not assessments that are done on a site by site basis.

Improving accessibility to public Open Space

- 15.2.9. The Green Infrastructure Study includes an accessibility assessment to analyse areas in the borough that are deficient in access to public open space, play areas and nature conservation, and maps are provided for each. The areas of deficiency in access to public open space are calculated by Greenspace Information for Greater London (GiGL) using their Areas of Deficiency (AoD) data model. Public open space categories are set out in the London Plan Table 8.1 and provide a benchmark for the provision of publicly accessible open space, categorising spaces according to their size, facilities and local importance.
- 15.2.10. Residents in Merton experience high accessibility to Regional Parks (98%) and Metropolitan Parks (99%). There is also a good level of accessibility to District Parks (77%) and Local Parks (72%). There is a notable gap in access to District Parks indicated by a continuous band of deficiency from west to north-east through Raynes Park, Wimbledon, Colliers Wood and Mitcham.
- 15.2.11. The best reflection of deficiency in access to open space is to the Local Parks, Small Open Spaces and Pocket Parks. In these areas of deficiency the lack of open spaces is more evident, although there is some evidence of existing open space which is not publicly accessible. There are some areas (particularly noticeable around Raynes Park) where there are gaps in access to both District and Local Parks. Major Developments proposed in these areas will be required to improve access to publicly accessible open space, either through design and public realm improvements, or by providing new publicly accessible open space on site. New public access routes should be designed to be accessible by all people. Where necessary, planning obligations may be sought to secure access improvements. Applicants are advised to consult the areas of deficiency maps provided in the Green Infrastructure Study for consideration as part of the design process.

- 15.2.12. Where necessary, to fund any costs to the council associated with onsite provision of new open space proposed as part of Major Developments, commuted sums may be negotiated on a case by case basis and the level of funding sought will be commensurate to the financial burden to the council that would arise due to the open space provision.
- 15.2.13. A large number of open spaces in Merton are linked by rivers, brooks and smaller open spaces, or are separated from one another by short sections of built development. This can limit the accessibility to and between open spaces. New development in these areas should explore opportunities to enhance the accessibility between these spaces, in line with the principles set out in the All London Green Grid guidance and London Plan Policy SI16(F). Improvements in accessibility should be delivered in tandem with the Transport policies.
- 15.2.14. It is important to protect and improve the existing links between and across open spaces. These links provide important informal recreational opportunities for walking and cycling, create a safe and pleasant environment, and allow appreciation of attractive landscapes and features of historical significance.

Green Infrastructure

- 15.2.15. Green Infrastructure refers to the network of parks, rivers, water spaces and green spaces, plus the green elements of the built environment, such as street trees, green roofs and sustainable drainage systems.
- 15.2.16. All development will be expected to incorporate elements of Green Infrastructure on site, to enhance biodiversity, contribute to the health and wellbeing of all residents and help mitigate the impacts of climate change. Examples include pollinator-friendly landscaping, tree-planting, green walls, green and blue roofs and rain gardens all of which can have multiple benefits. Reference should also be made to the Local Plan policies on Biodiversity and Nature Conservation (O15.3), Protection of Trees, Hedges and Other Landscape Features (O15.4) and Urban Greening (O15.5).

Allotments and food growing

- 15.2.17. Local food growing can help to create healthier food environments, improve food security, promote healthy and active lifestyles and help to improve social and community cohesion. Allotments and orchards are areas set aside for food growing and are recognised for their contribution to enabling healthy and sustainable lifestyles. These green spaces not only offer biodiversity and conservation value but also bring recreational, health and social benefits, by allowing residents to grow fresh produce.
- 15.2.18. The Green Infrastructure Study identifies there are 21 allotments in Merton; 19 of which are Council owned and the other two privately owned. It is important that allotments continue to be protected, while new spaces for growing food are also encouraged.

- 15.2.19. New proposed developments may provide ideal opportunities to incorporate spaces for residents to grow food. This does not have to be in formal allotment areas, but could extend to roofs, walls and balconies or by introducing trees and shrubs that produce food as part of the landscaping. It may be appropriate for areas to be used temporarily for food growing, provided it does not conflict with other policy objectives or land use priorities and does not have an unacceptable impact on the amenity of adjoining areas.
- 15.2.20. Food growing in schools can also help children's learning and skills, in addition to wider health and wellbeing outcomes.

Policy O15.3 Biodiversity and Access to Nature

1. We are committed to protecting and enhancing the natural environment. We aim to protect and enhance Biodiversity, particularly on Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest, and to improve accessibility to nature throughout the borough. We will:
 - a. Protect all Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest against inappropriate development that will adversely affect the nature conservation value of the site, and secure measures that enhance their nature conservation value;
 - b. Protect and avoid damage to Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest, populations of protected species, priority habitats and priority species;
 - c. Protect Green Corridors from development which may destroy or impair the integrity of the Green Corridor.
 - d. Require development to contribute at least 10% in net gains in Biodiversity, in accordance with statutory requirements and national guidance, by incorporating features such as green roofs and walls, soft landscaping, bird and bat bricks and boxes, habitat restoration, tree planting and expansion and improved green links. Where development is adjacent to or includes a watercourse, natural banks and processes should be restored with a 10m buffer, where feasible.
 - e. Require the following mitigation hierarchy to be followed, for development where significant harm to Biodiversity is unavoidable, and where the benefits of the development proposal clearly outweigh the impacts on Biodiversity:
 - i. Avoid damaging the significant ecological features of the site
 - ii. Minimise the overall spatial impact and mitigate it by improving the quality or management of the rest of the site
 - iii. Deliver off-site compensation of better Biodiversity value.
 - f. Expect Major Development on sites found in an area of deficiency in access to nature to address the deficiency, where suitable and viable.

Supporting text

- 15.3.1. Section 40 of the Natural Environment and Rural Communities Act 2006 places a duty on public authorities to have regard to the purpose of conserving biodiversity, through policy and decision making.

- 15.3.2. We are committed to protecting and enhancing biodiversity, particularly on Sites-of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest. The protection and enhancement of biodiversity in urban areas such as Merton is important, particularly in the context of biodiversity losses due to development pressure, climate change and deficiencies in access to nature. Protecting biodiversity and the wider natural environment can have a variety of significant positive impacts including strengthening wildlife movement and connections, improving health and mental wellbeing of residents, contributing to climate change adaptation and improving quality of life.
- 15.3.3. For clarity, reference in this policy to Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest include all sites that are designated on the Merton Policies Map as:
- Sites of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI);
 - Metropolitan, Borough or Local Sites of Importance to Nature Conservation (SINC); and
 - Local Nature Reserves (LNR).
- 15.3.4. Development proposals which are likely to affect sites that have been designated on the Policies Map as SSSI, SINC, LNR or Green Corridor will be required to demonstrate that such development will not adversely affect the nature conservation values of the site. Any proposals on adjoining sites will also need to ensure and demonstrate that the proposed development will not harm the nature conservation value of the designated site.
- 15.3.5. In line with the NPPF and London Plan Policy G6, significant harm to biodiversity on a site through proposed development should be avoided. In circumstances where harm is unavoidable, the mitigation hierarchy will be applied. It will be expected that where any mitigation or compensation is required, this will be provided at the equivalent, or better, biodiversity and habitat area and value.
- 15.3.6. The preservation of existing biodiversity, including wildlife habitats, is strongly preferred over re-provision as any redevelopment of an existing space will necessitate its total loss and replacement with a space that has to be established with plants and wildlife over time; this carries the risk that the replacement space will be less successful than that which it replaces.

Sites of Special Scientific Interest / Special Areas of Conservation – Wimbledon Common

- 15.3.7. Wimbledon Common is the only SSSI in the borough and this area is also protected by European legislation as a Special Area of Conservation (SAC). The Habitats Regulations require an 'Appropriate Assessment' to be carried out if a plan or project is likely to have a significant effect on Wimbledon Common (either alone or in combination with other plans or projects). This may apply to development projects and this is not the same as an Environmental Impact Assessment. The Natural England website has more information to help decide whether or not a development project requires an 'Appropriate Assessment'.

SINCS

- 15.3.8. There are 56 SINCs in Merton, covering an area of 833 hectares (22% of the borough). Proposals on, or in close proximity to SINCs should have a positive impact on biodiversity and will be assessed in accordance with London Plan Policy G6.

Local Nature Reserves

- 15.3.9. There are 15 LNRs in Merton; areas that have been statutorily designated under Section 21 of the National Parks and Access to the Countryside Act 1949. These are places that are considered to be important for wildlife, geology, education and enjoyment by local people. Public access to LNRs is important, provided that people visiting the site will not damage or disturb the wildlife.

Protected Species, Priority Habitats and Priority Species.

- 15.3.10. Although Merton is a built-up area in London, it is still home to many protected species and habitats that are valuable to biodiversity. While trees and green spaces provide habitats for many species, buildings can also provide roosting sites for bats and nesting opportunities for birds. Biodiversity should be considered at the early stages of the design process, as the benefits of creating spaces for wildlife also have significant positive impacts for the health and wellbeing of local residents.
- 15.3.11. Wildlife in the UK is protected under the Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981 (as amended). Applicants should check that wildlife and protected species will not be affected by a proposed planning application. The Natural England standing advice on protected species should be referred to for any development proposal on a site that may impact on a protected species, priority habitat or priority species. Any development that is located within or in close proximity to a SINC or is likely to have an impact on protected species, habitats or priority species, will be required to submit an ecological survey and appraisal. This is to ensure that we can make an informed decision to protect and enhance biodiversity.
- 15.3.12. Ecological surveys submitted with planning applications should be in line with the Natural England standing advice on protected species and:
- be carried out by an appropriately qualified ecologist
 - be carried out at an appropriate time of year and no later than six months prior to the submission of the planning application;
 - use appropriate methods for the species and the area;
 - be carried out early in the design process of a proposal;
 - identify any potential impacts a proposed development is likely to have on the ecology of a site; and
 - recommend suitable mitigation and enhancement measures for the proposed development.

- 15.3.13. Development proposals are required to consider the potential impact that lighting, noise or shading may have on biodiversity on and around the site. New proposed lighting should minimise impacts to biodiversity, protected species and priority habitats.
- 15.3.14. Any works that would affect breeding birds and their nests, such as works of demolition, vegetation removal or site clearance, will need to be done outside the nesting season from 1 March to 31 July inclusive (in accordance with the Natural England standing advice on wild birds).

Green Corridors

- 15.3.15. Green Corridors are continuous areas of open space, which link other open spaces to each other, allowing animals and plants to move in and around built-up areas. There are 18 Green Corridors designated on the Policies Map, covering an area of 1,023 hectares (27% of the borough).
- 15.3.16. We recognise the importance of maintaining and enhancing the network of Green Corridors. These areas effectively create corridors that enable the movement of plant and animals. They allow some animals to undertake movements between different habitats that they require for survival, maintain the presence of some animals and plants in places where they would not otherwise be found, and help to ensure the maintenance of the current range and diversity of flora and fauna, and the survival of important species.
- 15.3.17. Proposed development on sites in and adjacent to Green Corridors will need to consider biodiversity, wildlife and Green Infrastructure elements early on in the design process. This includes considering and mitigating against any potential impacts on biodiversity from elements such as lighting, noise or shading. Lighting can have negative impacts on birds, roosting bats and bats that are feeding or commuting to feeding areas.

Biodiversity Net gain

- 15.3.18. Biodiversity net gain is an approach which aims to leave the natural environment in a better state than it previously was. Development proposals should maximise biodiversity benefits and ecological connectivity through ensuring that biodiversity is a key consideration early in the design process.
- 15.3.19. Development, particularly for new and replacement buildings and extensions to buildings, should utilise opportunities to attract new species to a site. This can include the incorporation of artificial nest boxes and bricks in buildings to provide nesting and roosting opportunities for birds, including species under threat such as swifts, house martins, swallows and house sparrows, and where appropriate, bats. Swift bricks integrated into new buildings are preferred, as these are suitable for multiple bird species. As outlined in the NPPG 2019 (para 023) these relatively small features can achieve important benefits for wildlife. Applicants will be expected to provide details of such features as part of planning

applications and should refer to best practice guidance when designing a development, including that prepared by the Chartered Institute of Ecology and Environmental Management (CIEEM) and the British Standard BS 42021 for integral nest boxes.

- 15.3.20. Development proposals should prioritise the inclusion of Biodiversity on-site, selecting species for planting that complements surrounding habitats, maximises benefits to biodiversity and is beneficial to wildlife.
- 15.3.21. Improvements to biodiversity should not be restricted to conventional habitats but should extend to the increased use of green roofs and green walls. The use of sustainable drainage measures can also have significant biodiversity benefits – refer to Policy F15.9 and the Merton SUDs SPD for further guidance.
- 15.3.22. The Environment Act 2021 introduces a requirement for all development to deliver a 10% net gain in Biodiversity, except for those exempted. Applicants should refer to the DEFRA guidance, which includes links to the relevant statutory metric tool, to calculate the net gains in Biodiversity.
- 15.3.23. In their applications, applicants will need to identify local habitats of ‘strategic significance’ for their statutory metric calculations. The Mayor of London is currently preparing a London-wide Local Nature Recovery Strategy (LNRS); once published, Biodiversity net gain proposals will have to have regard to this LNRS. Until its publication, applicants will have to refer to the details within:
 - Merton’s Green Infrastructure, Biodiversity and Open Space Study 2020,
 - the relevant SINC citations,
 - the management plans of the relevant Local Nature Reserve, and
 - the recommended mitigation measures for enhancing Water Framework Directive water bodies from the Environment Agency’s [Catchment Planning System](#).

Areas of Deficiency in Access to Nature

- 15.3.24. There is generally good access to green spaces and nature conservation areas in Merton, however some parts of the borough are considered to be deficient in access. For clarity, areas of deficiency in access to nature are areas where people have to walk more than 1km to reach a publicly accessible metropolitan or borough SINC. These areas have been identified and mapped in the Merton Green Infrastructure Study 2020. These maps are regularly updated by GiGL and should be referred to when preparing planning applications.
- 15.3.25. Major Development proposals on sites that are located in these areas of deficiency will be expected to address these deficiencies, where suitable and viable. We will support improvements in accessibility to SINC in areas of deficiency through all developments, where this is practicable.

Geodiversity

- 15.3.26. There are no regional or locally important geological sites in Merton. However, there is a site on Putney Heath, approximately 160 metres from the borough boundary in Wandsworth, which is a site of local importance. Development proposals that could have an impact on the geological features of this site should have regard to London Plan Policy G9.

Policy O15.4 Protection of Trees, Hedges and Other Landscape Features

1. We are committed to protecting trees and enhancing other features of the natural environment. We will:
 - a. Encourage and support the protection of street trees, and secure appropriate replacements;
 - b. Ensure that development proposals protect and retain trees, hedges and other landscape features of amenity value, on site and on adjoining land, wherever possible, and secure suitable replacements in instances where their loss is justified;
 - i. The loss of trees, hedges and other landscape features of amenity value will only be justified when:
 - 1) Their removal would not have a significant negative impact on the local environment and its enjoyment by the public;
 - 2) Their removal is necessary in the interest of good arboricultural practice; or
 - 3) The benefits of the development outweigh the amenity value of any features that would be lost.
 - ii. In circumstances where 1), 2) or 3) applies, suitable high-quality re-provision of equal value must be provided on site. Where on site provision is demonstrably not possible, as agreed with the council, a financial contribution of the full cost of appropriate re-provision will be required.
 - c. Expect development proposals, where appropriate, to plant additional trees on site in a coordinated way to maximise the green infrastructure network and to increase the borough's tree canopy;
 - d. Use Tree Preservation Orders to safeguard significant trees of amenity value;
 - e. Expect proposals for new and replacement trees, hedges and landscape features of amenity value to consist of appropriate native species to the UK;
 - f. Require developers to ensure that bio-security measures are adhered to for trees, shrubs and herbaceous plants, to prevent accidental release of pests and diseases.

Supporting text

- 15.4.1. Trees, hedges, shrubs and other significant vegetation make an important contribution to the borough's townscape and the quality of life for residents. These elements provide visual and amenity enhancements to the built environment, while also providing much needed

habitats for Biodiversity. Trees, and in particular mature trees, can help to reduce impacts on air quality and contribute to climate change by capturing and storing carbon dioxide. Trees will continue to play a significant role in adapting to climate change by having a positive impact on reducing flood risk and helping to reduce the urban heat island effect.

- 15.4.2. The Green Infrastructure Study 2020 identifies that, although Merton has an overall tree canopy cover that is greater than the London average, a sustained expansion of tree and woodland planting is important. This is needed to address ongoing biodiversity declines, increase resilience to pests and diseases, increase shade and tackle climate change. The Study identifies the total tree canopy, including in private gardens, covers an area of 1,040 hectares, approximately 28% of the borough. There are different techniques for estimating tree and woodland coverage, but of the total tree canopy: 266.1 hectares (26%) consists of woodlands contained within parks and public open spaces; 15.2 hectares (1.5%) consists of individual woodlands; 116.7 hectares (11.2%) consists of street tree (canopy); and the remainder (61.3%) is found in private gardens, cemeteries and institutional grounds. London's tree coverage is estimated to be 20% and the London Environment Strategy has set a target to increase this by 10% by 2050.
- 15.4.3. We are supportive of the protection and retention of trees on development sites, as this will help to provide a platform to expand the borough's tree canopy. When considering the amenity value of a tree, we will look at Category A, B and lesser category trees where they are considered to be of importance to amenity and biodiversity, as defined by BS 5837:2012 (in accordance with the London Plan Policy G7C).
- 15.4.4. There will be an expectation for proposals to also provide new trees on site, to help add to the borough's tree canopy. While it is recognised that individual site constraints may mean this is not possible on every site, applicants will be expected to demonstrate they have considered the provision of new trees as part of their design concepts.
- 15.4.5. We will use the existing planning mechanisms including Tree Preservation Orders and Conservation Area designations to protect existing trees on private land. Applicants should refer to the laws and guidance on Tree Preservation Orders, including Part VIII of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990, the Town and Country Planning (Tree Preservation)(England) Regulations 2012 and government guidance on Tree Preservation Orders and trees in conservation areas. These links provide the necessary information and requirements on trees that have Tree Preservation Orders and trees within conservation areas.
- 15.4.6. In line with the NPPF and London Plan Policy G7, ancient woodland areas and veteran trees should be protected from development. These are irreplaceable habitats and form a key component of green infrastructure, helping to create resilient and sustainable places to live. Any proposed development in the vicinity of these protected areas should seek guidance prior to submitting a planning application. Further guidance on the protection of

ancient woodland and veteran trees can be accessed via the Forestry Commission or The Woodland Trust.

- 15.4.7. We consider it important that development proposals are accompanied by appropriate reports and surveys to deal with the impact of the proposals on the existing vegetation. We assess trees within the scope of BS 5837:2012. When applicable, developers will need to demonstrate that they have paid regard to current British Standards such as BS 5837:2012 'Trees in relation to design, demolition and construction - Recommendations', BS 3998:2010 'Tree Work – Recommendations' and other relevant documentation such as the Arboricultural Advisory and Information Service's 'Arboricultural Practice Note 12'.
- 15.4.8. New development should be designed positively to integrate existing trees. For trees that are located on a proposed development site, the appropriate arboricultural information should be provided to demonstrate that layouts have been informed by the use of such survey and tree constraints mapping information. If a tree is proposed to be removed, applicants will be expected to show that they have considered alternative design layouts and provide reasons why these layouts were not brought forward.
- 15.4.9. Tree planting should be considered from the design stage of a proposal. The location of new trees should be planned to complement proposed features, have an appropriately sized tree pit, be bio-secure and be appropriate for the intended use of the development. We may request details relating to the long-term maintenance for new trees and landscaping on development sites, to ensure planting becomes established, particularly within the first five years. Planning conditions will also be used, as appropriate.
- 15.4.10. All developments are required to protect and retain existing trees, hedges, shrubs and other significant vegetation, and provide sufficient space for the crowns and root systems of existing and proposed trees and their future growth. Developments within proximity of existing trees are required to provide protection from any damage during development.
- 15.4.11. In those exceptional circumstances where the loss of or damage to trees of value is unavoidable, mitigation through adequate planting will be secured. As set out in London Plan Policy G7C, recognised valuation systems should be used to inform suitable replacement planting based on the existing value of the benefits of the trees removed. Examples of such valuation systems include i-tree and CAVAT. We will require applicants to provide this information as part of the arboricultural report submitted with the planning application.
- 15.4.12. Planning conditions will be used for any development proposals where a replacement tree is required. Section 106 planning agreements may also be used in circumstances where a payment in lieu is required.
- 15.4.13. Where there are constraints to planting and re-planting cannot occur on-site, or only partial canopy cover can be re-provided, the development will be required to provide evidence to justify why it is not feasible. Once this is established to our satisfaction, it may then be

accepted that off-site compensation is appropriate, or that a financial contribution of the full cost of appropriate re-provision is required. The preference will be to prioritise planting over a financial contribution, unless there are exceptional circumstances in relation to compliance with other policy requirements.

- 15.4.14. Underground servicing often affects existing trees and/or can limit where new trees are located. Proposals involving existing and/or proposed underground servicing must ensure that the requirements for protecting existing trees and proposed new trees, are fully considered.
- 15.4.15. Although exotic species can have interesting aesthetic qualities, they can also have a damaging impact on biodiversity and the local ecology. We have a strong preference for native species to be planted but, where appropriate, will consider suitable exotic species. Species selection should also be appropriate for the site location and local conditions, taking into account a changing climate. Fruit trees will be supported, as these can provide a variety of benefits.
- 15.4.16. We will take appropriate measures to prevent or reduce the risk of transmission of emerging pests, diseases and invasive species that are detrimental to the health of trees. With the advent of introduced pests, such as the Oak Processionary Moth (*Thaumetopoea processionea*) and diseases such as Ash Dieback (*Chalara fraxinea*), trees, shrubs and herbaceous plants should follow BS8545: Trees: From Nursery to independence in the Landscape. This includes that trees should not be imported directly from European suppliers and planted straight into the landscape setting but spend a full growing season in a British nursery to ensure plant health and non-infection by foreign pests and diseases before being introduced into a development. Landscape conditions will be used to ensure that good practice is exercised as detailed by LTOA and the Forestry Commission.

Policy O15.5 Urban Greening

1. We are committed to ensuring that new development incorporates green infrastructure, to help create healthier places, enhance biodiversity and address the urban heat island effect. We will:
 - a. Require Major Developments to incorporate Urban Greening through site and building design, by:
 - i. Conducting an Urban Greening Factor (UGF) assessment in accordance with the methodology set out in the London Plan;
 - ii. Achieving an UGF of 0.4 for developments that are predominantly residential;
 - iii. Achieving an UGF of 0.3 for developments that are predominantly commercial.
 - b. Require all developments to consider Green Infrastructure at an early stage of the design process and incorporate this as part of an integrated design approach.
 - c. Strongly support the inclusion of Urban Greening for all other development in Merton.

Supporting text

- 15.5.1. Urban Greening describes the incorporation of Green Infrastructure elements into a development, such as vegetation, trees, green roofs, green walls, hedgerows and water features. There can be multiple benefits to including these features in new development including improved physical and mental wellbeing, biodiversity and habitat enhancements, improved air quality, water attenuation, carbon storage, improved visual amenity and helping to address the urban heat island effect.
- 15.5.2. London Plan Policy G5 includes a London wide UGF model to assist boroughs and developers in determining the appropriate provision of Urban Greening for new developments. We will use the London wide model in the determination of planning applications but may in time develop a local model through further GLA and local supplementary guidance.
- 15.5.3. The Merton Green Infrastructure Study 2020 includes a technical report which assesses the quantity and quality of green and blue infrastructure throughout Merton. The report identifies that there are only a small number of green roofs in Merton representing less than 0.1% of all green and blue infrastructure. This policy will help to ensure that higher levels of Green Infrastructure are provided on development sites through the use of urban greening features such as green roofs and walls, helping to enhance biodiversity and create healthier places.
- 15.5.4. Merton Council declared a Climate Emergency in July 2019 and is working towards the implementation of a Climate Action Plan that will set out the strategic approach to reducing

carbon emissions in the borough. One of the key action areas identified to help the borough become carbon neutral is enabling green space across Merton to capture carbon from the atmosphere. By ensuring that new developments incorporate Urban Greening, Green Infrastructure will improve across the borough and help to mitigate the impacts of climate change such as overheating, flooding and loss of biodiversity.

- 15.5.5. As set out in the Climate Change policies, development proposals will be required to demonstrate they are well designed, fully adaptable and resilient to the impacts of a changing climate. Urban Greening should be incorporated into the design of new development to assist in mitigating the risk of overheating and adverse impacts on the urban heat island effect.
- 15.5.6. All applicants will be expected to consider Green Infrastructure at the earliest possible stage of the design process and take every opportunity to incorporate urban greening elements into their development. This should be clearly shown through the Pre-application process.
- 15.5.7. Applicants will be required to provide the following information:
- Appropriate information which provides sufficient detail on the type(s) of Green Infrastructure proposed;
 - Justification indicating why the type(s) of Green Infrastructure have been proposed for the development;
 - The UGF calculation and score; and
 - Appropriate information on how the urban greening elements will be maintained and managed over the lifetime of the development.
- 15.5.8. Urban Greening is not only relevant for Major Development sites. Given that a large proportion of development that will come forward over the Local Plan period will be on small sites, it will be important that these sites also contribute to the provision of additional Green Infrastructure in the borough. Planning applications submitted for small sites will be strongly encouraged to incorporate Urban Greening on site as part of a development. While there are many ways this can be done, three examples include creating greener front gardens, using capillary matting instead of hard standing for car parking areas and increasing the overall amount of vegetation on site. Further information is provided in Merton Council's Small Sites Toolkit.

Policy O15.6 Wandle Valley Regional Park

1. We are committed to protecting the Wandle Valley Regional Park and maintaining it as a strategic, biodiverse and accessible corridor through the borough. We will:
 - a. Support the Wandle Valley Regional Park as one of London's major green networks, protecting biodiversity and supporting opportunities for formal and informal recreation through enhanced accessibility.
 - b. Protect and enhance the River Wandle, including its green and blue infrastructure, biodiversity and wildlife corridors.
 - c. Support opportunities for green infrastructure improvements to the Wandle Valley Regional Park and along the River Wandle.
 - d. Support the protection and completion of the Wandle Trail, as shown on the 'Wandle Trail / National Cycle Network Route 20 (NCN20)' Policies Map and the 'Indicative Cycle Network' Policies Map.
 - e. Require development within 400m of the Wandle Valley Regional Park boundary to consider its relationship to the park in terms of visual, physical and landscape links, and ensure that new development positively enhances accessibility to the park through improvements to walking and cycling.
 - f. Expect all new development within 400m of the Wandle Valley Regional Park to provide green infrastructure elements on site through Urban Greening.
 - g. Work with the Environment Agency, Thames Water, the Greater London Authority, landowners and developers to implement flood risk reduction measures which include Green Infrastructure, that manage river and surface water flooding while delivering wider benefits for water and air quality, people and wildlife.
 - h. Encourage the celebration of the Wandle Valley Regional Park through community celebrations, arts, cultural events and sporting activities that will support and promote tourism and recreation in Merton.
 - i. Work with neighbouring boroughs and relevant bodies to support and encourage increased accessibility through the Wandle Valley Regional Park.

Supporting text

- 15.6.1. The Wandle Valley Regional Park is made up of a number of sites that run along or nearby to the River Wandle. These spaces, particularly the Wandle Trail, are especially important

for the quality of life of residents in Merton, positively contributing to their health and wellbeing.

- 15.6.2. For the purposes of this document, the Wandle Valley Regional Park is taken to mean the areas of land in the borough which correspond to the area defined in the All London Green Grid Wandle Area Framework, as shown on the Policies Map.
- 15.6.3. The Wandle Valley Regional Park Trust was established in 2012 to provide leadership and coordination of a sub-regional partnership to improve the effectiveness, coherence, resilience and quality of the Wandle Valley Regional Park. The 2016-2021 Strategy identifies the Wandle Valley Regional Park as a strategically important asset for London. The Trust supports the promotion of the park not just as a collection of green spaces, but as an interconnected system that can benefit communities living and working in the wider Wandle Valley area.

Green infrastructure and biodiversity functions

- 15.6.4. The Wandle Valley Regional Park is one of the largest strategic green links in south west London. Rather than a single area of open land, the park is made up of a green grid of connected spaces with visual or physical links to the current or historic route of the River Wandle.
- 15.6.5. The Wandle Valley Regional Park enables improved access to a linked network of open spaces, including parkland, wildlife areas, riverside walks and facilities for children and young people, which increases the quality of the environment and contributes to the identity of the valley as a place to live, work and visit.
- 15.6.6. The River Wandle forms part of London's network of waterways, also known as the Blue Ribbon Network in the London Plan. It is an important Green Corridor for species movement throughout south-west London with a number of protected species found along its length. Biodiversity and wildlife should be protected and enhanced along the waterways. In line with the other green infrastructure policies, applicants will be expected to demonstrate that proposed development will not have a significant adverse effect on Protected Species or Priority Species and Priority Habitats.
- 15.6.7. For development within 400m of the Wandle Valley Regional Park, an increase in green cover through the provision of elements such as high-quality landscaping, trees, green roofs, green walls and nature based sustainable drainage will help to strengthen the Wandle Valley Regional Park as a network of green and open spaces, while also enhancing biodiversity.

Accessibility

- 15.6.8. The Wandle Valley Regional Park is a place for healthy living, enhancing physical and mental health by improving access to good quality public realm and green spaces.
- 15.6.9. The Wandle Trail is an established footpath and cycle way, providing a 12 mile (20 km) strategic green route that offers the enjoyment of a variety of chalk stream heritage, flora and fauna. Predominantly following the River Wandle, the trail runs between East Croydon station to the Thames Path in Wandsworth, crossing through Merton with a section of the trail in the north of the borough forming part of the National Cycle Network Route 20. The Wandle Trail links key destinations in the borough and beyond, via convenient shortcuts and quiet routes away from busy roads. It forms a strategically important part of the borough's cycling and walking network that plays a vital role in enabling active travel choices.
- 15.6.10. While most sections are in a good condition, there are some sections that will require future investment and improvement to enable a continuous trail that is fully accessible to all users, at all times of the year. We support the protection and completion of the Wandle Trail, including the identified improvements in access required in the north-east of the borough, near Earlsfield (refer to Policy Maps 'Wandle Trail / National Cycle Network Route 20 (NCN20)' and 'Indicative Cycling Network' and Table 16.1). This includes the currently inaccessible section from Trewint Street to Ravensbury Terrace. This will complete a missing link, and provide a safer, quieter and more pleasant alternative route for cyclists and pedestrians to the busy Durnsford Road bridge. Completion of the Wandle Trail missing link will involve joint working between the boroughs of Merton and Wandsworth, the Environment Agency and National Rail, supported through Section 106 contributions already secured, other funding sources and the provision of access routes already secured through adjacent development sites. Investment in the Wandle Trail should respect the character of the river's environs and be designed for pedestrian and cycle access.
- 15.6.11. Improvements to wayfinding and signage along the Wandle Trail and throughout the Wandle Valley Regional Park are welcomed, as these will help to increase accessibility and encourage more residents and tourists to visit. Access points and trails should be inclusive and provide access for all.
- 15.6.12. Proposed development along the Wandle Trail and within the Wandle Valley Regional Park should seek to enhance accessibility for pedestrians and cyclists through providing safe, welcoming and inclusive environments that will encourage active transport.
- 15.6.13. There are also future opportunities for the Wandle Valley Regional Park to incorporate a large area of open space stretching from Mitcham Common and Three Kings Piece to Beddington, in the neighbouring borough of Sutton. We will continue to work with the relevant bodies to support the expansion of this green space and enable access to and from the borough.

Development within 400m of the Wandle Valley Regional Park

- 15.6.14. The Wandle Valley Regional Park is a significant blue and green corridor that offers a range of visual, physical and health benefits to residents and visitors.
- 15.6.15. All applications for development within 400m of the Wandle Valley Regional Park, as identified on the Policies Map, will be required to show how the visual, physical and landscape links to the park have been considered for the design of the development. This should include details in the Design and Access Statement showing how the relationship between the proposed development and the Wandle Valley Regional Park has been considered in the design of the built form and access to the site. This is to ensure access to the Wandle Valley Regional Park is protected and enhanced, promoting sustainable travel options and healthier lifestyles.
- 15.6.16. Our aspiration is for new development to complement the existing Green Corridors. As outlined in our transport policies, development proposals should enhance or enable new walking and cycling connections and networks to the Wandle Valley Regional Park, including the Wandle Trail. Physical barriers such as railings and built form that disrupts continuity and access into and around the park should be removed through the design of new development.
- 15.6.17. Proposals that restrict or block off existing access to the Wandle Valley Regional Park will not be supported unless it can be demonstrated that alternative and better quality access will be provided.

Recreation and cultural functions

- 15.6.18. The areas that make up the Wandle Valley Regional Park are key cultural and recreational attractions for the borough, as well as being vital green and blue assets delivering a wide range of benefits. The vibrant mix of leisure and recreation opportunities, such as Morden Hall Park, Deen City Farm and Watermeads Nature Reserve attracts both local residents and visitors. These attractions are significant for the borough as they help to promote tourism and celebrate the cultural features of the area.
- 15.6.19. Tourism and recreation activities throughout the Wandle Valley Regional Park are encouraged, particularly where activities can promote active and healthy lifestyles.
- 15.6.20. Proposals should make use of, and improve access to, existing cycling and pedestrian routes in the Wandle Valley Regional Park and encourage sustainable commuting patterns for tourism and recreation activities.

Other

- 15.6.21. There are a number of overhead network power cables within the area surrounding the Wandle Valley Regional Park which include 20 pylons on the Beddington to Wimbledon

overhead. We will support the relocation of existing power lines, pylons and other visually intrusive servicing as part of planning agreements in relation to new developments where it is technically, practically, environmentally and economically viable. This will be dependent on agreements being made between landowners and the relevant infrastructure providers. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 (Infrastructure).

Strategic Policy F15.7 Flood Risk Management and Sustainable Drainage

1. As a Lead Local Flood Authority, we will work in partnership with the Environment Agency, water companies, developers, neighbouring boroughs and local communities to manage and reduce flood risk from all sources. We will:
 - a. Steer development towards areas at lowest risk of flooding from all sources through the application of the sequential test as set out in the NPPF and supporting national Planning Practice Guidance. Assess the cumulative impact of development and land use change and make strategic planning decisions using the most up-to-date flood risk data and information from Merton Council, the Environment Agency, other Risk Management Authorities (RMAs) and the National Flood and Coastal Erosion Risk Management Strategy for England (2020).
 - b. Implement the recommendations and objectives of Merton's flood risk management plans, such as the [Strategic Flood Risk Assessment \(SFRA\)](#), Local Flood Risk Management Strategy and other RMAs, flood risk management plans.
 - c. Require all developments to incorporate flood resilience measures and be adaptable to the future impacts of climate change.
 - d. Ensure all Major Development includes water efficiency measures such as rainwater harvesting or grey water recycling to minimise water consumption, and SUDS (Sustainable Drainage Systems) to deliver multi-functional benefits such as managing surface water runoff, improving biodiversity, providing amenity and water quality benefits.
 - e. Work collaboratively with water companies to help them develop and implement their Drainage and Wastewater Management Plans (DWMPs) to enable them to deliver water and wastewater infrastructure improvements across the borough.
 - f. Reduce the risk of flooding (from all sources) in an integrated way through coordination with the following local plan policies; Open Space and Green Infrastructure; Urban Greening; Managing Local Flooding; Sustainable Drainage Systems; Placemaking and Design.

Supporting text

- 15.7.1. Management of flood risk within Merton will be undertaken in line with the NPPF, Flood and Water Management Act 2010, Flood Risk Regulations 2009 and the European Water Framework Directive 2000 transposed into law through the Water Environment (Water Framework Directive) (England and Wales) Regulations 2003.
- 15.7.2. Merton Council has statutory duties and responsibilities, set out under the Flood and Water Management Act 2010. As Lead Local Flood Authority, Merton Council is responsible for managing local flood risk, including flooding from surface runoff, ordinary watercourses and

groundwater. The Environment Agency is responsible for main rivers (including the River Wandle, The River Graveney and the Beverley and Pyl Brooks in Merton). Thames Water are responsible for wastewater sewerage, including flooding arising from public sewers. Sutton and East Surrey Water and Thames Water are responsible for clean water supply in the borough. The sources and mechanisms of flooding are often interlinked, and Merton Council will continue to work in partnership with all RMAs and local interested groups, such as the South East Rivers Trust and neighbourhood groups to manage the risk of flooding.

- 15.7.3. Merton Council has updated the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) in partnership with Wandsworth Council and the Environment Agency. The SFRA takes consideration of the updated national climate change allowances. The Level 1 SFRA provides an overview of flood risk issues in Merton from all sources. The Level 2 SFRA assesses the risk to specific site allocations where development is proposed in areas at risk from flooding. The Level 2 SFRA provides sufficient information to allow the application of part b) of the NPPF Exception Test.
- 15.7.4. Information and guidance on how to carry out a Sequential Test and Exception Test and what must be addressed within a development's Flood Risk Assessment can be found in [Merton's online SFRA GIS map](#). Further guidance can also be found in the Environment Agency's current advice on Flood Risk Assessment, NPPF and the National Planning Practice Guidance, all of which are available online. Pre-application discussions with the Environment Agency and/or Merton Council are strongly recommended to confirm both the requirements for flood risk management, any mitigation which may be required and to ensure sustainable drainage is incorporated appropriately and in accordance with Policy F15.9 Sustainable Drainage Systems.
- 15.7.5. Merton's Local Flood Risk Management Strategy identifies Merton's objectives and measures for how we will manage local flood risk, (defined as flooding from surface water, groundwater and ordinary watercourses) and it includes specific requirements about management of flood risk to and from development. Developers should ensure that development proposals meet the objectives and requirements identified in the Local Flood Risk Management Strategy.
- 15.7.6. Flood events are expected to become more frequent and more significant in the future, as the UK's climate changes and this requirement will go some way to adapting to this change. The installation of sustainable drainage measures, such as green roofs, raingardens and swales can deliver multi-functional benefits: increasing biodiversity and urban cooling; enhance open space in built-up areas and improvements to water quality. [Merton's SUDS SPD](#) provides further guidance on designing and implementing SUDS in developments and addresses how Merton, as the LLFA, will review and evaluate third party drainage proposals on developments.

- 15.7.7. SUDS will be implemented in all developments. The requirement to utilise SUDS, including those in low-risk areas, is because surface water from one area of a catchment may contribute towards enhanced flood risk in another area of that catchment.

Policy F15.8 Managing Local Flooding

1. Developments must incorporate the latest climate change allowances as part of the Flood Risk Assessment (FRA) and/or Surface Water Drainage Strategy.
2. Where development is proposed in the Environment Agency's Groundwater Source Protection Zones 1 or 2, measures must be taken to ensure the protection of groundwater supplies.
3. Developments must demonstrate that the local water supply and public sewerage networks have adequate capacity both on and off-site to serve the development. Where there is limited or no capacity identified through predicted flood risk or capacity modelling, on-site improvements must be programmed/planned.
4. We will expect to see a sequential approach applied to the site layout, locating the most vulnerable elements of a proposed development within areas at lowest risk of flooding. All buildings should be set back from the top of the banks by at least 8m for main rivers and 5m for ordinary watercourses. This is to allow for future improvements and maintenance of land drainage and flood defences, improve the ecological functioning of river corridors and enhance amenity.
5. In Flood Zones 2 and 3 or on sites shown to be at high risk of surface water flooding and proposals for sites of:
 - a. 10 dwellings or more or,
 - b. 1000sqm of non-residential development or more or
 - c. on any other proposal where safe access/egress cannot be achieved,
 in accordance with the SFRA, a Flood Emergency Plan must be submitted.
6. We will permit appropriate development in Flood Zones 1, 2, 3a and 3b subject to meeting the criteria in the following table:

Flood zones: Land uses and developments restrictions	Sequential Test	Exception Test	FRA and Drainage Strategy
Flood Zone 3b: Functional floodplain The functional floodplain will be protected by not permitting any form of development on undeveloped sites unless it is: • Water Compatible development. • Essential utility infrastructure. In these cases, essential infrastructure that has passed the Exception Test and water compatible uses should be designed and constructed to remain operational and safe for users in times of flood; result in no net loss of	Required for essential infrastructure.	Required for essential infrastructure.	An FRA be needed for all developments. A Drainage Strategy be needed for all new dwellings and Major Developments.

Flood zones: Land uses and developments restrictions	Sequential Test	Exception Test	FRA and Drainage Strategy
floodplain storage; not impede water flows and not increase flood risk elsewhere. Redevelopment of existing developed sites will only be supported if there is no intensification of the land use, no increase in building footprint, number of units or bedrooms and a net flood risk reduction is proposed. Restoration of the functional floodplain will be supported. Proposals for the change of use or conversion to a use with a higher vulnerability classification will not be allowed.			
Flood Zone 3a: High Risk Essential Infrastructure and More Vulnerable development may be permitted where the Exception Test is satisfied. Water Compatible and Less Vulnerable land uses are permitted. Highly Vulnerable developments will not be allowed. Self-contained residential basements and bedrooms at basement level will not be allowed.	Required for all developments unless exceptions outlined in the justification applies.	Required for Essential Infrastructure and More Vulnerable development.	A Drainage Strategy will be needed for all new dwellings and Major Developments. An FRA is required for all development proposals.
Flood Zone 2: No land use restrictions Self-contained residential units at basement level and bedrooms at basement level will not be allowed by the council without right mitigation measures in line with Environment Agency Guidance and Merton Local Plan policy.	Required for all developments unless exceptions outlined in the justification applies.	Required for Highly Vulnerable development.	A Drainage Strategy will be needed for all new dwellings and Major Developments. An FRA be needed for all development proposals.
Flood Zone 1 No land use restrictions.	N/A	N/A	A Drainage Strategy will be needed for all new dwellings and Major Developments. In line with Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) and

Flood zones: Land uses and developments restrictions	Sequential Test	Exception Test	FRA and Drainage Strategy
			the Planning Practice Guidance, an FRA is needed for development sites which are: • more than 1 hectare (ha) • less than 1 ha, including a change of use in development type to a more vulnerable class (for example from commercial to residential), where it could be affected by sources of flooding other than rivers (for example surface water, groundwater and sewer flooding) as identified in the Merton Council SFRA • in an area which has critical drainage problems

7. Where a Flood Risk Assessment (FRA) is required, it must:

- a. Conform with national policy and guidance, as well as the BSI (British Standards Institution) Code of Practice on Assessing and managing flood risk in development (BS 8533:2017). Merton Council and/or Environment Agency may need additional research or information, depending on the type of development and location, to be included in the FRA.
- b. Be submitted with the planning application.
- c. Provide evidence of the application of the Sequential Test and where required, the Exception Test.
- d. Take account of the advice and recommendations within the Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment, Local Flood Risk Management Strategy and Surface Water Management Plan.

8. Planning conditions or planning obligations may be used, where appropriate, to secure flood risk mitigation and sustainable drainage measures, to mitigate flooding from different flood sources within development proposals.

Basements and subterranean developments

9. Basements within flood-affected areas of the borough represent a particularly high risk to life, as they may be subject to very rapid inundation. Applicants will have to demonstrate that their proposal meets the following requirements:

Flood Zone	Details
Flood Zone 3b Functional Floodplain	Basements, basement extensions, conversions of basements to a higher vulnerability classification or self-contained units will not be allowed.
Flood Zone 3	New basements: • Less Vulnerable / Water Compatible uses are permitted. • More Vulnerable uses will only be considered if; an FRA shows that the risk to life can be managed. Bedrooms at basement levels will not be allowed. • Highly Vulnerable uses such as self-contained basements/bedrooms use will not be allowed. Existing basements: • No basement extensions, conversions, or additions for Highly Vulnerable uses. • More Vulnerable uses: - will only be considered if an FRA demonstrates that the risk to life can be managed.
Flood Zone 2	New Basements: if the Exception Test (where applicable) is passed, basements may be allowed for residential use where they are not self-contained or used for bedrooms. Existing Basements: basement extensions, conversions or additions may be allowed for existing developments where they are not self-contained or used for bedrooms. If a basement, basement extension or conversion is acceptable in principle in terms of its location, it must have internal access to a higher floor and flood resistant and resilient design techniques must be adopted.
Flood Zone 1	No restrictions on new basements or extensions to existing basements, providing they are accompanied with the necessary assessments.

Supporting text

- 15.8.1. The protection of people, properties, and infrastructure from the risk of flooding from all sources is of immense importance. The flood risk and sustainable drainage systems policies is supported by Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA). Local Flood Risk Management Strategy (LFRMS) and Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP).
- 15.8.2. Merton is affected by several sources of flood risk, primarily surface water flooding which has been the cause of recent flood events in the borough in the summer storms of 2016, 2017 and most significantly in 2007. The borough is also affected by flooding from rivers, ordinary watercourses, sewers, reservoirs and groundwater flooding. The Level 1 SFRA gives an overview of flooding from all sources across the borough.

- 15.8.3. The Environment Agency's Risk of Flooding from Surface Water mapping, alongside Merton's SFRA, LFRMS and SWMP and historical flooding records of the borough, show that several areas including Colliers Wood, West Barnes and Raynes Park and Summerstown are affected by multiple flood risk sources.
- 15.8.4. We hold practical information on our website where users can find out if they are at risk of flooding, get help during a flood, report flooding and find out more about how we are managing local flood risk.
- 15.8.5. To create job opportunities, deliver homes and essential infrastructure, meet the demands of predicted population growth, enable future economic growth and secure improvements in areas such as Colliers Wood and the Wandle Valley, it will be necessary to develop on sites within areas at medium to high risk of flooding, subject to meeting the requirements of the Sequential and Exception Tests as set out in the NPPF.

Flood Risk Assessments (FRAs)

- 15.8.6. Flood Risk Assessments (FRAs) will be needed in line with national policy and guidance, as well as the BSI (British Standards Institution) Code of Practice on Assessing and managing flood risk in development (BS 8533:2017). This code provides detailed information on the requirements for assessing and managing flood risk in development and how to produce site-specific FRAs.
- 15.8.7. Developers should agree the scope of the FRA in consultation with the council in their role as the LPA and LLFA from the earliest stages of project planning and design to ensure that appropriate flood risk management measures are included as part of the design and layout. Developers must refer to the EA's guidelines on 'Flood Risk Assessment for Planning applications' or the EA's 'Standing Advice on Flood Risk Assessment' in cases where an FRA is not needed, including for householder applications and minor non-residential extensions. We will consult the EA on all proposals accompanied by an FRA or for any proposal within 20m of a main river or culverting operation.
- 15.8.8. FRAs must assess the risk of flooding in the future because of the impact of climate change on river flows and rainfall patterns, taking account of the latest climate change allowances. This will help minimise vulnerability and provide resilience to flooding in the future. FRAs must set out the proposed measures to manage flood risk over the lifetime of the development. This includes measures to steer development away from areas considered to be at high risk of flooding from all sources, applying appropriate site and building design (Policy 12.1), incorporating Sustainable Drainage Systems (Policy F15.9), maintaining and enhancing the borough's green and blue infrastructure (Policy O15.2) and contributing to urban greening (Policy O15.5).

- 15.8.9. FRAs must address the management of surface runoff, the extent of impermeable surfaces resulting from the development, and the potential for increased flood risk, both on-site and elsewhere within the catchment.
- 15.8.10. In addition to fluvial flooding, properties and infrastructure within the Merton are also at high risk of flooding from other, more localised sources, such as surface / groundwater / sewer flooding due to surcharging of sewers and drains or due to the failure of infrastructure. Flooding can also occur away from the fluvial floodplain because of development, where on-site/off-site infrastructure is not in place ahead of development. Therefore, a FRA is also needed for smaller development proposals in Flood Zone 1, where there is evidence of a risk from other sources of flooding identified in the SFRA.

Sequential Test and Exception Test

- 15.8.11. Future development in Flood Zones 3a and 2 will only be considered if the 'Sequential Test' has been applied following national policy and guidance. However, there will be some exceptions to this. The Sequential Test will not be needed if it is not a Major Development and at least one of the following applies:
- a. It is a site allocation that has already been sequentially tested, unless the use of the site proposed is not per the allocations in the Local Plan.
 - b. It is within a Town Centre boundary as identified within this Local Plan.
 - c. Redevelopment of an existing single residential property.
 - d. Conversions and change of use.
- 15.8.12. The Sequential Test will be needed in all other cases.
- 15.8.13. If, following the application of the sequential test, it is not possible or consistent with wider sustainability objectives (environmental, social and economic) for development to be in a flood zone with a lower probability of flooding, the Exception Test may have to be applied. The need for the Exception Test will depend on the potential vulnerability of the site and of the development proposed, in line with the Flood Risk Vulnerability Classification set out in national planning guidance.

Basement and Subterranean Planning Guidance Supplementary Planning Guidance (SPD)

- 15.8.14. Basement and subterranean applications must ensure they are safe from flooding and do not increase risk to and from the site. We will only allow basements and other underground/subterranean development where:
- a. As set out in other policies, it can be proven that it will not cause harm to the built and natural environment and amenity, including the local water environment, ground conditions and biodiversity.
 - b. The basement does not result in an increased risk of flooding to other locations and is itself protected from flood risk from all sources, including sewer flooding. The council will

require installation of positively pumped devices to protect the basement from the risk of sewer flooding and to show the location of the pump device on the planning application drawings

- 15.8.15. As required by policy D12.11, basement developments require the submission of more information in the form of a Basement Impact Assessment (BIA) including site specific ground investigation, Drainage Strategy, an outline Construction Method Statement (CMS) and a Construction Traffic Management Plan to provide us with a basis for deciding planning applications. [Merton's Basement and Subterranean Planning Guidance SPD](#) provides guidance and sets out what needs to be demonstrated as part of an assessment.

Policy F15.9 Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS)

1. All Major Development must include water efficiency measures to minimise water consumption such as rainwater harvesting or grey water recycling. In addition, all Major Development must include Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS) to reduce surface water runoff to greenfield rates and provide multifunctional benefits unless there is clear evidence that this would be inappropriate.
2. Details should be supplied which address the maintenance requirements of the drainage systems for the lifetime of the development which they serve.
3. We will require all developments to reduce the risk of flooding by:
 - a. Seeking mitigating measures against the impact of flooding from all sources and ensure all new development, including all basement and subterranean development, implements appropriate SUDS.
 - b. Ensuring developers demonstrate that the maintenance and management of the site's drainage scheme will take place for the lifetime of the development. This must be addressed through a SUDS Maintenance and Management Plan submitted as part of the planning process.
 - c. Requiring developers to incorporate soft landscaping, appropriate planting (including trees) and permeable surfaces into all new developments including non-residential developments, in line with Policy O15.5 Urban Greening.
 - d. Requiring the retention of soft landscaping and green spaces in existing gardens where possible.
 - e. Ensuring any development or re-development that effects a Heritage Asset or its setting (including conservation areas) must consider Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS) and demonstrate within a Heritage Statement the approach taken to ensure that there is no adverse impact on the character and appearance of the asset and that there is no long-term deterioration to the building's fabric.
 - f. Reducing surface water discharge to greenfield runoff rates.
 - g. Using conditions or planning obligations to secure flood risk mitigation and sustainable drainage measures.

Supporting text

Surface water and sewer flooding

- 15.9.1. The borough is very susceptible to surface water flooding. Surface water flooding happens when the ground and rivers cannot absorb heavy rainfall and when manufactured drainage systems have insufficient capacity to deal with the volume of rainfall. Typically, this type of flooding is localised and happens very quickly, making it exceedingly difficult to predict and give warnings. With climate change predicting more frequent short-duration, high intensity, rainfall and more, frequent periods of long-duration rainfall, coupled with an ageing Victorian sewer system and increasing pressure from growing populations, surface water flooding is likely to be an increasing problem.
- 15.9.2. Thames Water has modelled the impact of London's projected population growth and climate change on its drains and sewers to understand their ability to cope with these future challenges. The modelling shows that for a relatively common rainfall event in 2050 (one that would be expected on average once every other year), some areas of London, would not have sufficient drainage or sewerage capacity to manage the expected flows, leading to an increasing risk of surface water and sewer flooding.
- 15.9.3. We will seek to direct development away from areas at the highest risk of flooding, or, where development is required in areas at risk of flooding, we will ensure it is safe for the lifetime of the development, without increasing flood risk elsewhere. Development proposals should ensure that they have taken full account of flood risk and sought to utilise sustainable drainage measures.
- 15.9.4. To reduce the risk of surface water and sewer flooding, all development proposals in the borough that could lead to changes to, and have impacts on, surface water runoff must follow the London Plan drainage hierarchy:
 - a. Store rainwater for later use
 - b. Use infiltration techniques, such as porous surfaces in non-clay areas
 - c. Attenuate rainwater in ponds or open water features for gradual release to a watercourse
 - d. Attenuate rainwater by storing in tanks or sealed water features for gradual release to a watercourse discharge rainwater direct to a watercourse
 - e. Discharge rainwater to a surface water drain
 - f. Discharge rainwater to a combined sewer
- 15.9.5. As well as managing flood risk, consideration should be made for how rainwater-harvesting systems can be used to minimise the use of mains water, as promoted by Policy CC2.6 Sustainable Design Standards. This policy provides details on the Council's water efficiency standards.

Sustainable Drainage System (SUDS)

- 15.9.6. SUDS is a drainage and landscaping scheme which utilises a 'management train' of various drainage techniques used in series to mimic as closely as possible the natural site's processes, thereby mitigating and managing the impact of a development on flood risk, water quality and biodiversity and amenity value.
- 15.9.7. It is important to ensure that new development sites found within the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment identified area of 'increased risk of surface water ponding' implement surface water attenuation. It is imperative that this policy be read in conjunction with other Local Plan flood management policies and [Merton's Sustainable Drainage Design and Evaluation Guide Supplementary Planning Document \(SPD\)](#) (known as the SUDS SPD).
- 15.9.8. Merton's SUDS SPD supplies further guidance and support to the Local Plan policies relating to flood risk (from all sources) and SUDS. The SPD sets out our expectations on designing, maintaining and managing SUDS and is a material consideration as part of planning decisions.

Green roofs and walls

- 15.9.9. The design and operational needs of a green roof or wall should not place undue stress on water supply and other natural resources. Extensive green roofs, which are suitable for flat and pitched roofs and for retrofitting, with minimal maintenance and no requirement for irrigation once established, are particularly encouraged. All green and brown roof systems should use a high percentage of recycled products.
- 15.9.10. The provision of green roofs does not negate the need to make adequate open space provision on the ground. Any proposals for accessible green roofs need to be designed for security and safety and not adversely affect neighbouring properties.
- 15.9.11. The use of green roofs and green walls in smaller developments, renovations, conversions, extensions and retrofitting is encouraged and supported, where opportunities arise. Conditions will be used, where appropriate, to secure the proper installation, maintenance and responsibility for green roofs and walls.

Policy P15.10 Air Quality, Pollution and Land Stability

1. Merton Council will ensure that local environmental impacts of all development proposals do not lead to detrimental effects on the health, safety and the amenity of existing and new users or occupiers of the development site, or the surrounding land. These potential impacts can include, but are not limited to, air pollution, water pollution, noise and vibration, light pollution, odours and fumes, solar glare and solar dazzle as well as land contamination.
2. Several policies in the Local Plan contribute to reducing and/or mitigating the impacts of air pollution such as transport, green infrastructure, design and climate change policies. Developers must have regard to any guidance provided by Merton Council on local environmental impacts and pollution as well as on noise generating and noise sensitive development. Where necessary, we will set planning conditions to reduce and mitigate pollutant impacts. Appropriate site investigations and reports on pollution, contamination, and land stability, prepared by a competent and accredited professional, must be made available and submitted to the Local Planning Authority to inform the assessments set out in this policy.
3. The design and layout of new development must endeavour to minimise conflict between different land uses, taking account of users and occupiers of new and existing developments. Any noise and polluting activities or features such as plant equipment should be located away from areas of high pollution and sensitive land uses (such as schools, nurseries, play spaces, hospitals and residential dwellings) where possible to ensure that there are no detrimental impacts on living conditions, health and wellbeing or amenity.
4. Where there are, already significant adverse effects on the environment or amenity due to pollution, sensitive uses should be steered away from such areas. However, given the limited availability of land for development in the borough, this will not always be possible. Therefore, new developments, including changes of use, should mitigate and reduce any adverse impacts resulting from air and light pollution, noise, vibration and dust to acceptable levels.

Air Quality

5. Major developments in Merton and development briefs for large-scale development subject to an Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) must achieve Air Quality Positive Approach status.
6. All developments must be at least Air Quality Neutral and resist development proposals, which would materially increase exceedances of local air pollutants and have an unacceptable impact on amenity or health, unless the development mitigates this impact through physical measures and/or financial contributions to implement proposals in Merton's Local Air Quality Management Plan.
7. Residential development proposals and change of use to residential at street level, will need to submit an Air Quality Impact Assessment in areas of poor air quality.
8. Development proposals must consider the impact of air quality. An Air Quality Impact Assessment will be required for proposals in areas already subject to poor air, Major

Developments, developments involving biomass boilers, biomass or gas CHP (including connections to existing networks where the increased capacity is not already covered in an existing AQA), substantial earthworks or demolition and any development that could have a significant impact on air quality, either directly or indirectly. The following will be needed:

- a. An Air Quality Impact Assessment, including where necessary, modelled data.
 - b. Mitigation measures to reduce the development's impact upon air quality including the type of equipment installed, thermal insulation and ducting abatement technology.
 - c. Measures installed in the new development to protect the occupiers of new developments from existing sources of pollution.
 - d. Mitigation for developments to be used by sensitive receptors such as schools, hospitals, care homes, areas of deprivation and in areas of existing poor air quality; this also applies to proposals close to developments used by sensitive receptors.
 - e. The use of green infrastructure, including trees and hedgerows to reduce the exposure to air pollution to absorb dust and other pollutants.
9. Development proposals will be expected to demonstrate how they will minimise air pollution associated with the transport requirements including delivery, servicing and construction vehicles.
 10. All decentralised energy schemes will be expected to demonstrate that they can be used without having an unacceptable impact on air quality. Where this is not possible, CHP systems will not be prioritised over other air quality neutral technologies.
 11. We will seek financial contributions using Planning Obligations towards air quality measures where a proposed development is not air quality neutral, or mitigation measures do not reduce the impact upon poor air quality. In determining the contribution, the council will have regard to the London Plan Air Quality Neutral guidance (section 5).

Noise and vibration

12. Development proposals will be expected to:
 - a. Provide a noise assessment of any new plant and equipment and its impact upon both receptors and the general background noise levels.
 - b. Provide mitigation measures where noise needs to be controlled and managed
 - c. Agree to time limits and restrictions for activities where noise cannot be sufficiently mitigated.
 - d. Use good acoustic design within their development.
 - e. Where applicable, provide suitable mitigation measures by means of a planning obligation or condition.
 - f. Minimise noise from servicing and deliveries.
 - g. Protect the relative tranquillity in and around open spaces.
13. New development, which would have a significant effect on existing or future occupiers or the amenity due to noise or vibration, will not be allowed unless the potential noise problems can be overcome by suitable mitigation measures.

14. Where a noise-sensitive development is seeking planning permission to locate in an already noisy area (e.g. a town centre or near a busy road), the new noise-sensitive development will be responsible for mitigating impacts from existing noise-generating activities in line with the Agent of Change principle set in the National Planning Policy Framework and the London Plan Policy D13.
15. We will support good acoustic design and use of innovative technologies to minimise noise levels.
16. Where necessary, applicants will be expected to carry out noise assessments and provide details of the noise levels on the site. Where noise mitigation measures will be required to enable development to take place, an outline application will not normally be acceptable.

Light pollution

17. The potential adverse impacts from lighting arrangements will be controlled by requiring all developments that include proposals for external lighting, including illuminated signs and advertisements, security and floodlights and other illuminations, to submit details in line with the recommendation of the Institution of Lighting Professionals. Lighting details must show that it:
 - a. Is appropriate for the intended use,
 - b. Provides the minimum amount of light necessary to achieve its purpose and designed to minimise the detrimental impact of glare and light spill on the local amenity, nature, biodiversity and highways,
 - c. Is energy efficient and
 - d. Provides adequate protection from glare and light spill, particularly to nearby sensitive receptors such as residential properties and Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest, including the River Wandle.
18. Development proposals for leisure, sport and/or play facilities must have regard to Sport England's Artificial Lighting Guidance and London Plan Policy S5 Sports and recreation facilities.

Odours and fume control

19. Merton Council will ensure that any potential impacts relating to odour and fumes from commercial activities are mitigated by requiring the following:
 - a. An impact assessment where necessary
 - b. The type and nature of filtration to be used
 - c. The height and position of any chimney or outlet
 - d. Promotion and use of new abatement technologies

Ground conditions, Land contamination and instability

20. Where development is proposed on or near a site known to be, or there is good reason to believe may be, contaminated or have unstable ground, or where a sensitive use is proposed, the applicant must carry out a site assessment and submit a report of the findings to establish the nature and extent of the contamination and/or land instability. Development will not be permitted

unless practicable and effective measures are taken to treat, contain or control any contamination or land stability issues.

21. Developments must incorporate proper remediation measures for development on or near a site, which is potentially contaminated or has land instability issues.
22. Development will not be allowed unless practical and effective measures are taken to treat, contain or control any contamination or land instability issues so as not to:
 - a. Expose the occupiers of the development and neighbouring land uses including, in the case of housing, the users of open spaces and gardens, to unacceptable risk.
 - b. Threaten the structural integrity of the building being built, the site or adjoining the site.
 - c. Lead to the contamination of any watercourse, water body or aquifer.
 - d. Cause the contamination of adjoining land or allow such contamination to continue.
 - e. Cause or increase land instability issues on adjoining land or buildings.
23. We will not approve any application that the Health and Safety Executive (HSE) has recommended that permission should not be granted.

Managing pollution from construction and demolition

24. Merton Council will seek to manage and limit environmental disturbances during construction and demolition as well as during excavations and construction of basements and subterranean developments. To deliver this, we require the submission of Construction Management Statements (CMS) for the following types of developments:
 - a. All Major Developments.
 - b. Any basement and subterranean developments.
 - c. Development of sites in confined locations or near sensitive receptors; or
 - d. If substantial demolition/excavation works are proposed.
25. Where applicable and considered necessary, we may seek a bespoke charge, specific to the proposal, to cover the cost of monitoring the CMS.
26. For Major Development, applicants must show how they had regard to Merton's Air Quality Action Plan, Merton's Air Quality Supplementary Planning Document, the Non-Road Mobile Machinery (NRMM) Practical Guide, Dust Controls and Logistics Planning, from the earliest stage in the design of their development and its construction method.
27. Construction and demolition sites must ensure silt does not enter the local drainage systems or watercourses and is carefully controlled and managed on site to prevent pollution and environmental damage.
28. It is essential that construction and demolition operations have regard to the [Right Waste Right Place guidance](#) and [Waste Management Duty of care of practice](#) to ensure construction and demolition waste is managed correctly, to prevent pollution and misdescription of waste.

- 29.** Pollution incidents must be reported to the [Environment Agency 24-hour incident hotline](#)
- 30.** Vacant development sites must introduce increased security measures such as high security fencing/concrete bollards and 24-hour security to prevent trespassing and illegal waste operators moving onto vacant development sites, to deposit large amount of fly tipping and then abandon the sites.
- 31.** Operations that are likely to give rise to noise, dust, vibration, odour or other pollutants are also controlled by the licensing regulations implemented by Merton's Environmental Health Team, Pollution Teams and the Environment Agency. We advise that applicants discuss proposals with potential adverse impacts on air, land, light pollution, noise and water at the initial stages of the planning application process with Merton's Environmental Health Team.

Supporting text

Air quality

- 15.10.1. The council will apply London Plan policy SI1 Improving air quality to all development proposals in the borough, along with associated Mayoral guidance on Air Quality Neutral and Air Quality Positive standards and on ways to reduce construction and demolition impacts.
- 15.10.2. NPPF states that opportunities to improve air quality or mitigate impacts should be identified, such as through traffic and travel management, and green infrastructure provision and enhancement Air Quality Impact Assessments (AQA). All Local Plan policies will play a role in reducing and mitigating against the exposure to poor air quality that causes harm to health, including other green infrastructure and health and wellbeing policies. [Merton's Air Quality Action Plan](#), [Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan](#), [Merton's Health and Wellbeing Strategy](#) and [Merton's Air Quality Supplementary Planning Document \(SPD\)](#) support the local plan and outline steps we are taking to improve air quality in the borough.
- 15.10.3. Air pollution is not only detrimental to health and wellbeing but also has impacts on the environment and economy. The World Health Organization (WHO) identifies air pollution as the greatest environmental risk to human health, with 90% of the world's urban population living in cities exceeding its air quality guidelines. In the UK each year, it contributes up to 37,000 deaths and costs city regions over £20bn. In the UK 5.4 million people are living with asthma, around 1 million have 'difficult' asthma which includes an estimated 200,000 adults and children in the UK with 'severe' asthma, a condition that needs specialist assessment and bespoke support and treatments according to Asthma UK. There is emerging evidence which shows that air pollution increases the number and severity of COVID-19 cases.
- 15.10.4. The whole of Merton is designated an Air Quality Management Area (AQMA) and has three Air Quality Focus Zones in the borough. The main sources of particulate matter are road

transport (50.4%), re-suspended dust from roads and surfaces (19.9%) and static non-road mobile machinery (10.3%). In respect of the transport sources, apportionment data for the borough shows that diesel vehicles contribute approximately 90% of the NO_x emissions and 80% of the PM₁₀ emissions (based on 2013 modelled data).

- 15.10.5. Merton's air quality priorities are to continue to encourage sustainable travel and sustainable construction; to reduce exposure to air quality and raise awareness; and to work in partnership with residents, community and business groups, Transport for London and other organisations to concentrate on local pollution problems in Merton.
- 15.10.6. The Environment Act delivers key aspects of our Clean Air Strategy with the aim of maximising health benefits for all and sits alongside wider government action on air quality. It will deliver cleaner air for all by requiring the government to set targets on air quality, including for fine particulate matter, the most damaging pollutant to human health.
- 15.10.7. Councils and other relevant public bodies will be required to work together more closely to tackle local air quality issues, and it will be easier for local authorities to enforce restrictions on smoke emissions from domestic burning, which pollutes our towns and cities. In addition, the Act gives the government the power to make vehicle manufacturers recall vehicles if they do not comply with relevant environmental standards, ensuring illegally polluting vehicles are taken off the road quickly.
- 15.10.8. The Act includes a new legally binding target on species abundance for 2030, which will help to reverse declines of iconic British species like the hedgehog, red squirrel and water vole.
- 15.10.9. The Environment Act will deliver:
 - Long-term targets to improve air quality, biodiversity, water, and waste reduction and resource efficiency.
 - A target on ambient PM_{2.5} concentrations, the most harmful pollutant to human health.
 - A target to halt the decline of nature by 2030.
 - Environmental Improvement Plans, including interim targets.
 - A cycle of environmental monitoring and reporting.
 - Environmental Principles embedded in domestic policy making.
 - Office for Environmental Protection to uphold environmental law.

Air Quality Assessments (AQA)

- 15.10.10. The aim of an AQA is to find any significant impact on local air quality and/or disamenity due to dust and/or odour and/ or whether new development will introduce new exposure in an area of poor air quality. The contents of the AQA will depend on the nature of the proposed development.

- 15.10.11. We require air quality issues to be considered early in the planning process and to be assessed in detail if necessary (e.g for developments that may increase local emissions significantly). It is the best way of establishing a design led approach to mitigating emissions and reducing exposure. Further assessments must be carried out as the design evolves, to ensure that impacts from emissions are prevented or minimised as far as possible, and to fully quantify the expected effect of any proposed mitigation measures, including the cumulative effect, where other nearby developments are also underway or likely to come forward.
- 15.10.12. Air Quality Assessments must include 'air quality neutral' assessments, carried out with reference to the GLA's emission benchmarks for buildings, transport and combustion-based energy plants.
- 15.10.13. New developments are expected to contribute towards improving local air quality, particularly where they include potentially major new sources of emissions or could significantly increase traffic-generated emissions. Some developments such as schools, nurseries, hospitals and care homes for the elderly and housing, may be particularly affected by the potential impacts of poor air quality on the occupants of the development.
- 15.10.14. Consideration must be given to the impact of improvements on air quality elsewhere. For instance, traffic reductions could improve local air quality but push traffic-related air quality impacts to other areas. Early engagement with us is encouraged to assess how the development could avoid these unintended consequences. The supporting emerging Air Quality Supplementary Planning Document (SPD) provides further details on AQA and what we expect to be proved within an AQA. The assessment should provide decision makers with sufficient information to understand the scale and geographic scope of any detrimental, or beneficial impacts on air quality and enable them to exercise their professional judgement in deciding whether the impacts are acceptable, in line with best practice.
- 15.10.15. Development that may result in an adverse impact on air quality, including during construction, will require an Air Quality Impact Assessment, in order to consider any pollution impact linked to development proposals.
- 15.10.16. Necessary mitigation measures will be secured through negotiation on a scheme or using planning obligations or conditions where appropriate. Further guidance and more information on our air quality aims and priorities can be found in Merton's Air Quality Action Plan (AQAP) and [Merton's Air Quality Supplementary Planning Document SPD 2021](#).

Air Quality Neutral and Positive

- 15.10.17. We have adopted the London Plan's approach to Air Quality Positive and Neutral development. Large master planning and large-scale developments have the potential to include methods to improve local air quality. All other Major Developments should not make air quality worse and are encouraged to achieve an overall improvement to air quality. The

Air Quality Neutral requirement also applies to developments incorporating Solid Biomass Boilers and CHP (Combined Heat and Power) due to the potential impact of these technologies on air quality. When all measures to achieve Air Quality Neutral status have been exploited, financial contributions to offset the impact of the development on air quality may be considered as a final intervention. The process and calculation for this are set out in Section 5.2 of the GLA's Air Quality Neutral Planning Support Document (AQNPSPD).

Air quality and green infrastructure

- 15.10.18. Overall, vegetation and trees are regarded as beneficial for air quality, but they are not a solution to the air quality problems at a city scale; reducing vehicle journeys and adopting behavioural changes is key to improving our air quality.
- 15.10.19. The value of green infrastructure for urban air quality lies in its ability, not to remove pollution, but rather to control the distribution by strategically enhancing (or reducing) its dispersion close to its source, for example at the roadside. It acts as a barrier that reduces the public exposure to what could be emitted, and thereby further improves public health outcomes. However, we still need to create environments that incentivise behaviour changes in the way we travel and encourage walking, cycling and other sustainable modes. The design quality of our streets is crucial in producing attractive environments at a human scale, with reduced air and noise pollution and opportunities to connect with nature.

Air quality and combined Heat and Power (CHP)

- 15.10.20. Some carbon reduction measures for energy generation and spatial heating can adversely impact local air quality if not properly mitigated. The use of individual Combined Cooling, Heating and Power (CCHP), Combined Heat and Power (CHP) and Biomass to produce heat and power can deliver significant reductions of CO₂. However, the use of these technologies could also lead to increases in NO₂ and particle emissions. Therefore, their air quality impacts need to be assessed as part of an Air Quality Assessment. CHP or other combustion-based technologies that cannot demonstrate that they will have acceptable impacts, will not be accepted and instead the use of other sustainable energy generation air quality neutral technologies must be used, which reduce both CO₂ and NO₂ emissions.

Air quality, pollutants and transport

- 15.10.21. We will ensure that new development in Merton is adequately managed and integrated with the transport network, including public transport, pedestrian and cycle networks, to enable it to accommodate growth in a sustainable manner, so that it does not contribute further to air quality deterioration, increased noise and congestion. As set out in the Transport Policies, Transport Assessments/Statements will be required for development proposals to properly identify transport impacts and the mitigation measures to address them.

15.10.22. Freight, servicing and delivery vehicles, particularly heavy goods vehicles, are a significant source of noise and air pollution, particularly around commercial and industrial locations. Delivery and servicing trips have been increasing in London, a trend accelerated by the recent rapid market evolution in home delivery for a range of services as a result of the pandemic. However, low carbon alternatives such as electric vans and cargo bike deliveries have also started to appear. Where a development is likely to generate a significant amount of movement by goods or delivery vehicles, we will require the development of a Delivery and Servicing Plan in accordance with [TfL's latest guidance](#). A Delivery and Servicing Plan provides a strategy to improve the safety, efficiency and sustainability of delivery and servicing vehicles through a range of interventions including consolidation, low carbon delivery modes and the retiming of movements to avoid peak hours.

Noise and vibration

15.10.23. Noise and vibration pollution affect both health and behaviour. Characteristics that cause or increase noise pollution, such as poorly located emission sources, street canyons and noise sources, should also be designed out wherever possible. The main source of ambient noise in Merton is road traffic. However, other activities such as construction, or night-time activities may also impact on noise levels. Therefore, it is important that new development assists in reducing potential exposure. Development proposals need to consider acoustic design at an early stage of the planning process to ensure occupiers of new and noise sensitive buildings are protected.

15.10.24. For a long time, the responsibility for managing and mitigating the impact of noise on neighbouring residents and businesses has been placed on the business or activity making the noise, regardless of how long the noise-generating business or activity has been operating in the area. In many cases, this has led to newly arrived residents complaining about noise from existing businesses, sometimes forcing the businesses to close.

15.10.25. The Agent of Change principle, set out in the London Plan and the National Planning Policy Framework, places the responsibility for mitigating the impact of noise firmly on the new development. This means that where new developments are proposed close to existing noise-generating uses, applicants will need to design them in a more sensitive way to protect the new occupiers, such as new residents, businesses, schools and religious institutions, from noise impacts. This could include paying for soundproofing for the existing noise generating uses, such as an existing music venue.

15.10.26. The Agent of Change principle works both ways. If a new noise-generating use is proposed close to existing noise-sensitive uses, such as residential development or businesses, the onus is on the new use to ensure its building or activity is designed to protect existing users or residents from noise impacts.

- 15.10.27. Noise generating cultural venues such as theatres, concert halls, pubs and live music venues should be protected. This requires a sensitive approach to managing change in the surrounding area. Adjacent development and land uses should be brought forward and designed in ways which ensure established cultural venues are viable, contribute to the local economy and can continue in their present form without the prospect of licensing restrictions or the threat of closure due to noise complaints from neighbours.
- 15.10.28. Housing and other noise sensitive development proposed near to an existing noise generating use must include necessary acoustic design measures. This will ensure new development has effective sound insulation to mitigate and minimise potential noise impact or neighbour amenity issues. Mitigation measures must be explored at an early stage in the design process, with appropriate provisions secured through planning obligations.
- 15.10.29. Noise from construction during building of developments will be managed through use of planning conditions.
- 15.10.30. Merton Council will be producing a Noise and Vibration Supplementary Planning Document (SPD). It will provide further guidance on the implementation of Merton's Local Plan policy relating to noise and vibration, provide technical guidance for noise mitigation and measures, and sets out Merton's noise assessment requirements.

Light pollution

- 15.10.31. Light pollution can interfere with the timing of necessary biological activities of wildlife and can impact human health. We will support well-designed artificial lighting that maximises the positive aspects and minimises its impact on amenity and wildlife.
- 15.10.32. We will expect new buildings to be designed to minimise light pollution from internal and external lighting. We will use the relevant professional standards as a guide to assess light impacts such as the Institution of Lighting Professionals.
- 15.10.33. Lighting can be important for the accessibility of outdoor sports facilities and can help to improve their use. In new developments, to help provide a healthy and safe environment, it can also be used to enhance the appearance of some buildings. The form of lighting required will depend on the facility and its use, but efforts must be made to minimise the impact on the surrounding areas, and not to cause a demonstrable harm to the local community, biodiversity or local wildlife. Excessive lighting can have a negative impact on residents' quality of life, adversely affect wildlife, contribute to 'sky glow' and energy waste. Requiring the submission of details of external lighting in line with the recommendations of the Institution of Lighting Professionals for approval will allow external lighting and its impacts to be controlled and minimised.

Odours and Fume Control

- 15.10.34. Some commercial activities can have an impact upon the local environment. These impacts can include such things as odours, fumes, dust and steam. It is important that activities that create odour do not affect the surrounding amenity. Where appropriate, we will require odour assessments to make sure potential impacts are appropriately mitigated. Permitted development rights mean that some developments can accommodate a wide range of uses without the need for planning permission to change between them. Proposals for hot food premises will require mitigation measures to be incorporated to prevent unacceptable odour issues arising in the future.
- 15.10.35. As part of the development process, we require that steps be taken to ensure that any impact be considered carefully, and that mitigation is in place to manage these types of emissions. Applicants will need to apply the [Control of Odour and Noise from Commercial Kitchen Exhaust Systems](#) (prepared by NETCEN for the Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs).

Land Contamination

- 15.10.36. Industrial activity, waste disposal, accidental spillages and transportation can cause contamination of land. Often this contamination is associated with industrial processes or activities, which are now not active, such as former printworks and other activities that were part of the Wandle Valley's industrial heritage. According with the requirements of the Environmental Protection Act 1990, we maintain a register of contaminated land sites in the borough. We will require developers to undertake a site investigation of any contamination of sites. The investigation must prove the nature and extent of the contamination prior to determining the application.
- 15.10.37. Where development is proposed on a site that is known, or is believed to be, contaminated the need to carry out remediation or monitoring and to ensure adequate disposal of contaminated soil will be secured by planning conditions. We will consult and seek advice from the Environment Agency when considering applications on contaminated land.
- 15.10.38. The redevelopment of previously developed land (or 'brownfield') sites for beneficial uses, many of which may be potentially affected by contamination, provides an opportunity to deal with the potential risks posed by contamination to human health and the natural environment.
- 15.10.39. Contamination sensitive development would typically include developments that potentially put people in direct contact with contamination, such as new homes, parks and open space or school uses.
- 15.10.40. Hazardous Gas Installations also affect parts of Merton. We will consult the Health and Safety Executive (HSE) on planning applications using methodology and software known as PADHI, which is available online. The HSE provides advice on safety grounds as to whether

planning permission should be granted. Information on whether a site is affected by this requirement is available from the council.

Construction and demolition

- 15.10.41. There is a need to ensure that occupiers are protected from environmental disturbances during the construction and demolition phase of Major Developments, and during excavating and construction of subterranean developments such as basements.
- 15.10.42. We expect applicants and contractors to mitigate the construction impact, to implement good site management and communication, and proactively engage with the local community and affected residents. Innovative methods of construction to reduce nuisance and emissions from construction, should be implemented where possible.
- 15.10.43. We require the submission of Construction Management Statements (CMS) for the types of developments as set out in the policy. In addition [Merton's Basement and Subterranean Planning Guidance SPD 2017](#) sets out guidance to ensure that problems relating to excavation and constructions of basements, such as highway/parking impacts, noise, dust, vibration and disturbance to neighbours are avoided.
- 15.10.44. To manage the environmental impacts and ensure that the Construction Management Statements are adhered to, we will seek a charge from the applicant/developer to cover the cost of monitoring the CMS. Where an applicant/developer uses the Merton Council Building Control, a discount may be applied to this charge.
- 15.10.45. We may also require a management plan that sets out how developers monitor dust, noise and vibration, and where necessary take action if issues arise. It will also be necessary to control the hours of operation for noisy site works and the processes that need to be followed to work outside these hours, when and if required.
- 15.10.46. In line with the transport policies, we may also require a Construction Logistics Plan (CLP) in areas that are subject to high traffic congestion, to ensure that vehicles entering the site do not adversely impact on local traffic.
- 15.10.47. As part of our commitment to better air quality, we will also ask that the current regulations relating to Non-Road Mobile Machinery (NRMM) are applied through planning conditions.



Chapter 16. Sustainable travel

Strategic Policy T16.1 Sustainable Travel

1. Merton Council aims to deliver an efficient, safe and sustainable transport system that will:
 - a. Improve road safety outcomes in line with The Mayor's Vision Zero target.
 - b. Reduce traffic congestion and parking dominance on Merton's streets.
 - c. Address public health concerns associated with sedentary lifestyles through more active travel choices.
 - d. Minimise the vehicular emissions that contribute towards climate change and local air pollution.
2. To do this we will:
 - a. Plan spatial development in accordance with the transport principles for good growth and the "20-minute neighbourhood" approach, to create complete, compact and connected communities that facilitate walking, cycling and the use of public transport and reduce the need to travel by car.
 - b. Apply the [Healthy Streets Approach](#) to create accessible streets and public areas where it is safe and convenient to socialise, walk, cycle and use public transport.
 - c. Encourage and enable people to choose active travel modes, by implementing a comprehensive network of safe and convenient cycle and walking routes and providing supporting measures such as secure cycle parking, cycle training and route finding.
 - d. Work with Transport for London (TfL) and Transport Operators to promote and seek improvements to public transport infrastructure and services.
 - e. Encourage the management of vehicle use and parking to improve road safety outcomes reduce traffic dominance and minimise impact on the transport network.
 - f. Reduce vehicular emissions through supporting a switch to car clubs and electric vehicles and encouraging efficient, low-emission freight and delivery trips.

Supporting text

Transport challenges

- 16.1.1 The transport network plays a vital role in connecting communities and enabling people to access homes, jobs, education, services and leisure activities. However, accommodating these travel needs creates a number of challenges for the transport network. Traffic volumes in Merton have continued to increase over the last decade and this contributes towards road

congestion and results in many of the borough's street environments being dominated by parked cars. Major roads that carry heavy and fast flows of traffic create a noisy and unpleasant environment. They can also act as barriers that physically separate communities and can be intimidating and potentially dangerous for pedestrians and cyclists. Transport is also a major producer of the vehicular emissions that contribute towards climate change and local air pollution.

- 16.1.2 The Mayor's Transport Strategy and the Government's Decarbonising Transport Strategy set out the overarching policy framework and strategic approach to transport which focuses on reducing dependency on cars in favour of active, efficient and sustainable modes of travel. The Mayor has set a target for 80% of all trips in London to be made on foot, by cycle or using public transport by 2041. The specific target for residents' daily trips in Merton is 73% by 2041. Only 61% of these trips are currently made by sustainable modes, so to achieve this ambitious target we will need to work with TfL and other partners to facilitate a significant shift in travel choices and behaviour. The most effective way to achieve this will be through the implementation of a comprehensive package of transport measures that offer improved sustainable travel options alongside measures to better manage car use, parking and deliveries, including through a transition to low emissions vehicles.
- 16.1.3 The transport policies set out in this chapter have cross cutting objectives with other policies in Merton's Local Plan, in particular those on health and wellbeing, air quality and climate change. Enabling residents to make more active travel choices as part of their daily lives will play an important role in improving health and wellbeing. A shift to sustainable travel modes and lower emissions vehicles will also be vital to enable Merton to decarbonise its activities by 2050 and to reduce air pollution to within legal limits.

Transport and growth

- 16.1.4 Merton is due to grow significantly over the plan period and integrating land use change with transport will be essential to unlock the potential for growth in a sustainable way that does not have a detrimental impact on the transport network. The London Plan sets out that to enable sustainable growth requires an ambitious aim to reduce dependency on cars in favour of increased walking, cycling and public transport use. The Mayor's transport principles for good growth are:
- Good access to public transport.
 - High density.
 - Mixed-use developments.
 - People choose to walk and cycle.
 - Car-free and car-lite places.
 - Inclusive and accessible design.
 - Carbon-free travel and efficient freight.

- 16.1.5 Effective spatial planning can reduce the need to travel, particularly by car, by creating complete, compact and well-connected neighbourhoods where people can meet their everyday needs within a short walk or cycle. This approach is often referred to as the “20-minute neighbourhood” and represents a 10 minute walk each way, which research shows is the distance most people are willing to walk to access daily services (a 10 minute walk equates to a distance of approximately 800m).
- 16.1.6 The period when new development first becomes operational presents the ideal opportunity to influence travel patterns towards sustainable choices before residents, employees or other visitors have developed established long-term travel behaviours. It is therefore essential that development is located and designed to make active and sustainable travel modes a convenient and attractive choice and to reduce reliance on car journeys from the outset.
- 16.1.7 Focusing and intensifying significant new development around stations and town centres with a good range of transport options, can both reduce the need to travel by providing access to key local services and enable longer distance travel by public transport. Many parts of Merton benefit from good access to public transport, with the borough served by ten mainline rail stations, London Underground services, London Trams and a network of 28 bus routes. To ensure future development is sustainable whilst maximising opportunities for growth, development opportunities will be intensified around locations with good public transport accessibility, particularly the opportunity areas of Wimbledon, Colliers Wood and Morden.

Changing travel patterns

- 16.1.8 Fundamental changes to the way we shop, socialise and work, driven by technological change also have an associated impact on travel behaviour including through increased remote working patterns and more home deliveries. These existing trends have been accelerated by the COVID-19 crisis which resulted in some dramatic shifts in travel behaviours during lockdown periods, including a decrease in car and public transport journeys and an increase in local cycling and walking trips. Evidence indicates that the decrease in car journeys during the initial lockdown period coincided with a significant drop in local air pollution which provides a demonstration of the positive improvements that can be achieved by a shift in travel behaviour. Emerging evidence indicates that some of the positive changes to travel behaviour, such as increased cycling levels, have been retained. However, there are also indications that traffic volumes have grown again to above pre-pandemic levels, which has the potential to further exacerbate the transport challenges of local road congestion and air pollution.
- 16.1.9 Any long-term transition to more remote working patterns could have a significant positive impact on travel patterns by supporting local services, reducing commuting distances and encouraging more locally based active travel journeys. However, the shift to online shopping, whilst reducing individual shopping journeys, has resulted in a growth of delivery vehicle trips on the network, which will need to be managed more effectively in future to ensure safety and sustainability.

Policy T16.2 Prioritising active travel choices

1. To encourage and enable active travel choices we will require development proposals to:
 - a. Design the layout of development sites in accordance with the [Healthy Streets Approach](#) and prioritise safe and convenient access routes for pedestrians, cyclists and those with disabilities.
 - b. Ensure sites connect to and integrate well with the surrounding cycle, pedestrian and public transport networks and make suitable contributions towards improving routes where required.
 - c. Protect and enhance any existing publicly accessible cycle and pedestrian routes that cross development sites and maximise opportunities to improve public accessibility by providing new connections through sites.
 - d. Provide secure, covered cycle parking facilities that meet London Plan minimum standards (higher level requirements) and are designed to a high standard, having regard to the London Cycling Design Standards. Facilities should include provision for charging of electric cycles and a minimum of 5% of cycle spaces should accommodate users of non-standard cycles.
 - e. Provide suitable showers, lockers and changing facilities within developments that will provide employment.
 - f. Make provision for or a contribution towards publicly accessible cycle parking and cycle and scooter hire schemes where required.

Supporting text

Active travel and health outcomes

- 16.2.1 Active travel means making journeys in physically active ways, most commonly by walking or cycling but can also include other modes of travel, such as skateboards and push-scooters. Active travel trips also often form part of a longer public transport journey in order to reach a station or onward destination.
- 16.2.2 Walking and cycling are environmentally friendly, cheap and reliable forms of transport that provide a realistic alternative to the car for many short trips. Active travel choices are one of the easiest ways to integrate regular exercise into a daily routine. Most of the main causes of early death in London are linked to inactivity, including heart disease and cancer (Mayor's Transport Strategy). According to the British Medical Association 30 minutes of moderate exercise four to five days a week can halve the risk of a heart attack. If every Londoner walked or cycled for 20 minutes each day this would save the NHS £1.7 billion in treatment costs over 25 years.

- 16.2.3 The Mayor's Transport Strategy sets a target for all Londoners to do at least the 20 minutes of active travel they need to stay healthy each day by 2041. However, only around a third of Merton residents do 20 minutes of active travel a day and worryingly, there has been a slight decline over the last five years. The Government's decarbonising transport strategy sets out the aim that half of all journeys in towns and cities will be cycled or walked by 2030. Approximately 30% of Merton residents' daily trips are already conducted by walking but less than 2% by bicycle. TfL research indicates that a significant number of existing short car journeys in Merton could potentially be made by walking or cycling.

Cycle and pedestrian networks

- 16.2.4 Merton's existing cycle and walking route network comprises of a mix of types of infrastructure of varying quality. Pedestrian facilities including footpaths, lighting and crossings are generally provided to a high standard and well maintained. The existing [cycle network](#) has some sections of marked fully segregated and off-carriageway cycle lanes as well as routes on quieter roads and through low traffic neighbourhoods. There are cross boundary links to neighbouring boroughs, including the cycleways into Central London from Colliers Wood and from Raynes Park to New Malden. There are pleasant, traffic free walking and cycling routes through the borough's parks and open spaces that enable active travel choices by connecting key destinations via convenient shortcuts. In particular, the Wandle Trail provides a major active travel route across the borough that connects neighbourhoods including Morden and Colliers Wood.
- 16.2.5 It is, however, recognised that cycle and pedestrian provision in Merton is not of adequate standard in all areas and that significant barriers still exist to cycle and pedestrian journeys, particularly through the severance created by busy roads. We will work with Transport for London, developers and other partners to make further improvements over the plan period with the aim of providing comprehensive cycling and walking networks that enable active travel choices to be made. In order to contribute to the aim set out in the Government's decarbonising transport strategy, to deliver a world class cycling and walking network in England by 2040, Merton will produce cycling and walking strategies which will set out more detailed proposals for cycle and pedestrian route development over the plan period.
- 16.2.6 Development proposals must demonstrate through their Transport Assessment or Statement that sites are accessible by walking and cycling in accordance with TfL's [Healthy Streets Approach](#). An [Active Travel Zone \(ATZ\)](#) assessment should be conducted in accordance with TfL guidance which assesses and identifies opportunities to integrate with and improve cycling and walking networks ATZ assessments should particularly consider opportunities to improve cycle routes identified on the indicative cycle network map which shows cycling desire lines and potential routes that could form part of a future comprehensive cycle network to be delivered by the end of the plan period. Some sections of the network already have existing high quality cycle facilities in place and routes on the quieter roads will require minimal intervention. However, some routes will require significant intervention or further improvement to achieve the standard required. Developers should refer to Merton's and TfL's

latest cycle route network maps and transport/ cycling strategies for further information on existing and planned routes and seek to consult at an early stage to discuss any requirements in relation to the cycle or pedestrian networks.

- 16.2.7 Developments may be required to make financial contributions to cycling or walking schemes and/ or provide new routes across development sites. Any existing cycle or walking routes on or adjacent to development sites should be fully protected, including during construction phase, and opportunities should be sought to improve and upgrade routes as part of the development proposals. Development layouts must be designed to give priority to pedestrian and cycle movements, facilitate access to public transport networks and be designed in accordance with the [Healthy Streets Approach](#). New development should, where appropriate, seek to restrict traffic dominance by adopting the principles of low traffic neighbourhoods and filtered permeability into the site layouts and should integrate with, and contribute towards, any new or existing low traffic schemes on the surrounding street network. Proposals for gated developments that prevent public access through development sites by cyclists and pedestrians will not be permitted. New and improved street layouts including pedestrian and cycle-infrastructure must be provided to a high standard with regard to the latest best practice design guidance and requirements including; DfT [Cycle infrastructure design LTN 1/20](#), Manual for Streets and [TfL Streets Toolkit](#), [Streetscape Guidance](#), London Cycling Design Standards, TfL [Healthy Streets Approach](#) and [Healthy streets check for designers](#).

Cycle parking

- 16.2.8 To enable more people to take up or continue to cycle it is important that a sufficient quantity of high-quality cycle parking is provided within new developments in accordance with the higher-level requirements set out in the London Plan. Cycle parking must be easy to access in a convenient location within a development, at ground level wherever possible. The facilities must be secure, covered and be suitable for people of all ages and abilities, including those who might experience difficulties in lifting a bike or need a specialist cycle. Further guidance and requirements in relation to the design of cycle parking facilities is provided in Chapter 8 of the London Cycling Design Standards. Development proposals must provide full layout drawings prior to the determination of application, demonstrating that it is possible and easy to manoeuvre bicycles both to and within the proposed cycle parking facilities. In places of employment, supporting facilities must be provided including changing rooms, maintenance facilities, lockers and shower facilities (at least one per ten long-stay spaces).
- 16.2.9 Given the contribution of cycling to sustainable travel, we will generally be supportive of bicycle storage units or boxes in front gardens provided they do not impact on residential amenity and are designed in sensitive materials as set out in Policy D12.3t and paragraphs 12.3.17-18.
- 16.2.10 Mobility hire services are becoming more mainstream and include dockless electric bikes and electric scooters. These innovative services have the potential to provide a cost-effective,

sustainable and convenient way of getting around as an alternative to car and public transport use. We support these services where they are appropriately licenced and accredited through nationally recognised organisations, ensure safety for users and other road users and do not undermine take up of active travel. To accommodate these services, we will seek to provide designated parking locations and may require appropriate developments to provide suitable space for this purpose, particularly in town centres where trip generation is likely to be high and alternative available highways space is limited.

Policy T16.3 Managing the transport impacts of development

1. To manage and mitigate any impacts on the transport network in an efficient, safe and sustainable way, development proposals will be required to:
 - a. Submit a transport statement or assessment with regard to the latest [TfL guidance](#), which demonstrates that the scale and type of development is appropriate to the transport accessibility of the site and that proposals will not have a detrimental impact on the transport network. Mitigation measures to address adverse transport impacts, including through highways improvements and/ or financial contributions may be required to make the proposals acceptable.
 - b. Demonstrate that any detrimental impact on road safety can be mitigated to an acceptable degree with regard to The Mayor's Vision Zero target for road safety.
 - c. Demonstrate how trips generated by the development will be managed to maximise sustainable travel patterns and reduce reliance on vehicle trips. Developments that are expected to generate a significant number of trips will be required to develop a Travel Plan with regard to TfL's latest guidance.
 - d. Address the needs of people with disabilities and reduced mobility in relation to all modes of transport.
 - e. Demonstrate how any impacts on the transport network during the construction phase of the development will be managed and mitigated, with priority given to maintaining safe and inclusive access for pedestrians, cyclists and public transport users. Developments that will have an impact on the transport network during construction will be required to develop a Construction Logistics Plan informed by TfL's latest [Construction Logistics Planning guidance](#).
 - f. Demonstrate that the proposals and site layout make adequate provision for safe and suitable access to the site for all users.
 - g. Demonstrate that the development will adequately facilitate efficient, safe and low-emission delivery and servicing trips and where a significant number of delivery trips are expected to be generated, develop a Delivery and Servicing Plan with regard to TfL's latest guidance.

Supporting text

Assessing transport impacts

- 16.3.1 It is important that development proposals fully and carefully assess the projected impacts on the capacity of the transport network at the local, network-wide and strategic level and in

relation to all modes of transport. Development proposals will therefore be required to submit either a transport statement where transport impacts are limited or a full transport assessment where the development would be expected to have a significant or strategic transport impact. The transport assessment or statement should be developed in accordance with the [latest guidance provided by TfL](#).

- 16.3.2 The transport statement or assessment should demonstrate that the scale and type of development is appropriate to the transport accessibility of the site location. Specifically, significant, high-density development should be located in town centres and other locations that offer sustainable travel choices and reduce the need to travel by car. Any essential development that would be expected to result in large numbers of freight, servicing or delivery movements particularly by heavy goods vehicles, should be located appropriately on the strategic road network and should incorporate measures to support a transition to low carbon vehicle fleets.
- 16.3.3 The transport assessment must identify if the transport impacts of a new development are likely to be 'severe' which may lead to the permission being refused unless adequate mitigating measures can be provided to address any adverse transport impacts. Mitigation measures may include financial contributions towards or direct provision of walking and cycling facilities, public transport services and highways improvements. New streets or highways improvement schemes should be designed in accordance with the latest best practice guidance and requirements including; DfT Manual for Streets and [TfL Streets Toolkit](#), [Healthy Streets Approach](#) and [Healthy streets check for designers](#).
- 16.3.4 The transport statement or assessment should set out how the development supports the Healthy Streets Approach and The Mayor's Vision Zero target for road safety. Vision Zero sets out a strategy to reduce danger on the streets, so that by 2041 all deaths and serious injuries will be eliminated from London's transport network. The Vision Zero action plan sets out a strategy for making safety improvements to street design, road speeds, vehicles and road user behaviour.
- 16.3.5 Developments that will be expected to generate a significant number of journeys to the site by employees, visitors, students or residents should also submit a travel plan in accordance with TfL's [advice and guidance on Travel Plans](#). A travel plan is a strategy for managing travel to a site through the introduction of a package of measures that support sustainable travel choices. Developers should seek to engage with the council and TfL at an early stage of the planning process to discuss the specific requirements for a travel plan which will be dependent on the type, scale, location and transport accessibility of the development. The travel plan will be required to be monitored over a period of at least five years to ensure the development is meeting targets in relation to sustainable travel. To support this the council will seek to secure a travel plan monitoring fee via S106 agreement for all developments that are required to submit a travel plan.

Construction logistics

- 16.3.6 The construction phase of developments can present significant logistic and environmental challenges particularly for large, complex and constrained sites or sites that are located in town centres, residential areas or near schools. Construction is likely to generate a significant volume of trips often by heavy goods vehicles that are widely acknowledged to be involved in a disproportionate number of collisions involving cyclists. Development proposals should therefore seek engagement at an early stage of the planning process and set out proposals to ensure that the construction phase is adequately managed and that risks to the operation and safety of the transport network are mitigated. Proposals should also demonstrate that the transport impacts of the construction phase have been mitigated to maximise sustainability and reduce local air pollution, including through the use of rail or river (via the Thames) freight for significant developments where feasible. Developments that are expected to have a transport impact during construction, will be required to develop a Construction Logistics Plan which reflects the scale, complexity and location of the development and is in accordance with [TfL's Construction Logistics Plan Guidance](#).
- 16.3.7 Developments will be required to obtain the necessary approvals and licences before commencing works on or near publicly maintainable land. It is advised that a minimum of 60 days is given for submission and approvals for all permissions and licences to be assessed and issued. Please contact Merton's Highway Department [Network. Co-ordination@merton.gov.uk](mailto:Network.Co-ordination@merton.gov.uk). To ensure road safety and minimise disruption to road users we may seek a financial contribution via s106 to monitor operations where they are complex.

Deliveries and servicing

- 16.3.8 Freight, servicing and delivery vehicles, particularly heavy goods vehicles are a significant source of noise and air pollution, particularly around commercial and industrial locations. Delivery and servicing trips have been increasing in London due to the rapid market evolution in home delivery for a range of services, which has been accelerated as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic. However, low carbon alternatives such as electric vans and cargo bike deliveries have also started to become more widespread.
- 16.3.9 Where a development is likely to generate a significant amount of movement by goods or delivery vehicles, we will require the development of a Delivery and Servicing Plan in accordance with TfL's latest guidance. A Delivery and Servicing Plan provides a strategy to improve the safety, efficiency and sustainability of delivery and servicing vehicles through a range of interventions including consolidation, low carbon delivery modes and the retiming of movements to avoid peak hours. Development involving delivery focused services should provide adequate on-site electric charging infrastructure and parking to support low carbon fleets including e-cargo bikes.
- 16.3.10 Delivery and servicing demands can place additional pressure both on the kerbside and within the site boundary which can impact on road safety, parking and vehicular, cycle and pedestrian access. It is essential that servicing requirements are fully and safely

accommodated within site wherever possible, and these should be incorporated within the overall design at feasibility stage as it is difficult to modify a site layout post design. In exceptional circumstances, where the developer has justified why it is not feasible to provide some or all of the servicing requirements on site or where potential overspill can reasonably be anticipated, we may seek to introduce parking and loading controls to manage kerb space and will seek an appropriate financial contribution to facilitate this.

- 16.3.11 To help alleviate servicing concerns in relation to refuse, developers are required to provide refuse storage and collection solutions, which are safe, attractive and well-designed. Refuse facilities should be convenient, allow bins to be manoeuvred easily and include sufficient capacity to accommodate increased recycling requirements. For sites with restricted space and access, development proposals should demonstrate that bins will not obstruct adjacent footways or the highway, including by making provision for bins to be relocated to a convenient, suitably sized hardstanding on collection days. We will support underground waste collection systems for major redevelopment schemes provided there is no impact on road safety and where proposed systems are accepted by the council's appointed waste contractor.
- 16.3.12 Coach, shuttle bus and on demand bus services can provide a convenient means to convey people to large sporting/leisure events and major transport terminals, so can significantly reduce car journeys and congestion by combining single journeys or drop offs. Development likely to attract coach or shuttle bus trips will be expected to provide appropriate, managed picking up and setting down facilities. Where this is not achievable within the site then alternative approaches need to be explored within the transport assessment.
- 16.3.13 Taxis, Dial-a-Ride and community transport services can also form an important part of a sustainable transport mix that provides access to occasional vehicle use. Where appropriate to the use, developments should accommodate these modes on site and provide appropriate EV charging facilities.

Policy T16.4 Parking and Low Emissions Vehicles

1. Development proposals should manage car use and parking to ensure safety, reduce reliance on car use and support a transition to lower emissions vehicles.
2. Developments should provide the minimum level of car parking necessary taking into consideration the site accessibility by public transport (PTAL), in accordance with London Plan parking standards. Developments in areas with good public transport accessibility, including Town Centres and all locations with a PTAL rating of 5 to 6, will be expected to be car free.
3. All new development in Controlled Parking Zones, including conversions to multiple dwellings, will be required to be permit free, with all future occupants of that development being ineligible for on-street parking permits.
4. Financial contributions will be sought for new or enhanced parking controls where they are considered necessary to promote road safety and protect existing residential or business amenity.
5. Disabled persons' parking should be provided in accordance with London Plan standards be accommodated within the development site where possible and be provided with electric vehicle charge points.
6. Development that provides on-site parking provision must provide electric vehicle charging infrastructure which is appropriate to the scale and type of development and which meets or exceeds requirements set out in Building Regulations Approved Document S and the London Plan. The proposals must set out a strategy for the ongoing operation, management and maintenance of the EV charging infrastructure.
7. Residential developments that provide parking will be expected to support car club use as an alternative to car ownership, by funding a free trial use package for new residents for at least three years. Where appropriate, on-site parking spaces should be allocated to an appropriate number of car club vehicles which will be provided with electric vehicle charging infrastructure and be included within the London Plan maximum parking standards.
8. Development that provides any new provision or an amended layout of on-site car parking provision, should demonstrate that the proposals do not compromise pedestrian amenity, highway safety or increase flood risk. Any developments providing multiple or communal car parking spaces will be required to submit a Parking Design and Management Plan.

Supporting text

Car parking standards

- 16.4.1 Vehicles take up a lot of street space and high levels of car ownership and use have resulted in many of the borough's roads becoming congested and dominated by parked cars.

Reducing levels of car ownership can free up space on both development sites and on the highway for other more efficient and sustainable uses. We will therefore support and apply the approach set out in the London Plan of restricting car parking provision to restrain car use and will apply the London Plan maximum car parking standards for all use classes as set out in London Plan Policies T6 and T6.1-T6.5.

- 16.4.2 We will expect and support car free development for all development proposals in locations that will be well connected by public transport including all locations with a Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL) rating of 5 to 6. Car free development may also be considered or required in other locations on a case-by-case basis where it can be adequately demonstrated that sufficient sustainable travel choices will be available including where funded improvements to public transport are put in place to raise the PTAL. Developments in less accessible locations with a low PTAL rating should provide the minimum necessary amount of parking in accordance with London Plan standards ('car-lite').
- 16.4.3 Parking requirements for developments in areas with poor public transport accessibility outside of Controlled Parking Zones (CPZs) should more sympathetically balance the need to restrain generation of car trips with the impact of overspill parking on neighbouring areas. Development which is likely to increase on-street parking demand in the surrounding area will be expected to undertake parking surveys to assess potential impacts. Where required a financial contribution may be sought to introduce or enhance local parking control measures around the development site.

Permit free development

- 16.4.4 To manage on-street parking the council has introduced CPZs into some areas of Merton (a map of existing CPZs can be viewed on Merton's website). To prevent an increase in parking pressure, the council will ensure that all new development in CPZs is permit free, with future occupants being ineligible to apply for on-street parking permits. This will be secured through a legal agreement which will include a requirement that new occupants are informed of the "permit free" status of the development. The accumulation of residential conversions to multiple residential properties can place increased pressure on CPZs, so any new dwellings created through conversions will also be expected to be permit free.

Parking for people with disabilities

- 16.4.5 It is recognised that some people with disabilities will rely on car travel more than others, whether as a passenger or a driver, so disabled persons' parking should be provided for new developments. The amount and design of disabled persons' parking provision should be provided as set out within the London Plan (Policy T6.1 Residential parking and Policy T6.5 Non-residential disabled persons parking) and should be included within maximum parking provision, not in addition to it.

- 16.4.6 It is essential that disabled parking facilities are fully accommodated on site wherever possible and should be incorporated within the overall design at feasibility stage. Disabled parking provision should be conveniently located and provide adequate access space and be provided in accordance with requirements and design standards set out in London Plan Policies T6, T6.1, T6.5. In exceptional circumstances, where the developer has justified why it is not feasible to provide some or all the disabled parking for the development on site, consideration may be given to accommodating disabled parking on the public highway, subject to an appropriate financial contribution to facilitate this.

Parking management and design

- 16.4.7 As people take decisions about whether to own a car and what type of car to purchase, having a comprehensive and coherent parking management approach and pricing structure in place is essential. Where any communal car parking facilities are provided a Parking Design and Management Plan should be submitted and will be secured through planning condition or appropriate legal agreements. Proposals for the management and allocation of parking provision should align with Merton's strategic approach for managing parking including through appropriate parking charges. Specifically, as set out in London Plan Policy T6.1B, residential communal parking spaces should not be bought outright but leased on a regular basis (maximum annually). Employee, retail, destination and public parking should be allocated and/ or charged for appropriately. Parking charges should ideally be varied to reflect vehicle emissions with low emissions vehicles such as EVs being charged a lower rate.
- 16.4.8 Car parking layouts and spaces should be well-designed to provide adequate space and ensure highway safety in accordance with the latest best practice design guidance and standards. To ensure highway safety and protect pedestrian amenity, any proposals to create off-street parking and driveways which require the provision of a new access from the highway, will be required to apply for a dropped kerb in accordance with requirements set out in Merton's vehicle crossover information pack. To mitigate flood risk, any new or amended off-street parking facilities, including gardens converted to driveways, must take measures to reduce surface water runoff, such as the use of permeable materials and SUDS, in accordance with Policy F15.9 part-3d and Merton's Sustainable Drainage Design and Evaluation Guide.

Car Clubs

- 16.4.9 Car clubs provide an alternative to individual ownership by allowing members to use a car on a pay as you go basis for occasional trips without having the cost or hassle of owning the vehicle. Survey data (CoMo UK 2019) indicates that car club members reduce their private car use and increase their use of sustainable modes. 41% of car club members said they would have bought a new car had they not joined a car club.

- 16.4.10 To reduce levels of car ownership in new development from the outset, we will require residential developments to implement measures to support car club use, including car club membership packages for at least three years. For larger developments we may seek on-site dedicated car club bays, particularly in areas of lower public transport accessibility and where there is a lack of existing car club provision in the vicinity. Car club spaces should be included within the maximum parking provision as set out in the London Plan and not in addition to it. Car club bays should be convenient, accessible by different operating models/operators and be made publicly available at all times. Car Club operators should be part of a nationally recognised Accredited Scheme. [CoMoUK](#) provide further guidance on car club requirements for new development.

Electric Vehicles

- 16.4.11 Transport is a major producer of the vehicular emissions that contribute towards climate change and cars produce up to 19% of Merton's carbon dioxide emissions as a result of the 600 million kilometres driven each year. Transport emissions also account for approximately 60% of the emissions of nitrogen dioxide that contribute to local air pollution. Air pollution concentrations in Merton continue to breach the legally binding air quality limits and are particularly high in proximity to busy traffic routes including in the town centres of Morden, Mitcham, Wimbledon and Raynes Park. Air pollutants are recognised as a major contributor to poor health which particularly affects the most vulnerable in society including children, older people, and anyone with long-term health conditions. 6.5% of mortality in Merton is attributable to the harm caused by poor air quality, equivalent to around 75 deaths every year.
- 16.4.12 To address these issues, we will prioritise a reduction in car ownership and use, as a holistic solution that also tackles other transport challenges of congestion and road safety. However, it is recognised that there will continue to be some need and demand for car journeys particularly in areas with lower public transport accessibility. We will therefore support a transition to lower emission vehicles specifically to support a reduction in local air pollutants, noise and greenhouse gas emissions.
- 16.4.13 The Government has published a [decarbonising transport](#) strategy which includes proposals to increase the uptake of electric vehicles (EVs) and end the sale of new petrol and diesel cars by 2030. The International Council on Clean Transport (ICCT) estimates that the total number of EVs in London will increase by a factor of 30 by 2035 and has assessed that the demand for EV charge points in Merton will increase rapidly during this time and will require a mix of charging infrastructure to serve the different needs of users-including slow, fast and rapid chargers.
- 16.4.14 New development that provides parking provision must provide electric vehicle charging infrastructure appropriate to the scale and type of development. For residential and office development slow charge points are usually adequate. For public retail and destination car parking facilities, EV infrastructure should include conveniently located fast or rapid charging

facilities that enable the public to charge their vehicle on a “pay as you go” basis. EV charging infrastructure requires ongoing maintenance and operational management, so arrangements in relation to this should be set out within proposals, including within any Parking Design and Management plan.

- 16.4.15 Building Regulations [Approved Document S: Infrastructure for the charging of electric vehicles](#) sets out detailed requirements and technical standards that should be applied in relation to the provision of EV charging for residential and non-residential buildings that are new or undergoing major renovation or change of use. The amount of charge points provided should be in accordance with whichever is the higher applicable standard of the Building Regulations Approved Document S and London Plan (Policy T6 including T6.1 - T6.4) or the latest applicable standard. Developments not adequately covered by these standards or where a higher level of requirement has been identified may also be required to provide an additional amount or specific type of EV charging infrastructure. For example, developments generating trips by a high number of taxis or large operational vehicles may have specific requirements for rapid charging infrastructure. Parking spaces with provision for electric or other Ultra-Low Emission vehicles should be included within the maximum parking provision as set out in the London Plan and not in addition to it.

Policy T16.5 Supporting transport infrastructure

1. To protect existing transport infrastructure and to ensure that new infrastructure is provided to support growth and a low carbon future:
 - a. Existing land and buildings used for all transport network functions, including public transport services, will be protected from development, unless alternative facilities are provided to the satisfaction of relevant strategic transport authorities and service providers that enable existing transport operations to be maintained and expanded if necessary.
 - b. Land identified for new transport facilities and other related infrastructure will be safeguarded and secured through planning obligation.
 - c. Redevelopment of existing public transport sites must demonstrate how services and access for all users will be protected and improved through the provision of new or upgraded facilities and adequately maintained during the construction phase of development.
 - d. Development proposals should support capacity, connectivity and other improvements to the bus network and ensure that buses can operate efficiently to, from and within developments, and provide supporting infrastructure as required.
 - e. Development proposals for infrastructure required to decarbonise transport operations will be supported.

Supporting text

Public transport network

- 16.5.1 Public transport can help to reduce dependency on cars by providing efficient and affordable options for journeys that are either impractical or too long to walk or cycle. Parts of Merton benefit from a good public transport provision principally around the town centres but there are other parts of the borough where accessibility levels remain poor, and which are more reliant on local bus services. (See PTAL map.)
- 16.5.2 Approximately 30% of Merton residents' daily trips are made by public transport (TfL data, based on average daily trips for the period 2017/18 - 2019/20). This comprises approximately 9% of trips made by rail, 9% by underground and 12.5% by bus and tram.
- 16.5.3 For an outer London borough south of the river, Merton's public transport network is relatively good, comprising of Northern and District Line Underground services, mainline rail and tram services. However, crowding is a real problem in the peaks on most routes which can make journey experiences uncomfortable and unpleasant. There are also barriers to accessing public transport for disabled people and those travelling with young children.

- 16.5.4 The Mayor's Transport Strategy sets out that significant investment will be needed in the public transport network to improve the customer experience and support anticipated growth without increasing crowding. This policy protects and safeguards existing and potential routes and sites which are required to improve the public transport network and provide the necessary future capacity. Please also refer to Policy IN14.1 (Infrastructure).

Crossrail 2

- 16.5.5 The South West Main Line into Waterloo that runs through the borough serving Motspur Park, Raynes Park and Wimbledon stations, is the UK's busiest main line railway which results in severe crowding at peak times. The Mayor's Transport Strategy sets out that proposals for a major new line, Crossrail 2 will be essential to alleviate existing overcrowding and deliver additional capacity from central London to south London and beyond. The Mayor's Transport Strategy states that Crossrail 2 is an infrastructure scheme of national importance which will connect existing national rail lines in Surrey with tunnels from Wimbledon, so will have a significant impact on the borough. The route would increase London's overall rail capacity by 10% and will also reduce demand on the busiest section of the Northern line Morden branch by around 20%.
- 16.5.6 The impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on travel patterns has resulted in uncertainties around the future and financing of the scheme, although TfL still expect that the scheme will be required in the long term. An agreement between the Government and TfL in late 2020 has put the scheme development in good order until such time as the scheme can be further progressed. The delivery of Crossrail 2 will take place outside this Local Plan period.
- 16.5.7 Some land within the borough has been identified and safeguarded in the [Crossrail 2 Safeguarding Directions confirmed by the Secretary of State in March 2015](#). However, none of the sections of route needed to deliver Crossrail 2, south of Wimbledon Town Centre and the onward connection onto the South West Main Line, are formally safeguarded and some of the site allocations within Raynes Park potentially conflict with sites needed to deliver the route.
- 16.5.8 TfL and Merton Council will support the Secretary of State to refresh the safeguarding directions. We will continue to promote discussion-between TfL and developers potentially affected by the proposals at an early stage, including important sites beyond the current safeguarded limits that may be critical for the delivery of this strategic project.

Underground and suburban rail services

- 16.5.9 The Mayor's Transport Strategy proposes upgrades to the Underground network which will enable faster and more frequent services, as well as improved accessibility and a more pleasant travelling environment. Proposals for improvements to the suburban rail network will include an increase in frequency on the "Wimbledon Loop" from two to four trains per hour, which will significantly improve the existing capacity and the level of service in parts of the borough with stations on this route.

16.5.10 There are also planned upgrades to stations to improve safety, convenience and attractiveness. Proposals to provide step-free access at stations will improve accessibility to better enable disabled and older people and parents with young children to travel spontaneously and independently. Improvements to the public transport network will also be integrated with schemes to improve the connecting of streets and public realm for cyclists and pedestrians, to provide an attractive whole journey experience that will facilitate mode shift away from the car. Where there are development proposals on sites that include or connect to a station, we will seek to secure improvements to accessibility and facilities.

London Trams and Sutton Link

16.5.11 Merton is served by London Trams that provides a major orbital link between Wimbledon and Croydon Town Centre via Mitcham. However, the service suffers from overcrowding at peak times and a significant capacity increase is needed to accommodate the anticipated growth in homes and jobs in south London, without reliance on the car. The Mayor's Transport Strategy sets out proposals to upgrade the tram system to improve its reliability and to increase its peak frequency and capacity through longer trams, an expanded tram fleet and new tracking including twin tracking between Morden Road and Phipps Bridge tram stops.

16.5.12 A proposed new tram service, the "Sutton Link", would create a new, direct and quick route between Sutton and Merton that would offer interchange with the existing tram service. Following public consultation in 2019, TfL's preferred option would serve Colliers Wood via St Helier Avenue, Morden Road and Church Road. Work on the Sutton Link project was paused in July 2020 as it had not proved possible to identify the funding needed to deliver the scheme. If circumstances change and new funding opportunities emerge then the case for taking the scheme forward will be reviewed.

16.5.13 Other potential tram proposals include an extension to South Wimbledon and a new tram stop to serve Willow Lane Industrial Estate.

Bus services

16.5.14 Merton is already served by an extensive network of 28 bus services. However, as set out in the Mayor's Transport Strategy, significant enhancements to bus services will be required to make the bus an attractive alternative option to replace car journeys, particularly in parts of outer London less well served by public transport. The bus network is more flexible than fixed route public transport so can be more responsive to changes in demand as a result of new development by changing or adding services. Demand responsive bus services are being developed to fill accessibility gaps where a conventional bus service would not necessarily be viable. Development proposals should consider whether new or improved bus services and facilities are required to better serve existing and potential demand.

16.5.15 The Mayor's Transport Strategy sets out an aim for the TfL bus fleet to emit zero exhaust emissions by 2037 at the latest. To accommodate this, existing depot facilities, bus

interchanges and stops will progressively need to be adapted to provide the associated electric charging and communication infrastructure.

Proposed transport schemes

16.5.16 The table below sets out the key transport schemes identified in the Mayor's Transport Strategy and London Plan Policy T3 that are relevant to Merton and will deliver an enhanced or expanded travel network to accommodate growth sustainably. Additionally, a number of locally important proposals are shown. This list is not detailed or exhaustive, so developers should consult TfL's and Merton Council's latest Transport Strategies for up-to-date details of transport schemes proposed in Merton. Where a scheme could potentially be affected by a proposal, applicants should consult with the council and other relevant authorities, including TfL, at an early stage to understand the latest status of the scheme and identify impacts and whether any suitable mitigation is possible. Development proposals should identify new sites or routes that are or will be required for local public transport and active travel connections where appropriate and set them out in a transport assessment or transport statement.

Table 16.1: Indicative list of transport schemes

Proposal Number, Scheme and Location	Proposal Description, Status, Timescale and Funding
TN 1 Crossrail 2	Strategic infrastructure proposal for new underground rail line running across London between Wimbledon and New Southgate/Tottenham Hale with potential ground level links to the wider rail network. This scheme is currently unfunded and will not be completed in the lifetime of this Local Plan. Existing safeguarding of the scheme is retained - for the current status and safeguarding of land see https://crossrail2.co.uk
TN 2 Rail service improvements	Enhanced suburban rail services, particularly to improve the frequency of trains on the Wimbledon loop from 2 trains per hour to 4 trains per hour in each direction throughout the day. A study has been conducted by Network Rail (not yet formally published) that includes a proposal to increase the frequency of trains on the Wimbledon loop as a primary recommendation. Although no decision has been made or funding allocated at this stage, this could potentially be implemented by the late 2020s/early 2030s subject to post-COVID-19 recovery and service specification.
TN 3 Underground upgrades	Upgrades to Underground Services to improve capacity and quality of service. A proposed upgrade to the District Line that will increase frequencies to up to 16 trains per hour on the Wimbledon Branch is expected to be delivered by 2024.

TN 4 Step-free access	Improved station accessibility for all users at all rail stations that do not have step-free access including Motspur Park and Haydon's Road. Proposals to safeguard Wimbledon Chase Station redevelopment to ensure step free access can be delivered in the future. Stations that do not have funding secured but consideration will be given to submitting bids for future rounds of Access for All funding in collaboration with Network Rail and Rail Operators. All development sites that could impact on or enable step-free access will be required to safeguard potential future routes and schemes, including any redevelopment of Wimbledon Chase Station.
TN 5 Sutton Link – Sutton town centre to Colliers Wood	Proposal for a new tram route between Sutton and Colliers Wood. Currently unfunded and unlikely to be completed in the lifetime of this Local Plan. See https://consultations.tfl.gov.uk/trams/sutton-link
TN 6 Improvements to existing Wimbledon to Croydon Tram service	Service improvements including step-free access from Dorset Road to Morden Road tram stop, replacing existing single track with double tracks between Phipps Bridge and Morden Road tram stops to increase capacity. The TfL proposal for twin tracking does not currently have funding allocated, but if funding is secured the current anticipated timescale for delivery is beyond 2031.
TN 7 Other tram improvements	Potential new tram stop at Willow Lane to enhance public transport access to Willow Lane Industrial Estate. This scheme does not form part of TfL's plans and has no allocated funding, so would only be progressed during the plan period as part of appropriate enabling development and in collaboration with TfL. Street running spur extension from Morden Road tram stop. Delivery will require reallocation of road space and local widening secured through negotiation with landowners as opportunities arise. This scheme has no TfL funding currently allocated, but if funding is secured, timescales are anticipated to be beyond 2031.
TN 8 Bus network improvements	Service enhancements to meet existing and future demand, accessible bus stops and bus stop improvements, bus priority schemes, decarbonisation of the bus fleet and exploration of demand-responsive bus services. This is an ongoing annual programme which will be funded directly by TfL with potential S106 developer contributions towards specific service improvements linked to development proposals.
TN 9 Wimbledon Town Centre public realm improvements	Major scheme to improve the public realm and accessibility by cycling, walking and public transport, including improvements to the station. Will involve modification of one-way road system, reallocation of road space and schemes for sustainable management of deliveries and servicing. This major scheme will require a significant amount of funding from a combination of sources including TfL and/or Government grants, Strategic Community Infrastructure Levy funding and enabling development contributions. As set out the in Future Wimbledon SPD anticipated delivery timescales are from 2025 to 2040.
TN 10	Re-prioritisation of road space in favour of pedestrian, cyclists and public transport, improved Station access arrangements and public realm improvement and modification of one-way road system.

Morden Town Centre, London Road	This major scheme will require a significant amount of funding from TfL and enabling development schemes with an anticipated delivery timescale of late 2020s.
TN 11 Borough-wide walking network	Improvements to the walking network including routes, lighting and crossing facilities including the “missing link” along the Wandle Trail near Earlsfield (Wimbledon Park to Wandsworth). Merton will develop a walking strategy which will set out more detailed proposals for pedestrian route development and will be implemented on an ongoing basis over the plan period. The programme will be funded by a combination of funding for transport schemes allocated to the borough by TfL and/or Government grants, Strategic Community Infrastructure Levy funding and S106 developer contributions towards specific schemes linked to development proposals.
TN 12 Borough-wide cycle network	Development of a strategic network of cycle routes, including new feeder routes to the Cycle Superhighway and including the “missing link” along the Wandle Trail near Earlsfield (Wimbledon Park to Wandsworth) Merton will develop a cycling strategy which will set out more detailed proposals for cycle route development and will be implemented on an ongoing basis over the plan period. The programme will be funded by a combination of funding for transport schemes allocated to the borough by TfL and/or Government grants, Strategic Community Infrastructure Levy funding and S106 developer contributions towards specific schemes linked to development proposals.
TN 13 Cycle parking and hubs	Upgrades of existing cycle parking facilities and secure cycle parking hubs at Wimbledon, Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Morden. Merton will develop a cycling strategy which will set out more detailed proposals for cycle parking provision. Schemes will be implemented on an ongoing annual basis over the Local Plan period. The programme will be funded by a combination of funding for transport schemes allocated to the borough by TfL and/or Government grants, Strategic Community Infrastructure Levy funding and S106 developer contributions towards specific schemes linked to development proposals. Developers of key schemes in strategic locations may also be required to include cycle parking hubs within their development proposals.
TN 14 EV charging infrastructure	Development of a mix of EV charging infrastructure to facilitate the projected increase in EV ownership. Merton will develop an EV strategy which will set out more detailed proposals for the provision of EV charging infrastructure. Schemes will be implemented on an ongoing basis over the plan period, including through the provision of charging infrastructure secured through development proposals. The programme will be funded by a combination TfL and/or Government grants and developer and operator funded provision.



Chapter 17. **Monitoring framework**

Policy M17.1 Monitoring

- 1.** Merton Council will demonstrate the delivery of the Local Plan's spatial vision and strategic objectives by monitoring the implementation of policies and infrastructure.
- 2.** In the event that delivery falls significantly below what is required to achieve the necessary targets or should housing and accommodation need figures change significantly, the council will trigger a full or partial review of the Plan.

Supporting text

Monitoring framework

- 17.1.1. Monitoring the Local Plan is crucial to the successful delivery of its vision and strategic objectives. Section 113 of the Localism Act 2011 sets out the requirements for Authority Monitoring Reports (AMRs). Regulation 34 of The Town and Country Planning (Local Planning) (England) Regulations 2012 provides further detail on these requirements which are also reflected in the National Planning Practice Guidance (PPG) on Local Plans.
- 17.1.2. Monitoring is required to ensure that the Local Plan is effective. It also allows us to understand whether policies have worked as they were intended. The monitoring period will be implemented from the first year of adoption.
- 17.1.3. The monitoring framework table sets out the monitoring indicators for the Local Plan, which will be reported annually in the Authority Monitoring Report (AMR). The AMR is not the only monitoring tool. There are separate monitoring arrangements related to other council strategies, for example, the climate change strategy and action plan, and the South London Waste Plan.
- 17.1.4. Currently, the council has no reason to believe the plan will not be implemented in full. However, the council accepts there could be circumstances where development fails to come forward for a number of reasons, some of which are beyond the control of the council.
- 17.1.5. Should monitoring indicate Local Plan policies are not being implemented as intended or site allocation are not being delivered; the council will take appropriate action to resolve the issue(s). This may involve:
 - a. Producing Supplementary Planning Documents (SPD) and other relevant guidance to provide more detail of how policies should be implemented. Developing further working relationships with various partners across public, private and voluntary sectors to look at ways to facilitate implementation, including potential alternative forms of funding.

- b. Continuing to work with adjoining local authorities and agencies to address cross-boundary development needs.
- c. Reviewing capacity forecasts to make sure they reflect up-to-date guidance and any future changes to population and household growth.
- d. Engaging with residents, businesses, community groups, developers and landowners to identify and try to resolve barriers to delivery.
- e. Reviewing site allocations to make sure there is an adequate supply of new homes, new jobs opportunities and delivery of supporting infrastructure to meet future needs.
- f. Considering Compulsory Purchase Orders (CPO) powers.

Triggers for a local plan review.

17.1.6. As set out paragraph 33 of NPPF 2021 and draft NPPF 2023 policies in local plans and spatial development strategies should be reviewed to assess whether they need updating at least once every five years and should then be updated as necessary. Reviews should be completed no later than five years from the adoption date of a plan and should take into account changing circumstances affecting the area, or any relevant changes in national policy. Potential triggers for a partial or full review are:

- a. Housing completions fall more than 20% beneath the targets in the housing trajectory over any rolling three-year period.
- b. Any significant revisions or updates to the London Plan where it proposes different approaches to the delivery of growth within Merton, including in terms of the borough's overall housing target.
- c. Significant changes to accommodation need figures including those relating to the Traveller community.
- d. Economic factors which may restrict the ability of developers or public bodies to provide affordable housing or contributions towards infrastructure that may impede the timely delivery of development of the allocated sites.
- e. Changes in the availability of public funding which might restrict the delivery of supporting infrastructure or could prevent some sites from being able to come forward for development.
- f. Technological change such as changes in building methods or the continuing advance of online retailing which will have significant implications for the future of Merton's town centres.
- g. Increase in the % of appeals where design policies are cited.

- 17.1.7. Any review (partial or full) will determine whether the Local Plan needs to be updated. If required, any update is required to be in conformity with national and regional planning policies.
- 17.1.8. The table below identifies the key monitoring indicators and targets which will monitor the effectiveness of the Local Plan in the [Authority Monitoring Report \(AMR\)](#). All indicators and targets will be subject to periodic review through the monitoring process.

Local Plan Monitoring Framework

A number of these indicators also inform national and regional reporting, including notably the Housing Delivery Test and the Infrastructure Funding Statement.

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
1. Site Allocations	a. Progress towards delivery of site within timescales.	i. Delivery within set delivery timescale	1) No identified delivery progress within 5 years of the start of the site deliverability period.	a) Council to consider the reasons for non-delivery and take action where appropriate. b) Actions could include: dialogue with landowners to support delivery, support dialogue with potential delivery partners, site specific design briefs, local design codes, supplementary planning documents, engagement with potential funding sources and site promoters (e.g. GLA, SiteMatch).	All site Allocations

2. Growth / Opportunity Areas (as identified in Local Plan)	a. Number of new homes built within Merton's Opportunity Area (OA) as set out in Chapter 1: Growth Strategy). b. Amount of non-residential floor space built within the OA.	a.(i) London Plan indicative target (up to 2041) to deliver 5,000 new homes and 6,000 jobs (indicative figure). a.(ii) Cumulative housing completions since OA designation. b.(i) Cumulative non-residential floorspace approvals and completions since OA designation.	1) Annual decrease in net new homes in identified Opportunity Area over a three-year rolling period following adoption of the Local Plan. 2) Annual decrease in non-residential floorspace delivered in the identified growth area over a three-year rolling period following adoption of the Local Plan.	a) Council to consider the reasons for reduced delivery of homes, and non-residential in the Growth / OA. b) Council to consider whether the Local Plan's Growth Strategy needs to be reviewed and/or part review or full review of the Local Plan. c) Potential actions include: working with the GLA on an Opportunity Area Planning Framework; preparing area-wide (or site-wide) design codes, masterplans or supplementary planning documents; engagement with landowners and potential delivery partners; engagement with organisations which could help unblock particular delivery constraints (e.g. Transport for London, utilities).	Chapter 1B: Growth Strategy) Neighbourhood policies: Colliers Wood: Policy N3.1 Morden: Policy N5.1 South Wimbledon: Policy N7.1 Wimbledon: Policy N9.1 Site allocations within the OA. Strategic policy EC13.1 Promoting economic growth and successful high streets Policy EC13.2 Business locations in Merton Policy TC13.5 Merton's town centres and neighbourhood parades Strategic policy IN14.1 Infrastructure
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Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
3. Air quality To reduce emissions and concentrations of harmful atmospheric pollutants, particularly in areas of poorest air quality and reduce exposure.	a. Appeals allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that would have an unacceptable impact on air quality.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed.	1) Annual increase of allowed appeals over a three-year rolling period following adoption of the Local Plan.	a) The council to consider the relevant details of the planning applications and their consideration in the appeal decision notices. b) Actions could include: reviewing Merton's Air Quality SPD 2020; Consider whether the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a full or partial review of the Local Plan.	Policy P15.10 Improving Air Quality and Minimising Pollution Policy CC2.2 Minimising Greenhouse Gas Emissions Strategic Policy O15.1 Open Space, Green Infrastructure and Nature Conservation Policy T16.3 Managing the transport impacts of development.

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
4. Biodiversity To protect and enhance Merton's biodiversity and Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest (Statutory Biodiversity Net Gain will be monitored and reported in accordance with Section 103 of The Environment Act 2021).	a. Change in extent of area identified as Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest. b. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that would have an adverse impact on Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest and did not adequately apply avoidance, mitigation and/or compensation measures. c. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that results in unacceptable harm or loss of a tree/trees and there is no reprovision and/or compensation measures.	i. No net loss of Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest. ii. Zero appeal decisions allowed.	1) Annual net decrease in extent of area over a three-year rolling period following adoption of the Local Plan. 2) Annual increase in relevant appeal decisions allowed over a three-year rolling period following adoption of the Local Plan.	a) The council to consider the relevant details of the planning applications and their consideration in the appeal decision notices. b) The council to consider actions including: producing supplementary planning documents, whether the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full review of the Local Plan.	Policy O15.3 Biodiversity and Access to Nature Policy O15.4 Protection of Trees Policy O15.5 Urban Greening Policy O15.6 Wandle Valley Regional Park

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
5. Land and soil conditions, pollutants and water quality To retain or improve land stability. To ensure new development does not harm water quality.	a. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that results in an unacceptable impact on land contamination and/or stability. b. Planning permissions granted contrary to Environment Agency advice on pollution or water quality grounds.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed. ii. No approvals by the council.	1) Annual increase in relevant allowed appeal decisions over a three-year rolling period following adoption of the Local Plan. 2) Any council approval contrary to the monitoring indicator	a) The council to consider the relevant details of the planning applications and their consideration in the appeal decision notices. b) The council to consider actions including: producing supplementary planning documents, working with partners such as the Environment Agency on additional training and guidance; whether the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full review of the Local Plan.	Policy P15.10 Improving Air Quality and Minimising Pollution

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
6. Sustainable land use and tall buildings To make the best and most efficient use of land to support sustainable patterns and forms of development, including tall buildings where appropriate.	a. Major planning permissions granted and completed. b. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on tall buildings.	i. 95% of major planning permissions started within a three-year period from the date planning permission granted. ii. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to policies on tall buildings.	1) Annual increase in allowed appeal decisions where the council refused a planning permission for tall buildings that does not meet the borough's tall building policy (D12.6) over a three-year rolling target from adoption of plan.	a) Council to consider the circumstance of the decisions that have led to the trigger and consider whether the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full Local Plan review. b) Actions could also include additional design codes or guides (which would include community engagement), supplementary planning documents, engagement with landowners.	Strategic Policy D12.1 Delivering well designed and resilient neighbourhoods. Policy D12.2 Urban Design Policy T16.5 Supporting transport infrastructure Policy D12.6 Tall buildings

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
7. Heritage (including landscape, architectural and archaeological heritage) To conserve and enhance the existing historic environment including heritage assets.	a. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on the historic environment including heritage assets. b. Number of heritage assets on Historic England's Heritage at Risk Register (not including tombstones). c. Number of statutory Listed Buildings demolished as a result of development.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to historic environment policies. ii. No increase from 2022 baseline (Heritage at Risk). iii. No statutory Listed Buildings demolished as a result of development.	1) Annual increase in relevant allowed appeal decisions over a three-year rolling period following adoption of the Local Plan. 2) No increase from 2022 baseline (Heritage at Risk) over a rolling three-year period. 3) Increase in statutory listed buildings demolished as a result of development over a rolling three-year period.	a) Council to consider the circumstance of the decision that have led to the trigger and consider whether the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full Local Plan review. b) Actions could also include engagement with statutory consultees (e.g. Historic England, Gardens Trust) and local historic groups; additional conservation area or associated guides and management plans (which include community engagement), supplementary planning documents, engagement with landowners and potential funders.	Policy D12.3 Ensuring high quality design for all developments Policy D12.5 Managing heritage assets

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
8. Flood risk management To manage the risk of flooding from all sources and improve the resilience of people and property to flooding.	a. Number of planning permissions granted (either by the council or on appeal) contrary to Environment Agency advice on flood protection and water quality. b. Number of completed SUDS incorporated in major development proposals. c. Appeal decisions contrary to officers' advice on flooding relating specifically to managing flood risk for basement and subterranean developments.	i. No planning permissions granted or appeals allowed contrary to Environment Agency advice. ii. All completed major developments incorporating SUDS in accordance with policy. iii. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to flood risk management for basement and subterranean developments.	1) Annual increase in planning permissions granted or allowed appeal decisions where the council refused a planning permission contrary to Environment Agency advice over a three-year rolling target from adoption of plan. 2) Reduction in SUDS installed in new major developments in accordance with policy year on year over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan. 3) Increase in appeal decisions allowed year on year over a rolling three-year period where the council refused planning for development basement and	a) Council to consider the circumstance of the decisions that have led to the trigger and consider whether the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full Local Plan review. b) Actions could also include revisions to Merton's Sustainable Design Guide SPD 2020; revisions to Merton's basements and subterranean development SPD; additional engagement with utilities and the Environment Agency; submitting funding bids for greater support to address flooding from all sources; revisions to Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment and local flood risk management plans.	Strategic Policy F15.7 Flood Risk Management and Sustainable Drainage Policy F15.9 Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS) Policy D12.1 Basements and subterranean design

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
			subterranean proposals that result in unacceptable flood risk.		

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
9. Climate change To help tackle climate change through reducing greenhouse gas emissions and moving towards a zero carbon Merton by 2050.	a. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on climate change. b. Average percentage improvement in operational carbon emissions against Part L of the Building Regulations. c. Number of applications achieving 100% improvement against Part L of Building Regulations on site.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to climate change policies. ii. Achieving the carbon reduction targets set out in Policy CC2.2.	1) Annual increase in allowed appeal decisions where the council refused planning permission in accordance with the relevant policies over a three-year rolling target from adoption of plan.	a) The council to consider the circumstances of the decisions that have led to the trigger. b) The council to consider whether Policy CC2.1 CC2.6 requirements need to be reviewed as part of a full or partial review of the Local Plan. c) The council to consider whether the cost of carbon needs to be reviewed. d) Other contingencies include: producing supplementary planning documents to advise on specific issues, to work with other boroughs and the GLA on updating the London Plan 2021 Energy Assessment Guidance, preparing design guides for specific topics.	Strategic Policy CC2.1 Promoting Sustainable Design to Mitigate and Adapt to Climate Change Policy CC2.2 Minimising Greenhouse Gas Emissions Policy CC2.3 Minimising Energy Use Policy CC2.4 Low Carbon Energy Policy CC2.5 Minimising Waste and Promoting a Circular Economy Policy CC2.6 Sustainable Design Standards.

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
10. Noise and vibration To minimise noise, vibration levels and disruption to people and communities.	a. Appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on noise and vibration.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to noise pollution policies.	1) Annual increase in appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission on the ground that development would have an adverse impact or does not full mitigate or reduce noise impact over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan.	a) The council to consider whether policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a full or partial review of the Local Plan. b) Other contingencies include creating a supplementary planning document for noise, updating supplementary planning document for basement and subterranean development.	Policy P15.10 Improving Air Quality and Minimising Pollution and Land stability.
11. Water consumption Ensuring that Merton has a sustainable water supply, drainage and sewerage system.	a. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on water consumption.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to water consumption.	1) Annual increase in appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission on the ground that development would have an adverse impact on sustainable water supply, drainage and sewerage system over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan.	a) The council to consider whether policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a full or partial review of the Local Plan. Other contingencies include working with utilities (e.g Thames Water) to improve guidance to developers such as via supplementary planning documents or design guides.	Policy CC2.6 Sustainable Design Standards

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
12. Open Space To protect and enhance Merton's open spaces and natural environment.	a. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on Open Space. b. Extent of the areas of deficiency in access to nature and public Open Space. c. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission relating specifically the Urban Greening Factor policy (this includes green walls and green roofs).	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to green infrastructure, Open Space and nature conservation policies. ii. No increase in the extent of the areas of deficiency in access to nature and public Open Space. iii. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to failure to meet the relevant Urban Greening Factor targets.	1) Increase in appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission that would result in net loss of Open Space and nature conservation areas over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan. 2) Increase in extent of areas of deficiency in access to nature and public Open Space as a result of planning approvals. 3) Increase in appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission for not providing any Urban Greening within major developments over a three-year rolling target from adoption of plan.	a) The council to consider whether policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a full or partial review of the Local Plan. b) Other contingencies could include: - Reviewing the councils Open Space Strategy to consider reasons for deficiency in access to Open Space and nature conservation (e.g., creating new access points to parks or improving access to existing biodiversity areas). - Improving guidance on urban greening factors either via SPDs or design guides and codes.	Strategic Policy O15.1 Open Space, Green Infrastructure and Nature Conservation Policy O15.2 Open Space and Green Infrastructure Policy O15.3 Biodiversity and Access to Nature Policy O15.5 Urban Greening

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
13. Sustainable transport To enhance connectivity for all and increase the proportion of journeys made by sustainable and active transport modes.	a. Percentage of journeys by walking, cycling and public transport. b. Number of registered electric vehicles (EV) in Merton annually. c. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission relating specifically to the failure to provide adequate EV charging points and infrastructure or failure to meet cycle parking standards or failure to provide secure, covered cycle parking and facilities in accordance with the London Plan minimum standards and Chapter 8 of the London Cycle Design Standard.	i. Increase in overall sustainable mode share based on a rolling three-year average - 73% by 2041. ii. Increase in EV vehicles registered annually towards 100%. iii. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to failure to meet adequate EV charge points or cycle parking standards.	1) Reporting identifies under performance on trajectory to meet target for overall sustainable travel mode. 2) Increase in appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to the failure to provide EV charging points on site or failure to meet cycle parking standards over a three-year rolling period from adoption of the plan. 3) Increase in appeal decisions allowed that do not provide secure cycling electric chargers and secure parking facilities including non-standard cycling provision over a three-year rolling period from adoption of the plan.	a) The council to consider whether policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a full or partial review of the Local Plan. b) Contingencies include providing design guidance on the installation of EV parking and cycle parking standards (including with the GLA and other London boroughs).	Strategic Policy T16.1 Sustainable Travel Policy T16.2 Prioritising active travel choices Policy T16.4 Parking and Low Emissions Vehicles. Policy T16.5 Supporting transport infrastructure Policy D12.2 Urban design

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
14. Health and wellbeing To facilitate and improve the health and wellbeing of the population, reduce health inequalities and deliver safer and more secure communities.	a. Delivery of healthcare facilities identified in Merton's Local Plan and Infrastructure Delivery Plan. b. Developments completed resulting in a loss or gain of sports and recreation facilities. c. Number of Health Impact Assessments (HIA) submitted in accordance with policy HW10.2: Delivering healthy places. d. Number of new hot food takeaways granted planning permission found within proposals within 400 metres of the boundaries of a primary or secondary school.	i. (Monitoring will be reported in the Health and Wellbeing Strategy annual update known as the Merton Story and added to the AMR). ii. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to the loss of sports or recreational facilities for which there is a need. iii. 100% of relevant developments required to submit a HIA in accordance with policy HW10.2. iv. No planning permission granted for a new hot food take away within the 400 metres of a school.	1) Monitoring according to timescales required by the NHS deliver their service plans. 2) Increase in appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to the loss of sports or recreational facilities for which there is a need over three year rolling period from plan's adoption. 3) 100% of HIAs submitted within a three- year period in accordance with policy HW10.2. 4) Yearly increase in new hot food take aways within 400 metres of a primary and secondary school permitted over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan.	a) The council to consider the circumstances surrounding under-delivery and whether the policy requirements need to be review as part of a partial or full review of the Plan. b) Other contingencies include working with Sport England, sport governing bodies and the NHS in providing sports and recreation, other services, considering support for health and wellbeing services (e.g., via Community Infrastructure Levy; providing design codes and guides or supplementary planning documents to support sports, recreation and healthy places, improving access to the Healthy Catering Commitment	Strategic Policy HW10.1 Health (including mental health) and Wellbeing. Policy HW10.2: Delivering healthy places Policy TC13.8 Food and drink / leisure and entertainment Policy IN14.3 Sport and Recreation

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
15. Housing To provide type, quality and tenure of housing (including specialist and affordable provision) to better meet Merton's demographic changes and local housing demand.	a. Appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's housing policies. b. Number of net additional homes granted planning permission. c. Number of net additional homes completed. d. Progress against borough wide affordable housing targets. e. Number of Gypsy and Traveller pitches permitted. f. Updated needs assessment for Gypsies and Travellers.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to housing policies. ii. 12,376 homes for the Plan period 2021/22 - 2037/38. iii. 50% of new homes borough-wide to be affordable across the plan period. Of affordable homes, 70% to be low-cost rent and 30% to be intermediate tenure. iv. No net loss of pitches. v. Up-to-date assessment of Gypsy and Traveller needs to be completed in 2025.	1) Increase in appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission – over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan. 2) Housing completions fall more than 20% below the Local plan target in any rolling three-year period. 3) Meeting the targets in the Housing Delivery Test. 4) Affordable housing completions do not reach the statutory targets over a rolling five-year period. 5) The council to consider the impact on the Local Plan of the Mayor of London's Gypsies and Travellers Accommodation	a) The council will explore the circumstances behind under-delivery, the barriers and constraints to housing delivery and consider how these can be resolved. b) The council to consider whether the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full review of the Plan. c) The council to review whether Traveller accommodation assessments find that needs have significantly changed, which would trigger a partial update of the Plan. d) Other contingencies include undertaking the actions set out in housing delivery test action plans, such as encouraging development to optimise	Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing choice Strategic Policy H11.2 Housing Provision Policy H11.3 Housing mix Policy H11.4 Supported care housing for vulnerable people or secure residential institutions for people housed as part of the criminal justice system. Policy No. H11.5 Student housing, other housing with shared facilities and bedsits H11.6 Accommodation for Gypsies and Travellers

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
			Assessment Study which is scheduled for publication in 2024 and any further locally specific assessment that may be required as a result of Policy H11.6.	site density and where appropriate prepare site development briefs design guides etc building on Merton's Small Sites Toolkit and Borough Character Study; Investigate the barriers and constraints to housing delivery by engaging with developers/ agents of sites where it appears that construction activity has not started or stalled; engage with Housing Associations, funders (e.g. GLA) and developers to optimise affordable housing delivery, work with Clarion on pitch delivery and maintenance for Travellers.	

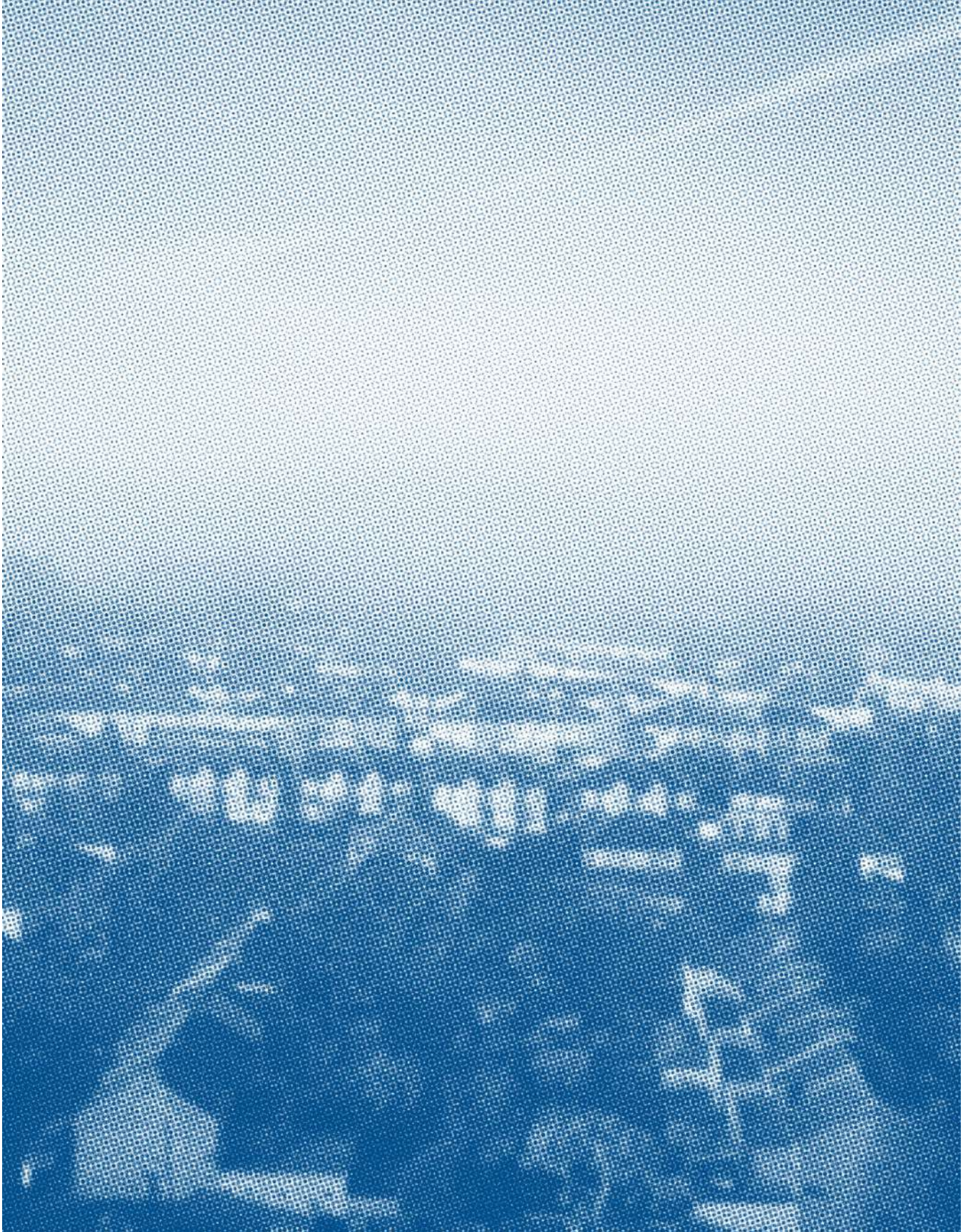
Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
16. Safe environments To contribute to safe and secure environments for all people including people with Protected Characteristics.	a. Appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on safe environments.	i. Zero appeals allowed contrary to the advice of the Metropolitan Police Designing Out Crime Officer.	1) Increase in appeal decisions allowed over a three-year period from adoption of the plan where the council refused planning permission for major developments that do not adequately meet design and place shaping principles.	a) The council to consider the circumstances behind under-delivery. b) Contingencies include whether the policy requirements need to be review as part of a partial or full review of the Plan; producing design guides or codes to support developers in enhancing the safety of existing environments.	Strategic Policy D12.1 Delivering well designed and resilient neighbourhoods. Policy D12.2 Urban design Policy D12.3 Ensuring high quality design for all developments Policy HW10.2 Delivering healthy places. Strategic Policy T16.1 Sustainable Travel.

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
17. Infrastructure To ensure that environmental, social and physical infrastructure is managed and delivered to support demographic change.	a. Delivery of infrastructure projects identified in the Infrastructure Delivery Plan (short, medium and long term as identified in the IDP).	i. Number of infrastructure projects delivered in each rolling five years of the plan period to meet need.	1) Phasing of key infrastructure not being delivered in accordance with need.	a) Council to consider whether there are any obstacles to the delivery of infrastructure in the first 5 years and later years of the Plan, through annual reviews. b) Contingencies include supporting the delivery of necessary infrastructure via Community Infrastructure Levy, considering co-location of public sector services if that helps viability (e.g. support by One Public Estate.	Policy IN14.2 Social and community infrastructure
18. Design To create attractive, mixed-use neighbourhoods, ensuring new buildings and spaces are appropriately designed and accessible, which promote and enhance a sense	a. Appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's urban design policies.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to design policies.	1) Increase in appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission that was contrary to the council's urban design policies over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan.	a) The council to consider the circumstances of the decision that have led to the trigger for action. b) Contingency measures include: - Creating local design guides and codes (including to address specific trigger issues) taking account of the National Model	Strategic Policy D12.1 Delivering well designed and resilient neighbourhood Policy D12.2 Urban design Policy D12.3 Ensuring high quality design for all developments

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
of place and distinctiveness.				Design Code and Guides. - Creating new site-specific planning briefs or supplementary planning documents. - Revising existing SPDs such as Merton's Borough Character Study, Merton's Small Sites SPD, Merton's Shopfront guide, Merton's sustainable drainage SPD. - (all of the above incorporate community engagement).	Policy D12.4 Alterations and extensions to existing buildings Policy D12.5 Managing heritage assets Policy D12.6 Tall buildings Policy D12.7 Advertisements Policy D12.8 Digital infrastructure Policy D12.9 Shop front design and signage Policy D12.10 Dwelling Conversions

Topic	Monitoring indicator	Target (if applicable)	Trigger for action	Contingency for each topic area	Local Plan policy
19. Education and skills and local employment To ensure the education and skills provision meets the needs of Merton residents, existing and future labour market and improves life chances for all.	a. Number of school places meets pupil needs. b. Number of Employment and Training Strategies offering local employment and apprenticeships as part of developments of over 150 homes / 10,000 sqm non-residential floorspace.	i. Delivery of necessary school places to meet needs. ii. All developments of over 150 homes / 10,000sqm non-residential floorspace to provide Employment Strategies including employment and/or training opportunities for local people.	1) Failure to provide new school places to meet identified pupil place needs over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan. 2) Failure of developments of over 150 homes / 10,000sqm non-residential floorspace to provide employment strategies.	a) Council to consider the circumstances of the decision that have led to a trigger. b) Contingencies include working with Dept for Education on creating and supporting appropriate school places to meet needs, supporting the creation of school places and facilities with Community Infrastructure Levy; council to consider whether a review of the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full review of the Plan.	Policy IN14.2 Social and community infrastructure Policy TC13.9 Culture, arts and tourism development Policy EC13.3 Protection of scattered employment sites

20. Economic growth and town centres To ensure the vitality and viability of existing town centres, local centres and parades. To ensure a sufficient supply of premises to meet demand for industry, logistics and services.	a. Appeal decisions allowed, where the council refused planning permission for development that is contrary to the council's policies on town centres and economic development. b. Extent of Strategic Industrial Locations c. Annual review of shopfront vacancy rate in Merton's town centres.	i. Zero appeal decisions allowed relating specifically to town centre and economic development policies. ii. No net loss of Strategic Industrial Locations.	1) Increase in appeal decisions allowed where the council refused planning permission that was contrary to the council's town centre and economic development policies over a three-year rolling period from adoption of plan. 2) Net loss of Strategic Industrial Locations over a three-year rolling period from adoption of the plan.	a) Council to consider the circumstances of the decision that have led to a trigger. b) Contingencies include consider the results of the annual review of shopfront vacancy in Merton's town centres and designated parades, support increased footfall and economic activity in town centres through supporting and hosting events, managing markets and liaising with businesses, work with partners such as Merton Chamber of Commerce, Business Improvement Districts and South London Partnership on programmes to promote businesses and jobs. c) Council to consider whether a review of the policy requirements need to be reviewed as part of a partial or full review of the Plan.	Strategic policy EC13.1 Promoting economic growth and successful high streets Policy EC13.2 Business locations in Merton. Policy EC13.3 Protection of scattered employment sites Policy TC13.5 Merton's town centres and neighbourhood parades Policy TC13.6 Development of town centre type uses outside town centres. Policy TC13.7 Protecting corner / local shops. TC13.9 Culture, arts and tourism development
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Chapter 18. **Appendices**

Appendix 1

A. Open Space

These open spaces are illustrated on the Policies Map.

Metropolitan Open Land (MOL)

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
1	Cannon Hill	Morden
2	Wimbledon Park	Wimbledon
3	Lower Morden	Morden
4	Beverly Brook/A3	Raynes Park
5	Copse Hill	Wimbledon
12	Wimbledon Common	Wimbledon
14	Mitcham Common	Mitcham
16	Morden Park	Morden
18	Wandle Valley	Morden

Open Space - Allotments and Farms

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
A001	Western Road Allotments	Mitcham
A002	Martin Way East Allotments	Morden
A003	Eastfields Road Allotments	Mitcham
A004	New Barnes Avenue Allotments	Mitcham
A005	Thurleston Avenue Allotments	Morden
A006	Eveline Road Allotments	Mitcham
A007	Effra Road Allotments	Wimbledon
A008	George Hill, Holne Chase Allotments	Morden
A009	Ridge Road Allotments	Mitcham
A010	Cottenham Park Allotments	Wimbledon
A011	Martin Way West Allotments	Morden
A012	Cannon Hill Common Allotments	Morden
A013	Arthur Road Allotments, New Malden	Raynes Park
A014	Tamworth Farm Allotments, Rose Avenue	Mitcham
A015	Phipps Bridge Allotments	Mitcham
A016	Durnsford Road Allotments, Gap Road	Wimbledon
A017	Haslemere Avenue Allotments	Wimbledon
A018	Cannizaro Park Allotments	Wimbledon
A019	Brooklands Avenue Allotments	Wimbledon
A020	Havelock Road Allotments	Wimbledon
A021	Mary Tate Almshouses Allotments	Mitcham
F001	Deen City Farm	South Wimbledon

Open Space - Churchyards and Cemeteries

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
C001	Buddhapadipa Temple Grounds	Wimbledon
C002	St Mary's Church, Wimbledon	Wimbledon
C003	Merton & Sutton Joint Cemetery	Morden
C004	Streatham Park Cemetery	Mitcham
C005	London Road/Victoria Road Cemetery	Mitcham
C006	Gap Road (Wimbledon) Cemetery	Wimbledon
C007	Morden Cemetery	Morden
C008	Mitcham Parish Church	Mitcham
C009	St Marys Churchyard, Merton Park	Morden

Open Space – Education

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
S001	Ricards Lodge	Wimbledon
S002	Kings College School Playing Field	Wimbledon
S003	Farm Road Playing Fields	Morden
S004	Harris Academy Morden	Morden
S005	Wimbledon Chase Primary School	Wimbledon
S006	Cranmer Primary	Mitcham
S007	Abbotsbury Primary School	Morden
S008	Raynes Park High School	Raynes Park
S009	Wimbledon High School Sports Ground	Wimbledon
S010	Hillcross Primary School	Morden
S011	Wimbledon College	Wimbledon
S012	Bond Primary School	Mitcham

S013	Haslemere Primary School	Mitcham
S014	Cricket Green School	Mitcham
S015	Harris Primary Academy	Mitcham
S016	Malmesbury Primary School	Morden
S017	Merton Abbey Primary and Harris Wimbledon Academy	South Wimbledon
S018	Benedict Academy Primary School	Mitcham
S021	Priory Church Of England	Wimbledon
S022	Beecholme School	Mitcham
S023	Wimbledon College Sports Ground	Raynes Park
S025	St John Fisher School	Raynes Park
S027	Kings College School Sports Ground	Raynes Park
S028	Aragon Primary School	Morden
S029	Hatfield Primary School	Morden
S030	Poplar School	Morden
S031	Rutlish High School	Morden
S032	Harris Academy Merton	Mitcham
S033	St Marks Church of England Academy	Mitcham
S035	Holy Trinity Primary School	Wimbledon
S036	St Thomas of Canterbury Catholic Primary School	Mitcham
S037	Liberty Primary School	Mitcham
S038	St Teresa's Primary School	Morden
S040	Garfield School	Colliers Wood
S041	Lonesome Primary	Mitcham
S042	Morden Primary School	Morden
S043	West Wimbledon Primary	Raynes Park
S044	Emmanuel School Playing Fields	Raynes Park
S045	St Matthew's Church of England Primary School	Raynes Park

S046	Wimbledon Park Primary School	Wimbledon
S048	Wimbledon College Prep Donhead	Wimbledon
S049	The Norwegian School Playing Fields	Raynes Park
S053	Melrose School	Mitcham
S054	St Marks Primary School	Mitcham
S055	Perseid Upper School	Morden
S058	Sacred Heart Catholic Primary School	Raynes Park
S060	Gorringe Park Primary School Playing Fields, Sandy Lane	Mitcham
S063	Merton Park Primary School, Church Lane	Morden
S064	All Saints C of E Primary School, East Road	Colliers Wood
S066	SS Peter and Paul RC Primary, Cricket Green	Mitcham

Open space - All other open spaces

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
CG001	Thompsons Nursery, Motspur Park	Raynes Park
M001	Morden Hall Park	Morden
M002	Figge's March	Mitcham
M003	Three Kings Piece	Mitcham
M004	London Road Playing Fields	Mitcham
M005	Wandle Park	Colliers Wood
M006	Dundonald Recreation Ground	Wimbledon
M007	Cranmer Green	Mitcham
M008	Moreton Green	Morden
M009	Lavender Park	Colliers Wood
M010	Durnsford Road Recreation Ground	Wimbledon
M011	Haydons Road Recreation Ground	Wimbledon
M012	Colliers Wood Recreation Ground	Colliers Wood

M013	Cottenham Park	Raynes Park
M014	Donnelly Green, Pollard Hill Estate	Mitcham
M015	Myrna Close Open Space	Colliers Wood
M016	John Innes Park	Morden
M017	South Park Gardens	Wimbledon
M018	Cherry Tree Estate Open Space	Mitcham
M019	Cherrywood Open Space	Morden
M020	Brenley Park	Mitcham
M021	Lyndhurst Recreation Ground	Mitcham
M022	Holland Gardens	Raynes Park
M023	Sherwood Park Road	Mitcham
M024	Kendor Gardens	Morden
M025	Vestry Hall Green	Mitcham
M026	Rowan Road Recreation Ground	Mitcham
M027	Church Lane Playing Fields	Morden
M028	Lynmouth Gardens	Morden
M029	Deer Park Gardens	Mitcham
M030	Lewis Road Recreation Ground	Mitcham
M031	Moreton Green	Morden
M032	Miles Road Open Space	Mitcham
M033	Upper Green (also known as Fair Green)	Mitcham
M034	All Saints Recreation Ground	Colliers Wood
M035	Nelson Gardens	Colliers Wood
M036	Margin Drive Open Space	Wimbledon
M037	Vectis Gardens	Mitcham
M038	Poplar Court Open Space	Wimbledon
M039	Rock Terrace Recreation Ground	Mitcham

M040	Oakleigh Way Recreation Ground	Mitcham
M043	Crooked Billet Open Space	Wimbledon
M044	Wimbledon Common (excluding Royal Wimbledon Golf Course)	Wimbledon
M046	Raynes Park Sports Ground	Raynes Park
M047	Cannon Hill Common	Morden
M048	Sir Joseph Hood Memorial Playing fields	Raynes Park
M049	King Georges Field	Morden
M050	Morden Park	Morden
M051	Mostyn Gardens	Morden
M052	John Innes Recreation Ground	Morden
M053	Ravensbury Park	Mitcham
M054	Cricket Green	Mitcham
M055	Police Green	Mitcham
M056	Mitcham Common	Mitcham
M057	Mitcham Sports Ground	Mitcham
M058	The Canons	Mitcham
M059	Pollards Hill Open Space	Mitcham
M060	Long Bolstead Recreation Ground	Mitcham
M061	Tamworth Farm Recreation Ground	Mitcham
M062	Abbey Recreation Ground	South Wimbledon
M063	Garfield Road Recreation Ground	Colliers Wood
M064	Land Adjacent River Wandle	Colliers Wood
M066	Morden Recreation Ground	Morden
M067	Edenvale Play Area	Mitcham
M068	Wandle Meadow Nature Park	Colliers Wood
M069	St Mary's Church field, Merton Park	Morden
M070	Robinhood Close Open Space	Mitcham

M071	Watermeads	Morden
M072	Joseph Hood Recreation Ground	Morden
M074	Merton & Sutton Joint Cemetery Surrounds	Morden
M075	St Mary's Chuchyard	Wimbledon
M076	Rowan Park	Mitcham
M077	Wimbledon Park	Wimbledon
M078	Land adjacent to River Wandle, Weir Road	Wimbledon
M079	Alfreton Close Corner Park	Wimbledon
M080	Welford Park and Path	Wimbledon
M081	Gap Road Park	Wimbledon
M082	Herbert Road Park	Wimbledon
M083	St Mark's Church	Wimbledon
M084	Edge Hill Court North	Wimbledon
M085	Edge Hill Court South	Wimbledon
M086	All Saints Road Open Space	Wimbledon
M087	Bushey Court Park	Raynes Park
M088	Three Kings Piece Pond and Open Space	Mitcham
M089	Marlowe Square Open Space	Mitcham
M090	Recreation Way Open Space	Mitcham
M091	Crossway Open Space	Raynes Park
M092	Trafalgar Garden	Colliers Wood
M093	Hamilton Gardens Open Space	Colliers Wood
M094	Hardy Gardens Open Space	Colliers Wood
M095	Caesars Walk Open Space	Mitcham
M096	Central Ward Residents Club	Morden
M097	Haynt Walk Open Space	Morden
M098	Botsford Road Open Space	Morden

M100	The Precincts Haig Homes Open Space, Green Lane	Morden
M101	St Helier Avenue Open Space	Morden
M102	Home Park Road Open Space	Wimbledon
M0103	Hertford Way Open Space	Mitcham
M0104	Wimbledon War Memorial	Wimbledon
M0105	Dennis Park Crescent Open Space	Wimbledon
M0106	Stanford Road Play Space	Mitcham
M0107	Land rear of Stanford Primary School	Mitcham
M0108	Seymour Road Park	Wimbledon
P001a	Natwest Sports Ground	Mitcham
P001b	Chilmark Road Open Space	Mitcham
P002	Raynes Park Playing Fields	Morden
P004	Raynes Park High School Sports Ground	Raynes Park
P005	Malden Golf Course	Raynes Park
P006	LESSA Sports Ground, Meadowview Road	Raynes Park
P007	Playing Field Wimbledon College	Raynes Park
P008	The Old Rutlishians Sports Club	Morden
P009	West Side Lawn Tennis Club	Wimbledon
P010	Queensmere Road Tennis Courts	Wimbledon
P012	Wilton Grove Tennis Club	Wimbledon
P014	Raynes Park Lawn Tennis Club	Raynes Park
P015	West Wimbledon Bowling Club	Raynes Park
P017	Royal Wimbledon Golf Club, Camp Road	Wimbledon
P018	Morley Park	Raynes Park
P020	Old Wimbledonians Sports Ground	Raynes Park

P021	Beverley Park Golf Range	Raynes Park
P022	Prince Georges Fields	Morden
P023	Messines Playing Fields	Morden
P024	Old Tenisonians Sports Ground	Raynes Park
P025	Morden Park Playing Fields	Morden
P026	Cranleigh Lawn Tennis Club	Morden
P027	Nursery Road Playing Fields	South Wimbledon
P028	Tooting & Mitcham Imperial Sports Ground	Mitcham
P030	Westminster City School Playing Fields	Mitcham
P033	Kings College School Sports Ground	Raynes Park
P034	The David Lloyd Club	Raynes Park
P035	All England Lawn Tennis Club	Wimbledon
P036	Former St Catherine's Playing Fields	Raynes Park
P037	BMX track	Mitcham
P038	Southey Bowling Club	Raynes Park
P039	Goals Wimbledon	Raynes Park
W001	George Hill Open Space and Pyl Brook Nature Reserve	Morden
W002	Priory Wall Open Space Walk, Priory Road	Colliers Wood
W003	Land Along Wandle River	Wimbledon
W004	River Wandle riverside walk (also known as Bennett's Hole)	Mitcham
W005	Land adjacent River Wandle	South Wimbledon
W006	Merton Park Green Walk	South Wimbledon
W007	Rookwood Open Space, Rookwood Avenue	Raynes Park

B. Nature Conservation

These areas of SSSI, SINC, and Local Nature Reserves are illustrated on the Policies Map.

Sites of Special Scientific Interest ('European Sites') and Special Areas of Conservation (SAC)

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
SSSI and SAC	Wimbledon Common	Wimbledon

Sites of Metropolitan Importance for Nature Conservation

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
M093	Mitcham Common	Mitcham
M136	Morden Cemetery	Morden
M091	The Upper River Wandle	Morden
M101	Wimbledon Common and Putney Heath	Wimbledon

Sites of Borough (Grade 1) Importance for Nature Conservation

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
01	Morden Hall Park and Deen City Farm	Morden
02	Wimbledon Park – Merton section	Wimbledon
03	Royal Wimbledon Golf Course south	Wimbledon
04	Wandle Trail Nature Park and the Lower River Wandle	Colliers Wood
05	Sir Joseph Hood Memorial Wood	Raynes Park
06	Worcester Park Green Lanes	Morden
07	Malden Golf Course and TWU Pipe Track	Raynes Park
08	Cannizaro Park	Wimbledon
09	Morley Park Woodland	Wimbledon
10	Cannon Hill Common	Morden
11	Morden Park	Morden

Sites of Borough (Grade 2) Importance for Nature Conservation

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
01A	Streatham Junction to Wimbledon Railsides	Colliers Wood
01B	East Wimbledon Railsides	Wimbledon
01C	District line through Wimbledon	Wimbledon
01D	Wimbledon to Dundonald Road Tramlink	Wimbledon
01E	Railsides west of Wimbledon station	Raynes Park
01F	Sutton Line south of Wimbledon	Wimbledon
02	Derwent Road Floodwash	Morden

03	Lower Pyl Brook	Morden
04	Pyl Brook Nature Reserve	Morden
05	Beverly Brook in Merton	Raynes Park
06	Oakleigh Way Nature Area	Mitcham
08	Cherrywood	Morden
09	Abbotsbury School Meadowlands	Morden
10	Myrna Close Valley	Colliers Wood
11	Budhhapadipa Temple Grounds	Wimbledon
12	Merton Park Green Walks	Morden
13	Prince Georges Playing Field	Raynes Park
14	Coombe Wood	Wimbledon
15	Ravensbury Park	Mitcham
16	Durnsford Wetland	Wimbledon
17	St Peter and St Paul Churchyard	Mitcham
18	Wandle Park	Colliers Wood
19	London Road Playing Fields	Mitcham

Sites of Local Importance for Nature Conservation

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
01	Ricards Lodge High School	Wimbledon
03	Church Lane Playing Fields	Morden
04	St Mary's Churchyard and Glebe Fields	Morden
05	Poplar First School Nature Area	Morden
06	Eltandia Hall Nature Area	Mitcham
08	Morden Recreation Ground Spinney	Morden
09	Moreton Green	Morden
10	Three Kings Pond and Commonsides Rough	Mitcham
11	Cranmer Green Meadow and Pond	Mitcham
12	Liberty Primary School Conservation	Mitcham
13	The Chase	Wimbledon
14	St Mary's RC Primary School Nature Garden	Wimbledon
16	St Mary's Churchyard	Wimbledon
18	Canons Pond	Mitcham
19	Raynes Park Sports Ground Wildlife Area	Raynes Park
20	Pyl Brook by Garth Road	Morden
21	St Laurence's Churchyard	Morden
22	Haig Homes Estate	Morden
23	Woodmansterne Nature Reserve	Mitcham
24	Bellamy Copse	Mitcham

Local Nature Reserves

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
01	Bennett's Hole	Mitcham
02	Cannon Hill Common	Raynes Park
03	Cherry Wood	Morden
04	Cranmer Green	Mitcham
05	Derwent Floodwash (proposed)	Morden
06	Fishponds Wood/ Beverley Meads	Wimbledon
07	Lower Wandle	Wimbledon
08	Merton Green Walks	Morden
09	Morden Park	Morden
10	Myrna Close	Colliers Wood
11	Oakleigh Way	Mitcham
12	Pyl Brook	Morden
13	Ravensbury Park	Mitcham
14	Sir Joseph Hood Memorial Wood	Raynes Park
15	Wandle Meadow Nature Park	Colliers Wood

Green Corridors

These Green Corridors are illustrated on the Policies Map.

Site	Name	Neighbourhood
GC01	Beverley Park	Raynes Park
GC04	Merton Park Railsides	Morden
GC05	Mitcham Common	Mitcham
GC06	Cricket Green & The Canons Recreation Ground	Mitcham
GC08	Mitcham Sports Ground	Mitcham
GC09	Morden Cemetery	Morden
GC10	Morden Park and surrounds	Morden
GC12	Mostyn Gardens	Morden
GC13	Phipps Bridge and London Road Playing Fields	Mitcham
GC14	Ravensbury Park	Mitcham
GC15	Raynes Park High School	Raynes Park
GC16	Raynes Park Railsides	Raynes Park
GC17	Raynes Park Railsides to Motspur Park	Raynes Park
GC18	Ricards Lodge	Wimbledon
GC19	Ridge Road to Wimbledon Park	Wimbledon
GC22	Wimbledon Common	Wimbledon
GC23	Wimbledon Park	Wimbledon
GC24	Wimbledon Railsides	Wimbledon

C. Metropolitan Open Land (MOL) – boundary amendments and exceptional circumstances

1. The following pages set out details of all the boundary amendments to Metropolitan Open Land (MOL), in accordance with national policy (NPPF 2021 para 140) and London Plan 2021 (Policy G3).
2. Relevant policies for MOL are set out in Chapter 15 (Strategic Policy O15.1 and Policy O15.2).
3. The new boundaries of all MOL sites are illustrated on the Policies Map.

MOL-01 – Cannon Hill

Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. Cannon Hill MOL is located on the border of the Morden and Raynes Park Neighbourhoods. It includes Cannon Hill Common, Joseph Hood Recreation Ground, Martin Way Allotments and a number of sport and recreation facilities.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – Bushey Road,
 - East – The David Lloyd building footprint, fencing and rear of residential properties surrounding Martin Way Allotments and Joseph Hood Recreation Ground.
 - South – Cannon Hill Lane, Parkway and the fenced rear boundaries of residential properties.
 - West – Fenced rear boundaries of residential properties facing Grand Drive to the west.

Description of MOL boundary change (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. To realign the MOL boundary with the current building line, which has changed through approved planning applications since the 2014 Sites and Policies Map was adopted. This boundary amendment is made to accurately reflect what is built on site, namely the outline of the David Lloyd building along with associated entrances and exits to the outdoor sporting features, fencing to the north and landscaping to the east.
4. The remainder of the site continues to meet the MOL criteria 1, 2 and 3 from the London Plan and maintains openness as detailed in the NPPF.
5. There would be no harm to the wider MOL function through the removal of this building. In fact, the building itself is deemed to harm the openness of wider the Cannon Hill MOL. Relevant Planning Application: 19/P3979.
6. This boundary change results in an addition of 0.54ha MOL (from 55.25ha to 55.79ha), which is a 0.98% change.

Map illustrating boundary change:



MOL-03 – Lower Morden

Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. The Lower Morden MOL is located within the Morden Neighbourhood.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – fenced residential properties on both sides of Arthur Road, along Marina Avenue, Tennyson Avenue, Westway and Meadowsweet Close.
 - East – Grand Drive, fenced residential properties off St Catherine's Close, Derwent Road, Coniston Close and Buttermere Close, Eveline Day Nursery, St John Fisher Primary School and Lower Morden Lane.
 - South – Garth Road, landscaped edge of Morden and Sutton Joint Cemetery abutting built form of adjoining industrial area.
 - West – the western boundary primarily follows the pedestrian walkways which provide a link from Trafalgar Avenue, along the rear of the industrial area, cemetery and equestrian centre, up and around Sir Joseph Hood Memorial Playing Fields, along the Beverley Brook. It should be noted that this also forms the borough boundary with LB Sutton.

Description of MOL boundary changes (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. There are four separate boundary changes:
 - a. Land off Meadowsweet Close. A minor amendment is proposed to realign the MOL boundary with the current building line which has changed since the 2014 Policies Map was adopted. The site is physically and visually separated, with a nursery building, outdoor play area and site boundary fence offering no connections to the MOL.
 - b. Correction to cartographic boundary error near Eveline Day Nursery & St Catherine's Close.
 - c. Land off Buttermere Close. A minor boundary amendment is proposed to realign the MOL boundary and remove a residential carpark. The carpark is ancillary to the adjoining residential units and is not linked to the cemetery. It does not contribute to the openness of the Lower Morden MOL. This appears to be an error in the 2014 Policies Map.
 - d. Proposed boundary amendments to remove four houses next to the cemetery from Lower Morden MOL. This is an error from the 2014 Policies Map. While the houses are directly adjacent to the cemetery, they are freehold properties separately owned and are not related to the cemetery. They do not contribute to the openness of the MOL.
4. These boundary changes represent a reduction of 0.2ha (from 81ha to 80.8ha), which is a 0.25% change.

MOL-04 – Beverley Brook / A3

Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. The Beverley Brook/A3 MOL is located within the Raynes Park Neighbourhood. It includes several sports & recreation grounds and part of the Malden Golf Course.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – Fenced residential properties off Somerset Avenue, Camberley Avenue, Coombe Lane, Coombe Gardens and Beverley Way.
 - East – The A3, fenced residential properties off Aboyne Drive and Taunton Avenue.
 - South – The built form of the adjoining industrial area and the landscaped edge of the overground railway line.
 - West – The A3 and the Beverley Brook, which also forms the borough boundary with LB Kingston.

Description of MOL boundary change (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. This part of the site appears to have been included as MOL in error in the 2014 Sites and Policies Plan. It does not meet the MOL criteria set out in the London Plan and is therefore recommended to be removed. The site is privately owned, is physically separated from the adjoining MOL, does not offer sports, leisure, recreation, art or cultural activities and does not contain features or landscapes of a national or metropolitan value.
4. These boundary changes represent a reduction of 0.02ha (from 28.96ha to 28.94ha), which is a 0.07% change.

Map illustrating boundary change:



MOL-05 – Copse Hill

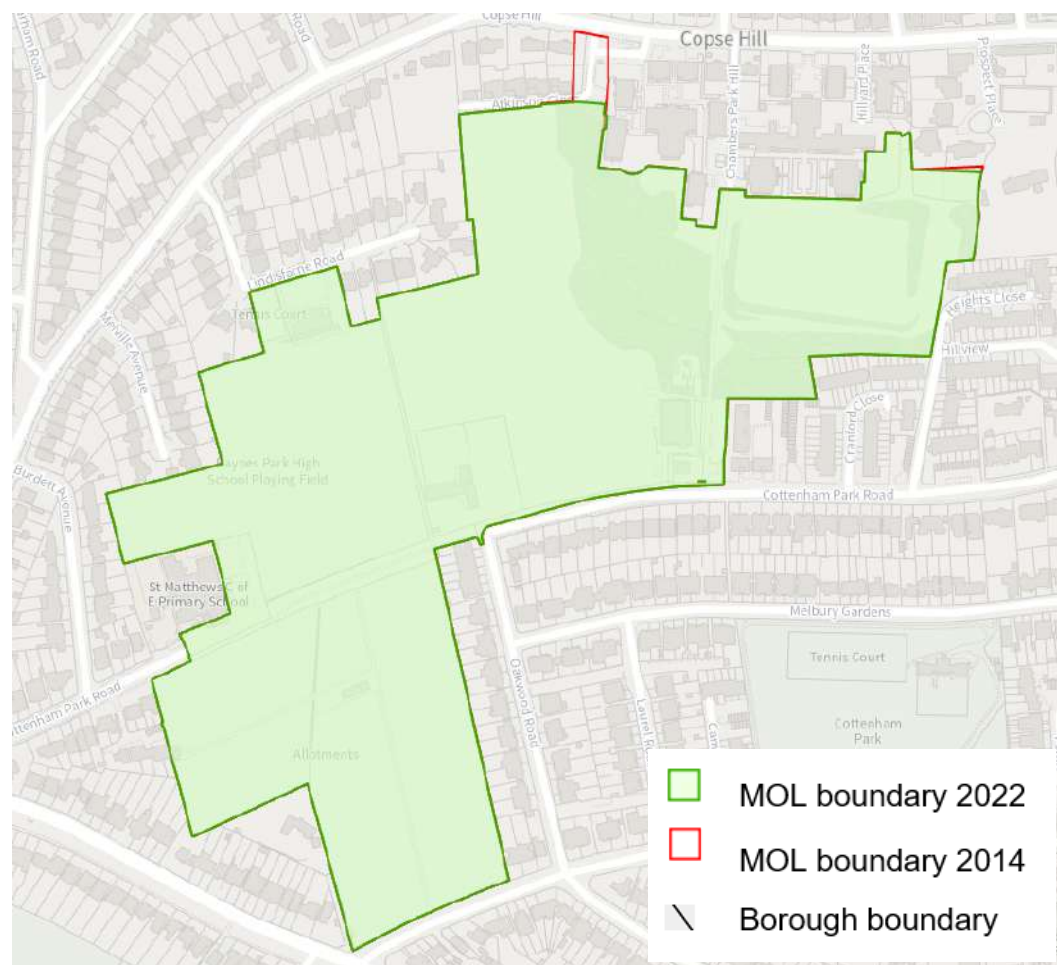
Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. The Copse Hill MOL is located within the Wimbledon Neighbourhood. It includes Morley Park and other green spaces around the Atkinson Morley residential development.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – Built form at Atkinson Morley and the former Wolfson Rehabilitation Centre.
 - East – Fenced residential properties off Heights Close, Cottenham Place and Prospect Place.
 - South – Cottenham Park Road.
 - West – Primary School and fenced residential properties off Melville Avenue and Burdett Avenue.

Description of MOL boundary change (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. Boundary changes are proposed to reflect the approved planning applications and new built form for this site. The built form of the new developments at Atkinson Morley and the former Wolfson Rehabilitation Centre set the physical boundaries of the northern edge of this MOL. Relevant planning applications: 13/P2722 and 16/P4853.
4. These boundary changes represent a reduction of 0.1ha (from 16.1ha to 16ha), which is a 0.62% change.

Map illustrating boundary change:



MOL-12 – Wimbledon Common

Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. The Wimbledon Common MOL is located within the Wimbledon Neighbourhood. It includes the Royal Wimbledon Golf Club, Wimbledon Common, and various sports, leisure and recreation facilities.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – Borough boundary with LB Wandsworth.
 - East – The A219.
 - South – Southside Common and fenced residential properties.
 - West – The A3.

Description of MOL boundary change (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. No boundary changes.

Map illustrating boundary change:

4. N/A

MOL-14 – Mitcham Common

Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. The Mitcham Common MOL is located in the Mitcham Neighbourhood. It includes Mitcham Golf Club, Mitcham Common, Cranmer Nature Reserve, and various sports, leisure and recreation facilities.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – Commonside East.
 - East – Borough boundary with LB Croydon.
 - South – Borough boundary with LB Sutton.
 - West – Railway and Tram lines, A239.

Description of MOL boundary change (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. No boundary changes.

Map illustrating boundary change:

4. N/A

MOL-16 – Morden Park

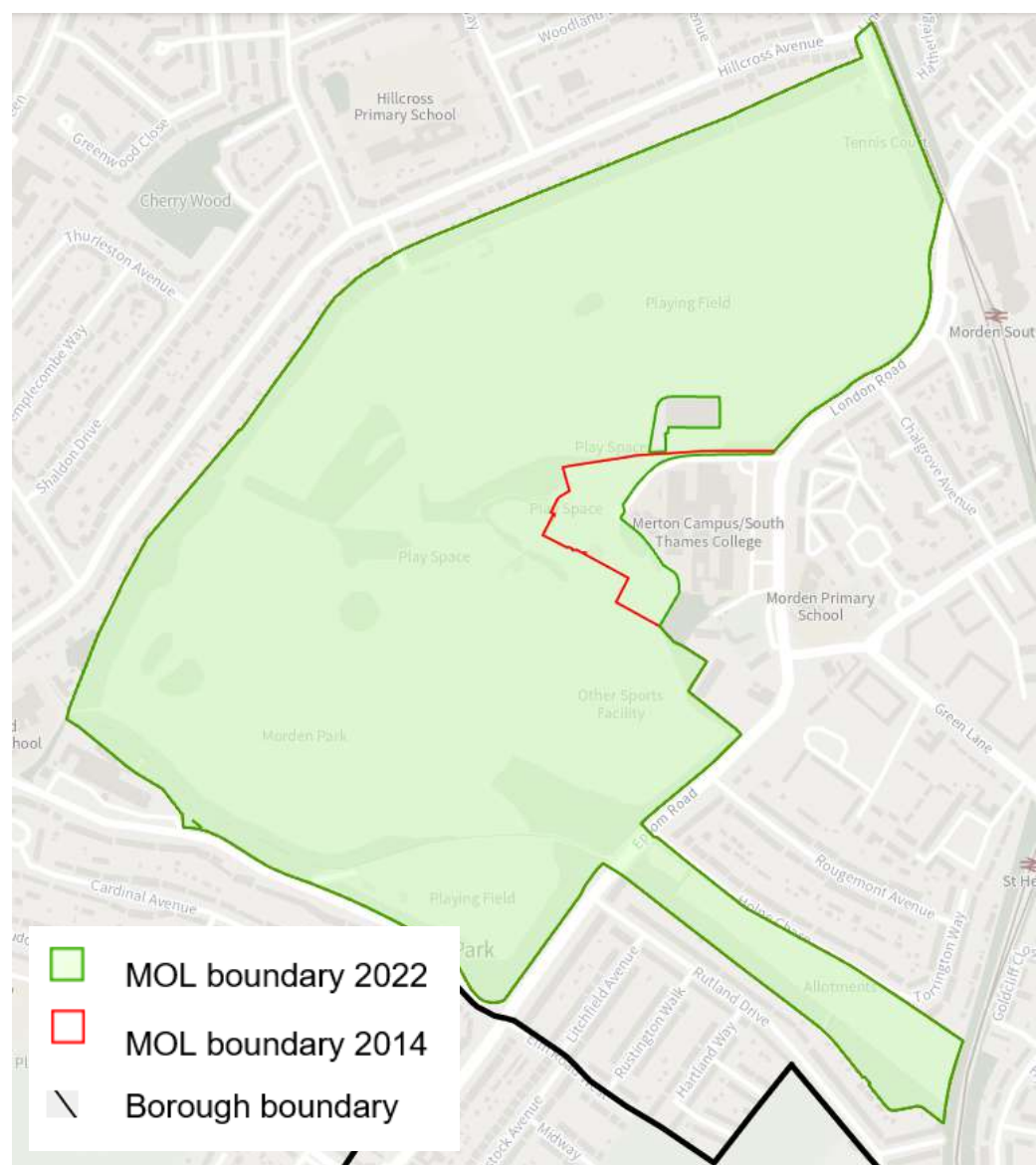
Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. The Morden Park MOL is located within the Morden Neighbourhood. It includes Morden Cricket Club, Morden Park and other recreation and leisure facilities.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – Railway line and rear fenced residential properties off Hillcross Avenue.
 - East – A24.
 - South – Lower Morden Lane.
 - West – Residential properties off Hillcross Avenue, Lower Morden Garden Centre.

Description of MOL boundary change (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. Boundary amendment to the former and new Morden Leisure Centre site and minor extension to the MOL boundary to include the adjoining carpark, play area and other ancillary features to the park. This proposed amendment is to reflect the location of the new Morden Leisure Centre, approved with a MOL land swap through a planning application and ensure all areas of Morden Park that meet the MOL criteria are included for protection. The former leisure centre building has been demolished and this area has now been restored for nature conservation purposes. Relevant planning application: 16/P0882
4. These boundary changes represent an addition of 1.56ha MOL (from 73.24ha to 74.8ha), which is a 2.13% change.

Map illustrating boundary change:



MOL-18 – Wandle Valley

Site Description (including relevant physical boundary features):

1. The Wandle Valley MOL stretches across a large area of the borough, through the Mitcham, Morden, Colliers Wood and Wimbledon Neighbourhoods.
2. The physical boundaries include:
 - North – Borough boundary with LB Wandsworth.
 - South – Borough boundary with LB Sutton.
 - East and West – The MOL follows the River Wandle and broadly encompasses the Wandle Valley Regional Park sites, which stretch across a thin corridor from north to south of the borough.

Description of MOL boundary change (including any exceptional circumstances):

3. 222 High Street, Colliers Wood. The removal of this retail property and adjacent car park is proposed and necessary to correct an error in the 2014 MOL boundary. This site does not form part of the Wandle Valley MOL corridor and is an anomaly that needs to be corrected. The built form and ancillary carpark are clearly separated from the park and do not contribute to the openness of the MOL.
4. Tooting and Mitcham Hub. As demonstrated through the approved planning application, this site meets very special circumstances and MOL is to be removed as per the granted permission and S106 agreement. The approved residential development will not contribute to the openness of the MOL and will act as a physical barrier to the surrounding area. Relevant planning application: 19/P4094
5. These boundary changes represent a reduction of 0.3ha (from 103ha to 102.7ha), which is a 0.29% change.

Maps illustrating boundary change:



- MOL boundary 2022
- MOL boundary 2014
- Borough boundary

D. Conservation Areas, Historic Parks and Gardens and Listed Buildings

Conservation Areas

Code	Name	Area (ha)	Code	Name	Area (ha)
1	Lambton Road	8.42	15	South Park Gardens	13.48
2	Dennis Park Crescent	6.89	16	Wimbledon North	137.0
3	Drax Avenue	8.61	17	Upper Morden	89.52
4	Dunmore Road	1.54	18	Vineyard Hill Road	6.88
5	Bathgate Road	11.49	19	Mitcham Cricket Green (including the Canons)	65.81 (8.4)
6	Bertram Cottages	0.60	20	Westcoombe Avenue	1.80
7	The Broadway	2.93	21	John Innes - Merton Park	31.67
8	Copse Hill	19.79	22	Merton Hall Road	6.30
9	Wimbledon Windmill	1.01	23	Wool Road	13.16
10	Wimbledon Village	7.28	24	Wimbledon West	114.71
11	John Innes - Wilton Crescent	10.41	25	Wandle Valley	101.07
12	Wimbledon Hill Road	11.27	26	Durham Road	3.92
13	Pelham Road	1.47	27	Kenilworth Avenue	2.57
14	Wimbledon Chase	3.26	28	Leopold Road	0.63

Historic Parks and Gardens

Cannizaro Park, Wimbledon	Grade II*
Wimbledon Park, Wimbledon	Grade II*
Morden Hall Park, Morden	Grade II
South Park Gardens	Grade II

E. List of Buildings of Special Architectural or Historic Interest

1. The buildings are classified in grades to show their relative importance as follows:
2. Grade I: these are buildings of exceptional interest.
3. Grade II* ("two stars"): particularly important buildings which are of more special interest.
4. Grade II: these are buildings of special interest, which warrant every effort being made to preserve them.
5. Historic England lists buildings and structures and hold the most up-to-date information on listed buildings and structures, which is available via their website:
<https://historicengland.org.uk/listing/the-list/>
6. Merton contains a rich heritage of buildings, which possess historical or architectural interest. While the most important ones are included on a separate nationally compiled or 'Statutory List', there are many others which may also be said to contribute to the local scene, or which are valued for their local historical associations. Merton's Local List can be found online:
<https://www.merton.gov.uk/planning-and-buildings/regeneration-urban-design/locally-listed-buildings>

Property	Street/ Road Name	Grade
Church of all Saints	All Saints Road, SW19	II
No. 1 (Stag Lodge)	Arthur Road, SW19	II
No. 19 (The Artesian Well)	Arthur Road, SW19	II
No. 16	Arthur Road, SW19	II
No. 157 (Butcher's Shop)	Arthur Road SW19	II
No. 7	Belvedere Drive, SW19	II
No. 1	Belvedere Drive, SW19	II
Ice House at No 1	Belvedere Drive, SW19	II
No. 12	Belvedere Drive, SW19	II
No. 14	Belvedere Drive, SW19	II
No. 4	Belvedere Square	II
No. 13	Belvedere Square	II
Nos. 5-8 (Consec.)	Belvedere Square, SW19	I
Nos. 9-12 (Consec.)	Belvedere Square, SW19	II
Nos.17-20 (Consec.)	Belvedere Square, SW19	II
Nos. 21-26 (Consec.)	Belvedere Square, SW19	II
Nos. 27-31 (Consec.)	Belvedere Square, SW19	II
Nos. 13 and 14	Berkeley Place, SW19	II
Wimbledon Theatre	The Broadway, SW19	II
Former Wimbledon Town Hall	The Broadway, SW19	II
No. 21	Calonne Road, SW19	II
Nos. 28, 30 and 32	Calonne Road, SW19	II
William Wilberforce School	Camp Road, SW19	II
Statue of Diana with Fawn	Cannizaro Park, Wimbledon, SW19	II

Old School House	Central Road, Morden	II
The Grange	Central Road, Morden	II
Colliers Wood LUL Station	Christchurch Road, Colliers Wood, SW19	II
No. 70	Christchurch Road, Colliers Wood, SW19	II
Singlegate School and Gatepiers	Christchurch Road, Colliers Wood, SW19	I
Garden Wall (4 sides) Church Field, including iron gate north of St Mary's Church	Church Lane, Merton, SW19	II
Church of St Mary	Church Path, Merton, SW19	II*
Freestanding 12C Archway	Church Path, Merton, SW19	II
Nos. 60, 62 and 64 with railings and date to No.64	Church Road, Mitcham	II
No. 66	Church Road, Mitcham	II
Parish Church of St Peter and St Paul	Church Road, Mitcham	II*
Tomb of Anne Hall (Died 1740)	St Peter and St Paul Churchyard, Church Road, Mitcham	II
Tomb of Thomas Stanley (Died 1811)	St Peter and St Paul Churchyard, Church Road, Mitcham	II
Tomb of Richard Cranmer (Circa Early 19C)	St Peter and St Paul Churchyard, Church Road, Mitcham	II
Table Tomb one yard to west of Tomb of Richard Cranmer	St Peter and St Paul Churchyard, Church Road, Mitcham	II
The Former Vicarage of St Peter and St Paul	Church Road, Mitcham	II
The Old Rectory House	Church Road, Wimbledon	II*
No. 16-20 (Even)	Church Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 22-26 (Even)	Church Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 55	Church Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 9 Prospect Housing (including No. 11)	Church Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 1 (Newton House)	Commonside East, Mitcham	II
No. 54 (Park Place)	Commonside West, Mitcham	II
Cote Cottage	28 Conway Road SW20 Commonside West, Mitcham	II
Christ Church	28 Cottenham Park Road, London, SW20	II
Nos. 15 and 17	Copse Hill, SW20	II
No. 11 Colbyfield	Copse Hill, SW20	II
Nos. 19 and 21	Copse Hill, SW20	II
No. 23	Copse Hill, SW20	II
No. 27	Copse Hill, SW20	II
No. 27 (Formerly Stables)	Copse Hill, SW20	II
No. 1 (Elm Lodge)	Copse Hill, SW20	II
Methodist Church	Cricket Green, Mitcham	II

The White House	Cricket Green, Mitcham	II
No. 9 (Chestnut Cottage)	Cricket Green, Mitcham	II
Obelisk	Junction with Madeira Road, Cricket Green, Mitcham	II
Tate Almshouses	Cricket Green, Mitcham	II
Drinking Fountain and Horse Trough	Cricket Green, Mitcham	II
Nos. 17-20 (Consec.)	Crooked Billet, SW19	II
Bidder Memorial	Croydon Road, Mitcham	II
Church of the Sacred Heart	Darlaston Road, SW19	II*
Churchyard Wall and Gateways to west and south of Church of Sacred Heart	Darlaston Road, SW19	II
Nos. 47-51	Denmark Road, SW19	II
Nos. 52 and 53	Denmark Road, SW19	II
Nos. 54-59 (Consec.)	Denmark Road, SW19	II
Nos. 60 and 61	Denmark Road, SW19	II
Nos. 62 and 63	Denmark Road, SW19	II
Nos. 64-71 (Consec.)	Denmark Road, SW19	II
Nos. 72 and 73	Denmark Road, SW19	II
No. 2a	Drax Avenue, SW19	II
Horse Trough/ Drinking Fountain	South Park Gardens, Dudley Rd, SW19	II
Former World War 1, Type G, RNAS Seaplane Shed: Network Rail, Wimbledon Depot	Dundonald Road (accessed from)	II
Wimbledon College	Edge Hill	II
Cottage with Cartshed 10 yards to south west of Hall of Wimbledon College	Edge Hill	II
Church of St Barnabas	Gorringe Park Avenue, Mitcham	II
Church Hall of St Barnabas	Gorringe Park Avenue, Mitcham	II
No. 1	The Grange, SW19	II
No. 2	The Grange, SW19	II
No. 7 (Fra Lunor)	The Grange, SW19	II
No. 6	The Green, SW19	II
No. 7 (Holly Cottage)	The, Green SW19	II
No. 2 (Good Hope)	Highbury Rd., SW19	II
No. 2 Motor House	Highbury Rd., SW19	II
Wall, west side of River Pickle (Medieval)	High Street, Colliers Wood, SW19	II
Colliers Wood, LUL Station	High Street, Colliers Wood, SW19	II
Drinking Fountain in Wandle Park	High Street, Merton, SW19	II
South Wimbledon LUL Station	High Street, Merton, SW19	II
Nos. 32, 33, 33A and 34	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 35	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 37 and 37A	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 38	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II

Nos. 38A, 38B, 38C 39, 39A, 39B (Ashford House)	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No.44 (Claremount House), 45 and 45A War Memorial	Junction with Parkside, High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Eagle House	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II*
Iron Screen railings, Gatepiers and Gates to Eagle House	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 57 including Nos. 1, 3 and 5 Lancaster Road	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Nos. 70 and 70A/ 70B	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 98	High Street, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Nos. 267A, 269 (Long Lodge)	Kingston Road, SW19	II
No. 120 (The Manor House)	Kingston Road, SW19	II
Dorset Hall	Kingston Road, SW19	II
K6 Telephone Kiosk (outside No. 182)	Kingston Road, SW19	II
Nos. 1, 3 and 5	Lancaster Road, SW19	II
No. 27	Lancaster Road, SW19	II
War memorial, St Winefride's Church	Latimer Road, SW19	II
No. 1	Lauriston Road SW19	II
No. 9	Lauriston Road, SW19	II
No. 15 and 15A	Lauriston Road, SW19	II
No. 17	Lauriston Road, SW19	II
No. 26 (The Village Club)	Lingfield Road, SW19	II
Nos. 109-111 (Odd)	London Road, Mitcham	II
Clock Tower at Junction with Upper Green East	London Road, Mitcham	II
No. 315 Burn Bullock Public House	London Road, Mitcham	II
Nos. 409 and 411(Mitcham Station)	London Road, Mitcham	II
Nos. 475-479 (Odd) (Mill Cottages)	London Road, Mitcham	II
Milestone on Figge's Marsh (Opposite Entrance to St James' Road)	London Road, Mitcham	II
No. 244 (Eagle House)	London Road, Mitcham	I
Forecourt Walls, Piers, Railings and Gates of Eagle House	London Road, Mitcham	I
Milestone opposite Elm Lodge	London Road, Mitcham	II
Nos. 346 and 348	London Road, Mitcham	II
No. 350 (White Hart Inn)	London Road, Mitcham	II
Nos. 470 and 472	London Road, Mitcham	II
Nos. 482 and 484	London Road, Mitcham	II
Church of St Lawrence	London Road, Morden	I
Tomb in Churchyard, 5 yards south west of Tower	Churchyard of St Lawrence, London Road, Morden	II
Mauvillian Tomb in Churchyard, Church of St Lawrence	Churchyard of St Lawrence, London Road, Morden	II
Headstone to John Howard (D1764) in Churchyard 16 yards to south of south Porch	Churchyard of St Lawrence, London Road, Morden	II

Headstone circa mid to late 18C immediately adjacent to south of Headstone of John Howard in Churchyard of St Lawrence	London Road, Morden	II
Morden Park House including walls and pair of Circular Garden Buildings attached to north west	London Road, Morden	II*
Drinking Fountain and Horse Trough	London Road, Morden	II
Milestone	London Road, Morden	II
Milestone Opposite Elm Lodge	Lower Green West, Mitcham	II
Mitcham Parish Rooms	Lower Green West, Mitcham	II
Remains of Hall Place (Chapel)	Lower Green West, Mitcham	II
Mitcham War Memorial	Lower Green West, Mitcham	II
The Canons	Madeira Road, Mitcham	II*
Dovecote court Adjacent to Pond to south east of the Canons	Madeira Road, Mitcham	II
Trinity United Reform Church	Mansel Road, SW19	II
Tooting Police Station	Mitcham Road (251), SW17	II
Church of St Winefride	Merton Road, SW19	II
Morden Hall	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Gates and Gatepiers to Main Entrance to east of Morden Hall, including attached wall to north	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Walls of Walled garden to south of Morden Hall	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Morden Cottage	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Snuff Mills (Western Block)	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Snuff Mills (Eastern Block)	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Pedestal and Statue of Neptune 10 yards to south east of Walled Garden	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Pedestal and Statute of Venus and Cupid 50 yards n. of Morden Cottage	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Morden Lodge	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
Cast Iron Bridge to rear of Morden Hall	Morden Hall Road (East Site)	II
Milestone (opposite No. 92)	Morden Hall Park, Morden	II
White Cottage	Morden Road, Mitcham	II
Ravensbury Mill	Morden Road, Mitcham	II
South Wimbledon LRT Station including shops	Morden Road, SW19	II
"Flint Barn" No. 35	Mostyn Road, Merton Park, SW19	II
No. 22	Parkside, SW19	II*
No. 36 (Falconhurst)	Parkside, SW19	II
No. 54 (Apostolic Nunciature)	Parkside, SW19	II
Drinking Fountain & Cattle/ Horse Trough	Parkside, SW19	II
No. 25 Well-House in Garden	Parkside, SW19	II

Horse Trough	Parkside, SW19	II
Pelham High School (Downham House)	Pelham Road, SW19	II
No. 98 Wandle Villa	Phipps Bridge Road, SW19	II
Fire Station	Queens Road, SW19	II
No. 54	Ridgway, SW19	II
Pair of Gatepiers to No. 54	Ridgway, SW19	II
Nos. 56, 56A, 56C and No. 1 Lauriston Road	Ridgway, SW19	II
No. 70	Ridgway, SW19	II
2 K6 Telephone Kiosks near junction with Murray Road	Ridgway, SW19	II
No. 10 (Wandle House)	Riverside Drive, Mitcham	II
St Luke's Church	Ryfold Road, Wimbledon Park	II
Queen Alexandra's Court (North Block)	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Queen Alexandra's Court (North Eastern Block)	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Queen Alexandra's Court (South Eastern Block)	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Queen Alexandra's Court (Southern Block)	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Garden Wall to west of Quadrangle forming Queen Alexandra's Court	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Entrance Gates, Gatepiers and Adjoining Walls to Queen Alexandra's Court	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Parish Church of St Mary	St Mary's Road, SW19	II*
Churchyard Walls to south of Churchyard of Church of St Mary	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
31B St Mary's Road	St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Ker Vault, 15 yards to south of Chancel	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Grosvenor Tomb, 5 yards to south of Chancel	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb, 1 foot to north of Grosvenor Tomb	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Savage Tomb, 15 yards to south of South Porch	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Bingham Tomb, 12 yards from Savage Tomb	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of Georgina Charlotte Quin, 1 yard to south west of Savage Tomb	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of John Tompkins, 3 yards to west of Savage Tomb	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Headstone to Eades	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tombstone of Thomas Lowick, 1 yard	Churchyard of St Mary's Road,	II

to west of south porch	SW19	
Hopkin (Mansel Philipps) Tomb, 25 yards to south west of church tower	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
White Tomb, 5 yards to south west of Hopkins (Mansel Philipps) tomb	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of G S Newton, 20 yards north west of Tower	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Headstone, 2 yards to south of Tower	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of Gerard de Visme, 10 ft to north of west tower of chapel	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of Elizabeth Johnson, 50 yards to north west of Tower	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb, 5 yards to south of Tomb of Gerard de Visme	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Table Tomb, 4 yards to east of Tomb of Gerard de Visme	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb, 5 yards to east of Tomb of Gerard de Visme	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Hatchet Tomb, 8 yards to east of Tomb of Gerard de Visme	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of John Lawson, 6 yards to north of chancel	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Johnson Tomb, 1 yard to north of Tomb to John Lawson	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Mausoleum of Sir Joseph William Bazalgette, 20 yards to north east of Chancel of St Mary's Church	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Bankes Tomb, 4 yards to north west of Bazalgette Mausoleum	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of Joshua Ruddock, 3 yards to north east of chancel	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Jennings Tomb, 5 yards to south of Bazalgette Mausoleum	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Tomb of John Teymme, 6 yards to east of chancel	Churchyard of St Mary's Road, SW19	II
Singlegate School	South Gardens, Colliers Wood	II
Lauriston Cottage	Southside Common, SW19	II
Great Hall Range to King's College School	Southside Common, SW19	II
Pillar Box on Pavement to north of King's College School/ Hall	Southside Common, SW19	II
War memorial, King's College School	Southside Common, SW19	II
Church of St John the Baptist	Spencer Hill, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Wall running Along south side of Road	Station Road, Merton, SW19	II
Wheel House at Messrs Liberty's Print Works	Station Road, Merton, SW19	II
2 Lampposts outside Nos. 12 and 34	Station Road, Merton Abbey, SW19	II

Colour House at Messrs Liberty's Print Works	Station Road, Merton, SW19	II
Nos. 1-5 (Renshaw Corner)	Streatham Road, Mitcham	II
Electricity Sub Station at Junction with Sunnyside Passage	Sunnyside, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Church Hall of St Barnabas' Church	Thirsk Road, Mitcham	II
Clock Tower	Upper Green East, Mitcham	II
No. 55	Upper Green East, Mitcham	II
Nos. 9-13 (Consec.)	Wandle Bank, Colliers Wood, SW19	II
Nos. 16 & 17	Wandle Bank, Colliers Wood, SW19	II
The Manor House (now forming part of the Rutlish School)	Watery Lane, Merton Park, SW19	II
Chester House	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Garden Building and attached Garden Wall to West of Chester House	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 4	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 6 (West Side House)	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Nos. 7 and 7A (Converted Stable Block adjoining north end of West Side House)	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Nos. 14-19 Consecutive (Hanford Row)	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 23 (Stamford House)	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 24 (The Keir)	West Side Common, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Wimbledon Common (King's Royal Rifle Corps) War Memorial	Wimbledon Common, SW19	II
Drinking Fountain at junction with Belvedere Grove	Wimbledon Hill Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
No. 100 (The White House)	Wimbledon Hill Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Base of Windmill at Mill House	Windmill Road, Mitcham, CR4	II
No. 2 (Heathfield House)	Windmill Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
The Old Windmill	Windmill Road, SW19	II*
Drinking fountain and horse trough	Windmill Road, SW19	II
Wall to rear of Block of Flats, west of easternmost Block (Partly numbered 9, II, 15, 17) (Medieval)	Windsor Avenue, SW19	II
Wall to rear of Block of the westernmost Block of Flats (partly numbered 27, 29, 31, 33) (Medieval)	Windsor Avenue, SW19	II
Southside House	Woodhayes Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II*
Coach House to north of Southside	Woodhayes Road, Wimbledon,	II

House	SW19	
No. 6 (Gothic Lodge)	Woodhayes Road, Wimbledon, SW19	II
Methodist Church	Worple Road, SW19	II

F. Archaeological Priority Areas and ancient monuments

1. Archaeological Priority Areas and Scheduled Ancient Monuments have been defined by the Historic England, Greater London Archaeological Advisory Service. Merton has 20 areas designated as Archaeology Priority Areas (APAs) arranged under a number of Tiers. Details about the Tier system and the APAs listed below can be viewed via:
<https://historicengland.org.uk/content/docs/planning/apa-merton-pdf/>

Archaeological Priority Areas (APAs)

Tier I

- Caesar's Camp, Wimbledon Common
- Merton Priory
- Morden Park Mound
- Ravensbury Saxon cemetery

Tier II

- Cannizaro
- Cannon Hill
- Lavender Park
- Merton 19th Century Cemeteries
- Merton Place
- Merton Village
- Mitcham
- Morden
- Stane Street
- Wandle Valley / Colliers Wood
- Wandle Valley / Mitcham
- Wandle Valley / Morden Hall Park
- West Barnes Farm
- Wimbledon Common
- Wimbledon Park House
- Wimbledon Village

Tier III

- Wandle Valley Earlsfield
- Mitcham Common
- Beverley Brook

Scheduled Ancient Monuments

- Caesar's Camp, Wimbledon Common
- Merton Priory
- Morden Park Mound

G. Flooding: Sequential Test and Impact Assessment

1. The aim of the sequential test is to steer new development to areas with the lowest risk of flooding.
2. Applying the sequential test to individual planning applications in accordance with the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF). Where an application fails to satisfy the sequential test or is likely to have significant adverse impact on one or more of the factors detailed in the Impact Assessment set out below, it will be refused.
3. This appendix sets out a summary of what is required for sequential tests and impact assessments. Applicants should ensure that they meet the requirements of the NPPF, national Planning Policy Guidance, Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) and other supporting documents such as the Council's [Sustainable Drainage Systems SPD and Basement and Subterranean Planning Guidance](#).

Sequential Test

4. The following should be included in submitted sequential tests.
 - a. Ensure that sites are assessed for their availability¹, suitability² and viability³.
 - b. Ensure that all in-centre options have been thoroughly assessed before less central sites are considered.
 - c. Ensure that where it has been demonstrated that there are no town centre sites to accommodate a proposed development, preference is given to edge-of-centre locations which are well connected to the centre by means of easy pedestrian access.
 - d. Ensure that in considering sites in or on the edge of existing centres, developers and operators have demonstrated flexibility in terms of:
 - i. scale: reducing the floorspace of their development.
 - ii. format: more innovative site layouts and store configurations such as multi-storey

¹ Availability - whether sites are available now or are likely to become available for development within a reasonable period of time (determined on the merits of a particular case, having regard to inter alia, the urgency of the need). Where sites become available unexpectedly after receipt of an application, the council will take this into account in their assessment of the application.

² Suitability – with due regard to the requirements to demonstrate flexibility, whether sites are suitable to accommodate the need or demand which the proposal is intended to meet.

³ Viability – whether there is a reasonable prospect that development will occur on the site at a particular point in time. Again the importance of demonstrating the viability of alternatives depends in part on the nature of the need and the timescale over which it is to be met.

developments with smaller footprints.

- iii. car parking provisions: reduced or reconfigured car parking areas; and,
 - iv. the scope for disaggregating specific parts of a retail or leisure development, including those which are part of a group of retail or leisure units, onto separate, sequentially preferable sites. We will not seek arbitrary sub-division of proposals.
5. In considering whether flexibility has been demonstrated, the council will take into account any genuine difficulties which the applicant can demonstrate are likely to occur in operating the proposed business model from a sequentially preferable site, for example where a retailer would be limited to selling a significantly reduced range of products. However, evidence which claims that the class of goods proposed to be sold cannot be sold from the town centre will not be accepted.

Flood Risk Assessments

6. You need to do a flood risk assessment for most developments within one of the flood zones. This includes developments:
- a. In flood zone 2 or 3 including minor development and change of use;
 - b. More than 1 hectare (ha) in flood zone 1;
 - c. Less than 1 ha in flood zone 1, including a change of use in development type to a more vulnerable class (for example from commercial to residential), where they could be affected by sources of flooding other than rivers and the sea (for example surface water drains, reservoirs);
 - d. In an area within flood zone 1 which has critical drainage problems as notified by the Environment Agency.

Flood Risk Vulnerability and Flood Zone ‘Compatibility’

7. This table does not show:
- a. The application of the [Sequential Test](#) which should be applied first to guide development to Flood Zone 1, then Zone 2, and then Zone 3; nor does it reflect the need to avoid flood risk from sources other than rivers and the sea;
 - b. The Sequential and [Exception Tests](#) do not need to be applied to [minor developments](#) and changes of use, except for a change of use to a caravan, camping or chalet site, or to a mobile home or park home site.

8. Where a development contains different elements of vulnerability the highest vulnerability category should be used, unless the development is considered in its component parts.

Flood Risk Vulnerability classification		Essential Infrastructure	Water compatible	Highly Vulnerable	More Vulnerable	Less Vulnerable
Flood Zone	Zone 1	√	√	√	√	√
	Zone 2	√	√	Exception Test required	√	√
	Zone 3a [±]	Exception Test required	√	X	Exception Test required	√
	Zone 3b ^π <i>'Functional Flood Plain'</i>	Exception Test required	√	X	X	X
Key: √ Development is appropriate X Development should not be permitted						

[±] In Flood Zone 3a essential infrastructure should be designed and constructed to remain operational and safe in times of flood.

^π In Flood Zone 3b (functional floodplain) essential infrastructure that has to be there and has passed the Exception Test, and water-compatible uses, should be designed and constructed to:

- Remain operational and safe for users in times of flood.
- Result in no net loss of floodplain storage.
- Not impede water flows and not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Note: The Flood Zones shown on the Environment Agency's Flood Map for Planning (Rivers and Sea) do not take account of the possible impacts of climate change and consequent changes in the future probability of flooding. Reference should therefore also be made to Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment when considering location and potential future flood risks to developments and land uses.

Flood Risk Vulnerability Classification

Essential Infrastructure	- Essential transport infrastructure (including mass evacuation routes) which has to cross the area at risk. - Essentially utility infrastructure which must be located in a flood risk area for operational reasons, including electricity generating power stations and grid and primary substations; and water treatment works that need to remain operational in times of flood. - Wind turbines.
Highly Vulnerable	- Police stations, ambulance stations and fire stations and Command Centres, and telecommunications installations required to be operational during flooding. - Emergency dispersal points. - Basement dwellings. - Caravans, mobile homes and park homes intended for permanent residential use⁴. - Installations requiring hazardous substances consent. (Where there is a demonstrable need to locate such installations for bulk storage of materials with port or other similar facilities, or such installations with energy infrastructure or carbon capture and storage installations, that require coastal or water-side locations, or need to be located in other high flood risk areas, in these instances the facilities should be classified as 'Essential Infrastructure')
More Vulnerable	- Hospitals - Residential institutions such as residential care homes, children's homes, social services homes, prisons and hostels. - Buildings used for dwelling houses, student halls of residence, drinking establishments, nightclubs, and hotels. - Non-residential uses for health services, nurseries and educational establishments. - Landfill and sites used for waste management facilities for hazardous waste. - Sites used for holiday or short-let caravans and camping, subject to a specific warning and evacuations plan.
Less Vulnerable	- Police, ambulance and fire stations which are not required to be operational during flooding. - Buildings used for: shops; financial, professional and other services; restaurants and cafes; hot food takeaways; offices; general industry;

⁴ For any proposal involving a change of use of land to a caravan, camping or chalet site, or to a mobile home site or park home site, the Sequential Exception Test should be applied.

	storage and distributions; non-residential institutions not included in 'more vulnerable'; and assembly and leisure. • Land and buildings used for agriculture and forestry. • Waste treatment (except landfill⁵ and hazardous waste facilities). • Minerals working and processing (except for sand and gravel working). • Water treatment works which do not need to remain operational during times of flood. • Sewage treatment works (if adequate measures to control pollution and manage sewage during flooding events are in place).
Water-compatible development	• Flood control infrastructure. • Water transmission infrastructure and pumping stations. • Sewage transmission infrastructure and pumping stations. • Sand and gravel workings. • Docks, marinas and wharves. • Navigation facilities. • MOD defence installations. • Ship building, repairing and dismantling, dockside fish processing and refrigeration and compatible activities requiring a waterside location. • Water-based recreation (excluding sleeping accommodation). • Lifeguard and coastguard stations. • Amenity open space, nature conservation and biodiversity, outdoor sports and recreation and essential facilities such as changing rooms. • Essential ancillary sleeping or residential accommodation for staff required by uses in this category, subject to a specific warning and evacuation plan.

⁵ Landfill is as defined in [Schedule 10 of the Environmental Permitting \(England and Wales\) Regulations 2010](#).

H. Employment opportunities for Merton

1. Policy EC13.4 'Local employment opportunities' sets out the council's policy to boost job opportunities from Major Development, commensurate to its scale.
2. The table below sets out how different scales of development will contribute towards jobs opportunities and business growth in Merton, in line with the council's planning policy.

Guidance on Employment Opportunities in Merton

	Scale of Development	Requirements
1.	From 10 homes/ 1,000 sqm of commercial floorspace up to 20 homes/ 2,000 sqm of commercial floorspace	Applicants are encouraged to advertise employment and business procurement opportunities (including jobs, work experience and apprenticeships for residents); in local newspapers (which are regularly delivered to homes in Merton), in Merton's job centre plus centres and on local job recruitment sites.
2.	From over 20 homes/ 2,000 sqm of commercial floorspace up to 50 homes/ 5,000 sqm of commercial floorspace.	Applicants are encouraged to provide an overall employment contribution of circa 15% of potential jobs created by the proposal towards increasing employment opportunities in Merton through; the supply chain, by creating apprenticeships or by creating jobs in the resultant end use.
3.	From over 50 homes/ 5,000 sqm of commercial floorspace up to 100 homes/ 10,000 sqm of commercial floorspace.	Applicants are encouraged to provide an overall employment contribution of circa 20% of potential jobs created by the proposal towards increasing employment opportunities in Merton through; the supply chain, by creating apprenticeships or by creating jobs in the resultant end use.
4.	From over 100 homes/ 10,000 sqm of commercial floorspace	Applicants are encouraged to submit an Employment Strategy with any planning application to demonstrate that proposals support local employment, skills development and training opportunities.

I. Marketing and Vacancy Criteria

1. The following details will be used to assess information submitted with planning applications, where marketing and vacancy evidence is required to be submitted. Applicants should make reference to these criteria before submitting an application.
2. The minimum period of vacancy/marketing is identified within the relevant Local Plan policies. The council must be satisfied that an active marketing campaign has taken place for all relevant floorspace on a site, for a continuous period, while the premises were vacant.
3. A marketing report will be required to be submitted to the council for assessment as part of the planning application. The report should include the following information to demonstrate that a thorough marketing campaign was carried out:
 - a. Evidence that the property was registered with at least one reputable local or national commercial property agent. This could include information showing correspondence from the property agent confirming that the marketing has commenced.
 - b. Evidence, through photos that an advertising board was placed on site, in a clearly visible location for the duration of the marketing period.
 - c. Evidence of the property details published through both online and traditional methods, and made available on request, for the duration of the marketing period. The marketing information should include the location and description of the site, size of the property, lawful land use, property type, specification, costs, rent and service charges. This information should clearly show that the property was marketed for the appropriate use, in reference to the relevant Local Plan policy.
 - d. Evidence showing that the marketing was continuous, from the point when the advertisement board was erected or the online ad was posted (not from the point at which the property agent was appointed). The length of the vacancy period must be clearly evidenced e.g. through the submission of correspondence from the property agent.
 - e. Evidence that the property was marketed at a reasonable price that genuinely reflects the market value. This should consider the appropriate use or uses, condition, quality and location of floorspace, including independent professional valuation from at least three agents to confirm the price is reasonable. If a property is in a poor condition, the marketing should include options both with and without refurbishment, and clearly reflect comparable site values.
 - f. Information on enquiries and offers received in response to the marketing. This should include the number of enquiries received, who each enquiry was from (name and type of business), the type of space or use they were interested in, confirmation on whether they viewed the property, confirmation on whether they made an offer, and a reason/s why the enquiry was unsuccessful and why any offers made were declined.

g. Evidence that all opportunities to re-let the site have been fully explored.

Appendix 2 Table showing which Development Plan policies are superseded by this Local Plan

1. Once adopted the Local Plan will supersede all existing policies in Merton's Core Planning Strategy (2011), Sites and Policies Plan (2014) and the Policies Map (2014).
2. The following table lists the policies from Merton's Core Planning Strategy (2011), the Sites and Policies Plan (2014) and the Policies Map (2014) which are:
 - a. Superseded by the Local Plan or,
 - b. Not taken forward
3. The [Estates Local Plan \(2018\)](#) and the [South London Waste Plan \(2022\)](#) are not affected. The policies in these documents will not be superseded by the new Local Plan and remain part of Merton's Local Plan.

Core Planning Strategy (2011) policies replaced by the forthcoming Local Plan

Core Planning Strategy policies	Replaced by forthcoming Policies in the Local Plan (submitted 2 nd December 2021)
Issues and options.	Good growth chapter
Merton's Core Strategy Spatial Vision.	Chapter 01c: Urban development objectives and vision.
Key Diagram (Figure 8.1 Key Diagram).	Figure 1: Merton's spatial strategy.
Policy CS 1 Colliers Wood.	Policy N3.1: Colliers Wood.
Policy CS 2 Mitcham Town Centre.	Policy N4.1 Mitcham.
Policy CS 3 Morden Town Centre.	Policy N5.1; Morden.
Policy CS 4 Raynes Park Local Centre.	Policy N6.1: Raynes Park.
Policy CS 5 Wandle Valley.	Policy O15.6 Wandle Valley Regional Park.
Policy CS 6 Wimbledon Town Centre.	Policy N9.1: Wimbledon.
Policy CS 7 Centres.	Strategic Policy EC13.1 Promoting economic growth and successful high streets.
Policy CS 8 Housing Choice.	Strategic Policy H11.1 Housing choice
Policy CS 9 Housing Provision.	Strategic Policy H11.2 Housing provision
Policy CS 10 Accommodation for Gypsies and Travellers.	Policy No. H11.6 Accommodation for Gypsies and Travellers.

Policy CS 11 Infrastructure.	Strategic Policy IN14.1 Infrastructure.
Policy CS 12 Economic Development.	Strategic Policy EC13.1 Promoting economic growth and successful high streets.
Policy CS 13 Open space, nature conservation, leisure and culture.	Strategic Policy O15.1 Open Space, Green Infrastructure and Nature Conservation.
Policy CS 14 Design.	Strategic Policy D12.1 Delivering well-designed and resilient neighbourhoods.
Policy CS 15 Climate Change.	Strategic Policy CC2.1: Promoting Sustainable Design to Mitigate and Adapt to Climate Change.
Policy CS 16 Flood Risk Management.	Strategic Policy F15.7 Flood Risk Management and Sustainable Drainage.
Policy CS 17 Waste Management.	Strategic Policy W14.4 Waste Management.
Policy CS 18 Active Transport.	Strategic Policy T16.1 Sustainable Travel.
Policy CS 19 Public Transport.	Strategic Policy T16.1 Sustainable Travel.
Policy CS 20 Parking, Servicing and Delivery.	Strategic Policy T16.1 Sustainable Travel.
Chapter 27 Delivery and Implementation (<i>Delivery of the Spatial Strategy and Core Policies</i>).	Main Modification Chapter 17: Monitoring policy 17.1 and monitoring framework
Chapter 28 Monitoring Framework.	Main Modification Chapter 17: Monitoring policy 17.1 and monitoring framework

Sites and Policies Plan (2014) policies replaced by the forthcoming Local Plan

Sites and Policies Plan policies	Replaced by forthcoming Policies in the Local Plan (submitted 2nd December 2021)
DM R1 Location and scale of development in Merton's town centres and neighbourhood parades.	Policy TC13.5 Merton's town centres and neighbourhood parades.
DM R2 Development of town centre type uses outside town centres.	Policy TC13.6 Development of town centre type uses outside town centres.
DM R3 Protecting corner/ local shops.	Policy TC13.7 Protecting corner / local shops
DM R4 Protection of shopping facilities within designated shopping frontages.	Policy TC13.5 Merton's town centres and neighbourhood parades.
DM R5 Food and drink / leisure and entertainment uses.	Policy TC13.8 Food and drink / leisure and entertainment.
DM R6 Culture, arts and tourism development.	Policy TC13.9 Culture, arts and tourism development.
DM R7 Markets.	Policy not taken forward.
DM H1 Supported care housing for vulnerable people or secure residential institutions for people housed as part of the criminal justice system.	Policy H11.4 Supported care housing for vulnerable people or secure residential institutions for people housed as part of the criminal justice system.
DM H2 Housing mix.	Policy H11.3 Housing mix
DM H3 Support for affordable housing.	Policy H11.1 Housing choice
DM H4 Demolition and redevelopment of a single dwelling house.	Policy not taken forward.
DM H5 Student housing, other housing with shared facilities and bedsits.	Policy H11.5 Student Housing, other housing with shared facilities and bedsits
DM C1 Community facilities.	Policy IN14.2 Social and Community Infrastructure
DM C2 Education for children and young people.	Policy IN14.2 Social and Community Infrastructure
DM E1 Employment areas in Merton.	Policy EC13.2 Business locations in Merton
DM E2 Offices in town centres.	Policy EC13.2 Business locations in Merton

Sites and Policies Plan policies	Replaced by forthcoming Policies in the Local Plan (submitted 2nd December 2021)
DM E3 Protection of scattered employment sites.	Policy EC13.3 Protection of scattered employment sites
DM E4 Local employment opportunities.	Policy EC.13.4 Local Employment Opportunities
DM O1 Open space.	Policy O15.2 Open Space and Green Infrastructure
DM O2 Nature conservation, trees, hedges and landscape features.	Policy O15.3 Biodiversity and Access to Nature Policy O15.4 Protection of Trees
DM D1 Urban design and the public realm.	Policy D12.2 Urban design
DM D2 Design considerations in all developments.	Policy D12.3 Ensuring high quality design for all developments
DM D3 Alterations and extensions to existing buildings.	Policy D12.4 Alterations and extensions to existing buildings
DM D4 Managing heritage assets.	Policy D12.5 Managing heritage assets
DM D5 Advertisements.	Policy D12.7 Advertisements
DM D6 Telecommunications.	Policy D12.8 Digital infrastructure
DM D7 Shop front design and signage.	Policy D12.9 Shop front design and signage
DM EP1 Opportunities for decentralised energy networks.	Not taken forward.
DM EP2 Reducing and mitigating noise.	Policy P15.10 Improving Air Quality and Minimising Pollution
DM EP3 Allowable solutions.	Not taken forward
Policy DM EP4 Pollutants.	Policy P15.10 Improving Air Quality and Minimising Pollution
DM F1 Support for flood risk management.	Policy F15.8 Managing Local Flooding
DM F2 Sustainable urban drainage systems (SUDS) and; wastewater and water infrastructure.	Policy F15.9 Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS)

Sites and Policies Plan policies	Replaced by forthcoming Policies in the Local Plan (submitted 2nd December 2021)
DM T1 Support for sustainable transport and active travel.	Policy T16.2 Prioritising active travel choices
DM T2 Transport impacts of development.	Policy T16.3 Managing the transport impacts of development
DM T3 Car parking and servicing standards.	T16.4 Parking, deliveries and servicing
DM T4 Transport infrastructure.	T16.5 Supporting transport infrastructure
DM T5 Access to the Road Network.	Not taken forward
Appendices (A –L).	Chapter 18: Appendices
Policies Map (2014)	Polices Map (submitted 2022)

Glossary

1. The glossary below should be used as a guide only and should not be considered the source of statutory definitions.

Accessibility

2. The general term for how easy it is for people to get to places, jobs, homes and services.

Additionality

3. Additionality is the principle that off-site carbon offset projects should involve projects that: would not have occurred without the offset funding; would not have occurred under a business-as-usual scenario; could not reasonably be expected to be undertaken as part of a developer's planning application; and are not required to meet national legislation. To demonstrate this, the Applicant will be expected to provide evidence, such as:
 - a. A business case showing that the work could not have happened as part of their existing decarbonisation plans/ regular maintenance without utilising the offset payment instead of paying it to the council; and
 - b. Evidence showing that the asset is not eligible for any other form of funding from national government, Mayoral programmes, etc. If the asset is eligible then the offset payment could only be used in addition to existing funding streams if it was demonstrated that it will deliver additional improvements.

Affordable Housing

4. Social rented, affordable rented and intermediate housing provided to eligible households whose needs are not met by the market. Eligibility is determined with regard to local incomes and local house prices. Affordable Housing should include provisions to remain at an affordable price for future eligible households or for the subsidy to be recycled for alternative affordable housing provision.
 - a. *Social rented housing*: is owned by local authorities and private registered providers, for which guideline target rents are determined through the national rent regime. It may also be owned by other persons and provided under equivalent rental arrangements to the above, as agreed with the local authority or with the Homes and Community Agency.
 - b. *Affordable rented housing*: is let by local authorities or private registered providers of social housing to households who are eligible for social rented housing. Affordable rent is subject to rent controls that require a centre of no more than 80% of the local market rent (including service charges, where applicable).
 - c. *Intermediate housing*: is homes for sale and rent provided at a cost above social rent, but below market levels subject to the criteria in the Affordable Housing definition above. These can include shared equity (shared ownership and equity loans), other low-cost homes for sale and intermediate rent, but not affordable rented housing.

Albedo

5. The surface reflectivity of the sun's radiation.

Amenity

6. Element of a location or neighbourhood that helps to make it attractive or enjoyable for residents and visitors.

Archaeological Priority Area

7. An area which is known to be of archaeological importance due to historic findings, excavations or historical evidence.

Article 4 Direction

8. A direction which withdraws automatic planning permission granted under Article 4(1) of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) Order 2015 (as amended).

Biodiversity

9. This refers to the variety of plants and animals and other living things in a particular area or region. It encompasses habitat diversity, species diversity and genetic diversity. Biodiversity has value in its own right and has social and economic value for human society.

Blue Infrastructure

10. Blue Infrastructure refers to urban infrastructure relating to water - comprising of a network of rivers, water spaces, plus the green elements of the built environment, such as street trees, green roofs and Sustainable Drainage Systems, all of which provide a wide range of benefits and services.

Brownfield Land

11. Previously developed land is that which is or was occupied by a permanent structure (excluding agricultural or forestry buildings) and associated fixed-surface infrastructure. The definition covers the curtilage of the development.

Building Research Establishment Environmental Assessment Methodology (BREEAM)

12. An international scheme that provides independent third party certification of the assessment of the sustainability performance of individual buildings, communities and infrastructure projects.

Business Improvement Districts (BIDs)

13. A Business Improvement District (BID) is a defined area within which businesses are required to pay an additional tax (or levy) in order to fund projects within the BID's boundaries.

Capital Asset Value for Amenity Trees (CAVAT)

14. CAVAT provides a methodology for calculating the monetary value and/or compensation where a tree is felled or damaged. It works by calculating a unit value for each square centimetre of tree stem, by extrapolation from the average cost of a range of newly planted

trees. This basic value is adjusted to reflect the degree of benefit that the tree provides to the local population. The adjustment is designed to allow the final value to reflect realistically the contribution of the tree to public welfare through tangible and intangible benefits. For further information see the London Tree Officers Association website at www.ltoa.org.uk/resources/cavat

Carbon dioxide/ Carbon

- 15.** Carbon is often used to refer to all Greenhouse Gases which cause global warming, for which carbon dioxide is the most significant.

Car Clubs

- 16.** A Car Club provides its members with quick and easy access to cars for hire. Members can make use of Car Club vehicles as and when they need them.

Centre Hierarchy

- 17.** The hierarchy of centres in the borough categorises centres and parades into 4 types: Main Centres, Local Centres, Neighbourhood Centres and Parades of local importance. They range significantly in size and function. The NPPF requires local planning authorities to define such a hierarchy.

Circular Economy

- 18.** An economic model in which resources are kept in use at the highest level possible for as long as possible in order to maximise value and reduce waste, moving away from the traditional linear economic model of 'make, use, dispose'.

Climate Emergency Declaration (or declaring a climate emergency)

- 19.** By declaring a Climate Emergency the council acknowledges that there is a need to act on the causes and impacts of climate change. As part of Merton's Climate Emergency Declaration, the council committed towards achieving net-zero carbon emissions for the borough by 2050, and for the council by 2030.

Combined Heat and Power (also see Decentralised Energy)

- 20.** The combined production of electricity and usable heat is known as Combined Heat and Power (CHP). Steam or hot water, which would otherwise be rejected when electricity alone is produced, is used for space or process heating.

Communal Heating Systems

- 21.** A Communal Heating System supplies heat to multiple properties from a common heat source. It may range from a district system heating many buildings to a system serving an individual block of flats.

Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL)

- 22.** The Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL) is a planning charge, introduced by the Planning

Act 2008 as a tool for local authorities to help deliver infrastructure to support the development of their area. It came into force on 6 April 2010 through the Community Infrastructure Levy Regulations 2010. It allows local authorities to raise funds from owners or developers of land undertaking new building projects in their area.

Community Needs Statement

- 23.** A document that assesses the proposed loss, reduction or relocation of social and community infrastructure uses.

Community Plan

- 24.** The Community Plan is the [Merton Partnership](https://www.merton.gov.uk/communities-and-neighbourhoods/community-plan) overall vision for the borough and describes how the council and its partners will work together with the local community to inform everything they do and put people first. Further information can be found on the council's website at <https://www.merton.gov.uk/communities-and-neighbourhoods/community-plan>

Comparison Retailing

- 25.** Comparison retailing is the provision of items not obtained on a frequent basis. These include clothing, footwear, household and recreational goods.

Conservation Area

- 26.** An area declared by a local planning authority in accordance with the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 (as amended), as being of special architectural, historical or landscape interest, the character or appearance of which it is desirable to preserve or enhance.

Conservation (Heritage)

- 27.** The process of maintaining and managing change to a Heritage Asset in a way that sustains and, where appropriate, enhances its significance.

Construction and Demolition Waste

- 28.** This is waste arising from the construction, repair, maintenance and demolition of buildings and structures, including roads. It consists mostly of brick, concrete, hardcore, subsoil and topsoil, but it can contain quantities of timber, metal, plastics and occasionally special (hazardous) waste materials.

Convenience Retailing

- 29.** Convenience retailing is the provision of everyday essential items, including foods, drinks, newspapers/magazines and confectionary.

Conversion

- 30.** The conversion of existing single dwellings into two or more smaller dwellings.

Decentralised Energy Networks

- 31.** Decentralised energy generation can be described as the generation of energy in the form

of heat and electrical power at or near the point of use, delivered to users via distribution pipes. This contrasts with the traditional (and more inefficient) centralised concept, where energy is transported, in some cases, many hundreds of miles from a centralised power station to the point of energy use. Schemes can vary in size from a few dwellings to wider networks.

Density

- 32.** Is expressed both in terms of dwellings and, to take better account of the needs of different types of household, habitable rooms per hectare.

Design Code

- 33.** A set of illustrated design requirements that provide specific, detailed parameters for the physical development of a site or area. The graphic and written components of the code should build upon a design vision, such as a masterplan or other design and development framework for a site or area. For further information see the National Model Design Code at www.gov.uk/government/publications/national-model-design-code

Design Guide

- 34.** A document providing guidance on how development can be carried out in accordance with good design practice, often produced by a local authority. For further information see the National Design Guide at www.gov.uk/government/publications/national-design-guide

Designated Heritage Asset

- 35.** A World Heritage Site, Scheduled Monument, listed building, Protected Wreck Site, Registered Park and Garden, Registered Battlefield or Conservation Area designated under the relevant legislation.

Developer Contributions

- 36.** (*see Planning Obligations or Community Infrastructure Levy*)

Development

- 37.** This refers to development in its widest sense, including buildings, and in streets, spaces and places. It also refers to, redevelopment including refurbishment as well as new development and changes of use. The full definition is set out in Section 55 of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990.

Development Brief

- 38.** A brief that sets out the vision and parameters for a development site. Apart from its aspirational qualities, a brief includes site constraints and opportunities, infrastructure requirements such as energy and transport, access and planning policies. It also sets out the proposed uses and key design principles and requirements.

Digital Infrastructure

- 39.** Infrastructure, such as small cell antenna and ducts for cables, that supports fixed and

mobile connectivity and therefore underpins smart technologies.

District Centre

- 40.** District Centres comprise groups of shops often containing at least one supermarket or superstore, and a range of non-retail services, such as banks, building societies and restaurants, as well as local public facilities such as a library. In Merton, the District Centres are Colliers Wood, Mitcham and Morden.

District Heating Network

- 41.** A network of pipes carrying hot water or steam, usually underground, that connects heat production equipment with heat customers. They can range from several metres to several kilometres in length.

Dual Aspect Dwelling

- 42.** A Dual Aspect Dwelling is defined as one with openable windows on two external walls, which may be either on opposite sides of a dwelling or on adjacent sides of a dwelling where the external walls of a dwelling wrap around the corner of a building. The provision of a bay window does not constitute dual aspect.

Edge-of-Centre

- 43.** For retail purposes, a location that is well connected and up to 400 metres of the primary shopping area. For all other main town centre uses, a location within 400 metres of a town centre boundary. For office development, this includes locations outside of the town centre but within 500 metres of a public transport interchange. In determining whether a site falls within the definition of Edge-of-Centre, account should be taken of local circumstances.

Embodied Carbon

- 44.** The carbon emissions emitted producing a building's materials, their transport and installation on site as well as their disposal at end of life.

Employment Land

- 45.** *See Offices and Industrial Land*

Energy Assessment

- 46.** A study which assesses the energy performance of a development against the London Plan and Local Plan energy policies which demonstrates how the development has maximised carbon savings against the Mayor's Energy Hierarchy.

Energy Efficiency

- 47.** This is about making the best or most efficient use of energy in order to achieve a given output of goods or services, and of comfort and convenience. This does not necessitate the use of less energy, in which respect it differs from the concept of energy conservation.

Energy Hierarchy

- 48.** The Mayor of London's approach to reducing carbon dioxide emissions in the built

environment. The first step is to reduce energy demand (be lean), the second step is to supply energy efficiently (be clean), the third step is to use renewable energy (be green) and the fourth step is to monitor, verify and report on energy performance (Be seen).

Energy Use Intensity (EUI)

- 49.** An annual measure of total energy consumed in a building (kWh/m².yr) which can be estimated at design stage and monitored in-use as energy bills are based on kWh of energy used by the building. It includes regulated (heating, hot water, cooling, ventilation and lighting) and unregulated (plug loads and equipment) energy.

Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)

- 50.** A procedure to be followed for certain types of project to ensure that decisions are made in full knowledge of any likely significant effects on the environment. The process of an Environmental Impact Assessment is governed by the Town and Country Planning (Environmental Impact Assessment) Regulations 2011 (as amended).

Examination

- 51.** Undertaken on the 'soundness' of the Submission Local Plan, namely that it is positively prepared, justified, effective and consistent with national policy. The examination is held by an independent inspector appointed by the Secretary of State.

Extra Care

- 52.** Extra Care is housing with care primarily for older people where occupants have specific tenure rights to occupy self-contained dwellings and where they have agreements that cover the provision of care, support, domestic, social, community or other services. This helps people to live independently, avoiding the need to move into a residential care setting. Schemes vary in scale and nature so an assessment will be made on a scheme-by-scheme basis if a proposal is considered as 'extra care', depending on the nature of the housing and its design features, the support services available including how care is bought and provided, and any eligibility criteria for tenants or owners.

Fabric Energy Efficiency (FEE)

- 53.** Measured in kWh/m².yr and available through the Government's Standard Assessment Procedure, Fabric Energy Efficiency covers space heating and space cooling energy demand.

Family Sized Home

- 54.** As set out in the London Plan 2021 paragraph 4.2.8, a family sized home is defined as having three or more bedrooms.

Floodplain

- 55.** Generally low-lying areas adjacent to a watercourse, tidal lengths of the river or sea, where

water flows in times of flood or would flow but for the presence of flood defences.

Flood Defence

- 56.** Infrastructure used to protect an area against flooding such as floodwalls and embankments. Flood Defences are designed to a specific standard of protection (design standard).

Floorspace Gross

- 57.** All floorspace enclosed within the building envelope.

Floorspace Net (for retail purposes)

- 58.** Area of a shop that is accessible to the public: sales floor, sales counters, checkouts, lobby areas, public serving and in-store cafes. Excludes goods storage, delivery, preparation area, staff offices, staff amenity facilities, plant rooms, toilets and enclosed public stairwells and lifts between floors.

Flood Zones

- 59.** Zone 1 (Low Probability) - Land having a less than 1 in 1,000 annual probability of river or sea flooding. (Shown as 'clear' on the Flood Map – all land outside Zones 2 and 3)
- 60.** Zone 2 (Medium Probability) - Land having between a 1 in 100 and 1 in 1,000 annual probability of river flooding; or land having between a 1 in 200 and 1 in 1,000 annual probability of sea flooding. (Land shown in light blue on the Flood Map).
- 61.** Zone 3a (High Probability) - Land having a 1 in 100 or greater annual probability of river flooding; or Land having a 1 in 200 or greater annual probability of sea flooding. (Land shown in dark blue on the Flood Map).
- 62.** Zone 3b (The Functional Floodplain) - This zone comprises land where water has to flow or be stored in times of flood. Local planning authorities should identify in their Strategic Flood Risk Assessments areas of functional floodplain and its boundaries accordingly, in agreement with the Environment Agency. *(Not separately distinguished from Zone 3a on the Flood Map)*

Note: The Flood Zones shown on the Environment Agency's Flood Map for Planning (Rivers and Sea) do not take account of the possible impacts of climate change and consequent changes in the future probability of flooding. Reference should therefore also be made to the Merton's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment when considering location and potential future flood risks to developments and land uses.

Fluvial Flooding

- 63.** Flooding resulting from water levels exceeding the bank level of a main river.

Fluvial Water

- 64.** Water in the River Thames and other rivers.

Free Floating Car Sharing Scheme

- 65.** Schemes where members can pick-up or drop-off designated vehicles in any parking space where they are entitled to park within the scheme operating boundary.

Futureproofing

- 66.** Ensuring that designs are adaptable and take account of expected future changes. For example, ensuring a heating system is designed to be compatible with future Net-Zero Carbon solutions.

Green Corridors

- 67.** Relatively continuous areas of open space leading through the built environment, which may link to each other and to Metropolitan Open Land. They often consist of rivers, railway embankments and cuttings, roadside verges, canals, parks, playing fields and extensive areas of private gardens. They may allow animals and plants to be found further into the built-up area than would otherwise be the case and provide an extension to the habitats of the sites they join.

Greenhouse Gas

- 68.** Any gas that induces the greenhouse effect, trapping heat within the atmosphere that would normally be lost to space, resulting in an increase in average atmospheric temperatures, contributing to climate change. Examples include carbon dioxide, methane and nitrous oxides.

Green Infrastructure

- 69.** Comprises the network of parks, rivers, water spaces and green spaces, plus the green elements of the built environment, such as street trees, green roofs and Sustainable Drainage Systems, all of which provide a wide range of benefits and services.

Green Space

- 70.** All vegetated open space of public value (whether publicly or privately owned), including parks, woodlands, nature reserves, gardens and sports fields, which offer opportunities for sport and recreation, wildlife conservation and other benefits such as storing flood water, and can provide an important visual amenity in the urban landscape.

Habitable Rooms

- 71.** Includes all separate living rooms and bedrooms, plus kitchens with a floor area of 13 sqm or more.

Health Impact Assessment (HIA)

- 72.** HIAs are a method of estimating the potential health effects of the implementation of a plan or programme where there are likely to be significant impacts.

Health Inequalities

- 73.** Health inequalities are defined by the UK Government as 'inequalities in respect of life

expectancy or general state of health which are wholly or partly a result of differences in respect of general health determinants.'

Heritage Asset

74. A building, monument, site, place, area or landscape identified as having a degree of significance meriting consideration in planning decisions, because of its heritage interest. Heritage Asset includes designated heritage assets and assets identified by the local planning authority (including local listing).

Historic Environment

75. All aspects of the environment resulting from the interaction between people and places through time, including all surviving physical remains of past human activity, whether visible, buried or submerged, and landscaped and planted or managed flora. Those elements of the historic environment that hold significance are called Heritage Assets.

Inclusive Design

76. Design that creates an environment where everyone can access and benefit from the full range of opportunities available to members of society. It aims to remove barriers that create undue effort, separation or special treatment, and enables everyone regardless of disability, age, or gender to participate equally, confidently and independently in mainstream activities with choice and dignity.

Industrial Land and Business Parks

77. Industrial Land and Business Parks are identified in the Local Plan and refer to land used for general industry, warehouses, storage, distribution and logistics and other similar types of industrial employment that may require 24-hour operations and can't be carried out in residential areas without detriment to amenity. Some sui generis uses may be appropriate such as vehicle repair garages, scrap yards, petrol filling stations, builders' merchants.

Infrastructure

78. Includes transport, energy, water, waste, digital/smart, social and community, and green Infrastructure.

Infrastructure Delivery Plan (IDP)

79. The IDP sets out the borough's infrastructure requirements over the lifetime of the Local Plan. It covers a range of social and community infrastructure, emergency services, green infrastructure, utilities and physical infrastructure, and transport infrastructure.

Infrastructure Delivery Schedule (IDS)

80. The IDS, sets out the where, what, why, who and when key infrastructure that is required in the borough will be delivered.

International, national and locally designated sites of importance for biodiversity

81. All international sites (Special Areas of Conservation, Special Protection Areas, and

Ramsar sites), national sites (Sites of Special Scientific Interest) and locally designated sites including Local Wildlife Sites.

Listed (Locally) Buildings

82. These are buildings, structures or features which, whilst not listed by the Secretary of State, are an important part of Merton's heritage due to their architectural, historic or archaeological significance. Locally Listed Buildings and structures are approved for inclusion on the list by the council. In Merton, the criteria used to identify locally listed buildings are: Architectural style, age and history, detailing, group value, building materials, subsequent alterations.

Listed (Statutorily) Buildings

83. These are buildings included in the list of Buildings of Special Architectural or Historic Interest which is compiled by the Secretary of State for the Environment and is a national list. Listed building consent is required for demolition and for internal as well as external alterations. There are three grades of building on the Statutory List: grade I, Grade II* and Grade II.

Local Centre

84. Local Centres including a range of small shops and services of a local nature, serving a small catchment within easy walking distance of residential areas. In Merton, the Local Centres as defined on the Policies Map are Arthur Road, Motspur Park, North Mitcham, Raynes Park, South Wimbledon and Wimbledon Village.

Local Implementation Plan (LIP) for Transport

85. Statutory transport plans produced by London boroughs bringing together transport proposals to implement the Mayor's Transport Strategy at the local level.

Local Nature Reserves (LNR)

86. This is strictly an area designated under section 21 of the National Parks and Access to the Countryside Act 1949. An LNR is one of several places in a city or town where animals can comfortably reside, and plants can grow wild. Sites are declared LNRs because they have features of special interest and are designated based on Natural England guidelines.

The London Plan

87. The London Plan is the spatial development strategy for the Greater London area and the Mayor of London is responsible for producing this planning strategy. The London Plan deals with matters of strategic importance to the area and forms part of the Development Plan for the borough.

Major Centre

88. Major Centres normally have over 50,000 square metres of retail floorspace and their retail offer is derived from a mix of both comparison and convenience shopping. Some Major Centres, which have developed sizeable catchment areas, also have some leisure and

entertainment functions. Merton's only Major Centre is Wimbledon town centre.

Merton's Climate Strategy & Action Plan

- 89.** Developed in response to the council's declaration of a Climate Emergency, this 30-year plan sets out the key actions required across four thematic areas (the Green Economy, Buildings and Energy, Transport and Greening Merton) to become a net-zero carbon borough by 2050, as well as the actions required to decarbonise the council's own operations by 2030.

Metropolitan Open Land (MOL)

- 90.** Extensive areas of land bounded by urban development around London that fulfils a similar function to Green Belt and is protected from inappropriate development by land-use planning policies.

Mixed Use Development

- 91.** Development for a variety of activities on single sites or across wider areas such as within centres.

National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF)

- 92.** The NPPF sets out the Government's planning policies for England and how these are expected to be applied, alongside other national planning policies. It sets out the Government's requirements for the planning system only to the extent that it is relevant, proportionate and necessary to do so. It provides a framework within which local people and their accountable councils can produce their own distinctive local and neighbourhood plans, which reflect the needs and priorities of their communities.

Nature Conservation

- 93.** Protection, management and promotion for the benefit of wild species and habitats, as well as the human communities that use and enjoy them. This also covers the creation and re-creation of wildlife habitats and the techniques that protect genetic diversity and can be used to include geological conservation.

Neighbourhood

- 94.** There are six Neighbourhoods in the borough, which are Colliers Wood, Mitcham, Morden, Raynes Park, South Wimbledon and Wimbledon. These are illustrated on the Policies Map.
- 95.** It should be noted these six Neighbourhoods are described as 'borough area' or 'sub-areas' in the Merton Borough Character Study SPD, but for the purposes of the Local Plan, they are referred to as Neighbourhoods.

Neighbourhood Parades

- 96.** Convenience shopping and other services easily accessible to those walking or cycling or those with restricted mobility.

Neighbourhood (Development) Plan

97. Neighbourhood Plans can establish a vision for an area, include general planning policies for the development and use of land in a designated neighbourhood area and they can allocate sites for development. These are plans on a much smaller scale than the Local Plan and should therefore be about local rather than strategic issues. Neighbourhood planning is optional, and a Neighbourhood Plan can only be written by a designated Neighbourhood Forum for a designated Neighbourhood Area. Neighbourhood Plans, once made, form part of the borough's Development Plan.

Net-Zero Carbon

98. An activity that causes no net release of carbon dioxide and other Greenhouse Gas emissions into the atmosphere, is considered Net-Zero Carbon. In order to achieve a Net-Zero Carbon balance, carbon emissions must be reduced as close as possible to zero, with any remaining carbon emissions being offset by equivalent carbon sinks.

Net-Zero Carbon Buildings

99. Net-Zero Carbon policies currently consider a building's regulated emissions and are measured as an improvement against Part L Building Regulations 2013. Under the Mayor's zero carbon policy, development must maximise carbon savings on-site against the Mayor's energy hierarchy, and once this has been achieved, offset any remaining regulated emissions via cash-in-lieu contributions to the council's Carbon Offset Fund, which is ring fenced to secure delivery of carbon dioxide savings elsewhere in the borough, or via off-site carbon offsetting projects which have been agreed with the council.

Office

100. A building or premises falling within the E(g)l or E(c)i Use Class Order.

Open Space

101. All the land that is predominantly undeveloped, other than by buildings or structures that are ancillary to the Open Space use, and bodies of water that are indicated as Open Space on Merton's Policies Map. The definition covers a broad range of types of Open Space within Merton, whether in public or private ownership and whether public access is unrestricted, limited or restricted.

Opportunity Areas

102. London's principal opportunities for accommodating large scale development to provide substantial numbers of new employment and housing, each typically more than 5,000 jobs and/or 2,500 homes, with a mixed and intensive use of land and assisted by good public transport accessibility.

Out-of-Centre

103. A location which is not in or on the Edge-of-Centre but not necessarily outside the urban areas.

Part L

104. Building regulation in England setting standards for the energy performance of new and existing buildings. Currently Part L Building Regulations 2013. The Government is in the process of consulting on changes to Part L for the Future Homes Standard.

Permitted Development Rights

105. Permitted Development Rights are a national grant of planning permission, which allow certain building works and changes of use to be carried out without having to make a planning application. Permitted Development Rights are subject to conditions and limitations to control impact and to protect amenity.

Photovoltaics (PV)

106. The direct conversion of solar radiation into electricity by the interaction of light with electrons in a semiconductor device or cell.

Planning Application

107. Administrative process where permission is sought from the local authority to carry out development. The form and content of the application is laid down in guidance. An application can be made in outline or detailed form for some categories of development.

Planning Condition

108. A condition imposed on a grant of planning permission (in accordance with the Town and Country Planning Act 1990).

Planning Obligation

109. A legally enforceable obligation entered under section 106 of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 to mitigate the impacts of a development proposal. A Planning Obligation places a charge on the land to which it relates.

Planning Permission

110. The consent given by the local planning authority for building operations as defined in the Town and Country Planning Act that do not constitute permitted development as defined in the general permitted development order (GDPO) or uses permitted by the Use Classes Order; usually subject to conditions and sometimes a legal agreement.

Planning Practice Guidance (PPG)

111. The national Planning Practice Guidance was published by Government as a web-based resource in March 2014 (and as amended), adds further context to the NPPF. Local planning authorities should have regard to advice contained in the PPG when developing their plans. The PPG is also a 'material consideration' when taking decisions on planning applications.

Playing Field

112. The whole of a site which encompasses at least one playing pitch as defined in the Town

and Country Planning (Development Management Procedure) (England) Order 2010.

Policies Map

113. A supporting document illustrating the spatial policies of the adopted plans.

Previously Developed Land

114. Previously Developed Land is that which is or was occupied by a permanent structure, including the curtilage of the developed land and any associated fixed surface infrastructure. This excludes land in built-up areas such as private residential gardens, parks, recreation grounds and allotments and land that was previously developed but where the remains of the permanent structure or fixed surface structure have blended into the landscape in the process of time.

Pluvial Flooding

115. Flooding from water flow over the surface of the ground often occurs when the soil is saturated and natural drainage channels or artificial drainage systems have insufficient capacity to cope with additional flow.

Primary Shopping Area

116. Defined area where retail development is concentrated (generally comprising the core and those secondary frontages which are adjoining and closely related to the core shopping frontage).

Priority Habitat

117. London's priority habitats are those areas of wildlife habitat which are of most importance in London. Most areas of priority habitat are protected within Sites of Importance for Nature Conservation.

Priority Species

118. These are species that are a conservation priority because they are under particular threat, or they are characteristic of a particular region.

Protected Species

119. Certain plant and animal species protected to various degrees in law, particularly the Wildlife and Countryside Act, 1981 (as amended).

Public Realm

120. This is the space between and surrounding buildings and open spaces that are accessible to the public, for example streets, pedestrianised areas, squares, and river frontages.

Public Transport Accessibility Level (PTAL)

121. This is a measure of accessibility to the public transport network. For any given point in London, PTALs combine walk time to the network (stations, bus stops) with service wait time at these stops to give an overall accessibility index. This can be allocated to six accessibility levels with one being poor and six being excellent. For Merton, good public

transport accessibility ranges between PTAL 3 to 4. For sites within PTAL 3, site circumstances such as the opportunities and services reachable through the nearest public transport network should be taken into account when determining whether access to public transport is good for that particular site. Transport for London provide the most up-to-date PTAL assessment via www.tfl.gov.uk/WebCAT

Registered Providers

122. These are normally approved housing associations, who provide social housing for the council, previously known as Registered Social Landlords. The Registered Providers share the Merton Housing Register and must be approved by the Homes and Communities Agency.

Renewable Energy

123. Energy derived from a source that is continually replenished, such as wind, wave, solar, hydroelectric and energy from plant material, but not fossil fuels or nuclear energy. Although not strictly renewable, geothermal energy is generally included.

Residential Care

124. Residential care homes are residential developments where several older people live, usually in single rooms, and have access to on-site care services. A home registered simply as a care home will provide personal care only – help with washing, dressing and giving medication. Care homes with nursing provide the same personal care, but also have a qualified nurse on duty twenty-four hours a day to carry out nursing tasks. These homes are for people who are physically or mentally frail or people who need regular attention from a nurse. Homes registered for nursing care may accept people who just have personal care needs but who may need nursing care in the future. Residential care homes are regulated by the Care Quality Commission.

Retrofitting

125. The addition of new technology or features to existing buildings in order to make them more efficient and to reduce their environmental impacts.

Re-use

126. The operation or process of checking, cleaning or repairing materials that have been discarded and are waste so that they can be used again for their original purpose as non-waste without any other pre-processing.

Scattered Employment Sites

127. An employment site that is not a designated employment site (a site that is not a Strategic Industrial Location or Locally Significant Industrial Site) as illustrated in Merton's Policies Map (as amended).

Scheduled Monument

128. Scheduled Monuments are identified by the Secretary of State for Culture, Media and

Sport under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Areas Act 1979. They are monuments of national importance to which statutory protection is afforded.

Secondary Heat

129. To recover useful energy, in the form of heat, from sources where processes or activities produce heat which is normally wasted (for example, recovering heat from the Underground network) or from heat that exists naturally within the environment (air, ground and water).

Sequential Test

130. A planning principle that seeks to identify, allocate or develop certain types or locations of land before others.

Service Retailing

131. Comprises of uses providing services such as hairdressing, beauty salons, dry cleaning, post office, and clothing hire, opticians and travel agents.

SGN

132. The British gas distribution company which owns and operates significant gas infrastructure within the borough.

Significance (heritage)

133. The value of a heritage asset to this and future generations because of its heritage interest. The interest may be archaeological, architectural, artistic or historic. Significance derives not only from a heritage asset's physical presence, but also from its setting.

Site of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINC)

134. Areas of land chosen to represent the best wildlife habitats in London and areas of land where people can experience nature close to where they live and work. Sites are classified into Sites of Metropolitan, Borough and Local Importance depending on their relative value. Unlike SSSIs (see below), SINC's are not legally protected, but their value must be considered in any land use planning decision. Procedures for the identification of SINC's are set out in Appendix 5 of the Mayor's London Environment Strategy.

Sites of Recognised Nature Conservation Interest

135. All sites that are designated on the Merton Policies Map as: Sites of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI), Metropolitan, Borough or Local Sites of Importance for Nature Conservation (SINC) and Local Nature Reserves (LNR).

Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI)

136. Areas of land with ecological or geological interest of national importance. They are designated by Natural England under the Wildlife and Countryside Act (1981 as amended) and have legal protection.

Social and Community Infrastructure

137. Infrastructure that is available to, and serves, the needs of the local community. This covers facilities such as health provision, early years provision, schools, colleges and universities, community, recreation and sports facilities, places of worship, policing and other criminal justice or community safety facilities, children and young people's play and informal recreation facilities. This list is not intended to be exhaustive and other facilities can be included as Social and Community Infrastructure.

Standard Assessment Procedure (SAP)

138. The methodology used by the Government to assess and compare the energy and environmental performance of dwellings against Part L Building Regulations.

SAP Carbon Emission Factors

139. Factors used to calculate the emissions generated by one unit of heat (kWh) for different fuel types (gas and electricity) in the Government's Standard Assessment Procedure.

Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA)

140. Required by European and UK law, SEA is a way of systematically identifying and evaluating the impacts that a plan is likely to have on the environment. The aim is to provide information in the form of an Environmental Report that can be used to enable decision makers to take account of the environment and minimise the risk of the plan causing significant environmental damage. Government guidance advises that, where a plan requires both strategic environmental assessment and sustainability appraisal, the former process should be integrated into the latter.

Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA)

141. A Strategic Flood Risk Assessment is a study carried out by one or more local planning authorities to assess the risk to an area from flooding from all sources, now and in the future, taking account of the impacts of climate change, and to assess the impact that land use changes and development in the area will have on flood risk.

Sui Generis

142. Uses which do not fall within any Use Class. Such uses include betting offices / shops, theatres, larger houses in multiple occupation, scrap yards, launderettes, night clubs and pay day loan shops.

Supplementary Planning Documents (SPD)

143. Documents which add further detail to the policies in the Local Plan. SPDs can be used to provide further guidance for development on specific sites, or on issues, such as design. SPDs are material considerations in planning decisions but are not part of the statutory development plan. The Mayor of London produces Supplementary Planning Guidance (SPGs) to provide further guidance on policies in the London Plan that cannot be addressed in sufficient detail in the plan itself.

Surface Water

144. Rainwater (including snow and other precipitation) which is on the surface of the ground and has not entered a watercourse, drainage system or public sewer.

Surface Water Attenuation

145. Mitigation measures for flood prevention and protection from surface water.

Sustainability Appraisal (SA)

146. The Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 requires Local Development Documents to be prepared with a view to contributing to the achievement of sustainable development. Sustainability Appraisal is a systematic appraisal process. The purpose of a Sustainability Appraisal is to appraise the social, environmental and economic effects of the strategies and policies in a Local Development Document from the outset of the preparation process. This will ensure that decisions are made that accord with sustainable development.

Sustainable Community Strategy (SCS)

147. See *Community Plan*

Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS)

148. SUDS mimic nature and typically manage rainfall close to where it falls. SUDS can be designed to transport (convey) surface water, slow runoff down (attenuate) before it enters watercourses, they provide areas to store water in natural contours and can be used to allow water to soak (infiltrate) into the ground, or evaporate from surface water, and lost or transpired from vegetation (known as evapotranspiration).

Third Generation (3G) playing pitch

149. A type of artificial grass pitch (AGP) known as 'third generation turf'. With 3G turf, the pile (the artificial grass 'blades') is supported by an infill of rubber crumb. Sports that can use 3G pitches include football, rugby and lacrosse, providing that certain specifications are met for each sport.

Town Centre

150. Shopping and service area with defined boundaries on Merton's Policies Map and as defined in Table 13.5a "Merton's town centre designations". It includes the Primary Shopping Area and areas predominantly occupied by main town centre uses within or adjacent to the Primary Shopping Area. References to Town Centres applies to major centre, district centres and local centres unless otherwise stated but excludes small parades of shops of purely neighbourhood significance. Existing Out-of-Centre developments, comprising or including retail and other town centre uses, do not constitute Town Centres.

Town Centre Type Uses

151. The uses to which town centre policies apply are:

a. Shops and offices

b. Leisure and entertainment facilities and the more intensive sport and recreation uses (including restaurants, cafes, cinemas, bars and pubs, night clubs, health and fitness centres, indoor bowling centres and bingo halls)

c. Arts, culture and tourism development (including theatres, museums, galleries, concert halls, hotels and conference facilities)

Transport Assessment (TA)

152. A comprehensive and systematic process that sets out transport issues relating to a proposed development. It identifies what measures will be required to improve accessibility and safety for all modes of travel, particularly for alternatives to the car such as walking, cycling and public transport and what measures will need to be taken to deal with the anticipated transport impacts of the development.

Transport Statement (TS)

153. A simplified version of a Transport Assessment where it is agreed the transport issues arising out of development proposals are limited and a full Transport Assessment is not required.

Travel Plan

154. A long-term management strategy for an organisation or site that seeks to deliver sustainable transport objectives through action and is articulated in a document that is regularly reviewed.

Tree Preservation Order

155. A Tree Preservation Order may be made to protect individual trees or groups of trees. The Order gives protection against unauthorised felling, lopping, or other tree works.

Urban Greening

156. Urban Greening describes the act of adding Green Infrastructure elements. Due to the morphology and density of the built environment in London, green roofs, street trees, and additional vegetation are the most appropriate elements of green infrastructure in the city.

Urban Greening Factor (UGF)

157. A land-use planning tool to help determine the amount of greening required in new developments.

Urban Heat Island

158. The height of buildings and their arrangement means that while more heat is absorbed during the day, it takes longer to escape at night. As a result, the centre of London can be up to 10°C warmer than the rural areas around the city. The temperature difference is usually larger at night than during the day. The Urban Heat Island effect is noticeable during both the summer and winter months.

Use Class Order

159. The [Town and Country Planning \(Use Classes\) Order 1987](https://www.planningportal.co.uk/info/200130/common_projects/9/change_of_use) (as amended) puts uses of land and buildings into various categories known as 'Use Classes'. "Change of use" can occur within the same Use Class or between one Use Class and another. Government can change the Use Class Order. The Planning Portal keeps an up-to-date record of Use Classes. https://www.planningportal.co.uk/info/200130/common_projects/9/change_of_use

Whole Life-cycle Carbon (WLC)

160. Whole Life-cycle carbon emissions are the total Greenhouse Gas emissions arising from a development over its lifetime, from the emissions associated with raw material extraction, the manufacture and transport of building materials, to installation/construction, operation, maintenance and eventual material disposal.